

In the name of God most Gracious, ever Merciful!

The Beloved and I

Volume 6: Isaiah to Malachi

Thomas McElwain

New Jubilees Version of Sacred Scripture in
Verse

With Verse Commentaries

Revised Edition

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Isaiah

The grand prophetic voice that faithfully
Reflects the state of the eighth century
Is now by many scholars thought to be
Synchronic whole to study in a spree.
The earlier text critical approach
Is now left in the dust by horse and coach.
Beloved, methinks the whole of industry
In Scripture could be viewed so merrily.
Who knows what is fact in reality
About the authors and the texts that come
Down through both hands and minds to
conundrum?
It's relevant today only that such
Writings hold common themes for men to
touch,
And common threads women have woven
much.

According to the order of LX
X Isaiah's the first book in complex
Of prophecy. But in the scheme of things
I see, it is but the continuings
Of those books that rely upon the stings
Of David who remains the king of kings.
The books of Moses and et cetera
Propound the beginnings as well as law.
The books of David show how on the earth
The reign of YHWH may appear in both
dearth
And in the rare and glorious days where
rule
The princes that have passed the divine
school.
The prophecy itself is not the fat
That people think in the darkness they've
sat,
A picture and prediction of the stark
That's waiting for those put out of the park.
Prophecy is to take a harp in hand
And like King David on the Dead Sea's
strand
Below En Gedi lift a skilful hand
And in the exaltation of the sound
Of royally divine across the bound
Of set and tuned strings speak upon the
ground
In syllables inspired, inspiring found.
Isaiah was a man who lived to see

The glow of Judah's final century
Before the great wound of captivity.
His singing started in the year that King
Uzziah died, or seven forty-thing,
And the concern upon his heart to ring
To the sound of the harp was the falling
Of Israel and Judah for their sin.
Judah lived under threat and under din
Of the Assyrian forces come to win,
And king and people turned their face to
find
Salvation of the military kind.
Isaiah came resisting putting faith
In horse and chariot as well as wraith;
He achieved fame prophetic when the hosts
Of the Assyrians fell from their boasts
Without a battle at Jerusalem,
Caught dead upon the sand in purple hem.
Exulting to be right inspired the songs
Recorded in this book of foreign prongs.
He trusts the nation yet may fall, but sees,
Beyond all failure of the folk on knees
Before the conqueror, the restoration
Of David's throne and kingdom and his
station.
So good Isaiah just continues here
Showing the models defined cloud and
clear
Of how and why to be faithful to God
While living in a body on the sod.
It seems the book contains some writings
too
That were provided later by the crew
Of good Isaiah's disciples in view.
Even in the first part of the book there
Are words reflecting captivity's share,
A century after good Isaiah:
The oracles against Babylon's claw
In chapters thirteen and fourteen in awe,
And the apocalypse in twenty-four
To twenty-seven, and poems in store
Of chapters thirty-three to thirty-five.
Toward the end of the Exile's contrive
An unnamed harpist with deep thoughts
alive
Looks forward to the coming time when
God
Would comfort His folk and restore the
prod

Of life in fair Jerusalem, and thus
Proclaim the way to live amid the fuss
Of empires is to hope in age to come,
The Messianic time when every bum
Of wicked government shall fail and fall
And righteousness stand high upon the wall.

This book of consolation comes to be
In chapters forty up to the lovely
Chapter fifty-five, in which rise to sing
The four great songs of YHWH's Servant
on wing,

The son once called from Egypt to atone
In suffering for the sins of folk and throne.
The recapitulation at the end,
Chapters fifty-six to sixty-six wend
Among the former themes both great and small
And reaffirm each one as divine call.

Isaiah 1

1 The vision of Isaiah son
Of Amoz, that he saw begun
On Judah and Jerusalem
In days of Uzziah, Jotham,
Ahaz, *and* Hezekiah, kings
Of Judah. 2 Hear therefore, O wings
Of heaven, and give ear, O earth!
For YHWH has spoken *things of worth*,
"I have nourished children brought up
Who have rebelled against My *cup*,
3 The ox knows its master, the donkey
Its master's crib *and without honkey*,
But Israel does not know, My folk
Do not consider *what I spoke*."

4 Alas, a sinful nation, and
A people laden *foot and hand*
With iniquity, and a brood
Of evildoers, children who'd
Be corrupters! They have forsaken
YHWH, and they have *in loss* mistaken
To provoke to anger the Holy
One of Israel, they've become *lowly*
And turned away backward. 5 Why should
You be stricken again? Why would
You revolt more and more? The whole
Head is sick, and the whole heart faint.
6 From sole of foot *without restraint*
Even to the head, no soundness
In it, wounds, bruises and a mess
Of putrefying sores, they've not
Been closed or bound up *on the spot*,

Or soothed with ointment. 7 Your country
Is desolate, every city
Burned with fire, strangers come devour
Your land in your presence *an hour*,
And *it's* desolate, overthrown
By strangers *you had not foreknown*.
8 The daughter of the fortress left
As a booth in vineyard *bereft*,
As a hut in cucumber garden
A besieged city *without pardon*,
9 Unless YHWH of hosts had left us
A very small remnant *in truss*,
We would have been like Sodom, and
Gomorrah-like *in our sins stand*.

Beloved, I do not criticize the people
You favoured by Your hand, their church
and steeple,
The synagogue or mosque: Your judgment
stands.
I strike not Israel nor other lands.
I only pray that You will do for me
What You did not do for the family
Of Abraham. Lord, make me like the ass,
Let me eat morning oats and hay and grass,
And recognize the barn and crib that's
mine.

Like Ishmael, to be an ass is fine,
If I can be a wild ass running free.
And so I freely turn from all that's me
To find my Self and master where You are.
I hitch my donkeycart to one bright star.

10 Hear the word of YHWH, you rulers
Of Sodom, give ear what law stirs
From our God, you people that scuff
Gomorrah, 11 "To what purpose *is*
The number of sacrifices
To Me?" Says YHWH. "I've had enough
Of burnt offerings of rams *and stuff*,
And the fat of fed cattle, I
Do not delight in blood of bull,
Or of lamb or goat *going by*.
12 "When you come before Me and full,
Who has required this from your hand,
To trample My courts *in My land*?
13 Bring no more futile sacrifice,
Incense to Me does not smell nice,
The first day of the months, the *days*
Of Sabbaths, calling assemblies,
I cannot stand iniquity
And the sacred meeting *fully*."

14 Your first day of the months and your
Appointed feasts I do abhor,
They are a trouble to My soul,
I'm weary of bearing *their toll*.

15 When you spread out your hands, I'll
hide

My eyes from you, though you abide
In prayer, I will not hear *the flood*.
Your *unclean* hands are full of blood.

The blood of sheep and goats You have
accepted

When brought with pure heart never
intercepted

By motives to buy off Your wrath or cover
The secret sin by some transgression lover.
The new moon and the Sabbath You
appointed

And loved when they were not sometime
anointed

With brave iniquity. The insincere
And sinful, wicked heart it is I fear
That spoils the sacrifice and spoils the day.
I bring no sacrifice but living action,
Remembrance of Your name for
satisfaction,

And sanctify both gift and hour that way.
The living human sacrifice please take
As I observe the rest in You awake.

16 "Then wash yourselves and make you
clean,

Put out the evil I have seen
You doing. Cease to do the wrong,

17 "Learn to do good, seek justice' *song*,
Rebuke oppressor, defend those
Who have no father, plead the close
Of widow. 18 "Come now, let us reason
Together," Says YHWH, "Though *in*
season

Your sins are like scarlet, they'll be
As white as snow, though crimsonly
They shine red, they shall be as wool.

19 "If you are willing *at the pull*,
Obedient, then you shall eat

The good of the land *for a treat*,

20 "But if you refuse and rebel,
You'll be devoured by a scalpel",
For the mouth of YHWH's spoken it,
And gives you warning as is fit.

To cease to do the evil only needs

The will response to Your command, it
feeds

On grace embedded in that word once
spoken.

Cease to do wrong, leave the command
unbroken.

It can be done with one moment's decision.
But doing well requires a greater vision.
It must be learned and justice must be
sought.

It needs rebuking the oppressor caught
Oppressing fatherless and widow too.

To do good thus requires the force to do.
Will and obey, You say, and offer meal,
Refuse, rebel and be oneself devoured.
Let me turn from the evil thing to real,
Stand for the right and be no faltering
coward.

21 How the faithful city's become
A harlot! It was full *in sum*
Of justice, righteousness lodged in it,
But now the murderers *begin it*.

22 Your silver has turned into dross,
Your wine mixed with water *for loss*.

23 Your princes *are* rebellious, and
Companions of thieves *in their band*,
Everyone loves bribes, and follows
After rewards. They don't impose
Defence of fatherless, nor does
The widow's cause arise for them.

24 So the Lord says *in stratagem*,
YHWH of hosts, Israel's Mighty One,
"Ah, I will rid Myself of foes,
And take vengeance on My foes *done*.

25 "I shall turn My hand against you,
And thoroughly clean *like the dew*
Your dross, and take away alloy
From all your *ways and every joy*.

26 "I'll restore your judges as first,
And your counsellors as *they durst*

At the beginning. Afterward
You shall be called city preferred
For righteousness, the faithful city."

27 The fortress shall be redeemed skitty
With justice, and her penitents
With righteousness *and righteous fence*.

28 Destruction of transgressors and
Of sinners *shall be jointly fanned*,
And those who forsake YHWH shall be
Consumed. 29 For ashamed they shall be
Of the terebinth trees which you've

Desired, and you shall surely prove
 Embarrassed because of the parks
 Which you have chosen *in the darks*.
 30 You'll be like terebinth whose leaf
 Fades, and as a garden *for grief*
 That has no water. 31 The strong shall
 Be as the tinder *prodigal*,
 And the work of it as a spark,
 Both will burn together *in dark*,
 And no one shall quench *them at all*
Till they are gone beyond the wall.

I offer, my Beloved, no offering here
 Upon this gallows floor but this one dear
 Myself, this booth in vineyard, garden of
 Cucumbers, city mine besieged with love.
 I offer pewter coins for silver plate,
 And dross to catch Your love and void
 Your hate.

I offer bribes of all things empty and
 Forlorn, the tinsel wealth of barren hand.
 I offer bribes of what I have to You
 And give the little empty self in change
 For Self on Self resounding in the Huu
 From coast to blessed coast and range to
 range.

Set all the strong as tinder with Your spark
 And quench not anything inside the park.

Isaiah 2

1 The word Isaiah Amoz son
 Saw about Judah and when done
 Jerusalem *under the sun*.
 2 And it shall come to pass at last
 The mountain of YHWH's house shall cast
 Its shadow on the mountain top,
 Exalted above where hills stop,
 And all nations shall flow to it.
 3 And many folk shall say when fit,
 "Come, let's go to YHWH's mountain and
 To the house of Jacob's God's stand,
 And He will teach us of His ways,
 And we'll walk in His paths *to praise*,
 For out of the fortress shall go
 The law, word of YHWH from the show
 Of Jerusalem *in a row*.
 4 And He shall judge among the nations,
 And shall rebuke many folk's *rations*:
 And they shall beat their swords into
 Ploughshares, and their spears too in view
 Of pruninghooks, till no folk lift
 Up sword against a nation's rift,

Nor learn war any more *for rue*.
 5 O house of Jacob, come and let
 Us walk in YHWH's light *where we've*
met.

The One who reigns alone upon the hill
 Of Zion, You Beloved, whose sovereign
 will

Alone I seek, is God of all the earth
 And of all nations, and of all they're worth,
 Not of the Jew alone, nor of the seat
 Of Gerizim, but of both chaff and wheat.
 You stand above the quarrel of each cast
 And arbitrate all born before the mast.
 You are alone the captain, Your rebuke
 Has weight above both Czar and over duke.
 Jerusalem is where the dome of peace
 Shall rein in violence and make it cease.
 Beneath that golden dome I stop to bow
 And turn my sword and spear into a
 plough.

6 That's why You've forsaken Your folk,
 The house of Jacob to a bloke,
 Because they've taken from the east,
 And are soothsayers and increased
 Like the Philistines, and they please
 Themselves in strangers' spawn *with*
slease.

7 Their land's full of silver and gold,
 Nor do their treasures end when sold,
 Their land is filled with horses too,
 No end of their chariots in view.
 8 Their land is filled with idols' crew,
 They worship the work of their hands,
 What their own fingers made *in strands*.
 9 The least man bows and the great too
 Humbles himself before that crew,
 So don't forgive *unfaithful pew*.

There are four gates of right and four of
 wrong.
 The first false gate is the gate of the east,
 The dualistic magic that so long
 Has called all faiths in people to the feast.
 The second false gate is the silver, gold
 That is no value despite how it's sold.
 It does not feed nor heal nor quench one's
 thirst,
 But just seduces souls to buy the worst.
 The third false gate is chariot and horse,
 Depending on the military force.

The fourth false gate is idols in the land,
False gods confected by mind and by hand.
Beloved, keep me away from all false
gates,
But let me find in You all glory waits.

10 Enter the rock, and hide in dust,
From the terror of YHWH, you must,
And from His majesty's glory.
11 The proud looks of a man shall be
Humbled, the haughtiness of men
Shall be bowed down *to earth, and then*
YHWH alone shall be exalted
On that day. 12 For the day *and grid*
Of YHWH of hosts *shall come* upon
Everything proud and lofty *drawn*,
On everything lifted up, and
It shall be brought low *every hand*
13 On all the cedars *that expand*
Upon the Lebanon high and
Lifted up, and on all the oaks
Of Bashan, 14 On all the high *smokes*
Of the mountains, on all the hills
That are lifted up, 15 on the sills
Of every tall tower, and on
Every strengthened wall, 16 and upon
All the ships of Tarshish, and on
All the fine vessels. 17 Human pride
Shall be bowed down, and haughtiness
Of men shall be laid low, confess
YHWH only will upon that day
Be exalted *against the fray*,
18 But the idols He shall *destroy*,
Utterly abolish *with joy*.
19 They shall *then* go into the holes
Of the rocks, and *moving like moles*
In caves of the earth, before great
Terror of YHWH, His glory's state
And majesty, when He'll arise
To shake the earth greatly *and skies*.
20 On that day a man will throw out
His idols of silver *and grout*
And his idols of gold, which they
Made, *each* for himself *in parade*
To worship, to the moles and bats,
21 To go into the clefts of *mats*
And rocks, and into rugged crags
Before the terror of YHWH's *flags*
And glory of His majesty,
When He rises to shake greatly
The earth. 22 Cut yourselves off from such
A man, whose breath *is hardly much*

In his nostrils, for of what account
Is he, and to what does amount?

The trees and towers and ships it seems are
those
Above all things that shall come down in
rows,
And then the proud and mighty shall be
caught
And brought low with the idols they have
bought.
The idols You will utterly abolish,
The gold cast down, the silver without
polish.
For the first time the motionless and mute
Of idols shall with one cry of dispute
Get up and walk into the holes and caves
To hide themselves from lightning and the
waves.
Unable to change then at last their course
Their worshippers will follow, no remorse
For voiding finely gold and silver's worth,
The first thing out of character on earth.

Should I cut myself off from ministry
Of the cleric whose shop is bishoply
In synagogue and mosque or in the church?
Should I leave their bright idols in the
lurch?

Beg me not, O Beloved, to flee from face
Of the benign clergyman and his race.
Where can I go but to You? But Your pace
Is too quick for my wandering without
grace.

Should I not bow before the feet of men
Indeed whose breath comes in nostril
again?

Then what of gold and oil, which does not
breathe?

Cannot I have some god from those that
seethe

About the ecumenical retreat?
I bow before Your invisible feet.

Isaiah 3

1 Behold now, the Lord, YHWH of hosts,
Takes away Jerusalem's boasts,
And from Judah the stay and staff,
And all the bread, water to quaff,
2 The mighty man, and man of war,
The judge and prophet, *on the shore*
The prudent and the elder's *door*,

3 The captain over fifty men,
 Aristocrat, counsellor's den,
 The artisan and orator.
 4 And I'll set children to rule them,
 And foolish ones to guard their gem.
 5 And the people shall be oppressed,
 Each by the other, and addressed
 One by his neighbour, and the child
 Shall be insolent and as wild
 Against his elder, and the mean
 Against the honoured man *for spleen*.

When the great Master of this Age began
 To reign he was a babe and not a man,
 He was a child and this the prophet knew
 And so he wrote the thing beforehand true.
 You, O Beloved, gave then a child to lead,
 But times were hard and he had to take
 heed

And keep himself in hiding from the foe.
 So to this day, that child become adult
 Is Your appointed everywhere men go,
 In peaceful cloister and in huge tumult.
 Now in his day and reign I see the base
 Is insolent to good men to the face,
 And skill and counsel disappear before
 His hoped return to hide himself no more.

6 When a man takes hold of his brother
 In the house of father and mother,
 And says "Be our ruler since you
 Have change of clothing, let this rue
 Be under your hand, so reign true."
 7 In that time he shall swear and say
 "I shall not take a healer's way,
 For in my house I have no bread
 Nor is their clothing for me spread,
 Don't make me chief of the folk led."

8 Jerusalem is spoiled, the land
 Of Judah's fallen on the sand,
 Because their tongue and actions strike
 Against YHWH to provoke the like
 Before His eyes in glory's band.
 9 Their very face is witness cast
 Against them, and they declare fast
 Their sin as Sodom, they don't hide.
 Woe to their soul! They've come to bide
 In wickedness *before the mast*.
 10 Say to the righteous, it is well,
 They'll eat their doings' fruit a spell.
 11 Woe to the wicked! *it shall be*
 Ill *with him*: for the reward's free

Of his hands shall be given him.
 12 As for my folk, children oppress,
 And women rule on their address.
 O my folk, those who lead you make
 You err and destroy in mistake
 The way of your paths *in their wake*.

The women ruling over Allah's folk
 This day are neither women nor a joke,
 But men transgendered by the verdicts
 made

In vicious and unrighteous ambushade,
 The harlots sculpted by the surgeon's knife
 To give the clergy temporary wife
 And pleasure sans responsibility.
 You see their limousines go riding free
 Through Tehran's streets, yet time will
 quickly come

When wickedness will fully make a sum,
 And You, Beloved, will ride in punishment
 By tank and missile of ungodly sent
 Upon those once established for the good.
 Ah, if those once good men did as they
 should!

13 YHWH stands to plead, He stands to
 judge

The people caught in any smudge.
 14 YHWH'll enter into judgement met
 With elders of His people set,
 And princes of His folk, for you
 Have eaten up the vineyard's due,
 The spoil of the poor's in your pew.
 15 "What do you mean to beat my folk
 And punch their faces at a stroke,
 The faces of the poor?" Says YHWH
 The Lord of hosts *come into view*.

You ask the question, my Beloved, and so
 You do deserve an answer, You should
 know.

Why is the plunder of the poor now found
 In every Christian kind of bank around
 And in the moneyed Jewish counting
 house,
 As well as in the Arab's sleeve and blouse?
 Why do they grind the faces of the poor
 From Philippines to Haiti, plain and moor?
 You who have all power in the universe
 Cannot feel how the pain grows worse and
 worse

Day after day that power is so divided

Where presidents and princes are resided.
It feels so good to crush the child and
weak,
The power surge for such is most unique.

16 Therefore YHWH says “Because the
girls

Of Zion are proud of their curls,
And strut with their necks up and eyes
As wanton, walking mincing guise
As they go tinkling with their feet,”
17 So YHWH will strike them for a treat
With a scab on top of the head
Of Zion’s daughters, YHWH will spread
Uncovered their bareness *in bed*.

18 In that day YHWH will take away
The courage of their tinkling sway
Of ornaments, their cauls and round
Tires like the moon *without a sound*,
19 The chains and bracelets and the veils,
20 The tiaras and leg ornaments,
The bands and tablets in their trails,
The earrings, finger rings and nose
Rings, 22 and the suits to change in rows,
The shawls and purses, 23 looking glasses,
And the fine linen *on their vents*,
And hoods and gauze *to cover passes*.

24 And it shall happen that instead
Of sweet scents their shall be stink’s *dread*,
Instead of a belt just a rent,
Instead of hair *with permanent*
Bald head, instead of girdle fine
A rope of sackcloth, and the brine
Of burning for beauty *on vine*.

25 Your men shall fall dead by the sword,
Your mighty ones in battle scored.

26 And her gates shall lament and mourn,
Desolate she will sit in scorn.

Put on wool now, and lay aside the chain
Of gold and silver crescent, face the rain
With bare cheeks and unpainted, take the
wool!

The wool is not for those who feel the pull
Of ever higher flights of fancy prayer.
All that is only gate of empty air.
The wool alone can calm the false self’s
cry,

And does so through the oneness by and
by.

O my Beloved, let me subvert the will

That strives in human heart, and striving
still
Would take the rank illusion for the true.
Let me not be at all, but only You
In every hope and help I try to find.
Let me put on the wool and not be blind.

Isaiah 4

1 And on that day seven women take
Hold of one man, saying at stake,
“We’ll eat our own bread and wear our
Own clothing, only let our power
Be called by your name to remove
The reproach of our maiden’s groove.”

I’m not sure that I see reproach in that
A woman has no husband, some are fat
For being gluttons, some are worse.
The husbandless is just not always curse.
I’m not sure that I see a better thing
In seven wives than one or even four.
Unless one has the grateful state of king
One is enough and one does not need more.
The lamentation of the day is sure
For one who turns away from true and
pure,
And yet polygamy gives comfort small
When there is hardly answer to the call.
Let me lament in no case that I find
Since good and bad with You are of a kind.

2 In that day shall the branch of YHWH
Be beautiful in gloried view,
And the fruit of the earth shall be
Excellent and fine where they see
Escape for Israel’s degree.

3 And it shall happen that the one
That’s left in Zion, and the one
Who stays in Jerusalem shall
Be called holy, and every pal
That’s written with the living in
Jerusalem for peace or din.

4 When the Lord’s washed away the sin
Of Zion’s daughters, and shall clean
The blood from Jerusalem’s sheen
By judgement’s spirit and fire’s *dean*,

5 Then YHWH will make on every place
Of dwelling in Mount Zion’s trace,
Upon her congregations yet
A cloud and smoke by the day met,
And shining of a fire by night,
For on all glory shall be might.

6 And there shall be a tent for shade
In the daytime from heat's parade,
And for a place of refuge and
For cover from storm and rain *scanned*.

I flee to You, Beloved, for refuge in
The time of storm and rain, both rain within
And storm without, and seek the cooling
shade

The tabernacle of Your presence made.
For over all the glory there is covering,
And on the hidden mount the cloud is
hovering,

So that my eyes see only trade and trick,
Instead of justice, marble halls and brick.
I flee to You, Beloved, for shelter from
The din within, and without dreary drum
That belts the clash and clang of heathen
prayer

In church and mosque and synagogue,
beware.

I strike the flaming cloud that comes by
night

And drink its fiery draughts with keen
delight.

Isaiah 5

1 I'll sing my well-beloved a song
About my beloved's vineyard fair.
My well-beloved has vineyards there
Upon a hill fruitful and strong.

2 He hedged it round, picked up each stone,
And planted with best vines alone,
And built a watchtower in it there,
And also made a winepress share,
And then expected it to yield
Grapes but it bore upon the field
Wild grapes *as though it had been bare*.

3 Jerusalem's inhabitants,
And men of Judah, judge *who prance*
Between me and my vineyard's care.

4 What could I have done more in flare
To my vineyard that I've not done?
Why then, when I inspected it
To see if it brought forth grapes fit,
I found it bore wild grapes *with pit*?

5 Now then, sirs, I shall let you know
What I'll do to my vineyard's *row*,
To turn aside its hedge *in show*
Of *fire's* devouring, to break down
Its wall to tread under *the town*.

6 And I will make it a wasteland,

It shall not be pruned, dug *nor manned*,
But filled with bramble briars and thorns;
And thick clouds I'll set in watch *bourns*
To rain no rain on it as planned.

7 For see the vineyard plot of YHWH
Of hosts is house of Israel's *crew*,
And men of Judah are the plant
Pleasant to His *eye*, and *in grant*
He looked for justice, and behold
Oppression, and for righteous *gold*,
But see a cry *and shout unfold*.

O my Beloved, I am a grape divided
Into not sevens but forties here provided,
A single grape one moment at Your lip,
A thing of little note by plane and ship.
If Noah found a sweet grape from his vine,
I pray You too might joy in what is mine
For purple sweetness momentary there
Upon Your tongue. There is no one to share
The morsel feast, I wait beneath Your fate
In hope You will find justice or its mate
And not oppression in my act and will.
I wait, a grape, one sweet or sour, but still.
Dig up Your vineyard and cast out the me,
Let only You and Youness find the tree.

8 Woe to those who pile property
On property and field in spree
Till there's no room for neighbourly,
But they live in a land lonely.

9 By the weapons of YHWH of hosts,
Don't many houses in their boasts
Become a desolation's toasts,
Great and good but empty *of roasts*?

10 For ten acres of vineyard yield
Just one bath, and the planted field
With seed in homer is unpeeled
To bare only an ephah *sealed*.

11 Woe to those who get up at dawn
To drink strong drink and fawn upon
Till nightfall, till they're drunk and drawn!

12 And harp and viol, tabret and pipe
Mix with the wine in their feasts ripe,
But YHWH's acts they do not behold,
His hands' work always leaves them cold.

13 That's why my people take the path
Into captivity, the wrath
Of no knowledge is in their wake,
And their honoured men die for sake
Of hunger and their multitude
Dries up for thirst *and without food*.

14 Therefore hell has enlarged herself,
Opened her mouth beyond her shelf,
Their gloried crowds with all their pomp
With joyous riot fill the swamp.
15 The low is brought down lower still,
The mighty man humbled on hill,
The eyes of the proud shall be cast
Down also *before troubled mast*.

The prophet of ancient times at the fore
Speaks not only of Israel and its store.
Not only men of Judah take their place
Before his pulpit to hear lack of grace.
The gathering of wealth I see around
Me in the global stealth, I hear the sound
Of rock and roil that beer drinkers
propound,
And know the prophet did not guess and
trace.

Beloved, I hate the thing and I abhor
The man who gathers on his plate and store
More than a man can eat, and I detest
The liquor that dribbles down on the vest.
Bring once again a new captivity,
Fill Babylon with multitudes in spree.

16 But YHWH of hosts in judgement rises,
And El the Holy One in guises
Shall be sanctified in the way
Of righteousness *come down to stay*.

17 Then shall the lambs graze in their way,
And the fat ones' deserts in sway
Shall be consumed in strangers' *pay*.

18 Woe for drawing iniquity
Out with the cords of vanity,
And sin as with a cart's thick rope.

19 They say "Let him make haste in hope
And hurry up his work in scope,
So we may see it, and so let
The counsel of Holy One met
Of Israel come near to see
And we will know it faithfully!"

20 Woe to those who call evil good
And good call evil, *in the wood*
Put darkness for a light, and light
For darkness, and the bitter bite
For sweet, and sweet where bitter stood!

21 Woe to those wise in their own eyes,
And prudent in their own sight's guise!

22 Woe to one great to drink wine, and
Men strong to mix liquor *in band*,

23 Who justify the wicked stand

For a reward, and take away
The righteousness from righteous sway!

I too, Beloved, say that You might make
haste
And turn these companies' roll into paste,
These presidents and ministers to baste.
But I say that word not in scorn that You
Do not exist to judge the earthly crew,
But rather in my anger at the view
Of high oppression in the park and pew.
I beg You hurry in my vengeance lust
To make the world once drowned a place
of dust.

I tire of mercy that gives up the just
To gone injustice. Still I plant a foot
Upon the mountain and dream of the root
Of Sinai where Your mercy and Your grace
Once shone upon dear Moses face to face.

24 Therefore as fire devours the straw,
And flame consumes the chaff *in craw*,
So their root shall be rottenness,
And their blossom in dust's *address*,
Because they've cast away the law
Of YHWH of hosts, despised the spell
Of Holy One of Israel.

25 Therefore the wrath of YHWH is
kindled
Against His people *and unswindled*,
And He has stretched His hand on high
Against them and struck them thereby,
The hills were shaken, bodies torn
And left upon the streets forlorn.
And yet after all this His wrath
Is not appeased and turned from path,
But His hand's still stretched out *in scorn*.

26 And He will raise a flag to be
In nations far across the sea,
And hiss at them around the world,
And they shall come swiftly as hurled.

27 None shall be weary, none shall stumble
Among them, none shall slumber humble,
Neither shall their belt come loose nor
The latchet of their shoes break sore,
28 Whose arrows sharp with bows all bent,
Their horses' hoofs like flint sparks sent,
Their chariot wheels like whirlwind lent:

29 Their roaring like a lion's voice,
They'll roar like young lions rejoice,
Indeed, they'll roar and take the prey,
And safely carry it away

And none deliver from the fray.
30 In that day they shall roar indeed
Like roaring of the sea in speed,
And if one looks into the land,
See there is dark and sorrow's band,
And light is dark in skies *unfreed*.

I shudder at the picture prophecy
Of Judah's fall before the cavalry
Of Babylon. I shudder at the stroke
And take back all my prayers against the
bloke

Who carries on such wickedness today,
That deserves judgement for reward and
pay.

The tongue that cannot sway a multitude
With such words may seem unworthy and
crude,

But truth is hearts are hard before appeal
Of justice at the hearth as well as wheel.

Come in Your time, Beloved, and break the
mast

Without my prayers that time should end or
last,

And I shall meet Your coming on the path
With joy in grace as well as in Your wrath.

Isaiah 6

1 The year that King Uzziah died,
I saw the Lord sitting *aside*
On a throne, high and lifted up,
And His train filled the temple *cup*.

2 Above it stood the seraphim,
Each one had six wings *stuck to him*:
With two he covered up his face,
With two he covered feet *in place*,
And with two flew *about in space*.

3 They called out each to each and said
"Holy, holy, holy is YHWH
Of hosts: and all His glory spread
Throughout the whole earth *old and new*."

4 And the posts of the door were shaken
By the voice of him *overtaken*
Who cried out, and the house was filled
With smoke *of all the incense spilled*.

How was the year that King Uzziah died
A different time from all the times before
And all the after years, the years of gore,
The year when Jesus Christ was crucified,
The third year of Jehoiakim the king,
Or any other year when Messias

Was seen in two or eased away by gas?
Was that a different kind of time, a thing
Unknown before, unknown from then till
now

To see You, Lord, sit high upon a throne?
A great invention like the telephone
Can hardly keep You well-informed on
how

Many tons of child died on earth today
And whether it would matter anyway.

There was a time when I too thought the
earth
Was filled with glory, glazed with gold and
song,

When I too thought the right of every
wrong

Was just as soon and sure as death and
birth.

And yet each further morning from my pain
(Small to be sure beside the comfortless
Deceptions of such ways I cannot guess)

I never cease to wonder how the rain
Can fall so gently, how the sun can shine
While all the world so filled with glory
God

Goes on across some bleeding soul rough-
shod,

And spills without apology the wine.
Was all the earth for one day filled alone,
Or can I find a glory of my own?

5 Then said I, "Woe *is* me! for I
Am unwrought, and because that I
Am a man of unclean lips to spy,
And I live with a folk unclean
Of lip, for my eyes now have seen
The King, YHWH of hosts *in the sky*."

6 Then one of the seraphim flew
To me with a live coal in view,
Which he had taken with the tongs
From off the altar *and the thongs*.

7 He laid it on my mouth and said
"See, this has touched your lips instead,
And your iniquity is gone,
And your sin is purged *and withdrawn*."

8 Also I heard the Lord's voice say
"Whom shall I send, who in the way
Will go for us?" Then I said "Here
Am I, send me *and do not fear*."

9 And He said "Go and tell this folk,
'Hear you indeed, but not a stroke

To understand, and see *the bat*,
 But yet perceiving none of that.'
 10 "Make the heart of this people fat,
 And make their ears heavy, and shut
 Their eyes, lest they see *all the glut*,
 And hear with their ears and gain sight
 Of understanding in heart *white*,
 And turn and be healed *from their spite*."
 11 Then I said "Lord, how long?" and He
 Replied, "Until the cities be
 Wasted without inhabitant,
 And the houses without an ant,
 And the land utterly left scant,
 12 "And YHWH remove men far away,
 And great forsaking of land's sway.
 13 "But if a tenth remain, then it
 Shall be devoured *both house and kit*,
 Like terebinth and oak with trunk
 After their leaves have turned to bunk,
 Like an acorn from its husk sunk."

I've seen the live-oak peer behind the veil
 Of morning mist, and hugely scan the pale
 New light in calm delight or scorn or mirth.
 I've seen the live-oak rearing from the
 earth.

It casts its leaves indeed, but never leaves
 A trunk in desolate against the breeze
 Of winter. It binds up its mossy sleeves
 And turns tough green against the
 centuries.

Beloved, though mammoth great, the live-
 oak stands,
 It drops the acorn brown from many hands.
 I've seen the husk grow black and damp
 with musk,

I've seen the live-oak still beneath the
 dusk.

The life may end indeed for that one tree,
 But from the acorn dead rises one free.

Isaiah 7

1 It happened in times of Ahaz
 The son of Jotham who was son
 Of Uzziah that Judah has
 Had for a king, that Rezin fun
 King of Syria and Pekah
 Who was son of Remaliah,
 The king of Israel, went up to
 Jerusalem to give it rue,
 But could not conquer it when done.
 2 And it was told to David's house

And spoken then "Syria's *grouse*
 Is joined with Ephraim, *the mouse*."
 And his heart was moved and the heart
 Of his folk as the trees that start
 In the wood move by the wind's *part*.
 3 Then YHWH said to Isaiah, "Go
 Out now to meet Ahaz in show,
 You and Shearjashub who's your son,
 At the end of the conduit done
 On upper pool in the highway
 Of the fuller's field *on a day*;
 4 "And say to him, 'Be careful and
 Be quiet, do not fear the band,
 Nor be fainthearted for the two
 Tails of these smoking brands in crew,
 For the fierce wrath of Rezin with
 Syria, and Remaliah's *myth*.
 5 "Because Syria and Ephraim,
 And the son of Remaliah grim,
 Have taken wicked plans to set
 Against you, saying 6 "Let's go get
 Judah and trouble it and make
 A breach in it for our own sake,
 And set another king in it,
 The son of Tabeal, *man fit*:"
 7 So says the Lord YHWH, "It shall not
 Succeed, nor come to pass the plot."
 8 "For Syria's head is Damascus,
 And Damascus' head's Rezin's *curse*,
 And within sixty-five years' run
 Broken Ephraim shall be done
 And no more be a folk *for fun*.
 9 "And Ephraim's head's Samaria,
 Samaria's head's Remaliah's *claw*.
 If you do not believe, then you
 Will never be set in your pew."'''

I too have spoken impudently to
 Those in authority over my pew
 As did Isaiah to Ahaz when he
 Promised that You would save him
 faithfully.

I've seen my impudence make chiefs doubt
 what

I had to say, and so the fault in glut
 Fell on me and I suffered at the butt.
 Isaiah is no wiser in my view.
 Beloved, Ahaz might have believed if You
 Had told Isaiah to say just the true
 Without the threat that unbelief would track
 The king out of his throne and with a
 smack.

But then You are just not a diplomatic
Bloke meeting both the greedy and fanatic.

10 Moreover YHWH spoke to Ahaz
Again and uttering this jazz:

11 "Ask a sign of YHWH Alohim,
Ask either in the depths' *pazaz*
Or in the heights above *that gleam*."

12 But Ahaz said, "I will not ask,
Neither will I tempt YHWH *in task*."

13 And he replied, "Listen here now,
O house of David *like a cow*,
It is enough you tire out men,
But will you weary God again?

14 "The Lord Himself shall give a sign:
See how a virgin shall combine
And bear a son and call his name
God-is-with-us, *but you're to blame*."

15 "Butter and honey shall he eat,
He'll learn to reject evil's street,
And choose the good *as for a treat*."

16 "And before the child comes to know
How to reject the evil show
And choose the good, the land you fear
Will be forsaken with its gear
By both of her kings *come to steer*."

17 "YHWH shall bring on you and your
folk

And on your father's house a stroke
Of days that never came before
From the day that Ephraim set store
Away from Judah by the score
Of the king of Assyrian *shore*."

The woman was a virgin when the prophet
Spoke these words, but it's not a thing to
scoff at

That she was married in time to receive
The seed of her conception on the sleeve.
The sign was not virginity, but that
You'd intervene before a child that sat
Upon its mother's knee could utter scat.
If the child meant is one born without dad,
Some hundreds of years later on the pad,
Then it's no sign at all to King Ahaz,
And makes Your word a laughing stock
and razz.

The Gospel quotes it for the name itself
To show that as in time of king and elf,
Even then You are with Your folk
Yourself.

I'd think Your presence and Your aid
would be

Enough for human hearts with faith and
glee

Without distractions of an argument
Whether the damsel had been or not lent
To a man's bed. The promise that You give
To save is what we need to rise and live.
I fondly wish that Ahaz had replied
With something as a sign from a sky wide,
Such as a falling star or an eclipse,
Instead of standing there with hands on
hips.

Then You would not have intervened to
make

A mess in human expectations' wake.
Aye, You're responsible for what men do
Since You knew just how stupid was the
crew.

18 "And it will happen in that day
That YHWH shall whistle for the stray
Fly in Egypt farthest away
Upon the river, and the bee
That's in Assyria's land *and free*."

19 "And they'll arrive and all alight
In desolation's valleys' plight,
And in the holes of rocks and on
All the thorns and the bushes *drawn*."

20 "On the same day the Lord will shave
With a rented razor *and brave*
From those beyond the river, by
The king of Assyria, to ply
The head and the hair of the feet,
And it shall take away *discreet*
The beard also *in which* you vie."

21 "It shall happen upon that day,
A man will feed a heifer *hay*
And two sheep of the flock to stay;
22 "And it will happen they shall give
So much in milk that he will live
On butter, for all of those left
In the land *and not ones bereft*
Shall eat butter and honey *cleft*."

23 "And it will happen on that day
That every place where thousands stay
In vines worth thousand's silver pay
Shall be in briars' and in thorns' sway."

24 "With arrows and with bows he'll come,
Because the whole land's thorny sum."

25 "And every mountain shall be ploughed,
And never shall be fear endowed

With briars and thorns, but it shall be
For sending out oxen *for free*,
And for the little sheep *in spree*.”

The future is a thing to fear, it seems,
Through ignorance. It shows in feeble
gleams

To king and prophet till Your word reveals
The time that destroys and the time that
heals.

It matters not whether water and bread
Or butter and honey are victuals fed,
The anxious mind recalls the past in dreams
And looks on future with the vision's
dread.

Beloved, I hear the cantillation set,
The vasty humour of the words that get
But faint response from humankind who've
met

The enervating priestly function, yet
I hope with the intensity that finds
Your path that earth and sky open the
blinds.

Isaiah 8

1 Moreover YHWH said to me, “Take
A large scroll, and write in its wake
With a man's pen concerning one
Maher-Shalal-Hash-Baz *the son*.

Does woman ever have the chance to
speak?

Let lusty men who say their sex is weak
Ask rather can a woman hold her tongue.
Such are the men that women live among.
In secret they contrive to state their case
Against oppression in this time and place:
When least expected, thunder, whispered
word,

An eyebrow raised, a single laugh that
stirred

The wrath if not the consciences of kings.
Ah, women deal in many, many things.
Without renown, they prophesy to men
Who merely turn, forget their names again:
The wife of such and such the title runs.
They prophesy in what they call their sons.

The fact is that the son was never named
Immanuel, it seems, for the king shamed.
Instead his virgin cum mother preferred

To name him with a word that had been
stirred

With prophecy and guileless hope for best.
Immanuel is unknown east and west.

It does not matter, my Beloved, if none
Bore that name under Ahaz' burning sun.
What matters is that You bear names that
show

That You are with Your creatures on the
go.

And as You rise from throne to seek the
rate

Of Your rule and opened celestial gate,
You still remain beside the smallest child,
No matter what his name is in the wild.

2 I took good witnesses to write,
Uriah the priest and the wight
Zechariah who was the son
Of Jeberechiah when done.

3 I went into the prophetess
And she conceived and bore to bless
A son. Then YHWH said to me, “Call
Him Maher-shalal-hash-baz all.

I guess Isaiah's wife was prophetess
Not only in living at the address
Of prophet, but because she came to guess
What You would tell the man to call his
son.

She was a prophet when she jumped the
gun.

Or then, Beloved, You heard a mother's cry
And forced the dad to listen to the cry
Of womankind to raise a voice, be heard.
What ever happened, my heart is still
stirred

To hear divine revelation unblurred.
My mother also gave me my own name
Because of what she had experienced tame,
Proud to be sprung from Pocahontas' fame,
So Thomas Rolf contributed a claim.

Beloved, give me a name of consequence,
A name that has both meaning and some
sense,

A name like Mahershalalhashbaz so
The women will stop here to see my show.
Quick to the prey and hasten to the spoil
To rob the reckless ones of half their toil,
Increase my store of love and faith and
hope

So that I may learn in a world to cope.
Beloved, give me a name to mind the way
You hasten to deliver night and day,
To delve in justice in the burning noon
And bring the right into the world and soon.

Beloved, give me a name to keep in heart,
Remembering Your mercy's loving part.

4 Before the child can say the words
Dadda and mamma, all the birds
Of Damascus and Samaria's
Spoil shall be taken without cause
By the *great* king of Assyria's.
5 YHWH spoke also to me again
And said 6 "Since this people in den
Refuses Shiloah's waters then
That flow in quiet, and rejoice
In Rezin and Remaliah's choice,
7 Now therefore, see, the Lord will bring
Up on them the waters in spring
Of the river, a current strong,
The king of Assyria come along,
And all his glory, and he'll rise
Upon over all his streams in size
And overflow his banks *in guise*.
8 And he shall pass through Judah; he
Shall overflow and in his spree
Reach to the neck, and stretch his wings
To fill the width of your land's *stings*,
But El is with us *in the flings*.

No matter what the kingly recompense,
No matter what the royal punishments,
Above the clouds of dust and spoil You stand,
Beloved, forever with us in the land.
The sea may overflow the wondered banks,
The river may dry up before the tanks
Of the domestic tyrant or the waves
Of the invader coming to make graves,
But beyond pestilence, Beloved, You sit
Among the righteous as they wait the fit
Of holocaust or just the global wit.
Beloved, Assyrian kings go out no more,
Assyrians themselves are caked with gore
And scattered where the winds of earth
propound
The story of mankind in battle sound.

9 Confederate, you people, and
You will be broken on the sand,

Listen now, every distant land,
Belt up, yet broken you'll not stand,
Belt up, yet broken you'll not stand.
10 Take counsel, still your plans shall fail,
Proclaim decrees, they'll not prevail,
For El is with us *and our band*.

11 For YHWH spoke to me outright so,
And taught me that I should not go
In the way of this people's show,
Saying 12 "Don't say 'A federation,
To all of those who hear the ration
Of this folk saying federation,
Don't be afraid when they are scared,
Nor fear destruction unrepaired."
13 Sanctify YHWH of hosts Himself;
And let Him be your fear on shelf,
And let Him be your dread *and dared*.
14 He'll be a refuge place *and true*,
Yet stumbling stone, offending rock
To both houses of Israel's stock,
A gin and snare to those who dwell
Within Jerusalem *a spell*.
15 And many among them shall stumble,
And fall down broken, *where they grumble*
Be snared and taken *when not humble*.
16 Bind up the testimony, seal
The law to my disciples' heel.
17 And so I shall await on YHWH,
That hides His face from the house view
Of Jacob, and I'll seek His due.
18 See, I and the spawn YHWH gave me
Are signs and wonders that may be
To Israel from YHWH of hosts,
Who dwells in the mount Zion's *coasts*.
19 And when they shall say unto you,
"Enquire of those who have a crew
Of their familiar spirits, and
Of wizards that peep and demand,"
Should not a people seek their God,
And not the living to the sod?
20 To Torah and witness thereof,
If they speak not for push and shove
According to this message, it
Is because they've no candle lit.

The Qur'an also makes the charge that all
Should take the Torah written on the wall
As the criterion of great and small.
I take the Decalogue, Beloved, and show
That all the Torah is with grace aglow,
And in that light of revelation I
Find all the answers that I need to try.

It is amazing that a few small words
 Illuminate all duty for the herds
 Of humankind. Parameters of life
 In Torah save both energy and strife.
 I take the witness that is clear and find
 That it reveals quick who and what is blind
 And where and which are truly of good
 mind.

21 And they shall pass through troubles and
 Through hunger, till it come to stand,
 That when they're hungry they shall fret
 And curse their king and their God yet
 And look up *to find what is set*.
 22 And they shall look unto the earth;
 And see there trouble, darkness' berth,
 Dimness of anguish and they'll be
 Driven to darkness *by degree*.

The prophet promised to the king his son
 Would be called the Immanuel when done,
 But the fact is the wife came in to say
 A different name and in an different way.
 Both You and dear Isaiah changed the set
 To Maher-shalal-hash-baz for a bet.
 That's no doubt why the prophecies that
 come

After such promises like steady rum
 Keep saying El is with us. I'm not dumb.
 I see how both of you contrive to state
 The thing over and over in the gate.
 Be reconciled, Beloved, Isaiah too,
 To what the mother said a name would do.
 Through humankind You learn what is a
 mate.

Isaiah 9

1 But darkness shall not always stay
 Upon the earth of troubles' sway,
 If the past time covered with shame
 The land of Zebulon and name
 Of Naphtali, then time to come
 He'll raise in grace the sea's way's *sum*,
 Beyond the Jordan and the land
 Of Galilee where nations *stand*.
 2 The folk who walked in darkness saw
 A great light, those who lived in awe
 Of death's land, on them light shone *grand*.
 3 You've multiplied the people and
 Increased the joy, their joy in band
 Before You is like the rejoicing
 In harvest or when men are voicing

The victory and the spoil in hand.
 4 You've broken down his burden's yoke,
 The staff upon his shoulder's stroke,
 The rod of his oppression's *span*
 As in the day of Midian.
 5 For every shoe brought in the noise,
 And every garment rolled in blood
 Shall be thrown in the flames and fire
 Shall consume them *cast in the mud*.
 6 For unto us *and to our joys*
 A child is born, a son *to sire*
 Is given and the ruling hire
 Shall be upon his shoulder *dire*;
 The wonderful counsellor and
 The mighty God, Father to stand
 Forever, he shall call his name
 The Prince of Peace *for his acclaim*.
 7 The increase of his government
 And peace have no end, are not spent
 Upon the throne of David sent,
 And on his kingdom in its set,
 Establishing with judgement met
 And justice from this day unto
 Eternity. The zeal of YHWH
 Of hosts this thing shall come to do.

The name is singular, and so the string
 Must be divided at the proper ring,
 And take only the last expression taught
 As the name of the one that we have
 sought.

The other words tell who it is who calls
 The name above the glowing stars and
 stalls.

Beloved, the pagan hope in children born
 In stables under stars to be forlorn
 Before three kings and at the shepherds
 beck

Will grasp at straws and often make a
 wreck

Of Your clear word that You are God
 alone,

That You are sole Creator on the throne.
 And yet the faithful too desire to find
 A prince of peace among the august blind.

8 The Lord sent a message to Jacob,
 A call to Israel to wake up.

9 And all the folk shall know and see,
 Ephraim and Samarian dandee
 That say in pride of a hard heart,

10 "The bricks have fallen down, but we

Will build up with hewn stones to start,
 The sycamores are cut down but
 We'll exchange them for cedars' glut."
 11 So YHWH shall set up foes to be
 Against Rezin, join enemy
 Together. 12 The Syrians before,
 And Philistines behind *the door*,
 And they shall consume Israel
 With open mouth. For all this *spell*
 Of His wrath has not turned away,
 But His hand's stretched out still to pay.
 13 For the folk do not repent at
 Smiting of them nor does *the brat*
 Seek YHWH of hosts, 13 so in one day
 14 YHWH will cut off the head and tail
 And branch and rush from Israel.

No doubt accommodation made to Rome
 After the Hellenizing trick at home
 By Pharisee and Sadducee at last
 Made Israel fugitive and outcast.
 It's not the cutting off of time and space
 To leave Jerusalem in her disgrace,
 But that the faith and faithfulness grew
 weak,
 The circumventing of the law to seek
 Survival under the imperial hand:
 That was the final cutting off in band.
 Beloved, if Israel is lost to You,
 Catastrophe's beyond the human view.
 Theology of replacement's a shoe
 That fits more poorly than the sinful crew.

15 The elder and the magistrate
 Take over as the head of state;
 The lying prophet in his rate,
 He is the tail *and reprobate*.
 16 The chiefs of this folk make them err;
 Destruction on the follower.
 17 That's why the Lord shall have no joy
 In their young men *in His employ*,
 He'll have no mercy on orphan
 And widow, for all in His scan
 Are hypocrites and wicked crew,
 And every mouth spouts foolish brew.
 Because of all of this His wrath
 Is not turned away *from the path*,
 But His hand's stretched out still *in view*.
 18 For wickedness burns like a fire,
 It shall devour the thorn and brier,
 And kindle in the wood and glade,
 Mounting up high like smoke *arrayed*.

19 So through the wrath of YHWH of hosts
 The land is darkened, *in their boasts*
 The people shall be fuel for fire,
 None sparing brother *from the pyre*.
 20 And he shall snatch on the right hand
 And be hungry, and he shall eat
 On the left hand, and all the band
 Shall not be satisfied *with treat*,
 But every man cuts to devour
 The flesh of his own arm *in power*.
 21 Manasseh, Ephraim and yet
 Ephraim and Manasseh set,
 Together against Judah met:
 For all this His wrath is not stayed,
 But His hand stretched out still arrayed.

The burden of this song's a hand stretched
 out,
 And caught among the briers and thorns for
 clout.

The reason is that all authorities
 Lead people out to stray and where they
 please.

Today praise goes to leadership ability,
 When leadership is always an aswility.
 Position is synonymous today
 With leading people in a wicked way.
 Beloved, I turn from every form of power
 And seek You only in the sacred tower
 Of Your word speaking on the mount an
 hour.

Let every sect of Judah and the great
 Manassich Ephraim pass from my gate.
 I set You only in my heart and state.

Isaiah 10

1 Woe to those who decree unjustly,
 And write out griefs in pride and bustly,
 2 To turn the needy from their right,
 And take the portion from the sight
 Of My people away, and make
 Of widows their prey and *in wake*
 Plunder the fatherless *in stake*.
 3 And what will you do in the day
 Of visitation and the sway
 Of desolation from afar?
 To whom will you flee *for a car*?
 And where will you leave glory's *star*?
 4 Despite Me they shall bow beneath
 The captives and some fall with wreath.
 For all this His wrath does not cease,
 But His hand's stretched out to increase.

5 Assyrian, the rod of My wrath,
The staff in their hand is the path
Of indignation I release.
6 I'll send him on hypocrisy,
Against the folk my wrath will see
I give him orders, take the spoil
And take the prey, and tread the coil
Down like the mire on street *and soil*.

If gross invasion is a punishment
Sent by Your hand on every nation spent
In false gods and in lack of justice lent,
Then I see Your hand everywhere I've
bent.
In fact I doubt that Your hand's in the
power
That tramples under tank and gun each
tower
Of humankind's achievements in the dour.
The whip today is in the day to come
The broken clout, the dowsed with fire and
rum.
But Your good prophet says the truth a
while
When he hopes that the folk repent from
guile.
Let me, Beloved, take message heart to
heart
And learn in faithfulness to do my part,
Obeying each commandment from the
start.

7 But he in fact does not think so,
Nor does his heart with such thoughts
glow,
But it is in his heart to bring
Destruction on the nations' *spring*.
8 For he says "Are not all my chiefs
Kings? 9 "Is not Calno *in reliefs*
As Carchemish? Is not Hamath
As Arpad? And Samaria's *wrath*
As Damascus? 10 "As my hand's found
The kingdoms of the idols' ground,
Whose graven images were great
More than Jerusalem's estate
And of Samaria in sound?
11 "Shall I not do as I have done
To Samaria and her spun
Idols to Jerusalem too
And to her idols *come in view*?"
12 That is why it shall come to pass,
That when the Lord performs *the mass*

Of His work on the fortress mount
And on Jerusalem *in fount*,
I'll punish the fruit of the stout
Heart of Assyrian king *in rout*,
And the pride of his high looks' *band*.
13 For he says "By strength of my hand
I have done this, by wisdom *grand*,
For I am wise, and I've removed
The bounds of the folk *as I proved*,
And robbed their treasures and I've put
Down the inhabitants on foot
Like a hero in courage *suit*.
14 "And my hand has found as a nest
The wreath of the folk *and the best*,
And as one gathers up the eggs
That are left I have gathered dregs
Of all the earth, and there was none
That moved a wing or after stun
Opened the mouth or peeped *a gun*."

The kings that lay waste to the earth
presume
In every age that You have given room,
Either that You are on their side for doom,
Or that Your idol is too small to care
Or interfere with their hands on the share.
Methinks both thought though
contradictory
Are those of every Christian prince to see,
Or of their spawn in secular slavery.
Beloved, the one who vaunts today shall
stand
Upon a brook and at a glassy strand
And hear Your voice no longer of
command
But in the judgement that is due to those
Who disobey Your statutes and would
close
The open door of grace on those You
chose.

15 Shall the axe boast itself on those
That cut wood with it, *not their toes*?
Or shall the saw stand up in pride
On one to push it side to side?
If the rod should shake against those
That lift it up, or the staff rose
By itself as though not of wood?
16 Therefore shall the Lord YHWH of
hosts
Send to His fat unhardihood,
And underneath his glory's boasts

He'll kindle burning fire that roasts.
 17 And Israel's light shall be a fire,
 His Holy One a flame and pyre,
 It shall burn and it shall devour
 In one day both his thorn and brier.
 18 It shall consume his forest's glory,
 Of his fruitful field soul and body,
 And they shall be as when the man
 That bears the standard hits the can.
 19 And the rest of his forest trees
 Shall be few so a child may please
 To count them all numbered with ease.

The poor vehicle of Your wrath that burns
 Upon the populace of earth that learns
 Is really not like wooden staff that spurns
 Or rod in hand to strike upon the ferns.
 You gave the power to decide to each man
 And woman on the earth, both slave and
 span
 Of pretence, and we all each day choose
 good
 Or evil in our pathway through the wood.
 Beloved, You do cast down before the gale
 Or before slow corruption of the sail
 The captain of the fleet that would prevail,
 But still each makes his choices and returns
 To doom and judgement for the thing he
 earns.
 It really is no complicated tale.

20 And it shall come to pass that day,
 The remnant of Israel to stay,
 And those escaped from Jacob's house,
 Shall no more depend on the grouse
 That struck him, but shall trust in YHWH,
 Holy One of Israel and true.
 21 The remnant shall return to be
 The remnant of Jacob in fee,
 And back to El the Almighty.
 22 For though your people Israel
 Be as the sand of the sea's *swell*,
 A remnant of them shall return,
 Destruction itself then shall burn
 To overflow with righteousness.
 23 For the Lord YHWH of hosts shall
 make
 An end determined for the sake
 Of all the land *that's in its wake*.

The picture is too rosy in the plot.
 A remnant did come back to favoured lot,

But they were weak and so forlornly caught
 Between the machinations of the Persians
 And the Samaritans in their own versions,
 And after them the Greeks and after that
 The Romans come out sleek and ever fat:
 It was no picnic to return excursions.
 Beloved, the golden age is just a myth:
 There is no day under a throne that's with
 All blessing and delight. The struggle tears
 The heart and head and hands, and the foot
 cares
 For hidden traps set in the market place,
 The field, the roadway, every royal brace.

24 That's why so says Lord YHWH of
 hosts,
 "O My people of Zion's boasts,
 Do not fear the Assyrian,
 He shall strike with a rod in plan,
 And shall lift up his staff to smite
 Against you, like Egyptian giant.
 25 "For yet a very little while,
 The indignation shall unfile,
 And My wrath in their timely spoil.
 26 "And YHWH of hosts shall make a
 whip

For him just like the slaughtership
 Of Midian at Horeb's rock:
 As on the sea was his rod's stock,
 So shall he lift it up again
 In the way of Egyptian den.
 27 "And it shall happen on that day,
 His burden shall be brought away
 From off your shoulder, and his yoke
 From off your neck, as at a stroke
 It shall be destroyed and because
 Of the anointing *of right laws*.
 26 He has come in against Aiath,
 Passover into Migron's path,
 At Michmash saw his weapons' *wrath*.
 29 They've gone over the pass, and they
 Have lodged at Geba for a day,
 Ramah's in fear, and gone away
 From Gibeah is Saul *to stay*.
 30 Lift up your voice, O Gallim's daughter,
 Let it be heard where Laish caught her,
 O poor Anathoth *without ray*.
 31 Madmenah is removed today,
 Gebim's inhabitants astray.
 32 That day he shall remain at Nob,
 He'll shake his hand against the mob
 Of Zion's daughter and the hill

Jerusalem *unburied still*.

33 See, the Lord YHWH of hosts shall cut
The bought with terror *and unshut*.
And the high ones shall be cut down,
The haughty humbled *in the town*.
34 He'll cut the thickets of the wood
With iron, and Lebanon for good
Shall fall by a strong one *come down*.

The seven steps up to Jerusalem
Begin at Geba's hillock for a gem,
And reach Ramah, the highland, where it
winds

About the mound of Saul, Gibeah's rinds.
It passes through the evils of the store
Of Anathoth, to find the open door
Of Madmenah, a dunghill's grand estate.
At last in Gebim's flowing cistern's rate
The cleansing miqwe prepares the soul's
hate

To stay in Nob and so repent before
Reaching the glory of the holy shore.
Beloved, I seek the seven veils to burst
Through each and leave behind the
darkness cursed
Where comfort in my blindness blessed and
nursed.

Isaiah 11

1 And there shall come forth a rod out
Of Jesse's stem, a branch in clout
Shall grow out of his roots' redoubt.
2 YHWH's spirit shall rest upon him,
The spirit of wisdom and *vim*
Of understanding, and *the right*
Of counsel settled in his might,
The spirit of knowledge in view,
And *spirit* of the fear of YHWH.
3 And it shall make him quick to know
The fear of YHWH, and he'll not go
To judge after the sight of eyes,
Neither reprove in hearing's guise.
4 With righteousness he'll judge the poor,
Reprove with equity and sure
For the meek of the earth, and he
Shall strike the earth with his mouth's fee,
And with the breath of his lips he
Shall kill the wicked *in their spree*.
5 And righteousness shall be the belt
About his waist, faithfulness melt
Across his back. 6 The wolf shall dwell
With the lamb and the leopard spell

To lie down with the kid, the calf
And the young lion come to laugh
Together, and a little child
Shall lead *out all these beasts and wild*.
7 The cow and bear shall graze in peace,
Their young ones resting in release
Together, and the lion shall eat
Straw like the ox *and call it treat*.
8 The nursing child shall play beside
The den of the asp and abide,
The weaned child shall put his hand in
The cockatrice' den *with a grin*.

My grandfather when he was just that age,
Two years old they say of the heritage,
His family kept in the kitchen one
Big blacksnake to keep down the rats for
fun.

The boy was playing with the handle set
In the churn once, and the blacksnake he
met
And struck it a blow with the wooden piece
And angered the blacksnake who did not
cease

Until he bit him on the arm where still
I used to see the scar stark white and grill.
There were days in the past at least when
those
Who lived upon the mountains and arose
To worship You beyond the wooded stream
Were not afraid of serpents guarding
cream.

9 They shall not hurt, shall not destroy
In all My holy mount's employ,
For earth shall be filled and wholly
With YHWH's knowledge as with the sea.

10 And in that day root of Jesse,
Which shall stand for a flag to see
Of the folk, to it shall the nations
Seek, and his rest in glory's rations.
11 And it shall come to pass that day,
The Lord shall raise His hand in stay
A second time to keep the way
Of His folk's remnant which is left
Out from Assyria bereft,
And from Egypt and from Pathros,
And from Cush and from Elam's *cross*,
And from Shinar, and from Hamath,
And from the isles of the sea's path.
12 He's set up a flag for the nations,
And gathered Israel's outcast stations,

And brought the scattered of the saints
 Of Judah from the four restraints
 Of all the earth *from Rome to Gath*.
 13 The envy of Ephraim shall flee,
 From Judah all adversary,
 And Ephraim shall not envy
 Judah, and Judah shall not vex
 Ephraim *for hope or health or hex*.
 14 But they shall fly upon the shoulders
 Of the Philistines toward the *boulders*
Of the west, they shall spoil the east
 Together, and lay hand increased
 On Edom and on Moab, and
 The children of Ammon command.
 15 And YHWH shall utterly destroy
 The tongue of the Egyptian sea;
 And with His mighty wind employ
 To shake His hand upon the lea
 Of the river, and shall strike it
 With seven streams and make it fit
 For men to cross dryshod *to sit*.
 16 There'll be a highway for those left
 Of His people *and unbereft*,
 The remnant from Assyria,
 As it was for Israel *in draw*
Of the day that he came up from
The land of Egypt here to hum.

You struck the Red Sea once and made it
 dry
 So refugees could cross the flood and cry
 Your praises under Miriam's blessed
 tongue.
 That was a day that any might have sung.
 You promise once again to strike the sea
 And blow Your winds and set a people
 free.

How many wait in quiet aspiration
 For that deliverance from desperation.
 I look down on the bee-hive houses that
 Dot the Assyrian desert habitat,
 And do not wonder that a people there
 Might truly hope to see a seabed bare,
 And in the darkness and the cooling shade
 I meditate the miracles You've made.

Isaiah 12

1 And in that day you'll say, O YHWH,
 I will praise You, though with me You
 Were angry. Your wrath's turned away,
 You comfort me upon my way.
 2 See El is my salvation; I

Will trust, and not in my fear cry,
 My strength and my song are Jah YHWH,
 And He is my salvation too.
 3 Therefore you'll draw your water out
 With joy from salvation's redoubt.
 4 And in that day you'll say "Praise
 YHWH,

And cantillate His name and do
 Declare his works among the folk,
 Note His name's an exalted *stroke*."
 5 Sing Psalms to YHWH, for He has done
 Excellent things, and this is known
 In all the earth. 6 Cry out and shout,
 You who live in fortress redoubt,
 For great is Israel's Holy One
 To stay among you and about.

Isaiah's Psalm's about as good, I say,
 As any David used to come and play
 Before the throne of Saul, and without pay
 Before the goats and sheep on a spring day.
 The lovely syllable drawn from Your name,
 The great Jah that I love here to proclaim
 Resounds about my attic chamber while
 I contemplate and cantillate in style.
 I am a single soul and come to You
 With the bright words that You inspired as
 true,
 And feel the narrow sting that many throw
 Against me saying "Jew", "Muslim" and
 "crow".

Repay that Christian taunt, Beloved, and
 make
 Them know that You alone rule every
 stake.

Isaiah 13

1 The prophecy of Babylon
 Which saw Isaiah Amoz' son.
 2 Lift up a flag on the high hill,
 Lift up the voice to them and still
 Wave to them to go in the gates
 Of the aristocratic rates.
 3 I've ordered out my holy ones,
 I summoned in my wrath the sons
 Of might as well, and those who raise
 A cry of joy in My high praise.
 4 The tumult of a crowd on high
 As of a great people come nigh,
 The clamour and the noise of kings
 Gathered with their nations in rings:
 YHWH of hosts calls His own to fight.

5 They've come from the far land of light,
From furthest heaven, YHWH and His
 wrath
To destroy the land in His path.

Celestial saints come out to battle ground
To fight along with the invaders' found
Before the water gates of Babylon.
The raider comes in stealth before the
 dawn.
The tumult of the armies that surround
The greatest of all cities with the sound
Of frightful war receives the seal of fate,
The approbation of You, strong and great.
Beloved, I too see how Your armies ride
Upon the clouds, winged spectres dark to
 hide,
And swift to dart among the arbour'd ways
Of my own hill where birch bows and pine
 prays.
The chatter of your armies comes to rest
And strips the mountain ash of berries best.

6 Howl then, for YHWH's day is at hand,
As spoil come from Almighty's band.
7 Therefore shall every hand be faint,
And every heart melt in complaint.
8 And they shall fear: sorrows and pains
Shall take hold of them without gains
Of a woman in labour: they
Shall be amazed and on that day
Their faces in flames shall give way.
9 See how YHWH's day comes, in His
 wrath
Cruel and fierce in His anger's bath,
To make the country desolate,
And spoil the sinners for their fate.

The Jew and Christian and the Muslim wait
For day of judgement, day of awful fate.
But truth is Your great day is never late,
And comes and comes again in measured
 rate.

The rise of kings, the fall of kings'
 grandsons,
Come in the rhythm of rocks on their buns.
My week too is cut short and by surprise
When sixth day evening paints the pattered
 skies
With crimson, then with opal on the down,
With one great blanket on the quiet town
Of Eilat or with wakened brawl and din

In every European town of sin.
The dawn of Sabbath is a darkness run,
The hope and joy of the judgement begun.

10 The heavenly stars, Orion too,
Shall not bring their own light to view,
The sun shall be dark when it rises,
The moon shall not shine in the crisis.
11 I'll punish the world for its sin,
The wicked for their wicked din;
And I'll cause the proud then to end
Their arrogant ways and will bend
The haughtiness that rulers spend.
12 I'll make a man more precious than
Fine gold; even a man *in scan*
Than golden wedge of Ophir's *span*.
13 I'll shake the sky, remove the earth
Out of her place *and from her berth*,
In the wrath of YHWH of hosts' *worth*,
In the day of His fierce wrath's *mirth*.
14 And it shall be like a chased deer,
And like a sheep of no man's gear,
And every man shall flee to his
Own people and turn to his biz.

In Babylon the scientists of old
Gazed on the stars to find the future bold.
No doubt that's why You want to cast them
 down,
And make the stars a laughing stock in
 town,
A darkness on the fields, and treasured way
Opened up to the spoiler on a day.
The craze of life determined by the speck
Of light that trembles on telescope's deck
Diminishes the value of all men:
But when You penetrate the magic den,
Then every soul will return to its own,
The chased deer find its rest, the sheep its
 bone
Fatigued by grazing on the hill and stone
Folded at last beneath the breast again.

15 Every one found shall be thrust through;
And all the crowd fall by sword's due.
16 Their children too shall be dashed down
In broken pieces in their frown,
Their houses shall be spoiled and their
Wives raped by the invaders' share.
17 See, I will stir up the Medes too,
Who care not for silver in due,
Nor for gold in delighted view.

What detail in the prophecy that spoke
Of Babylon's demise under the stroke
Of the invader! How did the man know
That the Medes would be foremost in the
show?

The explanation must be that the text
Was written later than we thought
perplexed,

After the fact, and then brought in to show
To the king where his name golden will
glow.

Beloved, the evidence that men best find
Is made to fool the foolish and the blind,
But I cling to You in Your knowledge and
In the grace that You scatter on the land,
Invisible in time, and slow to view,
A tinkle on the eardrum of the shrew.

18 Their bows shall sever the young men,
They'll have no pity on the den
Of the womb, their eye shall not spare
Even the children *in their care*.

19 And Babylon of kingdoms' prize,
The beauty of the Chaldees' eyes,
Shall be as when Alohims cast
Sodom and Gomorrah out fast.

20 It shall not be inhabited,
Nor dwelt in from the ages' bid,
Neither shall Arab pitch his tent,
Nor shepherds make their fold prevent.

21 But wild beasts of the desert way
Shall take refuge in the town's sway,
The ruins shall be full of sound
Of doleful creatures on the ground,
And owls shall perch above, below
Shall satyrs dance around *and slow*.

22 The wild beasts of the islands crow
In their desolate houses' show,
And dragons in their palaces;
And her time's near ready to fizz,
And her days shall not fail to go.

While prophecy and preacher make the
claim

That Babylon is desolate of fame,
The dwelling of the beast and doleful bird,
I find the opposite in kind's occurred.
I've met three men of Babylon and found
That they remember streets and shops
around,

And houses and some gardens filled with
trees,

Or else with date palms stiff against the
breeze.

Of course the centre that they pine for's not
Exactly on the ancient glory's spot.

That place is where the tourists come to
trot,

Or did so before war again in plot
Came in with rush and push and tinny lot
To smother what was left in store to please.

Isaiah 14

1 For YHWH will have mercy on Jacob,
And choose Israel and make them wake up
In their own land, and strangers shall
Be joined with them, and so they shall
Stick to the house of Jacob well.

2 The folk shall take them, they shall bring
Them to their place, *and to their spring*,
And Israel's house shall keep them in
The land of YHWH for servants' bin
And handmaids; they shall take captive
Those whose captives they'd had to live,
And they shall rule their oppressors.

3 It will happen the day that YHWH
Give you rest from sorrow *and rue*,
And from your fear, and from hard work
From which you could not stop *nor shirk*,

4 You'll take up this proverb *for scores*
Against the king of Babylon,
And say "How have the oppressors
Been turned aside, the bosses gone!"

5 YHWH's broken the wicked one's staff,
The sceptre of the rulers' *gaff*.

6 The one who struck the folk in wrath,
Kept beating them down *in their path*,
The one who in anger ruled such
Nations is down without a touch.

As I review the mass under the dome,
It seems to me that factions done in Rome
Are indicating that Babylon's fall
Extends beyond the Middle Eastern pall.
When Cyrus came to burrow under wall,
It was just the beginning of the squall.
The faith of Babylon is weak indeed,
It bends before the wind like fragile reed,
It blows before the gale and winging seed.
And yet it still remains alternative
To keeping of Your law, live and let live.
The bosses are a broken crucifix,

But still they mutter, peep, and show their tricks.

Beloved, I turn to You and what You give.

7 The whole earth is at rest and peace,
They burst in song never to cease.

8 Even the cypresses rejoice
Cedars of Lebanon lift voice,
Since you're laid down no woodsman
comes

Up against us *with axe and hums*.

9 Sheol beneath is moved for you
To meet you at your coming too,
It wakens up the dead for you,
All the chief ones that on earth grew,
It's raised up from their thrones all kings
Of all the nations *in their rings*.

10 They shall all speak and say to you,
"Have you also become weak too
As we are? Have you joined our crew?"

In allegory Isaiah returns

To make the very dead speak from their urns.

Who thinks this text makes souls immortal
earns

The foolishness he finds upon the burns.
I've seen the urns of dead and stayed to hear

What messages they whisper in the ear,
And testify now once and for all time:
The dead speak not in prose nor yet in rhyme.

Beloved, I wait for that day when the living
Of earth find rest, the very rest You're
giving,

In judgement now and in the future clime,
In Sabbath week by week and in the way
That rest from evil deeds shall once bear sway.

The meanwhile I whirl and dance on a
dime.

11 Your pomp is brought down to the
grave,

The sound of your viols *for knave*,
The worms are spread out under you,
And worms cover you *from the view*.

12 How you've fallen from heaven, bright
star,

Son of the morning! How you are
Cut to the ground, you who came to

Conquer the nations weakened through!
14 "I'll rise above the heights of cloud,
I'll be like the most High *allowed*."

15 Yet you'll be brought down to sheol,
To the sides of the pit *for goal*.

16 Those who see you shall closely look
On you, consider *like a book*,

"Is this the man that made earth shake,
The troubled kingdoms in his wake;

17 That made the world a wilderness,
Destroying cities at a guess,

Did not open prisons' address?"

18 All kings of nations, all of them,
Lie in glory, in his own gem.

19 But you're thrown out of your grave like
Abominable branch or spike,

Like the clothing of those who're slain
In battle of the sword in vain,

That go down to stones of the pit,
A carcass trodden down unfit.

20 You'll not join them in burial,
Because you destroyed your landfall,
And killed your people, wicked spawn
Shall never be renowned *when gone*.

21 Prepare the slaughter for his sons,
For wicked deeds their fathers' runs,
So they do not rise nor possess
The land, nor fill up world's address
With cities *glowing in their mess*.

I'm not sure by these words which king is
meant,

The king of Babylon and those he sent
To conquer the fair city, or the one
Who held sweet Babylon under the sun,
Saddam Husseyn, to take a name in vain
That represents a man beside the main
Of the Euphrates that was Yours and true.
Anyway, when I saw bedraggled view
Of Saddam I could not believe the man
Was he who had killed so many by plan.
Dragged out of his hole in the earth and
span

By those as sinister or more than he,
He was untidy and forlorn to see.
It does not pay to be Babylon's brew.

22 "For I will rise up against them,"
Says YHWH of hosts, "and cut of gem
Of Babylon, and all the rest,
The son and nephew with the best,"
Says YHWH. 23 I'll give it to possess

Unto the bittern, water pools;
I'll sweep it with destruction's tools,"
Says YHWH of hosts. 24 For YHWH has
sworn

Saying "Surely as my thought's born,
So shall it come to pass, I warn,
As I've decided it shall stand.
25 "I'll break Assyrian in My land,
And on My mountains tread him down,
Then shall his yoke fall with a frown,
His weight from their shoulders in span."

26 This is the purpose that's decided
On the whole earth, hand underid
Stretched out on all nations presided.
27 For YHWH of hosts has purposed it,
And who shall abrogate His fit?
And His hand is stretched out *in claim*,
And who shall quench *His fiery flame*?

True it is that Assyrian chiefs are gone,
Cut down before the budding of the dawn.
Both Babylon and Nineveh retain
A place where travellers may come not in
vain

To contemplate how human power and
wealth

Diminish in a year and as by stealth.
The yoke of the oppressor always falls
And tumbles from the city and its walls.
None can keep up the ragged wrath of
kings,

None can remain in power when power
swings.

Beloved, You only rule and that's because
As Sovereign and Creator, it's Your laws
That sway the universe, not those whose
paws

Come raging for a share of empty flaws.

28 In the year that king Ahaz died,
This vision rose up *by my side*.

29 Rejoice not, all of Palestine,
Because the rod that struck your mine
Is broken, for out of the root
Of the serpent shall come the boot
Of cockatrice, and so his fruit
Is fiery flying dragon soot.

30 The firstborn of the poor shall eat,
The needy lie down for a treat,
And I will destroy your root by
The famine, and he shall come nigh
To slay what's left of your spawn's sty.

31 Howl, O gate; cry, O city; you,
The whole of Palestinian crew,
Are melted, for there shall come down
From the north a smoke *on your crown*,
And none shall be left *standing in*
The times appointed *for his din*.
32 What's to be said then to the men
Sent by the nation from their den?
"That YHWH has set the fortress fast,
And His folk's poor shall trust at last."

The prophecy upon the Gaza strip
Tells of the fire of dragons and the grip
Of famine and the pestilence that tries
To redden already darkened sea skies.
I care not which poor come to eat at noon,
Whether the Jew or Arab with a spoon
Of silver or of pewter or of plate.
I care not for the coming of the state.
Beloved, my poor anarchist soul shrinks
back

From every form of violence in slack
And prays that all might live on the right
track,

And keep the commandments You once
proclaimed

On Sinai in Arabia the famed.
Beloved, look on Philistia's new lack.

Isaiah 15

1 The weight of sight in Moab's wake.
Because in one night was laid waste
Ar of Moab, and brought to lake
Of silence, because in the haste
Of one night Kir of Moab fell,
Laid in the silence *of a well*,

2 He's gone up to Bajith, and to
Dibon, the high places *on cue*
To weep; Moab shall howl upon
Nebo, and on Medeba drawn;
On all their heads is baldness set,
And every beard cut off *that's met*.

3 In their streets they shall wear sackcloth,
On their house-tops and in the trough
Of their streets every one shall howl,
Weeping with furrowed face and scowl.

4 Heshbon shall cry and Elealeh:
Their voice shall be heard to *the lea*
Of Jahaz; therefore the armed men
Of Moab shall cry out again,
Their life a grief to them *in den*.

5 My heart shall cry out for Moab;

His fugitives to Zoar's tab,
 A heifer three years old *with flab*:
 For by ascent of Luhith they
 Shall go up in weeping to sway;
 For in the way of Horonaim,
 They shall raise up a cry in rhyme
 Of its destruction *in its time*.
 6 Nimrim's waters are desolate:
 The hay is in a withered state,
 The grass fails, there is no green thing.
 7 Therefore their gear's abounding,
 And what they've laid up under pillows
 They'll bear off to the brook of willows.
 8 The cry is raised on Moab's borders,
 The howling unto Eglaim's hoarders,
 Its howling up to Beerelim.
 9 Dimon's waters are full of blood,
 I'll bring on Dimon like a flood
 Lions escaped from Moab's band,
 Upon the remnant of the land.

I've ridden not far from the well of gods
 And seen the dried and grey bush pods
 That wait the coming of the latter rain
 To bring them from their withering and
 pain.
 The centuries lie heavy on the land
 Of Moab just across the Dead Sea's sand,
 And all the azurine above its green
 Reflects the furnace burning on the scene.
 The hills of Dibon peer above the stream
 Of Arnon and reach northward to the dream
 Of Medeba from where I gaze upon
 Them from Engedi's sunset overdrawn,
 A blaze of colour, fire and purple gauze,
 That witness still the glory of Your laws.

Isaiah 16

1 Send a lamb to chief of the land,
 From the sea to the burning sand
 Of wilderness, and to the mount
 Of Zion's daughter *in account*.
 2 It shall be as a wandering bird
 Forced from the nest, the daughters stirred
 From Moab come to Arnon ford.
 3 Bring counsel and make judgement right,
 Make as night your shadow in light
 Of noon, hide outcasts, wandering ones
 Do not reveal *before the guns*.
 4 My refugees abide in you,
 O Moab, be a secret pew
 To hide them, from destroyer's face,

For ceased is the oppressor's race,
 Come to an end destroyer's mace,
 Devoured the spoilers of land's due.
 5 Set up in kindness is the throne,
 And sat down on it is truth's own,
 In David's tabernacle sent,
 Judging and searching out judgement,
 Swift doing righteousness alone.
 6 We've heard of Moab's pride, so proud,
 His proudful arrogance and loud
 Wrath, wrong are the ways he's allowed.
 7 So Moab shall lament Moab,
 Howling over all its confab,
 For grape-cakes of Kir-Hareseth
 It murmurs, they are struck *to death*.

While Moab may lament the sun and dross,
 The desert and the barren lands in loss,
 The throne of David, that eternal thing,
 Is still deserted of a reigning king
 In sight upon the earth. I trow the weight
 Of rulership and burden of the state
 Lies on the living shoulders of some man,
 But that is rule of faith and not the span
 Of sight. My eyes have not found to relate
 A vision of that blessed face and eye.
 I once in Makkah searched as I could try
 To find appointed master under sky,
 But no voice that I heard admitted such,
 And I found no face that could tell as
 much.

8 Because the fields of Heshbon wait
 In fallow, the vine in the gate
 Of Sibmah, lords of nations beat
 Her chosen vines, to Jazer's *street*
 They've come, wandered a wilderness,
 Her plants have spread *from their duress*,
 And gone over the sea's *retreat*.
 9 So I'll join Jazer's lamentation,
 Sibmah's vine, I'll give you a ration
 Of my tears, Heshbon and *the ray*
 Of Elealeh, because the day
 Of Your summer fruits and harvest,
 The sound of joy's failed *in the west*.
 10 And gladness and rejoicing are
 Removed out from the vineyards' *car*;
 And they shall not at all tread wine
 Into the vats, I've made rejoice
 Their joy with stillness of the vine.
 11 That's why my belly shall make sound
 Like a harp for Moab when downed,

My insides for Kir-Haresh bound.
 12 It will happen, when it is seen
 That Moab is tired of the scene
 Of the high place, that he shall come
 To his holy house in prayer's hum,
 But he shall never intervene.
 13 This is the vision's word that YHWH
 Has spoken about Moab due
 Since that time *that had been in view*.
 14 But now YHWH's spoken and He's said
 "Within three years, as the years bled
 Of a hired worker, and the shine
 Of Moab shall be despised vine
 With all that great crowd, and the rest
 Shall be but small and weak at best."

The din of raucous rock let none despise
 Who chorus with the hawk upon the skies
 Of music classical today that peaks
 In horrid decibel musicians' cheeks.
 There may be difference in cultural
 That hears the blatant voice unmusical
 Of what in the king's English is the growl
 Of stomach of no creature on the prowl.
 The penetrating sound is very slight,
 And yet was once compared to harps so
 light
 That those who live after Beethoven's ear
 Cannot imagine sounds so soft to hear.
 The still small voice, and not the storm at
 noon,
 Is the word that's divine when it's in tune.

Isaiah 17

1 The vision of Damascus. See,
 Damascus now has ceased to be
 A city, it shall be a heap
 Of ruin. 2 Aroer in keep
 Of its towns is forsaken, they
 Shall be for flocks that come each day
 To lie there and none drive away.
 3 The fortress of Ephraim shall cease,
 The reign of Damascus decrease,
 The rest of Aram, they shall be
 Like children of Israel's glory,
 Says YHWH of hosts *and says plainly*.
 4 It shall come to pass in that day,
 The honour of Jacob give way,
 His body fat shall fall away.
 5 It shall be as when reaper takes
 The standing corn and with his shakes
 Pulls down the ears, and it shall be

As one that harvests in valley
 Of Rephaim. 6 Still gleaned grapes
 Shall be left in it, as the drapes
 Of olive trees, two or three fruits
 In the top of the twigs from roots,
 Four or five on the outmost twig,
 Says YHWH Israel's Alohims big.

Three things arise in songs of hope and fear
 That prophesy the loss of land and gear:
 Three staffs that are like sisters Iroquoian,
 The maize, the squash, the bean are not a
 toy one;
 Three healers and providers of all men
 And women that inhabit dell and glen
 Of the land that was once promised to those
 Who followed Abraham in gallant rows.
 The barley and the wheat are first in line,
 And then the grape from which comes out
 the wine
 In sweetness of the winepress, and the late
 And ancient olive tree to be their mate.
 Three sisters everywhere are gifts divine
 To nourish all the world of small and great.

7 That day a man looks to his Maker,
 His eyes turned with respect of faqir
 To the Saint of Israel *and shaker*.
 8 He'll not regard the altars set
 Up by his hands, nor shall regret
 Respecting what fingers have made,
 Nor groves nor images' parade.
 9 In that day shall his strong towns be
 Like a forsaken bough on tree,
 And like an uppermost branch they
 Left for children of Israel's sway:
 There shall be desolation's way.
 10 Since you've forgotten Alohims
 Of your salvation, did not dream
 Of the rock of your strength, therefore
 You'll plant abundant plants in store,
 With a strange slip sowed in the score.
 11 The light of day you'll make plants
 grow,
 And morning light your seeds to show,
 But harvest is a heap of clay
 In hopeless sorrow and grief's day.
 12 Woe to the multitude of folk
 Who make noise like the sea-waves' stroke,
 And to the rushing nations who
 Pour out like mighty waters' view!
 13 The nations shall rush like the sound

Of many waters on the ground,
 But *God* shall rebuke them and they
 Shall flee and shall be chased away
 Like mountain's chaff before the wind,
 Like tumbleweed before whirlwind.
 See how at evening horrors rise,
 By morning he's gone before eyes.
 This is the future of those who
 Spoil us, and of the robber crew.

The robber is known not by what he takes
 From bin and store, or from the field, or
 shakes

From apple tree upon the night he wakes.
 The robber is not known by what is found
 As stolen in his hand or on his ground,
 Because he knows to use darkness and
 stealth

When he acquires his neighbour's stock
 and wealth.

The robber is best known instead by sound
 Of what he makes called music on the
 round.

The greater din he spreads through walls
 and roof

Heard at a distance like washer or hoof,
 The more his hand has been sunk in deceit:
 His music proclaims guilt in his retreat.
 Beloved, I plug my ears and keep aloof.

Isaiah 18

1 Ho, land under shadow of wings,
 Beyond the Ethiopian springs:
 2 That sends ambassadors by sea,
 Boats of bulrushes on the sea,
 "Go swiftly, messengers to that
 Nation scattered and peeled *of fat*,
 To a folk terrible to see
 From their beginning *of the spree*
 To this day, a nation in line
 And trodden down, whose land *and vine*
 The rivers have spoiled in *decline*."

3 All you dwellers upon the earth,
 Inhabitants of the world's berth,
 See when the flag is lifted up,
 Hear trumpet's blowing *like a tup*.

4 For so YHWH has spoken to me:
 "I rest and look out on My place,
 As a clear heat on the herb's face,
 As a thick cloud upon the dew
 With the day of harvest in view.

5 "For before harvest, when the bloom

Is full, and the blossom gives room
 To unripe fruit, then someone's cut
 The sprigs with pruning shears, the strut
 Of branches turned aside from rut.

6 "They shall be left abandoned there
 To the fowls of mountains and air,
 And to the beasts upon the earth;
 And the birds shall find summer berth
 Upon them and all earthly beasts
 Shall spend the winter on their *feasts*."

7 At that time find a present brought
 To YHWH of hosts, a nation's lot
 Drawn out and peeled, even a folk
 Afraid from the start of the stroke,
 A nation measured out by line,
 And trodden down, with lowlands spoiled,
 Into the place where they have toiled
 In name of YHWH of hosts' account,
 The fortress of Zion and mount.

Beloved, when humankind is cut down
 bare,

And life and land and water in their share
 Refuse to nourish man's society,
 I praise You that the birds and beasts go
 free.

Where fields no longer grow the staff and
 turn

Supporting soldier and merchant to earn,
 The spring finds something rising from the
 waste,

A new creation without hope or haste.

I've seen the desolation pour upon
 The church and state from midnight
 without dawn,

I've seen the fall of Rome and Babylon.
 But in my seeing where the cups lie broken
 I find a new prayer and a lively token
 In sprigs of trees some birchen and some
 oaken.

Isaiah 19

1 The vision against Egypt. See,
 YHWH rides upon a swift cloud and
 Shall come down into Egypt's land:
 The idols of Egypt shall be
 Moved at His presence, and the heart
 Of Egypt shall melt *at His dart*.

2 I'll set Egyptian against brother,
 And they shall fight against each other,
 And every one against his neighbour,
 Town against town with vim and labour.

3 The spirit of Egypt shall fail
 In the middle, and I'll prevail
 Against its plans, and they shall seek
 Their idols and charmers to peek
 By their familiar spirits, and
 To wizards spread *across the land*.
 4 And the Egyptians will I give
 Over to a cruel lord *to live*,
 A fierce king shall rule over them,
 Says the Lord YHWH of hosts *to them*.
 5 The waters shall fail from the sea,
 The river waste, dried in degree.
 6 They'll turn the rivers far away,
 Brooks of defence emptied to stay,
 The reeds and flags withered *in clay*.
 7 Papyrus by the brooks and at
 The mouth of streams, all things that sat
 There shall wither and blow away.
 8 The fishermen also shall mourn,
 And all that cast a rod forlorn
 Into the brooks, and they that spread
 Nets on the waters shall see dread.

Egypt through all her history has found
 The greatest disaster upon the ground
 Is when the river did not rise to feed
 The land with muck and truck, black soil in
 greed.

The water is the mainstay of the land,
 The hope, the history, the divine hand
 That moulded once the civilized to stand.
 The river is the greatest god of need.
 You always strike the heart of staff and
 bread,

You always appeal to both cart and head,
 And make the human eye see what with
 dread

You threaten on both goal and body wed.
 And yet acquaintance and admission
 bought
 At violence fails when the time is caught.

9 They also that work in fine flax,
 That weave their gauzy cloth in stacks,
 Shall be confounded in their lacks.
 10 Its foundations shall be struck down,
 The wage-earner troubled with frown.
 11 The princes of Zoan are fools,
 The counsels of the wise men's schools
 To Pharaoh just make beastly sense.
 How do you tell Pharaoh from hence,
 "I am the son of a wise clan,

Of ancient kings *under the ban?*"

12 Where are they, where are your wise
 men?

And let them inform you again,
 And let them know what YHWH of hosts
 Has planned for Egypt *and its boasts*.

13 Such fools princes of Zoan are,
 Princes of Noph raised to a star,
 They also have seduced Egypt,
 The stay of the tribes *in their crypt!*

14 YHWH's mixed a perverse spirit there,
 And they have caused Egypt to err
 In every action, like a drunk
 Staggering, in his vomit sunk.

15 There shall be no work for Egypt,
 No matter what it tries, it's slipped.

16 In that day Egypt shall be like
 Women to tremble at the strike,
 The shaking hand of YHWH of hosts,
 Which He raises against its *boasts*.

I too take honour and fame from the past,
 My grand ancestors, fleeting ghosts outcast
 Upon the western shores of Carrick and
 Upon the hills of Appalachian stand.

I too look back to some, whether as kings,
 Still as the influential in the rings,
 And praise them for their wisdom and their
 thought,

Their actions on the land, the cows they
 bought.

Whatever unsent ghost perverse in me,
 As I follow Your great command to be
 In honour of parent and ancestry,
 I beg You cast out on the tundra free
 To wander far never more to be caught.

17 And the land of Judah shall be
 A terror to Egypt's degree,
 Every one who remembers it
 Shall fear in heart and have a fit,
 For the counsel of YHWH of hosts,
 Which He has raised against its boasts.

18 In that day shall five cities in
 Egypt's land speak Canaan's tongue and
 Swear to YHWH of hosts *in their sin*,
 And one be called destruction's band.

Whatever's said of Assyria, I find
 The Coptic tongue is lost to every mind
 That walks in Egypt now, instead I hear
 Something so like the Canaanite a tear

Of far nostalgia dampens me resigned.
 Egyptians all today speak the rough speech
 Of Canaan and the Arabic to preach
 Upon the tops of minbars where the stone
 Still witnesses that Allah's God alone,
 Muhammad is Your prophet and Ali
 Is still Your friend and comfort and wali.
 Whatever reinforcements man may take
 From history to the Egyptian stake,
 Today the prophecy's true in its wake.

19 In that day an altar to YHWH
 Shall be raised before Egypt's crew,
 A pillar of witness shall rear
 To YHWH beside it's border *dear*.
 20 And it shall be there for a sign
 And for a witness of design
 To YHWH of hosts in Egypt's land,
 For they shall cry to YHWH and stand
 Before oppressors, and He'll send
 To them a saviour and one great
 Who will deliver them *in state*.
 21 And YHWH shall be known to Egypt,
 The Egyptians that day unclipped
 Shall know YHWH and make sacrifice
 And oblation; they'll in a trice
 Vow a vow to YHWH, make it nice.
 22 YHWH shall attack Egypt, He'll smite
 And heal it, and they'll come to light
 Before YHWH, and He'll hear their plaint
 And He shall heal them *from constraint*.
 23 In that day there'll be a highway
 From Egypt to Assyria,
 And the Assyrian shall come
 Into Egypt and *at the drum*
 Egyptians to Assyria,
 And the Egyptians, they shall serve
 Assyrians *as they deserve*.
 24 In that day shall Israel be third
 With Egypt and Assyrian herd,
 A blessing in the middle of
 The continents *with faith and love*,
 25 Whom YHWH of hosts shall bless and
 say,
 "Blessed by Egypt My folk to stay,
 Assyria the work of My hands,
 And Israel My heritage bands."

The pillar raised in Elephantine bears
 Witness to You, Beloved, though unawares
 Perhaps that You remain hidden, unseen,
 Even upon Egyptian's burning screen.

There was an altar and there was a house
 Built in Your honour, as though nibbling
 mouse
 Had torn the temple of Jerusalem
 Out of the earth, both branch and root and
 stem.
 Beloved, though I am not Egyptian nor
 Arab nor even Israelite in score,
 I find the altar on the desert sand,
 I find Your name and Your oblation stand
 Still witness beneath crescent moon and
 where
 The people come in pilgrimage to share.

Isaiah 20

1 The year Tartan came to Ashdod,
 Sent by Sargon Assyrian king,
 And fought with and conquered Ashdod,
 2 At the same time YHWH said a thing
 By Isaiah son of Amoz,
 Saying "Go out now and make loose
 The sackcloth from your waist and put
 Again your shoe from off your foot."
 And so he did, and walked around
 Naked and barefoot on the ground.
 3 And YHWH said "As My servant true
 Isaiah has walked nude in view
 And barefoot for three years to be
 A sign and wonder for to see
 In Egypt and Ethiopia,
 4 "So shall the king of Assyria
 Lead captive the Egyptians sold,
 And Ethiopians young and old,
 Naked and barefoot in the cold,
 Even with bare backsides unshipped
 And to the shame of *all* Egypt.
 5 "And they shall be afraid and shamed
 Let down by Ethiopia blamed,
 And by Egypt their glory claimed.
 6 The dweller on this coast shall say
 In that day, "See our confidence,
 Where shall we flee for help in tents
 From the Assyrian king and how
 Shall we escape *the broken bough*?"

Your prophet, my Beloved, went out to
 show
 His bare ass in the street and in the glow
 Of market in the biggest town I know
 Of ancient times, and he is still revered
 By Christian and by Jew and all such
 steered.

When Quakers stuck a butt out into view,
 When Doukhobors took to the streets bare
 too,
 The people pointed fingers then and
 laughed
 At the insanity that they had quaffed.
 That only shows, Beloved, that people now
 Are worse than any pagans in the row
 That they disdain and condemn with a look
 Of arrogance. Beloved, I cannot brook
 The infidelity around my nook.

Isaiah 21

1 The vision of the wilderness.
 As whirlwinds in the south address,
 It comes up from the wilderness,
 From horrors of a burdened land.
 2 A hard vision's declared to me:
 The robber robs in robber band,
 The spoiler spoils and grievously.
 Go up, O Elam, and besiege,
 O Media, all sighing's liege
 Have I made cease *upon the sand*.
 3 Therefore my loins are filled with pain,
 Pangs seize me as pangs of a lain
 Woman in labour, I'm bowed down
 To hear, dismayed to see *the frown*.
 4 My heart is palpitating and
 Fearful trembling takes by the hand,
 The twilight of my hope He's made
Caravan of fears on parade.
 5 Set table and a watchman, eat
 And drink, get up, princes and beat
 Oil on the shields. 6 For so's the Lord
 Said to me, "Go set with a sword
 A watchman, let him tell aloud
 What he can see *beyond the crowd*.
 7 He saw a chariot with a few
 Of horsemen, cart of asses' crew,
 A chariot that camels drew,
 And listened carefully *unbowed*.

The life of Bedouin upon the sand
 Is fraught with dangers always from the
 band
 Of robbing neighbours set to distribute
 The wealth that must be shared to keep in
 boot
 Society upon the desert root.
 I've seen the wastelands and bent down
 with care
 To find the secret life the deserts share.

There is a parallel under the glare
 Of tundra on my right hand where I stare
 Across saw-toothed horizon stretched out
 bare

From here to eastward to Vladivostok.
 The ptarmigan joins chorus of the roc.
 Beloved, I set my table in the shade
 Of logs instead of tent, and tightly laid.

8 He shouted with a lion's voice,
 "Sir, I stand always *as the choice*
 Upon the watchtower in the day,
 And I'm set in my ward to stay
 Whole nights and looking out *for prey*.
 9 "And see, here comes a chariot and
 A few of horsemen in a band."
 And he replied and so he said
 "Babylon's fallen, fallen dread,
 And all the graven images
 Of her gods by the power of His
 Hand has He shattered to the ground.
 10 "O my threshing and my corn's floor:
 I've heard the YHWH of hosts deplore,
 The Alohim of Israel found,
 I have declared to you the sound."

The theory is that Bedouin estate
 Is not a primitive form of the late,
 But rather a rejection in the style
 Of Abraham who left Ur with its guile
 And went to invent on the desert sand
 A planned culture and faith in desert band.
 The concept was that Babylon the great
 Was fallen because it did not succeed
 In making a society sans greed.
 Babylon is fallen became the cry
 Over the centuries where some rely
 On the simplicity of life instead
 Of graven idols and monuments spread.
 I flee from Babylon in desert led.

11 The vision of Dumah. He's called
 Me out of Seir, "Watchman appalled,
 What of the night? Watchman appalled,
 What of the night?" 12 The watchman said
 "The morning comes, also the dread
 Night. If you will enquire, enquire,
 But come back once more *from the dire*."
 13 The vision on Arabia's land.
 You'll stay in the forest in band
 In Arabia, travelling ones
 Of Dedanim *hot on your buns*.

14 The dwellers in Tema's land brought
 Water to the thirsty one caught,
 And bread before the fugitive.
 15 For they fled from the swords to live,
 From the drawn sword, from the bent bow,
 And from the grievous battle's show.
 16 For so has said the Lord to me,
 "Within a year, as the rents be,
 Shall falter all Kedar's glory;
 17 The bowmen left, the mighty men
 Of the children of Kedar's glen,
 Shall be diminished, because YHWH
 Israel's Alohim says it's true."

The glory that was Kedar and was built
 On fallen Babylon for grace and silt
 Has made its try over the centuries,
 And I have seen the trial's expertise
 In the establishment of Islam's ease,
 And found the disappointment that arose
 When that in human hearts that must
 oppose
 Your law, Your messengers, Your books in
 rose,
 Your sovereignty as Friday evening's
 close.
 Beloved, I take Islam, submission to
 You in the peace that crushes the nafs'
 view,
 And leave the institutions that retain
 That of old Babylon in idol's stain,
 The thread of dawn in black and white in
 dew.

I fled the sweet Christian who placed the
 blade
 Of his Gospel's knife in my back and
 stayed
 To hear the Sunnite message on parade.
 I ate the good bread's hospitality,
 I drank the pure water and coke for free,
 And found that this too was a company
 Of violence just like the Christian spree.
 The glory in a year's departed, but
 I find the secret chamber closed and shut
 From all the world's sin and iniquity.
 There I commune in peace with hidden
 souls
 Invisible to church and mosquely shoals,
 Blessed by the presence of ascended men
 Who represent Your will to earth again.

Isaiah 22

1 The prophecy of vision's vale.
 What is it now that makes you ail,
 Makes you go to the rooftops' tale?
 2 You city filled with shouting ones,
 City of tumult, joy that stuns,
 Your slain have not fallen by sword,
 Have not died in the battle gored.
 3 All your chiefs in band flee the bow,
 Bound captive are all in your show,
 Fleeing as far as they can go.
 4 So I said "Look away from me;
 And I shall weep much bitterly,
 Do not try to comfort me now,
 Since my folk's daughter's spoiled in row."
 5 For it's a day of trouble, and
 Of treading down *upon the sand*,
 And of perplexity *as ghosts*
 And beside the Lord YHWH of hosts
 In the vale of vision to break
 Down the walls and set up a *stake*
Of crying for the mountains' sake.
 6 And Elam's borne a quiver set
 In a chariot of horsemen met,
 And Kir has raised a shield *to let*.
 7 It shall take place your finest vales
 Shall be full of chariots, *like gales*
 The horsemen shall come in array
 At the gate *on that judgement day*.

For weeping I cannot repeat Your words,
 I hear the melodies like voice of birds,
 But sink within the vision's valley here
 To curse the world around me without fear,
 And bless the earth itself for quiet tear.
 What glory to be human in this place!
 What wealth of rage to know the human
 race!
 What excellence of beauty in the grace
 Of snowflake and of birchen branches dark
 Against the shine of whiteness in the park!
 Beloved, the wrenching pain of being
 makes
 A joyful croak come from my throat for
 sakes
 Of shouting in the city while the slain
 Are without sword or bullet, without pain.

8 He took away the veil of Judah,
 And you that day looked on the ruder
 Armour of the house of the woods.
 9 You've also seen the breach in goods

Of David's city manifold,
 And brought the waters deep *and cold*.
 10 You've counted houses in the town
 Jerusalem, and broken down
 The houses to build up the wall.
 11 A ditch also you did install
 Between the two walls for the flow
 Of water from the old pool's stow;
 But you've not looked unto its maker,
 Nor had respect for him to shaker
 Once long ago. 12 And in that day
 Did Adonai YHWH call to sway
 Of weeping and mourning and to
 Baldness and wearing sackcloth too.
 13 See joy and gladness, slaying oxen,
 And killing sheep, eating the toxin
 Of flesh and drinking wine to spue:
 Let us eat and drink for tomorrow
 We'll all die with or without sorrow.
 14 And it was revealed in my ears
 By YHWH of hosts, for the arrears
 Of this iniquity shall not
 Be cleansed from you until you rot,
 Says the Lord YHWH of hosts *in lot*.

The vasty world lays blame upon the
 Roman
 Philosopher of early time for combing
 His hair with pleasures of the day not
 thinking
 Of what catastrophe lies by his blinking.
 Fact is the blame if blame at all must fall
 Upon the sweetly Christian in the stall
 Who takes his bread and wine as due to call
 The flesh of Christ so he'll not die at all
 With or without a sorrow on the pall.
 Beloved, cleanse not indeed iniquity
 That trumps by human sacrifice to see
 The glories of celestial finity.
 Let crumbs of broadly flesh all be
 congealed
 With mould upon the wined and wondered
 field.

15 So says the Lord YHWH of *His* hosts,
 "Flee to your treasurers *of roasts*,
 To Shebna over the house boasts.
 16 "*Say then*, 'What have you here, and
 whom
 Do you have here as though for doom
 In sepulchre, one has cut out
 Himself a sepulchre's redoubt

On high and burrowed for himself
 A dwelling place on the rock shelf?
 17 "See, YHWH will carry you away
 Into great captivity's sway,
 Cast up and down in every way.
 18 "He'll throw you up and throw you
 down,
 And cast you out upon the town,
 Where you will die and where the carts
 Of your honour shall shame the parts
 Of your master's palace's arts.
 19 "And I will drive you from your station,
 And from your state and from your nation
 He shall pull you down from your ration.
 20 "And it shall happen in that day,
 That I will call My slave at bay,
 Eliakim son of Hilkiah:
 21 "I'll dress him with your cloak's attire,
 And strengthen him up with your belt,
 And give to his hand all the welt
 Of your rule, and he'll be a dad
 To inhabitants of the *sad*
 Jerusalem and Judah's pad.
 22 "The key of David's house I'll lay
 Upon his shoulder *for a ray*,
 So he shall open and none shut,
 And he shall shut and none rebut.
 23 "I'll fasten him as with a nail
 In a firm place, and in that pale
 He'll be for throne of honour there
 To *all* his father's house *and share*.
 24 "And they shall hang on him the glory
 Of all his father's house *in story*,
 The offspring and the issue too,
 And all the vessels, though a few,
 From vessels of cups even to
 All vessels of flagons *in view*.
 25 "In that day,' says the YHWH of hosts,
 'Shall the nail fastened to firm posts
 Be drawn out and cut down and fall,
 The burden there upon the wall
 Shall be cut off, for YHWH speaks all.'"

When good St. John saw in the visions bold
 That the key of David both hard and cold
 Should be granted the victor from the hold,
 He did not mention that his name was told.
 Eliakim fulfils the prophecy
 And leaves apocalyptic forgery
 To fight for right to the death of the spree.
 Beloved, is there no hope in this world now
 That all the writs of ancient time and brow

Have turned to dust beneath the tells
somehow?

The vessels are all taken in the wake
Of the invader long since sent to bake,
The morning dawns in silent glory where
You speak no more in audible sound's
share.

Isaiah 23

1 The vision against Tyre. Howl, ships
Of Tarshish, it's laid waste in slips,
So that there is no house nor gate,
From the land of Chittim the rate
Is revealed to them *in stalemate*.
2 Be still, you dwellers of the isle;
You whom Sidonian mercantile
Transported by ship pile on pile.
3 And by great waters Sihor's seed
The harvest of the river breed
Is her revenue; she's the mart
Of nations. 4 Then take shame to start,
O Sidon; for the sea has spoken,
The pounding of the sea and broken,
Saying "I do not go in labour
Nor bring forth children like the neighbour,
Nor do I nourish up young men,
Nor nurture virgins *in my glen*."
5 As at the word of Egypt's state,
So shall they fall to meet their fate
At the report out of Tyre's gate.
6 Pass over to Tarshish and howl,
You inhabitants of the isle.
7 Is this your joyful town whose fame
Is of ancient days in its claim?
Her own feet shall carry her off
To sojourn *in lands where they scoff*.

Till Alexander came the city sat
Indeed upon an island autocrat.
I only wonder that Isaiah dares
To predict its demise as unawares.
By paying ransom Tyre survived the great
Attacks of Babylon to meet her fate
Under the Persians. Isaiah's word's late.
The house of Tyre is friend to David's
mate,
The builder of the temple and the rate
Of treasure cast up for Your honour here.
And yet the diatribe is raised for fear.
Beloved, the ships still ply the Middle Sea
To Tarshish, and the Hezbollah stands free
Above the rubble of far century.

8 Who's taken this plan against Tyre,
The crowning town whose merchants dire
Are princes, and whose traffickers
Are honourable of all earth's fers?

9 For YHWH of hosts has purposed it,
To stain the pride of glory fit,
And bring contempt on every wit
Honoured upon the earth *to sit*.
10 Pass throughout your land like a stream,
O daughter of Tarshish to dream,
There's no more strength *in what may
seem*.

11 He stretched his hand over the sea,
He shook the kingdoms in his spree,
YHWH's given a command to be
Against the merchant town and free,
To break down its castles' degree.
12 And He says "You'll no more rejoice,
Oppressed virgin of Sidon's choice,
Get up and go out to Chittim,
There too you'll have no rest *or vim*.
13 Look out to the Chaldean's land,
This folk did not exist in band
Till the Assyrian set them
To dwell in the wilderness' hem,
They set up its towers and they raised
Up its palaces to be praised,
But he brought it to ruin razed.
14 So howl, ships of Tarshish, for your
Strength is laid waste *upon the shore*.

Oppression of the virgin of Zion came
Upon Jerusalem's crusader fame,
And so the stain of honour is the chair
Where the archbishop used to sit and
swear.

Archbishop of Tyre one in heart to be
With patriarch of Jerusalem's see
Stands in an awful horror's parody
Of David and of Hiram in the hall
Of cedars and of Solomon on call.
For that, if anything, let the ships howl,
Not for the Persians', Greeks' and Roman's
cowl,
But for the pagan stain on Your name set
By human sacrifice in wafer met,
By blood of grapes for blood of lambs to
let.

15 And it shall happen in that day,
That Tyre in forgetfulness stay

For seventy years, as by the day
 Of one king; at the end of time
 Of seventy years shall Tyre in rhyme
 Sing like a prostitute *for crime*.
 16 Take a harp, go about the town,
 You harlot of destroyed renown,
 Make melody sweetly and sing
 Many songs for remembering.
 17 And it shall happen at the end
 Of seventy years, that YHWH will fend
 To visit Tyre, and she shall turn
 To her rents and again shall burn
 Committing fornication with
 All the kingdoms of the earth stiff.
 18 And her wares and her profits be
 Forfeit to YHWH, it shall not be
 Treasured nor stored up in the fee,
 For her merchandise is for those
 Who dwell before YHWH in their rows
 To eat enough and have good clothes.

These words refer to mainland Tyre at best,
 The city citadel stayed in her rest.
 The seventy years that felled Jerusalem
 Were felt also by Tyre's purple and gem.
 The world sees Tyre's importance in the
 way

She sold to every country in the sway
 Of Middle Sea, but Your prophetic say
 Turns rather to her prostitution's day,
 Her worshipping the gods forever guessed
 By human hearts who will not meet the test
 Of Your ten laws to humankind that free
 All beings from the waste of tyranny.
 That is the thing that still goes unconfessed.

Isaiah 24

1 See YHWH makes earth an empty place,
 A waste and turns it on its face,
 And scatters those who run the race.
 2 And it shall be, as with the folk,
 So with the priest, as under yoke
 The servant as with master too,
 As with the maid, so mistress too,
 As with the buyer so with him
 Who sells, as with the lender *dim*
 So with the borrower *in trim*,
 As with the one who takes the bribe
 Of usury, so with the tribe
 Who pay the usury to him.
 3 The land shall be made desolate,
 And utterly spoiled *for its fate*:

For YHWH has spoken this thing's *rate*.
 4 The earth mourns and it fades away,
 The world languishes in its day,
 The arrogant of earth astray.
 5 The earth's also defiled by those
 Who live upon it in their rows,
 Because they have transgressed the laws,
 And changed the ordinance, their claws
 Have broken the eternal pact.
 6 So the curse has come in to act,
 Devouring the earth and those sacked
 To dwell upon its desolation,
 And so the earth's dwellers in station
 Are burned and few remain intact.

From kingdoms in particular You turn
 Your face in judgement on the worldly
 burn,
 And take all nations under wrath and grace
 To see the mercy of Your divine face
 As well as the destruction of the race.
 Sennacherib came in to slay the world,
 A century after his flag unfurled
 Came Nebuchadnezzar, the man of fate,
 Who startled empires after him and late
 With head of gold. So here begins the curse
 Of empires of the world for bad and worse.
 Beloved, as I look on transgression of
 Your laws about me in the land of love,
 May my hand wear obedience's glove.

7 The grape juice mourns, the vine must
 wilt,
 All merrymakers sigh in silt.
 8 The joy of tabrets ends at last,
 The sound of rejoicing is past,
 The happy harp is done and cast.
 9 They'll not feast with a song and wine,
 Strong drink shall be bitter in sign
 To those who drink it *while they pine*.
 10 The town confused is broken down,
 Every house is shut with a frown
 So no one can enter the line.
 11 They shout in the streets lacking wine,
 All joy is darkened, land's mirth gone.
 12 The city's left without the dawn,
 The gate is struck down by design.

The surplus of the fields in barley's wake,
 The doubled row of kernels at the stake,
 Made possible the city and the town

Seen above fields of green, yellow and
brown.
If power had stopped with city states and
kings,
The world might have gone on in revellings
Of harvest innocence if such that be
That drinks a toast to Ashtoreth to see
If morning will be filled with the same glee
As afternoon beneath the wedding dance.
But no, the greed of kings takes up the
lance
And changes earth from reeling in the
trance
To rolling in the tribute under lash.
The wealth needed to survive's kept in
stash.

13 For so the land among the folk
Shall be like shaking at a stroke
Of olive tree, like gleanings grapes
When vintage is done *down to scrapes*.
14 They shall lift up their voice, they'll
sing
To the majesty of YHWH's wing,
They'll cry aloud from the sea's *sting*.
15 So glorify YHWH with bright flame,
YHWH Alohims of Israel's name
In the sea islands' *wandering*.

The land made barren by intensive care
To rob it for the royalty's own share
Has long lain under sun and star to bare
A single eye to colonizers where
The earth can be despoiled without despair
Of local deities entwined to shake
A finger with ancestral voice's take.
The land under the empires rattles with
The sound of dry pods and the stalks of
myth,
And yet through centuries of blight and kith
Unnatural, there rises on the air
The secret hymns of David come to make
The murmurings of Torah where they dare
Like coltsfoot breaking pavement in a cake.

16 From all the earth we have heard songs,
Glory to the righteous in throngs.
But I said "My leanness, leanness,
Woe to me and to my address,
The treacherous deal out deceit,
In treachery they are complete.
17 "Fear and the pit and snare on you,

Inhabitants of earth in crew.
18 "It shall happen the one who flees
From fearful rumours' panoplies
Shall fall into the pit, and he
That escapes from the pit *once free*
Shall be taken up in the snare,
For the windows above give share
And earth's foundations shake *and stare*.
19 The earth is wholly broken down,
The earth dissolved and gone each town,
The land is moved out from its lair.
20 The earth shall reel about like those
Drunken, and be moved in its throws
Like a hut strewn, iniquity
Shall be heavy on its degree,
And it shall fall never to rise.
21 It is a day not to despise,
YHWH shall punish the high one's host
Above, and the kings of their boast
Upon the earth below *their cries*.
22 They shall be gathered in a band,
As prisoners in a pit stand,
And they shall be shut up to stay,
Visited after many a day.
23 The moon shall be confounded, and
The sun ashamed, when YHWH of hosts
Shall reign in the mount Zion, and
Within Jerusalem for toasts
Before His elders *come to stand*.

The desecration laid upon the earth
In divine judgement seems beyond the
worth
Of humankind, all fallen and destroyed
Beneath the guns and galleons employed
By Your servants who come to take their
share
Before they too fall under the moon's ware.
The devastation is a thing so vast,
That help and hope glimmer, smoulder, and
cast
Upon the darkness fade and wither fast.
And yet the moon confounded shall look
down
Upon peaceful Jerusalem, the town
Caught after centuries of pain and spoil
Within the joy of sun once shamed in coil
Now shining on the reign of peace
compassed.

Isaiah 25

1 O YHWH, You *are* my God. I will

Exalt You, I will praise Your name,
 For You've done wonderful *things still*,
 Your counsels in ancient time *came*
 In faithfulness *and* truth. 2 For You
 Have made a city ruined *crew*,
 A fort a ruin, and palace
 Of foreigners to be a place
 No longer, it will never be
 Rebuilt. 3 Therefore the strong decree
 To glorify You, the city
 Of horrid nations fears Your spree.
 4 For You've been a strength to the poor,
 Strength to the needy at Your door,
 A refuge from the storm, a shade
 From the heat, when the great parade
 Of the attack is like a storm
 Against the wall in battering form.
 5 You shall bring down the strangers'
 voice,
 As the heat in a dry place' choice,
 Even the heat under the shade
 Of the cloud; the branch that has made
 Terrible ones shall be unstayed.

This great apocalypse and universal
 Betrayed from frozen lips before dispersal
 Of prophets from the sun and torrid night
 Shines out upon my world in splendid light.
 If David had sung sweeter melodies
 Before the throne of Saul brought to his
 knees,
 I might have looked with less wonder and
 spare
 Upon the dancing alphabets that share
 These syllables of sound upon the air.
 But David's song is just one strain among
 The glories that the heavenly watchers sung
 Beyond the sprinkled stars, beyond the late
 Great symphonies of sparrows at the gate.
 I praise You too, though hardly David's
 mate.

6 In this mountain shall YHWH of hosts
 Make for all folk a feast of roasts,
 A banquet of fine things in store,
 Fat in the marrow, refined more.
 7 He's swallowed up upon this mount
 The face of wrapping in account
 Over all nations *tantamount*.
 8 He'll swallow death in victory,
 And the Lord YHWH will wipe away
 Tears from off all faces that day,

And the rebuke of His folk He
 Shall take away from off the earth,
 For YHWH has spoken *in His worth*.

When good Isaiah wrote, if such he did,
 These words upon a shard or cooking lid,
 He hardly meant more than the hopeful bid
 That small Jerusalem set out in toil
 Against the monstrous empires out to spoil
 Might one day get the chance to bring her
 corn
 And oil and grape juice in without one
 warn
 The coming of the armies on the morn.
 But brave John of Apocalypse saw higher:
 He thought the world would one day be on
 fire
 And all destruction fall on each empire.
 So earth would be renewed, and tears then
 gone
 Before the glow of messianic dawn,
 Before he quoted these words darkly
 drawn.

9 And it shall be said in that day,
 "Look, this is our Alohims way,
 We've waited for him, He will save;
 This is YHWH, we attend like slave
 Expecting Him, so we'll be glad
 Rejoicing in salvation had."
 10 For in this mountain shall the hand
 Of YHWH repose, and Moab stand
 To be crushed under Him like straw
 Trodden down for the dunghill's draw.
 11 And He'll extend His hands among
 Them, as a swimmer's reach and rung,
 He shall bring down their pride and all
 The spoils of their hands *in the stall*.
 12 And the fortress of the high fort
 Of your walls He'll bring strike in sport
 And lay them low down to the ground,
 And to the dust *with crash and sound*.

Those who were born after the holocaust
 Are used to finding earth ground and up-
 tossed
 As though there were no justice to be found
 Beyond imagination on the ground.
 And yet Your prophet centuries ago
 Pretends a day will come when You will
 show
 Again the rate of Exodus and know

Your folk obedient and make the glow
Of their prosperity run overflow.
If that should happen here upon this earth
Or in the pie sky of some greater berth,
I'm ready with this hymn to praise Your
name
After the wait of centuries in game.
I wait with flicker now sometimes a flame.

Isaiah 26

1 In that day shall be sung this song
In Judah's land: "We have a strong
City, salvation He has made
The wall and bulwark *hard and stayed*.
2 "Open the gates so that the just
Nation of truth enter as must.
3 "You will keep him in perfect peace,
Mind firm as he trusts in Your lease.

If You, Beloved, keep any man within
Perfect Islam, that one will find his bin
A lonely place, for no one in this world
Seems to take up Islam's true flag unfurled.
The name is on the lips of those who fight
In violence and trust in working might,
Of those who forget that You one time
chose
The Sabbath day to keep men on their toes,
Of some who steal and some who think the
rows
Of bowing in good Makkah will atone
For all sins unrepented of like stone.
The perfect peace is well enough spelled
out
In Bible and Qur'an and without doubt
In human hearts though buried by the
shout.

4 "Trust in YHWH then eternally,
For in Yah YHWH is guarantee.
5 "He brings down those who dwell on
high,
The lofty city He will cry
Low, and He lays it low indeed,
To the ground and to dusty *reed*.
6 "Trodden down by a foot, the feet
Of the poor, the weak from retreat.
7 "The path for the just is upright,
O upright One, the path in sight
Of the righteous You hold to light.
8 "Indeed in Your judgements' way,
YHWH,

We have waited expecting You,
Desire of soul is to Your name,
And Your remembrance *for our fame*.

The true service of every faith on earth
That pays the toll and is a faith of worth,
Is the remembrance of Your name that's
sung
In syllables of exultation's rung,
In melodies of lamentation stung,
In penance and petition's prophecy.
Indeed, Beloved, I come here faithfully
To prophesy with harp in harmony
With angel fowl behind the glass to see
If You are One above the manied glare
Of blight and sound that I find everywhere.
Your justice is a matter of faith's hope,
I pray it fall on president and pope,
But still I take remembrance as my rope.

9 "My soul desires You in the night,
I seek You in the morning light,
Your justice when its on the earth
Teaches its dwellers righteous worth.

As my breath turns toward the sleep at last
After the day of light and overcast,
As my thoughts quiet from the storm and
blast
Of rush and the oppression at the mast,
As my eyes close before the darkness
where
I meet the sullen night come everywhere,
My soul turns to You in the blessed word
Inscribed in Hebrew syllable and heard
To strike upon the fading mind and blurred,
I go to sleep with Your word on my lip,
And find the ancient message is still hip.
My service of remembrance has no crowd,
But is a mental turning, nothing loud,
As I am rocked to sleep as in a ship.

10 "Show grace to wicked people and
They will not learn the upright stand,
They'll still do evil in the land
Of the upright, and not behold
YHWH's majesty *as it's untold*.
11 "YHWH, Your hand's raised, they will
not see,
But they'll see shame for their envy
Of the folk, and fire of Your foes
Shall consume them *from head to toes*.

You have indeed shown grace to
 humankind,
 You've sent Your prophets to the deaf and
 blind
 In soul and justice, those who throw they see
 And understand, and yet iniquity
 Is in their hands who listen to lobby.
 You have established synagogue and
 church
 And mosque and temple not to leave in
 lurch
 The masses who come day by day to search
 Survival on the earth barren and green.
 You have provided grace upon the scene.
 And yet when I but mention that Your law
 Is above all the thing to keep in awe,
 I find the eyes turn from me and the hand
 Goes out to take the wicked contraband.

12 "YHWH, You will order peace on us,
 For You have worked our works in us.
 13 "O Lord our Alohim, such lords
 Besides You have bound us with cords,
 By You alone we come to make
 Remembrance and for Your name's sake.

Beloved, the first faith that You sent
 mankind,
 To Adam and to Eve watcher-designed
 Was the remembrance of the Sabbath day
 To mention Your good name in every way.
 You ordered peace on them and true Islam,
 The sharing of the earth without a qualm
 At peace with every bird and beast and fish,
 With fruit and grain and nut upon the dish.
 Beloved, the last faith that You came to
 show
 To humankind was Islam on the go,
 The message to the Jew to take the man
 Jesus as witness to Your law and span,
 The message to the Christian not to take
 Him as a god almighty for Your sake.

14 "Deceased they shall not live, and dead
 They shall not rise up in their stead,
 For You have come to destroy them,
 And all their memory *from Your hem*.
 15 "You've increased the nation, O
 YHWH,
 You have increased the nation due,
 And You are glorified, for You

Have spread them to earth's ends in view.
 16 "YHWH, in trouble they visit You,
 They pour out prayer upon Your rue.
 17 "Like a pregnant woman come near
 The time of her bearing *in fear*
 Of pain, she cries out in her toil,
 YHWH, You have seen us for Your spoil.
 18 "We've been with child, we've been in
 pain,
 But only borne flatulence' gain,
 We've brought salvation not a whit
 Upon the earth, nor come to sit
 Upon the world's dwellers as fit.

Isaiah is a wit to speak of such
 Things in the middle of the Psalm to touch
 The heart with exultation and uplift
 The mind with every glorious fine gift.
 I too have been given the chiding lip
 For mixing vulgar words with refined clip,
 And I too have ignored the gentle flame
 Of such correction to further my fame.
 But I have hardly come to face the crowd
 In worship to sing or to shout aloud
 That we have all been farting in the mass.
 I am not like Isaiah, not so crass.
 I let mine quietly like lad and wench
 Who look surprised and wonder at the
 stench.

19 "Your dead shall live, my body too
 From death shall arise *with that crew*.
 Awake and sing, you in the dust,
 Your dew as like the dew *in lust*
 Upon the herbs, and earth shall cast
 Out the dead *alive come at last*.

Perhaps for this word one who wrote the
 spell
 Of rhyme and unreason called the Gospel
 Reported that the graves opened when shut
 Before the glory of the death and glut
 Of righteousness that Jesus when he died
 Upon the cross released in living tide.
 I trust the story's true, though none can tell
 The history before the passing bell,
 But whether so or not, I seek the well
 Of fervent resurrection on my plate.
 Be it the body as Isaiah's great
 To come with pageantry and so relate,
 Or be it of the soul to do Your will,
 Beloved, I take the rising to the fill.

20 "Come, My folk, enter in your room,
And shut your doors about the gloom,
Hide for a moment till the doom
Has gone past *and turned from the tomb.*

21 "For see, YHWH comes out of His
place
To punish the earth's wicked race,
The earth also reveals her blood,
And no more cover her slain's flood."

I enter in my secret chambered room,
The stony heart within where still may
bloom
The flame of love to You, Beloved, and see
The hopes and helps of Your eternity.
I enter in the night-work that You cast
Upon my pilgrimage briefly to last,
And busy myself with the way You set
Before me on Mount Sinai when we met.
And when I come forth from the earthen
house
Where none spoke to me other than the
mouse
And You, Beloved, whose spirit shadowed
me,
I shall find that You've played an awful
spree
Upon the earth and cleansed it of sin's fee,
Of every wicked folk's iniquity.

Isaiah 27

1 In that day YHWH with His great sword,
The strong and thrusting, shall have gored
Leviathan that squirming snake,
Leviathan crooked at stake,
And He shall slay the dragon that
Is in the sea. 2 In that day yet
A charming vineyard, sing her met.
3 I YHWH keep it, each moment set
Her waters, lest any hurt come,
Night and day I guard it in sum.

A charming vineyard, vineyard of red wine,
The vineyard of Muhammad and the sign
Of all things fair, desired above the whine
Of dragons crouching in the deep of mine,
I see the words untrembled, and I hear
Their cantillation falling on my ear.
You guard the secret fact, Beloved, and I
Rush in to tell the whole world at a try.
No wonder angels hold the pagan eye

From reading what I write. I fail to keep
The mysteries of charm and dragons' deep.
Forgive the shrill cry of my sema and
Look condescending on me where I stand,
Bewildered not to enter in the band.

4 Fury's not in Me, who would give
Me briers or thorn combative?
I'd pass through them and I would burn
Them all together *as I spurn.*
5 O let him take hold of My strength,
Let him make peace with Me at length,
And he'll make peace with Me *and learn.*
6 He shall cause those who come of Jacob
To take root; Israel shall wake up
To blossom and bud and to fill
The face of the world with fruit *still.*

Isaiah quotes the famous book that wrote
Enoch when he takes sea dragon in note.
Or then the opposite may be the truth,
Unless they both quote Job read in their
youth.

Leviathan lays one wing on the sand
Of Ireland and the other on the strand
Of Labrador and when he turns to flee
He makes a living caldron of the sea.
Beloved, if You destroy the fairest yet
Of creatures You have made not to be pet,
What shall be left for earth in weal and
bane?

Exchange the mammoth beast for coach
and train
Is comfort to the human soul I guess,
But wildness has its nobler found address.

The figure of the vineyard that You plant
And cherish is a common one, I grant,
Because it speaks an accuracy where
The human heart is raised up once to bear
The fruit of righteousness in equal share.
The figure never takes into account
Vicissitudes of weather on the mount,
The vagueries of wind and sun and rain,
The joys of human harvest and their pain.
It only will address the multitude
Of mercies that You give to human brood
And wonders that we fail and are so crude
When You had in mind sweeter wine than
this,
A quicker heart, and impulse to the kiss.

If reproduction is best strategy
 For filling earth with those who faithfully
 Follow Your will, that is, Your law I see
 Writ on the stony tables of my heart,
 Then failure is the pass. First thing the art
 Of Israel has taken idols' part
 More oft than not, and second in the cart
 Is that the pogrom and the holocaust
 Come regularly so that most are lost.
 Alternative in conversion is tried
 By Christianity in armies' stride,
 And shows that numbers may be gained
 indeed
 Through violence or paying off their greed,
 But in each case Your law remains in need.

7 As striking of the smiter He
 Has struck him, has He *not freely*?
 As slaughter of his slain does He
 Not slay them *all and joyfully*?
 8 In measure in sending it out,
 You strive with it, and without doubt
 He's taken away by sharp wind,
 As in the day of an east wind.
 9 So by this Jacob's actions sinned
 Are covered, and this makes the fruit,
 To take away his sin to boot,
 In His setting all altar stones,
 As chalkstones beaten down like bones,
 They do not get up, neither shrine
 Nor images *lying supine*.
 10 For the fenced city's desolate,
 Forsaken habitation's rate,
 Left like a wilderness in state,
 Where the calf shall pasture of late,
 And lie down there consuming all
 Its branches *as though in the stall*.
 11 When its boughs are withered and
 wilted,
 They shall be broken off and tilted,
 The women come to set the fire,
 For it's a folk without desire
 Of knowledge, so no pity takes
 Its Maker on it *for their sakes*,
 And He who formed them will not show
 Them any mercy *where they go*.
 12 It shall come to pass in that day,
 YHWH shall beat off channel of clay
 In the river down to the stream
 Of Egypt, and you shall in scheme
 Be gathered one by one again,
 O you children of Israel's *den*.

13 And it shall come to pass that day,
 The great trumpet shall sound its lay,
 And they shall come who in the way
 Were ready to perish and fail
 In land of the Assyrian pale,
 And the outcasts in Egypt's land,
 And they shall worship YHWH and stand
 In the holy mountain *and gem*
Discovered at Jerusalem.

All men in church and synagogue today
 Turn toward the sunly eastern sky to pray,
 And none turn toward the temple wall that
 stands
 Beneath Jerusalem upon the sands.
 All men turn in the worship of the sun
 Toward its morning rays when they've
 begun,
 And only by an accident of dearth
 Turn toward Your city by Moroccan birth.
 And yet You promise that a hopeful time
 Will come upon the world in every clime
 When men and women stop in their address
 And turn toward Your temple to confess
 Their frauds and murders and unholy streak
 Of Sabbath breaking to oppress the meek.

Isaiah 28

1 Woe to the crown of pride and to
 The drunkards of Ephraim's pew,
 Whose glorious beauty's fading bloom
 At the head of fat valley's room
 Of those who lie in wine's fell doom.
 2 See how mighty and strong a hand
 Has the Lord, like a tempest's stand
 Of hail and a destroying storm,
 As floods of waters raging swarm
 Are poured out by hand on the land.
 3 The crown of pride, the drunkard's treat
 Of Ephraim trodden under feet,
 4 And the beauty and glory at
 The head of the valley and fat
 Shall be a fading flower and more,
 And quickly ripened fruit before
 The summer; which when looked upon
 Is all devoured before the dawn.
 5 In that day then shall YHWH of hosts
 Be for a crown of glory's boasts,
 And for a beauty's diadem,
 To the remnant of folk for gem,
 6 And for a spirit of judgement
 To him that sits in judgement sent,

And for strength to those who shall turn
The battle to the gate to *spurn*.

7 But they also have erred through wine,
And through strong drink out of design,
The priest and prophet also err
Through liquor, they swallow the stir
Of wine, and they go from the way
Through strong drink; from the vision's
 sway

They stumble in judgement's *incline*.

8 For all tables are covered by
Vomit, such filth in all the sty!

The excuse I have never heard priest make
Is that the ten commandments in Your
 wake

Do not prohibit drinking wine and ale
Or even liquor full, hearty and hale.
One might mind Timothy and stomach's
 sake,

Another might mind Torah, come to take
The tithes for strong drink on the golden
 mael,

And slumber in Jerusalem for tale.
But some things are simply not spoken
 there

Where You appear on Sinai for Your share:
Some things are matters of reason to spare.
The vomit on the table makes one think
The righteous man should avoid the strong
 drink.

The ten commandments merely show the
 brink.

9 Whom shall He teach knowledge and by
Whom does He show doctrine in sky
Weaned from the milk and from the breast?

10 For precept on precept is best,
And precept on precept and line
On line and line on line, so here
A little and there to appear.

11 With hesitating lips and tongue
Of foreigners will His speech wrung
Come to this people *and unsung*.

Isaiah hopes his method will prevail,
The study of the Scriptures not as tale,
But to compare each line with others met
That complement the subject firm and set.
Isaiah knows the way to find the truth
Of Your will, my Belovèd, from one's
 youth

Is to inspect the written Word above
With introspection and the look of love.
Isaiah looks backward to see the time
When Moses came from Midian with his
 rhyme

Of broken speech and stuttering to climb.
Isaiah looks forward to hear the note
Of good Muhammad recited in rote
Almost but yet unlike the tongue he wrote.

12 To whom He said "This is the rest
That you may give the weary best,
And this is the refreshing word,"
And yet they would not hear as stirred.

13 But the word of YHWH came to them
Precept on precept, gem on gem,
And line on line and line on line,
A little here, and there design,
That they might go and then fall back,
Be broken, snared, and taken slack.

As I look through the layered shining
 leaves

Of Your fair Scriptures where my donned
 heart grieves,

In line on line the precepts mount up high
From century to century to spy
The Sabbath still remembered and forgot
By priest and people in the sacred plot.
You give that rest in every prophet's word,
Down to the Seer on Patmos to be stirred,
And yet if I just mention to the bishop
Oppression of the poor might find in his
 ship

A boon and rest if he would once proclaim
The blessing and the grace of Your law's
 flame,

He turns about and says nailed to the cross
Is every word of God counted in loss.

14 So hear now the word come from
 YHWH,
You scornful men and all the crew
That rule this people in *their pew*,
And in Jerusalem in view.

15 Because you have said "We have made
A covenant with and have paid
Our dues to hell, so we agree,
When the grand scourge shall pass through
 free,
It shall not come to us, for we
Have made our lies our refuge, and

Under our falsehood we can stand.”

The Qur'an quotes this word in compliment
Or not to the Jews of Medina spent,
Who claimed the fire would touch them for
a scent

And leave them after intervals, relent.
And yet the Jewish crew is nothing yet
In piling up iniquities I've met
Among the grander Roman armies set
In priest and commerce men of colony
Who spew the global market with their fee.
The threat of last destruction on the world
Is just a theme for conference uncurled,
And then a bath in luxury hotel
And the visit of call-girl for a spell.
A moment only is destruction's spree.

16 So says the Lord YHWH, “See, I lay
In the fortress foundation's stay,
A tried stone and a precious one
Upon the corner, sure and done,
Believers shall not hurry way.

17 “The judgement also will I lay
To the line and the righteousness
To the plummet, and hail shall sweep
Away the refuge that you keep
Of lies, and the waters' address
Shall overflow the hiding place.

18 “So your covenant with death's face
Shall be annulled and your fond trace
With hell shall not stand; when the great
Scourge shall pass through then you shall
be

Trodden down by it *futilely*.

19 “From the time that it goes forth it
Shall take you, for morning by fit
Morning it shall pass over you,
By day and by night shall its view
Be a vexation only to
Understand the report's review.

20 “For shorter is the bed than length
Of a man to lie in his strength
Upon it, and the covering
Is narrower than needed spring
To wrap oneself up in the thing.

21 “For YHWH shall rise up as in mount
Perazim, he shall in wrath count
As in Gibeon's valley's *fount*,
That He may do His work that's strange,
And bring to pass His act in range
Unwonted and unseen *in grange*.”

22 So do not now mock, lest your chains
Be made the stronger for your pains,
For I have heard from the Lord YHWH
Of hosts a consumption in view
Determined on the whole world's *crew*.

The reason that destruction of the kind
Must come upon the grossly deaf and blind,
Is simply that the bed's too short for wined,
And there's no blanket that will cover all
The population of the shrinking ball.
It does not do to turn over and sleep,
And snore about the way darkness may
creep.

The fact is, whether help is near or far,
The feet stick out below the falling bar
Where blankets of well-being reach the
knee

At best and whistle at eternity.
Beloved, You may rise up and come to
stare

Upon the wreaking of Your vengeance
there,

Or join the sleep and let Your feet show
bare.

23 Lend ear to hear my voice, attend
And listen to me to the end.

24 The whole day does the ploughman take
To sow, does he open and break
The clods of his ground *for their sake?*

25 When he has made it smooth, does he
Not cast abroad the fitches free,
And scatter cumin on the lee,
And sow the wheat and the barley,
And the rye in appointed stake?

26 Teaching discretion Alohim
Comes to him to direct his *dream*.

27 For fitches are not threshed abroad
With threshing instrument on sod,
Neither is a car wheel turned round
Upon the cumin on the ground.
But fitches are drawn with a staff,
And cumin with a rod *in raff*.

28 The flour for bread is ground up small,
Because he does not stay the stall
To thresh it always, nor to crush
It with a cart wheel in the rush,
Nor do his hoofs beat it down small.

29 This too comes out from YHWH of
hosts,

In counsel wonderful of boasts,

And excellent in working toasts.

It's not clear what Isaiah wants to say
When he says ploughing is not here to stay,
But goes on into planting and that too
Ends with the growing and the harvest
view.

Perhaps he means the status quo I see
Around the world is not permanent spree,
But that a harvest time is coming fast
When wheat from chaff will be made clear
at last.

Until then, though, I make my daily round
Of sun and snow or rain upon the ground
And touch the same earth as I walk the
bound

Of forest and hear twittering the sound
Of angels flitting here from tree to tree,
Both summer and in winter faithfully.

Isaiah 29

1 Alas for Ariel, alas!
For Ariel, city of class
Of David! Add then year to year,
And let the sacrifice appear.
2 And I have sent distress upon
Ariel, and it has been drawn
In lamentation and in grief,
And it shall be to me in feoff
As of a great lion *in chief*.
3 I'll camp against you round about,
And lay siege against your redoubt,
And raise up forts against your *clout*.
4 And you shall be brought down to speak
Out of the ground, and your speech meek
Out of the dust, your voice shall be
As of one with spirit to see
Out of the ground and so your speech
Shall whisper from the dust to reach.
5 The crowd of foreigners in you
Shall be like the small dust in view,
The multitude of horrid ones
Like blowing chaff come in its tons,
And suddenly shall come the cue.
6 YHWH of hosts shall come into view
With thunder and an earthquake too,
A great crash, hurricane and storm,
And fire consuming *not to warm*.
7 And the crowd of all nations that
Fight against Ariel and vat,
That is all that fight against her
And her stores, and that distress her,

Shall be as a night vision's stir.
8 It's like when a hungry man dreams,
And sees himself devouring creams,
But when he wakes up to the void,
Or as when a man in thirsts dreams
That he is drinking, it's destroyed
Upon awaking, see then he
Is faint and he desires the spree,
So shall the multitude of all
The nations be, that follow call
To fight against mount Zion's wall.

Isaiah rides on his good luck when he
Predicted the fall of Assyrian spree
Without the intervention of army.
He quotes in chapter seven and makes free
To gloat in chapter twenty-two, and now
I'll bet a two-pence this chapter somehow
Harks back to the same glorified retreat.
He hopes to play the same trick on the feet
Of Babylon and Persia come the mill
Of empires upon earth to fit the bill.
Beloved, I turn to You no matter what
Storms of troops come to Quds to ram the
shut
Gates of Messiah prince. I bow in prayer
Alone with in the mosque above the stair.

9 Stand and wonder, look and cry out,
They are drunken through no wine's bout,
They stagger but not with strong drink.
10 For YHWH's poured on to make you
sink

In the spirit of a deep sleep,
And has closed your eyes not to peep:
Your prophets and your presidents
And scientists He hid in tents.
11 The vision of all has become
To you as a book's words in sum
And sealed, which is brought to the one
Who's educated as to stun,
"Read this, please!" and he says "I can't,
For it is sealed *with wax and rant*."

12 And the book's shown to ignorant,
"Read this, please!" and he says "I can't,
In learning I'm a debutant."

13 So says the Lord, "Because this folk
Come near with their mouth and the stroke
Of lips to honour Me, but yet
Remove their heart far from My set,
And their fear toward Me has been taught
By the precept of men in plot,

14 "Therefore, see, I will add again
 A marvellous work among men,
 A marvellous work and a wonder;
 The wisdom of their wise shall blunder,
 Prudent understanding in den.
 15 "Woe to those going deep to hide
 Their plans from YHWH, whose acts abide
 In darkness. And they say now, 'Who
 Sees us and who knows what we do?'
 16 "Surely your turning upside down
 Shall be seen as potter's clay's crown;
 For shall the pot say to the man
 Who made it, 'You made not from plan?'
 Or shall the thing framed say of him
 That framed it, 'His thoughts are but dim?'"

My tardema is centuries past that
 Of Adam in the garden where he sat,
 And with each massing century I see
 The vision dim and fail of the glory.
 If in the time of good Isaiah then
 The vision was sealed from the best of
 men,

Then what is my sight now that truth is lost
 Among the rubbled ruins of the bossed?
 I honour You with lip, indeed I do,
 As some of the words here appeal in cue,
 (While others seem to question Your estate,
 Ignore the ignorance about my pate).
 I pray my actions might be poetry
 Superior to what I write in spe.

17 "Is it not yet a little while,
 And Lebanon shall turn in *pile*
 A fruitful field, and fruitful field
 Shall grow into a forest's yield?
 18 "And in that day shall the deaf hear
 The words of the book and appear
 The eyes of the blind then to see
 Out of the dark obscurity.
 19 "The meek also increase their joy
 In YHWH, and the poor men employ
 Praises of Israel's Holy *One*.
 20 "For the horror is brought to nought,
 The scorner is consumed in plot,
 And all that wait iniquity
 Are cut of *from the shore and sea*.
 21 "Such ones make a man out as guilty
 For a word spoken, and lay silty
 A snare for the one who cries out
 Justice in the gate, turn about
 To remove what is just and take

A worthless thing instead *at stake*.
 23 "But when he sees his spawn, the work
 Of My hand where he does not shirk,
 They'll sanctify My name and make
 Holy Jacob's Holy One, shake
 With fear of Israel's Alohim.
 24 "They also who erred in the mind
 Shall come to understanding's *rind*,
 And those who murmured shall learn
cream
Of teaching's doctrine on the beam."

Prediction that someone will learn the true,
 The tables of the heart and stone in view,
 The thunder and the lightning on the crew
 Of Sinai, and words above all that You
 Spoke on a day when freedom was at hand
 Is something that at least I have found
 grand.

Psychology of making families
 Is something like to fail or else to please:
 When people see their spawn, they stop to
 think

What thing is leading them up to the brink.
 And then Your teaching, my Beloved, will
 sink

Into the heart and show the way to go,
 The right to do, and whether any show
 Can save the children from nuclear glow.

Isaiah 30

1 "Woe to rebellious sons," says YHWH,
 "Who make plans, but do not in view
 Of Me, but cover with a veil,
 Not of My spirit to *curtail*,
 To add wickedness to sin's pail,
 2 "Who walk down into Egypt's bane,
 Not asking at My mouth for gain,
 To strengthen themselves in the power
 Of Pharaoh, and to trust *the hour*
Of Egypt's shadow in the lane.
 3 "So Pharaoh's strength shall be your
 shame,
 Trust in Egyptian shadow vain.
 4 "In Zoan was his princes' fame,
 His messengers to Hanes came.
 5 "They were all ashamed of a folk
 That profit not nor help a stroke,
 Nor benefit beyond a shame
 And also a reproach *in name*."

The trust in Egypt is not meant to be

The faith in Egyptian idolatry,
But rather calculation to survive
The politics of Middle East alive.
Isaiah is portrayed to be a book
Of lovely faith and spiritual hook,
But in fact is a record of the struggle
Between the faction of Egyptian tuggle
And those who thought Egypt had seen its
day

And keeping company with it when
stronger
Was no reason to trust it any longer.
The language is so beautiful the mind
Imagines it a spiritual kind.
But politics is all that is enshrined.

6 The vision of the southern beasts:
Into a land of troubled *priests*
And anguish, lions young and old,
Where vipers and the burning bold
Flying serpent is, they will bear
Their wealth upon the shoulders bare
Of young donkeys, their treasures on
The camels' humps, to folk withdrawn
From benefit *and profit there*.
7 Egyptian help shall be in vain,
And to no purpose *on the wane*;
That's why I shout about this thing,
"Their strength's to sit still *while they*
sing."

The sense political Isaiah brings
Is that Egypt is ancient in the wings,
Inert before the youthful empires' birth
That wait on east and north for what
they're worth.
It's too decrepit to boast military,
It's strength is in its sitting down to sherry.
The real alternatives are two: to act
Within the budding empire with a pact
Contributing to culture and to race
In exchange for the freedom and the grace
To follow law of God, or then rebel
Against the civilized and live in hell
And frost of desert, nomadic and spent
In wineless nights beneath the stars in tent.

8 "Go write for them on tablet sure,
And note it in a book secure,
That it may be for future time,
For ever and ever *in rhyme*.
9 "This is a folk rebellious and

Lying children, spawn on the sand
Not hearing the law come from YHWH,
10 "That say to seers, 'Do not see',
And to the prophets *come in crew*,
'o not bring up a prophecy
To tell us to do right, but speak
To us smooth things, *for such we seek*,
And prophesy deceit *on cue*.
11 "Get out of the way, turn aside
Out of the path, let not abide
The Holy One of Israel
In front of us to stay a spell."
12 That's why Israel's Holy One speaks:
"Because you despise this word's streaks,
And trust in oppression perverse,
And dwell upon it *for the worse*:
13 "Therefore this wickedness shall be
To you a breach ready to fall,
And swelling out in a high wall,
Whose breaking out comes suddenly.
14 "And He shall break it as the crash
Of potters' vessel in the smash;
He shall not spare, it's not found there
In bursting of it any chip
To take fire from the hearth in clip,
Or take water upon the hip."
15 For so says the Lord YHWH, the One
Holy of Israel when done,
"Return to rest is your salvation,
In quiet and confident station
Shall be your strength," but you instead
Wanted to keep Sunday in bed.
16 And you said "No, we'll take to horse."
And so then you will flee perforce.
"We'll ride away upon the swift."
So those who pursue you will lift
A faster *foot upon the course*.
17 A thousand flee at one's rebuke,
You'll run away before the fluke
Of five; till you are left alone
Like a lighthouse upon a stone,
A single flag for a hill's *duke*.

The fault of ancient Judah was that they
Saw neither good alternative in sway,
But wanted to go on in the old way
Of dependence on the Nile and its pay.
The weakness of Egyptians was the chip
That turned around the Jewish sort of ship.
The choice was made by conquest come
not late
To turn out kings and people to their fate.

A better deal could have been cut with just
Diplomacy to set them up in trust.
Prophetic message is that ruin comes
From trusting in Egyptian sort of sums,
But after that when Babylon grows old
And falls, then it too will be in the cold.

16 And therefore YHWH will wait, so He
May be gracious to you and be
Exalted, and may have mercy
On you, for YHWH's an Alohim
Of judgement: blessed are all the team
Who wait for Him *to come and see*.
19 And so the folk shall come to dwell
In Zion at Jerusalem's well:
You shall not weep anymore there:
He'll be so gracious in your share
To hear the voice you raise in pew;
When He hears it, He'll answer you.
20 And though the Lord give you the bread
Of trouble and water instead
Of your affliction, still those who
Teach you will not be put from view
Into a corner any more,
But your eyes shall see *in their score*
Your teachers *coming out in crew*.
21 Your ears shall hear a word behind,
Saying "This is the way assigned,
Walk in it, when you turn to right
And when you turn to left *in sight*."
22 "You also shall defile the veil
Of your graven image in sale
Of silver, and the ornament
Of your molten images spent
Of gold, and you shall cast them out
As a rag covered with the spout
Of woman's monthly flow, and you
Shall say to it, 'Away and phew!'"
23 Then He shall give rain to your seed,
That you shall sow instead of weed,
And bread of earth's increase, and it
Shall be both fat and prospered fit.
In that day shall your cattle feed
In wide pastures *to fill their greed*.
24 The oxen likewise and the young
Donkeys beneath the service tongue
Fermented provender shall eat,
Winnowed with shovel and fan's *treat*.
25 And there'll be on every high hill,
Upon each mountain and to fill
Rivers and streams of water in
The day of the great slaughter din,

When ramparts fall down *and are still*.
26 Moreover the light of the moon
Shall be like light of the sun soon,
And the light of the sun shall be
Seven times brighter and in fee
Of seven days of light the day
That YHWH binds up the breach to stay
Of His folk and comes in to heal
Their stricken wounds *at their appeal*.

Although Isaiah wrote a book to be
The outline of good royal policy,
It does have an element set in faith,
The high-toned call to turn away from
wraith
And cast down every pagan sort of thing
And worship You alone and not the king.
That is a corollary to the way
He turns the hearts of people from the fray,
From loyalty to Egypt when its pay
Is too weak to resist the younger sway.
To get along with diplomatic share
Requires a firm decision to beware
Of pagan influences on the stair.
Beloved, I follow You here, if I may.

27 See the name of YHWH comes from
far,
Burning in His wrath and the star
Is heavy, His lips full of wrath,
And His tongue fire's consuming path:
28 His breath an overflowing stream
Shall reach up to the neck in beam
To sift the nations with the sieve
Of vanity, and so shall give
A bridle to the people's jaws
To make them err *from common laws*.
29 You'll have a song, as in the night
When solemn assembly is right,
And gladness of the heart, as when
One goes with a flute in the glen
To come to the mountain of YHWH,
The mighty One in Israel's view.
30 And YHWH shall make His glorious
voice
Heard and show striking arm for choice,
With anger of wrath and the flame
Of fire devouring, scattered claim,
And tempest and hailstones *of ice*.
31 For from the voice of YHWH breaks
down
Assyrian struck *both rod and crown*.

32 And in each place the staff shall pass,
That YHWH shall lay upon his *ass*,
Shall be with tabrets and the harp,
In shaking battles he will carp.
33 For Tophet is ordained of old,
The king's prepared it, he was bold
To make it deep and wide, the pile
Of it is fire and firewood's guile;
The breath of YHWH in rush and stream
Like brimstone kindles it *on beam*.

The choice of fair Jerusalem between
The two empires set on a rushing stream
Is based on predicting which of the two
Has more power to control all things in
view.

Foundation of the power may seem to be
An absolute and still determine free,
But here Isaiah looks toward a time
When human powers must fail before
divine.

Beloved, I seek Your justice from all crime
Of government and political mine.
I seek Your wrath to fall in flame and fire,
I seek the coming of Your judgement dire.
The kingdom of Your law remains in me
The hope of life and of eternity.

Isaiah 31

1 Woe to those who go to Egypt
For help, stay on horses equipped,
And trust in tanks for multitude,
And cavalry for strength imbued;
But they do not look to the Saint
Of Israel or seek YHWH's *restraint*.
2 He's also wise, and will bring down
Catastrophe *upon the town*,
And not call back His prophecy,
But rise against the wicked spree,
Against the help of those who do
Iniquity *in sacred pew*.
3 Egyptians are men and not God;
Their horses flesh, not spirit's pod.
When YHWH shall stretch out His hand
there,
Both the helper shall fall from stair
And the one helped fall down, and they
Shall all fail together *that day*.
4 For so has YHWH spoken to me,
"Like the lion and the young lion free
Roar on their prey when a crowd's sway
Of shepherds is called out to prey,

He'll not be afraid of their voice,
Nor crouch in hiding for their choice,
So shall YHWH of hosts come to fight
For mountain fortress on hill's site."
5 As birds fly so does YHWH of hosts
Cover Jerusalem *from ghosts*,
Covering and delivering,
Passing over upon the wing,
And causing to escape *the sting*.

As Judah erred in days of old to look
To Egypt for salvation from the crook
Of the Assyrians, so on a year
That I remember without pain or fear,
Although the six days of that week remain
A touchstone to many for current pain,
The folk that dwelt in old Jerusalem
Looked to Egypt for help and hope *pro tem*.
They joke that the debacle then that came
Was reading Russian tank gears for their
fame
From right to left, and so instead of moving
Forward they went backward into the
grooving
Of Sinai's desert to meet their mishap.
All faith in guns leads to some travelled
trap.

6 Turn back, you Israelites, to Him
Against whom you've revolted grim.
7 For in that day each man shall cast
Away his silver idols last,
And his idols of gold which your
Own hands have made to fill sin's *store*.
8 Then shall Assyrian fall with sword,
Not of a mighty man *restored*,
And the sword not of a mere man
Shall consume him, but as *in plan*
He'll flee from the sword and his young
Men shall be troubled *to the dung*.
9 "He'll pass to his redoubt for fear,
And his princes when flags appear
Shall be afraid," says YHWH, whose fire
Is in the fortress and His pyre
Is in Jerusalem *for dire*.

The Israelites upon that fateful year
Came on Jerusalem as with their gear
Assyrians to Ahaz without fear.
This time the gross invader took the tent
Of Quds and spread out under a sun spent
To enjoy hegemony on the bent.

How many times has that lost city known
 The conquest of new faces on the throne!
 One hardly knows to applaud anymore,
 But rather breathes a prayer that on the
 shore
 The bleeding will stop somewhere and
 peace come
 To narrow streets abiding in the hum
 Of selling and of waiting for the crew
 That comes each year to temple mount and
 view.

Isaiah 32

1 See how a king shall reign upright,
 And princes rule in judgement's *light*.
 2 And each be like a hiding place
 From the wind, a cover of *grace*
 From the storm, as rivers *that flow*
 With waters in a desert *show*,
 As the shade of a great rock in
 A land of weariness *and din*;
 3 Not dazzling to the eye of those
 Who watch, while hearers' ear bestows
 Attendance *from their head to toes*.
 4 The rash heart too shall become wise,
 And stuttering tongue to despise
 Shall be ready to speak out clear,
 5 The vile man no longer appear
 Generous, nor the knave be said
 To be bountiful *in his spread*.
 6 The vile person speaks villainy,
 His heart will work iniquity,
 And he'll practise hypocrisy,
 And utter error against YHWH,
 To make the soul as hungry too,
 And cause the drink to fail from lip
 Of the thirsty *in his lordship*.
 7 Wicked are the ways of the knave,
 He invents hard things to enslave
 The poor with lying words to crave
 When the oppressed speak right *and hip*.
 8 The generous invents good things,
 In generosity's his wings.

I'm not sure which heart of the politicians
 Both Israeli and Palestine's ignitions
 Can be the one that's rash in the words
 here.
 So many fit the parable and ear.
 I'm not sure which man of the lot is vile
 Within Israeli and Philistine pile,
 As every other one could fit the bill,

And hypocrite and knave are standing still.
 The oppressed are near every site and wall,
 And some are Jewish, and others appal,
 But generous there be and hope is near
 That peace and fond prosperity may reign,
 At least when Middle Eastern oil in drain
 Is finished and men turn back to regain.

9 Rise up, you women, from your ease,
 Hear my voice, careless daughters, please,
 Give ear to my speech's *trapeze*.
 10 Many days and years shall you be
 In trouble, careless women free,
 For the vintage shall fail and yet
 The harvest day has not been set.
 11 Tremble, women at ease, for doubt
 Cry, careless ones, and so set out
 Your clothing and make your flesh bare,
 And take up sackcloth then to wear.
 12 For udders they lament, for fields
 Of Muhammad, for the vine's yields.
 13 Upon the land of my folk rise
 Up thorns and briars, and to despise
 The joyful palaces in guise
 Of the joyful city *and wise*.
 14 Surely the palace has been left,
 The crowd of the city bereft,
 Fort and watch-tower become a den
 For ever, and wild donkey's glen,
 A pasture of herds *in the cleft*,
 15 Until the spirit be poured out
 Upon us from on high for stout,
 Wilderness be a fruitful field,
 And fruitful field be counted yield
 Of a forest *stayed round about*.

The fact is both the Jew and Arab are
 The sons of Abraham and so they star
 Both to live in the peace of faith beneath
 The cloudless sky of Jerusalem's heath.
 Some yearn for fields of Ahmed in the toil
 Of watering the orchards on the soil,
 Some yearn for David's kingdom in relief,
 Some yearn and some joy, others in their
 grief
 Are driven to such acts beyond belief.
 Pour out Your spirit, my Beloved, and see
 Prosperity and peace drown out melee,
 And let the Trinitarian oil man be
 A relict of the past, dead, cold and gone
 Before the coming of another dawn.

16 Then judgement shall stay on the sand
 Of wilderness and upright stand
 In the gardens *of all the land*.
 17 The righteous work shall be Islam,
 The effect of justice in calm
 And surety for ever *manned*.
 18 My folk shall live in peace and in
 Sure dwellings without battle's din,
 And in the quiet resting place;
 19 When it shall hail upon the wood,
 And the town bow as low as could.
 20 Blessed are you who sow beside all
 Waters, that send forth feet from stall
 Of ox and donkey *to the wall*.

Prediction of the faith of peace so far
 Has not developed into any star
 That leads humankind to the waters far
 That stay for ever thirst and make the state
 Of the messiah true over all hate.
 Prediction is a thing not to be stunned:
 There is no fate that proves the thing when
 gunned.

Prediction is no promise come in view
 That things must someday turn to right and
 true.

Prediction is the promise of good will
 That at any moment men on the hill
 May turn from evil and do right until
 The course of history is changed and all
 Find their place in peace on the earthly ball.

Isaiah 33

1 Woe to you who spoil and were not
 Spoiled, and act in a traitor's plot
 With those who have not been to you
 Traitors *in what they say and do!*
 When you have finished spoiling, then
 You shall be spoiled, and when your den
 Of treachery is broken up,
 They'll take with treachery your cup.
 2 O YHWH, be merciful to us,
 For we have waited for Your *bus*,
 Be their arm in the mornings and
 Salvation in a troubled land.
 3 From the voice of a crowd have fled
 The people, from Your raising spread
 The nations *round about as led*.
 4 Gathered is your spoil in a pile
 Of caterpillars running while
 The locusts run about *in style*.
 5 YHWH is exalted, He is set

On high, He fills the fortress yet
 With judgement and righteousness met.
 6 The steadfastness of your times here
 Is the strength of salvation near,
 Wisdom and knowledge, and the fear
 Of YHWH, it is His treasure dear.
 7 Hear "Their lion of God" they cry,
 Messengers of Islam come by
 With bitter weeping *where they steer*.
 8 Desolate are highways so that
 The traffic ceases on the path,
 He has broken the covenant,
 He's despised enemies in slant,
 Esteeming no man in his wrath.
 9 The earth mourns and withers in frown,
 Shamed Lebanon's trees are cut down,
 Sharon is like a wilderness,
 Bashan and Carmel shake distress.

Isaiah prophesies the falling down
 Of the Assyrian of golden crown,
 And at the same time looks down through
 the years

To coming of Islam and all the tears
 That coming makes, not just the spreading
 place

Of desert and of wilderness in trace
 Of cedars of Lebanon failing grace,
 But for the tears when that great lion of
 God

Exalted was stricken down to the sod
 Of prayer by sword. All things are noted
 well

In ancient Scripture, as oracle's spell.
 Beloved, I beat my breast and weep to tell
 The story of the fateful locust horde
 That in Muhammad's name raised up a
 sword.

10 "Now I'll rise," says YHWH, "I'll sit
 high,

Now I'll lift Myself to the sky.

11 You shall conceive chaff and bring forth
 Stubble, your breath like fire for worth
 Shall consume all of you thereby.

12 The folk shall be like burning lime,
 Like thorns cut up to burn in time
 Of fire. 13 Hear, you who sit far off,
 What I have done, and you nearby,
 Acknowledge the might of My try.

14 Sinners in Zion are afraid,
 Fear grasps the hypocrites' parade.

Who of us shall survive the fire
 Consuming, who unholy pyre
 For ever and ever unstayed?
 15 He who has acted righteously,
 And who utters things uprightly,
 The one who despised all the gain
 Of oppressions, and shakes the stain
 Of bribes from his hands, and stops ears
 From plans of shedding blood, whose eyes
 Are shut from seeing evil guise.
 16 He'll dwell exalted from his fears,
 His redoubt is the rocky rears,
 Bread shall be given him and sure
 And steadfast are his waters *pure*.

I've seen the feet go calmly through the
 blast
 Of coals red hot and flames that had been
 cast,
 But did not know that those whose test was
 there
 Were of the band who obey You with care.
 The fire consuming that such men survive
 Who keep Your law whether dead or alive
 Must not be the one kindled with the share
 Of walking on the coals with the feet bare.
 Indeed, Beloved, I cling in my retreat
 To Your commandments only, while my
 feet
 Walk only in the paths commanded by
 Your law that was once spoken on Sinai.
 I find my fortress in the wilderness
 And eat my bread and drink water You
 bless.

17 A king of glory your eyes see,
 A land far off *in its beauty*.
 18 Your heart shall contemplate the fate
 Of terror, where is the scribe's mate,
 Where the receiver, where is he
 Who counted the towers *in melee*?
 19 You shall not see a fierce folk rise,
 A people of deeper in guise
 Of speech than you can yet devise,
 Of a tongue that stutters so you
 Cannot understand *word nor cue*.
 20 Look on the fortress and the town
 Of our solemn assemblies down;
 Your eyes shall see Jerusalem
 A quiet habitation's hem,
 A tent not to be taken down;
 Not one of its stakes pulled from place,

Nor any cord broken in trace.
 21 But there mighty is YHWH for us,
 A place of rivers *glorious*,
 Streams of broad banks where no ship
 comes,
 No oars creep over it with drums.
 22 For YHWH's our judge, and YHWH is
 our
 Lawgiver, YHWH's our king *of power*,
 He will save us *by mighty tower*.
 23 Left are your ropes, they fail to hold
 Their mast, they could not spread the cold
 Sail, so's divided the great spoil,
 Even the lame receive for toil.
 24 Inhabitants shall not say "I
 Am sick," the folk who dwell nearby
 Shall be forgiven iniquity.

The city and the temple that surround
 The ark of covenant and blessing found
 About the tables of the law resound
 With praise to You, Beloved, for what You
 do,
 And what you have commanded Your own
 crew.
 The tattered tent of wilderness is made
 Anew in the Jerusalem parade,
 The covering of Kaaba in the night
 Protects the law of righteousness and light.
 Not only Jew and son of Abraham
 Enjoy the blessings of the goat and ram,
 But every Gentile that will take a look
 Into the heavenly Scriptures and good book
 Is contemplated by the angels there
 As worthy as the high priest on the stair.

Isaiah 34

1 Come near, you nations, come and hear;
 And listen, you folk, let earth hear,
 And all who live on it appear,
 The world and every bit of gear.
 2 For the wrath of YHWH's on all folk,
 And His fury on armies' stroke,
 He shall fully destroy them, He
 Has brought them into slaughter's fee.
 3 Their slain also shall be cast out,
 And their stench from their corpses rout,
 And mountains dissolve in their blood.
 4 And all the host of heaven in flood,
 The skies roll together like scroll,
 And all their host fall from the toll,
 As the leaf scatters from the vine,

As fruits from the fig tree entwine.
 5 Soaked in the sky was My sword, see,
 On Edom it comes down in spree,
 On the folk of My curse to be
 In judgement. 6 YHWH's sword's filled
 with blood,
 It glistens with the fat *and mud*,
 As with the blood of lamb and goat,
 With kidney fat of rams *to gloat*,
 For YHWH's made Bozrah's sacrifice,
 A great slaughter at Edom's *price*.
 7 And unicorns come down with them,
 The bullocks with the bulls in hem,
 And their land shall be soaked with blood,
 And their dust made fat *in the mud*.
 8 For it's YHWH's vengeance day, the
 year
 Of recompenses for the fear
 On Zion coming like a flood.

The day and year of recompense I fear
 Not, for I am not of the crowd to spear
 The righteous poor with profit and with
 claim.
 I am the back-hand of this world in blame.
 When I worked for my fame and for career,
 My actions were applauded and I had
 The glory and the praise of good and bad.
 But when I turned my hand to touch Your
 word,
 Beloved, the gleaming crowds that had
 been spurred
 Turned from my voice and song, and from
 my writ
 And left me all alone on the mount fit.
 And so I wait the day of vengeance with
 No trembling in the temple where I sit
 To ravel and unravel earthly myth.

9 It's streams shall be turned into pitch,
 Its dust into brimstone in ditch,
 The land shall become burning pitch.
 10 It shall not be quenched night nor day;
 Its smoke forever makes its way:
 For generations it lies waste;
 None pass through it for ever *chased*.
 11 The cormorant and bittern stay;
 The owl too and the raven's bay:
 He'll stretch out on it the line of
 Confusion, stones empty above.
 12 To the kingdom her nobles call
 But none arrive to stand in stall,

Her princes are nothing all.
 13 Covered her palaces with thorns,
 Nettle and bramble are her bourns.
 It shall be dragons' hiding place,
 A court for ostriches to race.
 14 Meet there the desert beasts the wild
 Dog, and the satyr cries there styled
 Where the night owl finds resting space.
 15 There made her nest the bittern, there
 She laid her eggs and hatched with care,
 Gathered under her wing to spare
 From vultures coupled and unguiled.
 16 Seek out the book of YHWH and read,
 No one of these shall fail indeed,
 None shall be lacking of her mate,
 For my mouth's commanded the rate,
 And His spirit comes to impede.
 17 And He has cast the lot for them,
 His hand divided gem by gem,
 They shall possess it always for
 All generations' living store.

The satyrs or the goats, the owls or spooks
 Inhabiting the palaces of dukes
 And kings, hardly ever lift voice in song
 Or wings, or shake a shaggy beard along
 The tumbling wall climbed, whether right
 or wrong,
 There to devour the sprig of tender leaf
 That always reappears in worlds of grief.
 Beloved, I read the book and still compare
 The murmuring of Psalms and Torahs there
 To twittering of beak around my share.
 The difference between my solitude
 And beastly sounds that make the lively
 mood
 Of forest is the punctuation where
 Your prophets' rantings come to rend the
 air.

Isaiah 35

1 The desert and the wilderness
 Shall be happy at their address,
 The desert shall rejoice and bloom
 Like roses *in a fancy room*.
 2 It shall blossom abundantly,
 Rejoice with joy and singing free,
 The glory of Lebanon be
 Granted it, the excellency
 Of Carmel and Sharon, they'll see
 YHWH's glory and excellency
 Of our Alohim *without gloom*.

3 Strengthen the weak hands and confirm
The feeble knees. 4 Say to the term
Of fearful, "Be strong, do not fear:
See your Alohim will come near
Revening, Alohim Huu comes
With a reward to do His sums
And save you *with your near and dear.*"

It's not just Jews can make the desert
bloom
(Although my heart returns into the room
Of En Gedi from the tundra and doom
That I inhabit like a ptarmigan),
For I have seen the fossil water in
The sands of Egypt glitter and rise up
To fill the gardens of the figs like cup,
Plantations of the olive with a din.
There is no soul aware of being I
Who cannot take a desert wing and fly
Into the heights of Carmel with a cry,
Into the bowers of Sharon where the rose
Is mingled with the poppies' painted toes,
And know that You are here to satisfy.

5 Then blind eyes shall be opened, and
The deaf ears unstopped, 6 lame men leap
Like a deer, and the dumb tongue keep
A song: for on the desert sand
Shall waters break out, on the land
Of barrenness streams *rise and seep.*
7 The parched ground shall become a pool,
The dry land springs of water drool,
In dragons' lairs, where each one lay,
The reeds and rushes bend and sway.
8 A highway shall be there, a way,
And it shall be called Sacred Way;
The unclean pass not over it,
But it's for those wayfaring fit,
Though fools, they shall not miss the ray.
9 No lion is there, no raging beast
Shall wander in it, not the least,
But the redeemed shall walk *and stay.*
10 The ransomed of YHWH shall return,
And come to Zion with songs and learn
Joy unrelenting on their heads,
They'll get joy and gladness *in spreads,*
And sorrow and sighs flee away.

Dear Jesus says to call no man a fool,
But that was after Isaiah in school
Used the word for the one who cannot read
The map while following the sacred creed

Of motorways instead of wandering steed.
Such ones are fools indeed, just ask the
mate
Who's driving in and out of the lost gate.
Jesus had disremembered future fate.
But Jesus and Isaiah are agreed
By word of the apocalyptic speed
That sorrows and sighs must go and recede
Before the joys that You, Beloved, instate
Upon the street of gold, the tree not late
To blossom and bear figs and olives' rate.

Isaiah 36

1 It happened in the fourteenth year
Of Hezekiah, king to fear,
Sennacherib, Assyrian king,
Came to attack the defencing
Of Judah's towns and took their gear.
2 The king of Assyria sent
Rabshakeh from Lachish and bent
On getting to Jerusalem
To Hezekiah king of them
With a great army. And he stood
By the conduit to the good
Upper pool in the highway left
To the fuller's field *that it cleft.*
3 *When they to the king had appealed,*
There came out to them *stocked and*
steeled
Eliakim son of Hilkiah,
Who was over household *and by her,*
And Shebna the scribe and Joah
Son of Asaph, recording *paw.*
4 And Rabshakeh said to them, "Speak
Now to Hezekiah, he's weak,
So says the great king, who is king
Of Assyria, 'What faith you bring?
5 "You speak vainly to have a plan
And strength to battle as you can.
In whom do you trust and rebel
Against me, *think now and do tell?*
6 "See now, you trust in the lone staff
Of this bruised reed at which they laugh,
In Egypt, on which if a man
Leans, it will surely, *spick and span,*
Go in his hand and pierce it through.
So is Pharaoh of Egypt to
All who trust him. 7 "But if you say
To me, "We trust in YHWH today
Our Alohim," is that not He
Whose high places and altars' fee
Hezekiah's taken away,

And told Judah in all their sway,
Jerusalem 'You'll worship here,
Jerusalem's altar with fear?'"

Beloved, I cling to a state that is weak
Beyond pallor of Hezekiah's cheek,
Weaker than failing Egypt and the bell
Of river Nile singing sweetly a knell.
I follow Peter Chamberlin whose dad
Was careful to keep at home all the sad
Traditions of the Huguenots who sang
The Psalms of David and without a clang
In secret kept the covenant of law,
The ten commandments. The son took the
chance
To found Mill Yard, but learned to
sorrow's dance
That churches always turn upon and
prance.

Conventicle in secret in the home
Can only oppose the fancies of Rome.

8 "Now then, I pray, give pledges to
My lord the Assyrian king due,
And I'll give you two thousand horse,
If you can set riders in course.
9 "How then will you turn back the face
Of even one captain in chase
Of the least of my master's men,
And put your trust on Egypt then
For chariots and for horsemen?
10 "Have I now come to the attack
Without YHWH's aid against the back
Of this place to destroy it now?
YHWH said to me 'Go up and plough
This land to its destruction now.'"

When just six women were left of the
crowd
That had sat in Mill Yard to sing aloud,
The Baptists sent their courtiers to present
Their claims that they should own the land
and rent.
The moneys that were set in sacred trust
Went to idolaters to polish rust,
And Your assembly went back to the true
Of staying by the hearth instead of pew.
The land is all destroyed, but after years
Of cantillating Psalms beneath the fears
Of Your commandments ten, we're still a
few
To guard walls of heavenly Jerusalem,

Reciting Your law's Sabbath stratagem,
Remembering forefathers' gracious crew.

11 Then said Eliakim the son
Of Holkiah and Shebna won,
And Joah to Rabshakeh, "Speak
Please to your servants in the reek
Of Syrian language, for we know
It and do not talk with the show
Of the Jews' language in the ears
Of the people that mind the tiers."
12 But Rabshakeh said to them, "Did
My master send me to the bid
Of your master and to you here
To speak these words? Should I appear
To the men on the wall so they
May eat their own shit and then stay
To drink their own piss in your way?"

Idolaters curse now as then in tongue
Of liturgies to idols in their rung.
It may have felt a barb, it may have stung,
In Hezekiah's day, but all grief's set
In grand parades beyond what can be met.
Please to speak in the Syrian tongue I pray,
And hear the scoffing at the Sabbath day
On tongue of priest and bishop and of pope.
They all continue in the blessed hope
Of sacred tongues in curses. Give them
rope,
Beloved, and let them hang themselves in
scope.
Slay all in me too, my Beloved, that stands
Against the truth of Your commandments'
bands,
And I shall live in more resplendent ray.

13 Then Rabshakeh stood up and cried
With a loud voice on the Jews' side
And spoke in the Jews' tongue and said
"Hear the word of the great king spread
Over Assyria, be led.
14 "So says the king, 'Do not believe
Hezekiah, he'll not relieve
You and save you out of his hand.
15 "Neither let Hezekiah stand
To make you trust in YHWH, and say
"YHWH will deliver us today,
And this town shall not under sway
Of the king of Assyria."
16 "Do not listen to Hezekiah,
For so says the king and pariah

Of Assyria, 'Make with me
 A treaty by a present, see,
 And come out to me, and then eat
 Every man of his own vine's treat,
 And every one of his fig tree,
 And drink every one of the sea
 Of his own cisterns *at his feet*,
 17 "Until I come and I take you
 Away to a land like your view,
 A land of corn and wine and dew,
 A land of bread and vineyards too,
 A land of oil, olive and honey,
 Where you may live with house and money
 And not die, and take no heed now
 To Hezekiah when his brow
 Persuades you saying "YHWH will save."

The pulpits all around me resonate
 With scoffing at Your law, Beloved, and
 state
 That none can keep Your word, that You
 were scoffing
 When You spoke that one time on Sinai
 doffing
 The silence of the universe to make
 The only sermon that You ever spake.
 The Rabshakehs fail not to wear a crown,
 They stride in pomp around the Roman
 town,
 In greed around Genevan horse and gate,
 In their deceit in London risen late.
 Beloved, I see the corn and wine flow out
 And wallow in the oil of their redoubt,
 And wait in quiet, clean obedience
 To Your ten laws in my own humble tents.

18 "Have any gods of nations down
 Saved their lands from beneath the frown
 Of the Assyrian king? 19 "Where are
 The gods of Hamath and *the star*
 Of Arpad? And where are the gods
 Of Sepharvaim, *flung to the clods*,
 Hena and Ivah? Did they come
 Deliver Samaria *and hum*?
 20 "What gods are there among all gods
 Of all countries that with their prods
 Saved their country out of my hand,
 That YHWH should deliver the land
 Jerusalem out of my hand?"
 21 But the people said not a word,
 They held their peace *as though not*
stirred,

For the king's command was to say
 Nothing in answer to his *spray*.
 22 Then came Eliakim the son
 Of Hilkiah of the housedom,
 And Shebna the scribe and Joah
 The son of Asaph in whose paw
 Was the recording, with clothes torn
 To Hezekiah, told the *scorn*
 Of Rabshakeh in what *he'd sworn*.

Have any gods delivered, truly said.
 The cannibal opens his sack to spread
 A sacred meal on altar and on town
 That lies beneath the godly sun and crown.
 Have any gods delivered, no indeed.
 The legend is that You broke Pharaoh's
 steed
 In ages past, but what I see amiss
 Is more of reproach than justice to kiss.
 The forest bears the gash, the road is plain,
 The scars are seen upon the land in vain,
 For every human soul bears in the breast
 The knowledge of Your oneness and
 confessed
 In I-nesses that cannot be escaped,
 Despite the countries that lie dry and raped.

Isaiah 37 (See 2 Kings 19)

1 It happened when king Hezekiah
 Heard it, he tore his clothes to sigh it,
 And dressed himself up in sackcloth,
 And went into YHWH's house *of wrath*.
 2 He sent Eliakim who was
 Over the household and the claws
 Of Shebna the scribe and the elders
 Of the priests clothed in sackcloth felders
 To prophet Isaiah the son
 Of Amoz, *who was worth a ton*.

When Hezekiah sends his servants to
 Isaiah, who's a prophet, for a clue,
 He does a good deed, for few kings await
 The word of prophet or of God in state.
 Bless Hezekiah for his humble deed,
 And bless those who follow him on his
 steed
 Rushing to find Your will, Beloved, in
 need.
 Few find Your will, despite its open share
 Proclaimed in ten commandments
 everywhere,
 Even upon the stone the Anglican

Set up in early churches under ban
Of Vatican. Few find the shining truth
Despite the help and hope of hearth in
youth,
Despite the care of years to show what can.

3 They told him, "So says Hezekiah,
'Today's a day of great pariah,
And of rebuke and blasphemy,
Because the time of birthing be,
And there's not strength to birth a flea.

4 "It may be YHWH your Alohim
Will hear all the words sans esteem
Of Rabshakeh Assyria's king
His master has sent with a thing
Of reproach to the living God,
And will reprove those words of clod
YHWH your Alohim has heard, so
Pray for the ones left in the show.'"

5 King Hezekiah's servants came
To Isaiah, *prophet by name*.

6 And Isaiah said to them, "So
Shall you say to your master, 'So
Says the blest YHWH, "Don't be afraid
Of the words which you have heard laid
By the servants Assyrian king
Has sent to blaspheme Me *a thing*.

7 "See, I'll send upon him a blast,
And he will hear a rumour cast,
And will return to his own land,
And I will cause him not to stand
Before the sword in his own land.'"

8 And Rabshakeh returned and found
The king of Assyria bound
In battle against Libnah round,
Though he had heard that he had gone
Up from Lachish *before the dawn*.

9 And when he heard say of the king
Of Ethiopia a thing,
And of Tirhakah, "See now he
Has come out to fight against you,"
He sent messengers back to see
Hezekiah saying in view,

10 "So you shall speak to Hezekiah
King of Judah and all that's nigh her,
Saying 'Let not your God in whom
You trust deceive you of your doom,
Saying "Jerusalem shall not
Be delivered into the plot
Of the king of Assyria."

11 "See, you have heard and heard with
awe

What the kings of Assyria
Have done to all lands by destroying
Them wholly, shall you be enjoying
Deliverance? 12 "Have nations' gods
Delivered them from any prods
Of my ancestors destroying,
As Gozen, Haran, and the spring
Of Rezech, and folk of Eden
Who were in Thelasar like men?
13 "Where is the king of Hamath and
The king of Arpad, and the land
Of the king of Sepharvaim's town,
Of Hena and Ivah *for crown?*"

Rebshakeh fails to see the sign of wind
Crossing the plains of how his king has
sinned.

Insensitive to cry of earth in weal,
The conqueror is always at the heel,
And rides rough-shod across the ropes of
steel.

That's why they all at last perish and fail.
Their works are forced and forced once to
prevail,

And force is artificial in the gale,
It does not last because it turns a tail
Against the laws of nature under sail.
The lust of conquest is perversion and
Runs in a dead-end on the desert sand.
The boasting of a general is heard,
But fails at last down to the latest word.

14 And Hezekiah got the brief
From the messengers in relief
And read it. Hezekiah went
Up to YHWH's house and spread the sent
Before YHWH. 15 Hezekiah prayed
Before YHWH and said where he stayed,
16 "YHWH *that is* Israel's Alohim,
Who stays between cherubim's beam,
You are the Alohim and You
Alone, of all kingdoms of earth,
And You have made both heaven and
earth.

17 "YHWH, bow down Your ear now, and
hear,

Open, YHWH, Your eyes, see and hear
The words Sennacherib has sent
The living God reproach to vent.

18 "Truly, YHWH, the Assyrian kings
Have destroyed nations and their things.

19 "They have thrown their idols in fire,

For they were not gods to desire,
 But the work of men's hands, and wood
 And stone, that's why destruction could.
 20 "So that's why, YHWH our Alohim,
 I pray to You, save from the scheme
 Of his hand, so all earthly kings
 May know that You above all things
 Are YHWH Alohim, only You.
To You alone worship is due"

I too have letters I've received for grief,
 And spread them before Your eye for
 relief,
 And find the words there disappear and fail
 Before the scintillating grace and grail
 Of Psalm and loved commandments I
 recite
 Before the coming of the morning light.
 I too have letters sometimes got for pain,
 I too have spread them out to view in vain
 Until the comfort of Your law appear
 And turn away my sorrow and my tear.
 Not vain is the loved word that You once
 told
 The fleeing shepherds looking for a fold
 Beyond the Red Sea's march out of the
 cold.
 Not vain is Your word to vanquish my fear.

21 Isaiah the son of Amoz
 Sent to Hezekiah what shows,
 Saying "So says YHWH Alohim
 Of Israel, 'What you would deem
 To pray to Me against the king
 Sennacherib of Assyria,
 I've truly listened to the thing.'
 22 "This is the thing that YHWH for awe
 Has spoken about him: 'Virgin
 Daughter of Zion despised your skin,
 Laughed you to scorn, the daughter of
 Jerusalem shakes head *and glove*.
 23 "Whom have you reproached and
 blasphemed?
 Against whom have you cast and beamed
 Your voice and lifted up your eyes
 Up high? Against the holy rise
 Of Israel. 24 "By messenger
 Have you reproached the Lord to stir
 Saying 'With crowds of chariots
 I have come up the mountain lots,
 To the sides of Lebanon, and
 Will cut down the tall and the grand

Cedar trees from it and the choice
 Fir trees from it, and I'll rejoice
 To enter in his borders' place,
 The forest of his Carmel's grace.
 25 "I've dug and drunk strange waters and
 With the sole of my feet I've fanned
 Dry all the rivers of the manned.'
 26 "Have you not heard how long ago
 I accomplished *great things of woe*,
 And formed it all in ancient time?
 Now I have brought to pass *the crime*
 That you should be here to lay waste
 Fortified cities *for a taste*.
 27 "That's why their people lacked the
 power,
 Dismayed and confounded an hour,
 They were like the grass of the field,
 And as the green herb without yield,
 The grass on the housetops to wilt
 Before the wind *and the wind's silt*.
 28 "Yet I know where you're coming from,
 Your advance and your retreat's sum
 And your rage against Me *like bum*.
 29 "Because your rage against Me and
 Your tumult has come up to stand
 In My ears, therefore I'll put hook
 In your nose and bridle to brook
 Your lips and I will turn you back
 In the way you came up to track.
 30 "And this shall be a sign to you,
 You'll eat this year such things as grew
 Of themselves, in the second year
 The same such things as so appear,
 And in the third year you shall sow
 And reap and plant vineyards to grow
 And eat the fruit of what *you know*.
 31 "What has escaped of Judah's house
 Shall once again take root and spouse,
 And bear fruit upward once to grow.

The little girls that run the streets with
 shout
 Around Jerusalem and all about
 Make ditties to sing at their games in scorn
 That Sennacherib ever had been born.
 I wonder if the king learned of their play,
 I wonder if he heard what lasses say
 About him and his might, his gods and all
 The deeds of valour he struck on the wall.
 Beloved, I scorn the mountain and estate
 Of those who have led armies round of late
 And tell their names derided for their fate

To bird and beast I meet upon my hill.
Not one of them's impressed as I relate
How many came about today to kill.

32 "Out of Jerusalem shall go
A remnant, and those who escape
Out of the mountain fortress shape
Up in the zeal of YHWH agape."
33 "Therefore so says YHWH of the king
Of Assyria, 'He'll not bring
Himself to this city, nor shoot
An arrow there, neither shall boot
Or his shield come, not throw a mound
Of earthworks against it on ground.
34 "By the way which he comes, he'll go
Back and shall not enter the row,'
Says YHWH. 35 'For I'll defend this town
To save it for My own renown,
And for my servant David's sake.'"
36 It happened that night that came out
The angel of YHWH, put to rout
The camp of the Assyrians
And killed as many in their cans
As hundred eighty-five thousand,
So when they got up dawn at hand,
See, all dead bodies *on the sand*.
37 Sennacherib Assyrian king
Turned back and left and then took wing
Back to live by Nineveh's *spring*.
38 It happened as he bowed before
Nisroch his god in temple store,
That Adrammelech and Sharezer
His sons attacked and killed the geezer
With a sword, and they both escaped
Into Armenia's land well graped.
And Esarhaddon his son reigned
In his place *since he was unfaned*.

That's what a king gets for his bowing
down
Before the idols of his sodden crown.
Nisroch is sure to be a disappointment
To those who serve before him in their
ointment.
Sons kill their fathers in the growing tale
Of competition for the right of sale.
Competing is the fastest way to fail
Is something every wise man's come to
know.
How few seek out their wisdom in the
show.
Art is the greater part of human breath,

All else just hurries on the coming death.
Beloved, I turn to You in sound and song
And flee away from every thing that's
wrong,
Until I find Your throne's eternal glow.

Isaiah 38

1 In those times Hezekiah fell
Ill like to die. And come to tell
Him was the prophet Isaiah
The son of Amoz, with éclat
Said to him, "So says YHWH, 'Set now
Your house in order, and your brow,
For you'll die, not live *anyhow*.'"
2 Then he turned his face to the wall,
And prayed to YHWH, *began to bawl*,
3 "I pray You, YHWH, remember now
How I have acted by Your face
In truth and with a perfect race
Of heart and have done good before
Your eyes." Hezekiah wept sore.
4 A word of YHWH to Isaiah
Said 5 "Go say to Hezekiah,
'So says YHWH David's Alohim,
Your father, I have heard your scream,
And I have seen your tears, just see,
I'll add to your days fifteen years.
6 "And I'll deliver you *from fears*,
And this town from the power's spree
Of the king of Assyria:
And I'll defend this city's *paw*.
7 "This is the sign I'll give to you
From YHWH, to prove that YHWH will do
This thing that He has promised to.
8 "See, I'll bring back again the shade
Of the degrees which have been laid
On the sun dial of Ahaz ten
Degrees backward,'" and so again
The sun returned ten degrees, by
Which degrees it had run the sky.

If Ahaz was inventor of the trick
To catch time by the sun dial with a flick,
Then I approve his symmetry, and yet
This miracle smacks of ignorance' set.
I know how it is possible, I think,
To raise the dead up from the ghastly brink,
And how to turn the water into wine
As do the man-gods here and there and
fine,
And how to curse a fig-tree lost in leaves,
But turning back the earth on axis grieves

My sore incredulity, unless forbid,
It means the sun's a ball of fire that hid
A few miles above the earth where it rid
A chariot around the mortal sleeves.

9 Writing of Hezekiah king
Of Judah, when he took the sting
And was recovered from the fling.
10 I said in cutting off my days,
I shall go to grave's gates *in praise*,
I am deprived of what is left
Of my years *lying here bereft*.
11 I said I shall not see YHWH more,
YHWH in the land of living shore,
I shall look on the face of man
No more with dwellers in world's span.
12 My pilgrimage is finished here,
Been taken from me like the gear
Of a shepherd's tent, I have drawn
Together like a weaver's *pawn*
My life: in weakness I'm cut off,
From day to night You come to scoff
At me. 13 I worry till morn's light,
That like a lion my bones He'll blight,
From day to night that You will make
An end of me *without a wake*.
14 And like a crane and swallow I
Did chatter, mourning like a dove,
And so I raised on high my eye,
O YHWH, oppression *and not love*
Is on me, be my surety.

King Hezekiah may have been the first
To take the image of the crane uncursed
For the soul crying in its last complaint,
And longing for the martyred, blood-
soaked saint.

The voice of the crane in my heart resounds
Across the universe, across its bounds
In search of that far mountain where the
stakes

Are planted in the bosom of earth's lakes.
Beloved, the day is fraught with sorrow's
speech,

The night is heavy with the words You
preach,

And yet I raise my eyes to find Your way,
Your throne and Your salvation and the ray
Of knowledge that no I can bear the groan,
Because there is no I but You alone.

15 What shall I say? He spoke to me,

He Himself has gone on the spree:
I shall go timidly my years,
And feed my soul with bitter tears.
16 O Lord, by these things men must live,
And all of these life's spirit give:
So heal me then and make me live.
17 Instead of peace see bitterness:
By You to my soul love confess
To take it from the pit's address
Of such corruption, You have cast
All my sins at Your back *at last*.
18 For the grave never shall praise You,
Nor can death celebrate Your view,
Those who go down into the pit,
Cannot hope for Your truth in wit.
19 The living truly shall praise You,
As I do this day; fathers too
To their offspring make known the true.
20 YHWH's there to save me, therefore we
Will sing my songs to melody
Of stringed harps all days of our life
In the house of YHWH *without strife*.

The king believes his eyes and ears to say
The dead do not arise in tomb to pray,
Nor sing the praises of the heavenly way.
Let that be my path to the truth and right:
The witness of the senses and the bright
Focus of human reason for delight.
Did You not form the human mind to seek
And rely on the syllogistic peek?
Yet with his reasoned argument the king
Turns to You to remind You of a thing:
The dead give no praise on the loving wing,
And so it's in Your interest to give life
As long as You would hear praise lifted
rife.

Beloved, does interest in all things have
sting?

21 Isaiah had said "Let them take
A lump of figs, and place the stake
For a compress upon the boil,
And he shall get well from his spoil."
And Hezekiah also said
"What is the sign by which I'm led
To go up to YHWH's house instead?"

If the physician now relied upon
The lump of figs instead of pills
withdrawn,
No doubt a king or too could be kept fresh

And out of the coils of death's early mesh.
If the physician now relied in brief
Upon the remedies of nature's thief,
No doubt the body that bends down in grief
Might rise again to whirl one more round
gone.

Beloved, I take the fig as fresh and fair,
Filled with its gleaming seeds and pinkish
ware,

And mind the days when my grandfather
bore

The brunt of cultivating figly shore.
The memory of sunlight that is past
Is healing to the heart shot at half-mast.

Isaiah 39

1 At that time Marodach-Baladan,
Baladan's son, king of Babylon,
Sent letters and a present to
Hezekiah, for he had cue
That he had been sick and at last
Had been healed from the illness cast.
2 And Hezekiah overjoyed
Showed them the house of his employed:
The silver and the gold and spice,
The precious perfumes to suffice,
And all his armoury and all
The treasures found there in their stall;
And there was nothing under roof
Of his dominion that was proof
Against the showing of the king,
Hezekiah showed everything.
3 Isaiah the prophet came in
To Hezekiah king *with din*
And said to him, "What said these men
And where have they come from again?"
And Hezekiah said "From far,
They've come from Babylon's land's
star."

4 Then he said "What did they see here
In your house *of your wealth and gear?*"
And Hezekiah said "All things
In my house they have seen in rings;
There has not been a thing that I
Did not show them when they came by
To see my treasures *and to spy.*"

5 Isaiah said to Hezekiah,
"Hear the message of YHWH's *pariah*:
6 "See, the days come that all that's in
Your house, what your fathers in bin
Have saved up till this very day
Is borne to Babylon away,

And nothing shall be left," says YHWH.
7 "And of your sons come from your ewe,
Whom you beget, they'll take, and they
Shall be eunuchs and there they'll stay
In palaces of Babylon
To serve the king from dawn to dawn."
8 Then said Hezekiah unto
Isaiah, "Good's the word of YHWH
That you have spoken *in my view.*"
He said in explanation too,
"For there shall be peace, it is true,
In all my days *and without rue.*"

Perhaps You meant to take the grand theme
of

The history of Your folk from above,
Perhaps Isaiah too saw boding fear
Of what should happen in another year,
But Hezekiah took the view of wise
And local man, a view not to despise.
Prosperity and peace do not last long
In any day and clime, in any song,
And so the message that it shall be well
For all my lifetime is a welcome spell.
Kings must be down to earth, see the
concrete,

If they are to survive and so compete
With forces that destroy the house and
home:

Eternity's the case only of Rome.

Isaiah 40

1 "Give comfort, comfort to My folk,"
Says your Alohim *at the stroke*.
2 "Speak comfortingly to the town
Jerusalem, cry down her frown,
Her battle is accomplished and
Iniquity pardoned to stand;
For she has received at YHWH's hand
The double for all her sins *planned.*"

The concept of atonement for the sin
The people have committed comes to win.
The double in the punishment abroad
Suffices to forgiveness from their God.
What use then is the sacrifice on crosses
To satisfy Jewish and Roman bosses?
If the captivity makes all things right
Then human sacrifice is just a blight.
Beloved, I find no comfort in the way
Of Babylon, nor ease in the king's pay.
Let evil fail and fall before Your stroke,

While You have mercy on Your wayward folk.

Isaiah's comfort is too hard to bear
By any people foundered anywhere.

3 The voice of one to cry aloud
In desert places for a crowd,
"Prepare the way of YHWH and make
Straight in the wilderness a wake
For our Alohim *and His sake*."

4 Every low place must be filled in,
And every bump and lump in bin
Scraped clear, and the crooked made
straight,

And the rough places smooth in rate:

5 And YHWH's glory shall be revealed,
And all flesh shall see it unsealed;

For YHWH's mouth has come to relate.

6 The voice said "Shout!" He answered
then,

"What shall I shout? For among men
All are grass and the beauty there
Is like the flower on a field bare."

7 The grass shall wither and the flower
Shall fade before the breath in power
Of YHWH, the folk are just grass there.

8 The grass shall wither, the flower fade,
But the word of our God is made
To stand for ever *in parade*.

How many quote these words for centuries
In view of John the Baptist in the breeze,
In view of Jesus Christ bent to his knees
Three times beneath the muddy Jordan's
wave

As though in a prediction of the grave?
And yet the truth remaining after all
Have raised a hallelujah with the call
Of Haendel rushing through the well-filled
hall,

Is that the people are as the grown grass,
Tough to the teeth and stubborn in the
mass,

But ready now to wither and to take
The faded blossom smoothly in the wake.
The highway is set high and packed and
spent,

But You remain ensconced in Your own
tent.

9 O Zion, who bring good news, go
Up on the high mountain and show;

Jerusalem, who bring good news,
Lift up your voice aloud in cues,
Proclaim and do not be afraid,
Say to the cities of the stayed
Judah, "Your Alohim's arrayed!"

10 See the Lord YHWH will come in
power,

His arm shall rule for Him the hour;
See His reward is with Him too,
And His work before Him in view.

11 He'll feed His flock like shepherd true;
He'll gather the lambs in His arm,
And bear them on His breast from harm,
And gently lead the suckling dam.

12 Who's measured the palm of His hand
To find the waters in their stand?

The heavens by span, who's meted out,
And comprehended without doubt

The dust of the earth, and has weighed
In scales the mountains and the stayed
Hills in a balance *of redoubt*?

13 Who's guided the spirit of YHWH,
Or counselled Him to teach a cue?

14 Whom did He consult for advice,
To teach him ways of judgement *nice*,
To give Him knowledge and to share
With Him understanding *with care*?

The measure of the hollow of Your hand,
Beloved, is just the shape of human
spanned,

The clay once moulded to receive the
breath

Of life from You, who hold him back from
death

With the waters and dust that You create
A haven for the soul of human mate.

The measure is well taken in the slight
And sweet body of humankind in sight,
The last thing in Your dream and song that
might

Arise upon the sixth day of the bourn
To find in all creation making's morn.

The measure, my Beloved, is truly great,
Though not for wealth and wisdom in the
state,

But that the measure's Your hand not
forlorn.

15 See how the nations are a drop
In the bucket, and counted fop
Of dust in the scales; see, He takes

Up continents as mere tent stakes.
16 Lebanon's not enough to burn,
Its beasts for a burnt offering spurn.
17 All nations before Him are naught,
And counted less than nothing wrought,
And vanity on a breeze sought.

Indeed, the nations are a vanity,
And continents a dribble on the sea,
While the soul living from Your power and
breath

Is the great measure of defying death.
The nation is a nothing, but the man
And woman that comes from Your hand by
plan

Is the infinitude of Your own brood,
The brook of Your creation and the mood
That tales the majesties of universe,
And shakes Your blessings on it for the
curse.

Beloved, the state is small and powerless
Before the image of Your form's address,
Before the will to live and love and do,
Before the praise that one can give to You.

18 To whom will you compare then El?
Or what likeness in image spell?
19 The craftsman melts an image well,
The goldsmith covers it with gold,
Surrounds with silver chains to hold.
20 One too poor for such treasure wrought
Chooses a tree that will not rot,
And finds a carpenter of skill
To make a graven image bought
And such a one to fit the bill.
21 Have you not known? Have you not
heard?

Was it not told you from start stirred?
Have you not understood the deep
Foundations of the earth to keep?
22 The one who sits on the earth's globe,
Above its dwellers as in drove
Of grasshoppers, that stretches out
The skies like a curtain or robe
And pitches like a tent in grove,
23 That brings the princes into rout,
He makes earth's judges vanity.
24 They shall not be planted, and see,
They shall not be sown, their stock free
Shall not take root in the earth's grout,
And He shall blow upon them too,
And they shall wither without dew,

And the whirlwind shall blow away
Their glory like the stubble grey.
25 To whom then will you compare Me,
With whom shall I an equal be?
Says the Holy. 26 Raise up your eyes
Above and see who can devise
These things, that brings out all the pack
By number, and calls without lack
Their names by the power of His might,
For He is strong in power and right
Not to fail in the looming track.

Though that image that You created when
You brought forth on the earth the world of
men

Cannot be compared to Your span and ken,
It is a grace as infinite and true
As anything divine that You may do.
The only way that humankind can take
The way to diminished state in the wake
Of majesty is to create a god
Made of the gold and silver and the sod,
And then sit down upon an ivory throne
Pretending that his own hand has been
shown

In glory of the universe. The bone
And blood relinquish then the glory past
And wallow in the mire of honoured blast.

27 Why do you speak, Jacob, and you
Israel peep saying "My way's view
Is hidden from the sight of YHWH,
And my judgement is passed in dream
Before the view of Alohim?"

28 Have you not known, have you not
heard,

The Alohim of all things stirred,
YHWH the Creator of the wings
Of the earth, does not faint for stings
And is not weary in searchings
Of His knowledge of deed and word?
29 He's giving power to the faint,
And to those not strong for complaint
He multiplies the undergird.

30 Even young men are tired and weary,
And youths may stumble seeing bleary,
31 But those who trust in YHWH renew
Their strength, and they shall mount in
view

Of eagles' wings, and they shall run
And not get tired for what they've done,
And they shall walk and not be faint.

I trust in You, Beloved, and do not raise
A hand, a word or prayer of plaint to faze
My enemy, because I do not know
With certainty who is my mortal foe.
The veils of knowledge in the earthly life
Prevent the knowing when to raise the
strife.

For danger that I might punish a friend
I leave my enemy for You to fend.
Beloved, I beg that You will ruthless be
Eradicating all iniquity
And casting in the dust each soul that takes
A part in slicing me with evil shakes.
From my heart too remove what I lay bare
Of disobedience before Your share.

Isaiah 41

1 Keep silence before Me, O isles,
Let the folk renew strength and smiles,
Let them come near, then let them speak,
Let's come near to judgement *and peak*.
2 Who raised the righteous from the east,
Called him to his foot, gave the feast
Of nations before him and made
Him to rule over kings' parade?
He gave them as dust to his word,
As driven stubble to bow's cord.
3 He pursued them, passed in safety,
By the way his feet did not see.
4 Who's made and done it from the start
Of generations in their part?
I YHWH, the first and with the last,
I am Huu. 5 The isles saw the blast
For fear, the ends of earth in fright
Drew near and came *before the sight*.
6 They helped each one his neighbour and
Said to his brother "Bravely stand."
7 The carpenter encourages
The goldsmith and the one who's biz
Is smoothing with a hammer him
Who beats the anvil, saying *trim*
"For joining it is good," and he
Fastened it with nails and strongly.

Beloved, You come declare Your name and
show
That You are first and last and all the row,
That there is none but You with power and
strength,
That all things are created and at length
Sustained by You alone, and yet the crew

Of humankind has always things in view
To substitute for worship and respect
While they turn from Your glory and
neglect

The right, the just commandment of Your
law

And keep the gold and silver thing in awe.
Beloved, You come declare Your name to
me,

And I turn from distractions on my wee
Wheel of life for a moment, and I see
A glimpse of truth before I eat the raw.

8 But you, Israel, are My servant,
Jacob whom I chose *where to plant*

The seed of Abraham My friend,

9 Whom I have taken from the end

Of the earth, and called you among

The chief men of it to be sung

To you, "You are My servant, I
Chose you not to throw in the sty."

10 Don't be afraid, for I'm with you,
Don't be dismayed, I'm your God *true*:

I'll strengthen you and I'll help you;

Indeed, I'll uphold you *in crew*

By My righteousness' strong hand too.

11 See all those who held Me in wrath

Shall be shamed and lost on the path;

They shall be as naught, all who strive

With you shall perish *from the hive*.

12 You'll look for them and not find them,

The ones who argued on your hem,

Those who war against you shall be

As nothing but an empty spree.

13 For I YHWH your Alohim keep

Your right hand, telling you *what creep*,

"Don't be afraid, and I'll help you.

14 "Don't be afraid now, Jacob's worm,

Men of Israel come out *to squirm*,

I'll help you," says YHWH and the one

Who will redeem you, Holy One

Of Israel, *the One to stun*.

Beloved, You chose our father Abraham,
Who likely's no progenitor in sham
Of my poor soul, to be Your friend and
lover.

You chose the good Jacob beneath the
cover

Of Leah unaware to be Your slave.

And so You have both friend and lover
grave,

And servant to provide what You may
 crave.
 But what am I to You, Beloved, who take
 The friend and lover and the servant's
 cake?
 Though You're Beloved to me, I have no
 ware
 Seducing You to look on me with care.
 Though I'm not worthy to be slave or
 friend,
 Nor lover yet, I cower and I bend
 Before the pearl and ruby that You spend.

15 See, I will make for you a new
 Sharp threshing tool with teeth on too,
 And you shall thresh the mountains down
 And beat them small, and make the brown
 Hills like the chaff *before your town*.
 16 You'll fan them, and the wind shall bear
 Them off, the whirlwind scatter there,
 And you shall rejoin then in YHWH,
 And glory in Israel's Saint *true*.
 17 The poor and needy look for drink,
 None for their tongue failing at brink
 Of thirst, I YHWH will hear their cry,
 I Israel's God will keep their sigh.
 18 I'll open rivers up on high,
 And fountains in the valleys low;
 I'll make the desert land to flow
 And dry land springs of water nigh.
 19 I'll cover desert lands with trees:
 The cedar, the shittah, *to please*
 The myrtle and the olive tree;
 I'll set desert with the fir tree,
 The pine and box together *free*.
 20 So they may see and know and think
 And understand the mass and link,
 How YHWH's power has accomplished
 this,
 Israel's Holy created this.

From Eilat to En-Gedi I looked round
 The desert ways to see what trees are
 found:
 The cedar and the myrtle on the bound
 Behind Jerusalem grew on the ground.
 The olive tree stood there before the town,
 The pine and box together were not brown,
 But everywhere I looked in joy or grief,
 I could not see the shittah for relief.
 Beloved, I must admit that I don't know

What shittah trees look like beneath the
 glow
 Of sunset toward the great sea and its show.
 Perhaps the trees whose names I only guess
 Are among shittah's most blessed address.
 Line up Your trees and bring them in a
 row.

21 Bring near your cause, says YHWH,
 bring out
 Your arguments, says the King *stout*
 Of Jacob. 11 Let them bring them up
 And show us what is in the cup,
 To let them show the former things,
 What they are so we may take wings
 Of thought and know what their end is;
 Or declare to us future whiz.
 23 Show things to come hereafter, so
 We may know that you're gods to grow;
 Do good or evil so we'll be
 Dismayed before the things we see.
 24 See, you are nothing, and your work
 An empty plate, and evil quirk
 Has chosen you *to stand and shirk*.
 25 I've raised up from the north to come
 One, from the rising of the sun
 To call upon My name in sum,
 And he shall raging come upon
 Princes like a brick and like those
 Who tread on the clay *with their toes*.
 26 Who's declared from the start so we
 Might know? And beforetimes to be,
 So we might say that he is just?
 Indeed no one shows from the trust
 Declaring it, none hears your dust.
 27 The first says to the fortress, "See,
 Look at them, and I'll give freely
 Jerusalem one who brings in
 Good news *to hear above the din*."
 28 I saw that there was no one there,
 Even among them to give fair
 Advice, and when I asked a thing
 They could not answer anything.
 29 See, they're all just a vanity,
 Their works are nothing in degree;
 Their molten images are wind
 And mere confusion *where they've sinned*.

Whether the tools of vengeance in the wake
 Of sinful works upon the city's stake,
 Or whether kings given the chance to show
 Their evil hearts in what they do in tow,

They're all a vanity because they know
The worship of their molten idols' glow.
Whether wise in the things of nature's path,
Or stupid in the ways they rise in wrath,
They're empty all because they reap a
swath

Of images for gods to bow and scrape.
Beloved, I decorate my house with crepe
And enter in the chamber where I find
Your feast goes on though I have whined
and dined.

Isaiah 42

1 Look at My servant I uphold,
My chosen one My soul is bold
To favour, I have put My mind
On him, he shall bring forth *the sign*
Of justice to nations' *incline*.

2 He'll not cry or lift up *his voice*,
Nor make himself heard *as by choice*
In the street. 3 A bruised reed he'll not
Break, nor quench dimly burning knot,
But bring out judgement in truth's plot.
4 He shall not fail nor be dismayed
Till he achieve the judgement made
On earth, and borderlands shall wait
For his teaching *to consummate*.

The teaching that You send by word and
speech

Of angel to Your prophets, servants each
Of You in majesty, Beloved, I wait
To hear and follow at my path and gate.
The teaching of the Decalogue I know
From the great and the thundering public
show.

The teaching of the Torah and the Psalms
I hear in melodies that fall as balms.
The teaching of the Gospel too resounds
In ears ready to obey divine bounds.
And last the teaching of noble Qur'an
Echoes upon a dark world for its dawn.
Beloved, I thank You for each servant sent
To kindle love and lighten up my tent.

5 So says Al YHWH creating skies
And stretching them out, to devise
The expanse of the earth and what
Grows out of it, and gives *unshut*
Breath to the people on it and
Their respiration as they stand.

6 I YHWH cantillate you with justice,

Take due hold of your hand *who trust us*,
And keep you and give as a pact
Of the folk, for a light in fact
To the nations. 7 To cure the blind
Eyes, to restore those in the bind
Of prison, those that sit in dark
Out of the prison house *and stark*.

Some say the servant here is the Messiah
But that itself hardly lifts the mind higher,
Since the word follows that Cyrus the Great
Is Your Messiah, My Beloved, in state.

Some say the servant here is Christ the king
Who came in humble form to teach a thing.
But Jesus was a preacher on the street,
So some words here defy the faithful bleat.
Some say the servant here's the one You
sent

Upon the southern desert where You spent
Your last in revelation to the world.
But he was not a healer where he whirled.
Beloved, I doubt not You meant all of them
Whom You sent to the world as precious
gem.

8 I am YHWH Huu's My name, and My
Glory I'll not give to a spy,
Nor My praise to idols cut *sly*.

9 See, the prediction's come to pass,
New things I bring under the glass,
Before they appear I am sure
To tell you about them *secure*.
10 Sing to YHWH a new song, His praise
From the end of the earth to raise
You who go down to the sea and
All that is in it, island strand
And those who live there in the land.

The argument is not so much whom You,
Beloved, sent to take on the human crew,
Whether Cyrus, Messiah or the one
Called Jesus, or Muhammad on the run,
But rather of importance is that none
May have the praise and glory due from
wombs

To the Creator, Judge, Raiser from tombs
To stand before Your face to hear the true.
Who make of prophet a divinity
Of light or flesh or other trinity
Despise Your word and name, Beloved,
and lay

A stumbling-block before the sinners way.

Let me give no praise to an idol made
Of stone or human concepts on parade.

11 Let the desert and its towns lift,
Kedar's villages praise the gift,
Let the dwellers of the rock sing,
Let their shouts on mountaintops ring.
12 Let them ascribe glory to YHWH,
Declare His praise in islands too.
13 YHWH shall go out like a strong man,
Stirring to jealousy *in span*
Like a warrior; and He shall shout
Indeed and roar and set to rout
His foes. 14 I've kept quiet so long;
I've been still and refrained my song;
Now I'll cry like one giving birth;
I'll consume everything of worth.
15 I'll make waste mountains and hills, and
Dry up all their herbs on the sand;
And I'll make rivers islands and
I'll dry up the pools *in their dearth*.
16 And I'll bring the blind by a way
They did not know there where they stray;
I'll lead them in paths they've not known;
I'll make darkness light to be shown,
And crooked things I'll make straight, so
These things I do to keep their show.
17 They shall be turned back and ashamed,
Those who trust in carved idols' famed,
Who say to molten images,
"You are our gods, *so start to fizz*."

The only Jesuses I've ever seen
Are football players on the Latin green,
Or images carved well in stone and sheen
Of marble or dressed on the plate or cloth
With oils and pigments. Beloved, are You
wroth?

The only Jesuses that make appearance
Are those set up in stony chapels clearance.
Perhaps when You promise You'll make
things straight

That were once crooked, You meant to
instate

The molten and the carven to bow down
In worship to such idols on the town.
Or then You meant that those who take the
shame

Of imaged Jesuses for worshipped name
Will be turned back from everything they
claim.

18 Hear, you deaf ones, and look, you
blind,

So you may see *what I've designed*.

19 Who's blind, but My servant? Who's
deaf

As the messenger I sent *reffed*?

Who's blind as the perfect, who's blind
As YHWH's own servant *on the bind*?

20 You see many things, yet do not
Observe the import of the taught;
You open up your ears but fail
To hear the *very bill of sale*.

21 YHWH's well pleased for His
righteousness;

He'll magnify the law's address,
And make it honoured *by the hale*.

22 But this is a folk robbed and spoiled,
All snared in holes, in prisons coiled,
They're a prey without an escape,
A spoil with none to move the scrape.

23 Who of you will listen to this?
Who'll give their ignorance a miss?

24 Who gave Jacob up for the prey,
And Israel into robbers' way?

Did not YHWH against whom we've
sinned?

Because they would not walk *when pinned*

In His ways, nor did they obey
His law, *but always went astray*.

25 So He's poured on him all the wrath
Of His anger, the strength *and lath*
Of war, and set him all around
On fire, and yet he knew not sound;
It burned him while he did not stay
To keep it in his heart *to pray*.

The words seem to suggest that You come
out

In anger when the sinful sing and shout.
Methinks the text is rather meant to say
Destruction is the state of things to stay
In disobedience: it's not result
But the cloud of the sinful way's tumult.
One can imagine that You do not grieve
Men in their punishment for what's up
sleeve,

Because the human mind is so constructed
It's capable of seeing the deducted
In syllogisms vain as well as right.
Beloved, let me walk in the law and light,
Obedient to Your word, though I am not
One of the sons of Jacob perfect wrought.

Isaiah 43

1 And now so speaks YHWH your Creator,
O Jacob, and the One that later
Formed you, O Israel, do not
Be afraid, for I have redeemed
You, and I've called you to the spot;
And you are Mine *for all that's seemed*.
2 When you pass through the waters, I
Will be with you, and under sky
Through rivers, they shall not rise high
Over your head; when you walk through
The fire, you shall not be burned too;
Neither shall the flame catch on you.
3 For I am YHWH your Alohim,
The Holy One of Israel's dream,
Your Saviour: I gave Egypt for
Your ransom, and the greater store
Of Ethiopian and Seba
For you *to keep you in My awe*.
4 Since you were precious in My sight,
You have been honoured for the right,
And I have loved you *day and night*.
5 Do not be afraid, I'm with you:
I'll bring your children *from the dew*
Of the east and gather you from
The west *in the way you should come*.
6 I'll say to the north, "Give them up."
And to the south I'll say like tup
"Do not keep back; bring My sons here
From far away, My daughters' dear
From the ends of the earth *for fear*."
7 Every one who's called by My name;
For I've created him for fame,
I've formed him and created frame.

I guess this passage beautied with delight
Is meant for sacred few before Your sight,
For I have seen the many drown beneath
The flood and I have touched the lily
wreath.

The precious in Your sight are very few:
The others fail before the flash of dew,
And crumple in the flame like a moth
caught

In lantern light in unexpected lot.
Beloved, I leave the lovely and the true
To Your salvation. I pick up the rue
Of those discarded like the falling chips
From sculptor's art, and while with hands
on hips
You see with satisfaction image bright,

I kiss the broken shards in humbler plight.

8 Bring out the blind folk that have eyes
And the deaf with ears *to despise*.
9 Let all the nations gathered be,
And let the folk in assembly,
Who among them can declare this,
And show the former things *we miss*?
Let them bring out their witnesses,
That they may be justified *whiz*,
Or let them hear and say it's true.
10 "You are My witnesses," says YHWH,
"And My servant I've chosen too,
So you may know and believe Me,
And understand that I am He:
Before me there was no El formed,
Neither shall after Me be *stormed*.
11 "I, I am YHWH, and beside Me
There is no Saviour *come to be*.
12 "I have declared and I have saved,
And I have shown when no strange braved
Among you, so you have been staved
As My witnesses," so says YHWH,
"That I am El *and I am true*.
13 "See before day was I am He;
There is none to save from My spree:
I'll work and who'll not let it be?"

You are the only Saviour, I suppose
The avatars of east and west arose
In vain to die on crosses that oppose
Their resurrections in the tales they chose.
You are the only Saviour, I'll not look
To human hand and heart to beat the crook,
For none come to the rescue of a rook
Like me who reads from nature and a book.
Beloved, You are the Saviour, there's no
more
To find or seek upon the rocky shore
Bound tightly by the ice that came so late
To help the greying sky to avoid fate.
Beloved, You are the Saviour from all
things
That haunt the ways of Bedouins and kings.

14 So says YHWH, your Redeemer, He
The Holy One of Israel's *tree*;
"For your sake I have sent to see
In Babylon, and have brought down
All their nobles, Chaldeans' *crown*,
Whose cry is in the ships *from town*.
15 "I am YHWH and your Holy One,

Creator of Israel *when done*
 Your King *for everything you've won.*
 16 So says YHWH, who makes in the sea
 A path, and a trail in the lea
 Of mighty waters in degree;
 17 Who brings out chariot and horse,
 The army and its power *in course*,
 They shall lie down together, they
 Shall not rise up, they've passed away,
 Quenched as the flax *the smoked to stay*.
 18 "Do not remember former things,
 Ancient events' considerations.
 19 "See, I will do a new thing, now
 It shall rise up, shall not your brow
 Know it? I'll even make a way
 In the desert, and rivers stay
 Across the wilderness *to stray*.
 20 "The meadow beast shall honour Me,
 The dragons and the owls to see;
 Because I give waters to be
 Upon the wilderness, and yet
 Rivers in the desert to get,
 To give drink to My chosen pet.
 21 "This folk have I formed for Myself,
 They'll bring out My praise *from their shelf.*"

The story is You brought a chosen folk
 Out of Egypt and with a mighty stroke
 Brought water from the rock to quench
 their thirst
 Before the desert well had come to burst.
 The horse and chariot in that fateful day
 Lay down together in the water's way,
 And lie there still beneath the Red Sea's
 sway,
 And so the power of Pharaoh came and
 broke.
 Beloved, do You mean here that Babylon
 Is also stricken before the bright dawn
 Of Your salvation without a sword drawn?
 The fallen city gleams before my sight,
 The sight of my imagination bright,
 Kindled by syllables of prophet's light.

22 But you have not called upon Me,
 O Jacob; you've been tired of Me,
 O Israel. 23 You've not brought me
 The little flocks of burnt offering,
 Nor have you honoured Me with *springs*
Of sacrifices. I have not
 Made you serve lot with offerings *bought*,

Nor tired you with incense *in plot*.
 24 You've not bought for Me with good
 coin
 Sweet cane, by the fat to enjoin
 Of your offerings you've not filled Me,
 Only you've made Me serve to be
 An excuse for iniquity,
 You've tired Me with your wickedness,
Bound up in your own small address.
 25 I, I am He who comes to blot
 Out your transgressions for My bout,
 I'll not remember more your sins.
 26 Put Me in your remembrance wins,
 Let us come into judgement dins,
 Declare your case so you may be
 Justified *by the things I see*.
 27 Your first father has sinned, and your
 Teachers transgressed against My store.
 28 So I've profaned the temple chiefs,
 And given Jacob curse's briefs,
 And Israel to reproaches' griefs.

Beloved, it's kind of You to come to say
 That You will blot out sins erased away.
 The people in my church hope not for that,
 They'd rather keep their sins and so get fat.
 It's not the blotting out of sins we love,
 But just forgiveness when bush comes to
 shove.
 I put You in remembrance as I whirl
 About the slaughter ground of grace to curl
 A hope and prayer that You'll not brush
 away
 The sinful crumbs that are my plaint and
 prey.
 If you will promise just to cancel debt,
 And forgive failures in the way I've met
 Your laws of love and help, then I will sing
 A sinful ditty to Your golden ring.

Isaiah 44

1 And now hear, O Jacob My servant;
 And Israel, whom I chose observant.
 2 So says YHWH that made you and
 formed
 You from the uterus *well-warmed*,
 A God to help you, so fear not,
 O Jacob, My servant in plot,
 And you, Jeshurun, whom I've got.

Say right now if I'm wrong, Beloved, to
 note

That when You speak of “My servant” by rote

In this part of Isaiah, You define
“My servant” as Your Israel on the vine.
I ask You to strike me dead if I fail
To understand this message of blackmail.
Your servant is clearly and simply just
Israel poured out to see upon the dust.
I ask You to make this clear as I feel
Temptation to find secret sense appeal:
Some say Your servant is just Cyrus met
Upon the throne, some say Your servant set
Is Jesus Christ, and I could well invent
Your servant to be one Muhammad sent.

3 For I'll pour water on the thirsty,
And floods on the dry ground for bursty,
I'll pour My spirit on your seed,
My blessing on your spawn decreed.
4 They'll spring up as among the grass,
Like willows by waters that pass.
5 One shall say “I am YHWH's” and one
Shall call himself by Jacob's run;
One shall submit his hand to YHWH,
And one take name of Israel's crew.

Your way of satisfying thirst reminds
Me of the giant who for thirsty minds
Pours out a thimbleful of water on
His little friend and nearly drowns the don.
It's better to be like the willow set
Beside the quiet streams where it can get
The silent flood by all the roots in town,
And so keep safe and dry the weeping
crown.

But blessing is a blessing, so I take
Both kinds and call them blessed for Your
sake:
Both those whose name is Israel on a spree,
And those who drink Your blessing quietly,
With only Your name for their comfort
here,
And only Your presence about the ear.

6 So says YHWH King of Israel,
And his redeemer for a spell
YHWH of armies *arrayed to tell*;
I am the first, I am the last;
Beside me there's no Allah's *blast*.

The bastard Jew in messianic place
Who tried to tell me two figures of grace

Are mentioned in Isaiah for a trace,
Is fool as well as bastard of his race.

The YHWH that's King and the YHWH
who redeems

Is just one figure, not nightmarish dreams
Of three or four or nine hung from the
beams.

He said the word redeemer here can prove
That Jesus Christ died on the cross to move
Guilt from both Israel and those who
groove.

Beloved, give me a faith with some good
sense,

No nonsense faith, that when it comes,
prevents

Me from falling for tales of mythic store,
And keeps my hand obedient, foot on floor.

The proof that king and redeemer are One
Is in the sentence that ends where begun.
He says I am the first, He says not we.
The same is last, so blast the Trinity.
That speaker who names Himself YHWH
alone

Is God, there is no God of flesh and bone.
Beloved, I take You at Your word and see
The glory of the universe to me
The gauge of hope and light for all set free
From bondage of nonsense in faith's
degree.

I take Your word and cantillate today,
And every day, and on the Sabbath pray
That You alone will be my sovereign King,
Redeemer and Allah of whom I sing.

7 And who, as I, shall call, and who
Shall declare it and set in view,
Since I appointed ancient crew?
And coming things shall all come true
And let them show them what's to do.

Indeed, Beloved, there is no one to stand
And lift a voice like Yours, in words so
grand.

Your song from the first could create the
light

And everything upon which light may
smite.

Your word reveals the past, the future too,
And Your word tells humans what they
must do.

Indeed, Beloved, the pitiful of crew

Who stand to claim the right to speak for
You
Are dastardly ridiculous to see,
They're gold and silver covered poverty.
Beloved, You have appointed from old
time
A folk to hold Your revelation's rhyme
Up to the world in witness. Now I hear
They recite Your commandments twice a
year.

8 Fear not and do not be afraid,
Have I not told you from times stayed
Declaring it *in vast parade*?
You are My witnesses. Is there
A God beside me *anywhere*?
Indeed there is no Allah such,
I know not even one to touch.

There's no Allah but You was well said by
The mouth of Isaiah, while others try.
But You reveal a blush of humour here
When You note that at least it would
appear
That You know not of any such around,
Though men and women, even young are
found
Who may know better than the One who
made
The universe and set it on parade.
Beloved, I do not join the loud guffaw
That You suppressed a while, then hid by
paw,
As it's unseemly for a man like me
To laugh out loud in Your eternity.
But I just smile to hear the little joke
You cracked before You disappeared in
smoke.

9 Idols that idol-makers make
Are all a vanity in stake;
Their sweet things have no profit there,
They testify to their own share,
They do not see, they do not know
To be ashamed of their own show.

The reason idols are so blind to see
The shame of their claims on the scenery
Is simply that they are made in the image
Of their creators running out to scrimmage.
I know a lot of people without wit
To see how stupid they've become in fit

To pretend to such wisdom where they sit,
And yet ignore the true, the great and fair.
Beloved, I find the true when come to share
The words of Your commandments with
the air,
I find the great to overcome all kings,
I find Your law is fairer than all things.
And so I turn from pop and pocket rings
And join the cantillation of Your care.

10 Who has formed a god or a molten
And graven image worth a dolten?
11 See, all his playmates are ashamed,
And craftsmen turn out to be men:
Let them assemble for the blamed
And stand up, for they've come again
To fear and be shamed *in their den*.

I see the fear about me every time
Controllers have a summit meeting climb,
And see the lengths they go to hide
themselves
Behind security of arms and elves.
I see the fear, but do not see the shame.
So far they wallow in their glory game,
The empty file and figments of their rhyme,
The desperate attempt to control all
Who breathe and buy a share of golden
doll.
Beloved, I see the makers of the great
And hollow idols sitting in estate,
And know that shame covers the shining
pate,
Though all unknown in the proud victims
rate.
A pigeon poops above the royal stall.

12 The smith with tongs works in the coals,
And fashions it with hammers' roles,
And works it with strength of his arms.
The smith gets hungry from the charms
And his strength weakens, when he drinks
No water, he gets faint in blinks.
13 The carpenter stretches a rule,
He marks it with a line for tool,
He fits it with planes and he marks
It with the compass set in arcs,
And so produces human form,
According his beauty's norm,
And keeps it in his house *unshorn*.
14 He cuts down cedars, and he takes
The cypress and the oak for stakes,

Which he strengthens among the trees
 Of the forest, he plants in breeze
 An ash and the rain does not freeze.
 15 Then it becomes a thing to burn
 For a man to take and to learn
 To warm himself with it and light
 It kindles and bakes bread's delight,
 Or if he will to make a god
 And worship it upon the sod
 A graven image to fall down
 In obeisance *upon his crown*.
 16 Half of it he burns in the fire,
 By half of it he eats desire,
 He roasts a pot roast, does not tire,
 Is warm indeed, and so exclaims
 "Aha, I'm warm enjoying flames."
 17 And with the rest a god he makes,
 His graven image after cakes,
 And falls down to it and he prays
 In worship before it and says
 "Save me, for you're my god *in games*."
 18 They do not know or understand,
 For He has shut their eyes in band,
 They cannot see, their hearts remand.
 19 None ponders in his heart to know,
 Neither is knowledge there to show,
 "I've burned part in the fire to go,
 And baked bread on the coals that glow,
 And roasted meat to eat the treat,
 And shall I make the rest a feat
 Of an abomination's street?
 Shall I fall down to pray a bit
 To a piece of wood hardly fit?"
 20 He feeds on ashes: deceived heart
 Has turned him away from his part,
 He cannot save his soul nor say
 "Deceit's in my right hand to stay."

If humankind can hardly understand
 That gods made of base metal on the sand
 Are not gods, but imagination's band,
 Then how can people stop to think that
 what
 They have imagined in religion's rut,
 The god defined by human heart and mind,
 And trimmed and trained to keep human
 hearts blind,
 Is not as much the work of human will,
 The fading of the light upon the hill?
 The Trinity is fashioned by the thought
 Of theologian in pagan trap caught,

The hope and help that God can be shaped
 to
 The needs perceived by human sanctions'
 view,
 The egotism of this place and pew.

21 Remember these, Israel and Jacob,
 For you are My servant to wake up.
 I've formed you, and you are My slave,
 O Israel, you'll not meet the grave
 Forgotten by Me *bold and brave*.
 22 I've blotted out, as a thick cloud,
 Your transgressions, and as a cloud,
 Your sins; and so return to Me
 For I've redeemed you faithfully.
 23 So, O you heavens; for YHWH has
 worked,
 Shout, lower parts of earth unperked,
 Break into singing, mountains and
 The forest, every tree in band,
 For YHWH has redeemed Jacob, and
 Honoured Himself by Israel's *stand*.
 24 So says YHWH, your redeemer and
 The One who formed you from womb's
 clanned,
 I'm YHWH that makes all things to be,
 That stretches out the sky to see,
 That spreads abroad the earth by Me.
 25 I make void tokens of deceit
 With their divining spirits meet,
 And prophecies from heart of man,
 Making their wisdom foolish span.
 26 Affirming the word of His slave,
 Performing His messengers' plot,
 He says to Jerusalem grave,
 "You'll be an inhabited lot,"
 And to Judah's cities, "You'll be
 Built up and I'll repair wholly
 The decayed places that you see."
 27 He says to the deep, "Be you dry,
 And I'll dry up the rivers nigh;"
 28 He says of Cyrus, "He is My
 Shepherd, and shall work My will high,
 To tell Jerusalem, 'You'll be
 Built' and to the temple to see
 'Your foundations shall be set down,'" *And so will rise again the town*.

The sequence of blessing is well spread
 out:
 The first thing that is done and without
 doubt

Is the remembrance, service of the stout.
 Only then do You say that You have come
 To blot out all transgressions in their sum.
 For this I am faithful to whirl and call
 Down on this faded flower in earthly stall
 The blessings of the stars and universe
 To blot out every wickedness and curse.
 Only then do I find at last that I
 Unconsciously rise up from where I vie
 And so return to You on earth and sky.
 Let Cyrus rise or fall, the temple's built
 Of things far greater than the stone and silt.

Isaiah 45

1 So says YHWH to His own anointed,
 To Cyrus whose right hand appointed
 I have held up and to subdue
 The nations before Cyrus' view,
 And I will loose the loins of kings,
 To open before him the wings
 Of the two-leaved gates, and the gates
 Shall not be shut from where he waits;
 2 I'll go before you, and make straight
 The crooked places, and the gate
 Of brass I'll shatter and I'll cut
 In two the bars of iron *that shut*.
 3 I'll give you treasures of the dark,
 And hidden riches in the park,
 So you may know that I am YHWH,
 The one to call by your name true,
 I'm Alohim of Israel's crew.
 4 For My servant, for Jacob's sake,
 And Israel My chosen in stake,
 I've even called you by your name,
 I have surnamed you for the game
 Though you knew nothing of My fame.

Pretence or not, no scholar can be sure
 To what extent the text and words are pure.
 But Cyrus will be amazed and turned by
 The prophecy not to fail to comply.
 There is a sense by which the Persians
 made
 Invention of Judaism's parade.
 It was a ploy political to keep
 The far-flung populations on the reap.
 Beloved, the quarrels of the Jew and those
 Who claim to be Your Christians on their
 toes
 Are vain indeed. Cyrus is Your Messiah,
 And any come to follow are pariah.
 The only hope for future is that men

Will choose to keep commandments once
 again.

5 I *am* YHWH, and *there is* no other,
There is no god besides Me, *brother*.
 I will gird you *and set you free*,
 Despite you're having not known me.
 6 That they may know Me from the rising
 Of the sun, from the west *surprising*,
 That there is none beside me. I
Am YHWH, and there's none else *to try*.
 7 I form the light, create the dark,
 I make peace, make the evil *park*,
 I YHWH do all this *on the sly*.

Are You the Lord, and is there none but
 You,
 No other god to whom the loved cries Huu?
 What proofs You give, Beloved, for Deity,
 That though I knew You not You come to
 Me
 To wash and change the diaper that I wear
 Unknown to me, an infant needing care!
 I thought I was an independent scholar,
 Not in a mother's care and prone to call
 her.
 You gird me though I do not see Your hand
 And do not have the strength to understand.
 I have not known though I keep finding
 You
 Each place I turn, in all the things You do.
 Beloved, who change the diapers of my
 flesh,
 Let soul with soul and flesh with flesh
 enmesh.

8 Drop down, you heavens, from above,
 And let the skies pour down and shove
 With righteousness, and let the earth
 Open and let them bring from dearth
 Salvation, and let righteousness
 Spring up together, I confess,
 That I YHWH created *the mess*.
 9 Woe to the one who lives to strive
 With his own Maker. Then let strive
 The potsherd with the potsherd's earth.
 Shall the clay say to one whose berth
 Is to fashion it, "What are you
 Intending to make? What you do,
 Will you make it with some hands too?"
 10 Woe to him who says to his dad,
 "What did you sire?" or to the *glad*

Woman, "What did you come to bear?"

Such is unheard of everywhere.

11 So says YHWH, Saint of Israel,
And his Maker, "Ask of Me well
Things to come concerning My sons,
And of My hands' work in its tons
Inquire of Me *and ask a spell.*

12 "I've made the earth, created there
Humankind upon it to share,
My hands have stretched the skies in sight,
And all their host I've brought to light.

13 "I've raised him up in righteousness,
And I'll direct his ways' address,
He'll build my city and he'll let
My captives go, not for the net
Of price or reward he might get,"
Says YHWH of hosts *in His witness.*

You claim that You've made every man
and son,

And every mother to bear them in tonne,
And so You also made Cyrus for fun,
To rebuild Your town, temple, and begun
To let Your people go back on the run.
If You raise Mede and Persian from their
hill

In righteousness to do and fit the bill,
Then You made me also with time to kill,
And ready to obey with steady will.
If I may ask of You the course events
Of Cyrus and his filling of the tents,
Then I may ask that You guide me aright,
Though my purpose on earth under the
sight

Of sun is not as great as his in might.

14 So says YHWH, "Egypt's labour set,
The marketing of Ethiopia,
And of the Sabeans when met
As men of stature, shall come raw
Over to you and they'll be yours;
They'll follow you in chains *and chores,*
And they shall fall prostrated down
To you, and supplicate your *crown,*
Surely El is with you and there
Is no other Alohims' share,
No other God round anywhere."

15 Truly You're an El to be hidden,
Alohim of Israel unbidden
The Saviour *of all in Your town.*

16 They'll be ashamed, they'll be
surprised,

All of them, they go *undisguised*
Into confusion, those who make
Idols *in pagan, wicked wake.*

17 But Israel shall be saved in YHWH
With everlasting saving *too,*
You'll not be ashamed of the view,
Nor surprised in endless world too.

18 For so says YHWH Creator of
The heavens and the skies above,
Alohim Himself who formed earth
And made it, established its worth,
He did not create it in vain,
But formed it to live on again,
I am YHWH, there's no other here.

19 I've not spoken a secret fear,
In a dark place of the earth near,
I did not say to Jacob's seed,
"You look for Me in a vain need,"
I YHWH speak righteousness indeed,
I declare the right things *decreed.*
20 Assemble yourselves and come near,
Draw together, you *without fear*
Who have escaped from the nations.
They have no knowledge *in their buns,*
Who carry the wood of their carved
Image, and pray to a god *starved*
That cannot save. 21 Tell and bring out
Your argument, yes, without doubt
Let them take counsel in their numbers.
Who has declared this *without slumbers*
From ancient time? *Who* has told it
From that time? *Have* not I, YHWH *fit?*
And *there's* no other Alohims
Besides Me, a just Alohims
And Saviour, none beside Me *sit.*

Is there no just God and a Saviour but
This One, this You beloved, who tell me
what

Is counsel from most ancient time? Have
they

Searched high and low to find a god at bay
And failed to find any but You? Perhaps
These modern days have filled our ample
laps

With technicalities of deep research
And with a microscope we'll find the perch
Where sits another god. Or if You'd rather,
I'll take a telescope, worked to a lather,
And find behind some distant star Your
mate

In hiding, call her so she won't be late.

Till then my soul is satisfied to find
Her eye for other gods continues blind.

22 Look to Me for salvation, all
The ends of the terrestrial ball,
For I am El, there's not at all
Besides Me on which you may call.
23 I've sworn by Myself, the word's gone
Out of My mouth in righteous spawn,
And it shall not return back there,
That every knee shall bow, and swear
Shall every tongue to Me *outdrawn*.
24 Only in YHWH, shall a man say,
"Have I righteousness and the lay
Of strength," to Him such a one comes
But ashamed are all those in sums
Displeased with Him *upon their bums*.
25 In YHWH shall all of Israel's seed
Be justified, gloried indeed.

I guess they guess that You are Jesus when
You say to look to You for saving then,
Since Jesus is so often called by name
Of El and so achieved the greater fame.
Beloved, only in YHWH, in You alone
Shall a man stay to say that You atone,
And that he has the righteousness and
power
To worship at Your throne a day and hour.
Beloved, cast shame on all who look to
man
For their salvation and strategic plan,
On all who have a saviour in the guile
Of church and government and club and
smile.
In You alone let Israel justified
Rise up in glory to sit at Your side.

Isaiah 46

1 Bowed down is Bel, stooped is Nebo,
Their idols for the beast and *show*
Of cattle, burdens loaded mired,
A weary burden for the tired.
2 They slouch and then collapse, they could
Not save the one that carried wood,
And they go to captivity.
3 Listen to me now, Jacob's tree,
And all that's left of Israel's house,
Borne from the belly under blouse,
And carried from the womb's degree.
4 Even to ancient days I'm He,
And to grey hairs I carry, made

And still I bear, bring on parade.

Babylon was called great for many things:
The rise of warlike and of noble kings,
The building of walls high and thick and
round
A city state that filled surrounding ground,
The planting of such gardens that amazed
The world of heathen worship come half-
crazed.
The greatness and success attributed
To Babylon's gods and goddesses hid
Before the coming of Cyrus too great
To set up on its throne another state.
Beloved, both gods and men collapse to see
Penetrating rays of eternity,
You only stay immovable and sane,
You and the law on Sinai always reign.

5 "To whom will you liken Me and
Make me an equal one to stand,
Compare Me so we're of one band?
6 "They lavish gold out of the bag,
And weigh the silver down to sag,
And hire a goldsmith so he'll make
Of it a god: such just falls down,
And yet they worship it *with crown*.
7 "They bear him on the shoulder, they
Carry him and set in array,
And there he stays, not to remove
From the place where he's set to prove,
Indeed one may cry out to him,
Yet he cannot answer for trim,
Nor save him from his trouble dim.
8 "Remember this and stand like men,
Bring it to mind, sinners, again.
9 "Remember former things of old,
For I am El, there's none else told,
I'm Alohim, there's none like me,
10 "Declaring the end from the start,
And from old times still to depart,
Saying 'My counsel here shall stand,
I'll do all My pleasures demand.'
11 "Summoning from the east a fowl
Of ravenous hunger *like owl*,
From a far land the man of My
Counsel, indeed, I've spoken why,
I bring it in, formed to comply.
12 "Listen to Me, stout-hearted men,
Far from righteousness *in your den*.
13 "I shall bring near My righteousness,
It will not be cut from address,

And My salvation shall not wait,
I'll put salvation in the gate
Of Israel's fortress for My state."

There is none like You, no, not one to be
A God with You to die on Calvary.
Although You send salvation by the hand
Of human power, great Cyrus come to
stand,

There's none to be compared like grain of
sand

To the mountain of Your being's
command.

There's none like You, Beloved, You only
are

God reigning over sun and moon and star
Relentlessly obeying divine will:
It's only man chooses rebellion still,
And in that choosing loses faith and fame,
Loses the right to liberty's bright flame.
Salvation does not wait for future years,
But comes the morning Cyrus once
appears.

Isaiah 47

1 Come down then and sit in the dust,
Virgin daughter of Babel's crust,
Sit on the ground, there is no throne,
Daughter of the Chaldeans' bone:
For you shall no more have the name
Of tender and delicate frame.
2 Take millstones and grind flour *in bed*,
Uncover hair, make bare unwed
Leg, and uncover the thigh too,
Pass through the rapine floods to do.
3 Your nakedness is brought to light,
Your shame revealed to all men's sight:
I'll take revenge and I'll not meet
You as a man upon the street.
4 For our redeemer, YHWH of hosts
Is His name, Saint of Israel's boasts.
5 Sit in silence, hide in the dark,
Daughter of the Chaldeans' lark,
For you shall no longer be called
The lady of kingdoms installed.
6 "I was angry with My folk and
I have polluted My own land,
And given them into your hand:
You did not show them mercy then,
But set hard yokes on the old men."

Though Babylon is long gone on a day,

And Cyrus lies within his grave for pay,
The spirit and the act oppressing men
Is still crushing the earth, crushing again.
Salvation brought by Cyrus has been seen
To wallow after time upon the green,
And in his stead arose a king and queen
Without the mandate of Your righteous
mien.

Beloved, You did not promise any more
Salvation from the saviours on Your shore,
And maybe that is best, since each one
turns

Into the despot for the grace he earns.
The Decalogue You implement alone
By the small voice that nothing can atone.

7 You said "I'll always be a queen,"
So you did not with serious mien
Take this to heart and so to mind
The end of the *grossly unkind*.
8 So now hear this, in pleasures sunk,
Living a careless life and drunk,
You who say in your heart "I'm great
And there's no other of such state
Beside me; I shall never sit
A widow, neither know the grit
Of losing children to the pit."

9 But these two shall come on you fast
In one day, loss of offspring cast,
And widowhood; they'll come on you
Fully for all the crowd in view
Of sorceries, enchantments due.
10 For you've trusted in wickedness;
You've said "No one sees my address."
Your wisdom and your knowledge, it
Perverts you, so you say in fit,
"I'm great, and there's no one beside
Me to rule sun and turn the tide."

11 That's why evil shall come on you,
You'll not know whence it came in view:
11 Catastrophe shall fall on you;
You'll not be able to put off
The desolation come to scoff
As suddenly as you have clue.

12 So stand with your enchantments and
The crowd of sorceries you've manned,
In which you've laboured from your youth,
And see if you have profit proof
Or if you can prevail to stand.

13 You're tired of making all your plans.
So now let astrologers' scans,
The stargazers' in monthly view,

Stand up and save you from the due
 That rushes in to conquer you.
 14 See, they shall be as stubble straw,
 The fire shall burn them in its maw,
 They'll not deliver themselves from
 The power of the flame to come:
 It's not a coal to warm beside,
 A fire to sit before and bide.
 15 So shall they be to you with whom
 You've worked and marketed in room
 From your youth up, they'll wander each
 One to his quarter, none shall reach
 Out to save you *from fire and leech*.

Chaldean wisdom studied how the stars
 Move round the sky and rule both men and
 gars.

That science was set up to profit state,
 The ruler in his palace not come late.
 The wisdom of old Babel is still here
 In dress of science to profit with gear
 To global pontiffs and the marketeer
 Not limited by either bolds or bars.
 Beloved, I see catastrophe come down
 As sudden on the modern market town
 As on the ancient city of renown.
 The scientists have sold their knowledge
 well,
 Subjected it to statistics and spell,
 And so they wonder at the coming knell.

Isaiah 48

1 Hear this, O house of Jacob, which
 Are called by name of Israel switch,
 And have come out of Judah's pool,
 Who swear by YHWH's name *as a rule*,
 And cantillate Alohims' name
 Of Israel, but not in *flame*
Of truth or righteousness in school.
 2 They say they're of the holy city,
 And trust in Israel's Alohims,
 YHWH of hosts is His name *in beam*.
 3 I have declared *and without pity*
 The former things from the start *gritty*,
 And they went out of my mouth's *ditty*,
 And I showed them, and suddenly
 I made them happen *visibly*.
 4 Since I knew you were stubborn and
 Your neck is like an iron band,
 Your forehead like a brass *lampstand*,
 5 I've from the start declared to you,
 Before it happened come in view

I showed you the thing I would do,
 Lest you should say "My idol true
 Has done these things, image of mine
 Graven and molten *come to dine*
 Commanded what should be *as due*."
 6 You have heard it, now see it's true;
 And will you not admit the view?
 I've showed you new things from this time,
 The hidden things *of prose and rhyme*,
 And you did not know them *a dime*.
 7 They are created now, and not
 From the beginning of the slot,
 Even before the day when you
 Did not hear them, lest by their cue
 You might say "See, I knew them too."
 8 Indeed you did not hear or know,
 Indeed from that time your ear's *stow*
 Was not opened: because I knew
 That you would deal a treacherous view,
 And were called a transgressor's name
 From the womb, *and so is your fame*.

Prediction of the future is a mark
 To prove that You are unique in the park
 Of gods and goddesses left in the dark.
 You tell the prophet what will come to pass
 So that when things take place the human
 mass
 Will have to admit that You're God not
 gas.

We have a way to get around the fact
 By saying that prediction has been packed,
 And Cyrus' name was added to impose
 Upon the tyrant in imperial rows
 When competition with the other nations
 Required ethnic groups to improve their
 stations
 In any way they could. Court machinations
 Produced it and not divine inspirations.

9 For my name's sake I will relent
 From My wrath, and for My praise lent
 I will refrain from you, so I
 Will not cut you off *under sky*.
 10 See, I've refined you, not with siller;
 I've chosen you from trouble's pillar.
 11 For My own sake, and for My own
 I will perform the thing alone,
 So I shall never be blasphemed,
 To give My glory to unseemed.
 12 Listen to Me, O Jacob and
 Israel, the ones I've called in band;

I'm He I am the first and last.
 13 My hand also has laid and cast
 Foundation of the earth, and My
 Right hand has laid span on the sky:
 And when I call to summon them,
 They stand together *at My hem*.
 14 Gather together all and hear;
 Which of them has proclaimed this gear?
 YHWH loved him and so He will do
 His pleasure on Babylon's crew,
 And His arm on Chaldean's too.
 15 I, it is I who've spoken true;
 I've called him; I have brought him too,
 And he shall prosper *in My view*.

If Israel or Babylon had kept
 Your ten commandments, they'd never
 have wept,
 But lived on in peace all eternity.
 Now all have sinned and Your choice is the
 spree
 Of fell destruction on all human tree,
 Or then to save a few in Your mercy.
 Beloved, My advice is to kill the lot
 And start afresh with some other in plot.
 At least have mercy on my favourite king.
 For Your own sake alone You keep the ring
 Of life in motion, for Your entertainment,
 You gather all before Your throne's
 arraignment,
 And blow Your breath to cool Your cup of
 tea
 As You gaze on Your game of strategy.

16 "Come near to Me, hear what I say;
 I don't talk in a secret way
 From the start; from the time long past,
 There am I: Now Lord YHWH has cast
 His spirit to send me *to stay*."
 17 So says YHWH, your Redeemer, He
 The Holy One of Israel's *tree*;
 "I'm YHWH your Alohim to be
 Your teacher to profit in fee,
 Who leads you by the way to go.
 18 "O that you'd followed all the show
 Of My commandments! Then your peace
 Had been like a river's release,
 Your justice like sea-waves' increase.
 19 "Your spawn too had been like the sand,
 The offspring of your loins to stand
 Like gravel there, his name should not
 Have been cut off before My plot.

20 "Go out to Babylon and flee
 From the Chaldeans, with the spree
 Of singing declare this and say
 It to the end of the earth's *day*;
 Say 'YHWH's redeemed Jacob His slave.'"
 21 If they are thirsty for the wave,
 He'll lead them through the desert land;
 He'll bring out water from the rock,
 Split the rock, waters burst the lock.
 22 "No peace," says YHWH, "for wicked
 stock."

The world still talks of peace despite the
 head
 Of war greater than anything instead,
 The poisoned bombs the USA has spread
 Across the Middle East to show how led
 By crucifixion people find solutions
 Irrational instead of revolutions.
 The world still talks of peace and of Islam
 But never seeks to keep commandments'
 balm.
 Beloved, I grasp the ten commandments
 now
 And write them on my hand and heart and
 brow.
 I seek the way that You pointed out when
 You spoke from Mount Sinai to chosen
 men
 From every tribe and nation in the glen.
 And so I receive peace from sheep and
 cow.

Isaiah 49

1 Listen now, islands, to me, hear,
 Nations from far off, *lend an ear*,
 YHWH from the womb has called me
 clear,
 From mother's belly my name's dear.
 2 He made my mouth like a sharp sword,
 In His hand's shadow is my ward,
 He fashioned me a polished shaft,
 And in His quiver hid me *chaffed*.
 3 He said to me, "You are My slave,
 O Israel, in whom the wave
 Of My glory *kindles the sword*."
 4 Then I said "I've laboured in vain,
 I've spent my strength in empty pain,
 Surely my judgement is with YHWH,
 And my work in Alohim's view."
 5 And now says YHWH that fashioned me
 From the womb His servant to be,

To bring Jacob again to Him,
Though Israel's not gathered *and trim*,
Still I'll be glorious in the eyes
Of YHWH, and my Alohims' prize
Shall be my strength *in every guise*.
6 And He said "It's an easy thing
To be My servant to the wing
Of Jacob's tribes and to restore
The saved of Israel *by the score*:
I'll also set you for a light
To the Gentiles, so you'll have right
To be My salvation to all
The ends of the earth *by the call*."

Some say the Jewish people are Your own
To save themselves and stay for You alone.
Some say they are Your chosen to present
The true faith to the world by what You
meant.

Some say they are Your loved since they
produced

An innocent to kill upon the cruced
In sacrifice vicarious and human
In an atonement sought for sins' acumen.
But I say, my Beloved, they are a light
To the world for preserving in words right
The ten commandments once addressed to
all

The mix of nations who came from the stall
Of Egypt and stood by the mount in thrall.
They serve You who make Your
commandments bright.

7 So says YHWH, the Redeemer of
Israel, his Holy One above,
To him that man despises and
To him whom the nation has banned,
To rulers' servant, kings shall see
And stand up, princes also flee
To worship, because Israel's Saint
YHWH's faithful choosing to acquaint
You *from among earth's progeny*.

8 So says YHWH, "In appointed time
Acceptable *to Me in rhyme*
I've heard you, in salvation's day
I've helped you, and I'll keep your way,
And give you for a covenant
Of the folk for establishment
Of the earth to bring back the lot
Inherited but fallow brought.
9 "So you may say to prisoners,
'Go free,' to those that darkness stirs,

'Appear.' They'll feed around the town
In pastures cast up *by the crown*.
10 "They shall not hunger, no, nor thirst;
Neither shall the heat on them burst,
Nor the sun strike them, for the One
Who has mercy on them's begun
To lead them, even by the springs
Of water shall be His guidings.
11 "I'll make all My mountains a way,
And My highways lifted *to stay*.
12 "See, these shall come from far, and
watch

How these from north and west *for notch*,
And these from land of Sinim's *pay*."

13 O heavens, sing! Be joyful, earth!
And break out in singing *and mirth*,
O mountains! For YHWH's comforted
His folk, pardoned His afflicted.

Beloved, You were Redeemer long before
The councils of the church gathered in
score

To find a way to save the Roman state:
You were Redeemer of the Jewish mate
Who came back from Babylon to create
A blossom in the desert and a star
Of righteousness in the Judean bar.
I've seen the highways lifted toward the
hill

Jerusalem marks out beyond the still
Dawn and leave at my back that Jericho
That through millennia has come to glow.
In silence my heart turns toward the brief
Almost inaudible song of new leaf,
The mountain singing, heaven and earth
leave grief.

14 But Zion said, "YHWH has forsaken,
I'm in His forgetfulness taken."

15 "Can a woman forget her child,
The one that she is nursing *mild*
And not have compassion upon
Son of her uterus *and spawn*?
Surely they may forget, yet I
Will not forget you, *though I try*.

16 "See, I have inscribed you upon
The palms *of My hands*, your walls *drawn*
Are always here before My face.

17 "Your sons shall make haste *from this*
place,

Your spoilers and those who laid waste
Shall go away from you *in haste*.

18 "Lift up your eyes, *and* look around
 And see, all these gathered in bound
 To you. *As* I live," says YHWH, "You
 Shall surely clothe yourselves in due
 With them all as an ornament,
 And bind them as a bride *intent*.
 For your waste and your desolate
 Places, and the land of your rate
 Of destruction, shall even now
 Be too narrow where dwellers cower,
 And those who swallow up somehow
 Will be sequestered far and late.
 20 "The offspring to replace the lost
 Shall say again in your ears *tossed*,
 'There is no room to spread out here,
 Give me more land to live with gear.'
 21 "Then you shall ponder in your heart,
 'Who has engendered me this part,
 Seeing that I have lost my spawn,
 Am desolate, a captive drawn,
 Removing to and fro *by dawn*?
 And who has brought up these? And see
 I was left all alone to be,
 And these where had they come *like*
dart?'"

Beloved, no doubt the promise made was
 kept,
 And the land spawned the children of the
 wept,
 But soon as numbers rose, new heathens
 swept
 Across the land with sword and plague to
 kill
 The measure of the children who would fill
 That tiny country. Times are always ill.
 Moments of joy, moments of sure reprieve
 May punctuate the hills of timely sleeve,
 But Hellenistic rule is followed by
 The Roman steel pretending from the sky
 To be one more wave of salvation's ply
 Till Arab and Crusader make their nest
 Upon the fortress of the chosen best.
 Your hands are sore with all the names that
 test.

22 So says the Lord YHWH, "See, I'll lift
 Up My hand to the Gentiles' *rift*,
 And set up My flag to the folk,
 And they shall bring your sons from yoke,
 Your daughters on shoulders *like gift*.
 23 "And kings shall be nurturing dads,

And their queens nursing mothers' *pads*,
 They shall bow down to you with face
 Toward the earth, and lick the *trace*
 Of dust from your feet, and you'll know
 That I am YHWH: for they'll not show
 A face of shame who trust My grace.
 24 "Shall prey be taken from the strong,
 Or lawful captive freed for wrong?"
 25 But so says YHWH, "The captives true
 Of the strong shall be snatched out too,
 And the prey of the tyrant saved,
 For I'll contend with him that braved
 You, and I'll save your offspring's crew.
 26 "And I will feed those who oppress
 You with their own flesh in a mess,
 And they shall be drunk with their own
 Blood as with sweet wine to atone,
 And all flesh shall know I am YHWH
 Your Saviour and Redeemer too,
 The mighty One of Jacob's crew."

I do not know the name of one to save
 The world from sin and its transgression's
 grave,
 But I know that the name of Judah's king,
 Her saviour and redeemer on the wing,
 Is not Josh, Jack or John or anything
 That human tongue has marshalled for a
 sting,
 But YHWH. You are the Saviour, You
 alone,
 No other joins You on celestial throne,
 And You are the Redeemer of those men
 Whose ancestors marched back from
 Babel's den.
 The one who brings another saviour near
 Is a usurper and an idol's fear,
 One to drink blood indeed and eat the flesh
 Upon the altar always white and fresh.

Isaiah 50

1 So says YHWH, "Where then is the writ
 Of your mother's divorce *in bit*,
 Whom I have put away *in fit*?
 Or which of My creditors due
 Is it that I have sold you to?
 See, for your sins you've sold yourselves,
 For your transgressions on your shelves
 Is your mother cast out from view.
 2 "Why was there no one when I came?
 Why did no one answer My claim
 When I called? Is My hand so short

That it cannot redeem in sort?
 Have I no power to save? Behold,
 At My rebuke I dry the sea,
 I make the rivers desert-shoaled,
 Their fish stink without water *doled*,
 They all die because they're thirsty.
 3 "I cloak the skies with blackness" veil,
 And make sackcloth their covering scale."

So many people tell me when I ache
 That You are punishing me at the stake
 For leaving such and such a church or yet
 Because You have some purpose I have met.

I'm glad to know that You do not profile
 The coming of oppressor in his guile,
 And You are not the cause of destitution
 Cast on the righteous for a retribution.
 Beloved, I accept that the evils come
 From disobedience to law and rum.
 The result of commandment-breaking here
 Along with drunkenness is more than tear.
 So I shall not blame You for acts of God,
 Catastrophes upon the sea and sod.

4 The Lord YHWH's given me the tongue
 Of the most educated rung
 So I might know how to speak sung
 A word in the right time to those
 Who are weary without repose;
 He wakes me up from morning light,
 And tunes my ear to hear aright.
 5 The Lord YHWH has opened my ear,
 I did not rebel not to hear.
 6 I gave my back to those who smite,
 My cheeks to pluck off hair with spite;
 I did not hide my face from shame
 And from the spitting *of their game*.
 7 The Lord YHWH will come to my aid,
 Therefore I shall not be afraid,
 Therefore my face is set like flint,
 I shall not be ashamed by dint.
 8 He's near to justify my way,
 So who will quarrel with my stay?
 Let's stand together: who's my foe?
 Let him come near and have a go.
 9 See, the Lord YHWH comes to my aid;
 Who's here to condemn my *charade*?
 They all grow old like a skirt worn,
 The moth consumes them *hat and horn*.
 11 See, all you who kindle a fire,
 Surrounded with the sparks of ire:

So walk in your fire's light you've made,
 And in the sparks of your parade.
 This shall you have borne from My hand;
 You shall lie down in sorrow's *band*.

Isaiah makes an issue of the tongue
 He has in capable for prose and sung.
 It's true that rhetoric is power to flail,
 And well-turned phrases top the daily mail.
 But fact is truth once spoken in fine words
 Or in the angry chattering of birds
 Is still a thing unpalatable here
 Where lawlessness is the law of the cheer.
 Beloved, I fly up in the sparks that rise
 From Your own sacrifice of my life's prize
 And wait in whirling at Your throne to see
 The justice that You promise faithfully.
 Let those who stand when darkness
 overtakes
 Find their reward when the new morning
 wakes.

Isaiah 51

1 Hear me, seekers of righteousness,
 Who follow YHWH in His address:
 Look to the rock from which you're cut,
 To the quarry-bed of the glut
 From which you were taken to *bless*.
 2 Look to your father Abraham,
 To Sarah who bore you, *a lamb*:
 For I called him alone and blessed
 Him and increased above the rest.
 3 For YHWH shall comfort the fortress,
 He'll comfort her place of distress,
 He'll prepare from her wilderness
 The like of Eden, and the land
 Of desert a garden for YHWH;
 Joy and gladness shall be in view,
 Thanksgiving and song in a band.

Look to the reed bed where the noble reed
 Grew up to hear the wind like rushing stead
 Invisibly course through the humble air,
 And long with loving anguish to be there.
 Write on my heart, Beloved, the simple lay
 That wandered through the generations'
 play
 That gave birth to my own vision and day:
 The eye of beauty turned on all things fair.
 Beloved, I slink on quiet step among
 The garish trees in desert garden slung,
 The purple and chartreuse of poison vine

Bewitching me from childhood with the
wine
Of Your own presence like the far off wind
That swallows all the courses that have
sinned.
I patter still about the bottom rung.

4 "Listen to Me, My people, and
Give ear to Me, My nation *grand*:
For law will proceed from Me, and
I shall make My justice rest like
A light for the nations *to strike*.
5 "My righteousness *is* near, and My
Salvation has gone forth, and My
Arms will judge the nations: their coasts
Will wait on Me, and on My boasts
They'll trust. 6 "Raise your eyes to the sky,
And look upon the earth go by.
For the skies will vanish away
Like smoke, the earth will age a day
Like clothing, and those who live there
Will die the same way, but salvation
Mine will have an eternal station,
And My righteousness will not be
Abolished *and eternally*.
7 "Listen to Me, *all* you who know
Righteousness, you folk on *the go*
In whose heart *is* My law, do not
Fear the reproach of men *unsought*,
Nor be afraid of their insults.
8 "For the moth will eat their results
Consuming like a garment, and
The worm will eat them like a hand
Of wool, but My righteousness will
Be forever, *eternally*,
And My salvation *shall go out*
From generation *without doubt*
To generations *round about*."
9 Awake, awake, and put on strength,
O arm of YHWH! Awake *at length*
As in the ancient days, as in
The generations *without sin*
Of ancient time. Did You not cut
Rahab apart, *and* wound the *rut*
Of the serpent? 10 *Are* You not *He*
Who once dried up the *barrier* sea,
The waters of the raging deep,
Who turned the sea depths to a road
For the redeemed and where they strode?
11 The ransomed of YHWH shall return,
And come to the fortress *to learn*
With singing, with eternal joy

Upon their heads. They'll obtain joy
And gladness, while sorrow and sighing
Shall flee away *from where they're lying*.
12 "I, *am* He who comforts you.
Who *are* you that you should take view
In fear of a man *who* will die,
And of the son of a man *gone by*
Made like the grass? 13 "And you forget
YHWH your Maker, who stretched the net
Of the heavens and laid the *stone*
Foundations of the earth *alone*,
You've feared continually every day
Because oppressor's furious way
Prepares to destroy. Now where *is*
Oppression and fury of his?
14 "The captive exile hurries, that
He may be loosed from *where he sat*,
That he should not die in the pit,
And that his bread should not omit.
15 "But I *am* YHWH your God, who set
The sea whose waves roared *in the wet*,
YHWH of hosts *is* His name *indeed*.
16 "And I have put My words *and creed*
In your mouth, I have covered you
With My hand's shadow, that I may
Plant the heavens, foundations lay
For the earth, and say to renew
The fortress, 'You're My people too.'"

The wealth for which men kill and others
die
Is just a flick of banker's signature.
More substance lies beneath the empty sky,
Free comer on the dragonfly's allure.
No moth shall touch my treasures hook and
fly
Where I'm the moth myself ready to ply
The hazards of the flame to find the fire
Of Decalogue on Sinai's brewed desire.
Beloved, I seek the gold of righteousness
Portrayed in script of filigree's address,
And bind it in my heart never to pass
Until my spark of life from the dry grass
Flies up into the darkness and impasse
Of spaces infinite by Your throne's lyre.

17 Awake, wake, stand, Jerusalem,
Who've drunk at hand of YHWH the dem
From His wrath's cup, you've drunk the
dregs
Of trembling goblet to last drop.
18 There is no one to guide her legs

Amongst all the sons in her prop,
 Nor is there anyone to take
 Her by the hand in all the wake
 Of children she has raised *in crop*.
 19 These two things have come upon you;
 And who will be sorry for you?
 Such desolation and destruction,
 Famine and sword, in what production
 Shall I find ways to comfort you?
 20 Your sons have fainted and they lie
 At intersections under sky,
 Like a wild bull caught in a net,
 Full of YHWH's wrath from the outset,
 The rebuke of your Alohim.
 21 Therefore now hear this, you afflicted,
 You drunk, but not with wine addicted.
 22 So says your Lord YHWH and your
 God
 Who pleads His people's cause with prod,
 "See, I have taken from your hand
 The cup of trembling, and the stand
 Of My wrath's goblet, you shall not
 Drink any more of what *you bought*.
 23 "But I'll put it into the hand
 Of those who torment you in band,
 Who said to you, 'Bow down so we
 May walk on you,' so in degree
 You lay down on the ground to be
 A street for them *instead of sand*."

I strike the rude rabbis who say the word
 Of Noah's covenant is worth a turd,
 That Gentiles have the duty and the power
 To set up systems of justice an hour.
 I've seen those legislations in their street,
 The trampling of the crushing Gentile feet
 Pretending right and law grow up and meet
 In what they do and say to those who
 cower.
 Beloved, permission from the rabbi horde
 To break Your Sabbath lays men to the
 sword
 Of paw of jungle. Give me yet a sip
 From trembling cup of Decalogue, then slip
 The dagger in my loving heart and hip.
 Let fall the heathen pumpkin and the gourd.

Isaiah 52

1 Awake, awake! Put on your strength,
 O fortress, and put on *at length*
 Your beautiful garments, O city
 Of holiness, Jerusalem!

O city on whom none have pity!
 For the uncircumcised and *hem*
Of the unclean shall no more come
 To you. 2 Shake yourself from the *dumb*
 Dust, arise, sit, Jerusalem!
 Loose yourself from *all* your neck's bonds
 O captive of the citadel
And daughter of the fortress *fronds*,
Loose yourself from your bonds that fell!
 3 For so says YHWH, "Since you have sold
 Yourself for nothing, *from the cold*
 You shall be redeemed without money."
 4 For so says the Lord YHWH, "My honey
 Went down at first into Egypt
 To live there *a while*, and then slipped
 Assyrian and without cause
 To oppress them *beyond all laws*.
 5 Now therefore, and what have I here,"
 Says YHWH, "My folk stolen away?
 Those who reign over them make way
 To wail," says YHWH, "and therefore My
 Name *is* blasphemed each day for aye.
 6 "Therefore My folk shall know My name,
 Therefore *shall know* in that day's *shame*
 That I'm who speaks, 'Indeed, *it's I*.'"

There are so many names beneath the sky
 By which men must be saved and wonder
 why,
 But there is only one name that will last
 Beyond the tempting powers of the blast.
 The names of gods and goddesses still fill
 The eyes and ears and heart climbing the
 hill
 To entertainments temenos to find
 Lush treatment of the well-whiskeyed and
 dined.
 Uncircumcised now pay a tribute fare
 And enter on the temple mount to swear,
 While many that love Your name wait
 beside
 The wailing wall to hear the summons
 cried.
 I enter at the other door and late
 With Muslims in that temenos prostrate.

7 How beautiful upon the hills
 Are the feet of him who fulfils
 Good news, who proclaims Islam [peace],
 who
 Brings glad tidings of good *things too*,
 Proclaims deliverance, who says

To the fortress, "Your God reigns *true!*"
 8 Your watchmen shall lift up *their stays*,
 With their voices they'll sing together,
 For they shall see face to face whether
 YHWH brings back the fortress *to power*.
 9 Break forth in joy, and sing together,
 Waste places of Jerusalem!
 For YHWH has comforted *an hour*
 His folk, redeemed Jerusalem.
 10 YHWH has made bare His holy arm
 In the eyes of nations' alarm,
 And all the ends of earth shall see
 Salvation of our God *set free*.

As soon as the name Jew became the sound
 Of righteousness, the enemy was bound
 To turn it to corruption, so the way
 Branches in true Jews and a falsar ray.
 As soon as the name Christian rose to fame,
 The evil heart blew on the bitter flame
 Till Christian was a byword in the claim
 Or Roman empire stricken in its day.
 Beloved, the word Islam means peace with
 You,

But it too is wrung out by snide in crew,
 And while the righteous bore to hide in
 hue,
 The tried and true in secret bridle grew.
 My poor faith clutches at the noble creeds
 But turns to You away from all their deeds.

11 Depart! Depart! Go out from there,
 Touch no unclean, go out from where
 She is, be clean, all you who bear
 The vessels of YHWH. 12 For you shall
 Not go out with haste, *prodigal*,
 Nor go by flight, for YHWH will go
 Before you, and Israel's God show
 Your rear guard *in the way you go*.
 13 Indeed, My servant shall deal *well*
 And prudently, *from where he fell*
 He shall be exalted, extolled
 And become very high and *bold*.
 14 Just as many astonished were
 At you, so his visage *demure*
 Was marred more than of any man,
 And his form more than men's sons can,
 15 So shall He sprinkle many nations.
 Kings shut their mouths *from their elations*
 At him, for what had not been told
 Them they shall see *and they shall hold*,
 And those things they had never heard

They shall consider in a word.

Your servant does not touch the unclean
 thing,
 No, not from the days when Maccabees'
 king
 Struck up the cleansing temple with a song,
 Your servant Israel turns from the wrong.
 Your servant Jesus Christ, in hour of life
 If not in legend, turned upon the strife
 Of unwashed cup and spoke a fresh word
 rife
 And then succumbed before the Roman
 knife.
 Your servant on the riverbank to fail,
 The waters of Euphrates dried in pail,
 Did never hesitate, but met the gale
 With calm peace and upheld the nations'
 wail.
 Marred is the visage in each day and clime
 Your servant comes to read the righteous
 rhyme.

Isaiah 53

1 Who has believed now our report?
 And to whom is YHWH's strength
 supposed?
 2 For he shall grow before him like
 A tender plant, and as a spike
 Out of dry ground. He has no form
 Or comeliness *in calm or storm*,
 And when we see him, *there's* no beauty
 To waken our desire or duty.
 3 He is despised, by men rejected,
 A man of sorrows and *neglected*,
 Acquainted with grief, and we hid,
 As it were, face from him amid
 Those who despised him, and we did
 Not esteem him. 4 Surely he's borne
 Our griefs and carried *both* our *scorn*
 And sorrows, yet we esteemed Him
 Stricken, smitten by Alohim,
 And afflicted. 5 But he *was* hurt
 For our transgressions, *and desert*,
 Was bruised for our iniquities,
 The chastisement for our Islam
 Was upon him, and by his *calm*
Acceptance of the stripes we're healed.
 6 All we like sheep astray from field
 Have turned, each one, to his own way,
 And YHWH has laid on him the flay
 Of iniquity of us all.

There's hardly any man today who claims
To add the Muslim to his list of names,
But recognizes now the suffering of
Imam Hussein who gave himself in love
Of Your folk when idolatry of power
Had gained ascendancy, if for an hour.
All so repent, just as the prophet's word
Gives light that they would do when they
were stirred

To see the innocent cut off in thirst
And given of the world only what's worst.
Stricken, smitten, afflicted, every age
Knows some who sacrifice the lettered
page
And quiet hearth to waken hearts again
From their departing in the ways of men.

7 He was oppressed and heard the call
Of affliction, yet opened not
His mouth, and he was *taught*
As a lamb to go to the slaughter,
And as a sheep *beside the water*,
Is silent at the shearing, so
He opened not his mouth *in woe*.
8 Taken from his captivity
And from judgment, and who will be
Witness aloud to his story?
For he was cut off from the land
Of the living, for the transgressions
Of My people *without confessions*
He was stricken. 9 He went down to
His grave like even wicked do,
And the wealthy submitted to
His deaths, for doing naught in crime,
In his mouth no deceit in time.

When Jesus cried upon the tree, he found
Only one other death beside him bound,
The zealot who robbed Romans for the
crowned.

When Israel met the Hellenes battle-starred
They sometimes won, but more often were
scarred

By traitors in their own ranks eating lard.
When Hussein was cut off from river bank
And left to drink the dregs of waters dank,
Three score and more of deaths joined in
his own,
Without crime and without deceit in bone.
Though crowds of servants rise, each one
alone

Meets with avenging powers that claim the
throne
Of righteousness, but in their scourge there
lies
Egypt's idolatry and Babel's flies.

10 The Almighty desired to let
Oppression fall on him and yet
He lay affliction on him, but
If you recognize the crime that
Was done against him, he will see
Offspring and the days of his fame
Shall be lengthened, and YHWH's will be
Successful in his hand and name.

11 And he would see the purpose *bless*,
Satisfied with his soul's distress.
With his knowledge My servant will
Teach Alohim's right way to still
More multitudes; their wickedness
He'll bear away. 12 Therefore, I'll bless
For him a portion with the great,
And he'll divide as spoils the great
In return for having poured out
His soul for death, counted in rout
Among the wicked, for he bore
The sin of multitudes, and *swore*
His prayer for the wicked *and sore*.

Affliction falls in every land and star
Upon the good and great in soul by far
Unrecognized before the school and state
For the realities that they are great.
Instead the tinsel and the thrust of hip,
The repartee of drunken tongues that slip
Remain applauded, while the dungeons
share

The tears of those who bow to You in
prayer.
Your servant is still taken at the gate,
Along the desert road, to lie in state
Before the tortures of a southern land
Surrounded by a Spanish sort of band.
Beloved, I pray for innocent who lie
Where sugarcane still meets eternal sky.

Isaiah 54

1 "Sing now, O barren one, you who
Did not give birth to any crew,
Break out in singing, cry aloud,
You who did not have birth pangs' bowed
With child; for more are the offspring
Of single mothers *on a fling*

Than of the married wife,” says YHWH.
2 Enlarge the place of your tent and
The curtains where your tent stakes stand,
Do not hold back, but lengthen cords
And make your pins strong *as though*
boards.

3 You’ll break out on the right hand and
On the left, and your spawn shall stand
In the lot of the Gentiles manned,
And fill forsaken towns with hordes.
4 Fear not, for you’ll not be ashamed,
Neither be confounded *and blamed,*
You’ll not be put to shame, for you
Shall forget the shame that was due
To your youth, and you shall not mind
Reproach of your widowhood’s grind.
5 Your Maker is your husband, and
The YHWH of hosts is His name grand;
And your Redeemer’s Holy One
Of Israel, God of all earth won
Is He called *by all in the land.*

This prophecy shows just how fragile is
Prediction of the future with a fizz.
You say what You wish with all Your heart
might
Take place upon the earth in human sight,
But all’s contingent on the human will,
Because You gave such freedom to both
Bill
And Barb. You say that Your folk must be
drawn
From Babylon to live to spread and spawn
And fill the cities of Gentiles forsaken.
Instead I see the holocaust has taken
The population from Danube and Rhine
In quite the opposite effect in fine.
Watch out, or those gathered on Zion’s hill
Will be bombed from existence in a trill.

“For like a woman set aside
And grieved in spirit *without pride*
Has YHWH called you, like a young wife
Rejected,” says your Alohim.
7 “For just a moment in the strife
Did I forsake you, but with beam
Of great mercies I’ll gather you.
8 “In overflowing wrath I hid
My face a moment under lid
From you, and in mercy in view
For ever have I loved you too,”
Says YHWH your Redeemer *in bid.*

9 “This is a Noah’s flood for me,
For I’ve sworn Noah’s flood to be
No more upon the earth, so I
Have sworn not to be angry by
You nor rebuke you *callously.*
10 “Because the mountains will depart,
The hills be removed from their start,
But My mercy shall never leave
You, neither shall My pact of peace
Be ended,” says YHWH with reprieve,
With kindness that shall never cease.

You promise to control the winds of fear
That smack across the world to bring a tear,
But You do not control the hands of men
Destroying more than anything again
That flood and spoil and fire hope to create
In havoc on a world not desolate.
You need not send a flood on Noah or
A tidal wave to teach men’s flesh to gore,
For we ourselves know how to destroy all
That we ourselves make on the turning ball.
No judgement time is needed in the fray:
We’ll kill ourselves to the last man or stay
To recreate the paradise once lost
When we thought to determine good and
crossed.

12 “I’ll make your windows agates rare,
Your gates carbuncles, everywhere
Your borders of fine stones *to spare.*
13 “And all your children shall be taught
Of YHWH, and great your spawn’s peace
wrought.
14 “In righteousness you shall be set,
You’ll be far from oppression met,
For you shall never be afraid,
And terror shall not make a raid.
15 “See how they surely come to stand
Together, but not by My hand,
Whoever gathers against you
Shall fall for your sake *in your view.*
16 “See, I’ve created the blacksmith
That blows on the hot coals *of withe,*
And brings out a tool by his work,
I’ve made the waster too to shirk.
17 “No weapon made against your state
Shall prosper, every tongue come late
Against you in judgement you’ll find
In condemnation and to bind.
This is the lot of slaves of YHWH,
Their justice is from Me,” says YHWH.

So You have set a bound on spoiler's rate.
I have not seen it yet, though it is late.
Perhaps since the day that Isaiah sang
You found another world where to
harangue,

And so Your promise is left intestate.
If You have set a limit on the score
Paid back in tanks and fire upon the shore
Of those who have the oil but not the
strength

To keep defences up against the length
Of families that try to be trees with core,
But fail even to reach the height of bush,
And are just tumble weeds for wind to
push,

I'll wait and see if justice finds a wing
Above the sea and shore and comes to sing.

Isaiah 55

1 Ho, every thirsty one, come here
To the water, and those *who steer*
Without a cent, come, buy and eat,
Buy without money, without treat,
Grape juice and milk *and have a seat*.

2 Why do you spend your money for
What is not bread, and work in store
For things that do not feed you more?

3 Turn down your ear and come to me,
Hear and your soul shall live to be,
And I'll make you a covenant
For ever, the mercies to plant
Of David *both to sing and rant*.

4 See, I have given him for a sign
In witness to the folk *and kine*,
A leader and commander to
The nations *gathered round in crew*.

5 See, you shall call a people that
You do not know, and nations sat
That did not know you shall rush to
You, because your Alohim YHWH
Is Israel's Holy One and true,
For it's He who glorified you.

The water and the grape juice and the milk
Are promised to the poor without an ilk.
And yet most people get none of those free,
But have to pay a pretty penny wee.
If I have one without the cost prepared,
Then I am fortunate among the spared,
For I'm charged for the milk and grape
juice bought,

But take the water freely from my plot
And spring beneath the lilacs' rain
unshared.

I take the water, my Beloved, and sweet,
And save the purple juice for a rare treat.
I hardly buy the grape juice, when I do
I give it to my daughter to drink too.
But milk I never buy or even meat.

Beloved, You give the bread to nourish
men

And women with their children in the den,
And I eat of the daily loaf as well,
Bought or made by my daughter's hand a
spell.

Beloved, You give the sign of David's song
To bear my soul in life and keep me strong,
And so I take to David all day long
And love his words of grief and cheerful
bell.

Commander of the faithful, he is first
Known by the rocky evidence uncursed,
The father of those who came after him
To lead Your people on in righteous vim.
Beloved, I taste the bread unblessed by
man

Or priest or elf, but nourished by Your
plan.

6 Look for YHWH while He may be found,
Call on Him while He's on the ground.

7 Let wicked people stop their way,
Unrighteous man his thoughts *in sway*,
And then let him come back to YHWH,
And He'll have mercy on him too;
And to our Alohim, for He
Will pardon him abundantly.

8 "Because My thoughts are not your
thoughts,
Neither are your ways My ways' plots,"
Says YHWH. 9 "For as the heavens are
higher

Than the earth, so is My ways' spire
Higher than your ways, and My thoughts
Are higher than your pondered plots."

Five thousand sonnets surely prove the
point,

Beloved, that You are higher in this joint.
I only raise my foolish questions here,
While You know all, who made all things
appear.

But in Your pardon and Your mercy's tale
 I meet the days and nights and do not fail
 To raise a rhymed and metered prayer to
 sail,
 And thank You for my comfort and my
 cheer.
 Let wicked men stop works and thoughts
 indeed,
 But leave me to my rhymely word and
 creed,
 For there's no harm in me, Beloved, my
 hand
 Is weak to spoil or cultivate Your land,
 And in the paradise that comes about
 From their repentance, I'll still rant and
 shout.

10 For as the rain comes down, and snow
 From the sky and it does not go
 Back, but waters the earth in flow
 And makes it bring forth bud and bloom
 To give seed to the sower's room
 And bread to those who eat and go,

11 So shall My word go from My mouth,
 Not to turn around *from the south*
 Back to Me empty, but to do
 What I had planned, and have success
 In the things I made it address.

12 For you shall wander out with joy,
 And be led round in peaceful ploy,
 The mountains and the hills shall break
 Out before you in song *and cake*,
 And all the trees of the wild field
 Shall clap their hands *when they have*
squealed.

13 Instead of thorn the fir tree grows,
 Instead of brier the myrtle rows,
 And it shall be to YHWH in fame,
 An everlasting sign in claim.

Ah, my Beloved, I do not need the fir,
 I cannot eat its cones, and myrtle's spur
 Is of no use to me for leaf and burr.
 I'd rather have the thorn with berries red
 To taste their floury meat and so be fed
 With something that will strengthen both
 the heart
 And hand to live and do my humble part.
 The hawthorn is a greater friend to me
 Than fir and myrtle growing on the lea.
 Ah, my Beloved, give me the brier too,

The blackberry growing in my tundra's
 view,
 And if not that, the arctic brambles do
 Not fail to cheer me, since they're sweet
 though rare.
 Beloved, increase the arctic bramble's
 share.

Isaiah 56

1 So says YHWH, "Keep judgement and
 act

Justly, for My salvation's pact
 Is soon to come; My righteousness
 Will be revealed *with thoroughness*.
 2 Blessèd is the man who does so,
 The son of man who makes a go
 Of it and keeps the Sabbath flow
 Without profaning it at all,
 And keeps his hand against the wall
 From doing any wicked thrall.

The prophets almost always come to think
 Of Sabbath in connexion with the wink
 Of wickedness in social matters too.
 For them the Sabbath-keeping is a view
 On justice and equality and true
 Keeping of righteous ways upon the brink.
 Christian establishment must separate
 The Sabbath from social affairs and state,
 Pretending it is just a formal show
 Of ritual outside the come and go
 Of social justice. That's because they know
 The Sabbath is a concrete way of baring
 The limitations of their power in sharing,
 Instead of law of jungle not too slow.

3 Neither let foreigner's son who
 Has joined himself to worship YHWH,
 Express the opinion that YHWH
 Has set me apart from His folk,
 Nor let the eunuch say in yoke,
 "See, I am just a dried up oak."
 4 For so says YHWH to eunuchs who
 Keep My sabbaths and choose to do
 The things that please Me and take hold
 Of My covenant *in faith bold*,
 5 Even to them I'll give of fame
 In My house and in My walls' claim
 Better than of sons and of daughters,
 I'll give them everlasting plotters
 Of fame that shall not be cut off.

The longing of the human heart is still
 And always to be immortal at will.
 Some find their immortality to be
 Preserved in their offspring lasting sweetly.
 Some find a deathless fame in building tall
 Their monuments whether on grave or stall.
 But true immortal fame comes not from
 those,
 But rather in the monument that rose
 From keeping Sabbath day and week by
 week,
 Even without sons or daughters in cheek,
 Even without a monument of stone.
 The Sabbath is the only claim to fame
 That humans can make here before Your
 throne:
 Let that be always my purpose and aim.

6 Also the sons of foreigners
 Who join themselves to YHWH for stirs
 Of serving Him, to love YHWH's name,
 To be His servants, every dame
 That keeps the Sabbath not profaning,
 And takes hold of covenant claiming,
 7 Even them will I bring to My
 Holy mountain, and make them joy
 In My house of prayer, and their burnt
 Offerings and sacrifices earnt
 Shall be accepted on My flame
 Of altar, for My house in name
 Shall be a house of prayer for all.
 8 The Lord YHWH that gathered in stall
 The outcasts of Israel has said
 "Yet I will gather others bred
 To him besides those that are spread."

My preacher says that love fulfils the law,
 And by that means no Sabbath has a claw.
 The fair commandment in its time revealed
 The Sabbath was the peaceful, restful field
 Of donkey and of ox in Jewish stall.
 I wonder that its blessings come at all
 Are worthy of a Jewish ass but not
 Of such a dandy as myself and taught.
 If donkeys have the right to Sabbath day
 For the chance that they're owned by
 Jewish gay,
 Then I too claim at least the grand reward
 Of donkeys before You, my Sovereign
 Lord,
 And cast a curse on rabbis and on priests

Who would deprive me of the Sabbath
 feasts.

9 All beasts of field, come to devour,
 And animals of forests' power.
 10 His watchmen are blind, knowing
 naught,
 They're all dumb dogs, they've not been
 taught
 To bark; asleep and lying down,
 Loving to slumber *in the town*.
 11 Indeed they're greedy dogs who stay
 With never enough in their way,
 Shepherds who do not understand;
 They all look to their own command,
 Each to his profit from the land.
 12 Come on, they say, and I'll take wine,
 And we'll fill up with gin and dine,
 And when tomorrow comes, the more
 We'll drink *and head down for the shore*.

The grand authorities who would deprive
 The working man of Sabbaths while alive
 Are raging beasts, though they pretend to
 be
 Sweet, loving priests under the canopy
 Of government and church and synagogue,
 Blotting out Your commandment in a fog.
 Six days of service never can suffice
 When wealthy people pretend to be nice
 And hire the poor to scrumpet and to slice,
 They're always waiting like the greedy dog
 For more in weight and doing of the cog
 From those who serve them in a moment's
 trice.
 Beloved, I take Your Sabbath and I know
 Without it social justice is a show.

Isaiah 57

1 The righteous dies, none stop to note;
 The merciful of men they tote
 Away and no one stops to mind
 The righteous are carried refined
 Out of range of evil to dote.
 2 He shall enter into Islam,
 In peace rest in their beds of calm,
 Walking in justice *as by rote*.

The idea of ripe wheat when good men die
 Has always smacked to me of the smile
 wry
 Of sour grapes, as Aesop used to say,

Or berries of the mountain ash at bay
As we who live beyond the grape line find.
The ultimate in letting go resigned
May seem, before this range of evil, kind,
But I still cling to life and wreak my mind.
Beloved, the thought that Islam is mere
death

Is really not far-fetched upon the breath
Of dancing on the tundra, eyes toward
London.

It is a giving up and leaving undone
The fancy living up and heaving prance
Conforming to unmerciful in pants.

But come near, sons of sorceress,
Spawn of adulterer and mess
Of prostitute *for your address*.

4 Against whom do you sport yourselves?
Against whom make wide faces and
In grimaces stick out like brand
Your tongue? Are you not children sprung
Of wickedness, deceitful rung?

5 Enflaming yourselves with the draught
Of idols under every plot

Of green tree, you slay children in
The valleys under cliff in bin
Of rocks. 6 Among the smooth stones
where

The stream flows is your portion fair,
They are your heritage, to them
Have you poured out drink offering's gem,
You've offered a meat offering too.
Should I get comfort from the spew?

7 Upon a mountain high, uplift
You set your couch and bring your gift
Of sacrifice gone up to shift.

8 Behind the doors also and posts
Have you set up remembrance boasts,
For you've uncovered yourself there
To someone other than My share,
And have gone up and made your bed,
And formed a *marriage* pact instead
As soon as you saw pleasure bred.

9 You go anointed to the king,
Abundantly perfumed to fling
Your messengers away and so
Debased yourself into hell's glow.

10 In the length of your way you're spent,
But never word complaining lent,
You've found the life of your hand so
You never were grieving to go.

11 And of whom have you been afraid

Or fearing for having been paid
For lies and for forgetting Me,
Not taking the things seriously?
Have I not kept quiet of old,
And still you did not fear Me *bold*?
12 I will declare your righteousness,
And your works: they'll no profit dress.

Nostalgia for the days when life was just
The choosing of which idol in the dust
To worship with gyration at the hip
So crops would grow enough to eat and
ship

Looks on the situation now of men
Who make a wider government again,
A Union so economy prevails
In Europe where justice is writ on sails.
Behind the economic justice find
The trafficking of women come resigned
To service all the justices confined.
Instead of honoured priestesses the lot
Is turned into a slave machine in plot
By poverty to eastward of what's not.

13 When you shouted, your armies came
To your salvation, but the flame
Of wind shall carry them away;
Vanity overtakes their day.

But the one who trusts in Me will
Possess the land and holy hill.
14 And he shall say "Raise up, and raise,
Prepare the way and keep the daze
Of stumblingblock from my folk's ways."

15 For so says the exalted One
Who dwells in eternity *spun*,
Whose name is Holy; "I shall dwell
In the high and the holy dell,
With him too of a contrite and
A humble spirit, to command
The spirit of the humble and
Revive the heart of the contrite.

16 "For I'll not always fight for right,
Nor will I always stand in wrath,
For then the spirit in My eyes
Should fail and those that I devise.

The wretched masses say the God of love
Is found in the New Testament by glove,
While Tanakh's noted for the wrath and
power
Of divine judgement preaching on the
scour.

Truth is the Gospel speaks more of the hate
Of hell than Moses, though it has come
late.

You have the face of mercy never changing
Behind the need for justice ever ranging.
Beloved, I need reminder not at all
Of mercy mixed with justice in the stall,
Of hope and hopelessness, of mighty call
To judgement because grace is all in pall.
Let none appear before the judgement seat
Without the help of olive oil and wheat.

17 "For his covetousness in wrong
I was drawn out in anger strong
To smite him: I hid and was mad,
He went on stubbornly and glad
In the way of his heart *and pad*.
18 "I've seen his ways, and so will heal,
I'll lead him too, he'll come to feel
Comforts restored to him and those
Who have lamented at his *throes*.
19 "I have made the fruit of the lips,
Peace, peace to him far off in ships
And to the one that is nearby,"
Says YHWH, "and I will heal *or try*.
20 "The wicked are like troubled seas,
When it cannot remain in ease,
Whose waters cast up mire and dirt.
No peace," says my Alohim's *sigh*
"To the wicked *and those who hurt*."

No peace or no Islam, I know not which.
Methinks they're opposite sometimes in
pitch,

The one thrown out and landed in the ditch,
The other marred so much in form that I
Can barely recognize the Meccan sky.
No peace or no Islam, Beloved, I pray
For both where I am sitting night and day,
Islam might turn to You alone and stay
Submitted to Allah, and peace find sway
Throughout the world of hope and
hopelessness.

Beloved, for peace and Islam's my address,
For Christian and for Jew and every kind
Of heathen, the unruly and resigned.
Then peace and Islam will be no more
blind.

Isaiah 58

1 Cry out, spare not, lift up your voice
And like a trumpet to rejoice

Show My folk their transgression's choice,
And Jacob's house their sins *and vice*.

2 And still they seek Me every day,
And they delight to know My way,
As a folk that worked righteousness,
Forsaking not statutes' address
Of their Alohim: they ask Me
For ordinances in the fee
Of justice, and they take delight
Approaching to Alohim's sight.
3 "We've fasted and why don't You see?
With introspection of degree

We examine our souls, and You
Take no notice of what we do."
See, while you're fasting still you take
Your pleasures and you come to make
All the same tasks in daily wake.
4 "It's for strife and debate you fast,
To strike with fist in wicked cast.
Do not fast just to make your voice
Heard from high places *of your choice*.

5 "Is it such a fast that I choose?
A day to examine one's views?
To bow prostrating like a reed,
To spread sackcloth and ashes' feed?
Will you call this a fast, a day
Acceptable to YHWH *for pay*?

6 "Is this not the fast that I choose?
The bands of wickedness unuse,
Untie the heavy burdens and
Let the oppressed go free *in land*
Where every yoke's broken *to stand*?
7 "Is it not to give out your bread
To hungry people and the spread
Of poor cast out into your house?
When you see the naked *like mouse*
And give him clothing, and your own
Flesh is not hidden from the bone?"

Some think the fast is eating no fat in
The days of vernal, heathen choice of din.
Some think the fast is waiting till the dark
To feast and revel and take pleasure's
spark.

But You, Beloved, choose fasting not of
face
And spoon, but of a very different chase.
For You the fast is tasted when all men
And women with their children in each den
Have food and drink and shelter and a ray
Of hope before the coming, brighter day.
For You the fast is taking clothing spun

And covering the shivering, lowly one.
Beloved, no fast has ever yet been done
In all the years since Isaiah gave way.

8 Then shall your light break like the morn,
And your health's stake spring up new-born,

And your righteousness go before
You while YHWH's glory is in store.

9 Then you shall call and YHWH reply,
And He will say when you shall cry,
"Here am I." If you take away
From among you the yoke of pay,
And cease to point and speak agley;

10 And for the hungry feel a pang,
And satisfy afflicted gang,
Then shall your light rise in the dark,
And your dark be as noonday's spark.

11 And YHWH shall guide you
everywhere,

And satisfy your soul to share
In the dry season, and make fat
Your bones, and you shall be like that
Garden well-watered, like the *vat*
Of water springs and always bear.
12 And they'll built from your ruins old,
Foundations shall remain untold
Generations, and you'll be called
Repairer of the beach well-walled,
Restorer of the paths *unrolled*.

How many times since the sweet word
revealed

To Isaiah has fair Jerusalem

Been torn down to the root, it's living
sealed,

And then rebuilt again like shining gem?
I cannot say the prophecy has failed,
I cannot say the dark night never paled,
But I can say today more hungry lie
Beneath the merciless, untroubled sky
Than have in any day after the cry
Of sweet Isaiah when he sighed and railed.
Beloved, I eat my fill and thank You that
The human stomach needs so little fat,
For little is what's found, and on the mat,
What is found is more wasted than set by.

13 "If you turn from the Sabbath day
Your foot from doing pleasure's sway
On My holy day, cantillating
The Sabbath in delightful rating,

The holy of YHWH, honoured waiting,
And shall bring honour then to Him,
Not doing your own ways and thing,
Not finding what you want nor speaking
Your own words, things of your own
seeking;

14 "Then you'll delight yourself in
YHWH;

And I will cause you to ride *shoe*
Upon high places of the earth,
And feed you with the lot of worth
Of Jacob your father *from birth*:
For the mouth of YHWH's spoken too."

The Shi'ite marja was right when he said
The Sabbath is a fasting day outspread
And mustahab on all men born and bred.
Your prophet takes the fast and Sabbath
day

And draws them into one, and shows the
way

To keep them both by turning will aside
From seeking wealth and pleasure on the
ride

To seeking social justice on the ball,
And sharing food and drink and sheltered
stall.

To turn the foot from doing Sabbath wrong
Is turning foot from the oppressed by
strong,

And so creating a new world to be
Where no one thirsts and none in misery
Find hunger and the cold their only fee.

Isaiah 59

1 See, YHWH's hand is not short, so it
Cannot save, nor His ear unfit
So that it cannot hear a whit.

2 But your iniquities have been
The separating *with your sin*
Between you and your Alohim.
And your sins have hidden the vim
Of His presence from you, so He
Will never hear your *entreaty*.

3 For your hands are defiled with blood,
Your fingers with iniquity,
Your lips have spoken lies in flood,
Your tongue uttered perversity.

4 None calls for justice, no one pleads
For truth, but they trust their vain deeds
And speak lies; they conceive the bad
And bear wickedness *on the pad*.

5 They hatch cockatrice eggs and weave
 A spider's web: the one will grieve
 To death who eats the fatal egg,
 And crushing it under the leg
 Just produces a viper's *sleeve*.
 6 Their webs do not become garments,
 Their works do not cover in tents,
 Their actions are iniquity,
 And violence is their hands' fee.
 7 Their feet to evil run in spree,
 They hasten to shed in degree
 The blood of innocence, their thoughts
 Are thoughts of wickedness in plots,
 Spoil and destruction their ways be.
 8 Way of Islam they do not know,
 There is no judgement in their show,
 They have made themselves crooked ways,
 Whoever follows them in praise
 Shall not know Islam's *peaceful rays*.

Establishment that goes by Islam's name
 Is often one of such eternal shame.
 Amazing it seems that Isaiah's word
 Should be so accurate by the news stirred
 Today in violence in every place.
 The treachery to Islam's word of grace
 Incredibly rises and goes apace.
 Beloved, I pray in Your great name that's
 known
 To all as Allah without flesh and bone,
 That You might intervene with those who
 own
 In word but not in deed what You have
 shown
 In the sweet lays of the Qur'an. I pray
 In fasting and prostration for the way
 That human blood is cheap before the
 groan.

9 That's why judgement is far from us,
 Why justice is not thunderous;
 Expecting light, darkness we find,
 We wait for brightness, and walk blind.
 10 We grope the wall like the blind, and
 We grope as if no eyes command,
 We stumble at noon as at night,
 In desolation's deathly fright.
 11 We all roar like bears and we mourn
 Like doves crying out and forlorn,
 We look for judgement and we find
 Salvation's gone and far behind.
 12 Our transgressions are multiplied

Before You, our sins testified
 Against us for our sins abide
 With us and our iniquities
 We know of them *in their bounties*.
 13 In sinful lying against YHWH,
 Departing from Alohim *true*,
 Speaking oppression and revolt,
 Conceiving and bearing the bolt
 From the heart words of falsehood's *crew*.
 14 And removed backward is judgement,
 And righteousness stands from the tent,
 For truth is weak to walk the street,
 And equity beats a retreat.
 15 Indeed, truth fails: he who departs
 From evil is target for darts;
 YHWH sees the evil in His eyes,
 There is no judgement *in the guise*.

Amazing in my view, but perhaps for
 The blindness that I occupy in store,
 Is the fact that the darkness on the shore
 Of government and business if not art
 Is not sought out and yet is each man's part
 Who steps out of Your law with horse and
 cart.

I'm not amazed at the blind act as such,
 But at the fact that arrows fly by touch
 To hit the mark with accurate in crutch
 As soon as anyone forsakes the great
 Inspired society to meet Your rate.
 When I spoke for myself or empty dream,
 The crowds flocked to hear both the whey
 and cream,
 But now I speak for Your law, they
 unteam.

16 And he saw that there was no man
 Nor intermediary span,
 So His own arm salvation brings,
 His own sustaining justice *sings*.
 17 For He put on his righteousness
 As a breastplate, a helmet's dress
 For salvation upon His head,
 And He puts on clothing outspread
 For vengeance, and clad in a cloak
 Of zeal, 18 according to deeds woke
 To render payment, rage upon
 His adversaries, reward drawn
 Upon His enemies, as far
 As the coasts He repays their scar.
 19 So they shall fear the name of YHWH
 From the west, and His glory too

From the sun's rising into view.
 When the foe shall come like a flood,
 YHWH's spirit shall lift *from the mud*
 A standard against him *and blood*.
 Coming to Zion is her redeemer,
 And to those who turn from the schemer
 In wickedness for Jacob's sake,
 So says YHWH *in redemption's wake*.
 21 As for Me, here's My covenant
 With them, says YHWH, My spirit sent
 Upon you, and My words which I
 Have put in your mouth by and by
 Shall not depart out of your mouth
 Nor ever from your offspring's mouth,
 Nor from the mouth of their offspring,
 Says YHWH, now and everlasting.

If there is any descendant to fear
 Of Isaiah in Zion or career
 Of any country in the world I see,
 He must be speaking to eternity
 On empty air, for all the churches now
 Join with the mosque and synagogue in
 row,
 And there's no peace, but only wicked
 show,
 Pretenders to Your justice in the glow
 Of slaughter and of bombing with a leer.
 Beloved, I love the great grandson of him
 Who spoke Your words of life and warning
 trim,
 For having ninety generations' vim
 While no one took note of Your message
 clear,
 But found in violence a road to steer.

Isaiah 60

1 Arise and shine, your light has come,
 The glory of YHWH's high to hum.
 2 See how darkness covers the earth,
 And thick blackness the people's berth,
 But YHWH shall arise upon you,
 His glory shall be seen on you.
 3 The Gentiles shall come to your light,
 And kings turn to your rising bright.
 4 Lift up your eyes and look around,
 They've gathered all upon the ground,
 They come to you, your sons shall come
 From far off and your daughters *rum*
 Shall be nursed at your side *and sound*.
 5 You shall see it and become bright,
 Your fearful heart swell at the sight,

Turned to you shall be the sea's crowd,
 The strength of the Gentiles aloud.
 A camel band shall cover you,
 The dromedaries of the crew
 Of Midian and Ephah too,
 All those from Sheba shall arrive,
 They'll bring gold and incense to thrive,
 To show forth the praises of YHWH.
 7 The flocks of Kedar all shall be
 Gathered together in your fee,
 The rams of Nebaioth shall serve
 You, they shall come up and not swerve
 From My altar, and I'll bring praise
 To the house of My glory's ways.
 8 Who are these flying like a cloud,
 Like doves to their windows allowed?

Dear to my heart is Kedar, Abram's son,
 Who was the second-born to Ishmael's fun,
 The one to seed a prophet born of hope
 To desert tribes before the world to grope
 Toward the light of virtue. Kedar dear
 Was faithful when all Israel failed to fear
 Your one anointed, David, who gave ear
 To Your law and was planted with his gear
 The king of earth. The flocks of Kedar
 move
 In disarray and milling in the groove
 Of Makkah and Madinah, show the way
 To Gentiles of the worship proud and gay
 Of You, One God alone, Allah in sway,
 YHWH, Alohim: and show the way to
 steer.

If Kedar is sweet, what of the first-born,
 Of Nebaioth, the hope of Abram's horn?
 The roaming and the carefree ways his dad
 Went all about the desert when he had
 Before him the hot winds by day, by night
 The frosts that made of dawns his first
 delight
 Stuck to his heart and hand. He left the way
 Of contemplation in the tents to stay
 With Kedar playing by the sheep and goats.
 He flew like tempest over sprawling moats
 Of sand and stone to find the lonely path
 Of justice in the desert without wrath.
 Beloved, I love as You Yourself the host
 Of Nebaioth, his children in their boast.

9 Surely the isles shall wait for Me,
 The ships of Tarshish first to see

And bring your sons from far away,
Their silver and their gold in pay,
To the name of YHWH Alohim,
To Holy One of Israel's dream,
Because He's glorified your *day*.

10 The sons of foreigners shall build
Your walls and their kings shall be willed
To serve you, because in My wrath
I struck you, but in favour's path
I've had mercy on you *and filled*.

11 Therefore your gates shall always be
Opened, they'll not be shut to see
By day or night, so men may bring
To you the strength of Gentiles' spring,
From them to bring up every king.

12 For the land and kingdom that will
Not serve you shall be struck and still,
Indeed those nations feel the sting.

13 The glory of Lebanon will
Come to you, the fir tree on hill,
The pine tree, and the box tree too,
To beautiful the place in view
Of My holy place, and I'll make
The place glorious in My feet's wake.

14 The spawn of those afflicting you
Shall come and bow before your view,
And those who despised you shall bow
Themselves down at your feet's soles now,
And they shall call you YHWH's fair town,
The Holy One's fortress come down
On Israel *for each holy brow*.

How many peoples in the centuries past
Have come to Quds on horses and to cast
Their foreheads on the paving stones that
make

Up churches and mosques in the city's
wake!

The pilgrimages to Jerusalem
Are longer and more diverse than the gem
Of pilgrimage to any place on earth,
Except in latter years the morn of worth,
Sweet Makkah, where dear Ali had his
birth.

My soles have trodden on the scattered
floor

Between the mosques and bowed down
with a score

Prostrating to You where red marbled halls
Now strut above the ancient temple halls.
I'm featured in the prophecy the more.

15 Since you've been outcast, held with
hate,

So that no man went through your gate,
I'll make you an eternal show

Of excellence, a joy to go
On many generations' row.

16 You'll suck the Gentiles' milk and suck
The breast of kings, you'll have the luck
Of knowing that I YHWH am your
Saviour and your Redeemer or
The mighty One of Jacob's *store*.

Are You, Beloved, the Saviour and the set
Redeemer, Mighty One that Jacob met
In flight before father and brother's net?

I had been taught that Jesus was the name
Of the only redeemer in the game,
The only saviour walking on the hill,
The mighty one in such disguise of skill
That none might recognize him for the
greed

Of human hearts to cover their own need.

Are You, Beloved, the Saviour? I rejoice
Salvation's not left to a human voice.

Are You, Beloved, Redeemer? Then let's
keep

The sandals on the feet. Let Jesus weep
Within the garden for his own and reap.

17 Instead of brass I shall bring gold,
Instead of iron, silver bold,
And for wood I'll bring brass, and for
Stones iron; I will also make
Your officers peace, for the sake
Of your chiefs righteousness in store.

18 No more shall violence be heard
In your land, spoiling nor preferred
Destruction nor such misery
Upon your borders; but your walls
Shall be called Salvation in stalls,
And your gates Praise *eternally*.

If peace is the faith of Islam and there
Is Judaism in righteousness fair,
Then Christianity is met here too
In the one word of what the Christians do,
The violence, the spoiling and the crew
Of their destruction of Mid-Eastern view.
The prophecy seems that the coat of mail,
The armoured tank, the bomb that makes
night pale,

Shall all return and in the end shall fail.

When pagan resurrecting gods are laid
To rest and only Islam's in parade,
And Judaism keeps Your divine law,
Then shall earth meet two witnesses in awe
To bring peace and justice to a world
stayed.

19 The sun shall be no more your light
By day, neither for brightness' sight
Shall be the moon to you; but YHWH
Shall be always a light to you
And your Alohim shall renew
Your glory *for both day and night*.

20 Your sun shall never set again,
Nor shall your moon go in its den,
For YHWH shall be eternal light
To you, and the days of your plight
Shall be ended *before all men*.

21 All your folk shall be righteous then,
They'll inherit the land for aye,
The branch of My planting come nigh,
The work of My hands so that I
May be the one they glorify.

22 The least shall be a thousand strong,
A small one a great nation's prong,
I YHWH will bring the time along.

The Roman sun and Arab moon both pause
Before You, my Beloved, before Your
laws,

And all join in the hope and health that cast
Obedience to Your statutes in the blast
Before the raging tempest not to last.
The one or two struck from the churchly
roll,

The three or four in Islam's robe and toll,
Shall multiply and join a thousand strong
Before the ten commandments in a song
Of worship and obedience to You.
The numbers that create historian cue
Shall fail and at last turn around the scale
And make Your word and law once more
prevail.

Beloved, I wait the coming of the hail.

Isaiah 61

1 The spirit of Lord YHWH's on me,
Because YHWH has anointed me
To preach good tidings to the meek,
He has sent me to bind up *sleek*
The broken-hearted, to proclaim
Freedom to the captives *in claim*

And opening the prison doors
To those who are bound *in their scores*;
2 To declare acceptable year
Of YHWH, and day of vengeance near
Of our Alohim, and to bring
Comfort to all that mourn *in ring*;
3 To appoint unto those who mourn
In the fortress, to give them bourn
Of beauty instead of the scorn
Of ashes, and the oil of joy
Instead of mourning for employ,
The cloak of praise instead of heavy
Spirit, that they may be in levee
Called trees of righteousness, the park
Planted by YHWH, so He *like lark*
Might be glorified *by the spark*.

Dear Jesus spoke as though this word
divine

Were prophesying him line upon line.
Isaiah might slide over on the throne
And give the man a bit of meat or bone.
The happy ending of the prophecy
May be repeated, like the melody
Of Handel on aria's sophistry.

I'm not so narrow that I cannot think
That words of Scripture spoken on the
brink

May not have applications for each one
Who reads them after all is said and done.
I'm willing to believe Jesus healed all
He met who needed help, but history's call
Shows vengeance still is missing from the
pall.

4 And they shall build the old waste places,
The desolations old in faces
They shall raise up again, and so
Renew the desert cities' *show*,
Those that had been abandoned by
The generations *passing nigh*.

5 Strangers have stood to feed your flocks,
The sons of strangers stood their shocks
To be your ploughmen and vinedressers.

6 You shall be named by all confessors
The Priests of YHWH; men shall call you
The servants of our Alohim,
And you shall eat the Gentiles' cream,
And in their glory then shall you
Boast yourselves *in the things you do*.

7 For your shame double recompense,
And for confusion in their tents

They shall rejoice in their repairs;
 So in their land you'll have your shares
 In double, everlasting joy
 Upon the head of every boy.
 8 For I'm the YHWH that loves judgement,
 I hate stolen goods in My tent
 For a burnt offering, and I'll make
 Their work in truth, and so I'll take
 A covenant's eternal stake.
 9 And their spawn shall be known among
 The Gentiles and their offspring sung
 By peoples; all who see them know
 They're the seed YHWH's blessed *on the*
go.

The offering plate that circulates the church
 Is often filled with stolen goods that perch
 Upon the bank accounts of those in search
 Of more impoverished people in the lurch
 To take advantage of and call it business.
 I call it rather unethical whizness.
 The wealth that's brought to You, Beloved,
 in glory
 To Your name in the temple has a story
 That's often sordid. Some attempt to right
 Their wrongs by paying You off in their
 sight.
 Beloved, I enter no tent here at all,
 No temple, no, nor mosque nor churchly
 sprawl,
 But only aisles fir-columned and addressed
 By pine nuts squirrels have devoured and
 blessed.

10 I will greatly rejoice in YHWH,
 My soul be joyful in my true
 Alohim, for He has clothed me
 With clothing of salvation free,
 He's covered me with righteous robes,
 As bridegroom decks himself with *strokes*
*O*f ornaments, and as a bride
 Adorns herself in jewels' pride.
 11 For as the earth brings forth her bud,
 And as the garden from the mud
 Causes seeds sown in it to sprout,
 So the Lord YHWH will cause a shout
 Of righteousness and praise to spring
 Forth before all nations to sing.

Not many who meet me here on the path
 Beyond the aspens and the birches' swathe
 See me dressed in tuxedo like a groom,

Much less adorned in diamonds in my
 bloom
 Of bride. Instead my cut-off boots may
 hide
 Darned socks and patches on my velvet
 pride.
 The earth that brings forth spring has
 moments when
 Her harvest is a muddy, swimming glen
 Bedecked with gold-green sprouts of grass
 again.
 I'm just too young to represent the lot
 Of treasure and of glory that You've got.
 I rather represent the hopeful spring,
 What's done is always vernal when You
 sing,
 What's spun is always kernel of Your ring.

Isaiah 62

1 For Zion's sake I'll not hold my peace,
 And for Jerusalem's release
 I will not rest till justice go
 Out with the brightness of a show,
 And its salvation like a lamp
 That burns *despite the wind and damp*.
 2 Gentiles shall see your righteousness,
 And all the kings your glory's dress,
 And you'll be called by a new name
 Which the mouth of YHWH has in claim.

The new name raises questions in the mind
 Of whoever produced the Revelation,
 And so he laid hold on exotic rind
 And quoted good Isaiah with elation.
 Zion shall have a new name and I guess
 An epithet Jerusalem shall dress.
 The new name I have heard is Quds to
 show
 How holy is the city in a row.
 What Jebusites profaned upon the shore
 Of Kidron has become a righteous store,
 And what thing David coveted the more
 Is now named holy as Your words confess.
 Beloved, I turn toward the holy gate
 And see how many whirl about in hate.

3 You'll also be a crown of glory
 In YHWH's hand, and a royal story
 In the hand of your Alohim.
 4 No more will you be called forsaken,
 Nor shall your land be longer taken
 For desolate: but you will seem

By name of Hephzibah, your land
 Will be called Beulah, for YHWH's hand
 Finds its delight in you and your
 Land shall be married shore to shore.
 5 For as a young man takes a wife
 Of a virgin, so your sons rife
 Shall marry you, and as the groom
 Rejoices over the bride's bloom,
 So shall your Alohim rejoice
 Over you *with a lifted voice*.

Both Hephzibah and Beulah are two names
 Of places in the mountains of my claims.
 The highways are so big and fast that they
 Can hardly be seen at all in the sway
 Of traffic. But I mind the time when I
 Knew Hephzibah as just a dusty sty
 Whose main joy was that soon I should
 arrive
 And find my grandmother hale and alive.
 The joys of progress since those days are
 few:
 The town is turned out from the highway's
 view
 And my grandmother is long dead since
 then.
 I am grandparent now among young men.
 Beloved, the rounds of joy and sadness
 know
 The words that dark Isaiah came to show.

6 I have set watchmen on your walls,
 Jerusalem, both day and night,
 They are not silent in their stalls,
But seek to proclaim what is right.
 You who keep YHWH in mind do not
 Refrain from speaking what you're taught.
 7 Give no silence to Him till He
 Establish and set graciously
 Jerusalem upon the earth.
 8 Sworn has YHWH by His right hand, and
 By the arm of His strength at hand,
 "Indeed I shall no longer give
 Your wheat to nourish those who live
 To be your foes, nor shall the sons
 Of foreigners drink up your *tons*
Of grape juice in your labour's worth.
 9 "Instead the harvester shall eat
 And praise YHWH, and those too whose
 feet
 Have brought it shall drink it within
 The courts of My holiness' din."

The way of life Isaiah assumes fair
 Is that each man should cultivate his share
 And gather in the grain and grape that he
 Is able in a year to eat freely.
 He has no concept of the craven way
 We specialize in marketing today.
 If I depended on the humble store
 Of corn I gather from my awkward shore,
 I'd starve before the coming of the light
 And buckle under hunger as my right.
 Beloved, You gave the scratching of the
 earth
 To stave off hunger and to stave off dearth,
 But Cain saved us from Your salvation's
 way
 In his creation of city and pay.

10 Pass on, pass on and through the gates,
 Prepare the pathway of the mates,
 Raise up, raise up a highway too,
 Pluck out the stones, lift up in view
 A standard for the people *true*.
 11 See YHWH's proclaimed to the world's
 end,
 Say to the fortress daughter kenned,
 "See, your salvation comes," behold
 His payment's with him, his work told.
 12 And they shall call them holy folk,
 Redeemed of YHWH and at a stroke
 You shall be called sought out and not
 A city in forsaken plot.

The prophecy is all about the run
 Of old Jerusalem, not the hot bun
 Of politics today, though preachers side
 With one or other of the folk in pride.
 Jerusalem is great, I've seen the wall,
 I've seen the excavations and the tall
 In monument of gold and where to pray
 When gates are opened in a lovely way.
 Beloved, salvation may have come and
 gone
 While the bazaar was closed before the
 dawn,
 It may have gone unnoticed by the eyes
 That now scan over Kidron's last surprise.
 It may be reckoned for an ancient book
 That pondered over crosses in a nook.

Isaiah 63

1 Who is that coming from Edom,

With dyed garments from Bozrah come,
 This glorious one in his address,
 Moving in his great strength *to bless?*
 I who utter in righteousness,
 The mighty to save *by the drum*.
 2 Why are your clothes red and your cloak
 Like those who tread out wine *for broke?*
 3 I've trodden the winepress alone,
 None of the folk shared in my groan,
 For I shall tread them in my wrath
 And trample them in fury's path,
 And their blood shall be sprinkled on
 My garments and will stain them drawn.
 4 The day of vengeance in my heart,
 The year of my redemption's part
 Has come *and shall not soon depart*.
 5 I looked and there was none to help,
 I wondered for upholding whelp,
 That's why my own arm only brought
 Salvation to me, and the lot
 Of my own anger was my help.
 6 I'll tread down the folk in my wrath
 And make them drunk in fury's path,
 And I'll bring down to earth their strength.

Beloved, I too tread down the world in
 wrath
 And sink Onassis' ships in bubble bath.
 I lift the cup of blood struck from the veins
 Of priest and bishop to the lips of fanes,
 Commanding them to drink their wanted
 froth,
 While I rage and tremble, unwonted wroth.
 I look and see that there is none to help:
 You stand above the earth like helpless
 whelp
 And wonder that all men turn from Your
 law.
 Reach out a sharp and blood-stained, angry
 claw.
 Beloved, I send the proud down on their
 knees
 And force them to conform to what You
 please
 To announce on Sinai. I have the right
 To life in peace under commandment's
 fright.

7 I shall remember then at length
 The tender mercies of YHWH and
 The praises of YHWH by the hand
 Of all that YHWH's bestowed on us,

And also the good bounteous
 Toward the house of Israel,
 Which He's bestowed upon them well
 By His mercies, according to
 His lovingkindnesses in crew.
 8 For He said "Surely they're My folk,
 Children that will not lie in yoke,"
 So He was there Saviour *for broke*.
 9 In their distress He was no foe,
 The angel of His presence show
 Saved them, in His love and the glow
 Of His pity He redeemed them,
 And He lifts them up, like a gem
 Carries them all the days in hem.
 10 But they rebelled and vexed His mind
 Of holiness, so He in kind
 Turned to be their foe, and He fought
 Against them *for the things they wrought*.
 11 Then He remembered days of old,
 And Moses and his people bold,
 "Where is he that brought them up out
 Of the sea with the shepherd stout
 Of his flock? Where is He that put
 His holy spirit hand and foot?"
 12 Who led them by Moses' right hand,
 With His arm glorious to stand
 Dividing the waters from land
 Before them, to make His name grand?
 13 Who led them through the deep and like
 A horse in the desert on spike
 Not to stumble, but always stand?
 14 As a beast goes down in the vale,
 YHWH's spirit caused him to rest hale,
 So did You lead Your people and
 Make Yourself a glorious name grand.

Do not blame me, Beloved, that I react
 To lawlessness in every human pact.
 The New Age thought that every man
 creates
 His own reality, and has no mates
 Except what he himself wants and relates
 Is egotistical scrap and insane.
 I follow on for my own health and gain.
 I follow Your example on the plain,
 Since You too turned in kind on those who
 swore
 Obedience to idols like a whore.
 Note that I share Your heart of sympathy,
 And turn again to them in such mercy
 Before they have repented full and true.
 In love and wrath I merely follow You.

15 Look down from heaven and behold
 From holy dwelling place of gold
 And glory, where is Your zeal told
 And Your strength and the sounding bold
 Of Your bowels and mercies uncold
 Toward me? Are they restrained to fold?
 16 For You are our Father, though still
 Abraham did not know our bill,
 And Israel does not recognize
 Us, You O YHWH, will not despise,
 You are our Father and You are
 Our own redeemer, and Your star
 Is everlasting *in the skies*.
 17 O YHWH, why have You made us stray
 From Your ways and hardened the way
 Of our heart from Your fear in sway?
 Repent for Your own servants' sake,
 The tribes of Your heritage wake.
 18 The people of Your holiness
 Possessed it just in small address,
 While our foes have come to tread down
 You sanctuary *with a frown*.
 19 We are Yours, You never took rule
 Over them, they were not the school
 Called by Your name, *a wicked pool*.

The Revelation marks the true Jew from
 The synagogue of Satan that had come
 By then to share the Roman empire's fuel.
 So sects rise up and quarrel and then duel.
 I care not that I'm stricken from the slate
 Of Christian church and thrown out at the
 gate.

I care not that I'm turned out like a dog
 From mosque as well and Jewish
 synagogue.

My only care is that Your law demands
 My love and my obedience in hands,
 And there I find my peace and there the
 bands

Of beauty and of love and happiness.
 I stay before the mountain to confess
 The promises in letters You address.

Isaiah 64

1 Oh that You'd rend the sky apart
 And come down so the mountains dart
 Unmade before Your presence' art!
 2 As when the melting fire burns,
 The fire that boils water and churns,
 To make Your name known to Your foes,

So nations tremble in their throes.
 3 When You did terrible things that
 We did not expect *on our mat*,
 You came down and the mountains flowed
 Down at Your presence *and Your goad*.
 4 For from the world's beginning men
 Have not heard nor by ear given ken
 Neither has the eye seen, just You,
 O Alohims know of the view
 Of what He's prepared for the one
 Who waits for Him *in what He's done*.
 5 You meet the one rejoicing and
 Doing the righteous thing to stand
 In Your remembrance in Your ways,
 See You are angered by the maze
 Of our sins, in those always plays
 The coming of salvation's days.

Ear has not heard nor has eye seen
 Is a phrase that St. Paul would glean
 From old Isaiah when he hopes
 To open up the future scopes
 To the eyes of Gentiles who make
 Jesus the leader of their stake.
 Whether or not the Pharisee
 Misapplies the promise in spe,
 I meet the one rejoicing now
 In the new sun behind the brow
 Of aspen hill and frozen lake,
 And with the morning breather take
 Another hearing, one more sight
 Of Your ineffable delight.

6 But we are all an unclean thing,
 All our justices come to fling
 As menstuous pads, and we all fade
 Like a leaf, and here on parade
 Are the iniquities we've made,
 Like the wind, bear us from the stayed.
 7 There's none who call upon Your name,
 Stirring himself to hold Your flame,
 For You have hidden face from us,
 And have devoured us for the fuss
 Of our iniquities *in claim*.
 8 But now, O YHWH, You are our Dad,
 We are the clay, and You are *clad*
 As potter, and we're all the work
 Of Your own hand *not wont to shirk*.
 9 Do not be very angry, YHWH,
 Do not remember wickedness
 For ever, but behold the view
 As we beg of You, and confess

We are all Your people *in dress*.
 10 Your holy cities are a waste,
 The fortress is a wilderness,
 Jerusalem has been erased.
 11 Our holy, beautiful address
 Where our ancestors came to bless
 You is burned up with fire, and all
 Our things within Muhammad's stall
 Are turned to ruin *in the fall*.
 12 Will You refrain Yourself for these,
 O YHWH? Will You withhold Islam,
 Afflicting us and without balm
 And sorely *for iniquities*?

The followers of St. Paul forget duly
 The rest of the words Isaiah says truly:
 That sin is wicked wrong and it must fail,
 And even righteous deeds in stinking rail
 Must be flung off and the soul quiet lie,
 Relinquishing the human will, to die
 In potter's hand until the wilderness
 Of fair Jerusalem meets the address
 Of fire and after fire the coming of
 The desert prophet with his burning love.
 Isaiah looks toward that time beyond
 St. Paul and lifts a hopeful, guessing frond
 That You will not withhold from Jew and
 saint
 Islam upon the day of Your restraint.

Isaiah 65

1 I am sought of those who asked not,
 I am found of those who have sought
 Not at all, I said "See me, see,"
 To a nation not called to be
 By My name nor planted in plot.
 2 I've spread My hands in supplication
 All day to a rebellious nation,
 That walks in a way that's not good,
 After their own thoughts *in a wood*.
 3 A folk that always would provoke
 Me to wrath to My face for broke,
 That sacrificed in gardens fair,
 And burned incense upon the glare
 Of altars made of brick to stare.
 4 They stay to worship among graves,
 And lodge where the monument paves,
 They eat pork and soup of unclean
 Things in their bowls and spoons *to glean*.
 5 They say "Stand aside, don't come near
 To me, for I'm a holier peer
 Than you." These are smoke in My nose,

A fire that scorches as it goes.
 6 See, it's determined at My face,
 I will not be quiet in place,
 But will give recompense and so
 Let the same fire in their heart glow.
 7 "Your sins and your ancestors' sins,"
 Says YHWH, "who've made perfume in
 bins
 Upon the mountains and blasphemed
 Me on the hills, so I have beamed
 Their former deeds in their hearts
creamed."

As prophesied by David of the time
 That Moses brought the people from the
 clime
 Of Egypt, the folk will not trust the voice
 Of desert prophet come here to rejoice.
 Instead the Hellenizing Jewish strain
 Becomes the wicked Christian pagan reign
 Of pork pie and of offerings wine and
 bread
 Given to heathen deities instead
 Of You, Beloved, Creator of all things.
 Against these two follies You come to
 kings
 And princes in the word that Islam brings
 To curse the infidel blasphemy,
 And show the world universal mercy,
 But only find another wicked spree.

8 So says YHWH, "As the new grape juice
 Is found in the cluster's abuse,
 And one says 'Don't destroy the use'
 For there's a blessing in the truce,
 So I shall do for my slaves' sakes,
 I'll not destroy all of their shakes.
 9 "And I'll bring from Jacob a seed,
 And from Judah possessor's deed
 Of My mount, and they will possess
 It, My elect and the address
 Of My servants shall have their lead.
 10 "Sharon shall be a fold of flocks,
 The vale of Achor in its locks
 A shelter for the herds, and for
 My people that have sought My store."

Another seed You bring in the last time,
 A tiny seed despised in prose and rhyme,
 A girl-child it may be, since men have
 strayed
 From Eden to the darkness of the raid

Of Rome and Athens, and Genevan stream
 As far as London in the futile dream.
 Another seed You bring, not one to be
 Known to the eyes of those in armoury,
 But hidden in the frozen land and lake,
 Beside pine-studded hill and in the wake
 Of mink and fox who shyly send a prayer
 That no man living uncover their lair.
 Beloved, I kiss the hidden seed and lay
 It's head to sleep and silently away.

11 But you are those that forsake YHWH,
 Forgetting My holy mount's view,
 Preparing a mess for that troop,
 Furnishing drink offerings to dupe
 That band of devils and their crew.
 12 So I'll count you up for the sword,
 And you'll all bow down to the floored
 Slaughter, because when I called you,
 You did not answer, when I spoke,
 You did not hear, but evil stroke
 Perpetrated before My eyes,
 And chose the thing that I despise.
 13 So says the Lord YHWH, "Now behold,
 My servants shall eat hot and cold
 And still be hungry with the fare,
 Behold My servants shall drink share,
 But still be thirsty, see with care
 My servants shall rejoice and yet
 Be bowed with the shame *they have met*.
 14 "See, My servants shall sing for joy
 Of heart, but you shall tears employ
 For sadness, and howl in the grasp
 Of troubled spirit *clip and clasp*.
 15 "You'll leave your name to be a curse
 To My elect, and what is worse
 The Lord YHWH shall slay you and call
 His servants by another name.
 16 "So the one who on earth for claim
 Shall bless himself, shall blessing take
 In the Alohim of truth's sake.
 And the one who swears on the earth
 Will swear in Alohim of truth,
 Because the former troubles lie
 Forgotten and because they fly
 Hidden away before My eye."

Suzanne sang of the ancient temple tune
 With hope that every Jew and Gentile soon
 Would hear the olden lays and come to
 show
 Obedience to You alone and know.

Instead the very seat of learning at
 Jerusalem turned out scornful fiat,
 And all the world turned a deaf ear to that.
 That's why there is a dearth of holy Word,
 And everywhere the doleful voice is heard
 That hocks and holes the dirge of heathen
 choice
 Deaf to the holy twitters of Your voice.
 Beloved, the former troubles barren lie
 Beneath the simple Psalms that meet the
 sky

Hidden from all and yet to multiply.

17 "For see, I make a brand new sky
 And a new earth; the former die
 Shall not be remembered, nor come
 Into the mind of all *or some*.
 18 "But be glad and rejoice always
 For what I create in those days,
 And see I make Jerusalem
 Rejoicing and her folk a gem.
 19 "I'll rejoice in Jerusalem,
 And joy in My people, the voice
 Of weeping shall no more find choice
 In her, nor crying in her hem.
 20 "No more shall there be the stillborn,
 Nor those who die young before sworn.
 The one who dies a hundred old
 Will be called a youth that's been sold,
 But when a sinner reaches that
 Age, he'll be considered a cat.
 21 "And they'll build houses and live there,
 And they'll plant vineyards, eat the share.
 22 "They'll not build and another stay,
 They'll not plant and another stray
 To eat it, for as the days go
 Of a tree so My folk's days show,
 And My elect shall long enjoy
 The work that their own hands employ.
 23 "They shall not work in vain nor bear
 Children for troubles in their share,
 For they are the seed of the blessed
 Of YHWH, and their offspring the best.
 24 "And it shall come to pass before
 They call I'll answer at the door,
 And while they are still speaking there
 I will hearken to every prayer.
 25 "The wolf and the lamb eat together
 The lion shall in every weather
 Eat fodder like the bullock and
 Dust shall be the serpents command.
 They shall not hurt, shall not destroy

In all my holy mountain's joy,"
Says YHWH *in His holy command*.

Some think the promise came in times long
past

Predicting course of the return at last
From Babylon by offspring of outcast.
Some think the promise is a future scene
Of Jesus' body glorious in sheen
Of church, the apple of his eye and keen.
But I know better secrets in the heart
Of darkened night when sorrow tears apart
The hopes of youth and all is black despair.
The voice of angel on the ear laid bare
Re-echoes on the promises to start.
Beloved, I know the mysteries that vain
Labour calls to the sun and falling rain.
While others guess, I know the divine art.

Isaiah 66

1 So says YHWH, "The sky is My throne
And the earth is My footstool's *stone*,
Where is the house you build for Me?
And where do I take rest to be?

2 "For all those things My hand has made,
And all those things are on parade,"
Says YHWH. "But to this man I'll look,
To the poor with contrite heart's nook,
Who trembled at My word and shook.

3 "The one who kills an ox shall be
As if he killed a man in fee,
And the one who sacrifices
A lamb as if he cut with whiz
A dog's neck; and the one who makes
A drink offering as if he takes
Pig's blood; and the one come to burn
Incense, as if he blessed the urn
Of an idol. Indeed, they chose
Their own ways, and so their soul goes
After abominations' rows.

4 "I'll also take their empty views,
And bring on them the fears they choose,
Because when I called they did not
Answer, and when I spoke a lot,
They did not hear; instead they rose
To do the evil in My sight,
And chose in what I don't delight."

The wine blessed in the chalice and raised
high
For all the folk to bow and sing and cry,

Is not what they think when they hear the
bell,

It's not the blood of Christ beneath the
knell.

The doubter thinks that it remains just
wine,

The fruit of grape and press after the vine,
But fact is the doctrine secret and fine
That it turns into blood is true as twine:
It turns into the blood of piggy swine.
Beloved, I stay at home, and when I drink
The grape juice from the paper carton's
brink,

I know at least pollution at a wink
Is limited to what the law requires
To preserve it from hopefuls and from
squires.

Because the cantillation of Your law
Has met today as in the fatal claw
Of ages past the ignorance of men,
The swilling of the wine to dance again
With devils on the shore by the mouse den,
For this, Beloved, You choose to let the
crowd

Descend to hell and there to sing aloud
The hymns of agony that were their choice.
Beloved, let me lift up another voice,
And beg Your pardon once more on the
earth

To give creation failed a renewed birth.
Write on the heart of stony flesh desire
To sip the syllables beyond Your ire
That echo from Sinai in blazing fire.

5 Hear the word of YHWH, you who shake
At His word, "Your brothers in wake
Who hated you and threw you out
For My name's sake, said 'Let YHWH
shout

For glory,' but He shall appear
To your joy and leave them in fear."

6 The sound of a noise from the town,
A cry from temple of renown,
A voice from YHWH that brings the pay
Upon His enemies in sway.

7 "Before she laboured, she gave birth,
Before her pain came, in his worth
She was delivered of a boy.

8 "Who's heard of such a thing in ploy,
Who has seen such things? Shall the earth
Be made to bear in one day's dearth?

Or shall a nation be born fast?
For as soon as the fortress blast
Came, she bore up her children cast.
9 “Shall I bring to birth and not cause
Delivery?” says YHWH. “Do laws
Bring to bear and yet shut the womb?”
Say your Alohim *to your doom*.

The brethren cast out the fair seed once
born
In secret to meet all the earth in scorn,
And even my prayer spoken and forlorn
In their behalf cannot remove the bourn.
And so that precious seed bore too a son
Before the pangs of labour had begun,
And be that one more sign that You replace
The wicked priesthood with the hidden
trace
Of simple keeping of commandments’ lace.
If virgin-born had been a sign to kings
Set in Jerusalem, this token wings
Today along the beech and walnut hill
In joys that pass under the fateful thrill
To find that rugged paths of faith fulfil.

10 Rejoice now with Jerusalem
And be glad with her, all her gem,
Rejoice with gladness in her hem,
All you that mourn for her *pro tem*.
11 So you may suckle and be filled
With the breasts of her comfort stilled,
So you may milk and with delight
Enjoy her full glory in sight.
12 For so says YHWH, “See I’ll extend
Islam to her stream without end,
And Gentiles’ glory like a stream
Flowing, then you will suck the dream
And be borne on her sides and hung
By the feet from her knees and sung.
13 As one comforted by his mom,
So I will comfort you and calm,
You’ll have solace, Jerusalem.
14 And when you see this stratagem,
Your heart shall rejoice and your bones
Shall flourish like a flower loans,
And YHWH’s hand shall be shown before
His servants, and His anger’s store
Toward His enemies *and drones*.

The faith of peace is still a sight most rare
Within Jerusalem’s walls come to share
The Jewish and the Christian with Islam

In name beneath the sharp-leaved, sighing
palm.
And yet while men of hate return to sword,
Deceitful to both men and to their Lord,
The pilgrim humble and unnoticed finds
The solace of Jerusalem to minds
That echo with the words of Your
commands.
Beloved, the proclamation at Your hands
Of law to love in holy, heathen lands
Returns in chambered hearts and on their
tongues
Into Jerusalem. The laboured lungs
Of pilgrims break the hurtful, fretting
bands.

15 For see, YHWH will come down with
fire,
And with His chariots like ire
Of whirlwind, to render His wrath
With fury, and rebuking path
With flames of fire upon the pyre.
16 For by the fire and by His sword
YHWH shall plead with all flesh implored,
And the slain of YHWH multiply.
17 “Those who practice ablutions sly
In gardens behind trees and eat
Pork and abomination’s treat,
And mice, shall all then be consumed
Together,” says YHWH *of the doomed*.
18 “For I know their works and their
thoughts,
It shall come I shall gather *knots*
Of all nations and languages,
And they shall come and see *the whiz*
Of My glory and of My biz.
19 “And I will set a sign among
Them, and I’ll send those on the rung
Escaped from them to every land,
To Tarshish, Pul and Lud to stand
And draw the bow, to Tubal and
Javan, to continents in band
Far off, that have not heard My fame,
And have not seen My glory’s claim,
And so among Gentiles proclaim
The splendour of My holy name.
20 “They’ll bring your brothers all to be
A gift to YHWH out of the spree
Of all the nations, on horse and
In chariots, in litters grand,
And on mules and upon swift beasts,
To My holy mountain of feasts,

Jerusalem," says YHWH, "just like
 The children of Israel in spike
 Bring an offering in a clean pot
 Into the house of YHWH *for lot*.
 21 "And I will take of them for priests
 And for Levites *to make the feasts*,"
 Says YHWH *when He reveals His plot*.
 23 "And it shall come to pass, from one
 First day of the month *in the sun*
 To another, and from one day
 Of Sabbath to another's sway,
 Shall all flesh come to worship there
 Before Me," says YHWH *on the stair*.
 24 And they shall go out, take a look
 At the dead carcasses that shook
 Of the men that transgressed My law;
 For their worm shall not die for straw,
 Neither shall their fire quench in awe,
 And they shall be abhorred and hated
 By all flesh *without breath abated*.

Three groups I see transported in the pen
 Isaiah plucked upon the river marge
 To write upon the parchment in his large
 Black letters: the descent of fire again
 Upon the Grecian invaders of men,
 The Hellenizing troops of Jewish barge
 That entice Athens' idols of their charge,
 And finally the Gentile band and den.
 Beloved, let me be of that Gentile crowd
 That returns to Your law being unbowed
 To idol and the science of the scroll
 Of fates. Beloved, let me look on the toll
 Of carcasses from Baghdad to the stream
 Of Jordan and wake from the evil dream.

Jeremiah

After the death of king Josiah came
 The decline of divine favour in flame,
 And two parties vied in the court of kings
 For power political instead of wings
 Of faith: the one trusted Egypt would rise
 Again a bulwark thrust against the skies,
 While others rightly saw that Babylon
 Was the new power to rule under the sun.
 And so they argued about whom to trust,
 While prophets laid their honour in the dust
 To seek all help from You, Beloved alone.
 Jeremiah cries to the heart of stone,
 Lifts up a voice lamenting that Your own

Should turn from You to politics and rust.

Jeremiah 1

1 The words of Jeremiah son
 Of Hilkiah, a priest *when done*
 Of those who *were* in Anathoth
 In land of Benjamin *for growth*,
 2 To whom the word of YHWH came
 down
 In days Josiah was *in town*,
 The son of Amon, king of Judah,
 In the thirteenth year of his reign.
 3 It also came in the days of
 Jehoiakim who was son of
 Josiah king of Judah, to
 The end of the eleventh year
 Of Zedekiah the son too
 Of Josiah, Judah's king *dear*,
 Up to the carrying away
 Of Jerusalem in the sway
 Of the fifth month captivity.
 4 Then the word of YHWH came to me:
 5 "Before I formed you in belly
 I knew you, and before you came
 Out of the uterus your fame
 I set apart, and I ordained
 You prophet to nations *arraigned*."
 6 Then I said "Ah, Lord YHWH, see now,
 I can't speak, I'm a child *in brow*."
 7 And YHWH said to me, "Do not say
 'I am a child *along the way*,'
 For you shall go to everyone
 To whom I send you when you're done,
 And what I tell you, you will say.
 8 "Do not be afraid of their faces,
 For I'm with you *to save your graces*,"
 Says YHWH. 9 And YHWH stretched out
 His hand
 And touched my mouth. And YHWH's
 command
 To me was, "See, I've put my song
 In your mouth, *so you can't go wrong*.
 10 "See, I have given you this charge
 Today over nations at large
 And over kingdoms, to root out
 And to pull down, destroy the stout,
 And to throw down and build and plant."
 I've been a child, and probably well known
 To You as sovereign sitting on your throne.
 But I have never felt Your hand on mouth

Nor heard Your speaking coming from the south.

That may be just because creating hand
Of You has never left my breath and sand,
But from the start to finish holds the form
In which I walk and talk by Your hand
warm.

It may be that I do not hear Your voice
Because in every syllable rejoice
The winds, the grasses, complaints of bird and
beast

That compass me around in royal feast.
Only the silence can make the word heard,
Only the letting go reveal hand stirred.

11 There was a word of YHWH to me,
Saying "Jeremiah, what see?"

And I said "Rod of almond tree."

12 YHWH said to me, "You have seen
well,

For I am watching My words' spell
To carry it out *hill and dell*."

13 YHWH's word came to me once again,
Saying "What do you see *and when*?"

I said "I see a boiling pot
Opened toward the northland's plot."

14 And YHWH said to me, "From the
north

An evil event shall break forth
On all the dwellers of the land.

15 "For lo, I'll call each family's band
From all the northern kingdoms' stand,"
Says YHWH, "and they shall come and
they

Shall each one set his sway
Up in the entering of the gates
Of Jerusalem *for estates*,
And against its walls round about,
Against all Judah's cities stout.
16 "And I will speak My judgements fair
Against them for their wickedness,
Who have forsaken My address,
And burned incense to idols there,
And worshipped what their own hands
made.

17 "So tighten your belt and get up,
And speak to them *though you're a pup*,
All I command, don't be dismayed
At their faces, for I will not
Let you be afraid of their plot.

18 "And see, I've given you today
For a strong city and for stay

Of iron pillar, brazen walls
Against the whole land as it falls,
Against the kings of Judah too,
Against its princes come in view,
Against its priests, against the folk
Of the whole country at a stroke.

19 "And they shall fight against you and
They shall not prevail where you stand,
For I'm always with you," says YHWH,
"To bring you to salvation's view."

You never gave me visions of the pot
And almond rod, I never heard the plot
Of Your voice telling me message
unsought.

I have no mandate struck in gold or got
From Your hand and Your throne, but still I
find

An empathy with Jeremiah's kind.
I find myself to rant against the priest
As well as king and president at least,
And to be thrown out of both church and
feast.

Without command I tighten belt and raise
A voice of judgement and a voice of praise,
One to the human prodigy and one
To You alone, Beloved, when I've begun.
Let me blast in jeremiad increased.

Jeremiah 2

1 A word of YHWH was for me saying:

2 "Go shout at Jerusalem's brow,
Say 'So says YHWH *to whom you're
praying*,

I do remember you and how
Kind you were in your youth somehow,
The love of when you were engaged,
When you followed after Me paged
In the desert and in a land
That was not sown *by human hand*.

3 "Israel was holiness to YHWH,
The firstfruits of His increase too,
All who devour him shall offend,
And destruction shall be their end,""
Says YHWH. 4 So hear the words of
YHWH,

O house of Jacob, *and be true*,
All the families of Israel's house.

5 So says YHWH *of His early spouse*,
"What fault did your ancestors find
In Me that they went off the blind
To walk after vain idols share

And become vain themselves *and bare?*”

6 They did not say “Where now is YHWH
That brought us from Egypt’s land’s crew,
And led us through the wilderness,
Through a land of deserts and mess,
Through a land of drought and of shade
Of death, through a land no one made
A path and where none had address?”

7 “I brought you to a fruitful land
To eat its produce out of hand,
And you came to defile My land,
And made My heritage to stand
Abomination *and a mess*.

8 “The priests did not say ‘Where is
YHWH?’

And those who treat of process due
Did not know Me, the pastors too
Transgressed against me, prophets came
To prophesy in Baal’s name,
And act according to his shame.”

You were the portable in gods, that’s why
The people followed You upon the dry
And parched land of the road past Mount
Sinai.

But even then they confused You with that
Sun-disk of Egypt between calf-horns sat.
So how can You expect them in the green
Of settlement not to turn the gods seen
Upon the Canaanite field’s fruitful sheen?
Beloved, the words of Jeremiah take
The legend of Your leading for the sake
Of Israel’s love to bolster up the view
That Josiah for politics made true.
The faith I bring to You is bare indeed:
I grasp in lust and monolatric greed.

9 “Why do I keep trying with you?”
Says YHWH, “and with your children too?”

10 “Go look at Chittim’s isles and see,
Send to Kedar, diligently
Consider and know if there’s been
Anywhere else this kind of sin.

11 “Has any nation changed their gods,
And yet they’re not gods, merely clods?
But My folk has changed glory’s sight
For things without profit *or right*.

12 “So be amazed, you skies, at this,
And be afraid and flee from bliss,”
Says YHWH. “My folk have done two
wrongs.

They have forsaken Me *in songs*,

The fountain of water of life,
And dug out cisterns, broken *knife*,
That hold no water *in the strife*.

Beloved, Your prophets always seem to
like

To praise good Kedar with a message rife,
And notice that he never leaves his faith
In the one God alone for wicked wraith.
When Israel follows after politics
And chances any goddesses with tricks,
The tents of Kedar in their faithful way
Keep to the shining light of righteous day.
Beloved, let the skies above be amazed
That humble people are not driven crazed
By policy and facile innovation,
But keep plodding on without exultation.
The Chamberlins beside the homely hearth
Kept to the Psalms and Sabbath despite
swarth.

14 Is Israel a servant here,
Is he a homeborn slave with gear?
Why is he spoiled, a prey *to tear?*

15 Against him roar young lions in rage,
And make his land a brigandage.

The children too of Noph, those bred
Of Tahapanes break your head.

17 Have you not brought this on yourself,
Forsaking YHWH your Alohim,
When He led you across *the stream?*

18 Now what have you to do with *elf*
Of Egypt, to drink Sihor’s flood?
Or what have you to do with mud
Of the Assyrian to drink
The waters at the river brink?

The prophets try to place the blame of
flood

Of foreign aggression upon the bud
Of trusting in the gods and goddesses
That blossom from the countries with a
fizz.

The fact is factions that placed trust in each
Empire around Jerusalem to reach
Weakened the kingdom by partisan
thought,

Failure to seek a higher road and taught.
The higher road was independence sought,
The national view of the state and church,
The wedding of You with the throne as
perch.

The monotheistical ideal came
To bolster nationalist views and fame,
No stronger basis leaves me in the lurch.

19 "Your own wickedness shall correct
Your wrong views, and what you select
In your apostasy shall make
Reproof upon you for My sake;
So know and see the bad and bitter,
That you've forsaken YHWH, *you quitter*,
Your Alohim, and that My fear
Is not in you," says Lord YHWH near.

It may not be quite accurate to say
That Israel kept once to the narrow way
In times of Moses, Joshua and Judges,
And only after Josiah now fudges.
Truth is the two ways were pointed out fast
By Moses, and Joshua too at last
Said choose you this day, and Elijah came
To Carmel with a holy light and flame.
The wrong does not teach right, but
reinforces
The everlasting coming to divorces.
Beloved, the prophet grasps at claws when
he
Reflects upon the past apostasy,
And hopes to ignite faith in the pretence
That faith was ever found in Israel's tents.

20 "From ancient time I broke your yoke,
And burst your chains, and then you spoke,
'I'll not transgress,' when on each height
Of hill and under each green mite
Of tree you wandered in the night
Of harlotry *instead of right*.
21 "I'd planted you a noble vine,
Completely a right seed of Mine:
How did you turn into a wild
Plant of a strange vine and defiled?
22 "Though you wash with nitre and take
Plenty of soap, still your sins' stake
Is marked before Me," says Lord YHWH.

Attributing Your name to a false god,
To vain things under fertility's pod,
Is what the commandment prohibits when
It says not to lift up Your name again.
Today as in the past the folk rise up
To say that they drink from communion
cup
While worshipping the risen Baal like tup

With the pretext that calling false gods
YHWH

Makes everything right in the divine view.
Beloved, baptism does not change the sin
A whit nor wash away uncomely din
Of pagan hymn and brawl beneath the star
Of Queen of heaven across from the bar.
Pollution's not on hand but heart within.

23 How can you say "I'm not polluted,
I've not followed Baal convoluted?"
See your way in the valley, know
What you've done, you are not a slow
Dromedary in ways saluted.

24 A wild ass in the wilderness
That sniffs the wind in joyous dress,
In her time who can turn away?
All who seek her will not be tired,
But in her month they'll find her *fired*.

25 Keep from walking barefoot, and keep
From being thirsty *for a peep*:
But you said "There's no hope, for I
Have loved strange gods and I shall ply
To go after them *by and by*."

26 As the thief is ashamed when he
Is found, so is the house in fee
Of Israel ashamed to be;

They with their kings, princes and priests
And their prophets *come to make feasts*,

27 Say to a block of wood "You are
My counsellor" and to a stone
"You have sired me" for *on their own*
That have turned their back on My throne
And not shown their face, but in time
Of trouble they will give a mime:
"Get up and save us *from the groan*."

28 But where are your gods that you've
made?

Let them get up and on parade
Save you in times of trouble laid,
As many as towns are your gods,
O Judah *laid out on the sods*.

The Protestant today protests that he
Does not follow Baalim in heathen spree,
And yet he holds fast that theology,
The human sacrifice, the waking god,
The rite of spring, the bud, the bloom, the
pod.

The very same in spirituality
Comes ever and anon upon the tree:

When trouble comes, the heart comes back
to beg
Your help, Beloved, as though the driven
peg
Had never left Your bosom. Here I go,
Beloved, semper reformandi in show,
But let my life return into the glow
Of Your law, Your face, and Your sacred
throne,
Where I shall worship You and You alone.

29 "Why will you come plead with Me
now?
You've all transgressed against My brow,"
Says YHWH. 30 "In vain I strike your
sons,

They're not corrected *on their buns*,
Your own sword has your prophets slain,
Like a destroying lion's *mane*.

31 "O generation, see YHWH's word:
A desert have I been injured
To Israel? A land in dark?

Why do My people say *a lark*,
'Rebelling we come not to You?'

32 "Can a girl forget jewellery's due
Or a bride her bridal gown's view?
Yet My folk have forgotten Me
Days without number, without fee.

33 "Why do you pretend you do right
To seek My love? That's why the sight
Teaches the wicked walk in night.

34 "Also upon your skirts is found
The blood of innocent renowned:
It did not take a secret search
To find it fresh upon your smirch.

35 "Yet you say 'I am innocent,
So surely His anger is spent.'
See, I will argue with you when
You say that you've not sinned again.

36 "Say! You're vile to repeat your game,
Even in Egypt you find shame,
As you were of Assyrian fame.

37 "Indeed, you'll go out from him too,
And your hands on your heads in view,
For YHWH has rejected your hopes,
And you'll not prosper with such *popes*."

Religious politics remain the same
After the centuries in the old game.
The leaders are both fickle and aware
Only of their own power to keep the stair.

So when they change their minds before the
folk
They claim it's this way that they always
spoke.
Their ways have been consistent, out for
broke,
And they speak truth: from start to finish
they
Have only been out to gain their own sway.
So when it's famous to toe to Your line
They pretend that's what they have done in
sign
From birth. And yet You fail to love their
eyes
Who come to You in hypocritic guise.
Leave me, Beloved, my own heart to
despise.

At the reception of the president
At the new year or at the evening spent
Remembering pretence of independent,
You see the frocks and gowns in pastel hue
Pass by in their parade of garish cue,
Look on the smirch of blood that stains the
cloth

Of the elite flying to fire like moth.

At the mass when the priest comes into
view

With skirts spread out and ironed and slick
as new,

See the spots red and crimson on them
spread,

Remember all the holocaustly dead,
The Jews, the Africans, Indians unfed.
Beloved, the days of state and business
keep

The barge afloat, while I rage and I weep.

Jeremiah 3

1 "They say 'If a man divorce wife
And she goes out from the home strife
To marry other men, shall he
Return to her again in fee?
Does that not greatly pollute land?'
But you have played the harlot band
With many lovers, yet return
Again to Me and do not spurn,"
Says YHWH. 2 "Lift up your eyes unto
The high places where you in view
Have fornicated, find a place
Where you have not lain in disgrace.
You've sat beside the road to wait

For Johns like desert Arabs mate,
 And you've defiled the land by your
 Fornicating and by the store
 Of your wickedness. 3 "So the showers
 Of rain have been withheld from bowers,
 And there has been no latter rain;
 But you had the daring face of
 A whore, without shame *called it love*.
 4 "Will you not from now on tell Me,
 'Dad, You're my guide in youthful spree?'"
 5 Does He keep it up for an age
 And watch for ever on the stage?
 See, these things you have spoken fast,
 Doing evil, yet not outcast.

Pollution of the land is the result
 Of idol worship caught in the sex cult.
 I cannot make connexion quite but see
 A glimmer of the golden bough lightly
 In touch with Jeremiah in his spree.
 But whether by contagious magic or
 By sympathetic magician in store,
 The fact is the pollution of the shore
 Of every country in the world today
 Suggests idolatry is in full sway.
 Beloved, I turn from plastic wrapper to
 The words on Sinai that were spoken true
 And faithful to prevent excess and strew,
 And find my faith and practice in Your
 pew.

I know a lot of Christians without shame
 Who talk about love blaspheming Your
 name.

TV evangelists have the same fame
 As Jeremiah's friends who played the
 game.

To die on cross is just a euphemism
 For the orgasmic whoreship of baptism.
 And eating bread and drinking wine's
 preamble

To eating menstuous pussy at a gambol.
 I hate to use these words, Beloved, it's not
 My kind of language nor what I've been
 taught,

But Jeremiah's teen-age mind in slot
 Is showing under Your name's
 approbation.

The language is no doubt the proper ration
 Against enormity of Christian station.

6 YHWH also said to me in days

Of Josiah the king *of praise*,
 "Have you seen the apostasy
 That Israel has done from Me?
 She has gone up every high hill
 And there under every green tree
 Has fornicated to her fill.
 7 "I said after she'd done all these,
 'Return to Me.' She would not please.
 Her traitor sister Judah saw.
 8 "And I saw and with ready claw
 For all of Israel's lack of law
 Divorced her and sent her away,
 Still traitor sister Judah *gay*
 Did not take warning, went to play
 The harlot too in the same way.
 9 "It happened fornication vile
 Of her actions came to defile
 The land, and she wrought fornication
 With stone and wooden *dildo's* ration.
 10 "And yet for all of this her traitor
 Sister Judah was no abater,
 Did not repent with her whole heart,
 But in pretence of righteous part,"
 Says YHWH. 11 And so said YHWH to
 me,

"The open sin of Israel's spree
 Is better than the treachery
 Of Judah in hypocrite's cart.

Israel's open, idol-worshiping farce
 Continues in the Christian verb to parse
 In human sacrifice and professed love.
 Judah's ancient dagger hidden in glove
 Continues in the mosque and synagogue.
 One incurs wrath, the other goes astray,
 And the oppressed by-stander lives to pay.
 Three-headed god that Christians worship
 still

May not be stone or wooden dildo's pill,
 But lives in the iconic video,
 And in the plastic vibrators that glow
 With jazz before the cross and altar show.
 Beloved, I turn to You alone and hear
 Commandments spoken singular with fear.

12 "Go and proclaim these words toward
 The north," says YHWH the Lord,
 "'Return, backsliding Israel,
 It was not that My anger fell
 On you for your destruction, I
Am merciful,' says YHWH, 'And I
 Will not remain angry for aye.'

13 "Only admit your sinfulness,
That in your doing you transgress
Against YHWH your God, and have
scattered
Your charms to strange idols and battered
Beneath each green tree, and have not
Obeyed My voice *as you've been taught,*"
Says YHWH. 14 "Return, backsliding
folk,"

Says YHWH, "for I'm married to you.
I will take you *and not revoke,*
One from a city and two from
A family, and you shall come
Into the fortress. 15 "And I'll give
You shepherds by My own heart's *sieve,*
Who'll feed you with knowledge and true
Understanding of *what to do.*
16 "Then it shall come to pass, when you
Are multiplied, increased in land
In those days *and by My command,*"
Says YHWH, "that they will say no more,
'Ark of the covenant of YHWH.'
It shall not come to *their* mind, nor
Shall they remember it, nor do
Their visits to it anymore.

The church claims to be that refuge You
give
To Gentiles and to Jews who come to live
Under the grace of Your forgiving sieve.
The principle of functional replacement
Of heathen practices is its abasement.
The church of Constantine accommodated
To cultic sacrifice and unabated
Idolatry with such replacements' view.
The same is fostered by missionised crew
In every place, and so we eat the brew
Of wine and bread instead of children's
flesh
And use a crucifix for dildos fresh,
Unless we're Protestant, and then we take
Imagined cross, masturbatory cake.

17 "At that time Jerusalem shall
Be called the Throne of YHWH, and all
The nations shall be gathered to
Jerusalem, and name of YHWH.
No more shall they follow dictates
Of their evil hearts. 18 "In those *states*
And days the house of Judah shall
Walk with the house of Israel,
And they shall come together out

Of the land of the north *with shout*
To the land that I've given as an
Inheritance to partisan.

19 "But I said 'How can I put you
Among the children and their due,
Bestowing on you the land of
Muhammad, heritage of love,
Beauty of the hosts of the nations?'
"And I said 'You shall *in elations*
Call Me, "My Father," and not turn
Away from Me, *nor My love spurn.*'

When You, Beloved, brought back from
their exile
Israelite folk who had been gone a while,
Brought them from Babylon and from the
plains
Of east and north once more to count their
gains,
You sorrowed to think they might touch the
land,
Muhammad's heritage by Your command.
The fortress of Jerusalem You find
Is at the west end far from temple lined.
Let that be for Judah's trifled descendants.
Let them take comfort in David's new
pendants.
But let Your Throne, Beloved, stand bright
and bare
For all nations beneath Muhammad's care.
And let the bride look from her peaceful
tower
Toward the golden spires at the prayer
hour.

20 "Indeed like a wife gone astray
From her husband has been your way
Of dealing treacherously here
With Me, O house of Israel near,"
Says YHWH. 21 A voice was heard upon
The high places, weeping *at dawn*
And supplications of the spawn
Of Israel; for they've perverted
Their way, forgotten YHWH *concerted,*
Their Alohim. 22 Repent, backsliding
Children, and I will heal *confiding.*
See, we return to You, for You
Are our Alohim, *You are* YHWH.
23 Indeed it's vain to look to hills,
The mountains crowding *with their stills;*
Truth is in YHWH our Alohim
Is Israel's salvation *in stream.*

24 Idol of shame's consumed the work
 Of our ancestors from *the quirk*
Of our youth, their flocks and their herds,
 Their sons and daughters *burnt like turds*.
 25 We lie down in our shame with face
 Covered, for we have sinned apace
 Against YHWH our Alohim's grace,
 We and our ancestors in place,
 From our youth to this very day,
 And we have not come to obey
 YHWH our Alohim's voice in sway.

If those upon the altars would just stop
 To see how heathen are the prayers they
 pop,
 And then repent of human sacrifice,
 The offering of sons of gods for nice
 Warm feelings in the church and money
 gained
 From oil and gas and corn once it's
 ungrained,
 Then the last prayer that Jeremiah makes
 Here would apply to them and for their
 sakes.
 Beloved, I hie me from the worship's din,
 And from the market-place, the den of sin,
 And come to the abandoned high place
 where
 You speak to the whole earth in witness'
 share
 To each soul singly, head and shoulders
 bare.
 I find both fear and solace lurking there.

Jeremiah 4

1 "If you'll return, O Israel,"
 Says YHWH, "Return to Me *a spell*,
 And if you'll put away your *sad*
 Abominations from My sight,
 Then you'll not be removed *from right*.
 2 "And you shall swear: 'As YHWH does
 live,
 In truth, in judgement righteous sieve,'
 And the nations shall bless themselves
 In Him and in His glory's *shelves*."

Beloved, if You were in such need of love,
 Why did you make the human heart with
 glove,
 The eye blind to the truth, the ear so small
 That it hears not the scratching on the wall?
 If You, Beloved, desired return to You,

Why did You make a heart that takes its
 cue
 Always from empty stars and fleeing sun?
 Why did You sow creation with the dun?
 I turn to You for fleeting moments sent
 Upon the night of fragrance in my tent
 And then enfold again upon the grief
 Of longing beyond hope, beyond belief.
 Be satisfied with Your eternity,
 Moments of Your reprieve, Your priceless
 sea.

3 For so says YHWH to Judah's men
 And to Jerusalem again,
 "Break up your fallow ground and sow
 Not among thorns *to make a show*.
 4 "Circumcise yourselves now to YHWH
 And take away the foreskins' *shoe*
 From your heart, You men of Judah
 And dwellers of Jerusalem,
 Lest My fury come tooth and claw
 Like fire, and burn as to condemn
 With none to quench, because of woe
 Of your wicked doings in show."

The churchly crew thinks Paul invented
 runs
 Of circumcision on the heartily buns,
 But You and I, Beloved, know that the pen
 Of Jeremiah quoted Moses when
 He called for circumcision of the heart.
 Perhaps it's true You whispered of that art
 Both noble and remarkable when You
 Bent across Sinai's ragged storming view.
 It is not realistic, Beloved, here
 To demand of men on earth to appear
 To break the ground since it was cursed
 with fear.
 You ask too much, Beloved, when You
 expect
 A man to put the knife to the select,
 When the raw flesh quivers where it is
 wrecked.

5 Declare you in Judah, declare
 Within Jerusalem, and share:
 "Blow now the trumpet in the land;
 Cry, gather together to stand
 And say 'Assemble in a crowd,
 And let's go in the fortress proud.'
 6 "Lift up a flag in Zion's way,

Strengthen yourselves, don't stand and
stay,

For evil I bring from the north,
And great destruction *coming forth*."

7 Gone up has a lion from his den,
Destroyer of nations again,
He's come from his place to make land
A desolation, and the band
Of your cities a waste without
Inhabitant *to range about*.

8 For this tie on sackcloth and weep
And howl, for the fierce anger *steep*
Of YHWH's not turned back from our
sleep.

9 "And it shall come to pass that day,"
Says YHWH, "the heart of king in sway
Shall perish and the heart of prince;
And the priest astonished shall wince,
And prophets wonder *at the way*."

I do not fathom, my Beloved, the deep
Aloneness of Your heart in anger's keep.
I've never suffered such wrath as You do,
My anger's just a ripple on the dew,
And then the calm stopped by the
buttercup,

The chickweed blossom, dandelion turned
up.

I cannot empathize with the great wrath
That turns the flaming suns out from their
path.

The human heart must perish at the thought
Of what You know, or pretend when
uncaught

That You are all love, sweet like Ashtoreth
Come on the groves at eventide with breath
Of kind forgiveness, solace and the meet
And hopeful understanding of the street.

10 Then said I, "Ah, Lord YHWH! surely
You have deceived, deceived greatly
This people and Jerusalem,
Saying 'You will have peace *in hem*'
Whereas the sword pricks to soul's *gem*."

11 At that time shall it be said to
This folk and Jerusalem's crew,
"A dry wind from high places' view
And in the wilderness toward
The daughter of My folk adored,
Not to fan nor to purify."

12 A full wind from these comes for Me,
Now also I speak judgements free.

13 See, he shall come up as the clouds,
And his chariots as whirlwind shrouds:
His horses faster than the wings
Of eagles. Woe to us! Our springs
Are spoiled *beneath a shredded sky*.

14 Purify evil from your heart,
Jerusalem, so that the part
Of saving may come to your *cart*.
How long shall your vain thoughts remain
Within you *to become a stain*?

15 A voice declares the thing from Dan,
Publishes affliction *in ban*
From Mount Ephraim. 16 And so declare
To the nations, and show the share
Against Jerusalem, now come
Besiegers from a far land's *drum*,
Raise their voice against Judah's towns.

17 "As keepers of a field *and downs*
Are they against her round about;
Because she's raised rebellious shout
Against me," says YHWH *without doubt*.
18 "Your ways and doings have procured
These things to you, and have ensured
Your wickednesses, because they
Are bitter, because they hold sway
Into your heart *to keep their way*."

You do not know what sword sweeps
human heart

With the impounded dying of Your start,
The pretence of Your peace, the lowly bud
Of prophet raging unheard by the flood
Of sand and wind that blow across the rift
Of the Arabian desert of the miffed.

You do not know, Beloved, because You're
not

A man encumbered with both time and
thought.

You see the ecstasies before the plot,
And know the calm before the age can
drift.

Yet right You are, Beloved, when You
condemn

The hand that crushes life's untimely gem,
The fragile waiting of a bloom unknown
Even among the tombs of flesh and bone.

19 My aching guts, my aching guts!
I'm pained to my very heart's struts,
My heart cries out within me; I
Cannot be still, since you my soul
Have heard the sound of trumpet roll,

And warning sound of war awry.
 20 Destruction on disaster cried;
 The whole land is spoiled in the tide,
 And suddenly my tents are rent,
 My curtains in a moment spent.
 21 How long shall I still see the flag
 And hear sound of the trumpet rag?
 22 My folk is foolish, they've not known
 Me, they are sottish children grown,
 They have no thought to understand.
 They are wise to do wickedness,
 But to do good they've no address.
 23 I looked upon the earth and see
 It was without form and voidly
 Under the skies without light's *hand*.
 24 I saw the mountains, how they shook,
 And all the hills moved like a brook.
 25 I saw, and see, there was no man,
 And all the birds in heaven's span
 Had fled away *beneath the look*.
 26 I stared, and see, the fruitful place
 Was just a desert way to trace,
 And all towns there were broken down
 At the presence of YHWH, the frown
 Of His fierce wrath *shown without grace*.
 27 For so said YHWH: "All the land knew
 A desolation, but end's view
 I have not made *upon the place*.
 28 "For this the earth shall mourn, the skies
 Above be black, because My sighs
 Have sounded it, I have decided,
 And will not change My mind unguided,
 Neither will I turn it backwise.
 29 "The whole town shall flee for the noise
 Of horsemen and bowmen in poise,
 They'll go into the thickets and
 Climb up the rocks, all towns shall stand
 Forsaken, with no dweller's *guise*.
 30 "And when you're spoiled, what will
 you do?
 Though you clothe yourself with red hue,
 Though you deck you with golden strew,
 And paint your eyes with stibic stone,
 You'll dress yourself in vain and groan
 That lovers despise you and seek
 Your life *the moment you are weak*.
 31 "I've heard a voice as of a girl
 In labour, and the anguish whirl
 As of one that brings forth her first
 Child, the voice of the daughter *cursed*
 Of Zion who bewails herself,
 And spreads her hands: 'Woe is my *pelf*,

My soul's tired of murders' *outburst*.'"

The whole town flees indeed, and every
 town
 That lives beneath the glitter of the crown
 Of painted faces. I have seen the drop
 Of honey on the lip. I came to stop.
 Beloved, the spoils are rampant on the
 grooved,
 And every human way slinks out behaved.
 The whole town flees, yet every spoil is
 spent
 On the hopes that the human waiting lent.
 Hear now the voice of labour, hear and
 know
 The faint diminishing of human show,
 The spreading of the hands, the piercing
 wail
 That meets the dawn as a remembered tale,
 Forgotten in eternal sweep of stars,
 Erased from memory, leaving no scars.

Jeremiah 5

1 "Run back and forth and through the
 streets
 Of Jerusalem, see retreats
 And know and seek the squares in it,
 If you can find a man that's fit
 To do judgement and seek the truth,
 And I'll forgive the town *with ruth*."

One righteous man alive on earth's enough
 To keep Your mercy from spoiling the
 tough.
 Beloved, I seek with Mr D.'s great light,
 A lantern lit in Greece both day and night,
 To find one righteous man on earth today.
 I do not find one but has eyes on prey.
 Admittedly, my sampling is so small
 And limited, there may be better call.
 There were one time in Israel in stall,
 Unknown to king and prophet, thousands
 left
 Who kept Your law and left earth unbereft.
 If I can just find that one righteous man,
 I'll slit his throat and leave the world to
 scan
 Your judgement long due by eternal plan.

2 And though they say "YHWH lives
 above,"
 They swear falsely *with hand in glove*.

3 O YHWH, are your eyes not on truth?
You've stricken them, but they've not
grieved,
You have consumed them, they've received
None of correction; they have made
Their faces harder than the stayed
Rock; they have refused to return.

The lovely world, the world where
daffodils
Still call the poet to the lakes and hills,
Has felt the lash of plague and war and
grief,
And yet turns not to Your only relief:
Awareness that there is no I but You,
And all humankind is of one boat's crew.
Does that not tell You, my Beloved, the
truth
That I have declared to You from my
youth?
The noble in the human heart is won
Not by the suffering in the world that's
done,
But by the stopping in silence for fun,
To see the beauty of Your hand and find
The bread of life beyond the drunken
dined.
Correction is not taken by the blind.

4 That's why I said, "Indeed these earn
Nothing in poverty, they're fools,
For they know not YHWH's way in
schools,
Nor judgement of their Alohim.
5 "I'd go and ask the great men who
Have known the very way of YHWH,
And judgement of their Alohim;
But these have altogether smashed
The yoke and burst the bonds and crashed.
6 "That's why a lion from the woods
Will kill them and a wolf *of hoods*
Shall spoil them and a leopard too
Shall spy upon their cities' view,
And every one that goes out then
Shall be torn into pieces when
Their sins are many and increased
Are their apostasies released."

The yoke, the easy yoke that Jesus spread,
The yoke of Decalogue to the new-fed,
Is smashed by those who preach the
Trinity,

And have faith in the sacrifice in spree
Of human lives on crosses for the dead.
The yoke, the easy yoke of spring and dress
Of life that sprouts without the heathen
guess
Of gods and goddesses new-slain to rise
In fables underneath the brazen skies,
The yoke lies shattered in a splintered
mess.
It was not vain that Moses dropped the
stone,
It was not vain You slew the golden throne
Of calf and dancers, that You make us
drink
Today the grit of profit from the sink.

7 "How shall I pardon you for this?
Your children just give Me the miss,
And swear by those that are no gods,
When I had fed them on full pods;
They committed adultery,
Gathered themselves in bands to be
In harlots' houses *on a spree*.
8 "They were as fed horses at dawn,
Every one neighed after *the lawn*
Of his neighbour's wife drawn upon.
9 "For these things shall I not lay charge?"
So says YHWH. "And shall not My soul
Take My revenge on such patrol?"

The falsehood posited by Christian ways
Results in the adulterer for praise.
Not only is the Trinity dressed up
But pagan god and goddess of the tup,
But the unfaithfulness to You to stay
In idol shadow and in idol sway
Relentlessly drives to the fash and gush
Of love and lust, of liquor on the lush,
Fulfilment of the juicy neighbour's lay.
Beloved, take no vengeance on what is cue,
Inevitable as the falling dew,
And natural as the rising of the sun
Upon the stained beds that at dusk were
won.
Forgive once more a world once gone
askew.

10 "Go up on her walls and destroy,
But do not make a full employ;
Take away her ramparts, for they
Are not raised up as in YHWH's way.
11 "For Israel's house and Judah's house

Have dealt Me like a traitor's *mouse*, "
Says YHWH. 12 And they have belied
YHWH

And said "He has not come in view,
Nothing will happen to our crew,
We'll see no sword nor famine due.
13 "And the prophets shall become wind
Without a message in them binned,
And so it shall be done to them."

14 So says YHWH Alohim of hem,
"Because you speak this word, behold,
I'll make My words no longer cold
In your mouth, but devouring fire
To this wooden people *of ire*.

15 "See, I'll bring a nation on you
From far away, O Israel's crew,"
Says YHWH, "it is a mighty band,
And ancient folk, you understand
Not one word of their tongue to know
What they mean when they speak and
show.

16 "Their quiver is an open grave,
They are all mighty men and brave.
17 "They'll eat up your harvest and bread,
Your sons' and daughters' share instead,
They'll eat up your flocks and your herds,
They'll eat up your vines and *like birds*
Your fig trees, they shall make you poor
In every walled city and sure
With the sword *raised*. 18 "Yet in those
days,"

Says YHWH, "I will not of your praise
Make a full end. 19 "And it shall come
To pass, when you shall say in sum,
'Why does YHWH our Alohim do
All these things to us as undue?'
Then you shall give them answer true,
Just as you have forsaken Me
And served strange gods on land and sea,
So shall you serve strangers and stand
In a place that is not your land."

The principle is simple and is just,
Beloved, if it tastes of both blood and dust:
To worship a god implies in the end
Worship of that god's maker and his friend.
The worship of the foreign gods that felt
So good and right to Israel hid a welt:
Their masters would appear one day to bind
All those who worshipped both the seed
and rind.

Beloved, the many gods around I see

Have hidden masters behind the bank's fee,
Behind the president, behind the church,
And all of these would leave me in the
lurch.

I eat the pod and drink the water free
From my own well, and pray to Your
degree.

20 "Declare this in Jacob's house and
Publish it in Judah to stand,
Saying 21 "'Hear this now, foolish folk
And without a heart under yoke,
Eyes they may have, but do not see,
And ears, but hear not *steadily*.'

22 "Do you not fear me now?" says
YHWH,

"Will you not tremble at My view,
Who have placed the sand for the bound
Of the sea by eternal ground,
That it cannot pass over it;
And though its waves may rush and rise,
Yet they cannot prevail in guise,
And though they roar beneath the skies,
They cannot pass over it fit.

23 "But this folk has revolt to share
Rebellion in their heart for care,
And they have turned aside, gone back."

24 Neither do they say in heart's slack,
Let us now fear YHWH Alohim,
Who gives the rain both early scheme
And latter in its season's beam;
He keeps for us appointed weeks
Of the harvest *for which He seeks*.

The rain-dance is a faith I cannot flout,
Being that it is an ancestral clout.
But Baal and Science tell us true enough
That sun evaporates the moisture's cuff
And lets it fall at last from cloud on land
And sea as far as I can understand.
The prophet claims that You send down the
rain

In love or in unconscious counter-stain.
I'll grant that superstitious view, if You
Will show the world that Baal is not true
To demand sacrifice of humankind,
The stroke of war, the execution blind
Of felon caught red- or black-handed where
The bribes and taxes failed to show their
share.

25 “Your sins have turned away these things,
 And your bad deeds withhold the springs
 Of good from you *and your offsprings*.
 26 “Among My folk are wicked men
 Who lie in ambush and set snares,
 They set a trap, catch unawares.
 27 “As a cage is full of birds, so
 Their houses are full of lies’ show;
 Therefore they have become so great
 And got rich *in both house and gate*.
 28 “They’ve got so fat they even shine,
 Indeed they go beyond the fine
 Deeds of the wicked *on the vine*;
 They do not grudge the cause to rise
 From the fatherless, in their guise
 They prosper, but the needy’s right
 They do not keep in justice’ sight.
 29 “For these things shall I not inspect,”
 Says YHWH, “a nation so select,
 Does not My soul avenge itself?
 30 “A wonder and horror on shelf
 Is done in the land; 31 “Prophets speak
 Falsely, and the priests keep their cheek
 By means of that, and yet my folk
 Love it, so what’s the end in stroke?”

The northern kingdom was of greater wealth,
 I know not whether because nature’s stealth
 Was in the plot: a greener land at least
 For humankind as well as fowl and beast.
 The wealth of Protestant, more northern
 show,
 Is parallel upon the surface glow,
 And may or may not mean that fatal ruse
 Of church invisible had better shoes.
 Beloved, hereby I shall forsake the views
 Of Protestant and Catholic in pews,
 And even the beloved in Orthodox
 That stand or bow upon the church floor’s
 rocks.
 I’ve neither wealth nor faith, nor god nor
 row
 Of penance, but I set false prophets low.

Jeremiah 6

1 ‘O children of Benjamin, come,
 In a band flee Jerusalem,
 Sound warning trumpet in Tekoa,
 Set up a signal fire to gleam
 In the town of Beth-Haccerem,

For evil’s from the north to show her,
 A great destruction and a scream.
 2 “The beautiful and delicate
 I’ve cut off from the fortress gate.
 3 “The shepherds with their flocks shall
 come
 To her, they’ll pitch their tents *in sum*
 Against her all around, they eat
 Each in his own place *his own treat*.”

I do not know when Benjamin fled or
 If it was in obedience to this roar
 Of Jeremiah bellowing above
 The sound of Bashan’s cows in heat or
 love.
 But I know that as far as India
 There has been found a breed that claims
 the law
 Of Benjamin and speaks the grand shema’,
 Despite the Hindoo cast that tints them
 more.
 Beloved, I have no known ancestor here
 That was at Sinai’s root to lend an ear
 To Your voice, but if You again appear,
 I promise to come and adore Your choice,
 Or if I am too old to walk or fly,
 I’ll send a grandson to hear You say why.

4 Prepare now war against her, rise,
 And let’s go up under the skies
 Of noon. Woe to us! For the day
 Moves relentlessly on its way,
 The shadows of the evening play.
 5 Rise, and let us go out by night,
 Let us destroy her palace site.
 6 For so says YHWH of hosts, “Cut down
 The trees and throw a mound *in crown*
 Against Jerusalem, the town
 To be attacked, she’s nothing but
 Oppression inside *the gate shut*.
 7 “As a spring pours out waters, so
 She spews out wickedness to show,
 And violence and spoil to know,
 Before My eyes is grief and sores
 Continually *in and outdoors*.
 8 “Be taught now, O Jerusalem,
 Lest My soul depart from your hem,
 Lest I make you be desolate,
 Land where no one lives in the gate.”

Plenty of people live within the gate
 That opens to the narrow streets and late

Into the sacred temple square to find
Two mosques open to prayer for the well-
dined.

Either You went back on Your threat at
last,

Or else the folk that live there in the blast
Have been taught by Your word to keep the
faith

In You and not follow after a wraith.
In truth, I find Armenian and more,
The Ethiopian there keeping score,
And every form of Christ-like on the shore,
As well as Jew and Muslim without gore.
Perhaps all of these have been tried and
true,
And only I alone march out of view.

9 So says YHWH of hosts, "They shall
glean

With care what's left of Israel's scene
As from a vine; turn back your hand
Like a grape-picker on the sand
Back to the baskets." 10 To whom do
I speak and bear the witness true
And find them listening to the due?
See, their ear is uncircumcised,
And they cannot hear the advised,
See, YHWH's message to them's reproach,
They have no gladness in the broach.

11 That's why I am full of YHWH's wrath,
I'm tired of holding to the path,
I'll pour it out on all the sons
Scattered upon the earth in tons,
And on the bands of youth in turn,
For even lord and wife shall burn,
The aged full of days' *concern*.

12 "Their houses shall be given to
Others, both fields and wives in view,
For I will stretch out My hand to
The land's inhabitants," says YHWH.

13 "From least to greatest of them all
Are sunk in covetousness' thrall,
And from the prophet to the priest
All are in their falsehood increased.

14 "They've also touched My people's hurt
Without serious concern to blurt
'Peace, peace', when there's no Islam's
peace.

15 "Were they ashamed in their release
To abominations' increase?
They were not ashamed, not at all,
They did not blush, that's why they'll fall

Among the rest who fall in gall;
At the time I shall come to them
To cast them down by stratagem,"
Says YHWH. 16 So says YHWH, "Stand
beside

The streets and see and ask hawk-eyed
For the old ways, the good and tried
To walk in them, and so to find
Rest to your souls. But they replied
'We'll not walk in any such kind.'
17 "I've raised up for you watchmen too,
Hear the sound of the trumpet's cue.
They say 'We'll not listen to you.'"

The circumcision of the ear was noted
In Torah too, for the people promoted.
While Jeremiah knows the knife is near,
He does not mean to cut a notch in ear.
He's speaking of the fact that some folk
hear
And others do not, when You speak out
clear.

It seems that speaking on Sinai a rate
Is not enough to set the world out straight.
It takes the hearing as well as the speech,
It takes the doing what I heard You preach.
Beloved, I join in Jeremiah's screech
And tell the denizens that would impeach
My heart to fail not when it comes to reach
Out and do what You order on my pate.

18 "So hear, you nations, come to know,
Assembly, what's found in their show.

19 "Hear, earth, and see what evil I
Shall bring upon this folk to die,
The fulfilment of their own thoughts,
Because they've not obeyed My plots,
But rejected My law for slots.

20 "What use to bring Me incense from
Sheba, from far sweet cane in gum?"

21 That's why YHWH says "See now, I lay
Such stumbling blocks before the way
Of this folk, and fathers and sons
Together shall fall to their stuns,
The neighbour and his friend I'll slay."

22 So says YHWH, "See, a people comes
From the north country and the bums
Of a great nation shall be raised
From the earth's farthest edges *crazed*.

23 "They shall lay hold on bow and spear;
They're cruel and have no mercy here;
Their voice roars like the sea, and they

Ride on their horses, in array
 As men for war against your stay,
 Daughter of Zion's fortress *in sway*."
 24 We have heard of their fame: our hands
 Turn weak, and anguish holds in bands,
 And pain as a woman in labour.
 25 Do not go to the field with sabre,
 Nor walk outside, for the foe's sword
 And fear's on every side *restored*.
 26 O daughter of my folk, put on
 Sackcloth, roll in ashes at dawn,
 Mourn as for your only son in
 Most bitter lamentation's din;
 For spoilers shall come suddenly
 Upon us *all before we see*.
 27 "I've set you for a tower and fort
 Among My people, so you'll court
 Their knowledge and try their way's
sport."

28 All of them turn aside to be
 Walking in vain apostasy,
 Slander of brass and iron. They're all
 Corrupters *of the house and stall*.
 29 The bellows have been burnt, by fire
 Has the lead been consumed, the hire
 Of the founder is spent in vain,
 Because their wicked deeds remain.
 Silver rejected, they've been called,
 YHWH's kicked them out *of field and
 stalled*.

The sacrifice and incense on the altar
 Is sweet to priest and to the one to falter
 At keeping of Your law, Beloved, on sale
 At Sinai to the humble and the hale.
 The error of the past was in the vice
 Of thinking sacrifice would make things
 nice,
 Relieve of such responsibility
 Of doing what You say and faithfully.
 That error smells so sweet that men today
 Join with their wenchens in the awful sway
 Of sacrifice and incense and the mood
 Of music to release it from the crude
 Of ancient pagan gore. What matters still
 Is that we need not listen on the hill.

Jeremiah 7

1 The word that came to Jeremiah
 From YHWH, saying *as by a crier*,
 2 "Stand in the gate of YHWH's house and
 Publish this word there by command,

'Hear the message of YHWH, all *you
 Of Judah* who come in these gates
 To prostrate before YHWH's estates."
 3 So says YHWH of hosts, Israel's God,
 "Make straight your ways *upon the sod*,
 And your actions and I will make
 You live in this place, *no mistake*.
 4 "Don't trust in lying words that say
 'The temple of YHWH *in the way*,
 The temple of YHWH, YHWH's house
here.'
 5 "For if you completely repent
 Of your ways and your actions meant,
 And if you with a whole heart stay
 To work out judgement in the way
 Between a man and neighbour's stay,
 6 "If you do not oppress the stranger,
 The fatherless, and widow *ranger*,
 And do not shed blood innocent
 In this place, or walk after tent
 Of other gods to your own hurt,
 7 "Then I will make you live alert
 In this place, in the land that I
 Gave your ancestors and for aye.
 8 "Indeed, you trust in lying words
 That profit nothing *else but turds*.
 9 "Will you steal, murder, and commit
 Adultery, swear falsely hit,
 Burn incense to Baal, and go after
 Other gods *unknown by their laughter*,
 10 "And *then* come and stand before Me
 In this house that is called to be
 By My name, and say, 'We are saved
 While doing all these sins engraved'?

An early expression of gospel true
 Is found in this passage of prophet crew:
 Shed blood of innocent within the view
 Of Zion's temple, then go out and sin
 With every lie and murder in the bin,
 Then come to church and say with piety,
 The blood shed cleanses me on Calvary.
 Beloved, let me not trust in lying words
 That are so spoken for the thrill of birds
 That bask in station of preacher and priest.
 Make of me rather one among the least,
 Who follow Your commands, and when I
 fail,

Repent and accept grace instead of tale
 That Christ has joined his blood to blood of
 Baal.

11 "Has this house called by My name now
 Turned into a thieves' den and mow
 Before your eyes? See, even I,
 I have seen it," says YHWH *in cry*.
 12 "But go now to My place in Shiloh,
 Where I set My name in first silo,
 And see what I did to it for
 My people Israel's wicked score.
 13 "And now, because you have done all
 These actions," says YHWH *to appal*,
 "And I spoke to you, getting up
 Early and speaking *like a tup*,
 But you did not hear, I called you,
 But you did not answer from pew,
 14 "Therefore I will do to the house
 Which is called by My name *for dowse*,
 In which you trust, and to this place
 Which I gave to you and *for grace*
 To your ancestors, as I did
 To Shiloh *long since when it slid*.
 15 "And I will turn you from My sight,
 As I have turned out every wight
 Of your kinfolk, posterity
 Of all Ephraim's *community*.
 16 "And so do not pray for this folk,
 Lift up cry, supplicate for bloke,
 Make intercession here to Me,
 For I'll not listen to your *plea*.

What a relief, Beloved, that I'm not set
 To pray for my foes and the Christian met
 To eat the human sacrifice in tale
 Atoning for improper use of mail!
 I thought Your fair Messiah chose to say
 That prayer for enemies was on the way,
 But that cannot be true, since here the
 prophet
 Commands me not to pray for those who
 scoff at
 Your golden law. Beloved, I meet the claw
 With lips tight shut. I only pray in maw
 Of David's words, and some of those are
 curses
 On enemies with silk and leather purses.
 What a relief, Beloved, that I need not
 Invent my own prayers outright on the
 spot!

17 "Don't you see what they do in towns
 Of Judah, in the streets *and downs*
 Of *old* Jerusalem? 18 "The kids
 Gather wood, the fathers' bids

Kindle the fire, and women knead
 The dough to make cakes for the greed
 Of the queen of heaven; and pour
 Out drink offerings to false gods score
 To move Me to My anger's door.
 19 "Do they make Me angry?" says
 YHWH.
 "Themselves they shame in their own
 view."
 20 Therefore says the Lord YHWH,
 "Indeed,
 My anger and My fury speed
 Out on this place, on man and beast,
 On the trees of the field increased,
 On the fruit of the ground. And it
 Will burn and not be quenched in fit."

The Jesus biscuit lies upon the tongue
 Of every kneeling fool both old and young,
 And tastes, no doubt, as bland is any flesh
 Prepared without the blood and spices
 fresh.
 The blood is separated in a dish
 The priest may guzzle like a flaming fish,
 Which leaves the cookies for the Queen of
 heaven
 To lie alone with or without the leaven.
 The ancient faith is documented here,
 It goes back further than it would appear
 By lessons of church fathers come to steer.
 The ancient faith in sacrifice to gods
 And goddesses, queen mothers with their
 prods
 Is still worn by the faithless on the sods.

21 So says YHWH of hosts, Israel's God,
 "Add your burnt offerings to the *pod*
 Of sacrifices and eat meat.
 22 "I did not speak to your ancestors,
 Commanding them in day's retreat
 That I brought them from the sequesters
 Of Egypt's land that they should burn
 Offerings and sacrifices earn.
 23 "But this is what I told them, saying
 'Obey My voice *and keep from straying*,
 And I will be your God and you
 Will be My people. So be true
 In all the ways that I've told you,
 And so it may be well with you.'
 24 "Yet they did not obey or lend
 An ear, but followed on the spend
 In the advice and the dictates

Of their own wicked hearts estates,
 And went back and not through the gates.
 25 "Since the day that your ancestors
 Came out of land of Egypt's doors
 Up to this very day, I've sent
 To you all My servants that went
 As prophets, I rose early and
 Send them all out upon the land.
 26 "Still they did not obey Me or
 Incline their ear, but stiffened score
 Of their neck. They did worse than what
 Their ancestors did *in the rut*.
 27 "Therefore you shall speak all these
 words
 To them, but they'll not leave their curds
 To obey you. You'll also call
 Them, but they'll not answer at all.
 28 "So you shall say to them, 'Now this
 Is a nation that does dismiss
 The voice of YHWH their Alohim
 Nor take correction *on the beam*.
 Truth has perished and it has been
 Cut off from their mouth *in between*.'

The people when they came from Egypt in
 The land of Canaan to raise up a din,
 Were not called there by You, Beloved, to
 win
 The day by offering and sacrifice bin.
 They were called out to obey You and be
 Your people and make You their God only.
 And yet they erred in bringing sacrifice,
 As though such things could turn sin sweet
 and nice.
 The African may bring honey and mice,
 The Semite of a late day camel skin,
 But You, Beloved, require the frequent
 sound
 Of doing right upon the bloody ground.
 You struck down Israel in ancient time
 For being too Christian, which was a crime.

29 "Cut off your hair and throw it out,
 And make a lamentation's shout
 On empty hilltops, for YHWH's left
 Forsaken generations deft.
 30 "For Judah's folk do wickedness
 In My sight," says YHWH. "They would
 bless
 Abominations in the house
 Called by My name, in evil dowse.
 31 "And they have built high places in

Tophet, the Vale of Hinnom's din,
 To burn their sons and daughters there
 In fire, which I gave no law's share,
 Nor did it come into My heart.
 32 "Therefore indeed, the days now start,"
 Says YHWH, "when it will no more be
 Called Tophet, or the Vale to see
 Of Son of Hinnom, but the vale
 Of slaughtering ground; for then they'll
 Bury in Tophet the last tale.
 33 "The corpses of this folk will be
 Food for the birds in the sky free
 And for the animals on earth.
 And no one will shoo *them away*.
 34 "Then I will make come to an end
 From Judah's cities and the bend
 Of the streets of Jerusalem
 The voice of gladness and of mirth,
 The voice of bridegroom and the lay
 Of the bride, for the land shall stay
 In desolation *and in dearth*."

I wonder if this is a promise that
 The influence of Zoroaster's fat
 Should come upon the city and the folk
 Of Israel beneath the Persian yoke.
 The Torah and Zabur are filled with bits
 Of Zoroastrian practice in fits,
 So why not also let the Parsee towers
 Of silence enter in upon the flowers
 Of fair Jerusalem? The vulture's fare
 In flesh is good for dealing anywhere
 With standing corpses. My Beloved, let me
 Forget the body and the spirit free,
 And join both bird and least to obey You
 While living and while breathing on the
 view.

Jeremiah 8

1 "At that time, says YHWH, "they shall
 bring
 Out the bones of Judah's each king,
 And the bones of his princes, and
 The bones of the priests and the bones
 Of the prophets, and all the bones
 Of Jerusalem's dwellers from
 Their graves, 2 "and they'll spread them in
 sum
 Before the sun and moon and stars
 Of the sky, whom they've loved for spars,
 And whom they've served and after whom

They have walked and whom they for
doom
Have sought and worshipped in the gloom;
They'll not be gathered up or buried,
But scattered dung on earth and harried.

Sin was the moon's name in the pantheon
Of gods and goddesses of Babylon,
And every star had her own place to fill
Within the temple from sky's over-spill.
And if not Babylon, Sumer's great run,
The Persian state was likely to be spun,
For there the stars shone in eternal grace,
The divine omens of the divine face.
Beloved, I look on winter's veil to see
The sky filled with sidereal canopy
And joy to see its grown immensity.
In summer quite the other way, I find
The sun and moon alone come out to bind
My hopes, delights and fears again
resigned.

3 "And death shall be chosen for life
By all the rest left in the strife
Of this wicked family and rife,
That shall stay in the places I
Will drive them," says YHWH of the sky.

The worship of the stars, the sun and moon,
The glitter-glamour weight of coming soon
In guru-sated ways, pop-stars' appeal,
All these stretch out beyond the frozen heel
To death beneath the civilized in wheel.
The worship of the stars, the faith today
Resounding in the media to play,
Turns on the carrousel in glad report,
In rocking, rolling, buying, glancing sport,
In stocks and bonds and taking things to
court.
My path contrasts in leaves etched in the
frost
Of hope and spring and all things without
cost,
The round of day and night, the Psalm
recited,
The whirling beneath skies of loves
requited.

4 And beyond that you'll say to them:
"So says YHWH: 'Shall they fall on hem
And not get up? And turn away
And not come back into the way?

5 "Why is Jerusalem's folk turned
Back in apostasy unspurned?
They keep deceit, refuse the learned."
6 I listened and I heard, but they
Did not speak in a righteous way,
No man repented evil deed,
Saying "What have I don't in speed?
Everyone turned to his own course,
As into battle rushes horse."
7 See, the stork in the sky knows when
To come and go, the turtle then
And crane and swallow know the time
Of their return, but my folk's mime
Is not to know judgement of YHWH.

The stork, the dove, the crane, and yet the
swallow
In four gates glisten where they come to
follow
The grace of hope and fervent knowledge
done
That You are Alohim and so's begun
The path to Your gracious eternity,
They live without cessation faithfully.
Four birds are signs of four gates in the air,
The earth, the water, fires and everywhere:
I whirl in the temptations of the true,
The heavens and hells of the obedient view,
And find the nest within the humble heart
Where, You, Beloved, return to take Your
part.
The stork reminds of law above the church
Now tumbled down in Iznik without perch.

8 How do you say "We are wise and
The law of YHWH is in our land?
See, He surely made it in vain,
The scribes wield pen without a gain?"
9 The wise men are ashamed to see,
They are dismayed in enmity,
See they have rejected YHWH's word,
And what wisdom from them is heard?
10 So I'll give their wives unto others,
And their fields to those who're not
brothers
To its inheritance, each one
From the least to the greatest son
Is given to covetous run,
From the prophet down to the priest,
In all of them falsehood's increased.
11 For they've touched the hurt of the
daughter

Of My people with careless *slaughter*,
Saying 'Peace, peace' when there's no
peace.

12 Were they ashamed for what they did
In their abomination's bid?

"No, they were not at all ashamed,
They could not blush when they were
blamed.

That's why they'll fall with those who fall,
In good time they shall hit the wall,"
Says YHWH *to them when He shall call*.

13 "I'll surely consume them," says
YHWH;

"No more grapes on the vine will do,
Nor figs on the fig tree, the leaf
Shall fade; what I've given in feoff
Shall pass away from them in due."

Consume me, my Beloved, consume my fig
That covers the gross body like a pig
Rooting in sore temptations of the prig,
Waiting in vain for one lucrative gig.
Consume me, my Beloved, consume my
grape,

Open my stony heart to divine rape,
Ravish the cords and burn the stubble there
Until nothing is left in me but fair.
Beloved, let fade the leaf on my last tree
And lead my soul into eternity,
Without the thought of self in that degree,
But only You, the real and tender bud
Opened and bloomed above the flood of
blood.

Then I shall eat both fig and grape and see.

14 Why do we sit still? Come together,
And let us all go into tether
In the walled towns and let us be
Silent there; for YHWH in decree,
Our Alohim has put us down
To silence and given *as to drown*
Instead of water gall to drink,
Since we've sinned against YHWH *to
slink*.

15 We looked for Islam, no good came,
For time of health, and see the shame!

16 The snorting of horses was heard
From Dan, the whole land then was stirred
At the sound of the neighing herd;
For they have come devouring land
And all that is in it to stand,
The city and those there interred.

The hope after the Prophet was abroad,
And at last heaven came down to kiss the
sod

When Umar in six thirty-four came round,
And Abdul Malik the builder was found
In six ninety-one to restore the grace
Of Your temple upon the holy place.
And yet for all the cry of peace, Islam,
The years failed in the waiting for the balm,
And evil came from those hands that
should calm

The world of its injustice at the trace.
The snorting of the horses is heard still
In recitation of Qur'an with will,
But what should have been mercy turned to
sand

Flowing unchecked out of Umayyad hand.

17 "For see, I'll send serpents to you,
And cockatrices in your pew,
Not to be charmed away with shoo,
And they will bite you," so says YHWH.
18 I'd comfort myself against grief,
My heart in me's without relief.
19 Hear the sound rise up from the cry
Of my folk's daughter for the ply
Of those that dwell in a far land,
Is YHWH not in the fortress stand,
Is its king not in it? "Why do
They provoke Me to wrath anew
With their graven images and
With foreign idols *in the land?*"

20 Harvest is past, the summer gone,
And we're not saved *despite the dawn*.

21 For grief of my folk's daughter I
Am also in grief from the sky,
My face is dark astonishment
Taken hold on me *and I'm bent*.
22 Is there no soothing ointment in
Gilead, and no physician?
Why then is not the health of my
Folk's daughter regained *in the try?*

The hills of Gilead still stand today
Remembering the promises astray,
The hopes of Israel, the promised ray,
And still the sun comes up to hear the bray.
The hills of Gilead I saw afar,
And then turned toward Jerusalem by car.
There are not enough days of my life here
To stop to enjoy the balms that appear

In Gilead after the centuries
Of hopes and garments of the narrow
breeze.

But in my northern clime I still can mind
The minutes in which I fell then behind
To quote in silence Gilead and then
Pass on my caravan road like all men.

Jeremiah 9

1 I wish my head a reservoir,
My eyes a fountain-gate ajar
Pouring out tears both day and night
For the slain of my people's right!
2 I wish I had in wilderness
An inn for pilgrims in address,
So I might leave my folk and go
Away from them, for they're not slow
Committing their adultery,
Treacherous men in assembly.

3 And they bend their tongues like their
bow

For lies, but have no valiant show
For truth upon the earth; for they
Proceed from evil in the way
To evil, and they don't know Me,
Says YHWH *Lord of eternity*.

4 Take heed every one of his neighbour,
And trust not any brother's labour;
For every brother will take over,
And every neighbour slander rover.

5 And they'll deceive each one his
neighbour,

And they will not utter the truth;
They've taught their tongue lies from their
youth,

And tire themselves in doing sin.

6 "Your house is in deceit's own bin;
Through deceit they refuse to know
Me," says YHWH *and not speaking slow*.

7 So says YHWH of hosts, "See, I'll melt
Them and try them for what they've spelt,
For how shall I do for the spawn
Of My folk *in the dusk and dawn*?

8 "Their tongue's an arrow shot, it speaks
Deceit: one speaks peace while he seeks
Against his mouth a heart that reeks.

9 "Shall I not visit them for these?"
Says YHWH; "shall not My soul at ease
Be avenged on such nation's sleaze?"

10 For sake of mountains I will take
Up weeping and wailing and make
For desert dwellings lamentation,

Because they're burned up in their station
So no one can pass through them there,
Neither can men hear cattle's share
In that place, both the birds that fly
And beasts have fled beneath the sky.
11 I'll make Jerusalem a heap,
A den of dragons and a keep
Of desolation every town
Of Judah without dweller's crown.

The birds have fled, they say, from where I
live,

And those that used to fly north transitive,
Now stay in Africa and meet the air
With subtle cries and so weather the share.
The climate change is what roughs up the
bill

According to one, while another still
Doubts that is so significant in fill.
The argument goes on, and the few that
Cross the Middle Sea are often shot at
By the Maltese, who have no other sport
Than shooting birds, according to report.
And yet, Beloved, I've heard the symphony
Of avian voices from my woods and tree
Confessing morning in their poetry.

12 Who's the wise man to understand?
To whom has YHWH's mouth uttered
band,

So he can declare what he heard,
Why the land perishes a brand
Burnt like a desert where none's stirred?

13 And YHWH says "Because they've
forsaken

My law which I set as their ration,
And have not now obeyed My voice,
Neither walking in that law of choice;
14 "But have walked after the vain
thoughts

Of their own heart, in Baalim's lots,
Which their ancestors taught in plots;"

15 Therefore says YHWH of hosts, the
God

Of Israel, "Behold the pod
I feed them, this folk, with wormwood,
And give them drink of gall *for good*.

16 "I'll scatter them among the folk,
Whom neither they nor any bloke
Of their ancestors have known, and
I'll send a sword after their band
Till I've consumed them *every strand*."

The giving of bile for drink is result
Of seeking golden ways and means'
tumult:

The golden era, the nostalgic turn
Toward the hope that I may trample urn,
The cold and flashing glitter of the deed,
The body of the idol of my greed,
All these return to bile at last when seed
Has sprouted and the evil share appears.
Where god's flesh is eaten, let arise fears.
The bile was first drunk at the foot of
Mount

Sinai itself, where golden calf in count
Was ground and mixed with drink turned
golden hue.

Beloved, let me reject the bile and crew
Of idols made of gold and golden brew.

17 Says YHWH of hosts, "Consider now,
And call for mourners to avow,
And send for cunning wives to come.

18 "And let them hurry *quarrelsome*
To wail for us so our eyes can
Run down with tears, our eyelids' span
Gush out with waters *and not rum*."

19 A wailing sound's heard from Zion,
How are we spoiled, greatly undone,
Because we have forsaken land,
Our dwelling cast us *on the sand*.

20 Yet hear YHWH's word, you wifely
crew,
And let your ear receive the due
Word of His mouth and teach your
daughters

The wailing of lamenting plotters.

21 For death has come in window spaces
And entered our palatial places
To cut off the spawn from without,
The young men from the streets *to shout*.

22 "Say," so says YHWH, "men's corpses
fall

Like dung on open field from stall,
And as the handful left behind
After the harvesters combined,
No one stops to pick it at all."

Fact is the major use of humankind,
After providing breath for leafed and vined,
Is in the fertilizing of the soil
When the body is ripe and leaves the toil.

Beloved, You speak as though it were an
ill,

A punishment to fertilize the hill.
It's rather more a glory to fulfil
A slot in web of nature and of life.
I only fear the bullet and the knife.
Perhaps the Parsee fear that body's strife
Will pollute water, soil or fire is at
The root of the view that it's horrid cat
To rot among the weeds and fill the earth
With greener fields and pastures of more
worth.

23 So says YHWH "Let not wise men take
Glory in his own wisdom's stake,
Neither let mighty man arise
To boast of his strength in his guise,
Let not the rich boast of his prize.
24 "But let him boast in this, that he
Understands and that he knows Me,
That I am YHWH and come to show
Mercy and judgement, righteous row
In the earth: for in these I know
Delight," says YHWH *in His decree*.

I glory and I revel in the while
That You are YHWH, Beloved, and in
Your smile
I live and breathe and write and still recite
The Psalms of David here both day and
night.

Some know that You are nothing but the
frost
Of blind chance working on the matter
tossed

About the universe, and some are still
Filled with the darkness of the heathen hill,
Believing that a Trinity of gods
Lends to the resurrection of the sods,
While some know positive in energy
Is the divine in every soul's degree.
But I know that You're YHWH and in my
breath

Is life in You and even joy in death.

25 "See, the days come," says YHWH,
"that I

Will punish each circumcised guy
With the uncircumcised *to vie*.

26 "Egypt and Judah, Edom too,
The children of Ammon in crew
And Moab, all around the world

And even desert dwellers curled,
For all these nations have remained
Uncircumcised *in what they've gained*,
And all the house of Israel
Have uncircumcised hearts *as well*. ”

The knowledge that the circumcision's vain
Is nothing Saint Paul invented in claim.
And even Jeremiah knew the truth
That circumcision that's done in one's
youth

Does not give right to tree of life or yet
To any blessing on the earth that's met.
It's only the heart that is tuned and set
To obey You, Beloved, in what You say
On Sinai to each one who's found the way.
The Moabite may fail from off the earth
For failure of cutting penis in girth,
But so shall all who trust in sacrifice
To atone for their sins and make them nice,
Instead of acting by commandments'
worth.

Jeremiah 10

1 Hear the message YHWH speaks to you,
O house of Israel in crew:

2 So says YHWH, “Do not learn the way
Of the heathen, know no dismay
At the signs of the sky, for those
Heathen are frightened by their rows.”

3 The customs of the folk are vain:

One cuts a tree on the terrain
Of woodland, the work of the hand
Of carpenter with axe *in brand*.

4 They decorate it with the strand
Of silver and with gold; they clip
It with nails and with hammer's whip,
So it does not move from its place.

5 They stand straight like a palm and yet
Do not speak, they must have a pet
To carry them, because they are
Not able to walk *to the bar*.

Don't be afraid of them, for they
Can do no evil *in the day*,
Neither can they do good *in pay*.

The text does not speak of the Christmas
tree,

Whose innocence is also lost on me,
But of ancient kind of idolatry
Beneath the guides of old astrology.
But whether Jeremiah knew or not

The trip of modern as ancient in plot,
They both detract from worship of the
Right,

The One Creator over all in sight.

Beloved, I turn to You with trees not few
Blocking the lakeshore from my failing
view,

And hesitate not to pray where the leaf
And branch sweep down upon me without
grief.

If sin there be or not, I see divine
Beyond the grace of tree, both fir and pine.

6 Since there is no one who's like You,
O YHWH; You are as great *as true*,
And Your name great in power to view.

7 Who would not be afraid of You,
O King of nations? For to You
Belongs all, since among all wise
Men of all nations in their guise,
And in all their kingdoms devise,
There in not anyone like You.

8 They're in one crew senseless and fools,
The doctrine of the empty pools
Is just the tree itself *for ghouls*.

It's true enough, Beloved, that there is none
Like You at all beneath the frozen sun.

I need not speak of majesty or power,
I need not note Your knowledge in its
flower,

But only rest upon one factor here:

You are not to be seen when You appear.

All kings are visible, and princes too,

And even captains of the bankly crew

Have offices and address where the post
Comes to be opened with or without boast.

But You, Beloved, invisible remain

No matter how densely You pack Your
frame,

No matter where You light or not Your
fame

Upon the inroads of sane and insane.

9 Silver slats are brought from Tarshish,
And gold from Uphaz to unleash
The work of craftsman, and the hands
Of the smelter; blue are the bands
Of their purple robes: they are all
The work of expert *men in stall*.

10 But YHWH Alohim of truth HUU
Alohim Living and King too

Of all the universe and time,
At His wrath trembles earth *in prime*,
And nations shall not stay before
His threatening *of power in store*.

11 So you shall say to them, "The gods
That have not made the heavens and *clods*
Of earth, they shall perish away
From the earth under heavens' sway.

12 He's made the earth by His power, He
Established the world by decree
Of His wisdom, and has stretched out
The heavens by His knowledge stout.

13 At the voice He raises on high
A multitude of waters fly
In the skies, and He causes mist
To rise up from the earth's ends *kissed*,
He makes the lightning with the rain,
And brings forth wind from treasures'
wain.

14 Man's knowledge is like that of beast,
Put to shame is each goldsmith's least
Graven image, for false is his
Molten image, no breath for whiz.

I fail indeed to find that human power
Of concentration and of reason's flower
Is intrinsically different from that found
Among the beastly crowd to which I'm
bound.

The hare that treats my apple trees set out
In youthful herbaceous colours in rout,
The squirrel that makes a home beneath the
eaves

Of the house golden that my dream
receives,
Both have more sense than many I have
known

To share with me the human blood and
bone.

What's unique in the human horde is just
Ability to enslave those who trust.
The crack of pawn shreds blight before the
heel.

The dung-bug is inventor of the wheel.

15 A breath of vanity are they,
The work of those once gone astray,
When examined, they fade away.

16 Jacob's portion is not like them;
For He's the fashioner of gem,
And Israel the rod of His claim,
And YHWH of hosts remains His name.

The vanity of man's work is revealed
Perhaps in microscopic of the field.
Just look at El Greco's painting revealed:
A web of grey across the ragged shield.
A vanity, a breath, a thought that's gone:
And yet the faith eternal that shone on
The moment of creation caught a light
That must forever diminish the night.
Beloved, Creator of the Universe,
Where microscopic still reveals no worse
Than megalithic planets on parade,
Your image here creating from what's
made

Is also awesome, also meets the fire
If only of a spark, in heaven's desire.

17 Gather from the land merchandise,
O dweller in the fortress vice.

18 For so says YHWH, "See now, I'll sling
The dwellers of the land and sting
Them this once till they find *the spring*."

19 Woe to me for my breaking, sore
Has been my wounding *at the core*,
But I said Only this is my
Grief, and I must bear it *or try*.

20 "My tabernacle's spoiled and all
My cords are broken *at the wall*,
My children have gone out from me,
And they are not, none to bend knee
To pitch my tent come many more,
Or to set my curtains in store."

21 The shepherds have become like beast,
They have not looked for YHWH *at least*,
Therefore they shall not prosper, and
All their flocks be scattered *in band*.

22 The sound of a report has come,
A trembling from the northland rum,
To make Judah's towns desolate,
A den of dragons *in their state*.

23 O YHWH, I know the way of man
Is not in himself or in scan;
It's not in the man as he walks
To direct his steps *around stalks*.

24 Correct me, O YHWH, but justly,
Not in Your anger by degree,
Lest Your hand crushing make me wee.

25 Pour out Your wrath on pagan folk
Who do not know You in Your stroke,
And on the families that do
Not call on Your name; in the stall
They've consumed Jacob, devoured all,

And broken up his dwelling's wall.

The pouring out of wrath on pagan folk
Is a prayer not allowed in Christian yoke,
But is accepted well in war and deed.
It just requires theology in seed
To grant the concept of just war in need.
The bramble took a lesson from the pope
And found just war, wrong-ended
telescope,

Was a death-line if not a hanging rope
To serve necessities of the state's greed.
Beloved, grant me a proper-pouring prayer,
One that calls imprecations on the air,
And curses everyone I think not fair.
Let me not be so sweet and so polite
As I brandish a flaming torch at night.

Jeremiah 11

1 The message that came to the man
Jeremiah from YHWH to scan:
2 Hear the words of this covenant,
And speak to Judah's men *in tent*,
3 And say to them, "So says YHWH God
Of Israel: 'Cursed be the sod
That does not obey the words of
This covenant *both push and shove*,
4 "Which I commanded your ancestors
In the day I brought them as questers
Our from the land of Egypt, from
The iron furnace, and in sum
Said "Obey My voice and do them
According to the stratagem
Of all I command you, so you
Shall be My people and my crew,
And I will be your Alohim.
5 "So I may establish the beam
Of the oath I swore to your dads,
To give to them a land with scads
Of milk and honey, as this day.""
I answered and said "YHWH, ok."

Beloved, You tell the prophet to curse
those
Aloud who refuse in their faithless rows
To obey the words of the covenant
That You spoke on Sinai in loving grant.
If I curse too, Beloved, in quoting You
Or quoting Your own prophet in his due,
I find that people say I'm impolite,
Imposing demands that are not my right.
Why worry? Jeremiah saw his plight

Before the task, and knew that priest and
king
Would not like to hear such a message
sting.
In my case a propos is more in me.
I'm the only one I effectively
Can curse and change to walk more
faithfully.

6 Then YHWH said to me, "Now proclaim
All these words to the towns of fame
In Judah, and in every street
Of Jerusalem, saying meet:
'Hear the words of this covenant,
And do them, *that is why I'm sent.*'
7 "For I have surely testified
Against your ancestors in pride,
The day I brought them from the land
Of Egypt, to this day to stand
Early protesting, saying 'Now
Obey My message anyhow.'
8 "But they did not obey or hear,
But walked each one by his own gear
Of evil heart; that's why I'll bring
On them all the words of this thing
That I commended them to do;
But they did not do them *in crew.*"

Hear the words of this covenant and do
Is what You say to prophet, son and crew
From Egypt into Canaan and as far
As the diaspora can take by car.
Hear the words of this covenant and live
You said to Joshua, that rogue to give
A human sacrifice to meet success.
And still the human crowd just stands to
guess.
Beloved, let me hear too indeed but more
Let me do according to Your words' store,
And I shall cross my stony paths of war
With self and nature to attain the hill,
The bridal path beneath me, and the still
Woods waiting for a peep from robin's
bill."

9 And YHWH said to me, "A plot's laid
Among the men of Judah *strayed*,
And among dwellers *on parade*
Upon Jerusalem's *streets laid*.
19 "They have turned back to evil deeds
Of their ancestors and their creeds
Who would not hear My message then;

And they went after other gods
To serve them: house of Israel's men
And house of Judah on their sods
Have broken My covenant then
Made with their ancestors *and clods*."

The failure of the masses of good men
To keep Your commandments in law again
Is not their ignorance, but fatal plot,
An evil choice decided on for naught.
The failure of the masses in good faith
Is not the result of a code or wraith,
No devil who makes innocents rebound,
But conscious choices made to stand the
ground.

Beloved, I stand no ground at all, but go
In whirling dance about the counter-show,
In every step I flee from self to Self
And lay my head upon the gallows shelf.
Let me too enter in the freedom of
Your Decalogue and so whirl on in love.

11 That's why YHWH says so, "Now
behold,
I'll bring evil upon them cold,
Which they'll not have strength to escape,
And though they beg of Me and scrape,
I will not listen to their tape."

12 The towns of Judah, dwellers in
Jerusalem have gone to bin,
And they have cantillated sin
To such gods to whom their perfume
Rose and they in their time of doom
Gave no salvation in their room.
13 As many as your towns you had
Your gods, O Judah; to the sad
Sum of streets in Jerusalem
You've set up altars for the gem
Of shameful things, altars to burn
Incense to Baal *as though to earn*.

Polytheistic systems are acute
And sensitive, distinguishing the root
Of every place, the subtle difference
Of field and hill and mountain and the
vents
Of stream and pool. This scientific way
Of finding measurement more fine today
Seems more sophisticated than the fray
Of claiming all men have one God alone,
One God and Sovereign on a single throne.

Art knows that each perfumed self in the
town
Is unique before joy as well as frown,
And one drum cannot keep the beat for all.
There must be gods and lords in throng and
thrall
To satisfy the human counting down.

14 So do not pray for this folk here,
Nor lift a cry, a prayer or tear;
For in the time I will not hear
Their cry to Me for trouble's *weir*.

15 What's for My beloved in My house,
Her doing wickedness as spouse
With many, and the holy flesh
Is passed out from your own address:
When you do evil, you rejoice.

16 YHWH called your name with His own
voice,

A green fair olive tree of choice
Fruit, with the sound of great tumult
He's kindled fire on its insult,
Its branches broken as result.

17 For YHWH of hosts who planted you
Has declared punishment on you,
For the evil of Israel's house,
And of the house of Judah's spouse,
Which they have done against themselves
To provoke me to wrath for elves
Of incense offered to the shelves
Of Baal *and every false god's house*.

Saint Paul too loves to talk about the tree
That brings the olive fruit out faithfully.
It was not his invention, he was free
To quote the prophet spuing out harshly
The curses of those for whom prayer's not
made.

I see a multitude in the parade.
Beloved, I pray for all in dervish way,
And so forgive my fevered, anxious stay.
I mediate the blessings of Your hope
To wicked killers and the blessed pope,
To charmaids and to cowboys twirling
rope.

I pray the prayers forbidden, but I turn
To You and to Your loving heart and yearn
The blessings of peace on a world to burn.

18 And YHWH has shown me what I
know,
You showed me their works out on show.

19 But I was like a lamb or ox
 Brought to the slaughter house on blocks,
 And I did not know they'd devised
 Plans against me saying surprised,
 "Let us destroy the tree and fruit,
 And cut him off from land and root
 Of living, so his name may be
 No more remembered *by decree*."
 20 But YHWH of hosts, who judge rightly,
 Examining inner parts' thoughts,
 Let me see Your vengeance in plots
 On them, for to you I've revealed
 My cause and *opened and unsealed*.
 21 That's why YHWH says of Anathoth
 And its men, who intend by troth
 To kill you, saying "Now do not
 Prophecy in YHWH's name by plot,
 So we won't have to kill your lot."
 22 That's why YHWH of hosts says
 "Behold
 I'll punish them *for being bold*:
 The young men shall die by the sword;
 Their sons and their daughters be gored
 By famine: 23 "Till there's no one left.
 For I will bring evil like theft
 Upon the men of Anathoth,
 The year of their doom's in the trough."

There is no paranoia but that's faint,
 Deficient of the real plot against saint.
 It is no wonder that the prophet thought
 There was no danger among the
 unwrought.

The great mistake of those who love Your
 law

Is to underestimate evil claw.

Beloved, I estimate instead the way
 A white dog in the woods looked out to
 play:

He feared my coming and his mistress took
 A short-cut through the brush to reach his
 nook.

The trick's to say "good boy" but keep
 quite still
 And not arouse in dogs a warning thrill.

Jeremiah 12

1 Righteous are You, O YHWH, when I
 Stretch out my plea towards Your *sky*,
 Yet let me speak with You about
 Your judgements. Why's there such a shout
 Of wickedness in prospering?

At rest are all traitors *in spring*.
 2 You've planted them, they've taken root,
 They grow up and they bring forth fruit;
 You're near their mouth, far from their
 boot.

3 But you, YHWH know me, You have
 seen

Me and tried my heart to a beam;
 Pull them out like sheep for the scene
 Of slaughter and prepare their cream.

4 How long is the land here to mourn,
 And every field's herbs wither shorn,
 Because of the evil that's borne
 In them? The beasts fail and the birds,
 Because they said in wicked words,
 He shall not see our end *in scorn*.

5 If you have run with footmen and
 They got with you too tired to stand,
 Then how can you compete with horses?
 And in the land of peaceful courses
 Where you had faith, then how will you
 Do in the swelling Jordan's view?

6 For even your brothers and house
 Of your father, they've played the grouse
 With you, and called a crowd in sway
 After you; don't believe their bray,
 Though they talk in a courteous way.

Beloved, I've run with human couriers
 And found my heart is weary of their slurs,
 And so I come to challenge You and send
 My missive prayers in verse and hope to
 wend

My way in gardens of the blessed and rest
 From wayward human troubles on my
 breast.

Then Jeremiah, in his cynic's cloak
 Comes crashing on my house of shards for
 oak.

If I am weary of the human toil
 And Grecian thought enmeshing me with
 coil,

He thinks You are a greater foe to spoil.
 Beloved, I trust not. I have found too much
 Of Paradise here in the earthly touch,
 And so I doubt the prophet's broken crutch.

7 I have forsaken my house, I
 Have left my heritage gone by;
 I've given the dear loved of my
 Soul to the power of enemy.

8 My heritage to me is like

A lion in the woods to strike;
 It cries against me, so that I
 Have hated it to high degree.
 9 My heritage to me is like
 A speckled bird the others strike;
 Come here all beasts of the field, eat
 And consume *speckled bird for treat*.
 10 Many are the shepherds who spoil
 My vineyard, they have trodden coil
 Of my lot under foot; they've changed
 My portion of Muhammad ranged
 Into deserted and estranged.
 11 They've made it desolate and so
 It mourns to me, the whole land's show
 Is desolate, because no man
 Lays it to heart *nor even can*.

12 The spoilers came on all high places
 Through the desert and desert traces;
 For YHWH's sword shall devour around
 From one end to the other ground,
 No flesh shall have Islam for peace.
 13 They have sown wheat but in release
 Shall harvest thorns; they see increase
 Of pain, but without profit's gain;
 And they'll be ashamed of your grain
 Because YHWH's fierce wrath *does not*
cease.

Good prophet Jeremiah seems to see
 The future of established Muslimry:
 The loving care to scribe the law's detail,
 The hope that with more words it cannot
 fail

To be the last and greatest word of all,
 Revealing Your will to all men in thrall.
 Truth is it may well be such in the stall,
 Though Talmud is also great to recall.
 Yet both fail through their beauty and their
 sense,
 Their human thrust to tighten all the tents.
 Despite care and precautions, every way
 Of human hope but helps to lead astray,
 Provides excuse again for violence,
 And shows when men say "Peace!" how it
 flees hence.

14 So says YHWH against all my foes,
 "The neighbours that touch lots in rows
 Which I have caused My folk Israel
 To inherit; Behold a spell,
 I shall pluck them out of their land,
 And pluck out Judah's house to stand.

15 "And it will happen after I
 Have plucked them out that I will spy
 On them and have mercy on them,
 And bring them out by stratagem,
 Every man to his heritage,
 And every man to his land's *wage*.
 16 "And it will happen, if they will
 Diligently learn My folk's bill,
 To swear by My name, as YHWH lives,
 As they taught My folk in their sieves
 To swear by Baal, then they shall be
 Built in the midst of My folk's *tree*.
 17 "And if they will not listen, then
 I'll utterly pluck up again
 And destroy that nation," says YHWH.

Does it suffice, Beloved, merely to swear
 By one name or another without care?
 Jehovah's Witnesses and Sacred Names
 Movement allow for such prophetic claims.
 But I would find more than the magic touch
 Of sound upon the wind: I am too Dutch
 For subtleties of mystics in the clutch.
 The metaphors of light and breath I take
 As little more than physical in rake,
 And names are merely arbitrary plots
 To represent realities in clots.
 And yet I'm bound I whirl beneath the light
 And sound of spirit's breath not come in
 sight,
 And cantillate Your name with all my
 might.

Jeremiah 13

1 So YHWH said to me, "Go and get
 A linen kilt and that kilt set
 Upon your loins, *don't get it wet*."
 2 So I got a kilt by the word
 Of YHWH and put it on me stirred.
 3 And YHWH's word came another time
 To me and said to me *in rhyme*,
 4 "Take the kilt that you're wearing now
 And get up and go to the brow
 Of the Euphrates, hide it there
 In a hole of the rock *and bare*."

Determined by environment and what
 My own flesh tells me I must do in rut,
 I rise like Jeremiah in old time
 To represent Your truth in act and mime.
 There's no escape for any man below
 To tell by actions free-wrought or in slow

Compliance to the will imposed and right:
 All rise to live and do at morning light.
 Beloved, I dress myself and wash to find
 Before me a day leading me as blind,
 And each thing that I do or wear or say
 Reveals Your glory in some kind of way,
 To shame or praise, but always loud and
 sere,
 To fame or haze, in a gay shroud or fear.

5 So I went and hid it again
 By the Euphrates as YHWH then
 Commanded me to do *in share*.
 6 It happened after many days
 YHWH said to me, "Rise in your ways
 To the Euphrates and take out
 The kilt that I told you about
 To hide it there *to stay a phase*."
 7 Then I went to Euphrates and
 Dug up the kilt out of the sand,
 And see the kilt was spoiled and worth
 Nothing after hidden in earth.
 8 Then YHWH's word came to me and
 said
 9 So says YHWH, "In this way outspread
 I'll spoil the pride of Judah led,
 Jerusalem's great pride *and dread*.
 10 "This wicked folk who will not hear
 My message, but walk without fear
 In the vain thoughts of their own heart,
 And follow other gods to start
 To serve them and to worship them,
 Shall be like this kilt and its hem,
 Good for nothing but to condemn.
 11 "Just as the kilt sticks to the waist
 Of a man, so I have debased
 The whole house of Israel and all
 The house of Judah in their stall,"
 Says YHWH, "so they might be to Me
 A people and a name in fee
 And for a praise and a glory,
 But they would not hear Me at all."

The round of clothing that men still put on
 Until the cloth wears out and then is gone
 Abides among the many, though I know
 Global economy may take the show
 For some who have the means to cast away
 New things for newer fashions in their day.
 The cycle of the old and new in all
 Things is a matter of the divine call.
 Each day You meet the pagan heart in trust

And cast with one breath that soul in the
 dust,
 So that she might get up and come to You
 In worship of the beautiful and true.
 Each day You give another chance in view
 To hear and understand as well as do.

12 So you shall speak to them this word;
 So says YHWH Alohim once stirred
 For Israel, "Every jar be filled
 With wine," and they will say to you,
 "Don't we know for a certain view
 That every bottle in its due
 Shall be filled with grape juice to spew?"
 13 Then you shall say to them, so YHWH
 Says, "See, I'll fill all dwellers too
 In this land, even kings that sit
 Upon the throne of David fit,
 And priests and prophets and those who
 Dwell in Jerusalem in crew
 Of drunkenness and sit in pew.
 14 "I'll dash them one against the other,
 Even the father and the brother
 Together with their children's score,"
 Says YHWH, "I shall not pity nor
 Spare nor have mercy, *only smother*."

Disdain for prophecy comes with the
 thought
 That it is just too simple in the plot.
 We know the wine comes to fill every pot.
 By the same spoken, the wine comes to fill
 With drunkenness the preachers at the still,
 The patrons in the pew, the evil lot
 Pretending to be righteous on the spot.
 Beloved, dash me and mine and come to
 spare
 Not any zeal to make me see the share
 Of poverty in profit and the glare
 Of emptiness in power before I'm caught.
 The prophecy's too simple when the train
 Is on a track consuming all the gain,
 Enjoying sparkling gleams of acid rain.

15 Hear then and listen, don't be proud,
 For YHWH has spoken *once aloud*.
 16 Glorify YHWH your Alohim,
 Before He brings darkness on beam
 And your feet stumble on the dark
 Hills and while you look for a spark,
 He turns it into shade of death,
 Makes it gross darkness *out of breath*.

17 But if you'll not hear it, my soul
Shall weep in secret places' dole
For your pride, and my eye shall weep
Sorely and run down with tears steep,
Because YHWH's flock's a captive *roll*.

The prophet weeps to see his folk remain
The captive of sophisticated gain,
Awareness in the pagan sort of vein
That all is deeper than it seems in sane.
The heathen joy of knowing is not blind:
It is a civilized way and refined.
It's true faith that seems uncouth in the
bind,
The raging against injustices lined,
Tenacious grasping to one God alone,
Without subtle distinctions for each zone.
The shade of death is peaceful at the brink,
It's glorifying YHWH that makes a stink.
Pride is all that we have, Beloved, take not
The last shred from the human sort of lot.

18 Say to the king and to the queen,
"Humble yourselves, sit on the green,
For your princes shall all fall down,
Even the glory of your crown.
19 "The southern towns will be shut up,
And no one open them to sup;
18 Judah shall be carried away
Captive, and all shall go astray.
20 "Lift up your eyes and see them come
From the north; where's the flock in sum
That was entrusted to you then,
Your beautiful flock *in the glen*?
21 "What will you say when He will come
To punish you? For you were rum
To teach them to be chiefs to rule
Over you; shall not sorrows' pool
Take you, like a wife in grief's school?"

I'm not a king or queen, and so the word
That Jeremiah speaks with his heart stirred
Leaves me cold on the summit of my herd.
I wonder if the days are many here
Beneath the frozen tundra of men's fear
When kings have read this word, come to
appear
Before Your sovereign throne to lend an
ear,
Or if not kings, at least then queens
preferred.

Beloved, speak to the king that would seek
place
Within the chambered stony walls in space
About my heart, and give my soul the room
To humble my ways now before my doom.
Let the carved throne that sits within my
lair
Be filled with One who owns and hears my
prayer.

22 And if you say in your heart, "Why
Do these things come on me to spy?"
For the greatness of wicked sin
Lies on your skirts' uncovered, in
Your heels made bare *in store and bin*.
23 Can Ethiopian change his skin,
Or leopard his own spots *to win*?
Then you also know to do good
Who are accustomed to be hood.
24 "So I'll scatter them as the straw
That passes away by the claw
Of the wind of the wilderness.
25 "This is your fate, your portion set
By measure from Me that you'll get,"
Says YHWH, "because you did forget
Me and trusted in your false dress.
26 "So I'll raise your skirts to your face
And show your shame under the trace.
27 "I have seen your adulteries,
Your neighings and the lewdities
Of your whoredom and evil trail
You leave on hills and fields." So wail,
Jerusalem! Do you not want
To be made clean and miss the taunt?

No, Your prophet is wrong on both
accounts.
Though leopard cannot change his spots'
amounts,
Each man and woman here is given choice
To follow in Your word and so rejoice,
Or disobey You in both pound and ounce.
It is not You, Beloved, who raises skirts
And shows erotic visions in fell spurts.
That too is done by choice, and not for
shame,
But for the profit in seductive game.
Your prophet does not realize the power
Of the fertility cult in his hour,
Nor that it would last to be core and
strength
Of the established faith at such a length.

All is resolved with politics in flower.

Jeremiah 14

1 YHWH's message come to Jeremiah
About the dearth *and its pariah*.

2 As Judah mourns and its gates fail;
They're black upon the ground and flail;
Jerusalem's cries rise in wail.

3 Their nobles sent their children to
Draw water, to the cisterns' view,
And they found there no water's cue.

4 Because the group is broken up,
For there was no rain in earth's cup,
The ploughmen were ashamed so they
Covered their heads *from light of day*.

5 For even the hind in the field
Has brought forth to forsake its yield
Because there was no grass *unheeled*.

6 Wild donkeys stood in the high places,
They sniffed the wind like dragon faces,
Their eyes failed without grasses' traces.

Speak not to me, Beloved, of the wild ass!
I enter ecstasy as soon as pass
Such words upon the wind above the sea!
Speak not, Beloved, speak not such words
to me!

As soon as I hear the name of that beast,
I forget what You say, whirling increased
By all the lovely fragrances I know
In meadow and on hill for my trousseau.
Beloved, if I wax eloquent to think
Of the wild ass upon the wilder brink
Of sand and sun and cloud and moon,
rejoice

That I must swoon should I once hear Your
voice.

It is enough, Beloved, to see that vision.
Keep You Yourself hidden from my
decision.

7 O YHWH, though our iniquities
Testify against us with ease,
Intervene for Your own name's sake;
Our backslidings many to take,
For we've sinned against You *awake*.

8 O Hope of Israel, Saviour in
The time of trouble, why begin
To be a stranger in the land,
A pilgrim that turns on the sand
To stay just a night *as unplanned?*

9 Why should You be like one surprised,

Like a soldier and one disguised?
Yet You, YHWH are among us, and
We are called by Your name, You stand
Not to leave us *with the unscanned*.

It was an irritation for a Jew
To tell me that Jesus was also You
Because he is the saviour and so YHWH.
The syllogism lacks in logic spent:
If You're the only Saviour to give vent,
And You are YHWH, it does not follow
that

Jesus is YHWH just because someone sat
Down to write that he was a saviour too.
Beloved, I thank You for sending the man,
I love him as a master and a plan,
If he indeed existed on the shore.
But I love You and only You the more.
Let my love be transformed each moment
here
Into obedience as well as fear.

10 So says YHWH to this people here,
So have they loved to wander near,
They've not refrained their feet at all,
So YHWH does not accept their ball;
Now He'll remember all their sin,
And doom them to the lowest bin.

11 So says YHWH to me, "Do not pray
Good for this people gone astray.

12 "When they fast, I'll not hear their
voice,

And when they offer up the choice
Burnt offering and oblation's voice,
I will not accept them, but I
Will consume them by the sword's cry,
And by the famine and plague's *eye*."

Though Jesus commands me to pray for
foe,

The prophet Jeremiah on the go
Hears Your command, Beloved, not once
to show

Petition for the chosen in a row.
Let all the airs above my lake reveal
What prayers are needed on the earth to
heal,

And all the whisperings of squirrel and rat
That sniffle in my bosky habitat
Pray what You will, Beloved, in the days'
wheel.

I'll let the prophets and the chosen folk

Come back again and once more on their
spoke
And mind my own affairs under the stroke
Of days and nights of sweet and frost for
broke.
So in the end as at first I appeal.

13 Then I said "Ah, Lord YHWH! Behold,
The prophets say to them as bold,
You shall not see the sword and you
Shall have no famine in your due,
But I will give you certain peace
In this place and *rest in release.*"

14 Then YHWH said to me, "Prophets lie
In prophesy in My name spy;
I did not send them, neither did
I commandment to speak or bid,
They prophesy to you by false
Vision and divination's waltz,
A vain thing, deceit in heart hid."

15 That's why YHWH says about the
same,
"Prophets come speaking in My name,
And I did not send them, but they
Say 'Sword and famine have no sway
In this land;' by sword and the dearth
Shall those prophets be snuffed from earth.
16 "The folk to whom they prophesy
Shall be cast out in alley sty
Out of Jerusalem because
Of famine and the sword in claws,
And they shall have no one to come
And bury them, their wives in sum
Nor their sons, nor their daughters' crew,
For wickedness on them I spew."

After translating and the contemplation
Of so many pages in careful ration
Of books claiming to be a revelation,
I near conclude that You sent nary one
Among the prophets, when the thing is
done.

My head and heart tell me that all prevail
To pretend that You blow upon their sail,
When in fact all speak from the human
heart,
Sometimes without guile, sometimes with
the start

Of heathen worship or the biased views
Of politics to help them in their mews.
Beloved, I take all prophets with a grain
Of malt and try to keep myself here sane

Before Your Decalogue upon the plain.

17 "That's why you'll give them this word
too;

Let my eyes run with tears in view
Both night and day, and so not cease,
For the virgin daughter's release
Of my folk is broken out wide
With a strong stroke *in head and side.*

18 If I go out into the field,
Then see the slaughtered and upheeled
By the sword! And if I go in
The city, then behold the din
Of those sick with the famine's bin!
Indeed both prophet and the priest
Go all around the land released
So they do not know it *increased.*

19 Have you rejected Judah all?
Does Your soul loath then Zion's wall?
Why have You struck us down in stall
So there's no healing there at all?
We looked for Islam's peace, and there
Was no good at all in the share;
And for the time of healing care,
And see only trouble's repair!

20 So we acknowledge, YHWH, that we
Are wicked, the iniquity
Of our ancestors too we know
Is sin against You and Your show.
21 Do not abhor us, for Your name,
Do not disgrace Your glory's fame,
Remember, do not break the claim
Of Your covenant with our frame.
22 Are there among the vanities
Of the Gentiles' gods in their sprees
Who can bring down the rain's degrees?
Or can the skies bring forth the showers?
Are You not He, O YHWH in powers?
That's why we shall depend on You,
For You have made all these in crew.

The folk looked for Islam as long as share
Of Muhammed was prophesied on air,
And thought that peace would come at last
to bear

Without relying on Egyptian care
Or on fair Babylon as a new state.
We hoped Islam would come before too
late.

The book and hope came too soon in the
way

It seems, since human hearts that time held
 sway
 And those You chose as divine guides were
 met
 By sword and poison from the royal set.
 You choose a time too early, yes, but think
 How it would be upon a later brink:
 There is no time when peace is truly held.
 It's only talk among the bargain spelled.

Jeremiah 15

1 Then said YHWH to me, "Now though
 Moses
 And Samuel stood before My posies,
 My mind would not turn toward this folk;
 Throw them out of My sight, each bloke.
 2 "And it shall happen, if they say
 To you, 'Where shall we go, which way?'
 Then you shall tell them," so says YHWH,
 "Such as are meant for death's own crew,
 To death; and such meant for the sword,
 To the sword; and those still not gored,
 To the famine; and who remain
 To their captivity unslain.
 3 "And I will set for them four kinds,
 Says YHWH, "the sword to slice behinds,
 The dogs to tear, and birds above,
 The beasts of the earth here to shove
 Devouring and destroying *rinds*.
 4 "And I'll cause them to be removed
 Into all kingdoms and reprov'd
 In all the earth, because the way
 Hezekiah's son Manasseh,
 King of Judah, for what he did
 There in Jerusalem *and hid*.
 5 "For who shall have pity on you,
 Jerusalem? or mourn your due?
 Or who shall go aside to ask
 How you are going in your task?
 6 "You have forsaken Me," says YHWH,
 "You have gone backward, so it's true
 I'll stretch out My hand against You,
 And destroy you; for I am tired
 Of begging you *to be inspired*.
 7 "And I will fan them with a fan
 In the gates of the land to scan;
 And I'll bereave them of their spawn,
 And I'll destroy My people drawn,
 They don't repent of evil plan.
 8 "Their widows are increased to Me
 Above the sands upon the sea;
 I've brought on them against the mother

Of the young men the spoiler's brother
 At noon, and I've made him attack
 It suddenly so there's no lack
 Of terror on the city's *back*.
 9 "The mother of seven becomes weak,
 She gives up the ghost, her sun's peak
 Is gone down while the noon yet rose;
 She's been shamed and confusion goes
 With the rest of those that I bring
 To the foes' sword and to its sting,"
 Says YHWH *without remorse in wing*.

The four gates are a smile of thinkers in
 The times before Pythagoras could win.
 The fire, the wind, the water, and the air
 All had their place in faith and acts to
 share.
 But the four gates of Your destruction here
 Met also in the symbols of good cheer
 That nature gives, are awful in their rhyme:
 They tell the end of canvassing for crime.
 Beloved, the sword is still beyond my
 grasp,
 But I prefer the dog to slithering asp,
 The vulture and the eagle to the clap
 Of other beasts that haggle in their time.
 The fingers never fail in counting well
 The fives and fours of good and evil spell.

10 Woe to me, my mother, and you
 Who bore me as a man of rue
 And one contending in the view
 Of the whole earth! I've neither lent
 On interest, nor have men been bent
 To lend me at interest, each one
 Of them come to curse me *a ton*.
 11 YHWH says "Truly it shall be well
 With your remnant; indeed I'll spell
 The enemy to beg for you
 In the time of evil and due
 Time of affliction *on your crew*.
 12 "Does anyone break iron, or yet
 The northern iron and with brass set?
 13 "Your wealth and treasures I will give
 To the spoil without price in sieve,
 And for all your sins where you live.
 14 "And I'll send you there with your foes
 Into a land none of you knows;
 For fire is kindled in My wrath,
 And it will burn you in your path.

The loved Qur'an makes sure that all men
know

That war is caused by interest of the stow.
And still the grand global economy
Is based on banking interest of the free.
That's why we've had world wars, though
not yet three,

And why there's always action in the field,
If only in the third world where the yield
Of death to white men is curtailed and
healed.

Beloved, You send the evil and the sword
On all men when the wealthy and deplored
Take interest. Is the answer to receive
Only each day the money and reprieve
Needed each day to survive without seed?
The daily bread You give lasts without
greed.

15 O YHWH, You know, remember me,
And take my case and revenge me
Of those who're persecuting me;
Do not take me away in Your
Mercy; know for Your sake in store
I've suffered reproach *and lots more*.

16 Your words were found, those I
devoured,

And Your word is to me empowered
To be a joy, and for the joy
Of my heart, the name I employ
Is Yours, YHWH, Alohim of hosts.

17 I did not sit where mocker boasts
And did not rejoice; but alone
I sat because of Your hand's throne;
For You've filled me with wrath to groan.

18 Why is my pain perpetual,
And my wound here incurable,
Refusing to be healed at all?
Will you be like a liar to me,
As waters failing cisterns free?

19 "That's why," says YHWH, "If you
return,

Then I will bring you here to earn,
And you shall stand before Me; and
If you take out the precious band
From the vile, You'll be as My mouth;
Let them come back to you from south,
But don't you go back to their band.

20 "And I will make you to this folk
A stalwart wall of brass by stroke,
And they shall fight against you and
Shall not prevail against your band;

For I am with you here to save,
And to deliver *from the grave*,"
Says YHWH *to each one not a knave*.
21 "I'll save you out of wicked hand,
And I'll redeem you from the band
Of terror *come upon the land*."

The promise made to Jeremiah may
Have been fulfilled in some divine-like
way,

But now methinks the prophethood he bore
Was heavy work and sorrow all the more.
Better not to encourage with the promise
Of Your protection, let be doubting
Thomas.

I do not trust that those who trust in You
Shall succeed on the earth, the sombre view
Of holocaust of Indian and the Jew
Suffices to make clear that You do not
Prevent the Inquisition on the spot,
But let those who keep Your law lie and rot
In prison or die squirming in the hands
Of those who torture at just war's demands.

Jeremiah 16

1 The word of YHWH to me also
Came, saying, 2 "Now you shall not go
To take a wife, nor shall you bear
Sons or daughters in this *nightmare*."

3 For so says YHWH concerning sons
And daughters who're born here by tons,
And concerning their mothers who
Gave birth to them, their fathers who
Produced them in this land: 4 "They'll die,
Die gruesome deaths, they shall not cry
For them nor shall they bury them,
But they'll be like trash on the ground.
Sword and famine shall eat their hem,
Their corpses shall be meat around
For the birds of sky, for beast
That upon the earth's *face increased*."

The horror of the corpse defiling ground
Is vividly and more so to be found
In Zoroaster's prophecy, and yet
This Jeremiah does not well forget.
The vultures are the best grave for the flesh
Of humankind is a principle fresh
From Parsee towers of silence that enmesh
The skies of Bombay with a line in line
To ancient prophets come inside to dine.

Beloved, the birds may well eat my flesh
too,
I do not know the future in my pew,
Though I can guess if time last on the earth
That my body may be accounted worth
The burying among Lord's People's crew.

5 For so says YHWH "Do not go in
The house of mourning, nor beat *shin*
In lamentation to mourn them,
For I have taken diadem
Of My peace from this folk," says YHWH,
"And lovingkindness, mercies *due*.

Breast-beating is a practice that goes back
At least to exilic prophets in pack,
And may be more ancient even than that,
Although forgotten by bishops in hat.
I beat my breast remembering the crew
Of divine guides that were done in for You,
For Hussein in remembrance of the wrath
Of caliph at Kerbala on the path
To thirst and death. Beloved, I beat my
breast
Beneath the glowing day till in the west
The time for prayer is signalled for retreat,
And then I bow prostrating at Your feet,
The shining columns of the earth and sky,
Near and remote as You were passing by.

6 "Both the great and the small shall die
In this land. And they shall apply
For burial, and none shall cry
For them, nor cut themselves, nor make
Themselves bald for their mourning's sake.

7 "Neither shall any tear their clothes
In mourning for them in their rows,
To comfort themselves for the dead;
Neither shall any give the cup
Of consolation or to sup
For father or mother instead.

8 "A banqueting house you'll not enter,
To sit there, eat and drink with venter."

9 For so says YHWH of hosts, the God
Of Israel, "See I will prod
Out of this place before your eyes,
And in your days, the voice and guise
Of mirth and gladness and the sound
Of the bridegroom and bride on ground.

Should people mourn today by tearing
clothes?

I think in ancient times the act arose,
Expression of grief and sometimes in
shows

Of horror and disgust. But what I think
About such wasteful habits at the sink
Is not much in praise for the thing at all.
I hope that when the time comes I must
fall,

No one will spoil a good, new shirt for me.
I don't approve of such wasting in spree.
But if some wish to enter in to eat
At their expense a celebration's treat,
I shall not bother in my grave, but rest
And let them sort their delights as they best
Can do and then go out to walk the street.

10 "And it shall happen, when you show
This folk all these words in a row,
They'll say to you 'Why does YHWH now
Pronounce this evil on our brow?
Or what is our iniquity?

What's our sin that we've done freely
Against YHWH Alohim's decree?"

11 "Then you shall say to them, 'Because
Your ancestors forsook My laws,'
Says YHWH, 'and followed other gods,
And have served them, though only clods,
And worshipped them forsaking Me,
And have not follow My decree,

12 "And you've done worse than your
ancestors,

For see you follow on as questers
Each of the evil of his heart,
So they may not obey My part;

13 "Therefore I'll cast you from this land
Into a land unknown at hand
By you or your ancestors' band,
And there you'll worship other gods
Both day and night without the rods
Of My favour *upon your sods*.'

In every catastrophic sort to rise,
The victims raise their hands up to the
skies,

And let the tears fall down from weeping
eyes,

And ask what did they do to deserve this?
Your prophet answers in the vein of bliss,
As though assuming that they know the
rule,

And every violent act is Your tool.

What does Your prophet say to one like me,
Who does not ask what has been done in fee
To deserve punishment, but rather takes
Your hand and heart in silence in the wakes
Of good and evil? I resent the shore
Of blame put on You, though sovereign
and more.
I do resent the implication's store.

14 "That is why, see, the time arrives,"
Says YHWH, "when they'll no more devise
Saying YHWH lives who brought the folk
Of Israel out of Egypt's stroke."

15 But rather they'll say then YHWH lives
That brought Israel's folk from the sieves
Of the northland, and from all lands
Where He had driven them in bands,
"And I will bring them up again
Into the land I gave their men.

16 "See I will summon fishermen,"
Says YHWH "and they shall fish for them,
And after that I'll send in glen
For many hunters, and they'll hunt
For them in every mountain's stunt,
And every hill and from the caves
Of the rocks, *both the free and slaves*.

The hunting out of the folk spread abroad
Upon the seas and every foreign sod
Goes on apace, and even to the end
Of western continents where time would
bend.

The Jewish sort of prayer is found among
The forest and the mountain people wrung
For Peru and the Amazon, and still
Around the world from China and the grill
Of Andalus the crowds awake and come.
The Decalogue was even made to hum
In some strange stones in the place I come
from.

Beloved, let men hunt and fish as they will.
The true day of rest and the temple stand
Within the heard divine and Your
command.

17 "For My eyes are on all their ways,
They are not hidden from My face
Their sins not veiled from My eyes' trace.
18 "I'll pay back double both their sin
And their iniquity to win,

Because they have defiled My land,
They've filled My lot with carcass band
Of their detestable things and
Abominations' *sacrifice*."
19 O YHWH, my strength, my fortress and
My refuge in affliction's stand,
The Gentiles shall come in a trice
To You for the earth's ends to say
"Surely our ancestors at bay

Inherited lies, vanity,
Things without profit *though with fee*."

20 Shall a man make gods for himself,
And they will not be gods *or elf*?

21 "That's why, see, I will make them
know

This once, I shall come out to show
My hand and power, and they shall know
My name's YHWH *above and below*."

When Jesus spoke of fishermen of men,
He merely quoted Jeremiah then.
He fished for Judah back from being caught
In captive snares of northern nations taught.
He fished for Gentiles, who would cast
away

The wicked idols they had made for pay.
The prophecy cannot be of the day
That Christianity arose to pray,
Because they did not cast aside the stroke
Of Mithra and Apollo for the yoke
Of the true God, oh no, they gave Your
name

To wicked idols and did without shame.
So priest of Rome and of Jerusalem
Join in the worship of silver and gem.

Jeremiah 17

1 Judah's sin's written with a pen
Of iron and with a diamond then,
It's graven on their heart of stone,
And on your altars' horns to hone.
As their sons mind their altars and
Their shrines by the green tree in band,
By the high hills, 3 O my mount in
The field, I'll give your wealth in bin
And all your treasures to the spoil,
And your high places there for sin,
Throughout your borderlands *in coil*.
4 And you've let go, even yourself,
Of the lot I gave you *on shelf*,
And I've made you to serve your foes,
In a land that none of you knows,

For a fire you've kindled My wrath,
Unto the age it burns *its path*.

Psychology of sin is that the mind
Views the surroundings to see if in kind
An eye is watching what the hand will do,
And if the coast is fear, the thing is true.
Such action leaves unnoticed that the sin,
Once acted on, leaves marks upon the bin
As though engraved on stone with iron pen,
And cut through and incised, polished
again

With diamond tip and blade. That is the
count,

Not whether neighbours see the whole
amount.

Beloved, see how I lay my stony heart
Before the crushing wheels of tumbling
cart,

Before the lay of Your law from the start.
You only soften stone to flesh apart.

5 So says YHWH, "Cursed the man who
trusts

In man, and has made flesh of dusts
His strength, and from YHWH turns his
heart.

6 "For he'll be like the desert part,
Not seeing good arrive, but live
In dry places of wilderness,
In salt flats that can never give
A house or home or yet address."

No doubt, Beloved, You make exception
when

I set my trust upon the best of men,
On Jesus or on fair Muhammad too,
On Ali grand, to mention but a few.
You cannot mean that trust in Christ is
vain.

The preacher made the faith to seem so
plain.

Ah me, poor me, whom am I to believe,
The preacher standing up and to receive
My offerings of both money and of care,
Or You alone, Beloved, of divine share?
The word of Jeremiah is just one
Word of a man, a young one too when
done.

If I trust in the synagogue or mosque
Or church, I trust in dust beside my kiosk.

7 Blessed is the man who trusts in YHWH,
Whose confidence has been in YHWH.

8 For he'll be like a planted tree
By the waters that spreads freely
Her roots there by the riverside,
And shall not know the heat in tide,
But her leaf shall be green and not
Be careful in the year of drought,
Neither shall cease from yielding fruit.

9 The heart's deceitful above all,
Frantically wicked *in its stall*,
And who can know it *from a doll*?

10 "I YHWH do search the heart and try
The inward parts, even to spy
Each by his actions for reply,
According to his acts' results."

11 As the partridge sits on the cults
And hatches nothing, so the one
Who obtains wealth when it's not done
By right, shall leave it e'er his time,
And at last be a fool *to climb*.

I don't know but the prophet Jeremiah
Quoted or wrote the first psalm as a flyer.

If so, no doubt he wrote first chapter set
In Genesis too, or then I forget.

The tree that's planted in the desert sand
But strikes a root to water under land
Is a fine picture of the way You send
Your nourishment to human hearts to bend
From all the dry and brittle round about
Towards the light and true, the sound and
stout.

Who can know the heart? None who does
not see

Beneath the hiding sands to rivers free,
Where You, Beloved, work close behind
the scenes

To shower the life and love with harvest
beans.

12 A throne of honour from the start
Set up on high is place and part
Of our sanctuary *in heart*.

13 O YHWH the hope of Israel,
All who forsake You do not well
In their own shame, those who depart
From me shall be writ with a dart
In the earth for forsaking YHWH,
The fount of living waters true.

14 Heal me, O YHWH, and I shall be
Healed; save me, and I faithfully

Shall be delivered: You're my glee.
 15 See how they tell me anyhow,
 Where is YHWH's word? Let it come now.
 16 I have not hurried on my way
 From feeding after You to stay,
 Nor wished to be led by a man.
 You know what has come from my lips
 Was moved before Your sight *like ships*.
 17 So do not be a fright to me,
 You are my hope on troubled sea.
 18 Let my pursuers be ashamed,
 But never let me here be blamed,
 Let them be frightened as they turn,
 But let me never fear the earned;
 Bring upon them the evil day,
 Destroy them with a double pay.

The fount of running water, it is true,
 Was an expression first said about You.
 The words have been inflated since that
 time

And wasted in the ways of prose and
 rhyme.

A Saviour You may be, indeed, but still
 There are so many saviours on the hill,
 Such as are born in stables under stars,
 Plied with the gifts of shepherds and the
 bars

Of magi, set to bear a weary cross
 And resurrect after three days to toss
 Up in the air and find there is no loss.
 Beloved, You are alone my Saviour here,
 Though You've saved from so much it
 would appear

There's nothing more to ask for in Your
 ear.

19 So says YHWH to me, "Go and stand
 In the gate of the folk in band,
 By which the kings of Judah come,
 And by which they go out to hum,
 In all gates of Jerusalem.

20 "And say to them, 'Hear now the word
 Of YHWH, you kings of Judah stirred,
 And all Judah and all who live
 Here in Jerusalem and give
 Entrance by these gates *like a bird*.'

21 "So says YHWH, 'Take heed to
 yourselves,
 And take no burdens from your shelves
 Upon the Sabbath day in hem
 By the gates of Jerusalem.

22 "Do not carry loads from your homes
 On the Sabbath, nor work your loams,
 But sanctify the Sabbath day,
 As I said of your fathers' way.
 23 "But they did not obey, and they
 Did not turn ears to what I say,
 But made their neck stiff not to do
 According to My teaching's view.
 24 "And it will happen, if you listen
 To Me,' says YHWH, 'to bring no glisten
 Of load or burden through the gates
 Of this city when Sabbath waits,
 But sanctify the Sabbath day
 To do no work in it *or pay*,
 25 "Then entering by this city's gate
 Shall come kings and princes in state
 To sit on David's throne and ride
 In chariots with horses plied,
 That and their chiefs, and Judah's men,
 The dwellers of Jerusalem;
 And this town shall always abide.
 26 "And they shall come from Judah's
 towns,

And from Jerusalem's near downs,
 And from the land of Benjamin,
 And from the plain and from the din
 Of mountains and from the south bring
 Burnt offerings and sacrificing,
 And food offerings and incense too,
 And sacrifices of praise due
 Into the very house of YHWH.

27 "But if you'll not come to obey
 Me to hallow the Sabbath day,
 And not to carry burdens then,
 Into gates of Jerusalem
 On Sabbath day, then I will light
 A fire in its gates and the site
 Within Jerusalem will burn
 And not be put out *in its turn*.'"

The prophets always tie the Sabbath day
 To justice and in keeping of the way
 Of the oppressed to give them some clear
 light

That they are not the pawns of noble right.
 But those who argue dogma would prefer
 Just to focus on which day takes the fur,
 A Saturday or Sunday in the blur.
 It is an arbitrary thing, no doubt,
 But one day in the seven leaves unstout
 The poor man's non-negotiable in rights,
 The certainty of rest on Sabbath's nights.

Beloved, You witness justice to the poor,
But few regard the rights that You made
sure.

Jeremiah 18

1 The message come to Jeremiah
From YHWH when He was speaking
higher,
2 Get up and do go to the house
Of the potter and there I'll drowse
You with My words. 3 And so I went
Down to the potter's house where bent
The potter at his potter's wheel,
Kneading the clay with hand and heel.
4 The vessel that he made of clay
Was marred in the potter's hand's way;
So he made it again to be
Another pot, and one that he
Liked better *than the broken clay.*
5 Then the word of YHWH came to me
And said 6 "O house of Israel,
Cannot I do with you as well
As this potter?" Says YHWH. "Behold
As the clay in the potter's hand,
So are you, house of Israel's band,
In My hand. 7 "The moment I speak
About a nation *strong or weak,*
Concerning a kingdom to pluck
It up, to pull down and destroy,
8 "If that land against whom I buck
Turn from the evil they employ,
I will turn from the evil *joy*
I thought to do to them *unstuck.*
9 "And at what instant I shall speak
Concerning a nation to peak,
A kingdom to build up and plant,
10 "If it does wickedly ascent
Not to obey My voice, then I
Will repent of the good that I
Said I would benefit them by.

My Hellenistic thinking runs aground
Upon this metaphor, though it be sound
As any allegory I have found.
The concept I cling to of God is that
You are omniscient, not in potter's vat,
And that You are omnipotent and fat.
So how can any cup You make turn out
A broken piece that even You would flout?
I'd think each pot that came out from Your
hand
Would be perfection to an ampersand.

The vision of You sitting at the wheel
With sloppy hands and splatters I can feel
Is beyond the grasp of the mind and heel
That abstracts from Your mercy an ideal.

11 "So now get going, tell the men
Of Judah and dwellers again
That are still in Jerusalem,
And say, 'So says YHWH in His stratagem,
"See I plan evil against you,
Devising a device of rue:
Turn back each one from sinful way,
Make your plans and acts good today."
12 "And they say "There's no hope at all,
But we will walk by our own call,
And we will every one do what
His evil heart has in his plot."
13 "That's why YHWH says "Just ask
around
Among the heathen on the ground,
If anybody's heard a sound
About such things that reach the bound
Of wickedness the virgin of
Israel has done *for hate or love.*
14 "Will anyone give up the snow
Of Lebanon for the dry show
Of stony field? Or shall the flow
Of cool waters in any place
Be forsaken *for desert's trace?*
15 "Because My folk's forgotten Me,
They've burned incense to vanity,
And idols have caused them to fail
In their ways from the ancient trail
To walk in paths of no avail,
16 "To make their land both desolate,
A constant hissing and a bet,
For everyone who passes by
To be amazed and shake his wry.
17 "I'll scatter them as with east wind
Before the enemy *unbinned;*
I'll show them the back, not the face,
The day of calamity's trace."""

The man and company that from all time
Has been sunk in the grist of sin and crime
Without a ray of truth or hope beyond
The constant swelling of the conscious
wand
Of I-ness is often in his estate
Moral to the extent he can relate.
It is the chosen seed, the mindful few,
Who have capacity in derring-do

To blaspheme beyond all the heathen crew.
They know the sacred nooks and crannies
where
To find Your glory and disparage there.
So You should not in gross astonishment
Stand up before the prophet that You sent,
Amazed that Moses' offspring have unbent.

18 Then they said "Come, let us devise
Conspiracy against the wise
Man Jeremiah, for the law
Shall not fail from the priestly claw,
Nor counsel from the wise nor word
Come from the prophet *when he's stirred*.
Come, let us strike him with the tongue,
And not listen to what he's sung."

19 Listen to me, O YHWH, and hear
The voice of those who crank their gear
Against me. 20 Is it right that bad
Falls on me for the good I've had?
For they have dug a pit for me.
Remember that I stood freely
Before You to speak good for them,
To turn away Your wrath from them.

21 So give their spawn over to die
Of hunger and pour out the cry
Of their blood from the hands that ply
The sword, and let their wives then weep
For their lost children as they reap
Their widowhood when husbands fall
Beneath the shadow of death's pall,
Let their youth be slain by the sword
In battle *where they'll all be gored*.

22 A cry rise up from their housetops,
When You shall bring a troop that stops
Suddenly on them, for they've dug
A pit to take me, in the rug
Hid snares for my feet *when I roared*.

23 And You, YHWH know all their plans
set
Against me to kill me when met;
Do not forgive iniquity,
Nor blot out their sin that You see,
But let them be cast down, so deal
With them at Your wrath's time *and heel*.

Your prophet is vindictive in the way
He remembers his foes when come to pray.
No doubt Your sweet Messiah called the
Christ
Meant such prayers when he commissioned
enticed

Disciples to pray for their enemies.
It's a relief to find out I don't need
To bless the wicked in their troubled greed
To war around the world and keep up
speed.
I'm free to relax and to shoot the breeze
Instead of agonizing on my knees.
Let pagan-taught in rhyme and supplication
Call blessings down on the oppressive
nation,
And pray for warlords in their hooks and
cranks
Controlling airborne bombers and their
tanks.

Jeremiah 19

1 So says YHWH "Go and get a flask,
A potter's earthen jar, and *ask*
Some of the elders of the folk
And elders of the priestly *cloak*."

2 "And go out to the Valley of
The Son of Hinnom, that's above
The entry of the potsherd gate,
And proclaim there the words *of hate*
That I will tell you, 3 "and say, 'Hear
The word of YHWH, O you kings near
Of Judah and inhabitants
Of Jerusalem *come to dance*."

So says YHWH of hosts, Israel's God
"Indeed, I will bring such a rod
Of destruction upon this place,
That whoever hears the disgrace,
His ears will tingle, *burn his face*.
4 "Because they have forsaken Me
And made this a stranger's country,
Because they've burned incense in it
To other gods whom neither kit,
They, their fathers, nor Judah's kings
Have known, and have filled this place'
stings

With the blood of the innocent,
5 "They've also built Baal's high places,
To burn their sons with fire *and fizz*
For burnt offerings to Baal, which I
Did not command or speak *to try*,
Nor did it come into My mind,
6 "Therefore indeed, the day's behind,"
Says YHWH, "that this place shall no more
Be called Tophet or on the *shore*
The Valley of the Son of Hinnom,
But the Valley of Slaughter *in them*.
7 "And I'll disperse all Judah's plans,

Jerusalem in this place' *fans*,
 And I'll cause them to fall by sword
 Before their enemies *and lord*
 And by the hands of those who seek
 Their lives, their corpses I'll have cheek
 To give as meat for all the birds
 Of the sky and for the beasts' turds
 Of the earth. 8 "I will make this town
 A desolation and a frown,
 A hissing, and all those who pass
 By it will be astonished *class*
 And hiss because of all its plagues.
 9 "And I will cause them to *the dregs*
 To eat the flesh of their sons and
 The flesh of their daughters *in hand*,
 And everyone shall eat the flesh
 Of his friend in the siege *and mesh*
 And in the desperation which
 Their enemies and those who pitch
 To seek their lives shall drive them to,
 In the despair *that is their due*.""
 10 "Then you shall break the flask in sight
 Of the men who go with your *right*,
 11 "And tell them 'So says YHWH of hosts
 "Even so I will break the boasts
 Of this people and this city,
 As *one* breaks a potter's clay, see,
 Which cannot be made whole again,
 And they shall bury *all the men*
 In Tophet till *there's* no more room.
 12 "So I will do this place to doom,"
 Says YHWH, "to its inhabitants,
 And make this town like Tophet's *dance*.
 13 "And the homes of Jerusalem
 And the houses of diadem
 Of the kings of Judah shall be
 Defiled like the place of filthy
 Tophet, because of the houses
 On whose roofs they have burned the *whiz*
 Of incense to all heaven's host,
 And poured out drink offerings to boast
 To other gods *and made a roast*.""

There is no sin at all, I'd say to burn
 Incense upon an altar or an urn.
 The recipe for good incense is left
 In law of Moses for deft without theft.
 What makes it sin is offering the sweet to
 The honour of the trinities in cue
 Of Baal and Ashtoreth and other fair
 Gods and goddesses on the evening air.
 Let someone stand up and tell me the fate:

Which church is more ancient in earthly
 state,
 The church rabbinical or Orthodox.
 One burns incense to Trinitarian stocks,
 One burns no sweet at all, but only talks,
 Despite the Torah recipe in blocks.

If You, Beloved, established incense smoke
 In Your Word, You deny the fatal stroke
 Of offering sons and daughters to the lord
 Is anything You thought of, but deplored.
 You hate the incense lifted up to Baal,
 Even though You allow it to prevail,
 But offering up of children and wholesale,
 Despite the faith of Herod, You eschew,
 Rejecting it no matter what the crew.
 You do not accept offering of the blood,
 The sacrifice of children in the bud,
 And yet the church in lurch sits on its perch
 To sacrifice the divine Son for smirch.
 I'd cast down such religion in the mud.

It would appear that Jeremiah is
 A secret Zoroastrian in bizz:
 He wants to give the flesh of men and kings
 To birds to eat to help them beat their
 wings.
 The birds soar over every temple where
 The faithful come to gather and in prayer
 Petition and give plaint upon the air,
 Or praise the penance of appointed share.
 Beloved, I bring the foot-toed gift to You,
 And bow prostrating with an end in view.
 Perhaps the Parsee p's will turn to cue
 Without Your help or the prophetic crew.
 Let every grave be purified in me
 Rolling in Hellenistic sophistry.

14 And Jeremiah entered in
 From Tophet, from where YHWH to win
 Had sent him up to prophesy;
 And he stood in the court nearby
 YHWH's house and spoke to all the folk.
 15 So says YHWH of hosts *not to croak*,
 The Alohim of Israel's yoke;
 See, I will bring upon this town
 And on all her suburbs' renown
 All the evil that I've proclaimed
 Against it, because they have framed
 Their necks not to hear My words *famed*.

Well Jeremiah was courageous or

A fool to go and recite all the store
 Of what You said, Beloved, before the door
 Of temple in Jerusalem in rate.
 But let me not condemn the man too late.
 I've also shouted out a thing or two
 Upon that very spot and stopped with hue
 And cry the Muslim crowd then passing
 through.
 In my case it was not to courage due
 But rather to the alternative screw.
 Beloved, if I'm allowed to go again
 Up to Jerusalem with trembling wen,
 I'll wash me and recite my prayers in peace
 Without a shout of Shi'ite law's release.

Jeremiah 20

1 Pashur son of Immer the priest,
 Also chief in the house increased
 Of YHWH, heard that Jeremiah
 Prophesied these things *in God's awe*.
 2 Then Pashur struck Jeremiah
 The prophet and put him in stocks
 That were in the high gate *in blocks*
 Of Benjamin, which was nearby
 The house of YHWH *beneath the sky*.

The start of every Inquisition here
 Is with incarceration without gear.
 Jerusalem or in Guantanamo
 Or by the lovely streets of Toledo,
 It's all the same: there is a priest who's
 chosen
 To be chief of God's house in Lederhosen.
 The names begin with Pashur in this text
 And go on randomly to the perplexed.
 Beloved, You made humankind so that it
 Would conform to any horror unfit
 Except for the few with insight and grace.
 So far so good, but then You turn Your
 face
 And leave the best to execution on
 A cross, electric chair, or shot at dawn.

3 And it happened on the next day
 That Pashur brought Jeremiah
 Out of the stocks. Then came to say
 Jeremiah to him, "YHWH does
 Not call your name Pashur the fuzz,
 But Monstrous Sight On Every Side.

I guess it's a good thing that You speak to
 The prophet and tell him what thing on cue

To say, because when You leave him alone,
 And free to utter things before the throne
 Of power, he withstands no temptation
 there,
 But proclaims insults on the holy air.
 The proof of prophethood is not that You
 Wish to give revelation more as due,
 But that You come to stop the vilest tongue
 From repetition in the ears of young.
 Sometimes the spell is broken and the
 words
 Fall honestly and cover earth with turds.
 Pashur had better have left well and good,
 When he heard what You said and
 understood.

4 "For so says YHWH, 'Behold, I'll make
 You a terror to your own stake
 And all your friends; and they shall fall
 By the sword of their foes in stall,
 And your eyes shall behold the thing;
 And I will give all Judah's wing
 Into hand of Babylon's king,
 And he shall carry them away
 Captive to Babylon in sway,
 And he shall take up sword to slay.
 5 "Besides that I'll give all the strength
 Of this city, and all the length
 Of workers in it and all things
 Of precious worth, treasures of kings
 Of Judah I'll put in the hand
 Of their foes who shall spoil the land
 And take them off to Babylon.
 6 "And you, Pashur, and all the spawn
 Living in your house shall go to
 Captivity; and you'll come to
 Babylon, and there you will die,
 And you'll be buried there and lie,
 You and all your friends to whom you
 Have prophesied such lies in pew."

The town was caught between two views to
 see
 Which king was better choice by the decree
 Of future and predict the coming share.
 Some said that Egypt was for centuries
 there
 And so over time better than to wait
 On upstarts shouting insults at the gate.
 Others predicted Babylon would take
 The day and Egypt fall down at the stake.
 Why make the matter an issue of faith,

One of obedience to You or wraith?
The prophets did not lie, but told the spell
They hoped would fortify the one and quell
The powers of the other. Jeremiah
Came in with opposite magic's pariah.

7 O YHWH, you have deceived me, and
I was deceived; for Your strong hand
Is stronger than I and prevailed,
I am mocked daily, all have sailed
To mock me. 8 For since I have spoken
And cried out, crying when awoken
Of violence and spoil, because
The word of YHWH was made a cause
Of reproach to me and a clause
Of derision in daily pause.

9 Then I said "I'll not mention Him,
Speak any more in His name *grim*,"
But His word was in my heart trim,
A burning lamp shut in my bones,
And made me tired to keep my groans,
And I could not prevent the tones.
10 For I heard the defaming of
Many, fear on every side's *shove*.
Persecute him and let us all
Persecute him inside his stall,
And my acquaintances came all
To watch for my stumbling *to fall*,
Saying "Maybe he'll be enticed,
And we shall win against him *diced*,
And we'll take vengeance on his *wall*."

11 But YHWH's with me a mighty one
And terrible, therefore the bun
Of my persecutors shall fall,
And they shall not prevail at all;
They shall be greatly ashamed too;
For they shall not prosper in due;
Eternal confusion on them
Shall not be put from mind *and hem*.
12 But, O YHWH of hosts, You who test
The righteous and see inner nest
And heart, let me see Your vengeance
On them, with You I'll take my chance.
13 Sing to YHWH, praise YHWH, for He's
saved

The soul of the poor from the laved
Hand of the wicked *and unstaved*.

I am not like Luther in his despair,
Or Beza, who sees sinfulness in share
Of every child born under earth air.
And yet clear-eyed I see the evil note

Rise in my heart, though it would all devote
In love to You. Dressed in the angel guise
Of light and power and hope beneath the
skies,
My way would save the world from its
demise.

Beloved, remove that gross will from my
breast
Each day that it awakens with the blessed,
And I will praise You for salvation guessed
Where there's no self but Self upon the
throne,
No expectation but the merest bone
Of Decalogue to treat me with my own.

14 Cursed be the day when I was born;
Nor let the day wherein was sworn
My mother to bear me be blessed.
15 Cursed be the man who brought the rest
Of tiding to my father then,
Saying "A boy is born again
To you" and make him glad *in den*.
16 And let that man be as each town
That YHWH's overthrown and cast down;
Don't let him hear the waking sound
At morn, nor shout on noon-day ground.
17 Because he did not kill me then
From the womb; or than in her glen
My mother might have been my grave,
And her womb always shield its slave.
18 Why did I come out of the womb
To see labour and sorrow's doom,
That my days should with shame consume?

The prayer of Job and Jeremiah sat
According to the legend in the cat
Who carried in her womb Lao Tze who
spent
More than his sixty years in bed she lent.
Some prove divinity by the fact that
Their mother was a virgin on the mat.
But others show divine appointment's feat
In being born with grey hair and beard
meet.

Lao Tze was a fine fellow from his birth
And Tao Te Ching reveals his utter worth
In jingles even finer than my own,
At least when sung by clever baritone.
If You had done as much for Jeremiah,
He could have slept through his days as a
crier.

Jeremiah 21

1 The word which came to Jeremiah
From YHWH, when the king Zedekiah
Sent to him Pashur the son of
Melchiah, and without his love
Zephaniah son of Maaseiah
The priest, saying as 2 “to enquire
Please from YHWH for us, it would seem
Nebuchadrezzar who was beam
Of Babylon makes war on us;
If so be that YHWH make a fuss
On our behalf by all His power,
That he may go from us an hour.”
3 The Jeremiah said to them,
Say to Zedekiah in hem:
4 “So says YHWH Israel’s Alohim:
‘See, I’ll turn back the battle stream
That is in your hands, and with which
You fight against Babylon’s stitch,
And the Chaldeans who besiege
You outside of the walls for liege,
And I’ll gather them in the ditch
Of the town, in the middle beam.
5 “And I Myself will fight you here
With an outstretched hand and the gear
Of a strong arm, in fury’s wrath,
And in great anger *for a path*.
6 “And I will strike inhabitants
Of this town, both man and beasts’ pants;
They’ll die of a great pestilence.
7 “And after that,’ says YHWH, ‘and set
Zedekiah Judah’s king met,
And his servants and all the folk
And such as are left by the stroke
In this city from plague and sword
And from the famine of unstored
Into Nebuchadrezzar’s hand,
The king of Babylon to stand,
And into the power of their foes,
And into the hand of all those
Who seek their life, and he shall strike
Them with the mouth of sword and spike,
He shall not spare them in pity,
Nor will he have on them mercy.’”

The message Jeremiah sent the king
Says that You Yourself planned to join the
fling
And fight in battle with the eastern horde
Against Jerusalem of one accord.
I’d think testosterone does not mark You
With all the failings of the manly crew,

But it would seem that Jeremiah thought
You had a soldier’s inclination’s spot.
Beloved, You once spoke on the mount to
say
Thou shalt not kill thy neighbour in the
way.

I reckon You’re excepted by estate
Of Sovereign of the universe, and wait
To kill the ones You like on dinner plate,
And then go on to fight another day.

8 And to this people you will say
“So says YHWH, ‘See, I’ll have My way
Before you, way of life and way
Of death. 9 “And so the one to stay
In this town shall die by the sword,
And by the famine and the plague,
But the one that goes out unscored
And falls to the Chaldeans vague
Who lay siege against you, he’ll live
And his life be his gift to give.
10 “For I have set My face upon
This city for evil undrawn
And not for good,’ says YHWH, ‘and it
Shall be delivered to the fit
Hand of the king of Babylon,
And he shall burn with fire the drawn.
11 “And as for the house of the king
Of Judah, hear word of YHWH sing;
12 “O house of David,’ so says YHWH;
‘Execute judgement in the dew
Of morning and deliver him
Who’s spoiled from the oppressor grim,
Lest My wrath go out like a fire,
And burn so none can quench its ire,
Because of wickedness you do.
13 “See now how I am against You,
O dweller of the valley and
The rock of the plain,’ says the grand
YHWH; ‘you who say “Who can attack
Us, who will come to meet our slack?”
14 “But I will punish you by what
Your actions serve to make unshut,’
Says YHWH, ‘and I will kindle fire
In the forest of your desire,
And it shall consume all the pyre.’”

To tell the truth, Beloved, I see the word
Of Jeremiah as a prophet stirred
And that of king and priest, though not
concurred,
As fumbings in the dark morass of faith

And vain philosophy before a wraith
To try an explanation of the fact
That might makes right no matter how men
act.

All try to find a reason and excuse
For some alliance to reduce abuse,
While armies and their success call the day,
And the stronger economy in sway.
Faith is a crutch to justify the way
Men fail of moral strength and come to pay
A guilty conscience for their theft agley.

Jeremiah 22

1 So says YHWH, "Go down to the house
Of the king of Judah *and spouse*
And speak there this message *to grouse*,
2 And say, 'Hear the message of YHWH,
O king of Judah, who sits due
Upon the throne of David, you
And your servants and your folk who
Enter in by these gates in crew.
3 "So says YHWH, "Do judgement and
right,

Deliver the spoiled from the fight
Of the oppressor, do no wrong,
Nor violence to those along
The way who're foreigners, and those
Without father or mother's shows,
The widow, neither shed the blood
Of innocent ones in the mud.
4 "For if you do this thing indeed,
Then there shall enter without need
By the gates of this house the kings
Sitting upon David's throne's wings,
Riding in chariots and on
Horses, he and his servants wan,
And all his people then outdrawn.
5 "But if you will not hear this word,
I swear by Myself," says YHWH stirred,
"That this house shall be desolate."
6 "For so says YHWH not to come late
To the king's house of Judah's mate;
"You are a Gilead to Me,
The head of Lebanon to see;
But I'll make you a desert free,
And empty cities on the spree.
7 "And I'll prepare destroyers too
Against you, every one in crew
With his arms, and they shall cut down
Your best cedars and cast the crown
Into the fire. 8 "And many folks
Shall pass by this city of strokes,

And they shall say each to the other,
'Why has YHWH done this thing to
smother?'

9 "Then they shall answer, 'Because they
Forsook the covenant and way
Of YHWH their Alohim in sway
And worshipped other gods and served
Them and from the right way have
swerved.'""

Ingenuously prophets come to say
That all crises will turn to splendid ray
If only kings and subjects will obey
Your bright commands as given on a day.
The serving widows with their rightful
share

And given orphans bed and home and stair
Will keep the boggy man of Babylon
And all his cavalry from coming on.
Beloved, the thought is dangerous for two
Reasons beneath a sky both grey or blue:
First, it may distract counsellors from what
Needs to be done to keep the town gate
shut,
And second, it may foster sacrifice
Of those we might think morally unnice.

10 Do not weep for the dead or moan,
But weep sorely for him and groan
For him who goes away, for he
Shall no more come back faithfully
To see again his own country.

11 For so says YHWH about Shallum
The son of Josiah *no bum*
But king of Judah and who reigned
Instead of Josiah, dad laid,
Who went up out of this place too:
"He shall not return here in view.

12 "But he shall die in the place where
They have taken him captive there,
And shall see this country no more.
13 "Woe to the one who builds his house
By unrighteousness and to dowse
His bedrooms by wrong-doing's course,
That uses his neighbour's perforce
Labour without paying a wage,
And gives nothing for his work's gauge;
14 "Who says 'I'll build for me a wide
House with large bedrooms on the side'
And cuts him out windows and makes
The ceiling with cedar and shakes
Painted with vermilion in stakes.

15 "Shall you reign just because you close
Yourself about in cedar rows?

Did not your father eat and drink
And do judgement and justice link,
And then it was well on his brink?

16 "He judged the cause of poor in need,
Then it was well with him indeed,
And was it not to know My lead?"

Says YHWH, and so He says indeed.

17 But your eyes and your heart are not
But for your covetousness' lot,
And for to shed blood innocent,
And for oppression and for bent
Violence to do it *unspent*.

18 That's why YHWH says about the man
Jehoiakim the son to scan
Of Josiah king of Judah;

"They shall not sorrow for his paw,
Saying 'Ah brother, sister, they
Shall not lament for him and say,
'Ah lord or ah his glory stay.'"

19 "He'll have a donkey's funeral,
Drawn out and cast beyond the wall,
Gate of Jerusalem to fall."

Beloved, give me a donkey's funeral
Outside the brave Quds' wall and stall,
And let me bloat beneath the sacred sun
That touches the dome of the rock begun
Before rise of the last millennium.
Promise me such a burial in sum
Where I can hear the golden angels hum
About the altars and the hooded veils
Of the sweet sanctuary with its sails.
Beloved, let me lie with the donkeys where
King David set his house with room to
spare,

And Solomon came out beside the ant
And spoke to it and every savoury plant.
Then I shall rest in peace and not recant.

20 "Go up to Lebanon and cry,
Lift up your voice in Bashan's sty,
And shout to them that will pass by,
For all your lovers are destroyed.

21 "I spoke to you in times employed,
But you said 'I'll not hear a word.'
This was your way from childhood up,
You disobeyed Me like a tup.

22 "The wind shall consume your
shepherds,
And your lovers turn into sherds,

Surely then you will be ashamed,
Confounded by wicked life blamed.

23 "Inhabitant of Lebanon,
Who make your nest in cedars won,
How gracious will you be when pangs
Come on you, as the pain of fangs
Of a woman when labour hangs.

Inhabitant of Lebanon is still
Not out of danger from the holy hill.
If no intruder comes to fit the bill,
The people themselves find a way to kill.
But Jeremiah has no interest in
Historic causes of the shameful din,
He only looks to see if men fulfil
Your divine law, and then proclaims their
sin.

Beloved, if sin is cause of wicked snare,
The plague, invasion, poison on the air,
Then let its distribution on the fair
Be according to every sinful share.
No one has paid enough, it seems, to bide,
So let Your mercy turn away and hide.

24 "As I live," says YHWH, "though
Coniah

The son of Jehoiakim higher,
King of Judah were signet on
My right hand, still I'd pluck you drawn
From there. 25 "And I'll give you into
The power of those who look for you
To take your life, and in the hand
Of those whose face you fear to stand,
Even the power of Babylon,
Nebuchadrezzar the king's pawn,
Into Chaldeans' hand outdrawn.

26 "And I will throw you out, and so
Also your mother who gave birth
To you, into another earth,
Where you were not born *to see show*,
And there you will die, be laid low.

27 "But to the land where they desire
To go back to, they don't find hire.

28 "This man Coniah, is he just
A broken idol in the dust?
Is he a clay pot in which there
Is no pleasure *in joy to share?*"

Coniah is a king who follows through
Upon the plan political and due
That's based on the statistics of the crew
And not upon the guesswork sent in stew

By Jeremiah, who favours the rue
 Of Babylon. My guess is that the rate
 Of words was written after fulfilled state
 To bolster the imperial decree
 To rebuild Quds and its sanctuary.
 It's justified by his idolatry,
 If such there was or not, I cannot see.
 Beloved, rewriting of Your history
 Is such a human plot in honesty
 That even prophets succumb to the spree.

29 O earth, earth, earth, hear word of
 YHWH.

30 So says YHWH, "Write to this man too
 That he'll be childless, one who'll not
 Prosper in all his days in lot,
 For no man of his spawn shall see
 Any kind of prosperity,
 Sitting on David's throne to rule
 Any more in Judah *like fool*."

The promise to David is for the space
 Of time eternal on the human race.
 But his son Jeconiah in the grace
 Of Babylon is told to hide his face.
 The promises to David are too great
 To have fulfilment in the world of late,
 And faith is sore tried to hold fast and sure
 The fearless hopes of David's strong and
 pure.

Beloved, is it a thing of grief to know
 That strong and pure in David have the
 show,

That some are strong and some are pure but
 no

Man is both strong and pure down here
 below?

I stake my fortune on the recitation
 Of words both strong and pure in their
 elation.

Jeremiah 23

1 "Woe be to shepherds who destroy
 And scatter sheep in their employ!"
 Says YHWH. 2 "That's why" says YHWH
 the God

Of Israel against the prod
 Of pastors that pasture my folk;
 "You have scattered My flock in yoke
 And driven them away and not
 Examined their ways in the plot;
 See I shall let rain down on you

Results of the evil you do,"

Says YHWH. 3 "And I will gather in
 The rest of My flock from the sin
 Of all the countries where they've been
 And where I've driven them and bring
 Them once again to their folds' spring,
 And they'll be fruitful and increase.

4 "And I will set up shepherds there
 Over them who shall feed their share,
 And they shall fear no more nor be
 Dismayed, nor any lacking see,"
 Says YHWH. 5 "See now, the days will
 come,"

Says YHWH, "that I will raise in sum
 To David branch of righteousness,
 And a king shall reign in address
 And prosper and shall execute
 Judgement and justice absolute
 Upon the earth. 6 "In his days shall
 Judah be saved and Israel
 Dwell in safety; this is his name
 By which he shall be called in fame
 YHWH is our righteousness *and well*.

7 "That's why, see, the days will come
 near,"

Says YHWH, when they shall no more fear
 To say "YHWH lives, who brought up dear
 The children of Israel with gear
 Out of the land of Egypt's dell.

8 But rather YHWH lives who brought up
 And led the spawn of Israel tup
 Out of the north country and from
 All countries I have made them bum,
 And they shall live in their own cell.

The name is Zedekiah, a name used
 By two or three, by some of them abused.
 Indeed, Beloved, You are my
 righteousness,

The gauge of my existence and address.
 The hope of Jeremiah that a king
 Of that name, if that is the very thing
 He means, should enter in an golden age
 Has not yet been fulfilled on history's page.
 Beloved, I'd think that humankind would
 tire

Of waiting for messiahs to set fire
 On fate of foul oppression and give wait
 To justice in the worldly kind of state.
 The human spirit is amazing still
 Beyond all patterns, before divine thrill.

9 My heart within me's broken for
 The state of the prophets in store;
 All my bones shake, I'm like a drunk,
 And like a man in wine who's sunk,
 Because of YHWH and for the word
 That His holiness *in me stirred*.
 10 The land's full of adultery;
 Because of swearing there freely
 The land mourns, and the pleasant lea
 Of wilderness is dried up where
 Their ways are evil and the share
 Of their strength is not right to bare.

The causal link between the awful brink
 Of growing desert and adultery,
 It is a thing I think escaping me.
 Perhaps the prophet says it with a wink.
 Perhaps I doubt because the place I live
 Is fraught around about and like a sieve
 With lakes on every side, and the rainfall
 Is sometimes great enough it would appal.
 If I lived in the barren hills around
 Jerusalem, say to the eastward bound,
 I might take more with less salt at the
 sound.

But I see all around adulterous act
 While every green thing flourishes in fact.
 My view may be Ashtoreth's, though,
 intact.

11 "Both prophet and priest are profane;
 Indeed in My house and My reign
 I find their wickedness is there,"
 Says YHWH. 12 "That's why their way
 will be

To them as slippery as a spree
 In darkness; they shall be pushed on,
 And fall, for I'll bring evil on
 Them in the year of their judgement,"
 Says YHWH *and that is what He sent*.

13 "And I have seen the folly in
 The prophets of Samarian din;
 They prophesy in Baal and cause
 My folk Israel to err in flaws.

14 "I've also seen the prophets in
 Jerusalem in horrors' bin;
 They commit their adultery,
 Walk in deceit, foster the free
 Hand of the wicked, so none will
 Turn back from his own wicked swill:
 They are all of them unto Me
 As Sodom and the dwellers in

Gomorrah *and Gomorrah's sin*.

15 "That's why" says YHWH of hosts
 about

The prophets: See, I'll feed them stout
 On wormwood and make them to drink
 The water of gall *for their stink*,
 For from Jerusalem's prophets
 Profaneness in all the land sits."

I don't know which prophet who came to
 sit

About Jerusalem fulfilled with wit
 The drinking of the wormwood in his stall.
 John in the Revelation greets the call.
 But Jesus Christ was made to drink the gall.
 I guess some cynic might at last recall
 That every text that can be on the wall
 Is spoken for in fulfilled prophesy
 Of Your Messiah in the Roman spree.
 I don't recall that any took this line
 To prove that he was prophet come to dine,
 One of those You eschew. Maybe that's
 why

The gall is left forgotten on the sly.
 Take all or none, I say, and not repine.

16 So says YHWH of hosts, "Do not hear
 The words of the prophets who steer
 Their prophecies to you: they're vain;
 They speak a vision from the stain
 Of their own heart, and not to speak
 From the mouth of YHWH *and to seek*.

17 "They still say to those who despise me,
 YHWH's said 'You'll have peace' and
 advise me

That every one who acts according
 To his own heart imagined hoarding,
 'No evil shall come to your boarding.'"
 18 For who has stay in YHWH's advice,
 Perceived and heard His word concise?
 Who's marked His word and listened
 twice?

19 See, a whirlwind of YHWH is out
 In fury, a tornado stout;
 It shall fall for grief on the head
 Of the wicked, *though safe in bed*.

20 The wrath of YHWH shall not turn back
 Until He's gathered up the slack,
 Until He's carried out the thoughts
 Of His heart, in the latter plots
 You'll think about it perfectly.

21 I have not set these prophets free,

And still they ran; I have not spoken
To them, and yet they show a token.

You have not sent a prophet in the world
Except those who take commandments
unfurled

And give all ten to everyone around
And show them how and why they are still
sound.

When Jeremiah makes that law profound
Before the eye and year of Judahite,
Then he's a prophet true and good and
right.

But if he has another thing to prove
Another message, a distracting groove,
A point to cause contention on the spot,
It's then he's turned to a satanic plot.
All men whirl back and forth in their
desire,

Sway from the good and true to meet the
fire,
But few rise in obedience' spark and
higher.

22 "But if they'd stayed in My advice,
And had caused My folk to hear nice
Words that I spoke, then they'd have turned
Them from the evil ways they learned,
And from their evil sacrifice.

23 "An Alohim nearby am I,"
Says YHWH, "not Alohim far off?"
24 "Can anyone hide in ways sly
Where I shall not see him *and scoff*?"
Says YHWH. "Do I not fill the sky
As well as earth?" says YHWH *with sigh*.
25 "I've heard what the prophets said,
those

Who prophesy lies in My rows,
Saying, 'I've had a dream, a dream.'
26 "How long shall this be in the scheme
Of prophets prophesying lies?

In their own heart the deceit flies.
27 "Intending My folk shall forget
My name by their dreams which they've set
Every man to his neighbour yet,
As their ancestors did forget
My name for Baal, *a false god met*.
28 "The prophet when he dreams a dream,
Let him tell what the dream may seem,
And the one that has My word, let
Him speak My word in truth well set.
What is chaff to the wheat to get?"

Says YHWH *as He lets down the net*.

The chaff is to the wheat as is the sound
Of hymn and prayer and market all around,
Whatever may distract me from the bound
Of Your commandments firmly on the
ground.

Beloved, I follow through the many gates,
The air, the water, fire, the earth in states,
And find illusion spread out everywhere
I whirl upon a world wrought for the fair.
And yet, above, beyond the meagre share
Of life and breath among abundant care,
I find Your name repeated in the way
All things revert to Your creation's sway,
And so I leave me dreams of scattered
chaff
Indulging soul in wheat's abundant staff.

29 "Is not My word just like a fire?"
Says YHWH; "and like a hammer dire
That breaks the rock in pieces' mire?"
30 "That's why, see I'm against the
prophets,"

Says YHWH, "that steal my words for
soffits,
Each one from his neighbour *to hire*.

31 "See, I'm against the prophets here,"
Says YHWH, "that use their tongues for
ear

And say 'He says' *and without fear*.

32 "See, I'm against those with false
dreams

Who prophesy," says YHWH, "of schemes,
And tell them, and make My folk err
By their lies and by light minds' share;
Because I did not send them out,
I did not command them to shout,
That's why they shall not profit this
People at all," says YHWH *to hiss*.

I too, Beloved, am much against the
prophets,
And so because of their distracting cough-
fits.

I hear the lovely bells, the tinkling sound
Of exquisite in rhyme come mincing round,
The helpful deaths and resurrections that
Awaken in the bread and wine in vat,
And turn away to find the living flood
Where columns of fir and birch in the bud
Lead me beside the festivals and feasts

Where twelve good fruits are laden without
priests
To turn them into flesh and blood of beasts.
I breathe and hear the cantillation rare
Of crow and moose upon the tingling air,
Of nature's law in ten for all the fair.

33 And when this folk, prophet or priest
Shall ask you saying at the least
"What is the message come from YHWH,
You'll say to them, 'What message new?'
I'll even forsake you," says YHWH.

34 As for the prophet and the priest,
And the people that say like beast,
The message of YHWH, "I will come
To punish man and house in sum."

35 So shall you say to every one,
To neighbour and to brother won,
"What has YHWH answered? and "What
more

Has YHWH replied, spoken in store?"

36 And YHWH's message mention no
more;

For every man's word shall be his
Own message, you've corrupted biz
In the words of the living God,
Of YHWH of hosts, our Alohim.

37 "And so you'll to the prophet nod,
'What has YHWH replied to you? And
What has YHWH spoken by your hand?'

The choice is simply between You and
those
Prophets and priests who claim to hoe Your
rows.

One cannot walk a middle fence that goes
Between the two, accepting these and
crows.

If I am Yours, Beloved, I don't belong
To priest and prophet who rise up for
wrong,

And they are many and lead every song.
Your own, Beloved, are not among the
crowd

Nor even in the smaller sects allowed,
But in the inner chamber where the soul
Alone meets heaven and earth above the
toll.

Beloved, I find the barren tent of stone
Surrounds in veils the palace of Your
throne,
Where I appear before Your face alone.

38 "But since you say, 'YHWH's message
came,

Therefore so says YHWH *as in blame;*'

Because you say this thing *in name:*

'The message of YHWH *is the same,*'

And I have sent to you to say,
Don't say YHWH's message *on the way.*

39 "That way, see, I, even I, do

Utterly come to forget you,

And I will forsake you all too,

And the town that I gave to you

And your ancestors and throw you

Out from before My face *as due.*

40 "And I will bring reproach on you,

An everlasting reproach too,

Which for shame in continued view

Shall never be forgotten *brew.*"

Remembrance and forgetting are concern
For those of us who whirl upon the burn.

Beloved, do not remember me as I

Do you, so many times beneath the sky

Forgetful of Your name and claim to fame.

Remember me rather as though in blame,

Full flowered and unforgettable to lie,

Revered for all the things I've yet to learn.

Bring Your reproach, I cannot steel the soul

Better than this before the fatal goal.

Bring Your reproach, but bringing it

indeed,

Keep me in Your remembrance as in seed.

Then I shall find the shame of every view

Has disappeared before Your hand and

You.

Jeremiah 24

1 YHWH showed me, see, two baskets full

Of figs set before the ample

Temple of YHWH, after the time

Nebuchadrezzar king to climb

From Babylon carried away

Captive Jeconiah from sway,

The son of Jehoiakim king

Of Judah, and the princes' *ring*

Of Judah with the carpenters

And smiths from Jerusalem's *spurs,*

And brought them to Babylon's *sting.*

2 One basket had very good figs,

Like the figs of the first ripe gigs;

The other basket very bad,

Too spoiled to eat, was all it had.

3 Then said YHWH to me, "What see you, Jeremiah?" And I took view
 To say "I see figs: the good ones
 Are very good figs *in their tons*,
 And the bad ones are very bad,
 Too spoiled to eat, both spoiled and sad."
 4 Again the word of YHWH came down
 To me saying *upon the town*,
 5 "So says YHWH Israel's Alohim:
 Like these good figs, so it would seem
 I'll know them that are borne away
 Captive from Judah, sent to stray
 Out of this place into the land
 Of the Chaldeans for good planned.
 6 "I'll set My eyes on them for good,
 And bring them back to this land's wood;
 And I will build them up again,
 And not pull down, I'll plant in glen
 And not pluck up. 7 "And I will give
 To them a heart to know *and live*
 That I am YHWH, and they shall be
 My people, and I faithfully
 Their Alohim, for they'll repent
 With their whole heart *where they are sent*.
 8 "As spoiled figs that one cannot eat,"
 Surely so says YHWH to compete,
 "So I'll give Zedekiah king
 Of Judah and his princes' ring
 And all left in Jerusalem
 And in this land and those in hem
 Of Egypt's land, 9 "I'll set them out
 To be removed in every stout
 Kingdom of the earth for their hurt,
 To be reproach and proverb curt,
 And taunt and curse in every place
 That I shall drive them *without trace*.
 10 "And I will send out the sword and
 The famine and plague on their band,
 Till they're consumed right off the land
 That I gave them and fathers' stand."

You call the king, Beloved a rotten fig,
 Which does remind me of the childish rig
 Of calling the last one a rotten egg.
 Perhaps You stand upon a better leg.
 Two questions rise here in the place to beg:
 One question is whether the king obeys
 Your law or not, or whether in a craze
 He must resort to some idolatry.
 The other question is the infamy
 Of politics, refusing to believe
 That Nebuchadnezzar gives no reprieve.

Beloved, I don't condemn Your wrath laid
 down
 Against idolatry, but if the town
 Is just political, You ought not frown.

Jeremiah 25

1 The message come to Jeremiah
 About all the folk in and nigher
 Judah in the fourth year of *king*
 Jehoiakim, son of the king
 Josiah king of Judah's ring,
 That was the first year of the reign
 Of Nebuchadrezzar the fane
 Of Babylon; 2 which Jeremiah
 The prophet spoke to all *the choir*
 Of Judah's folk, to all who live
 In Jerusalem fugitive,
 Saying 3 "Now from the thirteenth year
 Of Josiah son of the peer
 Anon king of Judah, to this
 Day, that is the twenty-third year,
 The word of YHWH has come to me,
 And I have spoken to you free,
 Getting up early with my voice,
 But you have not listened by choice."
 4 And YHWH has sent you all His slaves
 The prophets, rising with their staves
 Early and sending them, but you
 Have not listened nor turned ear due.
 5 "They said 'Repent again now too,
 Each on from his wicked way's rue,
 And from the evil of your acts,
 And live in the land that YHWH's pacts
 Have given you and your ancestors
 For ever and ever *bequesters*.
 6 "And do not follow other gods
 To serve them and worship in pods,
 And do not provoke Me to wrath
 With the works of your hands and path,
 And I'll do no hurt on your sods.'
 7 "But you would not listen to Me,"
 Says YHWH, "so you would provoke me
 To anger with the works you do
 To your own hurt *in your own pew*."

I note well, my Beloved, that prophets' role
 Is to oppose idolatry in toll.
 Their work is first and foremost to invest
 Your name with the reality and best
 That You are one alone, not more or less,
 And at their word nobody needs to guess.
 Diversity is argument of fame

That every person has his own god's claim,
And every glen and dale can claim the same.

But every leaf and snowflake is unique,
And still they show a common sort of pique:

Six-sided or all veined with what they seek.
Diversity of faces all point to
The one face that above all is the true.

8 That's why says YHWH of hosts:

"Because

You have not listened to My laws,

9 "See, I'll send and take all the clans
Of the north," says YHWH, "and the spans
Of Nebuchadrezzar the king
Of Babylon, My servant wing,
And will bring them against this land,
And against its dwellers in band,
And against those nations about,
And utterly set them to rout,
And make them an astonishment,
A hissing and desolate tent,
For ever and for ever *spent*."

The oneness of the God that You remain,
Beloved, in word and fact, is One to reign
And have servants of all men in their line,
Both Jew and Gentile, sober or in wine.
So Nebuchadnezzar's Your servant too,
As are all men and beasts that make the crew

Of earth below and those up in the sky,
The aliens and angels on the fly.

Beloved, we're all in one boat or
spacecraft,

And have one fate, whether to fore or aft,
One God of all, though of ten thousand
tongues,

One God among the ladders and the rungs
That lead around in spirals to raise up
A human leader to butt heads with tup.

10 "And I'll take from them sound of joy,
And voice of gladness to employ,
From bridegroom and the voice of bride,
The sound of millstones to abide,
The light of candle *at their side*.

11 "And this whole land shall be desert,
Astonishment, nations inert
Shall serve the king of Babylon
For seventy years *from this dawn*.

12 "It will happen when seventy years
Are finished, that I'll punish gears
Of Babylon's king and that land,"
Says YHWH, "for their wickedness' stand,
And the land of Chaldeans, and
Will make it always be desert.

13 "And I will bring upon that land
All the things I proclaim to stand
Against it, all writ in this book,
Which Jeremiah came and took
To prophesy on every land.

14 "For many nations and great kings
Shall serve themselves of them in rings,
And I will recompense each one
According to the deeds they've done,
And by the words of their own hand."

If Jeremiah had written this thing
About Babylon at the date of fling
Jehoiakim made, then I'd think the rate
Of punishment would have come on his
pate.

The theory of the liberal suggests
The writing was to stir the Persian nests
To favour the reclaiming of the land
Of Judah by a certain lobby's band.
The falsified in documents may stand
As true when they succeed to set in place
Establishments come to enjoy Your grace.
But if the prophecy of seventy years
Can be shown to have appeared without
fears

Beforehand, it's an argument to face.

15 For so says YHWH the Alohim
Of Israel to me in scheme,

"Take the wine cup of this wrath at
My hand and make all nations fat
To whom I send you drink it flat.

16 "And they shall drink and shall be
moved,

And be insane and yet reproved
By the sword I'll send on their mat."

17 Then I took the cup at YHWH's hand
And made all nations drink and stand
To whom YHWH sent me *in their band*.

The cup of wrath awakened at the hand
Of Jeremiah was still filled to stand
In John's apocalypse for a new brand.
The cup of wrath is poured for all mankind,
The pagan and the faithful ones in mind,

And all are faced with its most bitter dregs,
And all must learn to drink and find sea-
legs.

Beloved, pour out Your wrath on me and
mine,

And may the draught awaken from the vine
Complacent and in pleasure where I dine.
I'll read and hear with new eyes and with
ears

Tuned to obedience and without fears,
My nostrils waiting at the changing air
Before I dance upon the storm and glare.

18 Jerusalem, and Judah's towns,
And the kings of suburbs and downs,
And princes to, to make desert,
Astonishment, hissing and *blurt*
Of curse as it is to this day.

19 Pharaoh king of Egyptian *sway*,
And his servants and princes *gay*,
And all his people *in the way*,

20 And all the mixed folk and all kings
Of land of Uz, and all the kings
Of Philistines' country and springs
Of Ashkelon, Azzah, Ekron,
And the rest of Ashdod to pawn,

21 Edom and Moab, Ammon's spawn,

22 And all the rulers of Tyre and
All the kings of Zidon and band
Of the kings of the isles to stand
Beyond the sea: Dedan, Tema,

And Buz and the furthest in awe,

24 And all kings of Arabia,
And all the kings of the mixed folk
That lived upon the desert spoke,

25 And all the kings of Zimri and
All the kings of Elam *as scanned*,
And all the kings of Medes and more,

26 All the kings on the northern shore,
Both far and near, one with the other,
And all the kingdoms of earth *mother*,
And Sheshack's king shall drink the last.

The kings who came to drink the fashioned
cup

Of Jeremiah's divine wrath to sup
Have all gone in the way of ruin's own,
Except the one who sits upon the throne
Of happy Araby. I've never seen

The man. The one time I was clean
Upon the floor beside the Kaaba he
Was not within the palace or city.

I saw the royal folk from windows stare
Down on the crowd that set their feet now
bare

In circumambulation. What was in
Their minds as they stood there above the
din

I cannot know. But my heart swelled to
know

They paused to look benignly on the show.

27 "And you shall say to them: 'Hear this,'
Says YHWH of hosts, 'Alohim's kiss

To Israel; drink and be drunk,
And vomit and fall where you're sunk,
Because of the sword I will send
Among you *from the start to end.*'

28 "And it shall be, if they refuse
To take the cup from your hand's dues
To drink, then you shall say to them,
So says YHWH of hosts stratagem,
'You'll certainly drink *as I choose.*'

29 "For see, I start to bring the wake
Of evil on the city stake
That is still called for My name's sake,
And should you go unpunished then?
You shall not be unpunished men;
For I will summon up a sword
Upon all dwellers on earth gored,"
Says YHWH of hosts *with vengeance*
scored.

The punishment You wish to send upon
Judah is not the punishment that's drawn
To turn the people and their king and pawn
Out into hell forever and a dawn.
You save such for the Philistines now gone.
But still the punishment that You would
show

To Judah is expressed in words that glow
With vile heat and with rapine wrath
below.

Good John, when he repeats the cuply
drought,

Is not so obscene in the words he taught.
And yet the image is a burning fire,
And red reflection on the heaven and choir
Of the soul temple, leaning on Your ire.
Finish in me Your purifying lot.

30 "Now prophesy against them all
These things, and bring to their recall,
'YHWH will roar from on high, and send

His voice from His holy hill's end,
 He will roar mightily against
 His fold, He'll give a shout *incensed*,
 As those who tread *the grapes*, against
 All the inhabitants of the earth *dispensed*.
 31 A noise will come to the earth's ends,
 For YHWH takes issue and contends
 With the nations, He'll plead His case
 With all flesh. He'll give the race
 Of the wicked to sword,' says YHWH."
 32 So says YHWH of hosts: "It is true,
 Disaster shall go forth from nation
 To nation, and a conflagration
 Of wind raised from the earth's far ends.
 33 "And at that day the slain of YHWH
 Shall be from *one* end of earth to
 The *other* end of the earth, they
 Shall not be mourned, gathered, or buried,
 But be dung on the ground *uncarried*.

Neanderthalan burial is sought
 As proof that man is with early faith taught,
 And the belief in souls is the foundation
 Of every religion in early station.
 It does not follow: we can only know
 There was some reason for the burial show,
 Perhaps they loved the brother on the go,
 Perhaps they knew that corpses are not
 slow
 To cause a stink about the cave and fire.
 The fact of burial may well contrive
 To be excuse for one that's stayed alive
 To invent a religion of the hive,
 But it is not in evidence of fear:
 Faith rises up in I-ness and in ear.

34 "Wail, shepherds, cry! And roll about,
 You leaders of the flock *devout!*
 For the days of your slaughter and
 Your dispersions are quite at hand,
 You shall fall like an instrument
 Of Muhammad *by accident*.

The clay vessels that bring life-giving drink
 Were once called vessels of Muhammad.
 Think
 How deep was the desire that he should
 come
 That daily artefacts take up the drum.
 Clay vessels hold the living waters to
 The thirsty lip, and bring the thing that's
 true.

And like clay vessels can be dropped and
 broken,
 The scattered shards and useless are a token
 Of what Muhammad is and was to be:
 A burning light and warning to the free
 That bore his message straight and
 truthfully,
 But then was cast aside without remorse
 The meaning and intent of his discourse.
 If but to one, let his words live for me.

35 And the shepherds will have no way
 To flee, nor the leaders to stray
 From the flock to escape. 36 A voice
 Of the cry of the shepherds *choice*,
 A wailing of the leaders to
 The flock *will be heard*. Behold, YHWH
 Has plundered their pasture, 37 Therefore
 The peaceful dwellings furthermore
 Are cut down before YHWH's fierce
 wrath.

38 From lair like lion He takes His path,
 For their land's desolate because
 Of fierceness of oppressor's claws,
 And because of His fiercest wrath."

The Arab tents of those who rose to choose
 Another leader and the only faith to lose
 Before the prophet's body had grown cold
 Are all destroyed and may destruction bold,
 Relentless count the desert fuel and done.
 I hear the false leaders raise pious cry
 Of God is Great up to the solid sky
 And yet lap innovation in the sun.
 The lion of God take up the plundered field
 And plunder those who plunder Ali's yield.
 The leadership that falls on eager men
 Ends in the wailing of the weak and then
 In no escape from You, Beloved, who
 touch
 The pastures with a zeal unseen as such.

Jeremiah 26

1 In the beginning of the reign
 Of Jehoiakim the son of fane
 Josiah, king of Judah, this word
 Came from YHWH, saying as occurred,
 2 "So says YHWH: 'Stand in the court of
 YHWH's house, and speak to all the shove
 Of Judah's cities come to bow
 Prostrated before YHWH's house now,
 All the messages I command

You to speak to them out of hand,
Not leaving out a single planned.
3 It may be everyone will hear
And repent from his evil steer,
So I may relent from the sheer
Calamity that I propose
To bring on them because they chose
Their evil actions rows on rows.

In the beginning, famous words, that come
First in the word of revelation, sum
Of knowledge. In beginning You made all
In earth and sky to prostrate at Your call.
And so it was and so was seen to be
Good, very good, until I came to see
These words changed by the reign of some
new king
Whose jurisdiction jumps to take to wing
And cover all the earth if possible.
That's why the teeming world is always
full
Of evil ways. Choice must be made which
god
To serve, Beloved, You or the golden pod.
Let there be no beginnings but the reign
Of You, Beloved, whose unity is gain.

4 "And you'll say to them, 'So says
YHWH,
If you will not listen and do
According to My law, which I
Have set before you under eye,
5 "To obey the words of My slaves
The prophets whom I sent conclave
To you, both rising at the dawn
And sending them, with your ears drawn;
6 "Then I'll make this house like Shiloh,
And this city a curse below
All earthly nations in a row.'"

No clearer exposition of the way
Could be made in anything You could say:
Observe and keep the ten commandments
here
And that's the message the prophets made
clear.

The one's who seek another word to do
Or wallow in among the prophets crew
Miss out on what is valuable and true.
Some hope to find predictions that congrue
With what they find in history in view.

Some hope to find their pagan hopes
rebound
In vellum and in leather for a pound.
Beloved, I stand here once more with the
claim
That ten commandments represent Your
name,
And nothing more is needed in the game.

7 So the priests and the prophets and
All the people hearing the stand
Of Jeremiah when he spoke
These words in YHWH's house *for a
stroke,*
8 It happened then when Jeremiah
Had finished speak all the dire
Things YHWH had commanded to speak
To all the people, in a peek
The priests and prophets, all the folk
Took him and said "You'll die a stroke.
9 "Why have you prophesied in name
Of YHWH, saying 'This house of fame
Shall be like Shiloh, and to blame
This town shall be desolate shame
Without a dweller to its name?'"
And all the crowd came up together
Against Jeremiah in tether
In the house of YHWH *in their game.*

Distraction from the issue is the way
Both priests and people come out for their
prey.
They do not repent that they break Your
law,
Oh no, instead they focus on the claw
Contending that the word's subversive to
The well-being of temple and its crew.
They cast blame on the speaker to his rue,
Complaining he disparages the view
Of sanctuary, but refuse to note
The main thing was the ten
commandments' boat,
The boat they've sunk and so have
drowned their souls
On heathenism's resplendent atolls.

10 When princes of Judah heard these
Things, they came up from the king's ease
Into the house of YHWH and sat
Down in the entry of the mat
Of the new gate of YHWH's house frieze.
11 The priests and prophets came to speak

To the princes of all the streak
Of people, saying "This man ought
To die, because he prophesied
Against this city where we're taught,
And you heard with your ears beside."

The princes give the death sentence when
they

Are found within the clutches as the prey
Of priest and people: so the Inquisition
Was not a Latin kind of imposition,
But was invented by the princes that
Looked out upon Jerusalem and sat
Before the son of David to get fat.
Don't blame the Vatican, Beloved, if soon
Or late they follow suite like any goon.
They only take a cue from Your own king,
And so their claims may be right on the
wing.

They represent better than anyone
Your reign on earth. Jerusalem was fun
And gave the model of faith once begun.

12 Then Jeremiah spoke aloud
To all the princes and the crowd,
Saying "YHWH sent me here to sing
Against this house and everything
In this town, all the words you've heard.
13 "So now amend your ways unstirred
And what you do, and just obey
The voice of YHWH your Alohim;
And YHWH will repent in that day
Of the evil declared to stay.
14 "As for myself, see I am here
In your power, do to me with fear
What seems to and meet to your ear.
15 "But know for sure, if you kill me,
You'll bring surely innocent blood
Upon yourselves and this city,
On its inhabitants in flood,
For truly YHWH's sent me to you,
To tell you all these things are true."

The prophet Jeremiah makes attempt
To turn the notice back to the unkempt
Way folk have dealt with Your law when
they take
A course against the ten commandments'
cake.

He says if they will only do ten things
That You command, then all their temple
wings

Will rise in praise forever. But instead
He guesses they look for some blood to
shed.

That's what the people here all do today
Instead of ten commandments in the way,
They want to crucify a man and say
That cures the crisis and provides the pay.
They were sweet Christians in that hour
and time

And knew the litany down to the rhyme.

16 Then prince and folk together spoke
To priest and prophet at a stroke:
"This man is not worthy to die,
For he has spoken to us why
In name of YHWH our Alohim."

17 And certain elders of the scheme
Got up to speak to all the cream
Of the folk saying 18 "Micah the
Morasthite came with prophecy
In the days of Hezekiah
Who was the king then of Judah,
And said to all Judah's folk then,
'So says YHWH of hosts to you men,
"Zion shall be ploughed like a field,
Jerusalem be heaps for yield,
And the mount of the house just like
The heights of a forest to strike."'

19 "Did Hezekiah who was king
Of Judah then and the princeling
Of Judah put him to death then?
Did he not fear YHWH and again
Pray to YHWH and YHWH turned away
From the evil He thought to pay?
So we might get our evil way
Against our souls to act today.

20 "And there was also a man who
Prophesied in the name of YHWH,
Urijah Shemaiah's son too
Of Kirjathjearim, who proclaimed
A prophecy against this famed
Town and against this land just like
All words of Jeremiah's strike.

21 "And when Jehoiakim the king
With all his mighty men to sling,
And all the princes, heard his word,
The king tried to kill him deterred,
But Urijah heard it and feared
And fled, into Egypt appeared.

22 "Jehoiakim the king sent men
Into Egypt, Elnathan then
The son of Achbor and some men

With him into Egyptian den.
 23 "And they brought out Urijah from
 Egypt and to Jerhoiakim
 The king; who killed him with a sword,
 And threw his carcass unadored
 Into the common graves deplored."
 24 So Ahikam Shaphan's son's power
 Was with Jeremiah that hour,
 So they did not deliver him
 To the people for a death grim.

How slender and how fragile is the life
 Of those You send before the pruning knife
 Of pagan thought and worship and the
 throne!
 It all depends upon the word alone
 Of someone who will dare to stand and
 state
 The truth despite the crowd of heathen
 hate.
 It is a rare thing that such word is spoken,
 And the result is just a scattered token.
 Most times the one who does what You
 have said
 Is simply struck down to the ground and
 fed
 To pigs for later feasting before bed.
 Beloved, create more prigs that dare to take
 A stand against injustice for Your sake,
 And let them speak aloud before the bled.

Jeremiah 27

1 At the beginning of the reign
 Of Jehoiakim son of fane
 Josiah king of Judah came
 This word to Jeremiah's claim
 From YHWH, saying *a word of fame*:
 2 So says YHWH to me: ' Make a chain
 And yokes and put them on your neck,
 And send to king of Edom's beck,
 And to the king of Moab too,
 And to king of Ammonite crew,
 And to the ruler of Tyre and
 To the king of Zidon, by hand
 Of messengers which come in awe
 To Jerusalem in Judah
 Where is the king Zedekiah.
 4 Command them to say to their masters,
 So says YHWH of hosts and of blasters,
 The Alohim of Israel,
 So shall you all say to your masters;
 5 I've made the earth, the man and beast

Upon the ground, by power released
 And by My outstretched arm, and gave
 It to whom it seemed to Me brave.
 6 And now I've given all these lands
 Into Nebuchadnezzar's hands,
 The king of Babylon, My slave,
 And the beast of the field I gave
 Also to serve him in his bands.
 7 All nations shall come to serve him
 And his son and his son's son grim,
 Until the very time of his
 Land also come under My biz,
 And then many nations and great
 Kings shall benefit from his state.
 8 And it shall happen that the land
 And kingdom not to serve the hand
 Of Nebuchadnezzar the king
 Of Babylon and will not fling
 Their neck under the yoke of king
 Of Babylon, that land I'll sting,
 Says YHWH, with sword and famine too,
 And with the pestilence that's due,
 Till I've consumed them by his hand.
 9 Don't listen to your prophets or
 To your predictors on dreams' shore,
 To your enchanters, sorcerers,
 Who speak to you of what occurs,
 Saying 'You will not come to serve
 Babylon's king' *and so they swerve*.
 10 they prophesy a lie to you,
 To take you out from your land's view,
 So I should drive you out of pew
 And you should perish *like the dew*.
 11 "But the nations that bring their necks
 Under the yoke of the king's checks
 Of Babylon and serve him, I
 Will let them remain in their sty,"
 Says YHWH, 'and they shall till it
 nigh.'""

In the beginning there was only reign
 Of You, Beloved, and all the world was
 sane.
 Now King Jehoiakim is here today,
 Nebuchadnezzar too has come to stay.
 The foolish raise rebellion in an hour
 And think that You, Beloved, will save the
 flower
 Of aristocracy. The reason that
 You give no grant to changing of regime
 By overthrow of everyone that sat
 In world oppression, is quite simply team

That overthrows sits in the self-same seat.
The hearts of revolutionaries meet
With hands of the oppressor once the game
Is done, and everything is just the same.

12 I talked to Zedekiah too,
The king of Judah and in view
Of all these messages, and said
“Bring your necks under the yoke led
Of Babylon’s king and serve him
And his people and so live trim.

13 “Why should you die, you and your
folk,

By the sword and by famine’s stroke,
And pestilence, and as YHWH spoke
Against the nation that will not
Serve Babylon’s king in his plot?

14 “And so don’t listen to the words
Of the prophets that speak their sherds
To you saying ‘You shall not serve
The king of Babylon *and swerve*,’
For they prophesy lies to you.

15 “‘For I have not sent them,’ says
YHWH,

Yet they prophesy lies in view
Of My name; so I’ll drive you out,
And so you’ll disappear from scout,
You and the prophets who lift voice
To you *as though they would rejoice*. ”

It seems even You, my Beloved, submit
To heathen powers in government to sit.
In that case I am wise if I restore
To Caesar everything that’s gone before.
The Huguenot was wrong then to resist:
I can recite before the icon kissed
Your ten commandments in my heart and
mind
And no priest shall know that I’ve not been
blind.

Until the fall of Babylon the wise
Sit in the royal pew that they despise
And cantillate the hymns to Bel and Sin
And every Trinity and thing unclean.
I wait the day of Babylon’s great fall
To see the golden writing on the wall.

16 Also I spoke unto the priests
And to all these people *of feasts*,
Saying “So says YHWH, ‘do not hear
The words of your prophets and dear
Who prophesy to you and say

“Behold the vessels of YHWH’s way
Shall now shortly be brought again
From Babylon,” for they are men
To prophesy lies in your *den*.

17 “Do not listen to them, but serve
The king of Babylon with nerve
To live; why should this city be
Cast down and made a waste *to see*? ”

18 But if they’re prophets and the word
Of YHWH is with them *to be stirred*,
Let them now intercede with YHWH
Of hosts, so that the vessels’ view

Which are left in the house of YHWH
And in the house of Judah’s king
And at Jerusalem *on wing*

Need not move to Babylon’s *sting*.

19 For so says YHWH of hosts about
The pillars and the sea and rout
Of the bases and residue
Of vessels in this city too,

20 Which Nebuchadnezzar the king
Of Babylon did not unspring
When he carried captive away
Jecooniah the son in sway

Of Jehoiakim Judah’s king
From Jerusalem to the sting
Of Babylon, and the elite
Of Judah and Jerusalem;

21 Indeed, so says YHWH of hosts’ gem,
The Alohims of Israel,

About the vessels that stay well
In YHWH’s house and in house of king
Of Judah and Jerusalem,

22 “They shall be bourn to Babylon,
And there shall they be till the dawn
Of the day that I visit them,”

Says YHWH, “and then I’ll bring them up,
And restore them, *both plate and cup*. ”

The lovely pots are more important than
The heart and soul of every Jewish man.
They golden pots and silver and the brass
Were long ago returned from Bel’s house
mass.

The pots themselves created that fond fear
That brought the writing to Belshazzar’s
ear.

Not truth nor grace nor grandeur could
retain

Attention of the heathen folk and fane,
But only temple pots, the pots in store
That whistle in the desert wind the more.

Beloved, I am like others at your door:
I peer into the throne room after dawn
And see the glory spread on empty drawn,
And hear no word but silence till I've gone.

Jeremiah 28

1 It happened the same year at start
Of the reign of Zedekiah,
The king of Judah for his part
In the fourth year, the fifth month raw,
That Hananiah Azur's son,
The prophet come from Gibeon,
Spoke to me in the house of YHWH,
Before the priests and all the crew,
Saying then, 2 "So speaks YHWH of hosts
The Alohims of Israel's boasts,
Saying 'I have broken the yoke
Of Babylon's king at a stroke.
3 "Within two full years I'll bring back
To this place all the vessels' lack
Of YHWH's house Nebuchadnezzar
The king of Babylon and star
Took away from this place and bore
To Babylon *on river shore*.
4 "And I'll bring again to this place
Jeconiah the son in race
Of Jehoiakim Judah's king,
With all the captives in the ring
Of Judah that went to the wall
Of Babylon,' says YHWH to all,
'For I'll break the yoke of the king
Of Babylon *and make him sing*.'"

As in the days of Jeremiah and
Hananiah, the temple prophets stand
In their denominations to reveal
Their hopes political and wrought in steel.
One may be true among them, but to find
Such weedles in the mayracks is to bind
Both hand and heart forever in the search.
Beloved, You've left us all here in the lurch
Since the time that two prophets rose to
speak
And make the folk and king and temple
weak.
It's hard enough to submit to the sound
Of voice prophetic with just one around.
Cacophony of conflict in the word
Is still today the thing that has hearts
stirred.

5 Then prophet Jeremiah said

To Hananiah prophet bred
Before the eyes of priests and by
The eyes of all the folk come nigh
To stand there in the house of YHWH.
6 And prophet Jeremiah said
*Amen, let YHWH be by you led,
And act according to your words
That you have prophesied for curds
To bring back the vessels into
The very house of Lord and YHWH,
And all the captive people too
From Babylon into this pew.
7 "Yet you will hear what I say too,
To you and all the people's crew.
8 "The prophet before my time and
Before your time of ancient stand
Prophesied both against the lands
Of many countries and the bands
Of great kingdoms of war and plague
And pestilence and evils vague.
9 "Prophet prophesying Islam,
When the word of the prophet come
To pass, then shall the prophet be
Known, that he has come in YHWH's
decree."

The beggars of theology would make
The word of Jeremiah truth in stake:
Fulfilment of prediction is the test
To prove a prophet's speaking for the best.
But fact is Jeremiah makes no claim
Of how to tell the right from wrong in
flame:

He only vaunts the fact that Babylon
Has taken Jerusalem like a pawn,
And prophesying the contrary is
A foolish thing before the facts in biz.
Beloved, the mind of faith grasps at fine
straws,
Distracts from Your commandments and
laws,
Predictions and fulfilments of men's hopes
Turn hand and heart back to their darkened
scopes.

10 Then prophet Hananiah took
The yoke from off the neck and crook
Of prophet Jeremiah's neck,
And broke it and made it a wreck.
11 And Hananiah spoke before
All the people and said what's more,
"So says YHWH, even so I'll break

The yoke of Nebuchadnezzar
King of Babylon from the stake
Of all nations both near and far
Within the space of two full years.”
And prophet Jeremiah steers
His way departing from their wake.

See how the wicked prophet who speaks
peace,
The name of Islam for the fond release
Of violence upon both just and poor.
His victory is evident and sure.
He too can prophesy by wondered sign,
And break the yoke of wood, both oak and
pine,
And cry aloud in rhetoric as fine
As that You inspire with or without wine.
Beloved, I see Your beaten prophet go
In silence from the singing choirs that show
Your glory to the heavens, I see him lone
Down through the centuries without a bone
To chew for comfort, just an empty dish,
And rarely five loaves and a pair of fish.

12 Then the word of YHWH came back to
Jeremiah, after the view
Of prophet Hananiah breaking
The yoke from off the neck forsaking
Prophet Jeremiah, to say:
13 “Go and tell Hananiah, say
‘So says YHWH: “You have broken yoke
Of wood, but you shall make by stroke
A yoke of iron for each bloke.
14 “For in this way” says YHWH of hosts
The Alohim of Israel’s boasts:
“I’ve put an iron yoke upon
The neck of all these nations drawn,
So they may serve Nebuchadnezzar
King of Babylon *like a Caesar*,
And they shall serve him, and I gave
Him beasts of the field too *like slave*. ””

15 Then said prophet Jeremiah
Unto prophet Hananiah,
“Hear now Hananiah, for YHWH
Has not sent you, but it is you
Who make this folk trust in a lie.
16 “That’s why YHWH says now: ‘Indeed,
I
Will cast you from the face of earth.
This year you shall die in your berth,
Because you’ve taught rebellion here
Against YHWH *and against His fear*. ””

17 So Hananiah prophet died
The same year and the month decreed,
The seventh month *and left his gear*.

In the beginning prophecy was true,
And every man that took in hand to do
The prophet’s task spoke truly from the
Lord.
But as the reign of kings began, the sword
And flattery came in to reign instead
Of truth and grace and what, Beloved, You
said.
False prophecy breaks off the yoke of
wood,
The simple, few commands that told what
should
Be right behaviour, and brought in their
place
A yoke of iron, bowing to public face
And all the many customs that restore
The pecking order and put You out door.
I wait Your great salvation from the king,
The purse, the president, and those who
sing.

Does casting spells of witchcraft that
succeed
In killing others on the spot of greed
Prove that the witch is instrument to feed
Your glory and Your purpose on the wall?
From the outback of aboriginal
To Africa and the great turtle’s back
Such witches are not rare and are not slack.
If You are sovereign, so the scholars say,
Then all that happens happens in Your
sway,
And by Your sovereign will, and so today
Is bright with war and plague because You
slay.
Beloved, if you were just and true,
And merciful, no doubt You’d kill the crew
With the ark and let no soul slither through.

Jeremiah 29

1 These are the words set in the writ
That Jeremiah, prophet fit,
Sent from Jerusalem to those
Elders left among captive rows,
And to the priests and prophets, and
To all the folk there in the band
Nebuchadnezzar carried off
As captives from Jerusalem

To Babylon *for them to scoff.*

2 After that Jeconiah king
And the queen and the eunuchs' hem,
Princes of Judah and the town
Of Jerusalem, and craftsmen
And smiths who had departed then
From Jerusalem; 3 By the hand
Of Elasah, son of Shaphan,
And Gemariah son by plan
Of Hilkiah, whom Zedekiah
The king of Judah sent by crier
To Babylon and to the king
Of Babylon Nebuchadnezzar,
Saying, "So says YHWH of hosts, appeaser
Of Israel, to all those bourn
Away as captives, whom forlorn
I've cause to be carried away
From Jerusalem to the sway
Of Babylon: 5 "Build houses there,
And live in them, plant gardens fair
And eat the fruit of them *in share.*
6 "Take wives and beget sons and
daughters;

Take wives for your sons, give your
daughters

To husbands, that they may bear sons
And daughters; and be multiplied
There and not diminished *in pride.*

7 "And seek the peace of the town where
I have caused you to be bourn there
As captives, and pray to YHWH for
The peace of it, for in its peace
You shall have peace *and its increase.*

In every place and kingdom where the
crowd

Gathers pretending to praise You aloud,
The Huguenot, the Lutheran, unproud
The Orthodox all pray for king and state,
For president and for the country's fate.
It is the thing most politic at last

And bound to keep the peace with flag full-
mast,

And yet I wonder whether at the time
It was good Hananiah who gave rhyme
To faithfulness to You. When Jeremiah
Was useful his writings were treasured
higher

To make the Persians feel secure that Jews
Had always been their faithful catechues.
Beloved, keep me safe from poetic muse.

8 So says YHWH of hosts, Alohim
Of Israel, "Let not the dream
Of prophets and diviners beam
Among you for deception's fate,
Nor listen to your dreams of late
Which you've spun in your wishful
thinking.

9 "They prophesy falsely in blinking
To you in My name; I've not sent
Them," says YHWH. 10 YHWH will so
present

That "After seventy years have passed
On Babylon, I'll come at last
And perform My good word to you,
And bring you back to stall and pew.

11 "For I know the thoughts that I think
Toward you," says YHWH at the brink,
Thoughts of peace and not evil stink,
To give you an awaited end.

It was a brave thing Jeremiah did
By setting a specific day in bid.
But then the people could not bring in
proof

Fulfilment of the prophecy or goof
Because by then both folk and Jeremiah
Would all be in their graves or at least nigh
her.

All prophets are a cunning breed and fill
The oracle with things to fit the bill.
Beloved, I'm tired of prophets and of
words

Revealed by greedy hearts and stinking
turds.

Let me have just Your sermon on the
mount,

A drought of clear and cool water from
fount

Of heavenly glory and of earthly use
Instead of prophets and wicked abuse.

12 "Then you shall call on Me *a Friend,*
And you shall go and pray to Me,
And I will listen to your plea.

13 "And you shall seek and then find Me
When you search to your heart's degree.

14 And I shall be found by your soul,"
Says YHWH, "and I'll turn back the toll
Of your captivity, and I
Will gather you from all the lie
Of nations and places where I
Have driven you," says YHWH, "and I

Will bring you to this place again
From which I drove you captive men.”

Beloved, I lack at this moment some years
Of seventy in exile with my tears.
And yet with every passing day my heart
Longs less and less for the place of depart.
My grandmother’s no longer there for start.
The railroad shops are gone, the house is
set

Apart in flats that college students let,
The grocery on the corner is long gone,
The river that was such a mystery
Is now a muddy ditch as all can see.
I might as well stay on in Babylon
And hang my harp upon the willow tree,
Forget the songs of Zion in the dawn
And turn at evening from their history.

15 Because you’ve said “YHWH’s raise for
us

Up prophets in Babylon’s muss;”

16 Surely so says YHWH of the king
Who’s sitting on David’s throne’s wing,
And of the people who stayed well
In this city a time to dwell,
Who did not go out with you too
Into captivity in crew;

17 So says YHWH of hosts: “See, I’ll send
On them the sword and famine bend,
The pestilence and make them like
Spoiled figs too bad to eat a pike.

18 “I’ll persecute them with the sword,
With famine and with plagues unstored,
And set them to be removed to
All the kingdoms of earth in view,
To be a curse and to amaze,
To be a hissing and a craze
Among all the nations where I
Have driven them *under the sky*.

19 “Since they’ve not listened to My
words,”

Says YHWH, “which I sent to their birds
By My servants the prophets to
Rise up early and send, but you
Would never listen,” so says YHWH.

20 “So hear the word of YHWH, all you
Of the captivity, whom I
Have sent from Jerusalem to
Babylon.” 21 So says YHWH of hosts,
The Alohim of Israel’s boasts,
“Of Ahab son of Kolaiah,

Zedekiah son of Maaseiah,
Who prophesy a lie to you
In My name; See, I’ll send them to
The hand of Nebuchadrezzar
The king of Babylon and star,
And he’ll kill them before your eye.
22 “And of them shall be taken up
A curse by all those gone to sup
Captivity of Judah who
Are in Babylonian crew,
Saying ‘YHWH make you be like such,
Zedekiah and Ahab touch,
Whom Babylon’s king roasted well
In the blazing fire *for a spell*.’
23 “Since they’ve done wrong in Israel,
And commit there adultery
With the wives of their yeomanry,
And spoken deceit in My name,
Which I’ve not commanded in claim,
Even I know and a witness,
Says YHWH *to answer their address*.

How much deceit, Beloved, have I heard
spoken

In Your name by the preachers for a token
Of Gospel, when they say that what You
said

On Sinai was a word unseemly spread,
A thing that no man could accomplish here,
A lie told by God to keep men in fear!
There’s not a single priest or preacher
known

Who will admit the ten commandments
shown

Should all be kept as they are written down.
They all have catechisms with a frown
That tell why Sabbath is not to be kept,
And why You are not one but three
unswept,

And when to kill is the more valiant way
To foster US interests on the way.

24 “So shall you speak to Shemaiah
Also the Nehelamite’s paw,
Saying 25 ‘So utters YHWH of hosts,
Alohim of Israel to say
“Because you have sent in your name
Letters to all the folk in claim
Of Jerusalem and unto
Zephaniah the son in due
Of Maaseiah the priest, and to
All the priests saying for their rue:

26 “YHWH’s made you priest to stand in
place

Of Jehoiada the priest’s face,
So you should be chiefs in the house
Of YHWH, for every man to douse
Himself as a prophet you must
Put him in prison in the dust.’

27 “Now then why have you not reproved
Jeremiah of Anathoth,
Who makes himself a prophet moved
To you *without your being wroth*?

28 “Because he’s also sent to us
In Babylon, making a fuss
To say that it is long to wait,
So build houses and sit in gate,
And plant gardens and eat their fruit.”””

29 And Zephaniah the priest moot
Read this letter to Jeremiah,
The prophet, and let his ears nigher.

Let well enough alone is the good word
Of Jeremiah faced by bitter curd
Of life in Babylon. Don’t live in hope
Of justice and mercy beneath the pope.
Lie low, don’t rock the boat, and build a
house,
And live to help your sons to find a spouse.
Imperial in action must require
A population to provide the fire
Of income and of benefit to those
Who rule. And so a certain lowly pose
Is to one’s benefit. One need not build
A temple and have priests among the
skilled.
It is enough to read the Torah law
At home and guard the actions of one’s
paw.

30 Then came word of YHWH to the man
Jeremiah, saying in plan:

31 “Sent to all those who sit in rows
Of the captivity that shows:
‘So says YHWH about Shemaiah
The Nehelamite, “Since Shemaiah
Has prophesied to you, though I
Did not send him, you trust a lie.

32 “That’s why” says YHWH; “See, I will
send

Shemaiah the Nehelamite,
And his offspring to make an end:
He shall not have a man to dwell
Among this folk of Israel;

Neither shall he see the good I
Do for this people by and by,”
Says YHWH; “because he came to teach
Rebellion against YHWH and preach.”””

Your representative cannot refrain
From casting death-spells on the weakened
train

Of those who would rebel against the fane
Of Babylon and Rome, Geneva and
Fair Canterbury and wherever stand
The popes of Lutherdom. In that he shows
Unpleasant influence upon his toes
Of those he fails to offend and oppose.
Benign empires, whether of Bel or sweet
Mithraic trinities upon the street
Of Dublin, always have behind the smile
Two rows of sharpened teeth to match the
guile.

With innocence of mien I match the
greeting
While carefully low-profiling retreating.

Jeremiah 30

1 The message came to Jeremiah
From YHWH saying as to a crier:

2 “So speaks YHWH Israel’s Alohim,
Saying ‘Write all these words a-beam
That I have spoken to you here
In a book. 3 “See, the days are near,’
Says YHWH, ‘that I will bring again
The captivity of My men
Of Israel and Judah,’ says YHWH:
‘And I’ll make them return then to
The land that I gave as a plot
To their ancestors, what they’ve got.’”

4 And this is the message that YHWH
Spoke about Israel in pew
And concerning Judah in crew.

5 For so says YHWH; “We’ve heard a
voice

Of trembling, fear and not peace choice.

6 “Ask now and see whether a man
God into labour with the span
Of childbirth? Why does every man
I see have his hands on his paunch
As a woman in labour’s launch,
And all faces turn pale to scan?

7 “Woe! for great is that day like none,
Indeed a time of trouble done
To Jacob, still he’ll save his bun.

8 “For it shall come to pass that day,”

Says YHWH of hosts who still bears sway,
“That I’ll break his yoke from your neck
And take away your chains and wreck,
So strangers will no longer deck
Him with their obligations’ beck.
9 “But they’ll serve YHWH their Alohim,
And David their king whom on beam
I’ll raise up to fulfil their *dream*.

Unless the words of the return at end
Of seventy years were added by a friend,
The prophet stuck out neck at least to bend
If not to break, by warning of demise
Of Babylon before the Persian prise.
Perhaps the danger was not too great if
The royalty remembering the stiff
Messages calling Jew and Israelite
To the submission of Babylon’s right.
The warning could be seen in favour’s
light,
A chance to make a spell or token bright
To counteract the charm or prophecy,
A golden image to count off the fee
Of omen and of dream’s eternity.

10 “So do not fear, Jacob My slave,”
Says YHWH, “neither be in the wave
Of your dismay, O Israel;
For see I’ll save you from far off,
Your spawn from the land where they
scoff;
And Jacob shall return and be
At rest, in quiet on the lea,
And none shall frighten his degree.
11 “For I’m with you,” says YHWH, “to
save,
Though I make a full end of brave
Nations all where I’ve scattered you,
Yet I’ll not completely bestrew
You, but I shall correct your way
In measure with punishment’s sway.”
12 For so says YHWH, “Incurable
Is your bruise and your wound is full.
13 “There is no one to plead your case,
To bandage you for healing’s grace.
14 “All your friends have forgotten you,
They do not try to find your pew,
For I have wounded you by stroke
Of enemy, by cruel yoke,
For piles of your iniquity,
Your sins increased in wicked spree.
15 “Why do you cry for your affliction?

Your sorrows are uncured addiction
Because of your evil’s constriction,
Your sins expanding jurisdiction,
For this I’ve caused your dereliction.
16 “That’s why all who consume you shall
Be devoured themselves at the pall,
And all your foes and every one
Of them shall be captive and done,
And those who spoiled you shall be
spoiled,
Those who prey on you be encoiled.
17 “For I’ll restore your health to you,
And I will heal your wounds of rue,”
Says YHWH, “because they called you too
Outcast, the Zion in no one’s view.”

An outcast I have been from birth, it seems,
At least I have such memories of dreams,
But for the most part I have lived a life
Without the need of any surgeon’s knife.
Whether that is because You heal my case
Or whether I have merely lived by grace,
I do not know, and thanks would seem a
trace
Self-centred, since I know so many more
For whom the shelf has been less than a
bore
And often hell on berth, at least in store.
Beloved, an outcast is a lovely thing,
A chance to see the world as though on
wing
Above the tints of human art and showing,
Where sea is silver, and the woods are
glowing.

18 So says YHWH, “See, I’ll bring again
Jacob’s tents from the captive den,
And have mercy on his home glen,
And the town shall be built again
Upon the ruins left in pen,
And the temple shall stand again.
19 “Out from them go thanksgiving’s
sound,
The voice of dancers on the ground,
And I shall multiply their bound
And they shall not be few then found,
And I will glorify them round,
And they shall not be small in mound.
20 “Their children shall be as before,
Their congregations stand on floor
Before Me, and I’ll punish all
That oppress them *in land or stall*.

21 "Their nobles shall be of their own,
Their chief shall proceed from their throne,
And I will bring him near and he
Shall come up then approaching Me,
For who is this that set his heart
To come nearer to Me in part?"

Says YHWH. 22 "And you shall be My
folk

And I'll be your God *at a stroke.*"

23 See, the whirlwind of YHWH goes out
With fury, windy water-spout,
It shall fall with grief on the head
Of the wicked *standing outspread.*

24 The fierce wrath of YHWH'll not turn
back

Before He has performed the track
Of His hearts intents, in the days
To come you'll stop to ponder ways.

Despite the beauty of the Hebrew words,
The trinity of thoughts is full of turds.
I do not care for all the wrath I see
In my own heart and in Scriptures' degree.
I do not care for the racist in bill
That makes one folk Your own while
others will

Drop dead beneath Your wrath and
punishment.

And finally, I see no favour spent
In restoration of a temple site
To store gold in for solar gods' delight.
Beloved, I take Your love alone and wait
For all men to be Your own in their state,
And enter in the temple without hands
That You build of my inner chamber's
bands.

Jeremiah 31

1 "At the same time," says YHWH, "I'll be
The Alohims of each family
Of Israel, and they shall be
My folk." 2 So says YHWH, "The folk left
By the sword found grace though bereft
In desert places, Israel,
When I made him enter rest's spell."

3 YHWH has appeared of ancient time
To me, "Indeed I loved your rhyme
With everlasting love; therefore
I've drawn you in my loving store.

4 "Again I shall build you, and you
Shall be established, virgin crew
Of Israel; you shall again

Be adorned with your timbrels then,
And go again out on the earth
To dance with those come to make mirth.

5 "You shall plant vines upon the hills
Of Samaria *by their rills:*

The planters will plant and will eat
As common things their plantings' treat.

6 "For there shall be a day when they
Who watch upon the mountain way
Of Ephraim shall cry, 'Rise, let us
Go up to Zion credulous

To YHWH our Alohims *by bus.*"

7 For so says YHWH; "Sing with gladness
For Jacob and shout and confess
Among the chief of nations yet;
Publish and praise and say 'YHWH, set
To save Your people, Israel met.'

8 "See, I'll bring them from the north lands
And gather them from far in bands,
With them the blind and lame, the dame
With child and her labouring gain
With child together, a great band
Shall return here into the land.

9 "They'll come with weeping and with cry
Of supplications, then shall I
Lead them; I'll make them to walk by
Rivers of waters in straight ways
Where they shall not stumble in craze,
For I'm a counsellor and dad
To Israel, Ephraim no cad
Is My firstborn *upon My pad.*"

I rejoice in the love that You express
To Israel, the chosen folk to bless,
Who hold the oracles divine and sure,
The promises of Sinai as a lure.
I rejoice that such love someday may be
Expanded beyond border and degree,
And that You, My Beloved, might love as
much

All nations and all people from the Dutch
To Hottentot. The seed of truth is there,
And even God may learn and have a share
In development without heathen scare.
If You had seen the visions I have seen,
The earth like a sapphire upon the sheen
Of loveliness, You would know what I
mean.

10 Hear the word of YHWH, O you lands,
Declare it in the isles of bands
Far off and say, 'He that spread out

Israel will gather him about
And keep him like a shepherd flocks.”

11 For YHWH’s redeemed Jacob,
ransomed

Him from the hand of stronger gummed.

12 That’s why they’ll come and sing upon

The hill of Zion and flow drawn

Together to YHWH’s goodness shown

For wheat and wine and oil and cone,

For the young of the flock and herd,

Till they are like the garden docks

Well watered, and they’ll not be sad

Any more at all *for the bad*.

13 “The virgin shall rejoice and dance,

Both young men and old in the prance;

For I’ll turn mourning into joy,

And comfort them and so employ

To make them rejoice from their shocks.

14 “I’ll satisfy the soul of priest

With fat, and My folk make increased

With My goodness,” says YHWH *of*
knocks.

Beloved, You are a wonder at Your best,

But even humankind can without rest

Also perform the miracle that You

Maintain as greatest of all in Your view.

We share capacity to rise above

Both sorrow and grief to enter in love

The joy of being, even holocaust

Recedes from pain in certain moments lost.

Beloved, You turn my mourning to delight

And from the néant bring before my sight

The visions of reality behind

The shadows that I grasp when I am blind.

The alchemist of all that’s true and rare,

No stone, no mercury, no gold in share.

15 So says YHWH: “A voice has been
heard

In Ramah, lamentation spurred

By bitter weeping; Rachel weeps

For her offspring, and so she keeps

From comfort for her children, for

They were no longer *at the door*.”

16 So says YHWH, “Stop your voice of
crying,

And your eyes from tears and from sighing,

For you work shall receive reward,”

Says YHWH, “and they shall come
restored

From the land of the foe *abhorred*.

17 “And there is hope at last,” says YHWH
“That your children will find their due.”

The wise man that wrote Matthew’s Gospel
erred

Perhaps in saying this promise was stirred

On those in Bethlehem upon a year

When Herod brought the sacrifice in gear

Of firstborn and the children of his spear.

I only say this with a sigh and tear

To see the promise of the weeping came

To pass by that prediction, but the flame

Of their return has never met its claim.

The children, if they died, they are still
dead,

Each one a skeleton with shrivelled head.

The crying must continue where it’s led,

While hope died two millennia in shame.

Raise up those children, I’ll believe the
fame.

18 I’ve surely heard Ephraim who groans:

”You’ve punished me into my bones,

As a heifer is broken in,

Turn me back, and I’ll turn from sin,

For You are YHWH my Alohim.

19 “After my turning back I swim

In my repentance; when I knew,

I groaned for the day of shame’s view,

And showed you how I bore reproach

From my youth *till evils encroach*.”

20 “Is Ephraim My dear son? Is he

A pleasant child? Since My decree

Against him, I remember still;

For him My mercy comes to fill;

I’ll surely have mercy on him,”

Says YHWH *in spoken measures dim*.

The simple Gospel’s always bee to say

Repentance and turning to the right way

Brings grace and mercy from eternal sway

Of Your house and Your treasured

roundelay.

The treasure’s not in gold, nor yet in prayer

Of praise or in the hymn sounding on air.

The treasure is the heart divine that speaks

Within the bosom of the one who seeks.

Beloved, You make the way of life on earth

So easy and so sweet in simple worth,

Because in Your love You do not know
why

Repentance is so narrow on the fly.

You hold the easy things: justice, mercy,
The human heart sighs beneath penance'
fee.

21 Set you way marks and make high
heaps;
Set your heart toward the highway steep,
The way you went; now turn again,
O virgin of Israel, let men
Turn back to these your cities' *den*.
22 How long will you wander astray,
Backsliding daughter, from the way?
For YHWH creates a novelty
Upon the earth, a woman, see,
Shall compass a man secretly.
23 So says YHWH of hosts, Alohim
Of Israel; "Yet they'll say and deem
This speech in Judah's land and in
Its cities, when I bring again
The folk from captivity's pen;
'YHWH bless you, house of justice and
Mountain of holiness *to stand*.
24 "There shall live in Judah itself,
And in all the cities on shelf,
The tiller and the shepherd band.
25 "I've satisfied the weary soul,
I've replenished the saddened soul."
26 And then I woke up and I saw;
My sleep was sweet to me *on straw*.

27 "See, the days come," says YHWH,
"that I
Will sow the house of Israel nigh
And house of Judah with man's seed,
And with the seed of beast indeed.
28 "And it shall come to pass, as I
Have watched over them to pluck by
And to break down and to throw over,
And to destroy, afflicting rover;
So I will watch over them too,
To build and plant them," so says YHWH.
29 "In those days they shall say no more,
The fathers have tasted the spore
Of sour grape, and so the teeth
Of spawn are set on edge beneath.
30 "But every one shall die in pain
For his own wickedness and vain;
Every man eating sour grape,
His teeth are set on edge for shape.
31 "See, the days come," says YHWH,
"that I
Will make a new covenant try

With the house of Israel and by
The house of Judah coming night:
32 "Not according to covenant
That I made with ancestors' cant
In the day I took them by hand
To bring them out of Egypt's land;
And they broke then My covenant,
Though I was a husband to rant
To them," says YHWH *to understand*.
33 "But this shall be the covenant
That I will make with Israel's plant;
After those days," says YHWH, "I'll put
My law in their inward parts' root,
And write it in their hearts, and I
Will be their God, and they reply
As My own folk *under the sky*.

New Covenant is not something beyond
And after the Hebraic words and frond.
It comes with Jeremiah and not by
A later day and time with Jesus' sigh.
It differs from the first in just two ways:
It's made on heart and not on stony stays;
It's one not to be broken in its lays.
I look about at Jew and Gentile now
And see that neither has such pact in vow.
The ten commandments though written on
heart
Extend not further than the horse and cart.
And in that small extension few remain
To keep those laws here in the new domain
Neither this prophet nor Jesus impart.

34 "No more shall every neighbour teach
His neighbour, and every man preach
To his brother, saying, 'Know YHWH,'
For they shall all know Me in crew,
From the least of them to the greatest,"
Says YHWH. "For I'll forgive their latest
Iniquity, and their sin I
Will not remember by and by."

As soon as Your divine law comes within
The human heart and mind, You take their
sin
And never more remember what they did
And how they broke Your law when they
backslid.
Beloved, write on my heart that blessed
word
That from the mount of Moses spoke and
stirred

The hearer to the bone, write on my heart
 The sacred graphic text once without art
 Appearing on the tables of blue stone.
 I read and hear the covenant once grown
 Cold, barren and forgotten, yet the fire
 Of promise from Your lips kindles desire
 To lay my heart before Your writing pen.
 Write on me now as You wrote on them
 then.

35 So says YHWH, who gives sun for light
 By day, and ordinance by night
 Of moon and stars, and who divides
 The sea when the waves on its sides
 Roar, YHWH of hosts, His name's *delight*.
 36 "If those statutes depart from Me,"
 Says YHWH, "then seed of Israel's tree
 Shall also cease from being here
 A nation before Me and clear."

As long as Jew exists, You say Your law
 Will also not change, but remain in paw.
 Perhaps that is the reason we found best
 To raise a holocaust up to the test.
 If all Jews could be killed, we would be
 free

To ignore the commandments on our spree.
 It was not flesh and blood that we
 destroyed,
 But the imperative of the employed,
 The law itself that taught the heart to hate
 The flesh on which it was inscribed in state.
 Beloved, to know the vast psychology
 Of slaughter in human society
 Is not to justify any attempt
 Upon the part of well-groomed or unkempt.

37 So says YHWH: "If the sky can be
 Measured and the foundations deep
 Within the earth searched out to see,
 Then I will also come to sweep
 All the seed of Israel away
 For all that they have done at bay,"
 Says YHWH. 38 See, the days come, says
 YHWH,
 That the city they shall renew
 To YHWH from the tower Hananeel
 To the gate of the corner heel.
 39 <3The measuring line shall yet go
 Out over against it to grow
 Upon the hill Gareb, and be
 Around about Goath *greatly*.

40 "And the whole valley of the dead
 Carcasses and of ashes spread
 And all the fields up to the brook
 Of Kidron, to the corner nook
 Of the horse gate toward the east,
 Shall be holy to YHWH increased;
 It shall not be plucked up nor thrown
 Down any more for ever known."

You promise that the holy seed shall be
 As long as sky's unmeasured in degree.
 Perhaps that is the motive that we see
 Astronomer out to count up the fee.
 If we can only set the universe
 In bounds exact for better or for worse,
 Then by Your own promise the people fail
 And disappear beyond existence' veil.
 And when that happens the commandments
 fall,
 And all may live by love against the wall
 By the sweet jungle's law that serves the
 best
 And fittest with a day of gloried rest,
 Instead of Sabbath of the donkey and
 The servant and the son upon the land.

Jeremiah 32

1 The word that came to Jeremiah
 From YHWH tenth year of Zedekiah
 King of Judah, the eighteenth year
 Of Nebuchadrezzar *in fear*.
 2 For then the king of Babylon
 Sent his army besieging drawn
 Jerusalem; and Jeremiah
 The prophet was shut up as crier
 In the court of the prison, which
 Was in Judah's king's house *for pitch*.
 3 For Zedekiah king of Judah
 Had shut him up for being ruder,
 Saying "Why do you prophesy,
 And say, 'So says YHWH by and by,
 See, I'll give this city into
 The hand of king of Babyloo,
 And he shall take it as his due;
 4 "And Zedekiah, Judah's king,
 Shall not escape out of the spring
 Of the Chaldeans, but surely
 Shall be delivered in the spree
 Of king of Babylon and speak
 With him face to face *like a weak*,
 And look eyeball to eyeball *weak*.
 5 "And he'll lead Zedekiah out

To Babylon to be there stout
 Until I bring judgement on him,
 Says YHWH, and though in battle grim
 You meet the Chaldeans, you'll not
 Prosper or win the battles fought.””
 6 And Jeremiah said ”The word
 Of YHWH came to me, saying stirred,
 7 ’See, Hanameel son of Shallum
 Your uncle shall come in to hum
 To you and say “Now buy my field
 That is in Anathoth to yield,
 For you have got redemption’s right
 Upon that field to buy in sight.”””
 8 So Hanameel my uncle’s son
 Came to me in court of prison
 According to the word of YHWH,
 And said to me, “Buy my field, do,
 That’s in Anathoth, which is in
 The countryside of Benjamin,
 For the right of inheritance
 Is yours, and the redemption chance;
 Buy it for yourself.” Then I knew
 That this had been the word of YHWH.

It seems that Jeremiah had his doubts
 Whether the word that came in starts and
 spouts
 Was from You, My Beloved, or from
 another.
 He looked for evidence convincing brother.
 So when he dreamed his cousin would
 come by
 And sell a field to him, he was not shy
 To think You had a hand in it for why.
 I could not count the times my wife’s done
 so,
 And knew the future of the come and go
 Of neighbour or acquaintance of old time
 To step into our kitchen for a rhyme.
 Does that mean that it’s You, Beloved, who
 speaks
 To my wife by the hearth for what she
 peeks?
 If so, I’ve got a pipeline above crime.

9 I bought the field from Hanameel
 My uncle’s son, in Anathoth,
 And weighed out for him by appeal
 The money, seventeen *in cloth*
 Of silver shekels *not to steal*.
 10 I wrote it in a writ to seal
 Before witnesses and weighed him

The money in fair balance *trim*.
 11 I took evidence of the sale,
 Both what was sealed by legal bale
 And custom and the open *grail*.
 12 I gave the evidence of sale
 To Baruch son of Neriah,
 Who was the son of Maaseiah,
 In the sight of Hanameel my
 Uncle’s son, and before the eye
 Of witnesses who signed the writ,
 Before all the Jews that would sit
 In the court of the prison lit.
 13 And I commanded Baruch then
 Before their eyes telling the men:
 14 “So says YHWH of hosts, Israel’s God;
 ‘Take these contracts, the writ in prod
 Of purchase, both the sealed and that
 Which is open and put them flat
 In a ceramic pot so they
 May keep for many and many a day.’
 15 “For so says YWHH of hosts the God
 Of Israel: ‘Houses in pod
 And fields and vineyards shall again
 Be possessed in this land by men.””

Investment by obtaining worthless stock
 And waiting for it to rise in the wok
 Is not a bad way to increase one’s wealth:
 The dividends come quietly in stealth.
 So Jeremiah bought the land he knew
 Would be taken by Babylonian crew,
 And that he could not use as long as he
 Was stuck in prison by the king’s mercy.
 Beloved, I have invested in the grain
 Of morning flame in sky, though sound and
 sane,
 And put my money on the songs that cheer
 The robins having moved into the near
 By thickets where the arm of law has
 spelled
 A sacred habitat for beasts unquelled.

16 Now when I had delivered writ
 Of purchase to Baruch *and fit*
 Son of Neriah, then I prayed
 To YHWH, saying 17 “Lord YHWH
 waylaid,
 See You have made the heaven and earth
 By Your great power and stretched by
 worth
 Your arm and there’s nothing too hard
 For You to set about *unsparrd*.

18 “You show mercy to thousands and
Punish iniquity of band
Of the ancestors in the heart
Of their children after their part.

I see that Jeremiah knows the speech
That You came down on Mount Sinai to
preach,
And notes the mercy that You put in reach
Of thousands who love You and stay to
teach
Obedience to Your law, the sweetest peach.
I see that Jeremiah knows that You
Promised to give iniquity in due
Of generations up to three or four
And thus limit the rate of wicked score.
Beloved, the hopeful climate of Your law
Is more, it seems, than humans keep in
paw,
And yet the centuries that paved the way
To Jeremiah echo still today
With that great wonder and that speech and
ray.

“The Great, the Mighty El, and YHWH
Of hosts, is His name, 19 Great in *true*
Counsel, incomprehensible
In thought: whose eyes are open full
Upon all the ways of the folk
Of Adam [red earth], to render each bloke
According to his ways and by
The outcome of his plans to spy.
20 “You have set signs and wonders in
The land of Egypt, to the bin
Of this day and in Israel,
And among men of every spell,
And have made You a name as well
As at this day. 21 “And You’ve brought out
Your people Israel from out
Of Egypt’s land with signs and wonders,
And with a strong hand and stretched
thunders,
And with great terror *for their blunders*.
22 “And You have given them this land,
Which You swore to their fathers’ band,
Land flowing mild and honey *panned*.
23 “And they came in and took it over,
But did not obey Your voice rover,
And did not act by Your commands,
Not doing anything in hands
Of what You told them all to do;
That’s why You had this evil come

On them *to set them on their bum*.
24 “See how the cavalry appears
To take the city in arrears,
And the town’s given to the hand
Of the Chaldeans, that in band
Fight against it, because the sword,
The famine and the plague’s reward
Have come as You said would take place,
And see it now before Your face.
25 “And You said to me, O Lord YHWH,
Buy you the field for money due,
And take witnesses of the true,
For the city is given into
The hand of the Chaldean crew.”

When Jeremiah makes investment due
He does not seem too happy to accrue
The land he knows he’ll not have chance to
view.

That’s foresight to be sure, since many take
Life for an unending eternity,
Millennia to find and eat their cake
Under a palm or other desert tree.
Beloved, I to spread out my wings
As though the sheen of silver in all things
Were mine forever. Such a truant way
Is bound to get me more instruction’s pay.
I bring to witness of my purchase made
The tumble of the bumble-bee’s parade,
The lily-of-the-valley green and staid.

26 And word of YHWH to Jeremiah
Came saying to him as a crier:
27 “See, I am YHWH, the Alohim
Of all flesh, does anything seem
Too hard for me?” 28 That’s why says
YHWH:

“See, I will give this city to
The hand of the Chaldeans’ crew,
The hand of Nebuchadrezzar
The king of Babylon *and star*,
And he shall take it from afar.
29 And the Chaldeans come to fight
Against this city, come with might
And set fire to the town and burn
It with the houses where the urn
Was filled with incense sent to Baal,
And where poured out drink offerings hale
To other gods, provoking wrath.
30 “For the children of Israel’s path
And the children of Judah do
Only evil before Me too

From their youth: folk of Israel
Have only provoked me to spell
Of anger with the work of their
Hands," says YHWH *and for Israel's*
share.

31 "For this city has been to Me
A provocation in degree
Of wrath and fury from the day
That they built it up to today;
So I'd remove it from its place.
32 "Because of all the evil face
Of Israel's folk and Judah's too,
Which they have done to raise in view
My anger, they, their kings and yet
Their princes and their priests that met
Their prophets, and men of Judah,
Jerusalem's people *of straw.*
32 "And they have turned their back to Me,
And not the face I taught to see,
Rising up early to teach them,
They did not obey offered gem.

Does Jeremiah hear You speak the word
That suggests You are like any interred
God of the temples from Damascus' town
And all around the Middle Eastern frown?
They come at morning light to open doors,
They carry bread and incense on the floors
Of marble black and white and sometimes
blue,

To waken god and goddess overdue.
The expectations of the groaning state
Are always in the heart and mind of late
Crowds and the worshippers of town and
field.

A prophet though ought to have better
yield.

No one can turn a back to You for You
Are everywhere I look by human view.

34 "But they set idols in the house
Which is called by My name *as spouse*
To make it filthy. 35 "And they built
High places of Baal on the silt
Of vale of Hinnom's son, to make
Their sons and daughters pass for sake
Of Molech through the fire, which I
Commanded they not do with ire,
Nor did it come to mind that they
Should do abomination's way,
To cause Judah to sin *and sway.*

It is no use to complain, my dear One,
Since You created humans blind for fun.
The chips fall in the gutter for the feud
Of the idolatry by those imbued.
A thousand chips and more are swept away
While only one image of art's to stay.
So with Your own creation at the mill,
Though You are infinite in wisdom's skill,
The crowds are mere chaff of the divine
mill,

Though each flake for a moment in the
light
Reflects the brilliance of the sun for spite.
You put a moment of beauty in each
Before You dump the lot in hell to screech.

36 "That's why" says YHWH the Alohim
Of Israel about the beam
Of this city, of which you say,
"It shall be delivered in way
Of Babylon's king by the sword,
And by famine and plague unstored."

37 "See, I will gather them from all
The countries where I've driven in stall
By My wrath and My fury's fall,
And in great anger, and I'll bring
Thing here again and make them sing
In safety *by the crystal spring.*

38 "And they shall be My folk, and I
Will be their Alohim foreby.

39 "And I will give to them one heart
And one way to fear Me from start
For ever, for the good of them,
And of their children after them.

Beloved, You did give all mankind one
heart,

The same awareness of I from the start
Illuminating every gift and sound
From crackling of sky footstep on the
ground

To tinkling of the zephyrs all around
The firmament beyond all human bound.
It's only an illusion that the heart
Is lonely and divided from the part
Of all creation in eternal well.
It's true of both Gentile and Israel.
Beloved, I look around surprised to see
So few have heart of justice and mercy,
And then remember that there's none but
this

Great heart divine that everyone must kiss.

40 "And I will make a covenant
 Ages enduring and not pant
 To turn away from them again,
 From doing good to Israel's men,
 But I will put fear in their hearts
 Not to depart from Me *like darts*.
 41 "Indeed I will rejoice in them
 To do them good and then again
 I shall plant them in this land by
 My whole heart and soul *under sky*."
 42 For so says YHWH, "As I have brought
 All this great evil and unsought
 Upon this people, so will I
 Bring on them all the good to spy
 That I have promised *from the sky*.
 43 "And fields shall be bought in this land,
 Of which you say it's desert stand
 Without man or beast, but is given
 In hand of Chaldeans *to live in*.
 44 "Men shall buy fields for money and
 Sign deeds and seal them and take band
 Of witnesses in Benjamin,
 And what surrounds Jerusalem,
 And in the cities of Judah,
 And in the towns of mountains' claw,
 And in the cities of the vale,
 And in the towns of southern pale,
 For I'll turn back captivity,"
 Says YHWH *for Israel to see*.

No covenant with humankind endures,
 Each pact is for the one breath and the
 cures

Of whirling passages in feet and time,
 The arches of ascent the faithful climb,
 The arcs descending from the source of
 crime.

No covenant, Beloved, those spoken by
 The lips that do not die and do not lie,
 Can be eternal under earthly sky.
 The hope, Beloved, of every human breast
 Lies in illusion of the east and west,
 Progression of time as though it were true,
 When in reality there's none but You.
 Shut down the trembling echo and the sight
 Of universe and none will see the night.

Jeremiah 33

1 And the word of YHWH came again
 To Jeremiah. He was then
 Shut up in the court of prison,

Saying 2 "So says YHWH Maker done,
 And YHWH that formed it to set it;
 YHWH is His name *and He is fit*.
 3 "Call on me and I'll answer you,
 And show you great and mighty crew,
 Things that you do not know *as true*.'
 4 "For so says YHWH the Alohim
 Of Israel, about the beam
 Of this town's houses and about
 The houses of Judah's kings stout,
 Which are thrown down by cavalry,
 And by the sword, 5 'They come in spree
 To fin with the Chaldeans, but
 It is to full them with the glut
 Of carcasses of men, whom I
 Have slain in My anger and My
 Fury, and for all whose sins I
 Have hid my face from this city.
 6 "See, I will bring it health and cure,
 And I will heal them and be sure
 To reveal to them abundance
 Of peace and truth, *not song and dance*.
 7 "And I'll turn back captivity
 Of Judah and captivity
 Of Israel and will rebuild
 Than as at the first they were filled.
 8 "And I will cleanse them from their sin
 By which they've sinned against My grin,
 And I will pardon all their faults
 By which they've sinned by word and
 waltz.

9 "It shall be to Me name of joy,
 A praise and honour to employ
 Before all nations of the earth,
 Which shall hear all the good of worth
 That I will do for them; and they
 Shall fear and tremble for the way
 All the goodness' prosperity
 That I procure to it in fee."

The pardoning of faults is something wise
 And great that humankind too can devise,
 No doubt because created by Your will
 In images of the divine and still.
 But cleansing from such sin takes more
 than we
 Contrive in all human divinity:
 We may forgive, and as we do are free,
 But only You cleanse from the sinful spree.
 Beloved, I grasp the golden words and take
 A step beyond the Christian sort of wake,
 And plunge into that silver sea to make

My droplet disappear before the wave
Of YOUNESS that cleanses not just the brave,
But all who breathe the hope You have to
save.

10 So says YHWH "Again there shall be
Heard in this place of which you say
It is a desolation's prey
Without man and without beastly,
The cities of Judah and streets
Of Jerusalem without sweets,
Without man or inhabitant,
And without a beast that's extant,
11 "The voice of joy, voice of gladness,
The voice of bridegroom and address
Of the bride, their voices shall say
'Praise YHWH of hosts, for YHWH's in
sway;

His mercy is for ever too:'
And of them that shall bring in view
The sacrifice of prize into
The house of YHWH. For I shall turn
Captivity of the land spurn,
As at the first," and so says YHWH.

I enter in the city of my love,
The inner chamber where my spirit of
Stone glistens in the single light I bear,
Find old and new Jerusalem sits there.
The barren walls are silent and aghast
Before the earthly drought, before the blast
Of the east wind, and yet the slight outcast
That I have been is kindled with the share
Of hope and song that I find imaged there.
Beloved, the sound of joy You promise to
Inflate in old Jerusalem in due
Returns upon my heart as I expand
The Psalms of David in my heart and hand,
And find the walls re-echo though
unmanned.

12 So says YHWH of hosts "Once again
In this place which is desert fen
Without man and without beast then,
And in all the towns of the place,
Shall be a habitation's trace
Of shepherds pasturing their sheep.
13 "In the towns of the mountains' keep,
In cities of the vale, and in
The cities of the south, and in
The very land of Benjamin,
In suburbs of Jerusalem,

And in Judah's own towns for gem,
Shall the flocks pass again beneath
The hands of shepherds *of belief*,"
Says YHWH. 14 "See the days come," says
YHWH,

That I'll perform that good thing too
Which I have promised to the house
Of Israel and to the house
Of Judah. 15 "In those days and at
That time, I will cause to grow fat
The branch of righteousness to grow
Up for David, and he shall show
Judgement and righteousness below.
16 "In those days shall Judah be saved,
Jerusalem be safely paved,
And this is by what she'll be called:
YHWH is our righteous One installed."

As my song does expand beyond the walls
Of old Jerusalem, beyond the stalls
Of Judah and Damascus to the share
Of northern slopes of fir and pine to share
The sound of joy with birch and aspen air,
I find the desert and abandonment.
The flocks and herds have fled the single
tent,
The crowds that bowed before the incense
went,
And I am one alone before Your throne
To see that You are righteous, You alone.
The human unity that many seek
In sect and son of God must die as meek,
The divine spark rise up and leave the
stone.

17 For so says YHWH "David shall not
Lack a man to sit in his plot
Of throne in Israel's house for aye;
18 "Neither shall the priests of Levi
Lack a man before Me to burn
Offerings and kindle meat in urn,
To sacrifice ever and aye."

The sweet Christian says that Jesus still sits
Upon the throne of David with his wits.
Israelis fear the promise all the more
If anyone takes notice of the store.
The Muslim makes no claims above the
spree,
But hopes in the appearance of Mahdi.
Methinks there's little hope to sit and wait
For coming of a messianic state.

David's spawn lives again in me
As I sing Psalms to rise upon the slate.
If I'd a voice, Beloved, like other men,
My singing would make stop on hill and
fen

The crowds of worshippers that buy and try
To satisfy desire when You come by.

19 And the word of YHWH came nearby
To Jeremiah, saying *sigh*:

20 "So says YHWH 'If you can break My
Covenant of the day, and My
Covenant of the night, and that
There should not be day and night flat
In their time; 21 "then may also be
Broken My covenant's decree
With David My servant, that he
Should not lack a son to reign on
His throne and with the Levites drawn
As priests, My ministers of *dawn*.

22 "As the host of the sky cannot
Be counted, neither the sand caught
Of the sea measured, so will I
Multiply spawn of David My
Servant, and the Levites that come
To minister to Me *in sum*.'"

The covenant with David's sure as day
And night swim by my waking eyes and
prey

Upon my doubts and silences in sway.
When day and night cease from the earth
then I

Can be sure that the throne of David nigh
Is vacant and abandoned in the late.
Until then I have certainty to wait.
Beloved, I whirl about the empty room,
The star-filled tent, the melody of gloom,
And rush into the arms of scented doom.
The sons of David ever multiply
Like violets three-coloured or the sly
And pastel waifs sprung up against the sky.
I lose count in my passing asking whom.

23 And the word of YHWH came once
more

To Jeremiah *at the door*:

24 "Do not think of what this folk spoke,
Saying 'The two families in stroke
Which YHWH has chosen, will He then
Cast them off, even the last men?'
So they've despised My people that

They should be no more on their mat
A nation before them *that sat*."

25 So says YHWH "If My covenant
Be not with day and with night spent,
And if I have not set abroad

The statutes of the sky and sod;
26 "Then I will cast away the seed
Of Jacob, and David in need

My servant, so that I will not
Take any of his spawn in plot
To be the rulers over spawn
Of Abraham, Isaac and on
Jacob: For I will turn back their
Captivity in mercy's share."

When David was in Kedar with the fair,
Those days of evil and of wicked share,
When Israel invited not a nod
But trampled on anointed iron-shod,
Then he brought forth upon the Arab mate
The hidden child whose family had to wait
Until the voice was done and Rome had
turned

Away from holy mountain and the spurned.
Then the desired and the awaited came
To bring a word for Abram against shame,
Reciting still Your oneness and not three,
Yet recognizing anointed degree.
Beloved, I hold the secret of the throne
Of David, whose seed's uncounted and
grown.

Jeremiah 34

1 The word that came to Jeremiah
From YHWH when Nebuchadnezzar
King of Babylon with his dire
Army and all the kingdoms far
Of the earth under his domain,
And all the people, fought to gain
Jerusalem and all its towns,
Saying 2 "So says YHWH though with
frowns

The Alohim of Israel:
'Go speak to Zedekiah king
Of Judah and tell him a thing,
"So says YHWH 'See, I'll give this town
Into the hand of the renown
King of Babylon, and he'll burn
It with fire and he'll burn it down.
3 "You'll not escape out of his hand,
But surely taken by his band,
Your eyes shall look into the eyes

Of Babylon's king, no disguise,
 And he shall tell you face to face
 That you'll go to Babylon's place.”
 4 “Yet listen to the word of YHWH,
 O Zedekiah, king of Ju-
 dah; So says YHWH concerning you,
 ‘You shall not die by the sword’s view.
 5 “But you will die in peace, and with
 Obsequies of ancestors’ myth,
 The former kings that went before
 You, so shall they burn from the store
 Incent for you, and will lament,
 “Ah lord!” for I’ve declared the word,’
 Says YHWH.” 6 Then Jeremiah stirred,
 The prophet spoke all these words to
 Zedekiah, the king in view
 Of Judah in Jerusalem,
 7 When the king of Babylon’s band
 Would fight against Jerusalem,
 And against all the cities’ stand
 Of Judah that were left at hand,
 Against Lachish and Azekah:
 For these fortified cities in paw
 Stayed of the cities of Judah.

The history is known. The king looked in
 The eye of Nebuchadnezzar for sin,
 And was borne off to Babylon to live
 Beneath the sun bereaved and to forgive.
 Beloved all men look in the conquering
 eye,
 Or else look on the conquered passing by,
 And yet all are one and the same weak
 flesh.

I set before Your eye my faith afresh:
 My creed is no more and no less than this.
 You are one, and that oneness that I kiss
 Implies the unity of every son
 And daughter of creation when You’ve
 done.
 Let no divisive creed enter my heart,
 Nor in my industry nor in my art.

8 This is the message that then came
 To Jeremiah from the claim
 Of YHWH, and after the king made
 A pact between Zedekiah
 And all the folk from all Judah
 That were there in Jerusalem,
 To proclaim their freedom to them.
 9 That every man should let his slave,
 And every man release and wave

His maidservant of Hebrew cast,
 To go free, so none should at last
 Take service from them, not a Jew
 Of his own brother *in the crew*.
 10 And now when all the princes and
 All the folk had entered the band
 Of covenant, heard every one
 Should free his manservant to run
 And free his maidservant so none
 Should take service then anymore,
 They obeyed and released the score.
 11 But afterward they reversed it
 And made servants and handmaids fit
 That had gone free come back to sit
 In servitude, both slave and kit.”

One law for the free-born and Israelite
 And one for the stranger sitting in fright
 Beside the hearth may not at all seem right.
 So if the people start to treat the brother
 By the same law of slavery as another,
 All men are treated equally and fair.
 No doubt that’s what was in the heart and
 air,
 Not greed but justice. Always find the good
 In every motive as well as I could.
 There is a way that seems right to a man,
 And so each one goes according to plan
 And when my benefit converges with
 The justice that the strong permit their
 myth,
 Then I can praise Your name and law and
 ban.

12 And so a message came from YHWH
 To Jeremiah, and from YHWH,
 Saying “So says YHWH Alohims
 Of Israel; I made a beam
 With your ancestors in the day
 That I brought them out of the way
 Of Egypt’s land, out of the house
 Of bondmen, saying to each spouse:
 14 “At the term of just seven years
 Let go each man his brother peers
 Who is a Hebrew, which has been
 Sold to you, and when he’s served kin
 For six years, you shall let him go
 Free from you,’ but your fathers slow
 Did not obey Me, closed their ears.
 15 “And you had turned from doing right
 Before My throne and in My sight,
 Proclaiming liberty each man

To his neighbour, and made a stand
 Before Me in the house that's called
 By My name *and so is installed*.
 16 "And then you reversed the whole thing,
 Polluting My name by the sting,
 And made each man's servant return,
 And every handmaid in the stern,
 Whom you had set at liberty,
 You brought them into slavery,
 To be your slaves and handmaids earn."

Is it true, my Beloved, that You proclaim
 A Jew can be a slave in act and name
 For six years only and then must go free,
 While slaves of any other company
 Are slaves to slave their lives eternally?
 The word pronounced on Canaan was a
 sword
 To that man whose father was unadored.
 The word pronounced by Moses was not
 fair,
 Even it gave an exemption's share
 To maid and manservant. Beloved, beware.
 Exemption is inequity for good
 Or evil masque. You did then what You
 could.
 It's not my business, though, since I am not
 Jewish, but only Celt and Indian got.

17 So says YHWH, "You've not obeyed
 Me,
 In proclaiming the liberty,
 Each one to his brother and free,
 Each man to his neighbour to see,
 I proclaim liberty for you,"
 Says YHWH, "to the sword and plague's
 cue,
 And to the famine, and I'll make
 You be removed and so will take
 You into all the kingdoms' wake
 Upon the earth, *for your sins' sake*.
 18 "I'll give the men who have
 transgressed
 My covenant and not addressed
 The words of promise they had made
 Before Me, when they had waylaid
 The calf cut in two and passed through
 The two parts of it *as was due*,
 19 "The princes of Judah, the chiefs
 Of Jerusalem, without feoffs
 The eunuchs and the priests and all
 The people of the land and stall,

Who passed between the parts of calf;
 20 "I'll give them into hand to laugh
 Of their foes and the hand of those
 Who seek their life, and their dead ruts
 Shall be the food of fowl that struts
 Down from the sky and to the beast
 Of the earth *on the field increased*.
 21 "And Zedekiah king of Judah
 And his princes, *both kind and ruder*,
 I'll give into the hand of foes,
 And also in the hand of those
 Who seek their life, and in the hand
 Of Babylon's king's army band.
 22 "See, I shall command then," says

YHWH,
 "And cause them to return into
 This city; and fight against it,
 And take it and burn it with lit
 Fire, and I'll make of Judah's towns
 A desolation on the downs.

It seems a bit vindictive to my mind
 That You would make such a fuss when
 consigned
 To broken promises. I seek and find
 Much worse in broken promises around
 Me where I live and breathe upon the
 ground.
 The trail of broken treaties that is found
 The basis of the US I am bound
 Is far worse that the Jewish maid and boy
 Returned to servanthood and the employ
 Of their benign masters in greed and joy.
 Remember, my Beloved, the trail of tears,
 The child forced from the broken mother's
 fears,
 The march renewed, the crows that settled
 fast
 To peck the eyes from her lying outcast.

Jeremiah 35

1 The word which came to Jeremiah
 From YHWH in the days of the dire
 Jehoiakim son of Josiah
 The king of Judah, saying crier:
 2 "Go to the house of Rechabites,
 And speak to them, and bring the wights
 Into the house of YHWH, into
 One of the chambers of the crew,
 And give them wine to drink in view."
 3 Then I took Jaazaniah son
 Of Jeremiah, and the son

Of Habaziniyah, and his
 Brothers and all his sons in biz,
 And the whole house of Rechabites.
 4 And I brought them into the lights
 Of YHWH's house, to the chambered cote
 Of the sons of Hanan to dote,
 The son of Igdaliah, great
 Man that he was, which was in rate
 By the chamber of the chiefs' mate,
 Above the chamber of Maaseiah,
 The son of Shallum for whose hire
 The door was kept *from thief and fire*.

The keeping of the threshold is a rate
 Among the shamanistic of the state
 Of Turkic peoples who still bow the pate
 Before the entrance to what must elate.
 I too have been invited for my share
 Reciting of Al-Fatihah with care
 And love amidst the meal of walnut and
 The rice and broth brought out by grieving
 hand.

Departure from the hall and table set
 Was my embarrassment not to forget,
 Who stumbled on the high threshold as
 though
 Ali had not been kept in mind and show.
 Beloved, my Abdal heart is full to glow.
 I stumble as I whirl from row to row.

5 I set before the sons of house
 Of Rechabites canters to douse,
 Full of wines and cups and I said
 To them "Drink up, the wine *is* *bled*."
 6 But they said "We will drink no wine;
 For Jonadab the son supine
 Of Rechab our ancestor did
 Command us saying and to bid:
 'You shall drink no wine, not you or
 Your sons now and for evermore.
 7 "Neither shall you build houses or
 Sow seed or plant the vineyard's store,
 Nor have any such, all your days
 You shall dwell in tents for your praise;
 And so live long upon the land
 In which you are strangers to stand.
 8 "So we've obeyed Jonadab's voice,
 The son of Rechab who of choice
 Is our ancestor in all he
 Has charged us, to drink no wine's fee
 All our days, we, our wives, our sons,
 Nor our daughters either, by tons.

9 "Nor to build houses where to live,
 Neither have we vineyards to give,
 Nor field nor seed: 10 "But we remain
 In tents and so obey the fane,
 And do according to all that
 Jonadab our ancestor spat.
 11 "But it happened when came the king
 Nebuchadrezzar from the spring
 Of Babylon, that we said 'Come,
 Let's get Jerusalem to hum
 For fear of the Chaldeans' sum,
 And fear of Syrian army won:
 So we live at Jerusalem.'"

My own great grandfather gave word to
 each
 Of his own progeny with honeyed speech
 That none should touch the wine or
 whiskey's song
 No matter what temptation came along.
 I chose a wife from that tradition too,
 And so the generations still ring true.
 Though Your ten words contain no praise
 or rue
 In that regard, Beloved, I don't blame You.
 And yet through stick and shin I still
 eschew
 The lifted glass, the drunken path in view.
 Though I live in the great northern morass,
 And slip in summer on the frozen grass,
 I still set off the humming of the glass,
 The tinkle of the tripping and the gong.

12 Then came the word of YHWH unto
 Jeremiah, saying as due,
 13 "So says YHWH of hosts, Alohim
 Of Israel 'Go tell the scheme
 To Judah's men and dwellers in
 Jerusalem, "Will you not win
 To take to heart My words in bin?"
 Says YHWH. 14 "The words of Jonadab
 The son of Rechab, that in blab
 He commanded his sons not to
 Drink wine, are performed by the crew
 To this day they drink none, but still
 Obey their ancestor's last bill:
 And yet I have spoken to you,
 Rising early and speaking too,
 But you did not obey My view.
 15 "I've also sent you My servants
 The prophets all rising to dance
 Early and sending them to say

Return now each man from the way
 Of wickedness, and what you do
 Make right, and do not go in crew
 After other gods to serve them,
 And you shall dwell in the land's hem
 Which I have given you and to
 Your ancestors; but you have not
 Inclined your ear to hear My plot.
 16 "Because the sons of Jonadab
 The son of Rechab without flab
 Have performed the commandment of
 Their ancestor handed in love,
 But this folk has not obeyed Me,'
 17 "Therefore so says YHWH Alohim
 Of hosts, the Alohim in fee
 Of Israel 'See, I will bring
 Upon Judah and all the ring
 Jerusalem inhabiting
 All the evil that I've proclaimed
 Against them; because I arraigned
 Them, but they would not hear, and I
 Have called them, they would not come
 nigh.'"

18 And Jeremiah told the clan
 Of Rechabites and to a man,
 "So says YHWH of hosts, Israel's God,
 'Because you have obeyed the prod
 Of Jonadab your father, and
 Kept all his precepts out of hand
 And done all in view of command,'
 19 "Therefore so says YHWH of hosts still
 The Alohim of Israel's hill
 'Jonadab son of Rechab will
 Not lack a man to stand by Me
 For ever and eternally.'"

Sometimes it seems I'm the only man left
 Who does not taste the whiskey drawn in
 heft.
 My own Egyptian friend was sure that most
 Muslims converted to the Christian host,
 In evidence he brought the tale in boast
 That London's full of such to raise a toast
 And down the alcoholic swig to roast.
 I smile to see criterion so bold
 In proof of Christianity in hold:
 Get drunk and taste the swine's flesh so all
 see
 That salvation has fallen in grace free.
 Thank God I join with Rechabite band in
 My liberty from such evils in bin,
 To celebrate an ancient joy with din.

Jeremiah 36

1 It came to pass in the fourth year
 Of Jehoiakim son *and spear*
 Of Josiah king of Judah,
 That this word came *into the craw*
Of Jeremiah from YHWH saying
 2 "Take you a roll of book displaying
 And write in it all the words I
 Have spoken to you against lie
 Of Israel and Judah, and
 Against all the nations that stand
 From the day I spoke to you, from
 The days of Josiah *in sum*
 Even to this day, *every hum*.
 3 "It may be that the house of Judah
 Will hear all the evil and ruder
 Which I propose to do to them;
 And they may so turn back in hem
 Each one from his bad stratagem;
 Then I may forgive all their sin
 And their iniquity in bin."

I meet the scroll and book, Beloved, today
 As Judah when Jehoiakim held sway
 And sat upon King David's throne in
 peace.

The retribution that false deeds must bring
 In fruit of what was sown might well
 increase.

So Jeremiah read before the king.
 What was the price of peace with You that
 year,
 The fourth of King Jehoiakim for fear?
 You only wanted them to turn away
 From evil and confess the plot and stay
 Obedient to Your will in time to come.
 You did not ask a pledge or future sum.
 As soon as man turns from the evil deed
 You then forgive and that with right good
 speed.

4 Then Jeremiah called Baruch
 The son of Neriah, no kook,
 And Baruch wrote from the dictation
 Of Jeremiah all the ration
 Of YHWH which He had spoken to
 Him, on a roll of book in view.
 5 And Jeremiah gave command
 To Baruch, saying "I'm in band,
 And cannot go into the house
 Of YHWH, 6 "so you go like a mouse

And read the roll, which you now wrote
 From my dictation, YHWH's words smote
 In the ears of the people in
 YHWH's house upon the day of din
 And fasting, and also you'll read
 Them in the ears of all to heed
 Of Judah that come out *that day*
 From their cities *to temple's sway*.
 7 "It may be they will come to make
 Their supplication for their sake
 Before YHWH and will so repent
 Each one from his wicked way bent,
 For great is the wrath and the fury
 That YHWH has pronounced in a hurry
 Against these people *to resent*."
 8 And Baruch Neriah's son did
 Everything Jeremiah bid,
 And what the prophet did command,
 Reading the book on every hand
 The message of YHWH in the place
 Of YHWH's house *before every face*.
 9 It happened in the fifth year of
 Jehoiakim the son to love
 Of Josiah, king of Judah,
 In the ninth month, they set in awe
 A fast before YHWH for the folk
 All living in Jerusalem,
 And to all the people in yoke
 Who came from the towns at a stroke
 In Judah to Jerusalem.

Jehoiakim was not a righteous king,
 But he knew forms and he would do the
 thing
 Required by all tradition, so he called
 The people to the fast and unappalled
 By his hypocrisy proclaimed the day
 The month of fasting started. Ninth month
 fast
 Known from antiquity proved not astray
 And this brave king was true ecclesiast.
 Ninth month for fasting, so long known and
 kept
 By those who sought You, my Beloved,
 and wept
 To find the mornings empty, cool and clear,
 Speak to me too beyond the silence here.
 Stop tongue of word and bread and keep
 the eye
 From dark and light while You are passing
 by.

10 Then Baruch read the book containing
 The words of Jeremiah reigning
 In YHWH's house in the chamber of
 Gemariah who was son of
 Shaphan the scribe, in higher court,
 At entry of new gate's resort
 To YHWH's house in the hearing of
 All the people *and for their sport*.
 11 Michaiah Gemariah's son,
 The son of Shaphan, heard well-spun
 All the words of YHWH from the book,
 12 Then he went down into the nook
 Of the king, in the scribal room,
 And see, all the princes in gloom
 Sat there, Elishama the scribe,
 Delaiah Shemaiah's son's tribe,
 And Elnath son of Achbor,
 And Gemariah Shaphan's score,
 And Zedekiah who was son
 Of Hananiah, and a ton
 Of princes, all of them when done.
 13 And Michaiah told them about
 All the messages he'd heard out
 When Baruch read the book before
 The hearing of the folk in store.
 14 So all the princes sent Jehudi
 The son of Nethaniah broody
 The son of Shelemiah, who
 Was the son of Cush, into
 Baruch, saying "Take in your hand
 The roll that you've read contraband
 In hearing of the folk, and come.
 So Baruch and Neriah's bum
 Took the roll in his hand and came
 Over to them *to hear their claim*."
 15 And they said to him, "Sit down now
 And read it in our hearing too.
 So Baruch read it anyhow.
 16 It happened when they'd heard the view
 Of all the words, they were afraid
 Each one of them who sat and stayed,
 And said to Baruch, "We must tell
 The king of all these words in spell."
 17 And they asked Baruch saying "Say,
 How did you write these words this way,
 All these things from his mouth and sway?"
 18 The Baruch answered them, "He spoke
 All these things to me at a stroke,
 And I wrote them down using ink
 In this book *for to swim or sink*."
 19 Then the chiefs said to Baruch "Go
 And hide, both you and Jeremiah,

So no one knows your place of hire.”

I’ve written down again the words in store
That Jeremiah quoted and much more,
And though I hide upon my own lakeshore
Far from the galloping of greedy core,
I need not fear as Baruch did of old,
Simply because there is not of the bold
Who reads or listens to my tirade now,
Either in print or on street corner’s vow.
When Edward Elwall lifted up his head
To cry aloud against trinities led
Into the Church of England and outspread,
They took him to the court for wine and bread.

Even in those days long since gone awry
He was acquitted, though a Turkish spy.

20 And they went to the king not slow
And into the court and to show
To roll in the room of the scribe
Elishama, and told the ribe
In hearing of the king below.
21 So the king sent Jehudi then
To fetch the roll out of the den
Of Elishama the scribe and
Jehudi too and read it in
The ears of the king, also in
The ears of all the princes which
Stood beside the king at a pitch.
22 Now the king sat in winter house
In the ninth month, and not to dowse
There was a fire on brazier there
Burning before him for warmth’s share.
23 It happened when Jehudi read
Three or four leaves, he cut the spread
With a penknife and threw it in
The fire on the hearth and in bin
Till all the roll had been burned up
In the fire that flamed in the cup.
24 And the king and all his servants
Who heard and these words’ song and dance

Were not afraid and did not tear
Their garments *in repentance share*.

25 Still Elnathan and Delaiah
And Gemariah held out paw
To the king pleading not to burn
The roll, but he’d not hear or learn.
26 The king commanded Jerahmeel
The son of Hammelech for weal,
And Seraiah Azriel’s son,

And Shelemiah Abdeel’s son,
To take Baruch the scribe and yet
Jeremiah the prophet set,
But YHWH had hidden them *when met*.

I wonder that in those days far away
The king would have a penknife on display.
I don’t suppose the thing was Swedish
steel,

And yet I wonder what the king in heel
Would do with it, and if he knew to read,
And had his letters cosy in the reed.
The specialist in some reigns took the pen
While king and courtier hardly knew the
fen.

I understand that many such stood tall
Before the Czar himself, not far from all.
If the king reads and writes, I lift my hat,
Even if he’s irreverent on the mat
Before the word prophetic where he sat.
I still think that this king is a cool cat.

27 Then YHWH’s word came to Jeremiah,
After the king had burned the prior
Roll and the words which Baruch wrote
Dictated by Jeremiah,
Saying 28 “Take yet another note
And write on it with pen like claw
All the former words in first draw,
Which Jehoiakim Judah’s king
Has burned *after his knife-cut’s sting*.
29 “And you’ll say to Jehoiakim
King of Judah, ‘So says YHWH grim:
“You have burned this roll, saying ‘Why
Have you written down such a cry,
Saying “The king of Babylon
Shall certainly come unwithdrawn
To destroy this land and shall take
From it both man and beast in stake?”’”
30 So says YHWH of Jehoiakim
King of Judah, “He’ll have none trim
To sit upon David’s throne; and
His dead body shall meet the sand
In the day of heat and the night
Of frost *and not put out of sight*.
31 “And I will punish him and his
Spawn and his servant for their biz,
And I will bring on them and on
Dwellers of Jerusalem’s spawn,
And on the men of Judah, all
The evil I have come to call
Against them but they’d not obey.”

32 Then Jeremiah took away
Another roll and gave it to
Baruch the scribe, Neriah's true
Son, who wrote down by the dictation
Of Jeremiah all the ration
Of words of the book which before
Jehoiakim king at the door
Of Judah had burned in the fire:
As well as more messages dire.

I doubt that Jehoiakim really can
Wield pen on parchment like a ready man.
The prophet and priest Jeremiah takes
A scribe professional for his own stakes.
I can myself produce a ready hand
If not too beautiful in tone to stand,
Not copperplate like that my great
granddad
Produced as county clerk, a job not bad.
But now my hand slips over keys instead
Before I leave my poetry for bed.
And with a stroke I quickly find me led
Into the realm of those who cannot write,
But only touch the wonders of their flight,
And still grip royal powers despite the
fright.

Jeremiah 37

1 King Zedekiah the son of
Josiah reigned in the stead of
Coniah Jehoiakim's son,
Whom Nebuchadrezzar when done
The king of Babylon made king
In the land of Judah *to sing*.
2 But neither he nor his servants
Nor the people of the land dance
According to the word of YHWH
Spoken by Jeremiah due,
The prophet *of Alohim too*.
3 And Zedekiah the king sent
Jehucal son of Shelemiah
And Zephaniah the son higher
Of Maaseiah the priest to say
To prophet Jeremiah's sway:
"Pray now to YHWH our Alohim
On our behalf *for what things seem*."
4 Jeremiah came in and went
Out among the people forspent;
For they'd not put him in the fort.
5 Then Pharaoh's army came in sport
Out of Egypt and when the men
Of the Chaldeans that again

Besieged Jerusalem hear that,
They left Jerusalem out flat.

Beloved, if You propose to make the men
Of Judah believe that Babylon's ken
Is to be established for time and good,
And Egypt to be mocked and knocked on
wood,
They You might have prevented the fell
fate
Of the Chaldeans running from the mate
Of Egypt when he shows his army's rate.
We can be thought to doubt Your prophet's
word
When reason, habit, and the plague
deferred
Give Egypt every prospect to be heard.
Why knuckle under Babylon because
Some prophet sang a song about its claws,
When Egypt clearly has a chance to make
The Chaldeans flee once more in its wake?

6 Then came the word of YHWH unto
The prophet Jeremiah due
7 "So says YHWH Israel's Alohim,
'So shall you say to Judah's cream,
The king who sent you out to Me
To enquire of My show, "So now see,
Pharaoh's army come out to help
Shall go back to Egypt with yelp.
8 "The Chaldeans shall come again
And fight against this town of men
And take it and burn *to the ground*
With fire *and all in it that's found*.'"
9 So says YHWH, "Don't deceive
yourselves,
Saying 'The Chaldeans like elves
Will surely go away from us,'
For they'll not leave *without a fuss*.
10 "Though you had struck down the whole
band
Of the Chaldeans at your hand,
And there remained just wounded men
Among them, still they should again
Get up each one from his own tent
And burn this city to prevent."

If You have in Your sovereignty appointed
The king of Babylon as Your anointed
Against Egyptian stare and empire's star,
You give but little evidence and far.
One prophet speaks for and another comes

To speak against the Chaldeans and gums.
What is a king to do before the stroke
Of empires on both sides of iron yoke,
And prophets sending no consistent sound?
One has to choose between them on the
ground.

A king can only do what looks the best,
And so far and for centuries the west
Has always in time come through and with
zest.

I too do what I can with what is found.

11 It happened that when the army
Of the Chaldeans on their spree
Was scattered from Jerusalem
For fear of Pharaoh's stratagem,
12 Then Jeremiah went out from
Jerusalem and then to come
To the land of Benjamin and
To separate himself from band
Of the folk. 13 He came to the gate
Of Benjamin, a captain late
Of the ward was there, and whose name
Was Irijah, the son of *shame*
Of Shelemiah, *who was* son
Of Hananiah *without pun*,

And he took Jeremiah prophet,
Saying "You are traitor to scoff at
To go to the Chaldeans' run."

14 And Jeremiah said "It's false,
I do not dance Chaldeans' waltz."
But he would not listen to him,
So Irijah took him with vim,
And brought Jeremiah back to
The princes. 15 And the princes too
Were angry with Jeremiah,
And stuck him and put under paw

In prison in the house of one
Scribe whose name was then Jonathan.
For they had made that prison's pew.

16 When Jeremiah came into
The dungeon and in the room's stew,
And Jeremiah had been there
For many days in captive share,

17 Then Zedekiah the king sent
And took him out and so he went
Secretly to the king who asked
In his house saying where he basked
Is there a message come from YHWH?
And Jeremiah said "Here's clue;
For so He says, you shall be taken
By the hand of the king *forsaken*

Of Babylon, I'm not mistaken."

18 Moreover Jeremiah said
To king Zedekiah outspread,
"What have I done in your offence,
Or against your servants and tents
That you've kept me inside the fence?

19 "Where are now your prophets who said
The king of Babylon outspread
Shall not come against you nor in
This land at all *to punish sin*?

20 "Hear now, please, my lord king, and let
My petition to you be met,
Not to send me back to the place
Of Jonathan the scribe to trace,
Lest I die there *before your face*."

21 So Zedekiah the king said
To put him in the courtyard spread
Of the prison and gave him bread
Each day from the bakers' street fed.

Beloved, in Your word prophets are the
ones

Who cantillate the Hebrew songs and runs,
And so I too am prophet of that sort,
Because I sing the Hebrew Psalms for
sport.

I'm lucky that I'm not confined to be
In Jonathan's rooms for the dungeonry,
But in the courtyard of the king I stand,
Upon the rocky shore and bosky land.
I come down from my garret day by day
To cantillate the ancient words in sway,
To join the magpies on the fence and pay
Respects to sorrel flowering end of May.
I even taste a bit of bread in tune
Within the sight of wood-duck and of loon.

Jeremiah 38

1 Then Shephatiah, son of Mattan,
And Gedaliah son to fatten
Of Pashur and Jucal the son
Of Shelemiah on the run,
And Pashur the son of Machiah,
Heard the message that Jeremiah
Has spoken to the people, saying:
7 "So says YHWH, 'The one who will stay
in

This city shall die by the sword,
By famine and by plague abhorred;
But the one that goes out to meet
The Chaldeans shall live for treat;
For he shall have his life as prize

And live to earn his living's guise.'
 3 "So says YHWH, 'This city indeed
 Will be given into the greed
 Of Babylon's king's army come
 To take it *into Christendom*.'"
 4 So the princes said to the king,
 We beg you, hand this man from string,
 For so he weakens all the hands
 Of the soldiers in this town's stands,
 And the power of the people too,
 By speaking such words in their view,
 For this man does not foster good
 To this folk, but their harm from hood.
 5 Then Zedekiah the king said,
 See, he is in your hand and led;
 For the king is not one to do
 Anything against folk and you.
 6 So they took Jeremiah too,
 And threw him in the pit and pew
 Of Machiah son of the king,
 That is in the court's prison wing,
 Let Jeremiah down with ropes.
 And in the dungeon without hopes
 There was no water, only mud,
 So Jeremiah sunk in crud.

The fact is Jeremiah casts up spells
 Against the people with the things he tells.
 If magic does not wield a way of power,
 Still such talk tends to weaken in an hour,
 And there are always those whose fearful
 hearts
 Will succumb to the wilderness of darts.
 Magicians and all prophets to the last
 Should be taken up by police and cast
 Into the hopeful pit when mud is fast.
 Beloved, I seek You at the royal door,
 And find the officers and stately whore,
 But nothing of Yourself I may adore.
 Perhaps You're taken in the king's new net
 And let down by new ropes. She what You
 get.

7 An Ethiopian servant of
 The king, a eunuch without glove
 In the king's house, heard they had put
 Jeremiah in dungeon's foot,
 While the king sat under the gate
 Of Benjamin *to shade his pate*.
 8 The servant of the king went out
 Of the king's house as with a shout
 To the king and he said as stout,

9 "My lord the king, these men have done
 Evil in all that they have won
 Against Jeremiah the prophet,
 Whom they have thrown in pit to scoff at;
 And he's about to die for lack
 Of food where he is on his back,
 For there's no more bread on the stack.
 10 So the king gave an order to
 The Ethiopian servant true,
 Saying "Take thirty men with you,
 And take up Jeremiah who
 Is prophet still out of the pit,
 Before he dies *or has a fit*."
 11 So the king's servant too the men
 With him and went into the den
 Of the king under treasury,
 And took from there old rags for free,
 And let them down by ropes, you see,
 Into the pit to Jeremiah.
 12 The Ethiopian servant then
 Said to Jeremiah in den,
 "Put these old rags in your armpits
 Under the cords to prevent splits.
 And Jeremiah did so too.
 13 So they pulled up by ropes and crew
 Jeremiah, and took him out
 Of the dungeon to stand up stout,
 And Jeremiah then stayed in
 The court of the prison *to win*.

It is no racist slur, perhaps, that one
 Of African birth vying under sun
 Alone thought of Your prophet where he
 sat

In mud within the pit without a mat.
 And he alone thought to soften the cord
 That might have cut the armpits once
 restored.

It is no racist slur, perhaps, to note
 An Ethiopian came out and smote
 The persecution of Your friend and that
 Sweet singer of the prophecies out flat.
 Beloved, let every royal lodge and court
 Boast of at least one Ethiopic sport
 To soften the blows of human report
 And cushion Your judgement against the
 fat.

14 Then Zedekiah the king sent,
 And took Jeremiah unbent,
 The prophet to him to the third
 Entry that is in the house heard

Of YHWH, and the king spoke aloud
To Jeremiah: "Without shroud
I'll ask you, so answer uncowed."

15 The Jeremiah spoke unto
Zedekiah, "If I tell you,
Will you not surely kill me too?
And if I give you good advice,
Will you not listen in a trice?"

16 So Zedekiah the king swore
In secret on the royal floor
To Jeremiah, and he said
"As YHWH lives that made this soul led,
I will not put you to death nor
Will I give you into the store
Of the men who would kill you more."

17 Then Jeremiah said to him,
"So says YHWH Alohim not dim
Of armies, Israel's Alohim,
'If you will certainly take scheme
To surrender to the king of
Babylon's princes, then for shove
Your soul shall live, and this town not
Be burned with fire, and in your lot
You'll live as well as your spawn's plot.

18 "But if you don't surrender now
To king of Babylon's chief how,
Then this town will be given to
The power of the Chaldean crew,
And they shall burn it with fire too,
And you will not escape the brew."

The prophet is so sure of future hope
And the distress of Judah in its scope
That he does not back down, but gives the
word

In secret as well as in writ that stirred
The heart of king and officer preferred.
The king believes prediction whets his
tongue

And not the magic spells of weakened
rung,

And so comes to assure himself of all
That You reveal upon the glittered ball.
Beloved, I too seek truth among the pales
Of those predictions of disaster's wails,
And find them beached for flippers and
their tails.

Spout once if by land, two if by the sea
I come to meet my last eternity.

19 And Zedekiah the king said
To Jeremiah, "I am led

By fear of the Jews that have fled
To the Chaldeans, lest they take
Me up as mockery at stake."

20 And Jeremiah said, "Not they,
They will not turn you, but obey,
Please, the voice of YHWH that I say,
So it shall go well with you and
Your soul shall live and come to stand.

21 "But if your refuse to go out,
This is YHWH word come with a shout:

22 'See all the women that are left
In the king of Judah's house cleft
Shall be brought out before the king
Of Babylon's princes in ring
And those women shall say a thing:

"Your friends have set you and have yet
Prevailed against you with their set,
And your feet are stuck in the mud,
And they have turned back *from the flood.*"

23 "So they shall bring out all your wives
And your children into the hives
Of the Chaldeans, and you shall not
Escape out of their hand and plot,
But shall be taken by the hand
Of the king of Babylon grand,
And you shall cause this city here
To be burned up with fire and fear."

Kings are not free to do the thing they
wish,

But must take to heart every kind of dish
That shows a face in court and in intrigue,
And know who is in power and in league.
So Zedekiah feared the ones who spoke
In favour of Egyptian sort of yoke,
And those who had turned coat and gone to
make

Peace with the Chaldeans for city's sake.
Beloved, kings fear all parties, and their
heirs

In democratic forms for lack of stairs
Fear every lobby that wilds but sixpence
To vote them out of office into tents.
Let me fear You alone, Beloved, to whom
I turn in flight from myself and Your doom.

24 Then Zedekiah spoke again
To Jeremiah from his den,
"Let no man know these words at all,
And you shall not die *at the wall.*
25 "But if the princes hear that I
Have talked with you and they come by

And say to you, 'Now tell us what
 You told the king and do not shut
 It from us and we won't kill you,
 And also what the king said too,'
 26 "Then you shall say to them, 'I set
 My petition to the king met
 Not to put me back in the house
 Of Jonathan to die *like mouse*.'"
 27 Then all the princes came to ask
 Jeremiah about the task,
 And he told them according to
 The words the king ordered him to.
 So they left off speaking with him,
 And did not know that it was grim.
 28 So Jeremiah stayed to live
 In prison court definitive
 Until the day Jerusalem
 Was taken by the stratagem,
 And he was there when the town fell
To Babylon and to Babel.

When You, Beloved, come with the eastern
 kings
 To find my shelter in the court that rings
 With praise and the presumption that out
 flings
 From sweet and Christian sacrificial wings,
 Find me bereft and barren still, though tide
 Of hope and harrowing is at my side.
 The petty policies of market life
 Go all about me head and hand for strife,
 And yet I stand aloof by every hand,
 Made no participant of any band.
 Beloved, when You enter the golden gate
 And all bow beneath Your foot in their fate,
 Release me from the prison and the court,
 Remember that I cried to You in sport.

Jeremiah 39

1 In the ninth year of Zedekiah,
 The king of Judah, tenth month nigher,
 Came Nebuchadnezzar the king
 Of Babylon and all his sting
 Of army to Jerusalem,
 And they laid siege against its hem.
 2 Zedekiah's eleventh year,
 In the fourth month, and so to steer
 On the ninth of the month, the town
 Was broken up, *its walls thrown down*.
 3 And all the princes of the king
 Of Babylon came in a ring
 And sat in the middle gate, all:

Nergalsharezer by the wall,
 Samgarnebo, Sarsechim too,
 Rabсарis, as well in his pew
 Nergalsharezer and Rabmag,
 With all the residue rag-tag
 Of princes of Babylon's king.
 4 It happened when Zedekiah
 The king of Judah came and saw
 And all the men of war, they fled
 And left the city by night led
 By way of the king's garden, by
 The gate between the two walls nigh,
 And he went out the valley road.
 5 But Chaldeans in army strode
 After him and overtook him,
 Zedekiah near to the brim
 Of Jericho, and when they had
 Taken him, they brought him up sad
 To Nebuchadnezzar the king
 Of Babylon to Riblah's wing
 In the land of Hamath, where he
 Gave judgement upon his degree.

The irony is that when Jeremiah
 Fled from Jerusalem the captain crier
 Caught him before he entered Jericho.
 The same thing happened in the royal show
 To Zedekiah when he sneaked at night.
 Jeremiah travelled there in plain sight.
 Beloved, I have been caught by evil crew,
 By hand of the police, by legal brew,
 Though innocent and more so than Your
 man
 This Jeremiah with politics' scan.
 I too have been caught in strength of
 daylight.
 Send all who laid a hand on me for spite
 As refugees at midnight but to find
 The catcher catching them before, behind.

6 Then the king of Babylon killed
 The sons of Zedekiah filled
 In Riblah there before his eyes,
 Babylon's king without disguise
 Also killed all his noble guys.
 7 And then he put out the king's eyes,
 That's Zedekiah's, and put him
 In chains to take him captive grim
 To Babylon. 8 House of the king,
 And house of the folk in their sting
 The Chaldeans burned down with fire,
 Broke Jerusalem's walls in ire.

9 Then Nebuzaradan the chief
Of the guard carried off in grief
To Babylon the people left
In the city, and those as deft
Who had joined him, along with those
Of the folk remaining in rows.

10 But of the poor who had no wealth,
Those Nebuzaradan for health
Chief of the guard, left in the land
Of Judah and he gave in hand
To them vineyards and fields to stand
On the same day *of the disband*.

The thing You told to Jeremiah came
To pass in the very way of Your claim.
Your error was in not giving enough
Evidence You were speaking in the tough.
You sit ensconced in sovereign majesty
And look out over kingdoms and the sea
And do not realize how misty things can
be.

The dangers lurking in intrigue and dark,
The hidden mugger slinking in the park,
Are things unknown to You, at least in fear.
You know, but we wait for things to
appear.

So Your prophet turned out right in the end.
But choices were made before turn of bend,
Before the clarity of clang and gear.

11 And Nebuchadnezzar the king
Of Babylon gave charge to sing
Of Jeremiah, by the hand
Of Nebuzaradan to stand
As chief of the guard in command:

12 Take him and keep him under eye
Not to do harm to him for why,
But deal with him just as he hopes.

13 Nebuzaradan in his scopes
As chief of the guard sent the men
Nebushasban, Rabсарis then,
And Nergalsharezer as well
As Rabmag and the chiefs to tell
Of all the king of Babylon.

14 They sent and took Jeremiah
Out of the prison court withdrawn
And put him in the hand and paw
Of Gedaliah who was son
Of Ahikam, and Shaphan's son,
That he should take him home; so he
Lived there with his own family.

The fact that Nebuchadnezzar gave weight
Of hope and health in Jeremiah's fate
Is just more evidence the captain's right
Who caught him and arrested him in flight.
Collaboration with invaders must
Precede the raising of a man from dust,
And so the happy end and happy thrust,
When others lost their eyes as well as trust,
Makes one think Jeremiah had a will
Political and traitorous to fill.
Beloved, You might have left Your man to
be

Free of the royal deed and royal fee.
Then others might believe innocence.

15 Now YHWH's word came to Jeremiah,
While he was shut up in the mire
Of the prison court and He said:

16 "Go tell the king's servant who is
An Ethiopian and whiz,
Saying 'So says YHWH of hosts, who
Is Israel's Alohim in view,
"See, I will bring My words upon
This town for evil and not dawn
Of good; and they shall come to pass
In that day before you, alas.

17 "And I will save you in that day,"
Says YHWH, "and you shall go your way,
And not be given in the fray
Into the power of men for prey.

18 "For I will certainly save you,
And you'll not fall by the sword's cue,
But your life shall be your own prize,
Since you have trusted Me," says
YHWH."

The sweetness and the empathy once
shown

By Ethiopian behind the throne
To Jeremiah in the prison pit
You will reward with Your salvation fit.
I too have met once or twice in my life
An Ethiopian and without strife
Found sweetness and an empathy to share
Beyond the run of gill, beyond the fair.
Beloved, the Ethiopian cannot
Change skin, nor leopard yet a single spot,
For which I'm glad. It would be truly sad
If Ethiopian too became bad.

You give to every nation for its own
Gifts evident and others to be shown.

Jeremiah 40

1 The message that came from YHWH to
Jeremiah after that crew
Of Nebuzaradan the chief
Of the guard had for his relief
Let him go from Ramah when he
Had taken him in chains' degree
Among all those carried away
Captive from Jerusalem's sway
And Judah, those who went at drawn
Captive *in chains* to Babylon.
2 And the captain of the guard took
Jeremiah and said to look,
"YHWH your Alohim has declared
Evil upon this place He shared.
3 "Now YHWH's brought and done what
He said,
Because you sinned against YHWH's
spread,
And have not obeyed His voice, so
This thing has come on you *to show*.
4 "And now, see, I release you now
From the chains on your hand *and brow*.
And if you want to come with me
To Babylon, then come freely,
And I will look after you well;
But if you don't want a place to dwell
With my in Babylon, then stay;
See all the land is in your way,
Wherever it seems best to you,
Go there and there live in your pew.
5 Before he went back then he said
"Go back also and so be led
To Gedaliah who is son
Of Ahikam who's Shaphan's son,
The one the king of Babylon
Has made the governor to sit
Over the towns of Judah fit,
And stay with him among the folk;
Or go wherever you invoke."
So the chief of the guard gave him
Victuals and a reward and trim
Let him go where he would with vim.
6 Then Jeremiah went back to
Gedaliah Ahikam's crew
In Mizpeh; and lived with him there
Among the folk left in land's share.

The pagan captains turned the prophet in
To the hand of the governor to win,
Who gave the man both food and place to
live,

And a reward for what he had to give.
I guess that shows it's possible to keep
The pure word and divine among the sheep
With pastors who take gain for what they
do.
I should have thought corruption's then in
view.
Beloved, I've fed a sheep or two in time,
I've also slaughtered sheep if that's a
crime,
Like many pastors do. Give me reward,
The golden coin of sunrise and restored
The brazen, flaming bills of sun that sets,
And I will have the gains of hedging bets.

7 When all the army chiefs in field,
They and their men heard of the yield,
How Babylon's king had set up
Gedaliah Ahikam's tup
As governor in the land, and
Committed to him men to stand
And women and children and poor
Of the land, of those not bourn sure
As captive into Babylon;
8 They came to Gedaliah drawn
To Mizpeh, that is Ishmael
The son of Nethaniah's spell,
And Johanan and Jonathan
The sons of Kareah as can,
And Jezaniah the son of
A Maachathite, men at the shove.
9 Gedaliah Ahikam's son
The son of Shaphan swore when don
To them and to their men to say
"Don't be afraid to serve in sway
The Chaldeans; stay in the land,
And serve Babylon's king and stand,
And it shall be well with your hand.
10 As for me, I will live indeed
At Mizpeh and serve as by need
The Chaldeans who came to us.
But you gather grape juice and muss
And summer fruit and oil and put
Them in your store vessels by foot
And live in your towns with your seed."

The king of Babylon came by
And no one even asked him why
He wanted slaves and wives and rings
As well as gold and all such things.
He took the rich away to be
Adornments on his Christmas tree.

The prophets warned them for their
sinnings
That they stood well to lose their winnings.
Beloved, You warn the people and
The world astride the great bandstand.
But still the empty value placed
On power and metal goes untraced.
The wine and fruit and oil retire
Before the silver-stringed lyre.

The poor oppressed were left behind
To live wherever they could find
In empty cities' palaces,
To drink from crystal chalices
The king of Babylon left there
Because he thought they'd break
somewhere
Before he got to Babylon
With donkeys for to pack them on.
And so these poor had oil and wine
For the first time perhaps to dine.
They had the love of mercy since
Their suffering with the former prince.
Beloved, You never did forsake
The poor left in the battle's wake.

But they ate fruit instead of bread
To show that when all's done and said,
They were not free, but served the king
And for protection had to sing.
If oil is as dear Micah said
To love mercy, and if the bread
Is doing justly, while the wine
Is walking humbly with You, fine,
Then I shall give up eating fruit,
If that is keeping the king's suit.
Give me the bread of justice for
My apple and my peach's store.
And I, Beloved, shall dine with You
In woollen gown and without shoe.

11 Likewise when all the Jews who stayed
In Moab, Ammonites waylaid,
And in Edom, and all the lands
Heard that Babylon's king in hands
Had left a remnant in Judah,
And set over them hand and claw
Gedaliah Ahikam's son,
The son of Shaphan said and done,
12 Then all the Jews came back from there,
From the places of refuge bare,
And came to Judah's land to share,

To Gedaliah in Mizpeh,
And gathered wine and at a draw
Much summer fruit to keep in lair.
13 Moreover Johanan the son
Of Kareah, and the chiefs won
Of the bands that were in the fields,
Came to Gedaliah with shields
In Mizpeh, 14 and they said to him,
"Do you know that Baalis for vim
The king of the Ammonites sent
Ishmael Nethaniah's son spent
To kill you? But Gedaliah
The son of Ahikam for straw
Did not believe admonishment.
15 Johanan Kareah's son spoke
To Gedaliah at a stroke
In Mizpeh secretly and said
"Let me go, please, and I'll be led
To kill Ishmael who is the son
Of Nethaniah, and no one
Shall know; why should he kill you so
All the Jews gathered here in show
To you should be scattered again
And what remains of Judah's men?
16 Gedaliah Ahikam's son
Said to Johanan who was son
Of Kareah, "Don't do this thing,
You speak falsely of Ishmael's sling.

Jeremiah 41

1 To wit, in the seventh month came
Ishmael Nethaniah's son's flame
The son of Elishama and
Of royal family and band
And of the royal officers,
To Gedaliah with ten fers,
To the son of Ahikam there
At Mizpeh, and they ate their share
Of bread in Mizpeh to be fair.

Now Ishmael had no time for fruit,
He gave up oil and wine to boot.
He wanted freedom for his bread,
And so he made a plot instead
Of serving foreign kings their taxes.
He made a store of spears and axes
And under pretence of good peace
He fooled the governor's police
And at a banquet of friendship
He stabbed the poor man in the hip.
That comes of thinking just of bread
And leaving wine and oil unshed.

Ishmael of royal seed, pariah,
Thought that he was the Jews' messiah.

2 Up Ishmael son of Nathaniah
Got and the ten men of pariah
With him and struck down Gedaliah
The son of Ahikam the son
Of Shaphan with the sword to run
Through him and kill him, whom the king
Of Babylon set governing.

3 And Ishmael also killed the Jews
All that were with him in their crews,
With Gedaliah at Mizpeh,
And the Chaldeans men of awe.

4 It happened on the second day
After he killed Gedaliah,
No one knew that he'd gone astray.

5 There came some from Shechem and
from

Shiloh in Samaria's hum,
Eighty men with beards shaven and
Their clothing torn, and cut in band,
With offerings and incense in hand,
To bring them to the house of YHWH.

I'd always thought it was a heathen try
That let the folk cut and bleed in the rye.
They did the thing when one came on the
mount
Of Carmel with water barrels for fount.
But here the true and lovely cut themselves
As though they danced and prayed to satyr
elves.

I'll have to curb the tongues the criticise
Ashura's slashing of foreheads and thighs,
The bleeding backs of those who weep
aloud

For Husseyn and the martyrs in their
crowd.

Beloved, I join the vast procession where
The lovely and unlovely come to share
In grief to beat their chests with pain laid
bare,
And thirst beneath sun on Karbela's care.

6 And Ishmael son of Nathaniah
Went out of Mizpeh as a crier
All along as he went and when
It happened that he met those men,
He told them, "Come to Gedaliah
The son of Ahikam *and higher.*"

7 And when they came into the town,

Ishmael Nathaniah's renown
Son killed them, threw them in the pit,
He and the men with him as fit.

8 But ten men among them replied
To Ishmael, "Don't kill us, abide,
For we have treasures of grain too,
And barley, oil and honey dew."
So he refrained from killing them
Among their brothers' stratagem.

Ten men were saved for bread and mercy.
Good at avoiding controversy,
They had no wine nor thought of God,
But they had honey, which was odd.
Instead of divine ecstasy,
Their sweet talk gave them amnesty.
Sweet talk has passed for good religion
More times than crow has passed for
pigeon.

Beloved, I drink in You the sweet
That I a honey-bee find meet.
I sip Your wine of ecstasy
As I walk with You most humbly.
I give my life and acts and breath
And stand with ten, or go to death.

9 And the pit where Ishmael had thrown
All the carcasses of the blown,
Whom he had killed for Gedaliah,
Was the one Asa the king made
For fear of Baasha on parade
The king of Israel, and so
Ishmael son of Nathaniah
Filled it with those killed on the go.

10 Then Ishmael carried off the rest
Of the folk in Mizpeh with zest
As captives, the king's daughters too,
And all the people left in pew
Of Mizpeh, whom Nebuzaradan
The chief of the guard had once laid on
Gedaliah Ahikam's son;
And Ishmael son of Nathaniah
Carried them captive on their bun,
And went to Ammonites' pariah.

Ishmael takes refuge in Ammon awhile
From heathen hand and tongue to gain a
mile.

Ishmael though murderer has earned a
smile.

Let me take my ten captives in the way,

The ten words that You spoke in grand display,
 And carry them to Ammon as in feast
 To wait the coming of my faith increased.
 Beloved, rejoice with me that I'm alive,
 And not among the faithful in the hive
 Who fell before the sword for being trim
 With Nebuchadnezzar both strong and grim.
 I whisk away the crumbs and lift the glass
 Of tea and mint to see the nations pass
 Before the refugees of gold and brass.

11 When Johanan Kareah's son
 And all the chiefs of the bands won
 That were with him heard the bad news
 Of what Ishmael the son in strews
 Of Nethaniah did in crews,
 12 Then they took all the men and went
 To fight with Ishmael and the spent
 Son of Nethaniah and found
 Him by the great waters renowned
 That are in Gibeon's abound.
 13 It happened when all the folk that
 Were with Ishmael saw that out flat
 Johanan son of Kareah
 And all the chiefs of armies draw
 With him then they were glad *and sat*.
 14 So all the folk that Ishmael stole
 Away captive from Mizpeh's roll
 Turned round and went back with Johanan
 The son of Kareah for planning.
 15 But Ishmael Methaniah's son
 Escaped from Johanan to run
 With eight men to the Ammonites.
 16 Then Johanan son of Kareah,
 And all the chiefs of armies freer
 That were with him and all the rest
 Of the folk who returned at best
 From Ishmael son of Methaniah
 From Mizpeh, after he pariah
 Had secretly killed Gedaliah
 The son of Ahikam as well
 As the soldiers and women's spell
 And children and eunuchs whom he
 Had brought back from Gibeon's fee.
 17 And they left and stayed in a place
 Of Chimham by Bethlehem's trace,
 Ready to flee to Egypt's face,
 18 Because of the Chaldeans' race,
 For they were afraid of them since
 Ishmael Nethaniah's born quince

Killed Gedaliah son of old
 Ahikam, Babylon's king told
 To rule the land *for hot or cold*.

And yet what did poor Gedaliah do
 But submit to Your will come into view?
 He might have kept the lowly in their state,
 And near to Jerusalem for their fate,
 If Ishmael had not come to split his pate.
 Beloved, the ones who claim with louder
 voice
 To serve You with the arms of greater
 choice
 Reward the world and week with violence
 That dissipates what's left of flour and
 pence.
 It was so in that ancient day and now
 It is the rule of life on hand and brow
 That violence begets the which and how
 Of grief and pain for everyone around,
 The rich as well as poor upon the ground.

Jeremiah 42

1 Then all the chiefs of armies and
 Johanan Kareah's son's hand
 And Jezaniah who was son
 Of Hoshaiiah, and all the run
 Of folk from the least to the best,
 Came near, 2 and said as though for test
 To Jeremiah the prophet,
 "Please let our supplication met
 Be accepted before you and
 Pray for us to YHWH Alohim,
 For all these people left that seem
 So few left from so many scanned,
 3 "That YHWH your Alohim may show
 Us the way by which we should go,
 And what thing we should do below."
 4 Jeremiah the prophet said
 To them, "I have heard you in dread,
 See I will pray YHWH Alohim
 According to your words and dream,
 And it shall happen what YHWH shows
 In answer I'll give blows by blows,
 And keep back nothing from the rows."
 5 They said to Jeremiah "YHWH
 Be true and faithful witness too
 Between us, if we do not do
 According to what then says YHWH
 Your Alohim to us in view.
 6 "Be it good or not we'll obey
 The voice of YHWH our Alohim,

To whom we send you now to pray,
That it may be well in our scheme,
When we obey the voice of YHWH
Our Alohim *in what we do.*"

Give me, Beloved, that ancient faith that
cried

To Jeremiah after all the tide
Of heathen interventions on their pride.
Let me, beloved, obey Your voice and true
And whether good or evil, let me do
According to the word spoke on the mount
And writ with divine hand to an account.
"Be it good or not we'll obey" remains
The watchword of my heart instead of
gains

While I tramp over cobblestones to find
The harbour and the lake with islands
rined.

The shallow days rock me to slumber
stilled,

But when I hear Your word, my heart is
filled

With new life to regard what I have killed.

7 It happened after ten days that
The word of YHWH came down where sat
Jeremiah. 8 And so he called
Johanan Kareah's son hauled,
And all the chiefs of armies that
Were with him and all the folk from
The least to the best, every bum.
9 He said to them, "So now says YHWH
The Alohim of Israel's crew,
To whom you sent me to present
Your supplication at His tent.

10 "If you'll stay quiet in this land,
Then I will build you by My hand
And not pull down, and I will plant
And not pluck up by covenant,
For I've turned back from evil scheme
That I have done to you *in beam.*

11 "Don't fear the king of Babylon,
The one you're scared of do not shun,'
Says YHWH, 'for I'm with you to save,
Delivering from his power *and grave.*

12 "And I will show mercies to you,
So he will have mercy and do
Good to you and make you return
To your own land for *what you earn.*

13 "But if you say "We'll not stay here,
Nor shall we obey giving ear

To the voice of YHWH Alohim,
14 "Saying "No, but we'll follow scheme
To go down into Egypt's land,
Where we shall see no war at hand,
Nor hear the sound of trumpet call,
Nor be hungry for bread at all,
And so we'll live there in our wall,""
15 And now therefore hear YHWH's word,
you

Remnant of Judah and its crew,
So says YHWH of hosts, Alohim
Of Israel, "If you but dream
To set your faces to go to
Egypt and then go down there too,
16 "Then it shall be the sword you feared
Shall overtake you there arreared
In Egypt's land, the famine you
Feared shall follow close after you
There in Egypt and you'll die too."

But such religion soon turns weak,
For all it is is wind and reek.
When in a tight place all they had
To bet was bread, and that was bad.
In bread they touched security
From vengeance in the poor Chaldee.
They knew no mercy, knew no grace,
And so they feared the strong king's face.
The ones who only think of bread
In time of famine are not fed.
Beloved, let me find in Your store
Oil, wine and bread and nothing more.

The asked the prophet what to do.
He said "Sit tight, take off your shoe."
Because they had no oil or wine,
But took bread only as life-line,
They fled to Egypt from the king
Instead of telling him the thing
That Ishmael did was not their fault.
He runs who fears a just assault,
And cannot quite believe when told
That mercy too is just as old.
The oil and wine they thought to save
For situations far less grave.
They trusted in You, God, the most
When danger was not on their coast.

17 So shall it be with all the men
That set their faces once again
To go to Egypt to live there;
They shall die by the sword made bare,

By famine and by pestilence;
 And not of them shall stay in tents
 Escaping from the evil I
 Will bring on them *if they but fly*.
 18 For so says YHWH of hosts, the God
 Of Israel upon the sod,
 "As My anger and fury are
 Poured out upon the popular
 Of Jerusalem, so shall My
 Wrath be poured on you when you fly
 To Egypt, and you'll be a curse,
 Astonishment and something worse
 Than a reproach and you shall see
 This place no more eternally."
 YHWH has said of you, you who're left
 Of Judah, "Do not go bereft
 Into Egypt, but know for sure
 That I've warned you today secure.
 20 "For you showed yourselves in your
 souls
 Perverse when you sent for My tolls
 To YHWH you Alohim to say
 Pray from us to YHWH Alohim,
 And all YHWH Alohim shall bray,
 So proclaim to us all the scheme
 And we will do it *in a team*."
 21 And I declare to you today,
 And you have not come to obey
 The voice of YHWH your Alohim,
 Nor anything He gives *in scheme*.
 22 So now know for sure by the sword
 By famine and by the plague gored
 You'll die in the place you've desired
 To go and live there *in house hired*.

The principle is clear to see and needs
 No evidence divine for which it pleads.
 The way of safety in this world is just
 To keep a low profile down in the dust.
 The rich wish to get richer for the view
 Of power and security in their pew,
 But wealth just draws attention to the crew,
 And with increase, security lies down
 And opens up the doors to all the town.
 Have nothing worth the stealing is the best
 Way not to be beleaguered in the west,
 And have no power at all, then none will
 fall
 To ravaging an empty temple's stall.
 Beloved, my wealth is just a song and call.

Jeremiah 43

1 It happened that when Jeremiah
 Had finished speaking such pariah
 To all the people at the word
 Of YHWH their Alohim who stirred
 Him as YHWH their Alohim to
 Speak all these messages in view,
 2 Azariah Hoshaiiah's son,
 And Johanan Kareah's son,
 And all the proud men on their bun,
 Spoke to Jeremiah to say
 "Falsehood only's your speech today,
 YHWH our Alohim did not send
 You to say 'Don't go down and bend
 In Egypt to live there and fend.'
 3 "But Baruch Neriah's son sets
 You on against us for regrets,
 To give us over in the power
 Of the Chaldeans who are sour
 To put us all to death and take
 Us captives in Babylon's wake."
 4 So Johanan Kareah's son,
 And all the chiefs of forces won,
 And all the people did not stay
 Obeying the voice of YHWH's way,
 To dwell in Judah's land *a prey*.
 5 But Johanan Kareah's son,
 And all the chiefs of forces won,
 Took all the remnant of Judah
 That had returned from nations' claw
 Where they'd been driven, to live in
 The land of Judah *without sin*,
 6 Men, women, children, and king's
 daughters,
 And every person that the plotters
 Nebusaradan chief of guard
 Had left with Gedaliah hard
 The son of Ahikam the son
 Of Shaphan, and Jeremiah
 The prophet and Baruch in paw
 Who was the son of Neriah.
 7 So they came into Egypt's land,
 For they obeyed not YHWH's command,
 They came to Tahpanhes in band.
 Beloved, that's just the reason why I do
 Not belong to any established crew
 Of religion upon the face of earth.
 They took Your prophet Jeremiah worth
 The sun and moon and forced him in a
 march
 To Egypt to remain alive and parch.
 I'd rather come out of Babylon's share

As well as Egypt's and remain to stare
Alone at my woods green with spring and
fair

With blossoms of bird cherry than to go
Against Your commandments left out of
tow.

If there is any church or mosque or creed
That accepts all ten of them in their need,
Then I will embrace it in all my greed.

8 Came word of YHWH to Jeremiah

In Tahpanhes, to say pariah,

9 "Take two big stones in hand and hide

Them in the brick kiln clay inside,

Which is at the gate of the house

Of Pharaoh in Tahpanhes chouse,

In view of Judah's men to bide.

10 "Say to them, 'So says YHWH of hosts,

The Alohim of Israel's boasts;

"See, I will send and take the king

Of Babylon Nebuchadrezzar,

My servant and will set and bring

His throne upon these stones in friezer

That I have hidden, and he'll spread

His royal tent over their bed.

11 "And when he comes, he'll strike the
land

Of Egypt and at death's command

Such will die, and captivity

Will take its prey's activity,

And such ones fated for the sword

Will come by the sword to be gored.

12 "And I will kindle then a fire

In gods of Egypt's houses dire,

And he shall burn them and then take

Away their captives in his wake

Arrayed in land of Egypt's sake,

Just like a shepherd comes to don

His cloak and in success be drawn.

13 "He'll break down standing pillars yet

Of the house of the sun to set,

That's in the land of Egypt met,

And houses of Egyptian gods

He'll burn with fire *to ash and clods.* ""

The sun cult of the Bronze Age had its
roots

In agriculture, say the men in boots.

With archaeology armed to the teeth

With arguments well-founded underneath,

The temple of the sun rises to find

The wheat and barley of the ones who
dined.

It's known by every river where the flood
Scares up the hope of harvest in the bud,
From Egypt to the rise in the east,
The sun-god reigns over both man and
beast.

Beloved, I turn my back on every flower
Of idol and in generation's hour
Seek You out, my Creator in Your power.
Let suns and harvests lie where they
increased.

Jeremiah 44

1 The word that came to Jeremiah

Concerning all the Jews to hire

In the land of Egypt, who dwell

At Migdol, Tahpanhes as well

As Noph, and Pathros' land,

Saying 2 Says YHWH of hosts at hand,

The Alohim of Israel: "You

Have seen all the evil I do

Upon Jerusalem and on

All the cities of Judah drawn;

And see today they lie desert,

And no one lives there all inert,

3 "Because of wickedness which they

Committed to provoke My way

To wrath, when they went down to pray

With incense to other gods' sway

Whom they did not know, neither they,

You nor your ancestors *for hurt.*

4 "Still I sent you all My servants

The prophets, getting up to prance

Early and sending them to say

Don't do this horrid thing, I pray.

5 "But they did not listen a bit,

Nor turn their ear from wicked fit,

To burn no incense on the sod

To every kind of other god.

6 "That's why My fury and My wrath

Was pour out and upon their path,

And was lit up in Judah's towns,

Streets of Jerusalem in frowns,

And they are waste and desolate

As at this day *they lie in state.* "

All people follow the most common way,
And hardly notice difference when they
stray.

Just as the sweet Christian alive today
Does not consider when he comes to pray

That praying to a trinity is more
Like prayer to Baal and Ashtoreth in store
Than prayer to You, unique, alone and One
And Sovereign of the earth, the sea and sun.

You blame the folk for heathendom, but they
Are hardly away of the golden ray
The separates the gods of kingdom here
From You who made all things to love and fear.

The incense that was offered in Your name
Was tainted by the false concept to blame.

7 So says YHWH Alohim of hosts,
The Alohim of Israel's boasts,
"Why do you do great evil here
Against your souls, to cut off near
You man and woman, child and dear,
Out of Judah so none remain?
8 "In that you provoke Me again
To wrath with the works of your hands,
Burning incense against commands
To other gods in Egypt's lands,
Where you have gone to live and dwell,
So you cut yourselves off in spell,
So you might be a curse and mirth
Among the nations of the earth?

9 "Did you forget the evil sad
That your ancestors did and had,
The wickedness of Judah's kings,
The evil of their wives in flings,
And your own wickedness to boot,
The wickedness of your wives' suit,
Which they've committed in the land
Of Judah, and on every hand
Of the streets of Jerusalem?

10 "They have not humbled diadem
To this day, neither have they feared,
Nor walked in My law nor been steered
By My statues, that I have set
Before you and your fathers met."

Few are contrite for doing what all men
Around them do: in some years and some den

They bow in crowd to Father, Son and Ghost,

In others they bow merely to the boast
Of wealth, and on a cruise around the world
Many idols are set out and unfurled,
And all receive the homage of the crowd,

Set by public opinion and allowed.
You insist that the word upon the Mount,
The prohibition at the bitter fount,
That says that You alone by name of YHWH

May be worshipped by father, son and crew.

Insistence of that kind is quaint though true,
And never will convince the poor and proud.

11 So says YHWH of hosts, Alohim
Of Israel, "See I shall deem
To set My face against you here
For evil and cut off the gear
Of all Judah *cast out in beam*.

12 "And I will take the remnant lost
Of Judah that set face in cost
To go into Egypt's land where
They will sojourn and come to share
In the burning and so shall fall
In Egypt's land, under the pall
Of the sword and by famine nigh,
Least to the greatest, they shall die,
By sword and famine and remain
An execration, curse and stain,
Astonishment, reproach and cry.

13 "For I will punish those who dwell
In Egypt's land, as I cast spell
Upon Jerusalem and by
Sword, famine, and the plague to die.

14 "So none of Judah's remnant which
Went down to Egypt's land to pitch
Their tents shall escape or remain,
That they should return to the plain
Of Judah, as they do desire
To return to live there in quire:
For none shall return but the few
Who shall escape *Egyptian pew*.

Egypt is one thing, but it has its place.
Wherever a man is, he finds Your face
Before him in the flight or in the trace
Of searching for eternity and grace.
The ancient land of Egypt is still sweet,
Though as Your prophet promises in feat,
No power to reckon with along the way.
After Babylon others come in sway.
But Egypt still remains, the Nile and care
Of date palm and of green fields for their share.

Beloved, I've met more more than once to
see

In Egypt in the desert and the lea
Of pyramid and promise of degree.
Meet me once more in Egypt if I'm there.

15 Then all the men who knew their wives
Had burned incense to other drives,
And all the women who stood near,
A great crowd, all the folk in gear
Who lived in Egypt's land to stay
In Pathros answered him to say
To Jeremiah on that day:

16 "The message you have told to us
In the name of YHWH with a fuss,
We shall not hear, obey or muss.

17 "But we'll do what we say ourselves,
Burn incense to sky-queen or elves,
And pour out drink offerings to her,
As we have done, we every fer,
And our ancestors and our kings,
And our princes in Judah's wings,
And in streets of Jerusalem,
For then we had plenty in hem,
Both food and gear and we were well,
With no bad thing in Israel.

But since we left of burning that
Incense to the sky-queen in fat,
And pouring out drink offerings there,
We have lacked every thing to wear,
And been devoured by sword to share
In famine *in store and on mat.*"

19 The women also came to say
"And did we burn incense that day
To the sky-queen and pour the pay
Of drink offerings to her that way,
And make her cakes and then to pray,
And pour out drink offering to her
With out husbands' consent concur?"

In Egypt when the coast was clear
And there was nothing more to fear,
When there was bread to eat in plenty
For one or ten or even twenty,
Material socialism seemed
Less beautiful than they had dreamed.
So wine and incense found a place
To make their houses no disgrace.
Religion came to life again
With wine of god to drink, but then
The oil of mercy disappeared.
They got the habit when they feared.

And so incense became their stay
Appeasing gods for when they pray.

The smell of fear was clothed in sweetness,
The queen of heaven in discreetness
Implored for help with cakes and wine
But without oil to make them shine.
And so their atheism sent
Them on a new religious bent
That sees salvation as the goal
Ignoring bridges of the soul
That seek out You with hungry zeal
To love You in both woe and weal,
Not asking any pay or prize
For making such a compromise.
Self-seeking faith makes for cold hearts
And pompous clergy of old farts.

The faith of oil asks not a crumb
Nor kingship in millennium.
It only asks that You be free
To breathe from now eternally.
It only asks that You be bread
By which the soul is daily fed.
It only asks for mercy that
Where You are that is where I'm at.
Two faiths abound here in this world:
The faith of bread alone impearled
And faith of bread and incense-wine.
These two are both quite infantine.
They lead us out of phantom fears
Into a land of shades and tears.

By bread alone or by salvation
Is selfish faith in any nation.
But oil can turn the soul above
To selfless faith in burning love.
The oil ignited in the heart
Burns in relentless counterpart,
And ceaselessly goes on to pray
Where incense stops and angels stay.
Give me, Beloved, the better part,
The oil and wine to joy my heart,
And bread that I may in my deeds
Fulfil the justice the world needs.
You give the bread of life and You
Give oil and wine in what is true.

20 Jeremiah told all the folk,
Both men and women, every bloke
That gave him that reply to stoke:
21 "The incense that you burned in towns

Of Judah, and the streets for frowns
 In Jerusalem, you and your
 Ancestors, your kings and the score
 Of your princes, folk of the land,
 Did not YHWH remember the band,
 And did it not in His mind stand?
 22 "So YHWH could no longer bear that,
 Because your wickedness was fat,
 And because of the horrors that
 You have committed, that is why
 Your land's a desolation's cry,
 Astonishment, and curse and yet
 Without inhabitant now met.
 23 "Because you have burned incense and
 Because you've sinned against command
 Of YHWH and not obeyed the voice
 Of YHWH, nor walked in His law's choice,
 Nor in His statutes nor in His
 Testimonies, therefore this biz
 Of evil comes on you like whiz."
 24 Moreover Jeremiah said
 To all the people there outspread,
 And all the women, "Hear the word
 Of YHWH, all Judah that's been stirred
 In the land of Egypt *for curd*.
 25 "So says YHWH of hosts, Israel's God,
 Saying, 'You and your wives in prod
 Have spoken with your mouths and so
 Fulfilled with your hands too the row,
 Saying, "We'll surely do the vows
 That we have vowed, to burn and house
 Incense to the sky-queen, and pour
 Out drink offerings to her what's more,"
 You surely shall accomplish that,
 And perform your own vows in fat.'
 26 "So hear the word of YHWH now all
 Judah that swell in Egypt's thrall;
 'See, I have sword by My great name,'
 Says YHWH, 'that My name and My fame
 Shall no more be named in the mouth
 Of any man of Judah south
 In all the land of Egypt to
 Say As now lives the Lord God YHWH.'

Rabbinical tradition comes out flat
 To say the name of YHWH by thin or fat
 Shall not be spoken, nor by man or rat.
 No doubt they read the prophecy of that.
 Myself I do not speak the name of YHWH,
 But only say the word for "He" in lieu,
 Or rarely "Jah". The prophet would be glad
 Perhaps to hear obedience from a cad.

The prohibition came not out of spite
 Or for the thought Your name's a sacred
 rite,
 But in the punishment that people burned
 Incense to queen of heaven for what they
 earned.
 I know no queen of heaven, the virgin
 queen
 Known to me is a different one on scene.

27 "See, I shall watch over them all
 For evil and not good in stall,
 And all the men of Judah that
 Are in the land of Egypt sat,
 Shall be consumed by sword and by
 The famine until ends their try.
 28 "Yet a small number that escape
 The sword shall come from Egypt's cape
 Into the land of Judah, and
 All the remnant of Judah's band
 That have gone into Egypt's land
 To stay there, shall know whose words
 stand,
 My words or their words *in a scrape*.
 29 "And this shall be a sign to you,"
 Says YHWH, "that I will punish you
 In this place, so you may know that
 My words shall surely stand up at
 The evil of your habitat."
 30 So says YHWH, "See how I shall give
 Pharaoh Hophra, king to live
 In Egypt into the hand of
 His enemies, and in the glove
 Of those who seek his life, as I
 Gave Zedekiah king come nigh
 In Judah into the power of
 Nebuchadrezzar the king of
 Babylon, his enemy who
 Came seeking to take his life too."

You call the sign of history in its claim,
 But by the time its history to blame
 It is too late to change the chosen fane.
 The politics are too entangled here
 For me to know what You think's in the
 clear.
 Instead of Hophra, George, or Dick I take
 You only for my king and for my cake.
 Instead of Nebuchadnezzar the king
 I choose You for both sovereign and
 darling.

Choose me, too, my Beloved, along the shore
Of Nile or in the Gulf of Persia's gore,
And I shall then escape the prod and way
Of heathen head and heathen way to pray.
Beloved, look on my politics today.

Jeremiah 45

1 The word that Jeremiah who
Was the prophet uttered unto
Baruch the son of Neriah,
When he had written words of awe
In a book at dictation of
Jeremiah, in fourth year of
Jehoiakim who was son of
Josiah king of Judah, saying:
2 "So says YHWH, Israel's God waylaying
To you, 'O Baruch, you did say
3 "Woe is me now, for YHWH adds grief
To sorrow, I find no relief
In sighing and I find no rest.
4 "You shall say to him, 'YHWH says so:
"See what I've built I'll not be slow
To break down, and what I have planted
I will pull up, this whole land granted.
5 "Do you seek great things for yourself?
Do not seek them, for on the shelf
I will bring evil on all flesh,'
Says YHWH, 'but your life I'll give fresh
To you in safety everywhere
You go in *everything you dare*.'"

Beloved, I'd rather hear the word
That You give life to every soul that's
stirred,
And not just to myself, if I had name
Of Baruch to raise in higher acclaim.
Baruch is like to be the president
Of USA though man of camel tent.
Baruch was greater in the elders' eyes
Than even Jeremiah to despise.
They said Your words, Beloved, that
prophet spoke
Were once dictated by Baruch in stroke.
Behind the scenes, back of the prophecy
There are men of both high and low degree
Who hold the cords and let the puppets
free.
Who knows what's hidden in the divine
cloak?

Jeremiah 46

1 The message of YHWH which came to
Jeremiah the prophet's view
Against the Gentiles: 2 Against first
Egypt, against the army cursed
Of Pharaoh Necho, the king
Of Egypt, which was by the spring
Of the River Euphrates in
Carchemish, which before the din
Nebuchadrezzar the king of
Babylon attacked in the shove
Of the fourth year Jehoiakim
The son of Josiah the trim
King of Judah reigned in bin.

All this support for Babylon You make
Through Your prophet who sets his life at
stake
Repeating Your words to those who would
take
A scientific view statistically
That Egypt is the best bet of the free,
Reminds me that You told another prophet
That Babylon was fallen down to scoff at.
You said to come out of Babylon then,
So these Jews You stand up now to
condemn
Were not idolatrous as such but only
Ahead of their times in their views
untoneley.
Am I then to submit to Babylon
On basis of Jeremiah's word gone?
Beloved I wait for You in morning drawn.

3 "Order the buckler and the shield,
And draw near to the battlefield.
4 "Harness the horses, and get up,
You horsemen and stand like a tup
With helmets on; polish the spears,
Put mail coats on like brigadiers.
5 "Why is it I've seen them dismayed
And turned away back as waylaid?
And their strong soldiers beaten down,
And fled away before the frown,
For fear was round about," says YHWH.
6 "Don't let the swift ones flee the strew,
Nor the strong soldiers escape too,
They'll stumble and fall to the right
Side of the Euphrates in sight.
7 "Who's this that comes up like a flood,
Waters moved on the rivers' mud?
8 "Egypt rises like floods indeed,
Its waters moved like rivers' reed;

And he says 'I'll go up and will
 Cover the earth, and so I will
 Destroy the city with its folk.'
 9 "Come up, you horses, rage in spoke,
 You chariots, and let the great
 Men come out, Ethiopian rate
 And Libyans that handle the shield,
 And Lydians upon the field
 To bend the bow *and* arrow wield.
 10 "This day's of the Lord YHWH of
 hosts,
 A day of vengeance and of boasts,
 That He may take vengeance on His
 Foes; and the sword consume with whiz,
 And it shall be filled and made drunk
 With their blood, for the Lord YHWH's
 sunk
 A sacrifice on the right side,
 By the River Euphrates *wide*.
 11 "Go up to Gilead and take
 Balm, O virgin, daughter in wake
 Of Egypt; in vain you shall use
 Many medicines that you choose,
 But not be cured of illness' stake."

The date is set in the fourth year of king
 Jehoiakim, and yet some Muslims sing
 That sacrifice beside the river there
 Was prophecy of Hussein and his share
 Of martyrs that filled Karbela with care.
 If Christians can find Jesus everywhere
 He is not named in Scriptures that were
 famed

Long before he was brought forth and
 acclaimed,
 Then any may construe this text to mean
 That after Pharaoh Necho and the scene
 With Nebuchadnezzar, the land would see
 The coming of Hussein and his men free
 To die of thirst and arrows on the sand
 Beside the Euphrates to save the land.

12 The nations have heard of your shame,
 And your cry has filled the land's fame,
 For mighty soldiers stumble there
 Against the mighty in their share
 They both have fallen *at the claim*.
 13 Word that YHWH spoke to Jeremiah
 The prophet, how Nebuchadnezzar
 The King of Babylon, such geezer,
 Should come attack Egypt's pariah.
 14 Declare in Egypt, publish loud

In Migdol, and publish in Noph
 And in Tahpanhes to the crowd,
 Say then, "Stand fast, prepare to scoff;"
 For the sword shall devour around
 About you *where you stand your ground*.
 15 Why are your stalwarts swept away?
 They did not stand, because the sway
 Of YHWH did drive them all a prey.
 16 He made many to fall and yea,
 One fell upon the other's way;
 And they said "Get up, and let us
 Go again to our populace,
 And to land of nativity,
 From the oppressing sword on spree.
 17 They did cry there, "Pharaoh the king
 Of Egypt is a noise to sing;
 He's passed appointed time to bring."

The fateful day that Pharaoh and his band
 Was sunk in the Red Sea and stuck in sand
 Serves as a warning and a prophecy
 Of what's to come for their iniquity
 In later times, when Israel falls beneath
 The hand of Babylon and takes a wreath.
 Beloved, make the rod of Moses to start
 Upon the winds to bring me to my part,
 And may initiation in Your word
 Continue to the end to find heart stirred.
 The days of nations turn and turn again,
 As though in whirling dance upon the fen,
 And so prepare the prophecy of each
 Soul that repents the falsehoods that they
 preach.

18 "As I live," says the King whose name
 Is YHWH of hosts, "Surely the claim
 Of Tabor is among the hills,
 As Carmel by the sea that fills,
 So shall He come *as the time spills*.
 19 "O daughter dwelling in Egypt,
 Furnish yourself to go equipped
 Into captivity; for Noph
 Shall be a waste and place to scoff,
 Without a soul to live in crypt.
 20 "Egypt is like a fine young cow,
 Destruction comes there anyhow,
 It comes from the northland *and shipped*.
 21 "Also her workers like fat beef
 Are turned back fled into their grief,
 They did not stand, because the day
 Of their calamity in sway
 Came on them, there fated relay.

22 "Its voice like a serpent goes on,
 Like an army marching at dawn,
 With axes they've come in to her,
 As lumbermen against the fir.
 23 "They'll cut down her forest," says
 YHWH,
 "Though it cannot be searched in view,
 Because they're more in number than
 Grasshoppers swarming beyond scan.
 24 "Egypt's daughter shall be confounded,
 She'll be delivered and impounded
 Into the power of northern folk."

The northland is the way of warrior kings,
 At first Assyrian with horrid wings,
 And then the great of Babylon with its
 stings,
 And finally the Persians' wanderings.
 The stage is set for Alexander's foe,
 And for the Romans with the blazing cross
 To laminate the raging way they go.
 I too look from the north, the Vikings'
 horde

Pour out upon the people of the Lord.
 I see the waves recede and come again,
 And like the bowing grass above the glen
 Wage on in every place of hope and cord.
 Beloved, where else should Egypt look
 But to the north in such a southern nook?

25 YHWH of hosts Alohim in stroke
 Of Israel, says "See now, I
 Will punish the crowd of No by,
 And Pharaoh and Egypt too
 With their gods and their kings in view;
 Even Pharaoh and all of those
 Who trusted in him *as they chose*.

26 "And I'll deliver them into
 The power of slaying man and foe,
 Into hand of Nebuchadrezzar,
 King of Babylon and the pleaser
 Of his servants, and after that
 It shall be once more habitat
 As in the days of old," says YHWH.

27 "But do not be afraid then, you
 My servant Jacob, nor dismayed,
 O Israel; for see, I've made
 Your salvation come from afar,
 And your spawn from the land and star
 Of their captivity, and so
 Jacob shall return on the go
 And be at rest and at his ease,

And none shall make him fear or freeze.
 28 "Fear not, O Jacob, My servant"
 Says YHWH, "for I am here to pant
 For you, for I'll make a full end
 Of all the nations where I'd send
 You, but not a full end of you,
 But correct you in measure true,
 Not left without punishment due."

Let's imagine this new scenario:
 All nations on the earth are doomed to go,
 And in the end there will only be left
 Jacob and his sons after the bereft.
 I might become resigned to such a brief
 Despite anthropological belief,
 If there were certainty that every brother
 Of Israel would forget to kill each other.
 A radical plan like that ought to give
 Results with which society can live.
 More of the same old violence is not
 Sufficient to carry out such a plot.
 Maybe that's why the world goes on in
 blame

With every kind of nation, none the same.

Jeremiah 47

1 The word of YHWH that came upon
 Jeremiah the prophet drawn
 Against the Philistines, before
 Pharaoh's attack on Gaza's shore.

2 So says YHWH: "See the waters rise
 Up from the north and floods baptize
 The land and everything in it;
 The city where its dwellers sit;
 The men shall shout and then shall howl
 All who live there *beneath the scowl*.

3 "At the sound of stamping of hoofs
 Of his stallions, at rushing roofs
 Of his chariots, and rumbling wheels,
 The fathers shall turn on their heels
 Unable to save children's jowl.

4 "Because the day comes to the spoil
 Of all the Philistines in coil,
 To cut off from Tyre's town and yet
 Zidon every helper that's met;
 For YHWH will spoil the Philistines,
 The rest of Caphtor in designs.

5 "Here's come baldness on Gaza's town,
 And Ashkelon has been cut down,
 O remnant of their valley, when
 Will you cut yourself loose again?"

6 O sword of YHWH, how long till you

Are quiet? Put yourself from view
In scabbard, rest, and be still too.
7 How can there be quiet, since YHWH
Has given command against the crew
Of Ashkelon, against sea shore?
He has appoint it its store.

When the great prophet Muhammad, so
sweet
And blessed along with progeny to greet,
Recited the Suura of Chargers, did
He know how much of the chapter then hid
Within the prophecy of Jeremiah?
I must assume he did, because the glow
Of knowledge on his brow was never slow.
The chargers sweep across the screen of
late
In the art of Ahmed Moustafa's rate
In dots that pour out on the universe,
The one great point encompassing and
terse.
The sound and sight together twine and bid
The watcher and the listener on grid
To whirl in dotly spark a little higher.

Jeremiah 48

1 "Against Moab" says YHWH of hosts,
"The Alohims of Israel's boasts,
Woe to Nebo! For it is spoiled,
Kiriathaim's taken and uncoiled;
Misgab's confounded and dismayed.
2 "There's no more praise of Moab laid,
In Heshbon they devised a plan
Of evil against it to scan,
Let us cut it off from the land.
You too will be cut down, madman,
The sword shall pursue you unbanned.
3 "A voice crying from Horonaim,
Spoiling and great destruction's crime.
4 "Moab's destroyed, her little ones
Have caused a cry heard *above guns*.
5 "For the ascent of Luhith crying,
Go up weeping, go down with sighing
To Horonaim the enemies
Hear cry of desolation's pleas.
6 "Flee for your lives upon the heath
Naked as wilderness beneath.
7 "For since you trusted in your work
And in your treasures, they shall lurk
Among the takers, Chemosh go
Out into captivity's show,
Priest and prince together below.

Moab's the elder son of Lot I see
By all accounts, though bias may run free
In what the Bible records of the way
The man was conceived on a winter day.
One cannot help but think that slander
sheer
Alone's the motivation of the seer.
Be that as may, I praise You for the stay
Against incest: You condemn them instead
For their idolatry, priest and prince bred.
Beloved, incest or not, I take the view
That Your mercy is great in what You do.
I've never been amazed at justice' store,
And always thought that judgements might
be more.
But Your mercy's beyond my parvenu.

8 "The spoiler comes on every town,
No city shall escape the frown,
The valley also shall lie flat,
The plain be destroyed by all that
As YHWH has spoken *by His crown*.
9 "Give wings to Moab, so it may
Flee and in fleeing get away;
For its cities are desolate,
With no one to live there in state.
10 "Cursed be the one who does the work
Of YHWH deceitfully by quirk,
And cursed the one who keeps back sword
From blood *as fearful of the gored*.
11 "Moab has been at ease since youth,
Settled on lees, and not in truth
Emptied from pot to pot, nor gone
Into captivity once drawn;
That's why his taste remains in him,
And his scent has not become dim.
12 "So see how the days come," says
YHWH,
"That I will send to him in view
The wonderer to cause him too
To wander and shall empty out
His pots and beak their jars in rout.
13 "Moab shall shame for Chemosh too,
As Israel's house met the shame due
Of Bethel in their trusty view."

Moab is the place of the holy mount
On which the prophet Moses in account
Laid down his life and at its closing view
Saw all the panorama and the crew
Of Israel spread before him in the light

Of closing day and coming of the night.
 Yet Moab is condemned, cut off in shame
 Despite the glories of its former fame.
 Beloved, I have no fame at all to spin
 Against your prodigies against my sin,
 But still I cling to Moses' frantic word
 And what from Sinai's cloud lands I have
 heard
 Of life and health and knowing of the steep,
 The ten commandments spoken before
 sleep.

14 "How do you say 'We're mighty strong,
 And men of war in battle long?'"

15 "Moab is spoiled and fled from towns,
 His chosen young men from the downs
 Gone to the slaughter," says the King
 Whose name is YHWH of hosts to bring.
 16 "Moab's catastrophe is near,
 Calamity rushes with fear.

17 "All you around him, moan and grieve,
 All you who know his name's reprieve,
 Say 'How the strong staff's broken reed,
 The beautiful rod gone indeed!'"

18 "Daughter dwelling in Dibon's vale,
 Come down from your glory and wail
 In thirst; then Moab's spoiler comes
 To you to destroy all your sums.

Dibon is a wasting away indeed,
 Whether name of a place or meaning's seed
 In the speech of the prophet, so is found
 The inner truth at times along the sound
 Of names of places and men on the ground.
 Beloved, YHWH is Your name, and that
 sound brings

Into my spirit everything that sings,
 Whether upon a desert land before
 Either the burning sand or sunlit shore
 Of northern summers where the rock meets
 sea.

All is a singing cantillate to me.
 Beloved, Dibon be the place where I stand
 And look upon the desolation's band
 That furnishes Moab with crystal sand.

19 "Inhabitant of Aroer,
 Stand by the road and look, beware,
 Ask the one who flees and the girl
 Escaping, say 'What dangers whirl?'"
 20 "Moab's confounded, broken down;
 Howl and cry; tell it in Arnon,

That Moab's spoiled and broken crown.
 21 "Judgement has come upon the plain;
 Upon Holon, on Jahazah,
 And on Mephaath *like falling rain*,
 22 "And on Dibon, and Nebo's claw,
 On Bethdiblathaim *as for gain*,
 23 "On Kiriathaim, on Bethgamul,
 And on Bethmeon *at the pull*,
 24 "And on Kerioth, on Bozrah too,
 On all the towns of Moab's view,
 Far or near, *emptied or still full*.
 25 "The horn of Moab is cut off,
 His arm is broken *like a staff*."

Says YHWH. 26 "So make him drunk, for
 he
 Magnified himself up to be
 Against YHWH: Moab shall also
 Wallow in his vomit, also,
 Shall in derision be cast low.

Aroer is the name of place perhaps
 Or then the nakedness in its relapse
 That brings the desert mountain man back
 to
 The pristine garden state before Your view.
 I live in nakedness, I live there too,
 As vulnerable as any in the crew.
 The ancient times were wicked for all men,
 And all feared nature's hand and nature's
 glen.

But artifice has not made free men safe:
 Electrical power leaves the strong like waif.
 Beloved, Your judgement falls on those
 without

Technology to meet the cloven doubt,
 And on those who spend all in graven
 clout:

Nakedness falls is silence and in shout.

27 "Was Israel not a joke to you
 When he fell among thieving crew?
 You talked about him to rejoice.

28 "O dwellers in Moab for choice,
 Leave cities and hide in the rock,
 Be like the dove with nest in stock
 Of the caves mouth, covered by dock.

29 "We've heard the pride of Moab, he
 Is greatly proud, lift loftily,
 His arrogance, and pride start
 On the haughtiness of his heart.

30 "I know his wrath," says YHWH, "but
 no;

His lies shall not avail to go.

31 "So I'll howl for Moab's estate,
And cry for all Moab come late;
I'll mourn for Kirheres' men's fate.

32 "O vine of Sibmah, I will weep
For you with Jazer's laments deep,
Your plants have gone over the sea,
They reach to sea of Jazer's lea;
The spoiler takes your summer fruits,
And treads your vintage under boots.

33 "Let joy and gladness from the field
Of plenty, and the fruited yield;
I've made the wine fail from the press,
None shall tread with shouting's address,
Their sound shall fail and not confess.

34 "From the cry of Heshon up to
Elealeh, to Jahaz in view
They've uttered their voice from Zoah
To Horonaim even as far,
Like third-year heifer bawling rate,
Nimrim's waters be desolate.

Do You lament, Beloved, the vast
destruction

Of sinful peoples in the last construction
Of universe? Does Your heart bleed and
pain

Beneath the weight of scoffing and the vain
Recourse to marketing and torture plain?
I thought that You were passionless, not
prone

To change, not in the sway of time to groan
Or joy. The sunset is to You without
End or beginning. You need never shout.
When Esdras stood aghast to see the way
Whole populations fell like chips of grey
And useless marble for the sake of one
Great, human monument of pleasure done,
You chided him. Now Moab is Your hay.

35 "And I've made an end in Moab,"
Says YHWH, "of those who make confab
In the high places and there burn
Perfumes to his gods *from an urn*.

36 "That's why My heart cries out aloud
For Moab like pipes in the crowd,
My heart sounds pipes for all the men
Of Kirheres, because again

The wealth he'd got perished *by cloud*.

37 "For every head shall be bald and
Every beard clipped, and on each hand
Shall be cuttings and round each waist

Sackcloth is bound *for the unchaste*.

38 "Laments on all Moab's housetops,
And in its streets, for all the props
Of Moab I have dashed without
Pleasure," says YHWH *above the shout*.
39 "They'll howl 'How it is broken down!
How has Moab turned back with frown!'
So shall Moab be oath and clown,
Dismay to all of those about."

I have a bald spot on my head myself,
And my beard though clipped is like one of
elf

For length at times. In all of these effects
There is no lamentation that selects
My heart and soul to groan upon the shelf.
There's no belt of sackcloth I wear, that's
sure,

But had there been, no sorrow for the pure
Destroys my peace. Moab is lost to me
And so are all the marks of grief's degree.
Beloved, if You bring judgement on the
street
Of Moab or if Your forebear in sweet,
My jaundiced carriage is not moved at all,
But springs a peek along my mossy wall.
Howl if You like, Beloved, I keep my stall.

40 For so says YHWH; "See, he shall fly
As does the eagle in the sky,
And spread his wings on Moab's sty.

41 "Kerioth is taken, the strong hold
Is surprised, and strong men's hearts cold
In Moab at that day untold
Like heart of woman labour rolled.

42 "Moab shall be no more a folk,
Because he's magnified a stroke
Against YHWH. 43 "Fear the pit and snare
Upon you, Moab's dwellers there,"

Says YHWH. 44 "He who flees from the
fear

Shall fall into the pit made near,
And he who gets out of the pit
Shall be taken in snares to sit,
For I shall bring all upon it,
Upon Moab, their judgement's year,"
Says YHWH. 45 "Those who fled stood
there near

The shadow of Heshbon with gear;
But a fire shall come from Heshbon,
A flame from the midst of Sihon,
And shall devour the corner of

Moab, and the crown and the shove
 Of the tumultuous ones above.
 46 "Woe to you, Moab! How the folk
 Of Chemosh perish at the stroke,
 For your sons are in captive held,
 Your daughters also captives felled.
 47 "Yet I'll turn back captivity
 From Moab in the latter plea,"
 Says YHWH. "So far and then no more
 Judgement upon Moab for score."

In casting down the judgement on the sold
 Of Moab, my Beloved, were You not told
 Of Naomi and her old family
 Who found refuge in Moab for the spree
 Of famine in Judah? Not only they
 But Ruth and Orpah also found their way
 Along the cragged runs of Moab's sway.
 Your wings of comfort in distress came
 down
 In many times and places without frown
 On Moab. My Beloved, look on the town
 And mind the way You have been in
 renown.
 If Moab falls for its idolatry,
 Is desolate, what then may do the free
 Who seek a haven from Your last decree?

Jeremiah 49

1 "Against the Ammonites," says YHWH;
 "Has Israel no sons, heirs in view?
 Why does their king inherit Gad,
 His folk dwell in his cities glad?
 2 "Therefore, see, the days come," says
 YHWH,
 "That I will bring a cry and hue
 Of war to be heard in Rabbah
 Of the Ammonites, and the crow
 Shall be a desolation and
 Her daughters shall be burned in band
 With fire; then Israel shall be heir
 To those that had been his heirs there,"
 Says YHWH. 3 "Howl, O Heshbon, for Ai
 Is spoiled; daughters of Rabbah, cry,
 Put on sackcloth, lament, and run
 Back and forth by the hedges spun;
 Their king goes to captivity,
 His priests and princes in the spree.
 4 "Why do you glory in the vale,
 Your flowing valley to travail,
 Backsliding daughter, who put trust
 In treasures, who shall come to dust?"

5 "See, I will bring a fear on you,"
 Says the Lord YHWH of hosts in view,
 "From all those that are about you,
 And you'll be driven out each man,
 And none shall gather up his scan.
 6 "And after that I shall reverse
 Ammon's captivity and curse,"
 Says YHWH, *without punishment worse.*

Beloved, You do not countenance, it's
 clear,
 The burning of sons on altars with gear
 To names of heathen deities and dear.
 When Abram brought his son, You sent a
 guy
 From heaven to speak to him out of the sky
 Preventing holocaust. And that is why
 I wonder that You now prescribe the fate
 Of burning daughters at the city gate.
 The ruin of children in the conquest call
 Is just as much a sacrifice for all
 As laying babes across the burning arms
 Of Baal in effigy for human harms.
 Beloved, I turn from sacrifice today
 And fill my cup to last the bitter bay.

7 "Concerning Edom," so says YHWH
 Of hosts; "Is wisdom in the crew
 Of Teman? Is counsel destroyed
 From the prudent that once employed?
 Is their wisdom vanished from view?
 8 "Flee now, turn back and borrow deep,
 Inhabitants of Dedan steep;
 For I'll bring the calamity
 Of Esau upon him freely,
 The time I come to make him weep.
 9 "If gatherers of grapes appear,
 Would they not leave some gleaning here?
 If thieves by night come, will not they
 Destroy till they have all their prey?
 10 "But I have made Esau be bare,
 I've uncovered his secret lair,
 He cannot be hidden now there;
 His seed is wasted and his kin
 And his neighbours are not within.
 11 "Leave your orphaned sons, I will keep
 Them alive, let your widows peep
 For trust in me *and not to weep.*"
 12 For so says YHWH: "See those whose
 fate
 Was not to drink of the cup late
 Have surely drunk; and are you one

To go unpunished on your bun?
You shall not go unpunished now,
But surely drink it anyhow.
13 “For I have sworn Myself,” says

YHWH,
“That Bozrah shall be wasteland’s view,
Reproach, a desert, and a curse,
And all its cities shall be worse.”

Edom or Esau’s closer to the crew
Of chosen even that Ammonite few
In the days Ammon was the son in cue
Of Lot and not as now filled with the view
Of Abraham’s own children in the pew.
You do not even bring to light a sin
Of Esau for which You would split his bin.
You execrate vituperation here,
But do not clarify why he should fear.
The sinless too feel every scourge that’s
sent
Upon the earth in every place You’ve
meant.
Beloved, I raise a villain’s cry in vent
To see the falling of the innocent.
Have a regard, Beloved, when You appear.

14 I have heard a rumour from YHWH,
A messenger to heathen crew:
“Gather together, rise to attack,
Come to the battle, don’t be slack.
15 “For see, I’ll make you small to be
Among the heathen pageantry,
Despised among men *faithfully*.
16 “Your terribleness deceives you,
The pride of your heart come in view,
O you who live in rocky caves,
Holding to heights that the hill paves;
Though you should make your nest as high
As that of eagles near the sky,
I’ll bring you down from there,” says
YHWH.

17 “Edom too shall be desolate,
Every passer-by shall relate
Astonishment and hiss to see
All the plagues of Edom’s country.
18 “As in Sodom’s overthrow and
That of Gomorrah on the sand
Of near-by cities, all in band,”
Says YHWH, “no man shall abide there,
Neither son of man take its share.
19 “See him come like a lion from
The swelling of the Jordan scum

Against the dwelling of the strong;
But I’ll suddenly come a long
To make him flee from her; and who
Is chosen to appoint to do
Over her? Who is like Myself?
And who’ll appoint Me on the shelf?
Who is the shepherd that will stand
Undaunted before Me unmanned?”
20 Therefore hear the counsel of YHWH,
He’s taken against Edom’s crew;
And His purposes that He’s set
Against Teman’s people as met;
Surely the least of the flock draws
Them out, surely He’ll make the claws
Of their dwelling desolate straws.
21 Earth moves at the sound of their fall,
At the cry of the noise withal
Heard as far as the Red Sea’s wall.
22 See, He shall come and fly as high
As the eagle into the sky
To spread wings over Bozrah’s land,
And at that day shall heart of manned
Of Edom be as woman’s heart
In the pangs of her birthing’s start.

Still not one word to say what was done
wrong
In Edom but the singing of a song
When Israel fell because idolatry
Had eaten out the heart to last degree!
Beloved, I would have chosen like Isaac
Esau from the beginning of attack,
Instead of siding with Rebecca when
She by deceit made Jacob heir of men.
Israel was fill with such idolatry
To rouse wrath and disgust by Your degree,
And while I do not doubt that Esau’s store
Was too idolatrous to keep for more,
You do not bring the evidence to shore.
Beloved, do You not come to speak to me?

23 “Concerning Damascus: Hamath
Is confounded on Arpad’s path;
For they’ve heard the bad new to come,
They are fainthearted, and not rum,
Sorrow upon the sea to rise,
It can’t be quiet in demise.
24 “Damascus is gone feeble, turned
Herself to flee, and fear unspurned
Has seized upon her; anguished earned
And sorrows take her as a lass
In first travails and not to pass.

25 "How it's not left forsaken yet,
 City of praise, town of my pet!
 26 "So her young men fall in her streets,
 And all the men of war's retreats
 Shall be cut off in that day," so
 Says YHWH of hosts, *who is not slow*.
 27 "I'll kindle a fire in the wall
 Of Damascus, it shall devour
 Palaces of Benhadad's power."

Three cities count in this tirade You make
 Beloved for Syrians and others' sake.
 I do not know Damascus' name in store,
 But for that I know the two other's lore.
 Hamath's a fortress, Hittite it may be,
 North of Damascus and in safety's lea.
 Arpad's a couch, a rest given above
 The Sabbath of Israel to those You love.
 For the same sun that rises on the just
 Of Sabbath morning, comes to kiss the dust
 Of every town and country in its lust.
 You may destroy whom You wish, but at
 last
 You give Your blessing to all in the blast.
 Beloved, I look on three and am outcast.

28 "Concerning Kedar: the kingdoms
 Of Hazor, Nebuchadrezzar,
 King of Babylon strikes like bums,"
 So says YHWH; "Get up, go up to
 Kedar, and spoil the men in crew
 From the east. 29 "Their tents and their
 flocks
 Shall they take away from their stocks,
 They'll take to themselves all their veils,
 Their vessels and the camels' tails,
 And they shall cry to them for fear
 Is on every side, groan and tear.
 30 "Flee, get far off and burrow deep,
 Inhabitants of Hazor steep,"
 Says YHWH, "for Nebuchadrezzar,
 King of Babylon takes a star
 Counsel against you, and conceives
 A purpose against your reprieves.
 31 "Arise, get you up to the land
 Of wealth where no cares shall command,"
 Says YHWH, "with neither gates nor bars,
 And dwell alone *among the stars*.
 32 "Their camels shall be booty and
 The herds of cattle in spoil's hand;
 And I will scatter every band
 To all the winds as far away;

And I'll bring their calamity
 From all sides of it *in that day*,"
 Says YHWH *and speaking faithfully*.
 33 "Hazor shall be the dwelling place
 For dragons, forever the trace
 Of desolation, there shall be
 No man abiding there to see,
 Nor son of man, *nor any tree*."

Kedar, dark-skinned, Kedar, whom I love,
 And Hazor, an enclosure like a glove,
 How can You raze the beauty and the
 shove
 Born of Abraham and a child above?
 Bring back the flocks to Kedar, yes, bring
 back,
 And bless the hope and help and be not
 slack.
 The promise You give Babylon takes all,
 Has no regard for beauty and the stall,
 Gives no respect to righteousness nor yet
 To ancient bounds and keeps when they are
 met.
 Beloved, if Babylon is great and true,
 Then I will worship at the kingly pew,
 But if You know a better temple where
 I may bow, turn my face to find it there.

34 YHWH's word that came to Jeremiah
 The prophet against Elam dire
 In the beginning of the reign
 Of Zedekiah kind and fane
 Of Judah, saying 35 So says YHWH
 Of hosts: "See I will break the bow
 Of Elam, the chief of their show.
 36 "On Elam I will bring four winds
 From the four quarters of skies linds,
 And scatter them toward all those winds;
 And there shall be no nation where
 The outcasts of Elam are there.
 37 "For I will make Elam dismayed
 Before their enemies' parade,
 And before those who seek their life;
 I'll bring on them evil and strife,
 My fierce wrath," says YHWH; "I will
 send
 The sword after them till they bend.
 38 "I'll set My throne in Elam's way,
 Destroy from there the king and fey,"
 Says YHWH. 39 "But it shall come to pass
 In the latter days, I'll amass
 The captives back to Elam's grass,"

Says YHWH *of the latter day*.

The four winds are four gates of law to
preach
What such destruction comes from each to
each,
When all gates are the gates of air and law.
Beloved, show now three other gates in
awe.
One wind alone suffices, I must find
The fire and water before any kind
Of earth becomes the sweet rest of Your
way,
The habitation of the Sabbath day.
Be simple, yes, but don't exaggerate
By making every road come soon or late
The windy height of legal bond and strife.
Beloved, open to me the gates of life,
And I shall enter burning love to drink
At fountains clear the mysteries in brink.

Jeremiah 50

1 This is the message that YHWH spoke
Against Babylon and the stroke
Against the Chaldeans' land by
Jeremiah the prophet nigh.
2 "Declare among the nations and
Publish and set a flag to stand;
Publish and do not hide a thing:
Say Babylon's taken to wing
And Bel's confounded, Merodach
Is broken in pieces and slack;
Her idols are smashed in their track,
Her images a broken thing.

In fact the heathen images that stoke
The Vatican are polished to a stroke,
And none are fallen down, but all remain
A glory to their art and to their fane.
Bel's live and well and so is Merodach
In trinity and saint to take the flack
When You're too busy in the prayerful
track.
Beloved, there is no human heart but makes
Some idol in the flow of market takes,
And every church and mosque comes out
with rakes
To meet the synagogue with faithful
shakes.

I care not whether Babylon is set
In desert and without a temple met:

The gods are live and well, that's what You
get.

3 "Out of the north a folk shall come
Against her, which shall make her hum
In desolation where none swell,
They shall remove, depart a spell,
Both man and beast *to the last bum*.
4 "In those days then, and in that time,"
Says YHWH, "children of Israel climb,
They and the sons of Judah too,
Going and weeping; they are due
To seek YHWH their Alohim *true*.
5 "They'll ask the way to Zion then
With their faces toward that den,
'Come let us join ourselves to YHWH
In an eternal covenant
That will never be lost from view.'
6 "My folk have been like lost sheep scant;
The shepherds have led them astray,
They have turned on the hills away;
They've gone from mountaintop to hill,
Forgetting resting place and still.
7 "All finding them consumed them too,
Their adversaries spoke to spew,
'We don't offend, because they've sinned
Against YHWH, in whom justice binned,
YHWH hope of their ancestral crew.'
8 "Move from the midst of Babylon,
And go forth out of the land drawn
Of the Chaldeans, like the he-goats
Be in the flocks for what promotes.

Fact is we're talking not of Rome but still
Of Jerusalem set on Zion's hill,
And of the role the Persians came to play
In the rebuilding of her temple's sway.
The people of the north are not the sum
Germanic against the Italic hum
That made the paragraphs of Christian
dumb.

The northern folk are Median to share
With Persian in the royalty and glare.
When Cyrus emptied out the river flood
And clipped the king of Babylon in bud
The fate of old Jerusalem was set.
And now I see its domes glisten as wet
With dewly gold above the Muslims met.

9 "For see, I'll raise and cause to come
Up against Babylon a sum
Of great nations from the north land;

And they shall set themselves in band
Against her; from there she'll be brought;
Their arrows like a great man's wrought;
None shall return in vain to stand.

10 "And Chaldea shall be a spoil:
All who spoil her shall stand the toil,"
Says YHWH. 11 "Because then you were
glad

Because you rejoiced like a cad,
O you destroyers of My lot,
Because you have grown fat in plot
As the heifer at grass, and bawl
Like bulls *beneath the city wall*,

12 "Your mother'll be bewildered then,
She who bore you ashamed again;
See the last nations desert drawn,
A dry land's wilderness in spawn."

13 For wrath of YHWH it shall not be
Inhabited, shall be wholly

Desolate, every one that goes
By Babylon amazed what shows,
Will hiss at all her plagues to see.

14 Put yourselves in array to stand
Against Babylon round the land,
All you who bend the bow and shoot
At her, spare no arrows to root,
For she has sinned high against YHWH.

Encouragement to Persians in this book
Makes me think that the further that I look
In the past for the time of prophecy
The further I go astray in degree.
The book is clearly written to make sure
The Persians will rebuild a city pure
On Zion. See, the flattery set out
Of that northern kingdom that put to rout
Babylon by deflecting river stream
And coming under walls and under beam.
Beloved, even the documents that wave
Political reviews one still may save
And read for edifying soul and flesh
Before a faith in You that's ever fresh.

15 Shout out against her all around,
She's given her hand at the sound;
Her foundations are fallen bound,
Her wall thrown down before the call
Of vengeance of YHWH to install;
As she has done, do to her wall.

16 Cut off the sower from Babylon,
The one to wield the sickle drawn
In time of harvest; for the fear

Of the oppressing sword that's near
They shall go each back to his folk,
And they shall flee at every stroke
Each in his own land to appear.

17 Israel is scattering of sheep,
The lions have driven out to creep;
First came Assyrian with king
To consume him like anything;
And last this Nebuchadrezzar
King of Babylon has come far
To break his bones *before the sting*.

18 So says YHWH of hosts, Alohim
Of Israel: "See, I shall beam
Punishment on Babylon's king
And his land as I've sent the sting
On king of Assyrian wing.

19 "And I'll bring Israel again
To his own habitation's den,
And he shall feed on Carmel there
And on Bashan, and his soul's share
Shall be on Mount Ephraim then
And Gilead. 20 "And in those days
And in that time," says YHWH *of praise*,
"Iniquity of Israel

Shall be sought out to find the spell,
And not be found; for I will serve
Pardon on the folk I reserve.

The sower is cut off from Babylon.
Sowing is what built up the city done.
They say the double row on barley stem
Is what made possible Sumerian hem.
And all is built up on that first fine wave
That rose in civilized and to behave.
The sower is cut off from cities there
And so the land returns to desert wear
And glistens in the shimmering light of
noon
As though dead to the coming late or soon
Of life again upon the barren waste.
And still, Beloved, I enter in the haste
Of Babylon in spirit and to taste
What human beings can make of a boon.

21 "Attack the land of Merathaim,
Go against it, against the crime
Of Pekod's Inhabitants, waste
And utterly destroy in haste,"
Says YHWH, "and do by all that I
Commanded you to do thereby.
22 "A sound of battle in the land,
Of great destruction *come to stand*.

23 "How is the hammer of the whole
 Earth cut asunder, broken goal!
 How is Babylon wilderness
 Among the nations in address!
 24 "I've laid a snare for you, and you
 Are also taken in the screw,
 O Babylon, though not aware;
 You're found and also caught in snare,
 Because you've striven against YHWH."
 25 YHWH's opened up His armoury,
 And brought out weapons for His spree,
 For this is the work of Lord YHWH
 Of hosts in the Chaldeans' crew.
 26 Come against her from the far strand,
 Open her storehouses and grand,
 Cast her up as heaps on the land,
 Destroy her utterly, let stand
 Nothing left at all of her band.
 27 Kill all her bulls; let them go down
 To the slaughter, woe to their frown!
 For their day's come, judgement in town.
 28 The sound of those who flee and go
 Escaping from the land not slow
 From Babylon, and to declare
 In Zion the vengeance in share
 Of YHWH our Alohim, and there
 The vengeance of His temple's care.

Chaldean crew exists today and still
 In the Iraqi plain, unfrequent hill.
 Today their faith is Christian to the core,
 Kildani as they're called by Jews and more.
 Today Chaldean crew is put to flight
 By Muslim hordes who think they know
 the right.

Perhaps You prophesy the curfew drawn
 Against them here and against Babylon.
 I've met a few of those as refugees
 Who suffer in their families under trees
 Of Finnish wilds and in such Finnish towns
 As will accept these sweet folk without
 frowns.

Beloved, the wheel of history never slacks
 But always returns hard on people's backs.

29 Summon the archers, let them come
 Against Babylon, all in sum
 That bend the bow, encamp around
 And let none escape to the ground;
 Recompense her for what she's done;
 According to what she has won,
 Do to her, for she has been proud

Against YHWH and against the cloud
 Of Israel's Holy One *as bound*.

30 "Let her young men fall in the streets,
 And all her men of war's retreats
 Be cut off in that day," says YHWH.

31 "See now, it is I against you,
 O most proud," so says the Lord YHWH
 Of hosts: "for your day's come in view,
 The time I bring judgement on you.

32 "The most proud shall stumble and fall,
 And none shall raise him up at all;
 And I will kindle in his towns
 A fire, and it consumes with frowns
 All round about him *on the downs*."

Beloved, the archers that rose in their days
 Of capturing fair Babylon in haze
 Of morning dawning after Persian craze
 Of onslaught now are silenced. They are
 gone.

Peace has descended now on Babylon.
 The young men that fell in the streets now
 lie

As broken and neglected bones that vie
 With brick to hide from day's fell blistered
 eye.

Peace has come down on Babylon to stay.
 Beloved, the fires You kindled in the way,
 The battered heights regaining light of day,
 Are now extinguished in the peace that falls
 On Babylon and on mosaic walls.
 What Babylon had in debt she would pay.

33 So says YHWH of hosts: "Israel's folk
 And folk of Judah at a stroke
 Were both oppressed together; and
 All that took them captives in band
 Held them fast; they refused to let
 Them go *once established and set*."

34 Their Redeemer is strong; and YHWH
 Of hosts is His name and His due;
 He'll thoroughly review their case,
 So He may give them resting place,
 And trouble Babylon in race.

36 "A sword's on the Chaldeans' face,"
 Says YHWH, "and on Babylon's space,
 And on her princes and upon
 Her wise men, all her dwellers drawn.

36 "A sword is still upon the liars;
 And they shall dote before their fires;
 A sword is on her mighty men;
 And they shall be dismayed again.

37 "A sword falls on their horses too,
 And on their chariots in crew,
 And on the mingled folk in her;
 They shall become as wife or cur;
 A sword is on her treasury,
 And they shall be robbed of the fee.
 38 "A drought is on her waters filled;
 And they shall be dried up and stilled;
 For it's a land of graven gods
 And they boast in their idol clods.
 39 "That's why the wild beasts of the sand
 With the wild beasts of each island
 Shall dwell there, and the owls will stand,
 And it shall be no more a place
 Of habitation, and no race
 Shall live there for time out of space.
 40 "As Alohim overthrew then
 Sodom and Gomorrah again
 With neighbour towns around," says
 YHWH,
 "So shall no man abide the pew,
 Nor son of man enjoy the view.

I've seen the blue and golden wall that sets
 The glory of Babylon. None forgets
 The power of her markets and her hand.
 I've also seen the salt encrusted land
 Of Sodom and Gomorrah where they stand
 Beneath unblinking eye of history,
 Forsaken by all human company.
 Beloved, there is no human heart but falls
 Beneath the cutting scythe of Sodom's
 thralls.

There is a day of hope and happiness,
 A looking forward to the great address,
 An earning and acquiring of all things,
 A stumbling and a warning in the rings,
 And then the vacant halls without its kings.

41 "See a folk from the northern lands,
 And a great nation, come in bands
 Of kings shall be raised from the coasts
 Of the earth *against all her boasts*.

42 "They'll hold the bow and lance with
 fierce

Face without mercy come to pierce,
 With sound like roaring of the sea,
 And riding horses, each one free,
 Like a man to the battle come
 To attack child of Babylon.

43 "The king of Babylon has heard
 Rumours of them, and his hands stirred

Feebly, in anguish and in pang
 As a woman in labour sprang.
 44 "See, he shall come up like a beast,
 A lion from the swelling pieced
 Of Jordan to the dwelling strong;
 But I will make them run along
 Away from her; and who is choice
 To appoint over and rejoice?
 For who is like me? And who will
 Appoint Me to the time to fill?
 And who's the shepherd that will stand
 Before Me *unwavering and manned?*"
 45 Therefore hear the counsel of YHWH,
 That He has taken for the crew
 Against Babylon, and His goal,
 That he has planned against the toll
 Of the Chaldeans' land; surely
 The least of the *pastured* flock free
 Shall draw them out; and surely he
 Shall make their habitation bare.
 46 At the sound of the taking share
 Of Babylon the earth is moved,
 The cry's heard among nations proved.

If Babylon's the Church of Rome as speaks
 Brave Martin Luther in the joy he seeks,
 The northern kingdom is the Reformation
 Come in to spoil the Roman Church's
 ration.

The parallel if true comes back to slap
 The perpetrator in the head and lap.
 For You, Beloved, consistently
 commanded

Obedience to Babylon red-handed,
 And brooked no rebellion against that
 power,

Though heathen and changing the day and
 hour.

If Persia like the Reformation's tale
 Came in to rebuild temple and prevail,
 The tide of unity sucks back with force
 To Rome as to a given, charted course.

Jeremiah 51

1 So says YHWH: "See now, I shall raise
 Up against Babylon such ways
 Against those who live among them
 That rise up against Me *in hem*,
 A wind destroying *days and days*,
 2 "And will send out to Babylon
 Fanners to fan her dawn to dawn
 And empty her land: in the day

Of trouble they shall come in sway
 Against her round about as drawn.
 3 "Against the one who take aim let
 The archer bend his bow, and yet
 Against one dressed in coat of mail,
 And do not spare her young men's tale,
 Destroy utterly without fail.
 4 "So the slain shall fall in the land
 Of the Chaldeans, and the band
 Of those thrust through in her streets'
 stand."
 5 For Israel's not forsaken, nor
 Judah of her Alohim's store,
 And YHWH of hosts, though their land's
 filled
 With sin against Holy One billed
 Of Israel. 6 Flee then from out
 Of Babylon, and each man's rout
 May save his soul; be not cut off
 In her iniquity to scoff,
 For this is the time of vengeance
 From YHWH, He will render expense
 To her to be her recompense.
 7 Babylon's been a golden cup
 In YHWH's hand, that made earth turn up
 In drunkenness; the nations drink
 Of her wine, and that's why they sink
 In boastful madness at the brink.

The golden cup of vengeance on the earth
 That You held in Your hand, Beloved, as
 berth
 Poured out on good and evil for the store
 Of Babylon the great and greater more.
 The cup of wrath is still abroad today
 In every sort of government in sway
 That tries to bring peace on the troubled
 land,
 Succeeds in the oppression of the manned.
 Beloved, the way of empires is a way
 To keep the local robber once at bay,
 But still provides an even grander way
 Of farming populations under sway.
 I hide beneath the canopy of peace,
 Illusion of wickedness in release.

8 Babylon's fallen suddenly,
 Destroyed: howl for her; and take balm
 For her pain, if in such a calm
 She may be healed *under her palm*.
 9 We might have healed Babylon, but
 She was not healed: forsake her shut,

And let us go each one into
 His own country to take anew;
 For her judgement goes to the sky,
 And is lifted to sit on high.

Babylon's fallen is a message dear
 To John when writing on a further year,
 And centuries after the rend and tear
 Of that great city where the folk and gear
 Were taken in captivity and fear.
 What could that soldier mean by what he
 said,
 Since Babylon was lifeless then and dead?
 The spirit of the empire never died,
 But went on living in the Persian side,
 And in the Grecian and the Roman too,
 And in the Umayyad-Abassid crew.
 Who takes the fallen mantle now today?
 Competitors there are along the fray,
 But none relinquish anything of pay.

10 YHWH's brought fourth our justice: so
 come,
 And let us declare all the sum
 In Zion of YHWH Alohim.
 11 Make bright the arrows like a dream,
 Gather the shields; YHWH has raised up
 The spirit of the kings like tup
 Of the Medes, for His device runs
 Against Babylon and her guns
 To destroy it, because vengeance
 Of YHWH comes for His temple stance.
 12 Set up the standard on the walls
 Of Babylon: make the watch strong,
 Set up the watchmen, set along
 The ambuscades; for YHWH's devised
 And done what He spoke and apprised
 Against dwellers of Babylon.
 13 O you who sit on the floods drawn,
 Abundant treasures, your end come,
 Measure of your coveting's sum.
 14 YHWH of hosts has sworn by Himself,
 "Surely I'll fill you man and elf,
 As with caterpillars; and they
 Shall life a shout against your prey."

The One who inspired or invented these
 Words knew beforehand or after the breeze
 How Babylon was taken through the flood
 Of the Euphrates dried up for her blood.
 The drying of the Euphrates became

The watchword for the world's end in its
fame,

Just as the fall of Babylon seemed more
Than ending of the world upon its shore.
Some sit upon the floods today to share
Abundance of the treasure houses there,
And the same danger lurks behind the
throne

The defies You, Beloved, for maid or crone
Until the waters recede with the dam
Before the judgement of the great I AM.

15 He has made the earth by His power,
He's established the world an hour
By His wisdom and has stretched out
The sky by his knowledge in rout.

16 When he sounded His voice, a crowd
Of waters in the sky aloud;
And He made the vapours ascend
From the earth and from end to end;
He made the lightning with the rain,
And brought forth wind from treasures'
gain.

17 Every man's brutish by his thought,
And put to shame by image wrought
Of the refiner, for false taught
Is molten image, without breath
In them at all, *as still as death*.

18 Vain things are they, of errors done,
In time of their judgement they're gone.

19 Jacob's portion is not like theirs,
For He who formed all things in layers,
He is his portion and his lot,
YHWH of host's His name *in the plot*.

20 "An axe for me You are, a flail
Of war, and I've broken the tale
Of nations by you, will destroy
Kings as you are in My employ.

21 "By you I'll crush rider and mount;
By you I'll break chariot and count
The riders fallen *in My joy*.

In Genesis You make the heavens and earth
By Your beginning and without a dearth,
But here the gates open in three ways more:
By power, by wisdom and by knowledge
door.

St. Augustine would choose among the four
By wisdom and grant You no greater claim.
Each human eye perceives some of the
game

But only You know all. Though to our
shame

We men look on the narrowness of time
And take the part for whole, our greatest
crime.

You've nothing to forgive we make You
small,

It's we who must forgive our anthem's call,
And render to the mystery of space
The glories that are due to silent grace.

22 "With you also I'll crush both man
And woman, and with you in scan
I'll break in pieces old and young;
By you I'll crush the young man strung
With the maid; 23 "I will also break
In pieces by your shepherd's stake
And his flock; and by you I'll break
In pieces husbandman and yoke
Of oxen, and by you in stroke
I'll crush the chiefs' and rulers' *oak*.

24 "I'll render unto Babylon
And to all the dwell outdrawn
Of Chaldea all evil done

In Zion in your sight *and won*,"
Says YHWH. 25 See now, I'm against you,
Destroying mountain, so says YHWH,
"For you destroy all the earth too;
And I'll stretch out My hand on you,
And roll you down from rocks and make
You a burning mountain *at stake*.

26 "They'll not take from you just one
stone

For a corner or in the loan
Of a foundation, but you'll be
Desolation eternally,"

Says YHWH. 27 Set up a flag to stand,
Blow the trumpet in every land,
Prepare the nations against her,
Summon attack from kingdoms' stir
From Ararat, Minni, as well

As Ashchenaz; appoint a swell
Chief against her; let cavalry
Come rough as caterpillars' spree.

28 Set nations to attack with kings
Of Medes and captains in the rings
Of rulers, all lands in his sway.

29 The land shall tremble, grieve away;
For every plan of YHWH shall come
Against Babylon, to make from
The land of Babylon a waste
With no inhabitants there placed.

It's one thing in our weakness to paint You
 Too small upon the canvass of our view,
 And quite another to pound out the gold
 And raise it as divine flesh though it's cold.
 You rise to destroy Babylon and those
 Who consign You to images in rows,
 And all who join the crown to bow in
 prayer
 Before the idols set up everywhere.
 Beloved, though my ear cannot hear Your
 voice,
 Though my eye is blind to the divine
 choice,
 Let me eschew what seems of power and
 light,
 And hold to You unseen by day and night,
 Who speak in everything created bright
 That knows upon a world how to rejoice.

30 The mighty men of Babylon
 Refused to fight, they've stayed and spun
 In their fortresses, their strength failed:
 They became as women unveiled;

They've burned her palaces impaled;
 Her bars are broken and undone.

31 One post shall run to meet another,
 One messenger to meet his brother,
 To show the king of Babylon,
 His city's taken and undone.

32 The passages are stopped, the reeds
 They've burned with fire, soldiers like
 weeds

Are frightened by the battle steeds.

33 For so says YHWH of hosts, the God
 Of Israel, "Daughter on the sod
 Of Babylon is like the floor
 Of threshing, it is time to score
 Her with the flail, but yet a space,
 Time of her harvest shall replace."

34 Nebuchadrezzar the king of
 Babylon has devoured above,
 He's crushed me, he has poured me out
 An empty pot, swallowed like trout,
 He's filled his paunch with my sweet meat
 And cast me out *beneath his feet*.

35 The violence done to me and
 To my flesh be upon the stand
 Of Babylon; shall dweller in
 Zion say; and my blood for sin
 Upon Chaldea's dwellers' bin,
 Jerusalem shall say *and win*.

36 "That's why" says YHWH; "I'll plead
 your case,
 And take vengeance before your face,
 I'll dry her sea and her springs' trace.

Beloved, You will not be confined in form
 Of gold or light or cloud above the storm,
 In idols made by human hands nor by
 Anything risen in the earth or sky.

Beloved, You will not dwell in creeds
 alight

With fervour of priests and prophets
 who're right,

For You are Sovereign, without skin to
 catch

In net or snare of words by light of match.
 I see the greatness and the wisdom spent
 On every form of faith by humans meant,
 Acknowledge power and light, and yet I
 turn

Regretfully from what my hand may earn,
 And empty of both gift and sacrifice
 Stand without slipping on eternal ice.

37 "Babylon shall become a heap,
 A house for dragons in their sweep,
 Amazement and a hissing sound
 Without inhabitant there found.

38 "They'll roar like lions in a band;
 They'll yell like lions' whelps unscanned.

39 "In their heat I will make their feasts,
 And I will make them drunken beasts,
 So they may rejoice when they sleep
 Eternal slumber and not peep,"

Says YHWH *of the unawakened sheep*.

40 "I'll bring them down to butcher like
 Lambs and like rams with he-goats' spike.

41 "How is Sheshack taken! And how
 Is the praise of the whole earth now
 Surprised! How has Babylon been
 Made an amazement in the din!"

It is not Rome alone that keeps the way
 Of Babylon, though it has greater sway
 Than any other on the earthy maze.
 Geneva and Canterbury in phase
 With Byzance and Wittenburgian craze
 Join east with west to make all faiths alight
 With the illusion of receding night.
 It is not Rome alone, but every man
 Who has the inner temple's stony span

To choose, that chooses power instead of
right.

Beloved, I whirl upon the bloody sight
And slip upon the gore before the mount
To fall prostrating at Your own account,
Where Decalogue resides above the plight.

42 The sea's come upon Babylon;
She's covered with the waves come on.

43 Her cities are a desolation,
A dry land and a desert station,
A land where no man dwells to sigh,
Nor does the son of man pass by.

44 "I'll punish Bel in Babylon,
I'll bring out of his mouth the run
Of what he's swallowed up, so no
Oecumenical way will show
Him any more, indeed the wall
Of *ancient* Babylon shall fall.

45 "My folk, go out of her and save
Every man his own soul *and brave*
From the fierce wrath of YHWH *for knave*.

46 "And lest your heart be faint and you
Fear for the rumour that's heard true
About the countryside, a hue
Come in one year and after that
Another year shall hear the fat,
Violence in the land and chief
Against chief *and without relief*.

47 "So see, the days come that I'll do
Judgement upon the graven crew
Of images of Babylon;
And her whole land shall fall upon
Confusion, and all her slain fall
In the midst of her *by the wall*.

48 "Then sky and earth and all in them
Sing for Babylon to condemn,
For spoilers from the north shall come,"
Says YHWH. 49 As Babylon like bum
Killed Israel and made them fall,
So Babylon shall fall of all
The earth slain there *beneath the brawl*.

Bel of Babylon's just another word
For Christ or Mithra, Horus and the stirred
Tao before voice of Buddha had been
heard.

All faiths are a perennial delight,
Expression of the human frame of flight,
The structure of the human mind that fills
The heart with faith that there's no god on
hills

But I myself alone in glory's tills.
I hear You say to leave the trodden way
Of Babylon to walk the path of day,
And know that leaving that town and its
sway

Is not enough. I must relinquish all
The faith that seems right in the siren call
To find the humble true above the wall.

50 You who've escaped the sword, retreat,
Do not stand still, remember feat
Of YHWH far off and so remind
Yourselves Jerusalem *is kind*.

51 We are confounded, we have heard
Reproach, and shame covers unblurred
Our faces; for strangers have come,
Into the holy temple swum.

52 "That's why, see, the days come," says
YHWH,

"That I will make her judgement do
On graven images; and through
All her land wounded shall groan too.

53 "Though Babylon should climb the sky,
And though she come to fortify
The height of her strength, still from Me
Shall spoilers come to her in spree,"
Says YHWH. 54 The sound of a cry from
Babylon, great destruction come
From the land of Chaldean *scum*.

55 Because YHWH has spoiled Babylon,
And destroyed out of her the gun;
When her waves roar like waters great,
A noise of their voice raised in state;
56 Because the spoiler's come on her,
On Babylon and upon her
Mighty men taken, every one
Of their bows is broken and done;
For YHWH Alohims recompense
Shall surely requite *on their tents*.

57 "And I will make her princes drunk,
And her wise men, her captains bunk,
Her rulers and her mighty men;
And they shall sleep unending den;
And never wake," says the King whose
Name is YHWH of hosts and all crews.
58 So says YHWH of hosts: "The broad
walls

Of Babylon are broken stalls,
And her high gates are burned with fire;
And the folk vainly shall inquire,
In conflagration they shall tire."

Beloved, my life I've spent in searching
 where
 The faiths of humankind rise up to share
 The truth and light with humankind and
 make
 The journey of life right for judgement's
 sake.
 I've walked about the busy market place
 Of Babylon where creeds are sold for grace
 And found that all are flawed by human
 face.
 Beloved, the human face in every creed
 Is still a mirror of the right in seed,
 But I find it at last only when I
 Relinquish both the searching and the why,
 The human face and will to reach the sky,
 The human institutions broken down
 To find the new Jerusalem in town.

59 The word which prophet Jeremiah
 Set Seraiah son of Neriah,
 The son of Maaseiah, when he
 Went with Zedekiah in fee
 Of king of Judah to city
 Of Babylon in the fourth year
 Of his reign. Seriah indeed
 Was a quiet prince *in his need*.
 60 Jeremiah wrote in a book
 All the evil that came and took
 Babylon, all these words that are
 Written against Babylon's star.
 61 Jeremiah said to Seraiah,
 "When you come to Babylon higher
 And shall see and read all these words;
 62 "Then you shall say 'O YHWH for
 sherds
 You've spoken now against this place,
 To cut it off so none retrace,
 Neither the man nor beast but that
 It shall be waste and always flat.'
 63 "And it shall be when you have made
 An end of reading this book frayed,
 That you shall tie a stone to it,
 And throw it in Euphrates' mitt;
 64 "And you shall say 'So Babylon
 Will sink and not rise like the dawn
 From the evil that I shall bring,
 And they'll be weary with the sting.'"
 Thus far is Jeremiah's thing.

The prophets have the strangest ways to
 take

A book apart for human being's sake.
 The one will eat the thing and find the taste
 As sweet as honey, but around the waist
 A torture to the stomach on the make.
 But Jeremiah's way is just as queer
 As eating vellum and parchment with fear.
 To tie a stone around it and the sling
 The book into the river is a thing
 I might not have thought of myself in
 string.
 It's not a proof divinity contrives
 Inspiring the book for poor human lives,
 But some divine madness remains to teach
 The world what is and is not to impeach.

Jeremiah 52

1 Zedekiah *was* twenty-one
 Years old when he became the one
 To reign eleven years as king
 In city of Jerusalem.
 His mother's name *was* Hamutal
 Jeremiah's daughter and gem
 Of Libnah. 2 And he did in thrall
 The evil in the eyes of YHWH,
 According to all the things due
 Jehoiakim *in his own pew*.
 3 For through the anger of YHWH it
 Happened in Jerusalem and
 Judah, till he had cast the band
 Out from His presence as unfit,
 That Zedekiah rebelled too
 Against king of Babylon's crew.
 4 And it happened in the ninth year
 Of his reign, in tenth month and on
 The tenth of the month at day dawn,
 Nebuchadrezzar who was king
 Of Babylon, came he and wing
 Of all his army, to attack
 Jerusalem, and pitched no slack
 Against it, and built forts in back.
 5 And so the town was set around
 Until eleventh year in bound
 Of Zedekiah, king on ground.
 6 And in the fourth month in the day
 Number nine of the month in sway,
 The famine was great in the town,
 So that there was no bread *for frown*
 Or money for the folk to stay.
 7 Then the city was broken up,
 And all the soldiers fled like tup,
 And went out of the town by night
 By the way of the gate in sight

Between the two walls, which was by
The king's garden; Chaldeans sly
Surrounded the town all about,
And they went down by the plain's route.

The siege had lasted six months to the day
When Zedekiah caught before the fray
Slipped through the garden to scramble
away.

His youth was not excuse for what he did,
The reputation of the prophet hid
No means or reasons to rebel in time
Against the king of Babylon for crime.
Beloved, You set a siege upon my heart
Rebelling after months of loving dart,
And see with pity how I slip between
The lilacs in the semi-darkness' sheen.
Beloved, will You catch me in trap or snare
As I step smugly from confining lair
Beneath the faint stars that proclaim their
share?

8 But the Chaldean army came
Pursuing after king of fame
And overtook Zedekiah
In the plains of Jericho's maw;
And all his army fled the flame.
9 Then they took the king and bore up
To King of Babylon like cup
To Riblah there in Hamath's land,
Where he gave judgement on his stand.
10 The king of Babylon killed all
The sons of Zedekiah's fall
Before his eyes, and killed also
The princes of Judah not slow
In Riblah. 11 He put out the eyes
Of Zedekiah to despise;
The king of Babylon bound him
In chains and carried him out grim
To Babylon, and put him in
Prison till the day of his bin.

Beloved, catch me before Jericho's plain
As I slink down the hilly road in train,
Slay all my offspring, every sinful beat,
And put out the eyes that seek wicked treat.
Carry me to a far land bound in chains
As all around me atmosphere complains,
And sun and moon pitch in the horrid heat
And stars take pity on my bloody feet.
Carry me far away to sunlit walls,
To prisons shining beneath swallows' calls,

And bury me forever and a day
Within the prison of Your heart in sway,
And never, my Beloved, let me away,
Let me never depart the golden falls.

12 And in the fifth month and the day
Number ten of the month in sway,
Which was the nineteenth year of reign
Of Nebuchadrezzar the fane
Of Babylon, came chief of guard
Nebusaradan who was starred
To serve the king of Babylon,
Into Jerusalem for fun.

13 He burned the house of YHWH and yet
The king's palace and all the met
Palaces of Jerusalem,
And all the homes of the great men,
He burned with fire and burned again.

14 And all the Chaldean army
With the chief of the guard set free,
Broke down all Jerusalem's walls
Around about and in their brawls.

15 And Nebozaradan the chief
Of the guard bore without relief
Away the captives of the poor
Of the people and the rest sure
That had remained there in the town,
And those that had turned coat for frown
To save their lives before the king
Of Babylon, and everything
That was left of the people's ring.

16 But Nebusaradan the chief
Of the guard left for their relief
The poor of the land to their grief
As vinedressers and husbandmen.
17 Also the pillar of brass den
That were in house of YHWH and yet
The bases and the brazen vat
That was in house of YHWH and sat,
The Chaldeans broke and bore all
The brass to Babylon to gall.

18 The caldrons also and the spoons,
The shovels and snuffers and bowls,
All the pots of brass the dragoons
Took off from the service on shoals.
19 The basins, fire pans, and the bowls,
The caldrons, candlesticks and spoons,
The cups of gold in golden rows,
And those of silver as they chose,
The chief of the guard took and rose.
20 The two pillars, the sea and twelve
Brazen bulls under base to delve,

Which Solomon the king had made
In YHWH's house, the brass on parade
Was without weight and count unstayed.
21 As for the pillars height of each
Was eighteen armlengths in its reach,
A line of twelve armlengths went round,
The thickness of them four thumbs
crowned,

And it was hollow *by the sound*.
22 A brazen chapter made the crown,
The height of one of those came down
To five armlengths, with filigree
And pomegranates on degree
Around it all of brazen sea.
The second pillar also had
Pomegranates like the first one had.
23 There were ninety-six on each side,
All the pomegranates to ride
On filigree, a hundred round.

The pillars of the temple there where sat
My ancestors in faith and light and fat
Have all been taken by the Roman crowd
And given to idols to praise allowed.
The old Adventist faith that questions that
Old doctrine of the Trinity and more,
Atonement on the cross, the churchly gore,
Is spoiled and ruined and cast out of the
door.

The glory is departed and the share
Of hope in Your returning for the fair,
And yet I stay to dress the figs and bear
The olives that grow wild about the room,
Content in poverty and single doom,
Content to stay with heather and the broom.

24 The chief of the guard took Seraiah
The chief priest, also Zephaniah
The second priest, and from the door
Three keepers *of more than a score*:
26 He also took a eunuch out
Of the city, who had charge stout
Of soldiers and seven of them
Who were near the king's person's *gem*,
Which were found in the city's *hem*,
And the main scribe of all the host,
Who mustered the people in boast,
And sixty men of the land's folk
Found in the city at a stroke,
He took them all to Riblah's *oak*.
27 The king of Babylon struck them,
And put them to death in Riblah,

In the land of Hamath and stem.
So Judah was borne up in claw
Captive from his own camera.
28 This is the folk Nebuchadrezzar
Carried out captive, every geezer:
In the seventh year three thousand
Jews and twenty-three left in hand.
29 In the eighteenth year of the reign
Of Nebuchadrezzar for pain
He carried away captive from
Jerusalem eight hundred bum
And thirty-two persons in sum.
30 In the twenty-third year of reign
Of Nebuchadrezzar for drain
Nebusaradan, chief of guard,
Carried away captive unstarred
Of the Jews seven hundred more
And forty-five persons in store.
30 All the persons were four thousand
And six hundred taken in band.

31 In thirty-seventh year it came
To pass in captivity's frame
Of Jehoiachin king of Judah,
In the twelfth month, in the day ruler
Of twenty-fifth, Babylon's king
Evilmerodach in the spring
Of his first year he raised the head
Of Jehoiachin, had him led
From prison, kind of Judah fed.
32 He spoke kindly to him and set
His throne above the throne of yet
The kings with him in Babylon,
33 And changed his prison clothing spun,
And he always ate before him
All the days of his life grown dim.
34 As for his feeding there was set
Always a dinner from king met
Of Babylon, and every day
A portion till his death in sway,
All the days of his life *to stray*.

The rulers You've apportioned to the state
Of heathendom that guide the small and
great
Are benign and kind in the way they speak,
Though with a strong hand the prevent the
peek
Of any change toward the law that You,
Beloved, spoke on Sinai's eternal brew.
That all men have but one God is no thing
That they will accept in the heathen ring.
That You forgive without the bloody kill

Is nothing they can understand now still.
That Sabbath is a right of man and beast
Is a principle that they have released.
That life is sacred and no man must die
At human hand is something they belie.

Lamentations

Some say the style and content of this book
Belies the author Jeremiah's look.

It may be so, though in the aftermath
Of the destruction, he might take the path
Of formal lamentation. I have heard
The Finnish sort of laments that have
stirred

The Finnish hearts for centuries and note
That they are filled with formula of rote.
Each folk has its own pedestal and ware:
Finns weep better than others on the stair.
The book of such laments, though filled
with such

Formalities still now prevail to touch
The heart of stone with grief and grief as
much.

The sharpening of gems releases care.

Lamentations 1

1 Ah, does the town sit solitary,
Among her once were people merry!
Alas, she is a widow now,
A great one once and at the prow
Against nations, princess of states,
At last set to tribute in rates.
2 By night she weeps tears on her cheeks;
Between her lovers vainly seeks
Boys to comfort, while all her friends
Belong with traitors to their ends,
Become as enemies in cliques.
3 Gone to captivity is Judah,
Gone into her affliction ruder,
Greater to be her servitude,
Guest now among a heathen brood,
Going no rest from all the crude
Guys in pursuit of her with beaks.
4 Do not the ways of Zion mourn
Dumbfounded none come to the bourn
Due solemn festivals: her gates
Desolate all made in estates;
Dumbly priests sigh and virgins fail,
Disaster, bitterness her tale.
5 Her adversaries are the chief,

Her enemies prosper like thief,
Has YHWH afflicted her for all
Her sins transgressing at the wall;
Her offspring in captivity
Have gone before the enemy.
6 When from the daughter of Zion
Will all her beauty gone and done
With her princes become like harts
Without pasture; without their carts
Why do they go before pursuer
Weakened in sight of every viewer!

I might weep for the devastations wrought
By the Khmer Rouge, or Hutler's fateful
spot,
Or what Rwanda saw of blood and more.
I might weep for the millions lost in lore
When missionaries found the New World's
shore.

I might weep for my own of blasting fame,
The Covenanters for no better name.
It's not Jerusalem alone that sees
The blood run down beneath the ample
breeze.

The marsh Arabs, some perhaps of the
spawn

Of those who attacked Your city at dawn,
Have lately been annihilated by
The modern fanes of Babylon and sky.
There's always room to weep upon one's
knees.

7 Zeal in Jerusalem minds of
Zenith of her affliction's glove,
Zigzagging griefs contrasting with
Zithers by Muhammadan myth,
Zones ancient, when her people fell
Zing in the hand of foes to tell,
Zenanahs without aid where those
Zestful mocked at her Sabbaths' glows.
8 How has Jerusalem now sinned!
Honoured no more scattered by wind,
Having seen her in nakedness,
Hell-bent on despising her dress,
Hoarse in her sighs, turned back to mess.
9 The filth is in her skirts to send
That memory up to the last end;
Therefore she came down wonderfully;
Thanking no comforter to see.
Then YHWH, see my affliction bide:
There the enemy's magnified.
10 Yet the foe spreads his hand upon

Yesteryear's Muhammadans drawn;
Yelling, she saw heathen go in
Yon sanctuary, whom for sin
You have commanded they should not
Yield in Your congregation's plot.
11 Complaining, all her people sigh,
Coming to find their bread, or try;
Committing to loss Muhammad,
Clean for meat to relieve the sad;
Consider, YHWH and see, for I
Clamour in my own vileness' sty.

The Muhammadan myth mocks Sabbaths
to this day,
And there have even been cases astray
Where Jews reverting to Islam betray
The Sabbath rest that transmits men its ray.
Beloved, reward the Ethiopian
Who has regard to Sabbath as he can,
And bless the Shi'ite who remember to
Cut hair and nails before the Friday crew
Join in the prayer of One in praise of You.
Give each one her reward, who stops to
find
The clear waters of Sabbath while the
wined
Continue in the jungle law that makes
The weaker the dupe of the king's
mistakes.

Beloved, on blessed manna I have dined.

12 Like nothing to you, passers-by?
Look and see if any folk cry
Lost in such sorrow as am I,
Left in grief by the hand of YHWH,
Long is the day of His wrath due.
13 Mandating fire into my bones,
Making it win against my stones;
Matting a net beneath my feet,
More has he turned me to defeat;
Making me desolate and faint
Matching day's length without restraint.
14 Now the yoke of my wickedness
Nothing from his hand can outpress;
Netted in wreaths and come to my
Neck: He has made my strength to die;
New in their hands delivered me,
Not to rise but by YHWH's decree.
15 Stepping upon all my strong men,
Summoning assembly again,
Stinging against me, Lord would crush
Singly my young men in the rush:

So YHWH's stepped on the virgin girl,
Sung as daughter of Zion's churl,
Slung as in a winepress in flush.
16 I weep for all these things and my
Eye runs down with the tears to sigh,
All parted are comforters mine;
In desolation my spawn's vine,
Enemies have prevailed in sign.

Mandate, Beloved, the fire within my
bones
As I pass by the churlish, earthly thrones
And take the fire of love to You that I
Find raging on the earth, beneath the sky.
Mandate, Beloved, the quenchless grief of
grace,

The night and day search for Your divine
face,
And as I whirl all about the craven earth,
Quench my thirst not with water or with
dearth.

Beloved, the haven of attack and blast
Of arms is more than I've bargained to cast,
And while the fevered run is here to last,
I turn in smouldering silence toward Your
way,

Stop yearning and remain in quiet play
To find that You are still in roundelay.

17 Forth spread the hands of Zion's prayer,
Pulled up are stakes of comfort there;
Full well has YHWH commanded that
Poor Jacob's surrounded on mat,
Flung down is Jerusalem now,
Pointed at like a menstruous cow.

18 Saintly is YHWH, though I've rebelled,
Sinned against His commandment held;
See my sorrow and hear, all folk,
Sunken are my virgins by stroke,
Severed and borne captive all my
Sweet young men, I pray you and sigh.
19 Called for my lovers, they deceived;
Came priest and elder and received
City to be their own ghost town;
Coming like scavengers on down.

20 Rise, YHWH, see, I am in distress;
Regard my bowels' troubled ingress;
Returned within me is my heart;
Rebelled have I in grievous part;
Realms everywhere bow to the sword,
Reward at home is death's reward.

21 Sighing of mine is heard abroad,

Sign of comfort comes not on sod;
 Song of my trouble's heard by foe;
 Some joy it is to them to show;
 Summon Your day, they will be low.
 22 Their wickedness comes before You;
 Till them by their transgressions due;
 Toll of my sighs is great in view;
 The heart is faint beyond my rue.

Jerusalem knew every sort of prayer,
 But there is one that is beyond compare:
 The spreading out of hands devoid of ware
 In supplication to Your noble heart.
 Beloved, I turn toward the city's part
 And spread my hands with palms up to the
 start,
 And find that silence is Your answer still,
 A comfort and a warning on the hill.
 Summon Your day, Beloved, or then
 remain
 In Your unspoken knowing of terrain,
 While I bring from the night David's new
 song
 As ancient as the Meccan pilgrim throng,
 As quiet as the dark before the dawn,
 As fresh as the sprung light where I have
 lain.

Lamentations 2

1 Anger of YHWH covers in veil
 All the daughter of Zion's travail,
 And cast down from the heights to earth
 Account of Israel's beauty's worth,
 And he did not remember then
 Aught of His footstool when again
Anger flashed from His divine berth.
 2 By swallowing Jacob's folk YHWH
 Brooks no pity upon its crew:
 Because His wrath was great he threw
 Both strongholds and the daughter too
 Brought forth in Judah; and so He's
 Brought them down to the ground to freeze;
 Bound in pollution kingdom and
 Broken the princes of the land.
 3 Gone all the power of Israel
 Guttled by His fierce anger's spell:
 Great is His right hand raised to quell
 Grasp of the enemy, to break
 Gap of flames against Jacob's stake,
 Ghastly in burning all in wake.
 4 Does He not bent his bow like foe?
 Double to enemy He'd go

Down with his fight hand raise to kill
 Dozens of Muhammadans' spring
 Dowsing tents of Zion to fill,
 Drumming His wrath like anything.
 5 How YHWH's become an enemy:
 He's swallowed Israel in spree,
 He's swallowed up her palaces;
 Having destroyed His strongholds' whiz,
 Hiding no increase from the spawn
 Hoped for from Judah of outdrawn
 Hell of mourning, lamenting's *swan*.
 6 With shaking like a vine he vents
 Wrath on His tabernacle's tents,
 Violently destroying place
 Where the assembly came to pace;
 Why has YHWH caused the solemn feast
 With its sabbath to go decreased
 Without remembrance in Zion's way,
 While king and priest despise the sway
 Where His wrath comes to meet the day?
 7 Zapped off His altar has now YHWH,
 Zeal to hate His own temple's due,
 Zest of the foe He brings in view,
 Zone of her palace walls; they've made
 Zoom on the house of YHWH waylaid,
 Zipped as in day of grand parade.

Zion is cast down from the heights to earth.
 That's something You have never held as
 worth
 Correcting. I myself have seen the scene
 And found that Mount Zion's a thing
 between
 A gully and a hill. No mountain's there.
 Just a dry brook that sinks beneath its
 share.
 I've seen some mountains in my time, I
 swear,
 And they were grander than the rise up to
 The gate of the Messiah still in view.
 Try Mont Blanc for a start, its white head
 high
 And visible against a clean, clear sky
 Beyond Geneva and the lake as far
 As the road takes along the Rhone by car.
 I might as well say one candle's a star.

8 Has YHWH intended to destroy
 His wall of Zion's daughter's joy?
 He's stretched out a line, not withdrawn
 Hand from destroying *at the dawn*:
 He made the rampart and the wall

Have pain lamenting, go in thrall.
 9 To sink her gates into the ground
 The bars are destroyed round and round;
 Taken among the Gentiles are
 The king and her princes and star:
 The law's no more, her prophets too
 Tend no more vision from Lord YHWH.
 10 Yet sitting on the ground the old
 Yobs of Zion's daughter are sold
 Yogis of silence; they have thrown
 Yards of dust on their heads in groan,
 Yanked sackcloth round themselves in
 hem,
 Young virgins of Jerusalem
 Yield to hang down their heads to stone.
 11 Consumed by tears have been my eyes,
 Contorted bowels, poured out in guise
 Concealing earth my liver fails,
 Caused by the breach my folk entails;
 Confrères of infants faint upon
 City streets hoping for dawn.
 12 Languishing they beg mothers for
 Last flour and grape-juice in the store,
 Left like the wounded in the square,
 Last breath on mothers' breasts laid bare.
 13 Make me know what witness to bring,
 Minded to equate with you, sing
 My comfort to you, virgin thing
 Mated to Zion? For your wound's great
 Matching the sea, who cures your state?
 14 Now have your prophets prophesied
 Nothing but falsehood to your pride;
 Nor have they revealed on your side
 Nettling iniquity to bide,
 Nor brought you to penance in tide;
 Nothing but vain messages and
 Nought but cause to drive from the land.

The prophecy of falsehood, it is sure,
 Despite the language elevated, pure.
 The prophecy of peace throughout the
 world
 While keeping law of jungle still unfurled
 Cannot succeed. There must be rule of state
 That makes the non-negotiable in rate
 Of rights for the disenfranchised of late.
 Without that revolution will come soon,
 There is no force of violence in boon
 That can prevent uprising to the moon.
 Beloved, bring Sabbath as a measured thing
 To keep in place the president and king,
 And show that right of Decalogue is fair,

Not to be twiddled with and sent to spare.

15 So everyone that passes by
 Stops to clap their hands at your cry;
 Some hiss and some wag their head at
 Such spawn on Jerusalem's mat,
 Saying "Is this the city that
 Some call the pinnacle that sat
 Sweetly in beauty, all earth's joy?
 16 Perversely your foes speak attack,
 Pursing lips, gnashing teeth to clack,
 Proclaiming, "We've swallowed her up,
 Praying for this day come to sup,
 Pre-empting what we found in stack."
 17 And YHWH has done what He had
 planned,
 Over the word of His command
 Anciently spoken: He's thrown down
 And has not pitied *any town*,
 Ordered the enemy to sing
 Over you, He's set the horn's *ring*
 Of your attackers *with a frown*.
 18 So their heart cried to the Lord,
 Said "O wall of Zion's adored,
 Set tears to run down like a stream,
 Spilling day and by the night's dream,
 Save yourself no rest, do not let
 Cease apple of your eye upset.
 19 Quickly, get up, cry in the night,
 Quiver to start the watches right
 Quenching not heart poured in His sight
 Quantities rushed like water sprite,
 Questing the Lord for children's life
 Quelled by hunger in the street's strife.
 20 Regard, O YHWH, consider who
 Receives what You have done in due.
 Raw foetus flesh shall women eat,
 Reduced the priest and prophet meet
 Refused in the Lord's temple pew?
 21 See how young and old lie abroad,
 Streets covered with virgins and stout
 Single young men sword-slain about,
 Slain in Your anger, You have killed,
 Scattered without pity the stilled.
 22 Then You've summoned as to a feast
 Terrors around about increased,
 That in the day of YHWH's wrath none
 Together escape or stay spun;
 Those I have swaddled and brought up,
 They are consumed as My foes sup.

You summon terror as to wedding feast.

Does she wear white or black, the smooth
or creased?

Does she come tripping lightly and with
smile

To make her coming sinister with guile?
You summon terror, send a note in chance
With RSVP if she wants to dance,
With envelop perfumed and purple ink.
Does terror come to settle on the brink?
Beloved, the silent steps of terror still
Turn round an earth where many eat their
fill

And more it seems go to sleep in the dark,
With hunger gnawing tightly at the spark
Of darling sinking quietly to find
If terror's allowed some days to be blind.

Lamentations 3

1 Affliction I've seen by the rod
Of His wrath, *by the wrath of God.*
2 Among dark paths He's led me out,
Without light *wandering about.*
3 Against me He has turned all day.
4 Both flesh and skin he's bold to lay
Decrepit, broken bones for pay.
5 Building around me gall and gout,
6 Billeting me in darkened room
As ancient dead to meet their doom.
7 Greatly He's hedged me round so I
Cannot get out, He's held me by
A heavy chain *beneath the sky.*
8 Grow louder do my cry and shout,
My prayers He comes to shut them out.
9 Graven stones enclose my ways here,
He makes my paths crooked *in fear.*
10 Down in ambush like a bear He
Waits for me, and He secretly
Hides like a lion for the prey.

Those who think Jesus is God, that is, You,
Sometimes relate the blessed man in view
Of lion on the track of prey or not;
The lion of the tribe of Judah's plot.
But I have never yet heard tell or sing
That You are like a bear for anything.
If you are like a bear, I wonder if
You are a black or white one in the stiff.
Beloved, it does not matter what beast can
Best describe you by form, character, plan,
But colour is a thing of great import.
We creatures are a very racist sort.
So if you are a bear, Beloved, take note

To keep Your colour fair and well afloat.

11 Desolation turns round my way
And pulls me into pieces where
He makes my desolation bare.
12 Divined by His bow bent, He sets
Me as the arrow's mark *for bets.*
13 He's shot my kidneys with the straight
Arrows from His quiver in rate.
14 How I've become the butt of song
To all my people all day long.
15 He has filled me with bitterness,
He's made me drink wormwood's caress.
16 With grit He's broken my teeth too,
And fed me on ashes in brew.
17 Where have you taken me from peace?
I have forgotten spawn's increase,
18 While I said "My strength and my hope
Is perished from YHWH *and His scope.*"
19 Zeal in affliction and despair
Remember, wormwood and gall there.
20 Zones of remembrance still repair
To humble my soul everywhere.

Unless You are a primitive select
That anywhere around the world
unwrecked

Uses a bow, then arrows at the sling
Make me think that You are a red-skin
king.

You need not live in tipi, ride a horse,
That's all a recent Plains affair, of course.
More likely You live in a longhouse where
The family extended come to share
The maize, the beans and squash and stop
to find

The faces are as false as they're confined.
Beloved, the ancient manners of the race,
The ancient tongue, the memories of grace,
Are worthy of Your power and throne and
face

Even above the burning fires and mace.

21 Zestfully I consider this,
That is why I have hope to kiss.
22 Hidden in YHWH's mercies we're not
Consumed, His compassions fail not.
23 How they are renewed with the day:
Great is Your faithfulness in sway!
24 Here is YHWH now my heritage,
I say, therefore my hope is sage.
25 That YHWH is good to those who wait

For Him, and seek Him *at the gate*,
 26 To hope for good and quietly
 Wait for YHWH's salvation to be:
 27 This is good for a man to bear
 The yoke of his youth everywhere.
 28 In silence and alone he sits,
 Because he's borne it on his wits.
 29 Into the dust he lays his lip,
 In hope of any fellowship.
 30 Indeed, he gives his cheek to one
 Who strikes him, he's filled to the gun
 With the reproach *he has not won*.
 31 Cast off the Lord will not when done.

They told me Lamentations had no word
 Of comfort or of positive conferred,
 But here is one that's greater than another
 In any work of writing by a brother.
 Great is Your faithfulness indeed I find
 Despite the whirling of the worldly blind.
 Great is Your faithfulness, though
 humankind
 Is caught in treachery on every hand.
 Beloved, I flee from friend and brother and
 From my own self to seek in Your
 command
 The substance of all faith, the hope of
 dreams,
 The golden lights of truth, the silver
 streams
 That flicker through the mist of swirling
 white
 That joins and separates me from the right.

32 Cause grief He may, yet He will stay
 In His compassion by the sway
 Of His mercies in kindness' way.
 33 Can He afflict by His own will
 Or grieve the sons of men here still,
 34 Lest He crush under His feet all
 The prisoners in the earth's thrall?
 35 Leaving aside the right of man
 Before the face of Elyon's scan?
 36 Lacking justice in His judgement,
 Has the Lord not given the scent?
 37 May any command to take place
 What the Lord does not make in trace?
 38 Mouth of Elyon is source of all,
 Both good and evil *on the ball*.
 39 Man living may complain, but what
 Use is it before punished glut?
 40 Now let us search and try our ways,

And turn again to YHWH in praise.
 41 Needs be we lift up heart and hands
 To El who in the heavens stands.

The charismatic fools around this place
 Lift up their waving hands to swing a trace
 About the empty air they think is filled
 With Your spirit just because beaked and
 billed
 Can utter nonsense on the slaughter ground.
 Beloved, judge those who muddy divine
 sound.
 This word's one written in the eastern shore
 In centuries long past, the lifted lore
 Of hands was not the Baalish swing they
 love,
 But raising hand palms out, not shot above,
 But at the level of the ears to say
 Allah is greater than their earthy sway,
 Their evil arms and bombs, and under way
 Attacks on safe civilians asked to pay.

42 Now we've transgressed and have
 rebelled,
 You have not pardoned *though You've*
 quelled.
 43 So You've spread wrath on us to drive,
 You've killed not pitying alive.
 44 Setting a cloud before Your face
 You keep our prayers out of the place.
 45 Scruff refuse among all the folk
 You've made us *and put under yoke*.
 46 Picked up by foes with open paw
 We find ourselves *under their claw*.
 47 Prophecy comes to us in fear,
 A snare and a destruction near.
 48 Pouring torrents of tears, my eye
 Mourns defeat of my people nigh.
 49 Eye trickling tears, it does not cease,
 There is no coming of release,
 50 Until YHWH looks down from the sky.
 51 Acting against my heart, my eye
 Regards spawn of my city cry.
 52 Sorely like a bird my foes come
 To chase me without cause *or crumb*.
 53 Surrounding my life in a pit,
 They cast a stone here where I sit.
 54 Streams overflowed above my head,
 "And I have been cut off," I said.
 55 *Quickly* I call upon Your name,
 O YHWH, from the low *pit in claim*.
 56 Quavering You have heard my voice,

Do not hide Your ear from my choice,
Hear my cry, *so I may rejoice.*
57 Come near at day, I called on You,
You said "Do not fear, *just be true.*"

After laying the blame on You, the man
Tells me not to fear, just be true to plan.
Today the world finds that You only bear
Love unconditional to all the fair.
I doubt the word of ancient wisdom there,
I doubt the love without conditions' span,
I doubt that I can live a day at all
Or even one hour outside of the thrall
Of fear, given I doubt both hill and hall.
But let me, my Beloved, be ever true,
Despite the circumstance, to Your own
view,
Through cloud of information in review,
Through failure of finance and custom's
rue.
Keep me still whirling while I'm on the
ball.

58 Replying, Lord, You plead my cause,
You have redeemed my life from claws.
59 Remember, YHWH, You've seen my
wrong,

So judge my cause, for me *be strong.*
60 Rightly You see their vengeance all,
Their imaginations in thrall.
61 Song of reproach You've heard, O
YHWH,

All their imaginations' brew,
62 Sizzling lips rising against me,
Device against me constantly.
63 See when they sit, when they get up,
I am the music in their *cup.*
64 Take vengeance upon them, O YHWH,
According to the work they do.
65 Tender a cover on their heart
To curse them from the very start.
66 Trample them down and so destroy
In wrath under YHWH's sky employ.

Beloved, I've never heard from You reply.
The air is silent when You're going by.
I've never heard You plead my cause at all,
And like so many others in the stall
It bears some pleading from the wrath of
both
The small and great who great me with an
oath.

I do not know what's in Your lofty mind,
What You remember of the good and kind
Or of the wicked show upon the earth.
So judge my cause, Beloved, there is no
other
To do so, though You are not a good
mother,
Always out of sight, never with a word
Of comfort that at least I could have heard.
In life and lamentation, all is blurred.

Lamentations 4

1 Ah, how dim has the gold become!
The most fine gold changed into scum!
The sanctuary stones poured out
At the head of the streets about.
2 Best sons of the fortress are like
Fine gold, esteemed like pots to strike
At the hand at the potter's wheel!
3 Given to sea monsters is to nurse
At the breast their young ones *perverse,*
But the daughter of my folk stands
Cruel as the ostrich on the sands.
4 Dipped is the tongue of sucking child
Stuck to the roof of mouth in wild
Thirst, and the young ones beg for bread
And there's no one to deal for dread.
5 How desolate upon the streets
Are those who did feed upon treats,
Those who were laid on silken bed
Are now led to the dung and fed.

The early Advents sought to find the start
Of sanctuary in a golden part,
A real thing, not a ghostly vacuous fart.
The Hellenistic spirit, hand of Rome,
In stealth has stolen all that faith and loam
And spiritualized everything until
The sea monsters alone drink milk and
swill.

The pen of good Uriah fails to show
The blind hearts now the righter way to go,
And all look to scholastic rule and air,
Denying golden street and harp as fair.
Gold was once flesh of gods, and so is still
To bankers who flick pens at wealth at will,
And sign away to faith of Rome a bill.

6 What sin of my folk's daughter rises,
Above Sodom's punishment prises,
That was thrown down and suddenly
With none to stay with hands or plea.

7 Zealots of Nazarites were pure
 Like snow, whiter than milk's allure,
 More ruddy in body than stone
 Of rubies, polished and to hone
 Like sapphire, *a gem bright and sure.*
 8 How their face is blacker than coal,
 None recognizes them in toll.
 9 Those killed by the sword win a fate
 Better than those who stay to wait
 The death of hunger, for they pine
 Away, stricken through want of vine
 And field *that became desolate.*
 10 Yet tender women's hand have boiled
 Their own spawn, they became meat toiled
 On the destruction of the spawn
 Of my people *without the dawn.*
 11 Can YHWH accomplish all His wrath?
 He's poured out anger on our path,
 He's kindled fire in Zion's way,
 Destroyed foundations *in a day.*
 12 Let kings of earth, all those who dwell
 Upon the earth, who could not tell
 The foe and enemy should come
 To enter in Jerusalem
Believe the destruction in sum.
 13 Many the sins her prophets did,
 Iniquities that her priests hid,
 Shedding the blood of the just there.
 14 Now wandering like blind men and bare
 In the streets, they've spoiled all with
 blood,
 So none could touch their garments' crud.
 15 Sound loud to them, "Depart, unclean,
 Depart, depart, touch not the scene,"
 When they fled out to wander there,
 They said among the heathen's share,
 That they shall no more sojourn there.
 16 Pelting of YHWH's divided them,
 He will no longer regard them;
 They did not have respect for priest,
 Showed no regard for elders' *feast.*
 17 Our eyes fail watching in vain help,
 In watching we have found the whelp
 Of a nation that could not save.
 18 So they hunt our steps to the grave,
 So we cannot go in our streets,
 Our end is near, and our day greets
 The consummation to deprave.
 19 Come persecutors faster than
 The eagles of the sky to scan,
 They follow us upon the hills,
 They ambush us in desert rills.

20 Rushing breath of our nostrils fell
 In their pits, YHWH's Messiah tell,
 Of whom we said "Beneath his spell
 We'll live among the heathen well."
 21 Sing and be glad, O Edom's spawn,
 Who live in the land of Uz drawn,
 The cup will also come to you,
 You will be drunken with the brew,
 And naked *in that day come too.*
 22 The punishment of your sin's done,
 O daughter of Zion unspun,
 He'll not take you captive again,
 He'll deal with you sin too, O den
 Of Edom, He'll show what you've done.

The prophet Jeremiah, if he came
 To write the Lamentations of his fame,
 Predicted the jet fighter with this word,
 Faster than eagles flying in absurd
 And wicked show of power and hate.
 As beautiful as eagles, see them wait
 On ship decks armed with runways in the
 sun,
 Full of the expectation of the gun.
 Whether with great insight or inspiration,
 Or with the realizing human ration
 Is always evil and predictable,
 The prophet sees the future with a pull.
 The eagle sight is also Gospel's spell,
 How often it too has been a life's knell.

Lamentations 5

1 Remember, YHWH, what's come on us,
 Consider and see all the fuss.
 2 Our heritage is given away
 To strangers, and our houses' sway
 To foreigners *who do not pay.*
 3 We're orphans and we're fatherless,
 Our mothers are in widows' dress.
 4 We've drunk our water bought for pay,
 Our wood is sold to us each day.
 5 Our necks are under persecution,
 We work for no rest in solution.
 6 We've given Egyptians our own power,
 Assyrians so we might scour
 For bread to feed in distribution.

A few thousand of Jews in days gone by
 Are nothing but a drop beneath the sky
 Of all the dispossessed. I hear my own
 Native American without a groan
 Sink quietly, with a forgotten sigh.

The millions that were scattered, felled, and
slain

Among the red men for the slighter gain
Of furs and lands mean nothing here or
then.

They are among the most forgotten men.
Beloved, if You keep memory alive
Within Your heart, what matter if You
strive

In Your eternity? The past is done
And gone, no more to see the sun.
One shoah succeeds others on the run.

7 Our ancestors have sinned and failed,
And we have borne results entailed.

8 Servants have ruled us, there is none
To save us from their power that won.

9 For fear of our lives we fetch bread,
Because of sword in desert led.

10 Our skin was scorched black as in heat
Of an oven without retreat
From terrors of famine replete.

11 They ravished Zion's women there,
The maids of Judah's cities fair.

12 Princes are hung up by their hand,
Faces of elders bear their brand.

13 They took young men for studs in fee,
Young children fell beneath degree
Of wooden burdens constantly.

14 The elders have ceased from the gate,
The young men from music to rate.

15 The joy of our heart fails at last,
Our dance is turned to mourning cast.

16 The crown has fallen from our head,
Woe to us who have sinned instead!

There's hardly any on the earth today,
And hardly in the past of ruthless sway
That is not herded in some and same way
Into the famine, ravishment or power
Of prostitution on a fainting hour.

Why weep for fast reality at all?
Why not rejoice within to see the thrall
Of dandelion thrust up from the black pit
Of asphalt to bloom without hope or wit?
Beloved, I shut myself within, without
And touch the silence of my own with
shout,

With shout of silence in a skull laid bare
To sun and wind and rain with nothing
there.

I mutter words none understand to swear.

17 And this is why our heart is faint,
And why our eyes dim with restraint.

18 For Zion's mountain desolate,
The foxes walk there with a mate.

19 But You, O YHWH, remain for ever,
Your throne and Your every endeavour
From generations consummate.

20 Why do You constantly forget,
Forsaking us so long in set?

21 Turn us to You, O YHWH, and we
Shall be turned, so renew and see
Our days as in ancient degree.

22 For if you utterly reject,
You've been wroth against us unchecked.

If Jeremiah asked the question then,
And heard no answer by his faith again,
What hope is there now when I raise a cry
In questioning before the troubled sky?
Beloved, I raise the question till I die,
And You may speak or not as best You
choose,

But I shall breathe blasphemies as I muse
Until light floods the heart that You abuse.
Beloved, the help and hope of song and
pine

Resettle after every prayer of mine,
And though I shake me like a dervish dog,
The fluff remains to itch me in the fog.
Grief or the acquiescent power to stay,
I rise and sing on peach and every day.

Baruch

The centuries to follow in the wake
Of Jeremiah and kingly mistake
To trust Egyptians for safety in store
Show that the reputation more and more
Of Jeremiah grew in every way.
Not only Baruch as a book bears sway
In testimony of that genre's pay.
The influences seep through Pentateuch
And reach from peasant up to king and
duke.

Beloved, the book of prayer and prophecy,
Letter posted against idolatry,
Distils in wisdom for a night and day,
And so I turn to read its pages few
And find them leading ever back to You.

Baruch 1

1 These are the words of the book which
Baruch who was son of Neraiah,
Son of Mahseiah *for a switch*,
Who was the son of Zedekiah,
The son of Hasadiah, son
Of Hilkiah, in Babylon
Wrote 2 in the fifth year, seventh day
Of the month, at the time when sway
Of Chaldeans conquered the town
Jerusalem and burned it down.
3 Baruch read the words of this book
In the hearing and in the look
Of Jeconiah the son of
Jehoiakim, Judah's king's *love*,
And in hearing of all the folk
Who came to hear what the book spoke,
4 Before the mighty men and princes,
In the hearing of the elders' *winces*,
And in hearing of all the folk,
From least to great, all in the yoke
Of Babylon by River Sud.
5 They wept and fasted, and in flood
Prayed before YHWH, 6 they gathered up
Money, each one by his own cup,
7 And sent it to Jerusalem
To Jehoiakim the high priest,
The son of Hilkiah, the gem
Son of Shallum, and to each priest,
And to all the folk *but not beast*
There with him in Jerusalem.

The practice of collection for the poor
And for adorning shrines has come down
sure
From the days of Baruch and Babylon,
The product of oppression once begun.
Collection for the poor of that fair town
Was performed by even man of renown,
Saul of Tarsus, so long the practice vied
Among the faithful on the riverside.
Beloved, I've given all that I have earned
To feed the hungry or to serve the spurned,
And count no loss but only reach the tide
Of living in my comfort to abide.
The world turns on its groans from side to
side
And yet its folk have nothing ever learned.

8 At the same time, on the tenth day
Of Sivan, Baruch took array
Of vessels of the house of YHWH,

Which had been carried away too
From the temple, and to return
Them to the land of Judah stern,
The silver vessels which the son
Of Josiah Zedekiah,
King of Judah, had made to stun,
9 After Nebuchadnezzar king
Of Babylon bore everything
Away from Jerusalem then
Jeconiah and the princes' men
And prisoners and mighty men
And the folk of the land, and brought
Them to Babylon in the plot.
10 And they said "We hereby send you
Some money, so buy with it too
Burnt offerings and sin offering new
And incense, and grain offerings too,
And offer on altar of YHWH
Our Alohim, 11 "and also pray
For the life of the king in sway
Of Babylon, Nebuchadnezzar,
For the life of his son and pleaser
Belshazzar, that their days on earth
May be like days of heaven in worth.
12 "And YHWH will give us strength, and
He
Will give light to our eyes, and we
Shall live under protecting hand
Of Nebuchadnezzar to stand
As king of Babylon and by
Protection of his son to cry
Belshazzar, and we shall serve them
A long time and in favour's hem.

Here starts establishment of religion,
The wicked influence of Babylon.
Babylon's faith is found in every place
Where prayer is made for king and kingly
race.

All men love kings and so tempted to pray
For them instead of keeping the right way.
I too love pageantry and royal suit,
And bands and marches and the tread of
boot,
But let me not like church and synagogue
Make formal prayer on behalf of the wog
That sits upon the throne of power and
state.

Beloved, bless every man, even the king,
But keep me from deception of his wing
And faithful to the law in Decalogue.

13 “And pray for us to YHWH our God,
For we have sinned upon the sod
Against YHWH our Alohim, and
Up to this time YHWH’s wrath may stand,
His anger turn not from our band.

14 “And you’ll read this writing we send
To you to make confession tend
In YHWH’s house on the days of feast
And at appointed times increased.

15 “And you shall say ‘Righteousness still
Belongs to YHWH our God until

Confusion of face as today
Remains to us in Judah’s prey,
To dwellers of Jersusalem,
And to our kings and princes’ gem,
And priests and prophets, elders too,

17 “Because we have sinned before
YHWH,

18 “And we have disobeyed Him too,
And have not obeyed voice of YHWH
Our Alohim, to walk upright
In the statutes of YHWH for light
That He has set before our pew.

19 “From the time YHWH brought our
dads out

Of Egypt’s land to this days grout,
We’ve disobeyed YHWH Alohim,
And have neglected, it would seem,
His voice. 20 “So to this day there cling
To us calamities and wing
Of curse that YHWH declared and spoke
Through Moses His servant in stroke
When He brought our ancestors out
Of the land of Egypt with shout
To give us a land flowing with
Milk and honey, *and not a myth*.

21 “We did not heed the voice of YHWH
Our Alohim in words to do

From all the prophets that He sent,
22 “But we each followed the intent
Of our on wicked heart to serve
Other gods and going to swerve
In evil in the sight of YHWH
Our Alohim in what we do.”

Each man must find philosophy to show
An explanation for the grief in tow.
Baruch like other prophets so explains
Captivity and increase of folk’s pains
By some allusion to the presumed sins
The victims had incurred upon their shins.
The grief itself is evidence in state

Of their wrong-doing in the soon or late.
Beloved, I hate and oppose all such things
And every attempt to make living springs
Of Your injustice on the earthen sod.
I do not have faith in the act of God
Portrayed in each catastrophe I see.
I trust that You are good, not wicked spree.

Baruch 2

1 ““So YHWH confirmed His word, which
He

Spoke against us, and faithfully
Against our judges who enjoined
False verdicts against Israel,
And against our kings there purloined
And against our princes a spell
And against men of Israel

And Judah. 2 Under the whole sky
There’s not been done like what you spy
Him doing in Jerusalem,
By what is writ with stratagem
In the law of Moses, 3 that we
Should eat, one the flesh of his son
Another flesh of daughter’s bun.

4 And He gave them into the power
Of all the kingdoms round our tower,
To be reproach and desolation
Among every surrounding nation,
Where YHWH has scattered them in
station.

5 They were brought low and not raised up,
Because we sinned against the cup
Of YHWH our Alohim, in not
Heeding His voice *to teach the plot*.

6 ““Righteousness is to YHWH our God,
But confusion of face and prod
To us and our ancestors’ nod,
As is today. 7 All those grave hurts
With which YHWH threatened us in spurts
Have come upon us. 8 Yet we’ve not
Entreated YHWH’s grace by repenting,
Each one of us from every thought
Of wicked heart and not relenting.

Let Baruch speak for himself in the crowd.
I’m sure that repentance had been allowed
By many in the state, for in the day
Of good Elijah, whose prophetic stay
Thought he alone was there to keep the
way,
There were five thousand and two more to pray

To You alone, Beloved, without the proud.
How many then when Baruch spoke the
word

Had in the silence of heart stricken, stirred,
Prayed for Your grace entreating penitence
With tears and groanings in their captive
vents.

I too feel I'm alone upon the lea
Of my mountain and lake: by faith I see
The thousands praying still and faithfully.

9 And YHWH has kept calamity
Ready, and YHWH has brought to see
Before us, for YHWH's just in all
His works which He commands in call
Us to do. 10 Yet we've not obeyed
His voice, to walk YHWH's statutes laid
Which He set before our parade.
11 "And now, Israel's YHWH Alohim,
Who brought Your people from the stream
Of Egypt with a mighty hand
And with signs and with wonders and
With great power and outstretched arm, and
Have made You a name, as today,
12 We've sinned, gone ungodly astray,
We have done wrong, O Lord our God,
Against all Your statutes and prod.
13 Let Your wrath turn away from us,
For we are left, few for a muss,
Among folk where You've scattered us.
14 Hear, O Lord, our prayer and our plea,
And for Your own sake set us free,
And grant us grace in sight of those
Who took us to exile in rows,
15 That all the earth may know that You
Are YHWH our Alohim *and true*,
For Israel and his descendants
Are called by Your name's heritage.

The prophet is amazed the people do
Not obey You despite the punishment
That lies upon the Israelite in tent,
Despite the cup of wormwood and the rue.
The prophet wonders that the horrid view
Of the captivity that You have sent
In no way has been able to prevent
Idolatry of sundry in the crew.
Beloved, your prophet may have studied
law

But the psychology of love and fear
Escapes his holiness as I can see.
Today men know that love and not the claw

Inspires both loyalty and eye and ear:
Learn from the wisdom of this century.

16 O Lord, look down from where You
dwell,
Consider us. Incline ear well,
O Lord and hear, 17 open Your eyes,
O Lord, and see, for dead who lies
In Hades, whose spirit's been taken
From body, will not now be shaken
To give glory's justice to YHWH,
18 But the one who's greatly distressed,
That goes about bent over vest
And feeble, and the eyes that fail,
And the one that hungers for tale,
Will give You glory's righteousness,
O Lord. 19 For it is not address
Of some righteous deeds of our fathers
Or of our kings that we for bothers
Bring before You in plea of grace,
O YHWH our Alohim to trace.

Beloved, Your prophet deigns to think that
You

So covet praise that You will come in view
To help and save if You just understand
That praise comes best from every
suffering band.

I will not stop to accuse prophet of
The thought that You showed such a lack
of love

And let the people fall in their despair
For the very purpose that they should bear
More valuable offerings on the stair.
Beloved, the primitive in thought may seem
Naïve to me ensconced in pleasant beam,
But in truth faith today is just as trite:
When such catastrophe falls on the right,
They always proclaim You've some goal in
sight.

20 For You have sent Your wrath and Your
Anger upon us, as before
You did declare by Your servants
The prophets, saying 21 "So says YHWH:
'Bend your shoulders and serve in due
The king of Babylon, and you
Will remain in the land which I
Gave to your ancestors to ply.
22 "But if you'll not obey the voice
Of YHWH and will not serve by choice
The king of Babylon, 23 'I'll make

Cease from the towns in Judah's wake
And from the region round about
Jerusalem the voice to shout
Of mirth and gladness, and the voice
Of the bridegroom and to rejoice
The bride, and the whole land will be
A desolation and empty."

You give the folk, Beloved, the choice to
live

In peace beneath the servitude to give
The heavy burdens of tribute in sieve
To Babylon's king, or to rise and fight,
Defending house and home and slave and
right.

The fruit of one is that the city stand,
The product of the other in the land
Is devastation at invader's hand.
The choices that You give, Beloved, are
slight,

But very like the ones I see tonight,
As I regard the market empire here
That desecrates the Sabbath without fear.
Submit to law of false democracy
And live in some peace under the decree.

24 "'But we did not obey Your voice,
To serve the king of Babylon,
And You have confirmed Your words'
choice,

Which You spoke by Your servants won
The prophets, that bones of our kings
And bones of our ancestors' springs
Would be dug up out of their graves,
25 And indeed, they've been cast in waves
Out to the heat of day and frost
Of night. They perished in the cost
Of misery, by famine tossed
And sword and pestilence *embossed*.

26 And the house that's called by Your
name

You have made as it is today,
Because of the wickedness' way
Of house of Israel and blame
Of house of Judah gone astray.
27 "'Yet You have dealt with us, O YHWH
Our Alohim, in Your kind due,
And in all Your compassion's view,
28 "As You spoke by Your servant Moses
On the day when You came and chose us
Commanding him to write Your law
In the presence and in the awe

Of the folk of Israel, to say,
29 "If you will not choose to obey
My voice, this mammoth multitude
Will surely turn into a crude
Small number among nations, where
I'll scatter them and make live there.
30 "For I know they will not obey
Me, for they are a stiff-necked folk.
But in the land of exile's stroke
They'll waken to the truth and stay
31 "To know that I am YHWH their God.
I'll give them a heart and a prod
To obey and an ear to hear,
32 "And they will praise me without fear
In the land of their exile, and
Will remember My name, 33 and stand
To turn from their stubbornness and
Their wicked deeds, for they will mind
The ways of their ancestors' kind,
Who sinned before YHWH. 34 "I will
bring

Them again to the land and spring
Which I swore to give to their dads,
To Abraham and Isaac and
To Jacob, and they'll rule its pads,
And I will multiply their stand,
And undiminished all their band.
35 "I'll make an everlasting pact
With them to be their Alohim
And they shall be My folk in fact,
And I'll never again remove
My people Israel from the groove,
Of the land I gave them to prove."

The everlasting covenant it seems
Appeared with the return from the ripe
dreams
Of Nebuchadnezzar to build the town
And temple under joy and under frown.
The covenant the prophet would see here
As everlasting and without a fear
Turned out to be the Hellenizing gear,
The torture of the faithful and the tear
Of those who conformed to the law set
down.

Fulfilment of the promise was some less
In the reality come to address
Than hope of peace and fast tranquility.
That's why, Beloved, I take a pain of fault
To hear that You will save the wheat and
malt.

Baruch 3

1 O Lord Almighty, Alohim
Of Israel, the soul would scream
In anguish and fainting to You.

2 Hear, O YHWH, and have mercy too,
For we have trespassed before You.

3 For You're enthroned for ever, and
We perish always as You stand.

4 O Lord Almighty, Alohim
Of Israel, hear now the beam
Of the prayer of Israel's dead
And of the sons of those unled
Who've sinned before You, who did not
Heed the voice of YHWH their God
sought,

So that calamities have come
Upon us. 5 Do not remember
Iniquities of ancestor,
But in this crisis remember
Your power and Your name all in sum.

The sweet Christian pretends in times of
old

You bore salvation on the true and bold
Because of their obedience to law
And without grace to diminish the claw.
Yet Baruch in ancient times comes to
plead,

Not ancestral obedience to creed,
Nor his or his own people's better deed,
But Your power and Your name to save in
need.

Grace is eternal, my Beloved, it seems,
Both in the true faith and the one of
dreams,

And there's no saving without mercy's
way,

Without the grace to cover sins and pay.
But grace itself is in the law You spoke
On Sinai, reject it, take heathen yoke.

6 For You are YHWH our God, and You,
O Lord, will we praise as is due.

7 For You have put the fear of You
In our hearts in order that we
Should call upon Your name, and we
Will praise You in exile, for we
Have put away from our hearts all
Our ancestors' wicked way's gall
Who sinned before You *in their stall*.

8 Indeed, today we're in exile
Where You have scattered us a while

To be reproached and cursed and punished
For all the wickedness unfurnished
Of our ancestors who forsook
YHWH our Alohim at a look.

The factor of release that provides power
Of Your obedience for just an hour,
The hand to keep Your law, though light of
use,

Is that fear that You place in hearts and
nouns.

It is not terror that produces flame
Of obedience to Your spoken game,
But fear of Your opinion for Your fame
Instead of what the other people claim.
Public opinion is what keeps the soul
From her obedience to You as goal,
A greater fear of what people may say
Than of what You, Beloved, on judgement
day

Hark back to when You first revealed the
way

On Sinai and stood up to take the toll.

9 Hear the commandments of life, O
Israel, give ear, learn wisdom so!

10 Why is it, O Israel, that you
Are in the land of your foes' crew,
And grow old in a foreign land,
That you're defiled with the dead flanned.

11 That you're counted among those in
Hades? 12 You have forsaken fount
Of wisdom. 13 If you'd walked the mount
Of Alohim, you would be dwelling
In peace forever at the telling.

If any man had kept the sacred word
Of Decalogue pronounced on wing of bird
To soar above Sinai like soar today
The swallows around Mecca's heart in
sway,

He would be dwelling in peace of Islam,
The peace of full submission to Your balm.
Instead establishments of faith come round
To circumvent Your law and make the
bound

Appear more loving and more free in
sound,

When in fact all establishments agree
To enslave partisan eternally.

Beloved, I hear commandments of life and
Rejoice to know that one ear in the land

Takes hold in faith determined where to stand.

14 Learn where there's wisdom, where there's strength,
Where understanding, that at length
You may perceive the days of life
Where there's life and peace without strife.
15 Who's found her place? And who's gone in
Her storehouse and her treasure bin?
16 Where are the princes of the lands,
And rulers of earth's beasts in bands,
17 Those who shoot birds on wing for sport
And save up silver and gold sort
In which men trust, and without end
To their acquiring things to spend,
18 Those who scheme to get silver, and
Are anxious, whose labours expand
Beyond the counting on the hand?
19 They've vanished, gone down to Sheol,
And others risen in their toll.

Those who spend life seeking success of things,
The gathering of wealth, the right of kings
And priests (I use the words symbolically
Of those who grasp abusive power in spree),
When they come to give their account at last,
After the struggle and the hopes in blast,
Find not security and rest, but ticket
To enter Hades by the nearest wicket.
Beloved, the chaff, though driven by the wind
Of great desire among those who have sinned,
Is piled high to be burned, and it would seem
There's always room at the top of the cream.
While waiting for the furnace to be heated,
Let's go and shoot some birds among the seated.

20 Young men have seen the light of day,
And lived upon the earth in sway,
But they've not learned in knowledge path,
Nor understood her ways and math
To lay hold on her *roundelay*.

21 Their sons have strayed far from her way.

22 She's not been heard of in Canaan,
Nor seen in Teman by the plan
23 Of sons of Hagar, who seek for
Understanding on the earth floor,
The merchants of Merran and Teman,
The story-tellers and the seaman
Seekers for understanding, they
Have not learned of wisdom her way
Nor given thought to her paths' sway.

What's lovingly called Islam by the great
And by the small reporters for the state,
The faith of Arab, who by all accounts
In the Qur'an is worst in its amounts,
Is but the straying far from the right way,
Commandments that You posed upon a day.

The story-tellers and each Sindibad
Command their notice to make the heart sad,
But true Islam's in words the prophet spoke
To lead both Jew and Christian from their yoke
Into the freedom of Your sacred law,
Keeping the ones You send all still in awe,
To gather humankind to realize
One God and one boat carry all the wise.

24 O Israel, how great's the house
Of Alohim! And how vast grouse
Of territory that He holds!
25 It is great and has no bounds' folds,
It's high and without measure's moulds.
26 The giants were born there, and they
Were famous in ancient time's sway,
And tall and mighty in the fray.
27 Alohim did not choose them, nor
Give them the way to knowledge store,
28 So they perished because they had
No wisdom, they perished as bad.
29 Who has gone up into the sky
To take her and brought through clouds
nigh?

30 Who has gone over the sea, and
Found her, and will buy her for brand
Of gold? 31 No one knows how to find
The path to her, and where to bind.
32 But he who knows all things knows her,
He found her by intelliger.
He who laid the earth for all time

Filled it with four-footed to climb,
 33 He who sends forth the light to go,
 Called it, and it obeyed not slow,
 34 The stars shone in their sequences,
 And were glad, he called them to whiz,
 And they said, "Here we are!" They shone
 With gladness for Him on His throne.
 35 This is our God, no other can
 Be compared to Him come to stand!
 36 He found the whole way to wisdom,
 And gave her to Jacob His *rum*
 Servant and to Israel who He
 Loved. 37 Afterward she came to be
 On earth and dwelt among men free.

Beloved, You gave to Israel the way,
 The life and truth in the commandments'
 sway,
 Imprinted them upon the fleshly heart
 Of prophet and of people in their part,
 And some have been humble and faithful
 too
 To represent the good path and the true,
 And some have failed to keep their eye and
 crew
 Beneath the law that led like light of day.
 Beloved, I thank the folk who kept alive
 The knowledge of Your law, though You
 deprive
 Them of their honour, when they failed to
 strive
 To keep it in faith and in all they do.
 Thanks to them, whether they retain or not
 The rewards of the earth and heavenly plot.

Baruch 4

1 She's the book of God's commandments
 And law enduring to ascents
 Of all eternity. All who
 Hold her fast will live, and those who
 Forsake her will die *with their crew*.
 2 Turn, O Jacob, and take her, walk
 Toward her light shining *on the rock*.
 3 Don't give your glory to another,
 Your benefits to a strange brother.

The law that Your prophet says is for ever
 Has met its end in Christ by those who
 sever
 Our lives from that great benefit You gave.
 Make human sacrifice of god or slave
 Atonement for the breaking of Your law

Save such who break it without love or awe
 Makes me forget to rejoice at Your word.
 Come now, Beloved, atonement is absurd.
 Eternal life, if life there be, is met
 Loving Your law and living in its set.
 Why test the waters of the Gospel bet
 Against truth of experience heart stirred?
 I shall not turn my glory to another
 Nor walk away from law's light for a
 smother.

4 Blessèd are we, O Israel,
 For we know what is pleasing well
 To Alohim. 5 Take courage, folk,
 Memorial of Israel's stroke!
 6 It was not for destruction that
 You were sold to the nations flat,
 But you were handed over to
 Your enemies because that you
 Enraged Alohim *in your pew*.
 7 For you provoked Him who made you,
 By sacrificing in the view
 Of demons and not Alohim,
 8 Forgot eternal Alohim,
 Who brought you up, and so you grieved
 Jerusalem, who unreprieved
 Reared you. 9 For she saw that the wrath
 That came upon you in your path
 Was from Alohim, and she said
 "Listen, neighbours of the fortress,
 Alohim has brought great distress
 On me, 10 for I've seen outspread
 My sons and daughters hopeless led
 Into captivity, which He,
 The Eternal brought on their head
 11 With joy I nurtured them to be,
 But saw them go out grievingly.
 12 Let no one rejoice over me,
 A widow and bereaved I be,
 Let desolate because of sins
 Of my own children without wins,
 Because they turned away from law
 Of Alohim to meet the claw."

Jerusalem's bereaved to find the way
 That Jews have forgotten the light of day.
 Beloved, there's hardly one on earth to stay
 Who's not worse than the Jews in force to
 pay
 In sacrifice to gross idolatry.
 Jerusalem may grieve, and yet be free
 In knowing that if some are bad to see,

They are not as bad as the Catholic stars
Who bow to images and count their bars,
Or Baptists who engage in false prayer to
Their Trinity and the atonement's cru.
Let the town weep, if weep she must, but
know

That Jewish arms and Jewish idols' show
Are briefer than the rest of heathen glow.

13 "They did not regard His laws right,
They did not walk in ways of light
In Alohims' commandments, nor
Tread the paths of discipline's shore
In righteousness. 14 "Let neighbours come
Around the fortress, mind in sum
The capture of my sons and daughters,
Which the Eternal brought to slaughters.
15 "For He brought against them a folk
From far off, shameless in their stroke,
Of a strange language, with respect
For no elder nor pity checked
For a child. 16 "And they led away
The widow's most loved sons as prey,
Bereaved the lonely woman here
Of her daughters. 17 "But I, how can
I help you? 18 "For He who brought span
Of these calamities on you
Will deliver you from the crew
Of your foes. 19 "Go, my children, go,
For I have been left lone and slow.
20 "I've taken off the robe of peace
And put on the sackcloth's release
Of my supplication, I'll cry
To the Eternal as I sigh.
21 "Take courage, my children, and cry
To Alohims, and He will save
You from the power of the grave
And the hand of the foe to rave.
22 "For I have put my hope at last
In the Eternal to save you,
Rejoicing has come to me fast
From the Holy One, because of
The mercy which soon from above
Will come to you at the hand of
Your everlasting Saviour's love.
23 "For I sent you out with grief and
With weeping, but Alohims' stand
Will give you back to me with joy
And gladness for ever in play.

The promises are great, but as I view
How they're fulfilled in history and pew

Of Maccabee and Bar Kochba in sight,
My heart quakes with the grief of doom
and night.

As far as centuries may light the path
Some plague falls on the town, and falls
some wrath.

More can be said, perhaps even today
Come Israel on Jerusalem to play,
Encouraged by the guns its children sway.
Live and let live, if even that were score,
Where is the great delight promised in
store?

Against millennia of grief and pain,
Incitement of peace and more war in vain,
Nothing attempted yet assuages gain.

24 "For as the neighbours of the fort
Have now seen your capture's report,
So soon they'll see salvation too
By Alohims, which comes to you
With great glory and splendour due
Of the Eternal. 25 "My children,
Endure with patience the wrath then
That's come on you from Alohims.
Your enemy has crossed the stream
And overtaken you, but you
Will soon see their destruction and
Will tread upon their necks in band.
26 "My tender sons travelled rough roads,
They were taken like flock by goads
Carried off by the enemy.
27 "Take courage, my children, and cry
To Alohims, for you'll come by
To be remembered by Him who
Also has brought this upon you.
28 "For just as you purposed to go
Astray from Alohims below,
Return with tenfold zeal to seek
Him. 29 "For He who brought these in peak
Calamities on you will bring
You everlasting joy with spring
Of your salvation on the wing."

Endure with patience wrath. Indeed, that
part
Of prophecy's fulfilled to the last dart.
The world's a slaughter ground and
happiness

Impossible in such a gross address,
But as I whirl with Your name on my lips
Despite the Rabbis' disapproving hips,
I take comfort before death on the wail

That You too have words that come to avail
In service of remembrance as You turn
In Your unchanging habitat and burn
Without quenching, without consuming
leaf.

I take comfort in You before my grief,
And find above the shoah the relief
Of everlasting joy I shall not earn.

30 Take courage, O Jerusalem,
For He who called you once a gem
Will comfort you by stratagem.

31 Wretched will be those who afflict
You and rejoiced when you were kicked.

32 Wretched will be the cities where
Your children served as slaves in share,
Wretched will be the city which
Received your sons out of the ditch.

33 Just as she rejoiced at your fall,
Glad for your ruin and its pall,
So she will be grieved at her own
Desolation upon the stone.

34 And I will take away her pride
In her great population's stride,
Her insolence turns into grief.

35 For fire will come upon her chief
From the Eternal many days,
And long she shall tread in the maze
Of demons whirling in the haze.

36 Look toward the east, Jerusalem,
And see rejoicing that has come
To you from Alohim in sum!

37 Indeed, your sons are coming, whom
You sent away, back from their doom,
Gathered from east and west, at word
Of the Holy One who was stirred,
Rejoicing in Alohim heard.

I have a heart of vengeance that is great
Enough to rejoice that the coming state
Of Hitler is a wretchedness to be
Condemned and doomed for all eternity.
But such is not enough to heal the wound
Of hopelessness the world transcends
harpooned.

Such cannot carry me in flight to be
A spark of light upon paternity.
Beloved, if joy I must, let me rejoice
Through memories too awful to give voice,
And let me see the city lie beneath
The peace of swordlessness and without
sheath.

Then I shall come again in my return
With love within to fester and to burn.

Baruch 5

1 Take off the garment of your grief
And your affliction for relief,
Jerusalem, and clothe you in
Beauty of glory in the din
Of Alohim's eternity.

2 Put on the robe of righteousness
From Alohim, put on address
The diadem of the glory
Of the Eternal One to see.

3 For Alohim will show your splendour
Everywhere under heaven's surrender.

4 For your name will for ever be
Called by Alohim to be free,
"Peace of righteousness and glory
Of godliness." 5 And so arise,

Jerusalem, stand under skies
And look toward the east, and see
Your children gathered from the west
And from the east, at the word's hest
Of the Holy One, rejoicing
That Alohim's minded the sting.

6 For they went forth from you on foot,
Led away by their enemies down-put,
But Alohim will bring them back
To you, carried in glory's stack,
As on a royal throne for lack.

7 For Alohim has ordered that
Every high mountain and the flat
Of everlasting hills be made
Low and the valleys filled and stayed
To make a level ground, so that
Israel may walk safely on flat
In the glory of Alohim.

8 The woods and every fragrant team
Of trees have shaded Israel
At God's command beneath His spell.

9 Alohim will lead Israel
With joy, in the light of His glory,
With mercy and righteousness' story
That come from Him and His to tell.

The many miles of forest in the track
Of Finland landscape at my front and back
Show shade indeed upon the white nights
where

I wander or remain among the fair.
But rarely does this forest shade the few
Of Israel among the righteous crew.

It mostly shades the Lutherans who call
Your law impossible, a pact in thrall,
And hope instead for grace to disobey
And to oppress the poor in their own way.
Beloved, the forests that surround the town
Jerusalem shade no one from the frown
Of blistered sun. Beware what You recite
To prophets with a quill with which to
write.

Baruch 6

1 A copy of what Jeremiah
Sent to those who as a pariah
Were taken out to Babylon
As captives by their king when done,
To give them the word Alohim
Had commanded him at full beam.
2 Because of the sins that you've done
Before Alohim, you will be
Taken to Babylon in fee
As captives by Nebuchadnezzar,
The king of Babylon, a geezer.

If this is punishment for all the sins
Of the ancestors in idols free bins,
Then why the constant simpering to make
The people conform to the sheer mistake
Of politics? If breaking every treaty
With Egypt would amend Judaeen sweetie,
Then where's the punishment for former
sin?

And if not, why so prophesy in din?
Faithfulness to Pharaoh more than undue
In disobeying Your law cooked their stew.
Beloved, the bind hypocrisy I find
Even in Your own prophets is unkind.
The fact is most folk did not obey You,
And what came on them had nothing to do.

3 So when you come to Babylon
You'll stay there for a long time drawn,
As many as seven generations,
And after that I'll bring your stations
Away from there in peace and free.
4 In Babylon you will see gods
Made of silver and gold and clods
Of wood, which are carried upon
Men's shoulders and inspire fear drawn
Upon the heathen. 5 So take care
Not to fall in to such a snare
Like the aliens or let
Fear of these gods then come to get

A hold on you, and when you see
The crowd in front and back freely
Worshiping them. 6 Say in your heart,
"It's You, O YHWH, we owe the part
Of worship only." 7 For I'll send
My angel with you not to bend,
And he is watching what you do.
8 Their tongues are smoothed by craftsman
true,

And they themselves are laid with gold
And silver, but they're false when sold
And cannot speak. 9 People take gold
And make crowns for the heads of gods,
As they would for a girl who prods
A love of ornaments, 10 sometimes
The priests secretly take gold rimes
And silver from their gods and spend
It on themselves, 11 and even rend
Some of it to the harlots in
The brothel. They deck their gods' bin
With clothing like that made for men,
These gods of silver, gold again
And wood, 12 which cannot save
themselves

From rust and ruin on their shelves.
When they've been dressed in purple robes,
13 Their faces are wiped of microbes
Because of the dust from the temple,
Which is thick on them like a stemple.

Though I do not live in fair Babylon,
I've seen gods made of gold and silver
drawn,

And seen how awful Trinities with spawn
Entice the crowds to every kind of wake,
To every seal of sin and every stake.
I've seen the priestly claw caught in the till,
And gift brought to the harlot for the spill,
And turned from every church and
synagogue,

And from the holy mosque to make my log
Of single soul to serve You on Your throne,
While every man remains brother of stone.
Without a binding to the church to share
I'm citizen of the world, so I bear
My kinship to adherents everywhere.

14 Like a local chief the gods hold
A sceptre, though they are not bold
To destroy anyone offending.
15 It has a dagger and portending
In its right hand, and has an axe,

But it cannot save from the tracks
 Of war and robbers *till it cracks*.
 16 That's why it's evident that they
 Are not gods, do not fear their sway.
 17 For just as a dish is worth nought
 When it is broken, so the taught
 Gods of the heathen when they're set
 Up in their temples to be met.
 Their eyes are full of the dust raised
 By the feet of those who are crazed
 To enter there. 18 And just as gates
 Are shut on every side and pates
 Of those who have offended king,
 As though sentenced to death and sting,
 So the priests lock their temples fast
 With doors and bars against the blast
 Of robbers' plundering the thing.

The axe may break an idol made of stone
 Or wood and leave the splinters without
 groan,
 And may have done so in the heathen past,
 But now we are too civilized to last.
 The idol is a thing of art, and so
 Is preserved from the sacred head to toe,
 Which means the argument the prophet
 made

Is never seen these days upon parade.
 Beloved, You must come now and
 intervene
 Yourself to make us know what You may
 mean:
 You'll have to raise the axe Yourself to
 show
 Idols so well protected do not glow
 With more divinity than is Your own
 In the sky on an invisible throne.

19 They light lamps, even more than they
 Light for themselves, though their gods
 may
 See none of them. 20 They are just like
 Abeam of the temple, but strike
 Men in their hearts with fear,
 When worms from the dark earth appear
 Consuming them and their clothes sere.
 21 They do not notice when their faces
 Are blackened by temple smoke traces.
 22 Bats, swallows, and birds light on them,
 On bodies and heads, as do cats.
 23 From this you'll know that they in hem
 Are not gods, so do not fear them.

24 As for the gold they wear in vats
 Of beauty, they don't shine unless
 Someone wipes off the crust with zest,
 For even when they've being cast
 They have no feeling of the blast.
 25 They are bought at any cost, but
 There is no breath in lung or gut.

The bird poop on the statue of the god
 Apollo proves that he's made of mere sod,
 And nothing of the glory of the sun,
 And nothing of the story myth has spun.
 The bird poop on the head of Ashtoreth
 Proves that she never lived to draw a
 breath,
 And all is empty, all but hope and fear,
 And prayer for rain and guidance how to
 steer.

Beloved, if You could humble shrines of
 old
 By rat and criminal fowl in the fold,
 We theologians have got round the trick:
 No bird can poop on Trinity, we're slick.
 The fact no bird poop lies on Father-Son
 And Ghost must mean they're divine to a
 ton.

26 Having no feet, they must be borne
 On human shoulders, being shorn
 Of worth in sight of all men born.
 27 And those who serve them are ashamed
 Because through them these gods are
 claimed
 To stand, lest they fall to the ground.
 If any one sets one of them
 Upright, it can't move from its hem,
 And if it's tipped over, it can't
 Straighten itself, yet gifts not scant
 Are placed before them as before
 The dead. 28 The priests sell then the store
 Of sacrifices that are set
 Before these gods, use what they get,
 While their wives preserve some with salt,
 But give not to the poor for fault.

Beloved, You've caught the pagan gift for
 shame
 And brought them all down to a better
 claim.

It used to be the sacrifices made
 A tidy sum for priest when they waylaid,

And what they could not sell or eat that
day,
Their wives salted to save and put away.
But You have spoiled their fun by changing
that.

The sacrifice has hardly any fat,
And is a wafer so thin that the whole
Lies on one tongue to keep it at the goal.
The wine is left for priest alone to drink
And keep him on drunkenness' brink.
He does not even have a wife with salt,
Though brothels provide all without a fault.

29 Sacrifice to them may be touched
By menstruous women or those clutched
With childbirth. Since you know by these
Things that they are not gods to please,
Do not fear them. 30 For why should they
Be called gods? Women serve array
Of meals for gods of silver and
Of gold and wood, 31 and in a band
In their temples the priests sit down
With their clothes rent and with a frown,
Their heads and beards shaved, and their
heads

Uncovered. 32 They howl at the spreads
And shout before their gods as some
Do at a funeral feast's hum
For a man who has died. 33 The priests
Take some of the clothing of feasts
Of their gods to clothe wives and spawn.
34 Whether one does evil out-drawn
To them or good, they will not be
Able to repay it in fee.
They cannot set up a king or
Depose one. 35 They cannot give wealth
Or money, if one makes in stealth
A vow to them and fails to keep,
They cannot hold to account's sweep.

One argument that idols are not true
Is that their offerings can be touched by
crew
Of menstruous women and still hold their
rue.
The opposite must be the holy case
Of offerings brought to You under the
mace.
Maybe that's why the priesthood in Your
book
Is made of males alone with healthy hook.
The argument to me seems one contrived

In circular through laws that have survived.
Can we not just imagine that the shame
Of such impurity entails no blame,
And unwashed sacrifices are as good
For Baal and Ashtoreth met in the wood
As lambs and rams are in Your temple
hood?

36 They cannot save a man from death
Or rescue the weak from the breath
Of the strong. 37 They cannot restore
Sight to a blind man, nor the more
Rescue a man who's in distress.
38 They take no pity on address
Of widow nor do they do good
To an orphan. 39 These things of wood
And overlaid with gold and siller
Are like stones from the mountain's filler,
And those who serve them will be put
To shame. 40 Why then must any foot
Come to them as gods, or should any
Call them gods? Besides, for a penny
Even the Chaldeans themselves
Dishonour them, 41 for when like elves
They see a dumb man, who can't speak,
They bring him and pray Bel to seek
The man's healing, as though Bel could
Understand any speakinghood.
42 Yet they themselves cannot perceive
This and abandon such gods' weave,
For they have no sense to receive.

They bring a dumb man to the dumb go so
The dumb idol might make the man not
slow
To speak, and yet see nothing in the show
Of inconsistent on the earth below.
All faiths are filled with inconsistencies
And quaint and superstitious scores to
please.

The Christian knows that Jesus is a God,
And knows the command not to picture
prod,
And yet makes icons of the son of man.
The Muslim who does not know deity
Rests on the humble form will never see
A picture made of him, though he's by plan
As human as a human being can.
It ought by right to be opposite tree.

43 And the women, with cords tied on,
Sit under colonnades from dawn

To burn bran for incense, and when
 One's led off by one of the men
 And copulated with, she then
 Mocks the woman next to her, for
 She was not seductive in score
 And her cord was not broken more.
 44 Whatever's done for them is false.
 Why then must any one come waltz
 Think that they are gods, or then call
 Them gods? 45 They are made in the hall
 Of carpenters and goldsmiths, they
 Can be nothing but what the sway
 Of craftsmen wish them to be prey.
 46 The men who make them surely will
 Not live very long on their hill,
 So how can what they make be gods?
 47 They have left only lies and prods
 For those who come upon the sods.

The sacred prostitutes of then and now
 Have two things in common on harlot's
 brow:
 The calling is holy and to confess,
 And all are in competition's address.
 In older times they only had to sit
 With cord revealed and ready with the kit.
 But now they must be advertised with care
 Of writhing to rock music for their share.
 The crooning of the nightclub and the fame
 Of church are of a similar acclaim,
 But the poor girl without make-up and tape
 To accompany her to sacred rape
 Is left to sit upon abandoned pew,
 Perhaps with naught to comfort her but
 You.

48 For when war or calamity
 Comes on them, the priests consult fee
 Together as to where they can
 Hide themselves and their gods by plan.
 49 How then can one fail to see that
 These are not gods, for they out flat
 Cannot save themselves from war or
 Calamity upon the shore.
 50 Since they are made of wood and set
 Over with gold and silver debt,
 It will after be known that they
 Are false. 51 It will be clear as day
 To all the nations and kings they
 Are not gods but work of men's pay,
 And there's no work of Alohim
 In them. 52 Who then can fail in beam

To know that they are not gods' way?
 53 For they cannot set up a king
 Over a country or give wing
 Of rain to men. 54 They cannot judge
 Their own cause or save if to budge
 One who is wronged, for they've no power,
 They are like crows between tower
 Of heaven and earth. 55 When fire breaks
 Out in a temple for the sakes
 Of wooden gods covered with gold
 Or silver, their priests flee the hold
 And they escape, but the gods will
 Be burnt in two like beams and fill.
 56 Besides, they can give no resistance
 To a king or to foes' persistence.
 Why then must any one admit
 Or think that they are gods and fit?

The argument that gods are put in store
 Of safety during every time of war,
 And thus show they're incapable of being
 Divine before every human that's seeing,
 Is proof at least their priests do not believe.
 It is not proof for certain they don't grieve.
 It's possible the wooden face may hide
 The feelings of a lover to abide.
 It's possible in theory, yes indeed,
 But never to be trusted for a seed
 To bear fruit on the final day of greed.
 No doubt that's why the priesthood stands
 erect
 In doubt before infidel and elect,
 In hope of further benefits' respect.

57 Gods made of wood and overlaid
 With silver and gold on parade
 Are not able to save themselves
 From thieves and robbers to their shelves.
 58 Strong men will strip them of their gold
 And silver and of their robes told,
 And depart with the spoil, and they
 Cannot keep from being a prey.
 59 So it's better to be a king
 Who shows his courage in his wing,
 Or a household pot with some use,
 Than to be such false gods' abuse,
 Better even a house door that
 Protects its contents, that such fat
 False gods, better a wooden post
 In a palace than false gods' boast.

The prophet says it's better far to be

A chamber-pot in which a child may pee
 Than to sit on a god's throne in the house
 Of temple prostitute and see the mouse
 Come out and nibble at the offerings left
 In honour of the goddess that's bereft
 Of life and movement for eternity.
 The potty argument is full of flavour
 And wit to witty folk to love and savour,
 But is no argument to pagan dream
 Who is enamoured of what fine things
 seem.
 Sophistication lifts idolatry
 To art and thought above its sophistry,
 While chamber-pots are useful but they're
 lowly.

60 For sun and moon and stars that shine
 Sent forth to function and combine,
 Obey. 61 So also lightning too,
 When it flashes, it comes to view,
 And the wind also blows on cue.
 62 When Alohim commands the clouds
 To pass the whole world in their crowds,
 They carry out but His command.
 63 The fire sent from above and spanned
 Mountains and woods does what it is
 planned.
 But these idols are not compared
 With them in face or power shared.
 64 Therefore one must not think they're
 gods
 Nor call them gods, for they are clods
 Not able either to decide
 A case or to do good to men's hide.
 65 Since you know then that they are not
 gods,
 Do not fear them. 66 For they have prods
 Neither curse nor bless their kings,
 67 They cannot show signs in the wings
 Of heaven and among the nations,
 Or shine like the sun or give rations
 Of light like the moon. 68 The wild beasts
 Are better than they are in feasts,
 For they can flee to cover and
 Help themselves when danger would stand.
 69 So we've no evidence at all
 That they are gods, though they are tall
 Do not fear them standing in stall.

The sun and moon obey the right routine
 And can be relied on to count the scene

Of days and years and months before the
 crowd,
 And their obedience, it is allowed,
 Show that there is one to whom they still
 give
 Obedience though themselves do not live.
 The argument is logical to trace,
 And gives a good excuse for claims on
 grace.
 Beloved, You're ultimate reality,
 But who knows if You give command to be
 Or not to those things in the world around,
 The regularities of sea and ground?
 The argument for and against may sound
 Good logic, but in the end all is found.

70 A scarecrow in cucumber bed,
 That guards nothing before it spread,
 So are their gods of wood decked out
 With gold and silver laid about.

The truth is that the scarecrow serves the
 goal,
 It is effective in the purposed whole.
 So too is human idol worship here:
 It keeps the masses easier to steer.
 Idolatry's a necessary way
 To keep the state a stable form a day.
 If all the gods of city and of state
 Were overthrown there would be neither
 hate
 Nor power to cast the human mass in pay.
 The king must serve his gods and make
 them stay
 If he would keep his subjects meek and
 still.
 He needs the divine to stay on his hill.
 Beloved, I see no hand of power where I
 Walk out beneath the empty trembling sky.

71 In the same way, their gods of wood,
 Covered with gold and silver hood,
 And like a thorn bush in a field,
 On which every bird sits in yield,
 Or like a dead body cast out
 Into the darkness after rout.
 72 By the purple and linen that
 Rot on them you will know out flat
 That they are not gods, and they will
 At last themselves rot on their hill,
 And be a reproach in the land.
 73 Better therefore is a just hand

That has no idols, for he will be
Far from reproach eternally.

Though gods are nothing more than corpses
cast

Upon the roadside without sail or mast,
They are as useful as the ghosts that rise
From corpses to rule all men in their guise.
The fear of ghosts is like the fear of gods:
It fosters respect for the elder pods,
The elder statesmen like grandmother's
hand.

There's no oppression by successful band
Without the fear of gods, though empty
show

And without reality in the blow.
Beloved, it is indeed a better thing
To find a just hand in a reigning king
Than idols, but just think of the result:
No profits from the taxes and the cult.

Ezekiel

The dates of the book itself would place it
Among the captives in exile and fit
Between five ninety three and a year near
Five seventy-one in the prophetic gear.
But some is addressed to those living in
Jerusalem before the siege of sin,
And some to nations all around before
The Babylonians evened the score.
Ezekiel was a priest, but more than that,
He made himself a sign upon his mat,
A visionary of unknown sights too,
The first of the apocalyptic crew.
Beloved, I love him for his frantic view
As well as for the new heart in new fat.

Ezekiel 1

1 It happened in the thirtieth year
Of the captivity of fear,
In the fourth month, on the fifth day,
As I was where the captives stay
By River Chebar, heavens unrolled,
I saw Alohim's visions told.
2 On the fifth day, in the fifth year
Of King Jehoiachin's career
As captive, 3 the word of YHWH came
Expressly to Ezekiel same
The priest, the son of Buzi, in
The far land of the Chaldean

And by the River Chebar, and
There upon his *head* was YHWH's hand.
4 Then I looked, and indeed, there came
A whirlwind from the north *like flame,*
A great cloud with a raging fire
Engulfing itself *in desire,*
And brightness all around it and
Pouring out of its midst expand
Like amber colour from the fire.
5 Also from within it *there came*
The likeness of four *and by name*
Living creatures, and they looked so:
They had the likeness of a man.
6 Each had four faces, *on the go*
Each had four wings *not to be slow.*
7 Their legs *were* straight, *as straight as*
can,
And the soles of their feet *were* like
The soles of calves' feet *like a spike.*
They sparkled like the colour of
Burnished bronze *from below, above.*

Configuration of faith in the days
Of bronze are not hidden in some gross
haze.

The sun cult, graves aligned to meet its
will,

The cross imposed upon its discus still,
The agriculture well developed by
Society well known to stratify.
Beloved, all these detract from what You
said

On Sinai to the slaves that had been led
To freedom: now the Christian way to bed
Is back to slavery in the sun-cult bred,
The cross, the phallic symbols that are bled,
The stratified society in church,
The eastward turning of prayer where they
lurch

In time to markings carved upon a birch.

8 Hands of a man under their wings
On their four sides, *the hands of kings,*
Each of the four, faces and wings.

9 Their wings touched one another too,
But did not turn when they went through,
But each one went straight forward *best.*

10 As for the likeness of the rest,
Their faces, *each* had a man's face,
Each of the four also in place
Had the face of a lion to right,
The face of an ox on the left,

And each an eagle's face *in sight*.
 11 So *were* their faces *and their heft*.
 Their wings stretched upward, where two
 reached
 To touch each other, and two breeched
 To cover their bodies. 12 And each
 One went straight forward *and to reach*,
 They went where the spirit impressed
 To go, and did not turn addressed
 When they moved. 13 As for the likeness
 Of the living creatures' address,
 They *were* like burning coals of fire,
 And to fro moved *to admire*
 Among the living creatures there.
 The fire was bright, and *in the air*
 Out of the fire went lightning *fair*.

The beasts painted so finely on the walls
 Of caves may represent the glowing stalls
 Of hunting magic, or the ornament
 Of ritual of theriotheist sent.
 The high Paleolithic also casts
 The pregnant female idols on the hearth,
 And so together both in line that lasts
 Enunciate a faith ancient and swarth.
 The matriliturgy goes on aware
 Of totem in both clan and in the share
 Of each man holding weapon in the air.
 Beloved, the faces still haunt prophets now
 That polytheism upon the brow
 Is shameful and forbidden in the lair.

14 The living creatures to and fro
 Like flash of lightning ran to go.
 15 Now as I looked at the living
 Creatures, indeed, there was *a thing*
 A wheel on earth beside each one,
 Living creature four faces *done*.
 16 The likeness of the wheels and their
 Workings *was* like the colour fair
 Of beryl, and all four had the same
 Likeness, their workings likeness came,
 As it were, a wheel in a wheel.
 17 When they moved, they went toward the
 reel
 Of any one of the four ways,
 They did not turn aside their gaze.
 18 As for their rims, they were so high
 They were awesome *against the sky*,
 And their rims *were* full of eyes round
 All four of them. 19 When the living
 Creatures went, the wheels went *to sing*

Beside them, and when the living
 Creatures were lifted from the earth,
 The wheels were lifted up *to girth*.
 20 Where the spirit wanted to go,
 They went, *because they were not slow*,
 There the spirit went, and the wheels
 Were lifted together with *seals*,
 For spirit of the living beings
Was in the wheels *and in their seeings*.
 21 When those went, *these* went, when
 those stood,
These stood, when those lifted *for good*
 Up from the earth, the wheels were lifted
 Up together with them, for gifted
 With the spirit of the living
 Creatures *was* in the wheels *and wing*.

The sun cult in the Bronze Age gave birth
 to
 Such chariots drawn by horses not few
 With solar disc over it in the lands
 Boreal where the northern light commands.
 In Sweden Ezekiel might have found out
 The disk on wheels that turned about,
 about.
 In Spain he might have found the heavenly
 lord
 In figurines with disks beneath adored
 Feet of the horses who pulled without
 sword.
 Beloved, around the world the vision goes,
 The idols face the people in their rows.
 But where are You when the great sun-god
 shows?
 You're making jokes with prophets for a
 while
 In visions far from Euphrates and Nile.

22 The likeness of the firmament
 Above the heads of those live *sent*
 Beings *was* like the colour of
 An awesome crystal, stretched above
 Their heads. 23 Under the firmament
 Their wings *spread out* straight where they
 sent
 One toward another. Each one had
 Two wings of which covered each lad
 On one side, and each one had two
 Which covered the lad's other too.
 24 When they travelled, I heard the noise
 Of their wings, like the waters' noise,
 And like the voice of the Almighty,

A tumult like the noise of flighty
 Hosts, and whenever they stood still,
 They lowered their wings down until
 25 A voice came from above expanse
 Over their heads, and when their dance
 Stopped, they let down their wings *and bill*.
 26 Above the firmament, above
 Their heads *there was* the likeness of
 A throne that looked like sapphire stone,
 And on the likeness of the throne
 A likeness with the appearance of
 A man as it were high above.
 27 Also from the appearance of
 His waist and upward I saw, as
 It were, the colour of *as has*
 Amber with likeness of a fire
 Within it all around its spire,
 And from the appearance of his waist
 And downward I saw, *where I faced*,
 As it were, the appearance of
 Fire with brightness around, *above*.
 28 Like the appearance of rainbow
 In cloud on a rainy day, so
Was the appearance of the bright
 All around it *and in its light*.
 This *was* the appearance of that
 Likeness of glory *where YHWH sat*.
 So when I saw, I fell on face,
 And heard a voice speak *in that place*.

Ezekiel saw in vision divine form
 And heard in his audition cold and warm
 The divine voice arising from above
 The throne of sapphire, throne of fear and
 love.

I cannot say, Beloved, if You are caught
 In visible formation though unwrought,
 Or if the forms he saw were those cast by
 The shadow of the covering angel's sky.
 Beloved, I do not hear the voice, I do
 Not see the visage of divine and true,
 Nor do I hold the Hellenistic view
 That in matter and spirit empties You
 Of all reality. But I stand firm
 That You are the Reality in term.

Ezekiel 2

1 And He said to me, "Son of man,
 Stand on your feet, *stand if you can*,
 And I'll speak to you *man to man*."
 2 Then the Spirit entered me when
 He spoke to me, and set me then

On my feet, and I heard Him who
 Spoke to me. 3 And He said to me
 "Son of man, I am sending you,
 To the children of Israel *flee*,
 To a rebellious nation that
 Has rebelled against Me *out flat*,
 They and their fathers have transgressed
 Against Me to this day addressed.
 4 "For impudent and stubborn *are*
These children. I'm sending you *far*
 To them, and you shall say to them,
 'So says the Lord YHWH *to His gem*.'
 5 "As for them, whether they hear or
 Whether they refuse *to hear*, for
 They're a rebellious house, yet they
 Will know a prophet's been their way.
 6 "And you, son of man, do not be
 Afraid of them nor their decree,
 Though briers and thorns *are* with you and
 You live among the scorpions' band,
 Do not be afraid of their words
 Or dismayed by their looks like curds,
 Though they *are* a rebellious house.
 7 And you shall speak my words no chouse
 To them, whether they'll come to hear,
 Or whether they'll turn back their ear,
 For they are a rebellious house.
 8 But you, son of man, hear what I
 Say to you, don't rebel or try
 Like that rebellious house, but you
 Open your mouth and eat the due
 That I give you to say and do."
 9 And when I looked, see, there a hand
 Was sent to me, and see, the stand
 Of a roll of writing in it;
 10 And he spread before me the writ
 Within and out were written down
 Laments and griefs and woe *to drown*.

Beloved, I have no mandate from Your
 mouth
 As did Ezekiel to both north and south.
 I have no message given by Your tongue,
 My only speech is that in torment wrung
 From human heart and lips, the human
 ware.

And yet I fear no stand of court or share
 Of hopeless tyranny. I know the rate
 Of public opinion's against my fate,
 And still I raise a fist against the fair,
 The rich, the poor, the proud ones
 everywhere.

I have been bludgeoned by the feathered
soft
Pretending to be freedom sent aloft,
And know its stench and power to
demonize
The very best of right in human guise.

Ezekiel 3

1 Then he said to me, "Son of man,
Eat what you find, eat this roll's span,
And go and speak to Israel's house."
2 So I opened my mouth like mouse,
And he made me eat that roll's bran.
3 And he said to me, "Son of man,
Let your belly be filled as can,
And fill your gut with this roll that
I give you." So I ate out flat,
And it was sweet to tongue to taste,
Like honey in a honey paste.
4 And he said to me, "Son of man,
Go up to Israel's house by plan
And speak My words to them, you can.
5 "For you're not sent to a folk tossed
By a foreign language embossed
And of a hard tongue, but unto
The house of Israel in crew.
6 "Not to many folk of strange speech,
Not to a language hard to preach,
Whose words you cannot understand.
Indeed if I'd sent to their land
They would have obeyed, though
unmanned.
7 "But house of Israel will not hear
What you say because in their ear
They do not take My words with fear:
For all the house of Israel are
Impudent and hard-hearted star.
8 "Behold, I have made your face strong
Against their faces in the wrong,
And your forehead strong against theirs.
9 "As diamond harder than flint shares
I've made your forehead; do not fear
Nor be dismayed as they appear,
Though they're a house rebelling here."

Though I have a face strong as flint to cast
In teeth of impudence of priestly crased,
I am not sent at all, and if I'm sent,
It's to a folk whose language has been
spent
In northern silences, in liquor rent,

A foreign speech and strange one, even
bent
Beyond the need in frumpish tyranny.
But every tongue has potential to be
The tongue of human heart and to be free.
Beloved, I'm sent if sent at all to speak
In foreign languages but only peek
Within my heart words near to be forgot
Of childhood stories by the vacant lot,
Of words of the long dead if I should seek.

10 And He said to me, "Son of man,
All My words that I'll speak by plan
To you, receive them in your heart,
And hear with your ears *set apart*.
11 "And go to those who came to be
In the midst of captivity,
To the sons of your people and
Speak to them and tell them in band,
So says the Lord YHWH, if they'll hear
Of whether they'll reject with leer."
12 And lift me up, a spirit did,
And I heard behind me the grid
Of great rushing: "Blessed is the glory
Of YHWH from His place in the story."
13 Also the sound of living things
With wings that touched each other's
flings,
And the sound of the wheels to turn
In noise of great rushing to earn.
14 So the spirit lifted me up,
And took me away from the cup
In bitterness, in heat of mind,
But YHWH's hand held me from behind.

Here is a paradox I have to say,
That Your prophet caught up before the
fray
By spirit and by wing and wind to hear
Is once delivered from the bitter fear,
Is once delivered from the bitter way
Before he lands among the captive prey.
I'd think his bitterness might then increase
To see the exiles go without release.
But everything man writes is filled to brim
With paradox, the thing we love with vim.
It's only Your word, Decalogue, I find
Reveals no paradox to human mind,
But is as clear as crystal to the wined,
As straight as geometry is designed.

15 I came to the captivity

At Telabib, who live to see
The river of Chebar, and I
Sat where they sat without reply
Astonished then for seven days.

I too should be astonished to fly high
And over desert and three rivers nigh
To reach the river Chebar there where I
Would sit for seven days to catch my
breath.
Indeed, I should be astonished to death.
The way You handle prophets is a shame,
Dragged kicking and shouting before the
flame
And caught up in the sky with multitude
Of dove and eagle and the swallow's
brood.
Beloved, I'd think twice before I replied
With favour to a call come from Your side
To be a prophet to relate Your way.
I'd count to ten and turn around to pray
Another task, another grace to stay.

16 It came at end of seven days,
That YHWH's word came to me and said
17 "Son of man, I have set you led
A watchman to Israel's house spread,
So hear the word of My mouth, and
Give them warning from Me to stand.
18 "When I say to the wicked, 'You
Will surely die,' and you in cue
Say nothing to warn him, nor speak
To warn the wicked from his peek,
To save his life; the same bad man
Shall die in his wickedness' *span*;
But his blood I will ask of you.
19 "Yet if you warn the wicked, and
He does not turn from evil planned,
Nor from his wicked way, he'll die
In his iniquity to spy,
But you've delivered your own soul.
20 "Again, when the righteous *in toll*,
Turns from his righteousness *in toll*,
Committing iniquity's *role*,
And I lay stumbling block for him,
He shall die; because you were dim
Not to give him warning *with vim*,
He'll die in his sin, and the right
That he has done no more in sight
Shall be remembered; but his blood
Will I require at your hand's *bud*.
21 "But if you warn the righteous man,

So that the just sin not by plan,
And he does not sin, he shall live,
Because he's warned, and you shall give
Life to your own soul *as you can*."

I've saved my own soul and my life,
Beloved,
In the words that I write hooded and
gloved.
I clearly state against both state and church
That those who disobey leave in the lurch
Both self and others under pine and birch.
I state again to every human brow,
There is one law eternal anyhow,
The Decalogue that tells in ten short words
How humans should live among beasts and
birds.
If no one listens to my faithful speech,
But goes on after those who teach and
preach
To worship three or four, to break the day
Of Sabbath and to kill in times of grey,
I've saved my soul in everything I say.

22 And YHWH's hand was there upon me;
And he said to me, "Get up, see,
And go into the plain, and I
Will talk there with you by and by."
23 Then I got up, went to the plain;
And see, YHWH's glory would remain,
As glory I saw by the stream
Of Chebar; and *as though to deem*
I fell on my face *not in vain*.
24 Then the spirit came into me,
And set me on my feet to see,
And spoke with me, and said to me,
"Go shut yourself in your shanty.
25 "And you, O son of man, behold,
They shall put bands upon you cold,
And tie you up with them and you
Shall not go out among the crew.
26 "And I'll make your tongue stick into
Your palate, so you'll be dumb too,
No longer warning of the due,
For they're a rebel house *in view*.
27 "But when I speak with you, then I
Will open up your mouth to cry,
And you'll say to them, 'So says Lord
YHWH; the one who hears Him adored,
Let him hear; and the one who will
Not, let him close his hearing still;
For they're a rebel house *for pill*.'" "

I'm shut with the cold bands of iron and steel,
 And broken beneath every Finnish heel,
 An exile from the supposed land of free
 Where took place the greatest in history
 Of holocausts and shoahs when the race
 Of red men were shunted out without trace.
 You've chosen me to write these awful words
 And shout them among bumblebees and birds,
 Accused and persecuted for the rate
 Of white and non-white fallen on my pate.
 Then finish off the punishment in me
 And make my tongue stick to eternity,
 And give me rest from frantic poetry
 Before my life is passed and I am late.

Ezekiel 4

1 You also, son of man, come take
 A tile and lay it in your wake,
 And draw on it the city plan,
 Jerusalem *in sight and scan*.
 2 And lay siege against it, and build
 A fort against it, and unstilled
 Throw up a bulwark on it too;
 Set the camp also by its crew,
 Battering rams as unfulfilled.
 3 And take you then an iron pan,
 And set it for a wall in span
 Of iron between you and the town;
 And set your face there with a frown,
 And let it be besieged, and you
 Shall lay siege against all its crew.
 This be a sign to Israel's house.
 4 Lie there too on your left side's dowse,
 And lay the sins of Israel's house
 Upon it; by number of days
 That you shall lie upon its stays,
 You will bear their iniquity.
 5 For I have laid upon the tree
 Of years of their iniquity,
 According to number of days,
 Three hundred and ninety in stays;
 So shall you bear iniquity
 Of Israel's house *and faithfully*.
 6 And when you've done them all, then lie
 On your right side, and you will try
 To bear the sins of Judah's house
 For forty days and like a mouse:
 I've set for you each day to be

For a year *in eternity*.

I mark the principle, and mark it well,
 To pick it up against after a spell,
 To use when days of prophecy are writ
 Without an explanation to the fit.
 A day for one year, so the rhyming goes,
 And prophecy will then reveal the rows
 Of coming kingdoms from the head to toes.
 Beloved, I thank you as did Paul one day
 For hiding from the generals in the fray
 The scoring of the victory to last,
 And showing to the simple in the blast
 The haven and the chart before the caste.
 Beloved, I count a day for every year
 And wait for Your own justice to appear.

7 That's why you'll set your face toward
 The siege of Jerusalem's cord;
 And your arm shall be bare, and you
 Shall prophesy against it there.
 8 And see, I will lay bands on you,
 And you shall not turn from the view
 From one side to the other till
 You end the days of your siege still.

Between good Hesiod and the man they
 killed
 With draught of hemlock, one prophet
 fulfilled
 The role of visionary in the track
 Of seeing matter and spirit both lack
 Solidity of right philosophy.
 The acts of priest Ezekiel flew in face
 Of every human thought for thoughtful
 race,
 And showed that thought's enfeebled by
 the word,
 And action only is the sign occurred
 That can express reality at all,
 Whether in the Semitic sort of stall
 Or in the rotten glory of the hall
 Of Athens. My Beloved, I think and speak
 And in a moment act both strong and weak.

9 "Take also wheat and barley and
 Beans and lentils and millet stand
 And fitches and put them into
 One pot and make you bread to chew;
 By the number of days that you
 Shall lie upon your side in view,
 Three hundred ninety days and you

Shall eat of it day and night too.
10 "And your food which you'll come to
eat
Shall be by weight, each day the treat
Of twenty shekels; time to time
You'll eat a bit *as fearing crime*.

You serve the minimum of human need
To your prophet and punish him indeed.
The recipe must then contain the seed
Of all nutrition's secrets in its store.
I read it faithfully and keep the score.
The wheat and barley and the lentils and
The beans and millet with the fitches stand
The perfect recipe of bread to bake.
I take the recipe for my own sake.
Although I may increase the rate I eat,
And have a bit of oil for bitter treat,
And bitter herb as well for vitamin,
I see the recipe in protein's grin
Is perfect and better than any bin.

11 "You'll also drink some water there
By measure, sixth of a hin's share;
From time to time you'll drink *with care*.
12 "And you shall eat as barley cakes,
And you shall bake it with the rakes
Of shit that comes out of a man,
And in their sight *and by My plan*."
13 And YHWH said "Even so shall sons
Of Israel eat their defiled buns
Among the Gentiles in their runs."
14 And I said "Ah Lord YHWH! See here,
My soul's not been an unclean leer
From my youth up to now I've not
Eaten what's dying in the pot,
Or torn to pieces, neither came
Abomination in mouth's claim."
15 Then he said to me, "See, I give
You cow's dung for man's shit, so live
To make your bread with that in sieve."
16 And He said to me, "Son of man,
See I will break the staff in span
Of bread here in Jerusalem;
And they shall eat bread like a gem
With care, and drink water by share,
And with astonishment to bear,
17 "That they may lack both bread and
drink
And be astonished there to think,
And waste away at their sin's brink."

Beloved, I think Your stroke of genius hits
No spot of empathy where my heart sits.
I speak the same hope that Your prophet
shares
That I might eat the kosher best of wares.
Polluted is the water and the bread
Of London City and New York outspread
With shit a-plenty where the wealthy fed.
Let those You warn not to destroy the earth
Eat of those balls of shit and suffer dearth.
I hie me to my spring and take the leaf
Of my own garden without fear or grief.
I leave poor prophets to Your hand and
care
And kings and occupants to what they
share
Of shitty waters and the piss they bear.

Ezekiel 5

1 And you, son of man, take a knife
As sharp indeed as tongue of wife
Of a barber with razor edge,
And cause it to cut down the hedge
Of hair on your head and your beard,
And weigh the hair, divide the cleared.
2 You'll burn with fire a third of it
Within the city where you sit,
When the days of the siege are done;
And a third part flay with knife-blade;
And a third part scatter *for fun*
In the wind, and I'll draw unstayed
The sword after them *in parade*.
3 You'll also take a few hairs out
And wrap them in your cloak about.
4 Then take some of them once again
And throw them in the fire amen,
And burn them, from them shall arise
A fire in all Israel's house prize.

In Bangladesh the Hindu practice still
Invades Islamic faith and act and will.
They shave the baby's head of hair and
weigh
It to see how much in more alms to pay.
I'm glad to see the practice has a part
In what Your prophet did and said to start
His prophecy before the coarse and art.
And yet I cannot think but innovation
Is the best word for such a confrontation,
And let the heathen mow their own faith
down
And strut with it about the flooded town.

I cut my hair at last to root of crown
In Muna without sacrifice to stay
And save the wisps and carry them to
weigh.

5 So says the Lord YHWH, "This is that
Jerusalem I've set out flat
Among the nations and lands round.
6 "And she has changed My judgements'
ground
To wickedness more than those found
In other nations, and My laws
More than the countries round her claws.
For they've refused My judgements and
My statutes not to walk or stand."

So I was right to make a bucky strike
At innovation before Your word's spike.
The Muslim's changed Your verdict and to
spare
So has the Rabbi in the things to wear.
And that's not speaking of the Christian
bear
That varnishes the heathen stories there.
Beloved, give me no verdicts of this day
Of Rome's apostasy and Mecca's fray.
Give me the verdicts of Your word alone,
Pure and undefiled from before Your
throne,
In Abraham's rejoicing and the book
Of Moses and the heart that David took,
The fount of Christ's humility and in
Muhammad and Ali's cup lit within.

7 So says the Lord YHWH, "Because you
Multiplied more than any crew
That are around and about you,
Not walking in My statutes true,
Nor keeping of My judgements due,
But did according to the way
Of nations' judgements round your hay;
8 "That's why" says the Lord YHWH, "See
now,
I, even I against your prow
Will execute judgement on you
In sight of the nations in crew.
9 "And I will do in you what I
Have not done before nor will I
Do any more the like, for why?
Because of all the things you try
In your abominations' cry.
10 "That's why the father shall eat sons

Among you, and the sons for buns
Shall eat their fathers; and I'll lay
Judgement on you and the whole sway
Of those left I'll scatter away
In all the winds *in heaven's pay*.

14 "Wherefore, as I live," says Lord
YHWH,

"Surely because you came to spew
Defilement on My temple too
With all your horrid things in view,
Sacrifices to idols new,
Therefore I will diminish you;
My eye shall not spare nor will I
Take pity on your hew and cry.
12 "A third part of you'll come to die
With plague and famine be consumed
Among you, and a third part fumed
Shall fall by the sword among you;
And I will scatter to the wind
A third, draw sword after unbinned.
13 "So shall My anger be fulfilled;
And I'll cause my fury unstilled
On them, and I'll be comforted;
And they shall know that I am YHWH,
And I have spoken in My due,
When I've fulfilled My fury's hue.
14 "And I shall give you for a waste
And a reproach in nations' taste
That are around about you here,
In the sight of all that appear.

15 "So it shall be reproach and taunt,
Instruction and astonished vaunt
To all the nations around you,
When I shall execute judgements
On you in wrath and fury too,
In raging rebukes on your tents.
I YHWH have spoken what is due.
16 "In sending evil darts to take
Bread from the mouth and stomach's sake
Among you appointed in wake
Of your destruction, that I send,
And famine I add to and lend,
And break your staff of bread in stake.
17 "So I'll send on you famine and
Such evil beasts and grieve your band;
And plague and blood shall pass through
you;
And I will bring the sword in view.
I YHWH have spoken, *it is true*.

The words are his and not Your own, I
know

Because what happened then in Israel's
 show
 Was just a fob in cluckety on the go
 Compared with genocides that even I
 Have seen portrayed beneath a calmer sky.
 He had no sense of what things were in
 store
 For human kind, much less on Israel's
 shore.
 He did not dream the Maccabean fate,
 The coming of the Grecian, Roman state.
 He dresses Your words in the feeble light
 Of primitive in hate, uncouth in spite.
 The Bible is a human book I see.
 You would have had a clearer spectropy
 On eating human flesh of son and wight.

Ezekiel 6

1 Now the word of YHWH came to me,
 Saying: 2 "Son of man, turn and see
 Toward the mountains of Israel,
 And prophesy against them *well*,
 3 "And say, 'O hills of Israel,
 Hear *now* the word of the Lord YHWH!
 So says the Lord YHWH to the *true*
 Mountains, to the hills, to the vales,
 And to the valleys *on their scales*,
 "Indeed I, *even* I, will bring
 A sword against you, and I'll fling
 Destruction on your high places.
 4 "Then your altars shall be *like fizz*
And desolate, your incense towers
 Shall be slashed down, and I will throw
 Down those killed among you to show
 Before your idols *in their bowers*.
 5 "And I will lay the corpses down,
 Corpses of Israel's sons in town
 Before their idols, and I will
 Scatter your bones on altars' hill.
 6 "In every place you live the towns
 Shall become wastelands *for My frowns*,
 And the high places shall become
 A desolation *of the dumb*,
 So that your altars may be laid
 In waste and desolation made,
 Your idols may be broken and
 Made to cease *from city and land*,
 Your incense altars be cut down,
 And your works wiped out from the town.
 7 "The slain shall fall down where you are,
 And you shall know that I'm *a star*
And YHWH God only near and far.

The Hebrew tense is not of time and so
 The future is not sure in come and go.
 I rather think I should translate in slow
 Regard for the past and the things that
 show.

To bow before the image of a god
 Or mother goddess, though comfort in pod,
 Is to become a corpse, a thing that's dead
 In sacrifice unvivified and fled.
 I sacrifice myself to You and find
 I rise up whole and ready to be dined.
 But should I bow to idols in the glow
 Of secret or of public retroblow,
 I'd rise a moving corpse, the living dread,
 The denizen of crypts the Romans bled.

8 "Yet I will leave a remnant, so
 You may have some that will not go
 Under the sword where nations low,
 When you'll be scattered in the row
 Of countries *going to and fro*.
 9 "Those who escape of you shall mind
 Me among the nations combined
 Where they shall be carried to be
 Captives, because I broke the ley
 Of their whore's heart departing Me,
 And their eyes which follow the tail
 Of idols; and they will loathe their
 Own flesh for the evil in share
 That they've committed on the stair.
 10 "And they shall know that I am YHWH,
 And have not said in vain I'd do
 This evil to them in their view.

Indeed, Beloved, You left some of the crew
 To live and suffer in Judean view,
 And finally be scattered in all lands
 Again by cruel Romans and the hands
 Of mercenary soldiers in their bands.
 They lived to give their offspring after
 years
 Of pogroms to come under Hitler's shears.
 Reality of history is not
 Predicted in the slightest of the taut
 And awful verses of the prophet's lot.
 Perhaps You thought the human mind
 could bear
 Only a little of the coming share.
 You blinded Yourself and the human race
 To what would come in horror and take
 place.

11 So says the Lord YHWH, "Strike by hand

And stamp with your foot on the land,
And say 'Also for all the band
Of wicked horrors of the house
Of Israel! For they like grouse
Shall fall by sword and famine too
And by the pestilence in view.'

12 "The one far off shall die beneath
The pestilence come without wreath,
And the one nearby with the sword,
And the one left besieged ungored
Shall die by the famine; so I
Will lay my fury on their sty.

13 "Then you shall know that I am YHWH,
When their slain shall come into view
Among their idols round in crew
Of their altars, on each high hill,
On all the mountaintops to fill,
And under every tree that's green,
And under every thick oak seen,
The place where they offered incense
Sweet to all their idols' presence.
14 "So I will stretch out My hand on
Them and make the land empty drawn,
Indeed more desolate than that
Wilderness toward Diblath in flat,
In all their habitations; and
They'll know that I am YHWH and stand."

I've seen the hills of Edom and the glow
Of sunset in reflection on the show
Of Ammon's heights, and they looked bare
to me.

You stretched Your hand, Beloved, on bush
and tree

And made an end of groves with desert
spree.

The whole land is converted at a breath
To You alone as God, and yet the death
By hate and gun still stalks the glowing
land.

Beloved, You must again take the
command.

My heart bleeds too to see the narrow
strand

Of hope recede and so I leave a word
Tight folded in an expectation blurred
Caught in the youthful toil in En-Gedi,
The touch of life in Bethlehem's country.

Ezekiel 7

1 The word of YHWH came to me saying

2 "And you, son of man, so YHWH's
saying

To the land of Israel waylaying;
An end has come at last upon
The four corners of the land's spawn.

3 "Now is the end upon you, and
I'll send My anger down to stand
On you and will judge you by what
You have been doing to the glut,
Avenging the horrors you strut.

4 "And My eye shall not spare, nor will
I have pity; but I will fill
You with the punishment your ways
Deserve, and your horrors in maze
Shall be among you, and you'll know
That I am YHWH, *and I'm not slow.*"

The thought that some catastrophe will
teach

The people better than a voice to preach
Is just naïve, Beloved, beneath the reach
Of Your divinity and wisdom's care.
You ought to know the better for Your
share.

We have not learned that You are YHWH
by right

Of pain and grief upon our homely site.
We did not learn in ages past nor did
We learn it from the Nazis when we hid
Or when sent to the gas without a lid.
You'll have to find another strategy
If you want to teach people some degree
Of knowing that You're God of all we see.
The Decalogue in fact does it for me.

5 So says the Lord YHWH, "A bad thing,
A great affliction's come to sting.

6 "An end has come, come has the end:
It lies in ambush, see its trend.

7 "Here's come the dawn destroying you,
O you who live on the land's dew;
Come has the time, the day in view
Filled with trouble is near, it's true
This time and not rumours on hills.

8 "Soon I'll pour out My fury's bills
On you and vent My rage on you:

And I will judge you by your ways;
And recompense your horror's praise.

9 "My eye shall not spare, neither will
I have pity; I'll fill the bill

Of punishment to you for what
 You've done and for your horrors' glut
 Among you, and you'll know that I
 Am YHWH that attacks *from the sky*.
 10 "See the day, see it coming fast;
 The morning is now almost past,
 The rod has blossomed and the pride
 Has budded *around every side*.
 11 "Violence is raised in the rod
 Of wickedness; none on the sod
 Shall stay of their great multitude;
 Nor even any of their brood;
 And none shall wait their passing crude.
 12 "The time has come, the day draws near;
 Let not the buyer rise for cheer,
 Nor let the seller mourn for dear;
 For wrath's on all both far and near.
 13 "The seller shall not come back to
 What has been sold, though still in pew
 Of life; for the vision is due
 Upon the whole crowd not to come;
 Nor shall any rise up to hum
 In life's iniquity *for rum*.
 14 "They've blown the trumpet,
 preparation
 Is done, but none goes out to station;
 For My wrath's on all the crowd's nation.
 15 "The sword's without, and pestilence
 And famine within the offence;
 The one left in the field shall die
 By the sword, and the one to vie
 Still in the city shall succumb
 To famine and plague's odium.

I like the way you put the choices given
 To humankind upon the earth we live in.
 The one left in the field dies by the sword,
 The one who takes his refuge in accord
 Of city safety succumbs to the fate
 Of famine or an epidemic late.
 Disease and violence and hunger still
 Lie in ambush for almost all who will
 Be born before I die. Beloved, I make
 A truce with You, if only for Your sake.
 No wonder Hellenistic thought is geared
 To spiritualize all that we've feared,
 And made of You, the sole Reality,
 A spectre at the harvest of the spree.

16 "But those who do escape shall run,
 And be on mountaintops in sun
 Like doves of the valleys to mourn,

Each one for wickedness he's borne.
 17 "All hands shall be feeble for scorn,
 And all knees weak as water worn.
 18 "They'll clothe themselves in sackcloth,
 and
 Horror shall cover them in band,
 And shame shall be on every face,
 And baldness on all heads to trace.
 19 "They'll throw their silver in the streets,
 And take away their golden treats;
 Their silver and their gold shall not
 Be able to save them in plot
 Of YHWH's wrath; they shall not remain
 To satisfy their souls, in vain
 They try to fill their paunch with grain:
 Because it is the stumbling block
 Of their iniquity in stock.
 20 "As for the beauty of his gem,
 He set it in majestic hem;
 But they made images of their
 Abominations and the share
 Of their detestable things there;
 That's why I've set it far from them.
 21 "And I will put it in the hands
 Of strangers for a prey's remands,
 And to the wicked of the earth
 For a spoil, they shall spoil its worth.
 22 "I'll also turn My face from them,
 And they shall spoil My secret gem;
 For robbers shall come into it,
 And there defile *the clean and fit*.

It is irrational to think that gold
 Can save anyone from the fears that hold
 The human heart, the fear of pain and grief,
 The fear of death and famine, and belief
 That neighbours are out there to steal the
 store
 Of peanut butter horded in the floor.
 Gold has just one good quality in it:
 It does not spoil but keeps on being fit,
 Though fit for what besides the body made
 Of mythic images upon parade,
 I wot not. Still the crowd is slave and fast
 To gold and thinks security at last
 Is in the possession of more and more.
 Gold is more precious even than the gore.

23 "So make a chain; for the land's full
 Of bloody crimes, the city full
 Of violence. 24 "That's why I bring
 The worst of the heathen to spring,

And they shall hold their houses; I
 Will also make the pomp to vie
 Of the strong to cease; and their holy
 Places shall be defiled by lowly.
 25 "Destruction comes; and they shall seek
 Islam or peace and find no peek.
 26 "Mischief shall come on mischief and
 Rumour shall be on rumour's hand;
 Then they shall seek prophetic vision;
 But law shall perish with derision
 From priest and ancient counsel's stand."

Indeed the world still seeks Islam or peace,
 At least the most part think they do for
 fleece.

Perhaps Islam's not found merely because
 Sincerity of search is not in claws.
 Islam is simply the Qur'an today,
 And not a history and culture to slay.
 It's just the recitation of that word
 And doing what it says with a heart stirred.
 The Qur'an makes criterion of what
 You handed to Moses besides the shut
 Book of the Torah, the tables of law,
 The ten in view of every man with awe.
 I lay hold on the Decalogue and know
 That Islam lights the way that I should go.

Ezekiel 8

1 It happened in the sixth year, in
 The sixth month and fifth day in bin,
 I sat in my house and there too
 With me sat Judah's elders' crew,
 And then the hand of the Lord YHWH
 Fell there upon me *in their view*.
 2 And I looked and see it was like
 Appearance of the fire to strike;
 From the appearance of his waist
 And downward, fire; and from his waist
 Upward like brightness as in hue
 The amber shining in its due.
 3 And he stretched out what was like hand,
 And took me by the hair to stand;
 The spirit lifted me up high
 Between the earth, between the sky,
 And brought me in great visions to
 Jerusalem, to the door to
 The inner gate with northern view;
 Where was the seat of image due
 To jealousy, provoking too.
 4 And see glory of Alohim
 Of Israel there, by what did seem

I saw in the valley of *dream*.
 5 Then he said to me, "Son of man,
 Lift up your eyes and so to scan
 Toward the north." So I raised up
 My eyes to northward like a tup,
 And see to northward at the gate
 Of the altar this image great
 Of jealousy to enter late.
 6 And he said to me, "Son of man,
 Do you see what they do by plan?
 The great abominations that
 The house of Israel out flat
 Commits here, that I should go far
 Away from My temple as star?
 But turn again once more and see
 Even greater stupidity."

The flaming visitor came down to show
 Ezekiel the vision on the go
 Of what defiles Your temple in the show,
 The idol, imaged god, that marks the row
 Of the cathedral and the church I know.
 I've seen the idol set up in the church,
 I've felt its wrath from out the fleshly perch
 Where it rules hand and heart and fills the
 head

With darkness in the way that such are led.
 Beloved, I've seen the idol motionless
 Upon the morning of my own address,
 And find it must be emptied daily from
 The temple of the heart as well as sum
 Of stone and mortar hearing hymns that
 hum.

7 He brought me to the door of court;
 And when I looked, there was a sort
 Of hole in the wall. 8 Then he said
 To me, "Son of man, dig with dread
 Now in the wall." And when I'd dug
 In the wall see a door to plug.
 9 And he said to me, "Now go in,
 And see the wickedness for sin
 That they are doing here *to win*."
 10 So I went in to see, and there
 Was every kind of creeping there,
 Beasts horrible, and all the share
 Of idols in Israel's house, and
 Inscribed upon the wall to stand.
 11 There stood before them seventy men
 Of the ancients of Israel's den,
 And in the middle of them stood
 Jaazaniah the son of *hood*

Shaphan, with every man in hand
His censer, and thick incense stand.
12 Then he said to me, "Son of man,
Have you seen what the ancient band
Of Israel's house do in the dark,
Each man in the chambers in spark
Of his imagination's lark?
For they say "YHWH does not see us,
YHWH has forsaken omnibus."

You made the human mind of such
contrived
That the part seems the whole when he's
survived
To study universe and everything
That enters in the vision of his wing.
The trinity of subject and object,
The vehicle of perception select
Suggests to minds both dark and to reflect
That threefold in reality is true.
The Father, Son, and Holy Spirit do
Seem to the mind at worship all we can
Understand of the divine in its plan.
It takes humility instead of sense
To accept that Oneness is no pretence
And demands idols be cast from our tents.

13 He also told me, "Turn again,
And you shall see a greater wen."
14 And he brought me to the gate door
Of YHWH's house toward the northern
shore,
And see there sat women by score
Weeping for Tammuz regimen.
15 And he said to me "Have you seen,
O son of man? Turn round in beam,
And you shall see a greater scheme
Of horrible idolatry."

Some weep for Hussein in his great distress
To point of idolatry to confess,
And others weep for Jesus on the cross,
An image of Tammuz among the dross
Of Middle Eastern faiths for centuries.
The Tammuz faith is still around to please
The Baptist and the Catholic and tease
The Presbyterian down on his knees.
Beloved, if I were You I would strike down
Idolatry in church as well as crown.
Your patience with the world's beyond my
ken.
I would be more than wrathful in my den.

If flood was not enough one day to quell
The thing, then send down fire to do it well.

16 He brought me in the inner court
Of YHWH's house, and see there for sport
At the door of YHWH's temple, there
Between the porch and altar fair,
About twenty-five men, with their
Backs toward YHWH's temple, and their
face
Toward the east; and so apace
They worship the sun in its race.
17 He said to me, "Have you seen this,
O son of man? Is it to miss
In the house of Judah that they
Commit abominations' sway?
For they have filled the land with grief:
And have come back beyond belief
Provoking Me to wrath; and see,
They put the branch to their nose free.
18 That's why I'll deal in My fury;
My eye shall not spare in the spree;
Neither will I return pity;
And though they cry in My ears loud,
Yet I will not regard the crowd."

I cannot fathom what dark mind it takes
To set aside the Sabbath in the wakes
Of Sunday and then bow to worship You
Toward the Sun and satisfy that cue
And not think that it is idolatry.
On Sunday they worship the crossly tree,
The point of light that Constantine brought
out
As Christian Sun worship and without
doubt.
Disarmingly the arguments may flow,
But grasping at such rays upon the go
Just adds to wickedness of heart and hand.
Destroy, Beloved, Sun worship from the
land.
But at the same time convert Sabbath-
keeper
From being such a stinker for a reaper.

Ezekiel 9

1 He shouted also in my ears
With a loud voice, saying for fears,
"Let those who rule the town come near,
Every man with his weapon gear."
2 See six men came down from the way
Of the higher gate in the sway

Of the north, and each man in hand
Had a weapon of slaughter planned;
And one man among them was decked
In linen, and an inkhorn checked
By his side like a scribe; and they
Went in and stood beside the ray
Of brazen altar, *there to stay*.

3 Israel's Alohim's glory went
Up from the cherub and was sent
To the threshold of the house lent.
And he called to the man decked out
In linen, with the inkhorn stout
By his side like a scribe *devout*.

4 And YHWH said to him, "Go about
In the town of Jerusalem,
And set a mark on diadem
Of the men that sigh and who cry
For all abominations wry
That are done in the city's hem."

I sigh and cry, it's true, Beloved, but I
Am not in Jerusalem or in view
Of that fair city. I do what I do
Just south of tundra and beneath the sky.
I sigh and cry for what I like to spy
As the abominations of the crew
That claims to worship three in one as You,
But really worships Tammuz and Day Eye.
Beloved, my heart is splintered by the task
Of sighing and of crying in the blast,
And yet I wonder how much in my mind
Is truly set for Your glory in kind.
Remove my Tammuz that I cast out now,
Even if one with a thorn-broken brow.

5 And to the others he said there
In my hearing, "Pass in to share
The city after him and strike;
Your eye shall not pity the like,
Nor shall you anybody spare.
6 "Kill all, the old and young, both maid
And little children on parade,
And women, but do not come near
Any man with the mark to steer,
And start at My temple and raid."
Then they began with the old men
Who sat before the temple then.
7 And He said to them, "Spoil the place,
And fill the courts with corpses' race;
Go out." And they went out to kill
Into the city *with a will*.
8 It happened as they slaughtered there,

And I was left, I fell in prayer
Upon my face, and cried and said
"Ah Lord YHWH, will You kill the bred
That's left of Israel in Your
Pouring out of Your wrath in store
Upon Jerusalem with gore?"

9 And He said to me, "Wickedness
Of Israel's house, Judah's address
Is very great, the land is filled
With blood, and the city unstilled
Of its perversity: they say
'YHWH has forsaken the earth's ray,
And YHWH does not look on *for pay*.'
10 "And as for Me also, My eye
Shall not spare, and neither will I
Have pity, I will recompense
Their way on their own head and sense."
11 And see the man decked out to be
In linen, with the inkhorn free,
Reported the matter, and said
"I've done as commanded and led."

The genocides of human families
Are old as conquistadors in the breeze
Of Mexico and in recent Peru.
The genocides of Bosnia in brew
Followed the Serbian deaths of the freeze
Of Vatican to rid the world of all
Called Orthodox upon the earthly ball.
The hitting back itself is nothing new.
Beloved, this prophecy's not yet fulfilled.
There has never been righteous hand that
spilled

The blood of the idolater and left
The world pure for Your worship unbereft.
Commandment-keepers simply do not
wield

The fate of the wicked and the well-heeled.

Ezekiel 10

1 And I looked and saw in the sky
Above the heads of cherubim
There appeared over them to spy
As though a sapphire stone undim,
And like a throne *rising up high*.
2 And he spoke to the man decked out
In linen and said *as in shout*,
"Go between the wheels and beneath
The cherub, and fill your hand's wreath
With coals of fire from in between
The cherubim, and scatter keen
Over the city." So he went

While I watched the one *who was sent*.
 3 And the cherubim stood to right
 Of the house, when the man in sight
 Went in; and the cloud filled the court,
 At least the one of inner sort.
 4 And YHWH's glory arose up from
 The cherub, and threshold to come
 Of the house, and the house was filled
 With the cloud, and the court was chilled
 With the brightness of YHWH's glory.
 5 The sound of the cherubim's wings
 Was heard to outer court in flings,
 As the voice of El Shaddai when
 He comes to speak *in ears of men*.
 6 It happened when He had commanded
 The man decked in linen expanded,
 Saying "Take fire from out between
 The wheels, and from between the scene
 Of cherubim; then he went in
 And stood beside the wheels *that spin*.
 7 One cherub reached out from among
 The cherubim to the fire hung
 That was between the cherubim,
 And took some and put in the grim
 Hands of the one decked in linen,
 Who took it and went out again.

Fire-walking is one thing, Beloved, to see
 Even among Americans the free.
 It used to be only the Hindu race
 Was willing to strike out at such a pace.
 Of course this is not walking, but to take
 A double handful of hot coals to shake.
 That's done right here among the Iroquois
 Who open up the stove in false-face joy.
 Beloved, as I tramp through the bosky way
 Above my log house in the spring today,
 Methinks the wheels descend in gratitude
 Upon the leaf beginnings and their brood,
 And I take up in handfuls fire and light
 After the winter darkness and the night.

8 And there appeared in cherubim
 The form of a man's hand *and slim*
 Beneath their wings *both taut and trim*.
 9 And when I looked, see the four wheels
 Beside the cherubim *for keels*,
 One wheel by each cherub to look
 The colour of beryl *in hook*.
 10 As for appearances there's one
 Likeness to all the four in sum,
 As one wheel in the other's nook.

11 In their going on their four sides
 They go; they do not turn in rides,
 But go straight on as the front points,
 Moving forward, no turning joints.
 12 And their whole body and their backs
 And their hands and their wings in tracks
 Of wheels were full of eyes around,
 The wheels that they four had in bound.
 13 As for the wheels, I heard the cry,
 O wheel! 14 And every one came by
 With four faces: the first face looked
 Like the face of a cherub hooked,
 The second face that of a man,
 The third the face of lion's scan,
 The fourth face in an eagle's plan.

Even Azilian times were up to date
 In dropping beastly figures from the rate
 Of faith and fair religion of the state.
 The spots vermillion on one side of stone
 Replaced the ancient art of bone on bone,
 And still make puzzles for the scholar
 shone.

Totemic emblem these no doubt are like
 Australian aboriginal to strike.
 The prophet's psyche seem more potently
 Archaic than that ancient time's degree.
 Anyone can invent the wheel, it's just
 Applying it to raise the troubled dust
 In locomotion that requires the fame
 Of modern faith, if only in a name.

15 And the cherubim lifted up,
 It is the living creature's tup
 That I saw by river Chebar.
 16 And when the cherubim went far,
 The wheels went by them *not to jar*;
 And when the cherubim went up,
 Their wings above the earth like cup,
 The same wheels also did not turn
 Away from their side *of the burn*.
 17 When they stood up, these also stood;
 And when they were lifted for good,
 These lifted up along them too,
 The living creature's spirit due.
 18 And went abroad glory of YHWH
 From off the threshold of house due,
 And stood over cherubim's view.
 19 The cherubim lifted their wings,
 And rose up from the earth in flings
 As I saw; and when they went out,
 The wheels beside them too went stout;

And every one stood at the door
 Of east gate of YHWH's house's shore;
 Glory of Israel's Alohim
 Was over them above to beam.
 20 This is the living creature I
 Saw under Israel's Alohim
 By the river Chebar to vie;
 And I know they were what they seem,
 Cherubim *shining in the gleam*.
 21 Every one had four faces each,
 And every one four wings to reach;
 And the likeness of human hands
 Under the wings *as strong as bands*.
 22 The likeness of their faces gleams
 The same way as faces it seems
 I saw by the river Chebar,
 Appearances and themselves star;
 They all went straight forward *and far*.

The cherub is first found in Genesis
 But no one here knows what a cherub is.
 With wings and faces beastly and of man,
 It's hard to find consistent form and plan.
 To block the way to life or then to show
 The path to Paradise, no man can know.
 Two cherubs on the ark look down upon
 The ten commandments under mercy
 drawn.
 And yet, Beloved, the fact that two are
 there
 Suffices not to prove they do not share
 In some idolatry. I turn my face
 From both the image that Moses would
 trace
 And that of Enoch and Ezekiel
 To find the One: YHWH, Alohim, or El.

Ezekiel 11

1 And lift me did a spirit and
 Bring me to the east gate to stand
 By YHWH's house, and look eastward to
 Behold at the door at the view
 Of the gate five and twenty men,
 Among whom I saw Jaazaniah
 The son of Azur *and pariah*;
 Pelatiah son of Benaiah,
 Both princes of the folk drawn nigher.
 2 And He said to me, "Son of man,
 These are the men of devious plan,
 Who give wicked advice to this
 City *and do not fail or miss*.
 3 "They say 'It is not near, let's build

Houses; this is a caldron filled
 And we're the flesh in benefice.'
 4 "So prophesy against them now,
 And prophesy, O son of man."
 5 And YHWH's spirit fell on my brow,
 And said to me, "*Speak if you can*,
 'So says YHWH, "So I've heard you say,
 O house of Israel, I relay
 What I know comes into your mind.
 6 "You've multiplied the slain in kind
 In this town, and you've filled the street
 With corpses *who could not retreat*.
 7 That's why the Lord YHWH says: Your
 slain
 Whom you have laid upon its plain,
 They are the flesh, and this the pot:
 But I'll bring you out of the lot.
 8 "You've feared the sword; I'll bring a
 sword
 Upon you," so says YHWH the Lord.'
 9 "I'll bring you out from there and put
 You under power of strangers' foot,
 And will bring judgements on your horde.
 10 "By the sword you will fall, and on
 The border of Israel I've drawn
 Judgement on you, and you will know
 That I'm YHWH *above and below*.
 11 "This shall not be your caldron nor
 Shall you be the flesh in its store;
 I'll judge you on Israel's gates drawn.
 12 "And you shall know that I am YHWH,
 For of My statutes you don't do,
 And My judgements are far from you.
 And by the laws of nations round
 You have acted upon the ground."

The spiritualizing of the true
 Is part of the process that I would rue,
 The process that makes it right for the best
 To kill other human beings in test.
 The warfare of the spirit is the war
 That justifies the slashing out for gore.
 I feel the great seduction of the light
 That claims that matter is too dark for
 sprite,
 And all reality is found among
 The spirit beings that eternal sung.
 I feel the great seduction and the power
 Of spirituality as a thing dire,
 And turn my feet from aerie flights to find
 Reality upon the earth and kind.

13 It happened when I prophesied
That Pelatiah by the side
Of father Benaiah then died.
Then I fell down upon my face
And cried with a loud voice in trace,
And said "Ah Lord YHWH, will You make
A full end of Israel in wake?"

The prophet intercedes with You to make
An end of slaying people for Your sake.
I rather beg you to slay all the more,
Take even life from me and from my core,
And leave nothing but You alone to live
Within my graven temple and to give
My actions and my thoughts no right but
that
Reflected from Your throne where You
have sat.
Beloved, the prophet begs surcease of
death,
But I return to You with each drawn breath.
Each exhalation must repeat Your name,
For there is nothing else of any fame.
The prophet begs and so do I today
Beneath the dark and underneath the ray.

14 And the word of YHWH came to me,
Saying "Man's son, your sibblingry,
Men of your kin and all the house
Of Israel to whom dwellers grouse
There in Jerusalem to say
'Get you far from YHWH, we in prey
Have this land for possession's sway.'
16 "So say 'So says the Lord YHWH:
"Though
I've cast them off in heathen crew,
And though I've scattered them abroad
Among the nations on the sod,
Still I will be to them as though
A little temple where they go
In the land where they are put low.

The temple was cast up in gold and stone,
Within it came to represent Your throne
The ark with cherubs golden to see where
The Decalogue met mercy on the stair.
But stone can be defiled by enemy
And so it was, as well as by the free
Who came to set up there where You alone
Should bide, their own open idolatry.
But my Beloved, the sanctuary here
Where I live far from every holy tear,

The sanctuary where You come to dwell
In one heart of flesh outside Israel's spell
Is one that cannot be defiled at all
Except the one choose other in the stall.

17 "So say 'So says the Lord YHWH, "I
Will gather you from the folk nigh,
And bring you out of the countries
Where you are scattered *in the breeze*,
And I'll give you Israel's land's *ease*."
18 "And they shall come here and they'll
take

Away the horrors in their wake
All evil things from here in stake.
19 "And I will give to them one heart,
And I will put new spirit's *part*
Among you, and I'll take the heart
Of stone out of their flesh and I
Will give them fleshy hearts *come nigh*.
20 "So they may walk in My statutes,
And keep My ordinances' *roots*,
And do them; and they'll be My folk,
And I'll be their God *at a stroke*.
21 "And to those whose heart goes to sigh
After the heart of wicked sty
And their abominations' cry,
I'll take vengeance for their way on
The own heads," says Lord YHWH anon."

Beloved, I have an inner temple where
The stone walls darken everything I wear,
And in that temple I keep candle flame
In the night tide so You will see what name
Awaits Your coming on the cool of air.
Come in that temple that arises fair
In turrets and in minarets to grace
The halls where Your petitions meet Your
grace.
Come turn the heart walls stony now to
flesh
And find the praise rise up in a word fresh,
To satisfy Your law's obedience.
I sit beneath the flower-covered tents
Of Ararat and know the moving night
Comes once more before Makkah in her
light.

22 The cherubim lifted up wing,
And the wheels against them to sing,
And the glory of Israel's God
Is over them above *the sod*.
23 Then the glory of YHWH went up

From the centre of town like cup
 And stood upon the mountain that
 Is on the city's east side's mat.
 24 And a spirit lifted me up,
 And brought me to Chaldea's cup,
 To the removed, and in a sight,
 By a great spirit come to light,
 Till the vision passed from my sight.
 25 And I spoke to those there removed
 All the things that YHWH to me proved.

The cherub bears the arsh, Your holy
 throne,
 By the traditions of the Jews I've known.
 And others say that You bear rather them,
 Since You cannot be borne in any hem.
 Some say the cherub separates divine
 From earthly by a spirit's body's wine.
 Some say the cherub unites all in one,
 But the divine in coming and the won.
 But those who say the prayers of saints
 unite
 The cherubs in the kisses of delight
 Say more than any man has any right.
 And yet, Beloved, there is no breath in
 sight
 But from Your lips to mine when all is
 done,
 From Your eternity to my fell night.

Ezekiel 12

1 YHWH's word came to me then to say,
 2 "Son of man, the place where you stay
 Is a rebellious house, and they
 Have eyes to see, but do not see;
 And ears to hear, but they plainly
 Do not hear: rebellious are they.
 3 "So, you son of man, get your stuff
 Ready to move out in the rough
 In their sight; and you'll make a shift;
 Maybe they'll stop and think *unmiffed*,
 Though they're rebellious ones *and tough*.
 4 "So take your stuff by daylight out
 In their sight as one leaving rout,
 And you shall go out while they see,
 As those gone to captivity.
 5 "Dig through the wall and let them see,
 Carry things out by its debris.
 6 "Before their eyes on shoulders cast
 You'll be borne in the darkness massed,
 With covered face, nor see the ground,
 For I've made you a sign *and sound*

To Israel's house *that may be found*."
 7 And I did as I was commanded:
 I took my stuff out by day handed,
 As stuff for the captivity,
 And in the evening I made free
 To dig by hand through the wall and
 Bring forth in the twilight to stand,
 Borne on shoulder in their sight manned.

The object lesson is not lost at all,
 Diogenes too heard insistent call
 To act the part and be a sign in tawl.
 Ezekiel would dig through the wall.
 The blanket could be used to cover him
 From the sight of all things that saw him
 dim,
 Or as a tramline out to show the folk
 A hero in the vantage of an oak.
 Beloved, give me a task to dig as well,
 Although You must know I'm in a slow
 spell,
 For digging takes less talent than the saw
 And hammer and the building of the raw.
 Let rotting wall fall quickly as I stake
 A claim in Paradise with pick and rake.

8 And in the morning came the word
 Of YHWH to me, saying as stirred,
 9 "Son of man, did they not tell you,
 The house of Israel in crew,
 The house rebellious *in My view*,
 'What are you doing? What's occurred?'
 10 "Say now to them, this is what Lord
 YHWH says 'This burden of adored
 Prince in Jerusalem, and all
 The house of Israel by call
 Among them.' 11 "Say 'I am your sign;
 As I have done, so here divine
 What shall be done to them, and they
 Shall be taken captive in sway.
 12 "The prince in their midst shall be borne
 Or should be in the twilight's scorn,
 And shall go out, and they shall dig
 Through the wall to bear out the big;
 And he shall cover up his face,
 And not see the ground with eye's trace.
 13 "And I will spread my net for him,
 He'll be taken in My snare dim;
 And I will carry him to be
 In Babylon in the land free
 Of the Chaldeans; but not see
 It though he shall die there in fee.

14 "I'll scatter out toward every wind
 All that by helping him have sinned
 And all his bands; and I will draw
 Out the sword after them *like claw*.
 15 "And they shall know that I am YHWH
 When I shall scatter them in view
 Of nations and disperse them in
 The countries *because of their sin*.
 16 "But I will leave of them a few
 Safe from the sword, famine, plague too;
 So they can tell all that they did,
 Abominations to the lid
 Among the heathen where they come;
 They'll know that I am YHWH in sum."

Your lack of psychological insight,
 Beloved, is something hard to see in spite
 Of the great distances in time and place
 That separate this text from cant and grace
 Of my co-workers in the modern race.
 You ought to know that such captivity
 Would only result in syncretic spree
 And not the knowledge that You are the
 One

Divine alone above and below sun.
 Perhaps the leaving of a few to tell
 The story that You are One God's a spell
 More clever in the competition's swell.
 Perhaps. But I should think a larger crowd
 Of missionaries had declared it loud.

17 And the word of YHWH came to me,
 Saying, 18 "Son of man quakingly
 Eat your food and drink tremblingly
 Your water with care in degree.
 19 "And say to the folk of the land,
 So says the Lord YHWH to the stand
 Of people in Jerusalem,
 Of Israel's land and diadem,
 'They'll eat their bread with care and drink
 Their water with astonished link,
 So her land may be desolate
 Of everything that's in its rate,
 Because of all the violence
 Of people living in their tents.'
 20 "Inhabited towns shall be waste,
 The land a desolation's taste,
 And you'll know I'm YHWH *uneffaced*."

The prophet measured bread and water then
 To prophesy the siege among his men,
 And shortage of the gross necessities.

He did not think his actions could not
 please
 A later generation on their knees.
 Truth is, the water need not be weighed
 now,
 But purified instead and then allow
 Consumption. In those older days the great
 Danger was just attack by other state.
 Today the danger of attack is more,
 But beside that there's still the greater store
 Of filth around the world in pestilence,
 Enough that sword and famine need no
 rents.
 That trinity is true at least for pence.

21 And the word of YHWH came to me,
 Saying 22 "Son of man, what's to see
 Of that proverb in Israel's land
 That says 'The days are long to stand,
 And every vision fails in hand?'"

23 "Tell them then, 'So says the Lord
 YHWH,

"I'll make this proverb cease for you,
 And they shall no more say the word
 As a proverb in Israel stirred;"
 But tell them, "The days are at hand,
 And vision fulfilled *by command*.

24 "There'll be no more false visions nor
 Flatter divinings in the shore
 Of Israel's house *for evermore*.

25 "For I'm YHWH: I will speak and what
 I speak shall come to pass unshut;
 It shall not tarry, in your days,
 Rebellious house, I'll say the lays,
 And will bring it to pass, no stays,"
 Says the Lord YHWH *beside the door*."

26 And there was a message sent me
 From YHWH, and saying *faithfully*:

27 "Son of man, see what they will say
 In Israel's house: The visions stay
 For many days, and what he sees
 In prophecy for times of ease.

28 "So say to them, 'So says Lord YHWH,
 "None of My words but come in view
 Before long, but the word I speak
 Shall be done *quickly in a week*,"
 Says the Lord YHWH, yes, the Lord
 YHWH."

It seems a strange thing to my heart today
 That folk in the old time that once held
 sway

When some Ezekiel prophesied Your word,
Repeated such a proverb heart unstirred.
They said the time of visions was long past.
I should have thought that message from
the cast

Was new and quite original at last.
But no, the cynical and doubting heart
Is just as old as faith and fearing part.
The evolutionary stride is not
Reflection of reality in plot.
There's always been highly developed
thought:

Denial of reality in slot.
Only the supersonic beats the cart.

Ezekiel 13

1 And YHWH's word came to me and said,
2 "Son of man, prophesy instead
Against Israel's prophets now led
To prophesy, and say to them
That they prophesy stratagem
Of their own hearts, but hear the word
Of YHWH, *and so have your hearts
stirred.*"

3 So says the Lord YHWH, "Woe unto
The foolish prophets that give cue
Of their own spirit, but have seen
Nothing at all *above the green.*

4 "O Israel, your prophets are like
The foxes in the deserts' *spike.*

5 "You have not gone up in the gaps,
Nor made protecting hedge in laps
For Israel's house to stand before
The battle in YHWH's day *on shore.*

6 "They have seen vanity and more,
The lying divination's score,
Saying 'So says YHWH', and YHWH's
not

Sent them: and they have been in plot
To make others hope in the word
That they confirmed had once occurred.

7 "Have you not seen a vision vain,
And spoken in a lying gain,
While you say 'YHWH has said', and yet
I have not spoken what you set?

8 "So says the Lord YHWH: Because you
Have spoken vanity for cue
And seen lies, that's why look and see
I am against you in your spree,"
Says the Lord YHWH and faithfully.

9 "And My hand shall be on the prophets
That see false visions at their soffits,

That predict lies: they shall not be
Among My people's assembly,
Neither shall they be inscribed in
The writing of Israel's house bin,
Nor shall they enter Israel's land;
And you'll know I'm Lord YHWH at hand.

It need not be so sinister a game
That prophets change the word but keep the
fame.

While Theophrastus and Eudemus woke
To transmitting what Aristotle spoke,
It was not till Andronicus came by
After two hundred years under the sky
The thoughts forgotten of the master knew
Again the light of philosophic crew.
The purpose was not to foil on the truth,
But to improve the grasp of knowing youth.
The synergistic flight could not remain
Exactly as the father in the rain.
But You are right, Beloved, idolatry
Is a denial of Your symmetry.

10 "Because indeed they caused to err
My folk, saying: Shalom! Peace stir;
And there's no peace, and the folk built
Up a wall and daubed it with silt
Without straw but with chalk in whir.

11 "Say to those who daub it with such,
That it shall fall, fall at a touch;
And there shall be a pouring rain;
And you, O great hailstones in train
Shall fall; and a tempest rend vain.

12 "See, when the wall is fallen down,
Shall it not be said with a frown
To you. Where is the daubing brown
With which you've daubed it *as a stain?*"

13 So says the Lord YHWH: "I will tear
It with a tempest not to spare
My fury; and pouring rain there
In My wrath, and great hailstones in
My fury to consume in din.

The dire ediction made prophetic here
Is one against Jerusalem in fear
Of long ago. And yet the peaceful word
Brings to my mind Islamic faith unstirred.
There is no peace and there is no Islam
Despite the protestations under palm.
All fails for greed and cruelty. The balm
Of Gilead is dried up in the pot,

And commerce is what this old world has
got
Both in its peace and in Islamic plot,
In Nazareth's cheeses and New York's rot
Of empty stocks and bonds floating and
sot.

Beloved, there is no peace indeed, I wot,
Whether the tempest rage or yet the calm.

14 "So I will break down the wall you
Have daubed with chalk and bring its view
Down to the ground, so its foundation
Shall be uncovered in its ration,
And it shall fall and you shall be
Consumed within it, till you see
That I am YHWH *and faithfully*.

15 "So I will fulfil My wrath on
The wall, and on those who have drawn
On it with strawless silt and say
To you: The wall's no more to stay,
Nor those who daubed it in their way;
16 "The prophets of Israel who say
Concerning Jerusalem's prey;
And who see visions of her peace,
When there's no peace," says Lord
YHWH's lease.

17 You, son of man, set your face hard
Against your people's daughters' pard,
Who prophesy from their own heart,
And prophesy about their part,
18 And say: So says the Lord YHWH; Woe
To the woman who comes to sew
Pillows under every elbow,
And to those who make kerchiefs right
For the head of every sized might
To spoil of souls! Will you hunt souls
Of My folk and then save the souls
Alive that come to you in tolls?

I bear You witness, my Beloved, today
That heathen kerchiefs still come into play,
The sign of Islam, though in history's way
The same belong to Jew and Christian
sway.

The wearing or the not wearing of sash
Becomes the gauge of morality's cash,
Instead of keeping to the simple ten
Commandments that You spoke once way
back when.

The big end of the egg, says Irishman,
Or else the small to cut, is a good plan

To make distinction who should lose a
head.

I'd think enough trouble's in finding bread.
Take off the hijab, or leave it alone,
But turn, Beloved, my heart's tables of
stone.

19 Will you pollute Me with My folk
For handfuls of barley in croak
And for some bits of bread to stroke,
To slay souls who don't deserve death,
And save alive those whose last breath
Should be cut off, by lying so
My people hear your lies below?

20 That's why the Lord YHWH says:
Behold

I am against your pillows rolled,
By which you hunt souls to make flee,
And I'll tear them from your arms wee,
And will let the souls then go free,
The souls you hunt to make them flee.

21 Your kerchiefs also I will tear,
And save My people from your power,
And they shall no more be in hand
To be hunted *out of the land*;
And you'll know I am YHWH *to stand*.

You prophesy the fall of Christendom
And of the Jewish ladies wed to bum,
And finally of Islam as the veil
Is torn and flung aside at the assail
Revealing the corruption that's within:
All faith communities just hide their sin.
The purpose of the veil is so that those
Who hide beneath it need not keep on toes,
But may project a moral image while
Adulteries are fed up pile on pile.
Beloved, look on this heart adulterous,
Veiled with the coating of skin, blood, and
pus,

And have both grace and mercy on the
earth,
And save the unsaved that stands without
worth.

22 Because of paining righteous hearts
With falsehood, those who from the starts
I did not make sad; and you make
The hands of the wicked at stake
Strong so he should not repent from
His wicked ways, by promise rum
Of life *eternal*; 23 therefore you

Shall have no longer in your view
Vain idols nor come to predict
By heathen divinations *slicked*;
For I'll save My folk from your hand,
And you'll know I am YHWH *to stand*.

I know, Beloved, so many preachers that
Promise life to those who came in and sat
To hear the din of Pentecostal prate
That I recognize the word right away.
Those who rely on human sacrifice
On crosses or on torture stays will pay
With the damnation You pronounce in
slice.

It's not my word but Yours, Beloved, I say.
Why does the world not repent of the sin
Of breaking Ten Commandments on a win?
The answer's simply that the preachers tell
Them it's all right, since Jesus said a spell
And died to atone for all future loss.
So go and sin the more and give a toss.

Ezekiel 14

1 There arrived at my house a few
Certain elders of Israel's crew,
And sat down there before my view.
2 A message from YHWH came to me
Saying 3 "Son of man, secretly
These men have set heart idols up,
And with their wickedness like tup
Set stumbling blocks: so why should I
Answer their questions on the sly?

My dearest reader, and I say with smile,
Beloved, and not a hint of craven guile,
Will deride my naïve approach to You,
And ridicule my words spread out in view.
The reason for such treason to the soul
That has no more reflection but the toll
Of You and You alone, is just because
Of idols in the heart, idols with claws.
And so they set their stumbling blocks to
win

Just as the elders of Ezekiel's grin
Thought to cast off his prophecy in bin.
So why should I, Beloved, send out my
light
Of poetry to those who fail aright
To read the words, and only find a blight?

4 So speak to them and say to them,
"So says the Lord YHWH 'Every gem

Of Israel's house that sets up in
His heart his idols, and sets gin
Of stumbling block of wickedness
Before his face, comes to address
The prophet, I YHWH'll answer him
According to the number grim
Of his idols come to confess.
5 "So I may take Israel's house in
Their own heart, because by the grin
Of their idols they're all estranged
From Me *in the sins where they've ranged.*'
6 "So say to Israel's house, 'The Lord
YHWH says 'Repent and turn implored
From your idols; and turn away
Your faces from idols astray.
7 "For every one of Israel's house,
And every stranger like a mouse
That stays in Israel, each one
Who separates himself when done
From Me, and sets up in his heart
His idols, and puts stumbling cart
Of his iniquity before
His face, and the comes to implore
Before a prophet to enquire
Of him concerning Me, in ire
I YHWH will answer his desire.
8 "I'll set My face against that man,
And make him a sign and the scan
Of a proverb, and I will cut
Him off from My people and shut,
And you'll know I'm YHWH *if you can.*
9 "And if the prophet is deceived
When he's spoken a thing received,
I YHWH have deceived that prophet,
And I'll stretch out My hand to get
Upon him, and I'll destroy him
From among My folk Israel *trim*.
10 "And they shall bear the punishment
Of their iniquity unspent,
The punishment of prophets too
Shall be as the punishment due
On him who comes to seek his view.
11 "So Israel's house no more may go
Astray from Me, neither for show
Be polluted any more with
All their transgressions from their myth;
But that they may become My folk,
And I may be whom they invoke,"
Says the Lord YHWH *before the yoke.*'''

There are so many prophets in my way,
So many speaking in Your name for pay,

And others speaking freely of the day
 The spirit knocked the sense out of their
 head
 And made the teacher of the wine and
 bread,
 That I am reticent in my belief
 That You will make them all come to some
 grief.
 You promise to do them in for their share
 In preaching the idolatrous faith's ware.
 I wait to see the lightning strike and bring
 The priest and preach to the mud to sing.
 So far I only see them rant and sting
 Their followers for gold-lined offering.
 Perhaps You've still got something on the
 wing.

12 The word of YHWH came to me, saying
 13 "Son of man, when the land repaying
 Sins against Me by trespassing
 Sorely, then I will stretch My wing
 Upon it and break staff of bread,
 And send famine upon it spread,
 And cut off man and beast instead.
 14 "Though these three men were there to
 pray,
 Noah, Daniel, and Job in sway,
 They should but save their own soul's way
 By their righteousness," says Lord YHWH.

The prayer of Job saved all the horrid crew
 That spoke ill of Your character in view.
 The prayer of Daniel also save the king,
 The heathen hero of Babylon's ring.
 The prayer of Noah save from all the earth
 The seven closest to his place of birth.
 And do You say that even if these three
 Were praying for Israel in time to see
 When one Ezekiel prophesied a note,
 That such prayers would not be heard for
 their rote?

No wonder my prayers now leave nothing
 changed
 In a world where Your Decalogue is ranged
 With what the perpetrators of the game
 Call an injustice not to murder fame.

15 "If wicked beast pass through the land
 At My behest and spoil the stand
 So that it fails in desolation,
 And no man goes through it in station
 Because of the marauders' ration:

16 "And these three men there, as I live,"
 Says the Lord YHWH, "they should not
 give
 Salvation to son or to daughter,
 But they only be saved from slaughter,
 But the land should be desolate.
 17 "Or a sword I brought on the grate
 Of that land, and I say: O sword,
 Go through the land; cut off the horde
 Of man and beast in their estate:
 18 "Though these three men were there *to*
pray,
 As I live," says Lord YHWH *today*,
 "They should save neither son nor
 daughter,
 But only save themselves from slaughter.
 19 "Or if I send a pestilence
 Into that land, and pour *in vents*
 My fury on it and in blood
 To cut off man and beast in bud:
 20 "Though Noah, Daniel, Job were there,
 As I live" says the Lord YHWH *fair*,
 "They should save neither son nor
 daughter,
 But only save themselves from slaughter
 By their righteousness *laid out bare*."
 21 For so says the Lord YHWH, "How
 much
 More when I send by four to touch
 Jerusalem with judgements sore:
 The sword, the famine, beast and *more*
In pestilence, to cut of from
 It man and beast *and all in sum*?
 22 Yet, behold in it shall be left
 A remnant brought forth unbereft,
 Both sons and daughters; and behold,
 They shall come out to you as bold,
 And you shall see their way and hold;
 And you shall find comfort from all
 The evil that I've made befall
 Jerusalem, the whole ill haul.
 23 And they shall comfort you, when you
 See their ways and their doings view,
 And you shall know that not in vain
 Have I brought on them spoil and pain,
 Says the Lord YHWH, says the Lord
 YHWH.

The fact is Daniel is not said to have
 A son or daughter among Jew or Slav.
 He was a eunuch by the statement made
 In the book that bears his name on parade.

Of course he may have had a daughter
 when
 He still lived in sight of the natal den.
 I praise You, my Beloved, You brought to
 pass
 This mention of good Daniel with no lass,
 For some have doubted that he held the
 score
 Against the kingdoms of the world and
 more.
 It is a witness that a man was found
 To write a righteous word upon the ground,
 Full recognized by his contemporary,
 Even if he had no time then to marry.

Ezekiel 15

1 The word of YHWH came to me, saying
 2 "Son of man, what's the vine tree
 swaying
 More than any tree, or a branch
 Among the forest trees to launch?
 3 "Shall wood be taken from it for
 Any task, wall, window or door?
 Or will anyone take a pin
 From it to hand a pot therein?
 4 "See, it's just good to throw on fire
 For fuel; the fire consumes the pyre
 From both ends of it and between
 It is burned up, good for no scene.
 5 "See, when it was whole it was not
 Good for anything in the plot;
 How much less shall it be worth then
 When fire has consumed it again?"
 6 So says the Lord YHWH, "As the vine
 Among the trees of forest pine,
 Which I have given the fire for fuel,
 So will I give dwellers in duel,
 Jerusalem's dwellers *to dine*.
 7 "I'll set My face against them too;
 They'll go out from one fire in view,
 Another fire will burn them too;
 And you shall know that I am YHWH,
 When I set My face against them.
 8 "And I will make the land in stem
 A desolation, because they
 Committed trespass in their way,"
 Says the Lord YHWH *to have His say*.

The porous wood of the wild vine was
 great,
 As I remember from a child's estate
 For smoking like cigars and even more

For swinging from above the leafy floor.
 In faith, I never inhaled smoke myself,
 As did my cousin like a wicked elf,
 But all of us found fun in swinging wild
 Toward the sky, happiness of a child.
 Beloved, let those with less imagination
 Throw cast out vines upon the fire in ration,
 While I go back to being what I was,
 A swinging monkey on the vine that does,
 While You remain to rule the universe
 From Your own throne. A God could do
 much worse.

Ezekiel 16

1 Again YHWH's word came to me saying
 2 "Now son of man, do be conveying
 Jerusalem to know her straying.
 3 "And say 'So says Lord YHWH unto
 Jerusalem, "Your birth and due
 Origin is of Canaan's land,
 Your father Amorite, the hand
 Of Your mother Hittite in band.

Ah my Beloved, reproving on the folk
 Of Israel is blessing to invoke
 On me, poor Celt and Hittite, I had thought
 I had no part in heritage or plot
 Or even in the blessing of Your curse.
 Who's cursed by You could always do
 some worse.

Let any word come to me from Your lips
 In blessing or in cursing, and my chips
 Are fortunate, for there is nothing here
 But Your word in all things that must
 appear.

Beloved, I joy to know Jerusalem
 Is home of homely Hittite as Your gem,
 And so I kiss the stones on Aqsa's floor
 And weep to find myself in haven's shore.

4 "As for your origins, the day
 That you were born none cut away
 Umbilical cord, nor were you
 Washed in water to make soft dew
 Nor were you salted at all, nor
 Were you swaddled in softness' store.
 5 "No eye would pity you to do
 Any of these good things for you,
 To have compassion on you too,
 But you were thrown out in the field
 In open sight and so to yield
 You despised to yourself the day

When you were born *and cast away*.

Hardly a baby born today is salted,
And I'm not sure if that's a thing now
faulted.

Next time I have a newborn I may try
How salt does or if it will make him cry.
Water perhaps is what they use today
Without the salt and oil in nature's way.
The septic world is still where I must pray
Three times or five upon the sodden clay
With or without the salt of sinner's pay.
Beloved, I'm born with every breath I take,
And resurrected in the life kiss' wake,
And find poured on me watered sweat and
oil,
And salt come on my flesh for all my toil.
Beloved, all these thing show I'm for Your
sake.

6 "And when I passed by you and saw
You filthy in your own blood's maw,
I said to you there in your blood,
'Live!' Yes, I said in bud
To you lying there in your blood,
'Live!' 7 "I have cause you to increase
As the bud of the field's release,
And you have multiplied, come great,
And you've put on beauty ornate,
Breasts fashioned and your hair becoming,
Whereas you were naked, bare, humming.
8 Now when I passed you and looked on,
See, your time of love was there drawn,
And I spread my skirt over you
And covered you bareness from view,
Indeed, I swore to you and made
A covenant with you that stayed,"
Says the Lord YHWH, "you were mine
made.

9 "Then I washed you with water and
I washed completely from your hand
Your blood and I anointed you
With oil. 10 "I surely clothed you too
In cloth embroidered, and shod you
With badgers' skin, and girded you
With fine linen, and with silk true.

11 "I decked you out with ornaments,
I put bracelets with your consents
On your hands, a chain on your neck.

12 "I put a jewel up to bedeck
Your forehead, earrings in your ears,
A beautiful crown that appears

On your head. 13 "So you were decked out
With gold and silver, all about
You was fine linen, silk and work
Embroidered, and you lurk
Eating fine flour, honey and oil,
Very beautiful was your coil
Become a kingdom on the soil.

I have no precious jewel though I'm Hittite,
I have a little silk perhaps in sight
And more, it may be, in white linen, too,
And yet I am a dervish in my pew.
I want no gold, I want no silver new
Beyond the gold of sunsets in my view
And silver in the cloud above the rain.
I want to wealth beyond the purple stain
Of sunrise behind aspens for my fill.
I live and breathe beside a golden hill.
Beloved, as I find you in all these things
Let me not go the way of folk and kings.

14 "Your fame went out among the folk
For your beauty, it was a stroke
Of perfect comeliness, which I
Put on you," says the Lord YHWH *nigh*.

15 "But you trusted in your own fair
Looks and played the whore by your fame,
And poured out fornications there
On every passer-by for shame.

16 "And of your garments you did take
And deck your high places to make
All different colours, and to play
The whore on them, unheard of way.

17 "You've also taken your fine jewels
Made of my gold, my silver tools,
That I had given you, and made you
Images of men, and in view
Committed whoredom *in their pew*.

Beloved, I've surely sat beneath the shade
Of idols in the houses on parade
Where pomp and state return in daily round
To resonate You name upon the ground.
The heathen trinities in gold and cloud
Rise higher than the prayers of gathered
crowd.

And here I too am found among the loud
Heathen who bend the knee before the
proud.

Beloved, although I visit church and hall
Of mosque and synagogue, let not the pall
Of recklessness to disobey your call

Come on my soul. Beloved, may I return
From market and altar always to learn
Obedience to Your word, kind or the stern.

18 “You took your brodered clothing and
Covered them and set my oil stand
And my incense before their band.

19 My meat to which I gave to you,
Fine flour and oil and honey too,
That I fed you, you’ve set it by
Them for a sweet savour and high,
And so it was,” says the Lord YHWH.

20 “Moreover you’ve taken your sons
And your daughter, whom on their buns
You’ve borne to me, and these you’ve
offered

In sacrifice to them and proffered
To be eaten. Is this whore’s work
A small thing *hidden in the murk*?

21 “That you have killed my children and
Given them to pass through the band
Of fire to them, *small thing in hand*?

22 “In all abominations and
In your whoredoms, you have not thought
Remembering your days untaught
Of youth, when you were naked, bare,
Lying filthy in your blood there.

Beloved, is there a difference in the mark
Of burning children on the idol stark
Held in the iron arms of Molech’s fire
Raged in the hollow temple of desire,
And raising prayer in sacrifice in vain
Of human body on a cross once slain?
Is not the human sacrifice in all
Its forms in every idol’s name a pall?
Save me, Beloved, from every idle threat
Of cross and resurrection to be set
In dreams of grandeur on the throne of
earth.

Give me instead a place of greater worth
Where in the closet I come to Your hand
In my prostration without heathen band.

23 “It happened after all your ill,
‘Woe, woe to you!’ says Lord YHWH still.

24 “That you have also built for you
A famous place, and made in view
A high place in every street too.

25 “You’ve built your high place at the
head

Of every way, and you have sped

To make your beauty be abhorred,
And spread your legs to every lord
That passed by, and increased your whored.

I’ve built no church at all, beloved, nor yet
Created gatherings wherein are set
The howlings of reproach that must be met
Where people dance and shout their praises
to

Fertility cults where come into view
Gods dying and gods resurrecting too.
I place no trust in Canaan’s faith to find
The springtime represented in the kind
Beams of Baal shining and the new found
growth.

I turn away from every sort of oath
That rests on human sacrifice and blood.
I turn from heathen vomit and the mud.
Beloved, I stand in emptiness and see
A temple in Your time’s eternity.

26 “You’ve multiplied your fucking too
With the Egyptians, neighbours’ crew,
Big in the flesh, and you’ve increased
Your whoredoms to provoke unceased
My wrath. 27 “See that’s why I have
stretched

My hand over you and have fetched
Diminished fare, and given you
Over to the will of the crew
That hate you, and the Philistines’
Daughters, who are ashamed in signs
To see your lewd ways and designs.

They say the Saudi faith police go to
Egypt to celebrate wedding or two
And spend a leisured hour in her embrace
Before they speak intended vow to trace
Divorce upon the newly wedded face.
This cover for a prostitute’s a game
That continues to every Muslim’s shame,
And yet the days that pass, pass just the
same

Without a change in what men do in blame.
Beloved, the centuries, millennia
Do nothing to improve Your throne of awe.
Since You’re invisible, men are not caught
By Your sight in the places they have
taught

To humble girls with bloody ploughs in
plot.

28 “You’ve also played the whore with
men

Of Assyria, because then
You were insatiable, you played
The harlot with them unafraid
Unsatisfied yet to be laid.

29 “Moreover you have multiplied
Your fornication in the pride
Of Canaan to Chaldean side,
Unsatisfied yet to be laid.

30 “How weak’s your heart,” says the Lord
YHWH,

“Seeing you do all these things too,
The acts of an imperious whore,
A whorish woman *in her store*.

31 “That’s how you build your high place
at

The head of every way, you sat
To make your high place every street,
Not as a prostitute for treat
Because you disdain pay in meat.

32 “Adulterous wife that takes in strangers
Instead of her own husband’s *rangers*.

It’s not that You inspired Ezekiel with
A metaphor to proclaim as a myth,
A parable comparing adultery
With worshipping image, idolatry.
The fact is the two are but one when seen
For the two sides of silver coin in sheen.
The Eucharist on Sunday morning finds
The strip club closed, and likewise the
church blinds

Are shut when the ladies come on the stage.
The two are agreed in their patronage,
The two continue in one heathen page
The ancient rites that were all of the rage
When earth and sky were seen once to
engage

In fertile celebration of the age.

33 “All prostitutes receive their gifts,
But you instead give presents’ shifts
To all your lovers, hiring them
That they may come from every stem
To you for your whoredoms with them.

34 “You’re just the opposite of those
Other women in what you chose
Of your whoredoms, since none come to
You to commit whoredoms in view,
In that you give to them reward,
And no reward comes on your sward,

So you’re the opposite of those.

35 “So harlot, hear the word of YHWH.”

The church as prostitute is worse, beware,
Not because she fails to take her own share
Of wheat and wine, but because when she
calls

She claims to give herself freely to balls.
The prostitute that decks herself in beads
And spangles to entice men to lewd deeds
Always takes for her trouble pounds and
pence.

The church is free where image and incense
Comply with ancient rite to purge the soil
Of winter unmagic before the toil
Of seeding for the resurrecting god.
The lewdness of the church upon the sod
Costs but the voluntary penny put
Into the sack. But both uncover foot.

36 So says the Lord YHWH, “Because
your

Filthiness was poured out the door,
And your bareness uncovered through
Your whoredoms with Your lovers true,
And with all the idols of your
Abominations, by the blood
Of your children shed in a flood,

37 “That’s why I’ll gather all your beaux
With whom you’ve taken pleasure throes,
And all that you have loved, and all
Those you have hated, and I’ll call
Them together and round about
Against you to uncover doubt
About your nakedness to them,
That they may see all of the gem
Of your bare flesh by stratagem.

38 “And I will judge you as though one
Who broke wedlock and shed *by gun*
Blood is judged, and I’ll give you blood
In fury and with jealous stud.

39 “I’ll turn you over to their hand
And they’ll throw down your high place
stand,

And break down your high places, they
Shall strip you of your fine array,
And take you lovely jewels away,
And leave you naked *under day*.

40 “They bring against you company,
And stone you with stones *as you flee*,
And thrust you through with swords *in*
glee.

Fertility of old is seldom seen
Within the synagogue or the mosque bean.
But still the seed is there, the weeping and
The stretching out to star and moon of
hand,

The questioning of those gathered for
prayer

If they know of a woman for whose share
They might engage in marriage as a pair
For hour or two or even for the wear
Of many days, despite the fact that two
Women are wives already in the crew.
There's no establishment of faith that
knows

To keep itself away from whorish toes.
Establishment itself's idolatry,
And where there's such the whores are
always free.

41 "And they shall burn your house with
fire,

And execute judgements' desire
Upon you in the sight of many
Women, and I will cause you plenty
To cease from playing the whore then,
And you shall give no hire to men.

42 "So I will make my wrath towards you
To cease, and my jealousy too
Shall depart from you, and I'll be
Still, and will no more be angry.

43 "Because you've not remembered days
Of your youth, but have fretted ways
To me in all these things, now see,
That's why I also by decree
Will recompense your way on your
Own head," say the Lord YHWH once
more,

"And you shall not commit these rations
Of lewdness on abominations.

The days of Israel's youth were days in
which

Your law was set in stone and mouth of
pitch

In patriarch and prophet and in judge,
And in the righteous king who would not
fudge

With prohibition to exact the tax
To multiply wives, horses, and the axe.
The humble king that rejects source of
power

To rely on Your Torah in the hour
Of judgement, is the king of Israel's youth.
Let me return, Beloved, to that fair truth
And know the way of legislation here
Usurps the justice when You would appear.
I see the halls of marble and of state
And know that filth lies beneath glass and
plate.

44 "See, those who speak proverbs shall
say

This proverb against you *that day*,
'A daughter follows mother's way.'

45 "You are your mother's daughter who
Hates her husband and children too,
You are the sister of your own,
Who loathed their husbands and their
grown,

Your mother was a Hittite and
Your father of Amorite band.

46 "You older sister's Samaria,
She and her daughter that live far
At your left hand, your younger one
That dwells at your right hand when done
Is Sodom and her daughters' bun.

47 "Yet you've not walked after their ways,
Nor in abominations' craze,
But as it were a little thing,
You're more corrupt than all their fling.

48 "While I live," says the Lord God
YHWH,

"Sodom your sister does not do,
She nor her daughter, what you do,
You and your daughters *all in crew*.

49 "See, this was the iniquity
Of you sister Sodom in fee
Of pride, full of food and in great
Idleness hers and daughters' state,
Neither did she make strong the hand
Of poor and needy in the land.

50 "And they were prideful, and they did
Abominations and not hid,
That's why I took them all away
As I saw was the proper way.

The mixing of Your name, Beloved, to sit
On the established faith's whoredom to fit
That of Israel of old, whose sin was greater
In pretending to serve both You and satyr.
The resurrecting god, the sacrifice
Of human blood is set out to entice
The same mindset that in the ancient time

Thought Molech's greed to eat the first
born prime

The greatest satisfaction that the world
Could get to keep stability unfurled.
Beloved, the cover or Your law and name
Upon the heathen dance leaves just the
same

The pagan core, the spirit's longing shame.
I flee to You alone who have the claim.

51 "Samaria's not done the half
Of your sins *with the calf*.

But you have multiplied your own
Abominations all alone

And more than they, and justified
Your sisters in your wicked ride.

53 "You also, who have judged your own
Sisters, bear your shame all alone,
For your sins are more wicked than
Any ever your sisters can,

They are more righteous now than you,
Yes, be confounded and bear too
Your shame, in that you've justified
Your sisters in their evil side.

53 "When I turn back captivity
Of them, captivity, you see,
Of Sodom and her daughters plea,
Captivity of Samaria
And her daughter to stand in awe,
Your captives will stand at their trough.

54 "That you may bear alone your shame,
And be confounded and to blame
In everything that you have done,
In being their comfort when won.

55 "When your sisters Sodom and her
Daughters return to their former
Estate, and Samaria and her
Daughters return to their former
Estate, then you and your daughter
Shall return to your former lure.

You wink, Beloved, at sins set in the past
Of those who did not know Your law to
last,
But in their ignorance cast and recast
Their thoughts about to find a message fast
In nature and the growing in the spring
Of new leaf and the bud for birds to sing.
You rather lay the burden of the guilt
On those who know better, and yet have
built
Unlawfully a state and church that's set

Against Your law and Sabbath when
they're met.

The images of evil are not those
Merely in form of elephant and throes
Of monkey grimace, nor of such that rise
In Greek and Roman human beauty's guise.

56 "For you did not speak in the day
When your pride only held the sway
Of your sister Sodom astray.

57 "Before your wickedness was shown,
When you reproached the daughters grown
Of Syria, and all round her,
The daughters of Philistine cur,
Who despise you round as they stir.

58 "You've carried your lewdness around
And your abominations' ground"
Says YHWH *wherever He is found*.

59 For so says the lord YHWH, "I will
Treat you according to you fill,
You have despised your oath in breaking
The covenant *and that forsaking*.

60 "But I'll remember my treaty
With you in the days of your free
Youth, and I'll set up everlasting
Treaty with you *and none outcasting*.

61 "Then you'll remember your ways and
Be shamed when you shall receive hand
Of your sisters, your elder and
Your younger, and I'll give them to
You for daughter, though not your due.

62 "I'll set my pact with you and you
Shall know that I am truly YHWH.

63 "That you may mind and be
confounded,
And never open your mouth grounded
Any more because of your shame,
When I'm calmed down toward you for
blame
Of all you've done," says the Lord YHWH.

I wait Your memory, Beloved, to set
Shame on the heart of every man I've met
To make the world turn from idolatry
And return to justice and unity
Of the one and the true divinity.
I wait Your remembrance, Beloved, to take
The idols from my heart and mind and
break
The images that my thoughts would resign
To cling to as expression of divine
In every sort of catechetical wine.

I wait, Beloved, returning from the froth
Of this world delusion and from Your
wrath
To find the world created as anew
In twitterings and roarings at Your view.

Ezekiel 17

1 The word of YHWH came to me saying
2 “Son of man, set riddles relaying,
And speak a parable unto
The house of Israel *in pew*.

3 “And say ‘So’s saying the Lord YHWH,
“A mighty eagle, wings in view,
Long of wing, full of feathers too,
In many colours, came unto
Lebanon and perched on the height
Of the cedar *shining in light*.

4 “It broke of the top of its new
Twigs and carried it into view
Of a market place, and it set
It in a city merchants met.

5 It also took seed from the land
And planted it on fruitful strand,
It placed it by great waters and
Set it as a willow tree’s *stand*.

6 It grew spreading as a low vine,
Whose branches turned toward *the sign*
Of it, and the roots of it stayed
Under it, and so it was made
A vine and sprouted branches out,
And shot forth sprigs *and round about*.

7 There was another eagle too,
A great one with great wings in view,
And many feathers, and see, this
Vine did not bend her roots to kiss
Toward it, nor shot forth branches to
It so it might water with dew
The furrows of her planting too.

Another eagle! My, what visions fine
Come to Ezekiel without any wine!
Rarely have I seen any eagle, and
The sight of one is truly vision grand.
An eagle perched on cedar tree to pluck
The topmost twig, and plant it in the muck
And see come up instead of cedar willow:
The vision beats all that rests in my pillow.
Beloved, I dance to cantillate the words
That describe these beautiful, noble birds.
The feathers shine and scintillate before
My wondering eyes set out once to explore

The treasures of Your Book. I find the
pattern
Of eagle feet overprints that of slattern.

8 It was set in good soil beside
Great waters that under its tide
It might bring forth branches and bear
Fruit, and be a fruitful vine there.

10 Say then, so says the Lord YHWH,
“Shall

It prosper? Shall he in cabal
Not pull up the roots of it and
Cut off the fruit from off its stand
So that it withers? It shall soon
Wither in all the leaves of noon,
Even without great strength or yet
Many people to pick it set.

10 Yes, see, though planted shall be
Prosperous? And not utterly
Wither when the east wind will touch
It? It will wither in the clutch
Where it came up to grow and be.

The Bible finds the east wind often rough
And withering to every plant not tough
Enough to stay the dryness and the heart.
The east wind in the Book is rarely treat.
The east wind rarely touches me and mine
Here on the tundra prospering and fine.
I look toward the east wind and the pine
That stretches out across the versts of space
And let my spirit and my wonder race
Across the woodlands that go on to trace
The world to further shore many days
hence.

The east wind brings wonders to nomad
tents
And to the single soul perched on the rock
Of granite that remains my home and stock.

11 Moreover the word of YHWH came
To me saying, “Tell as in blame
The house rebellious, ‘Don’t you know
What these are? Tell, see, the king’s show
In Babylon will come to blow
Jerusalem, he’s taken out
Its king and princes and led them
All out with him to Babylon.
13 He’s taken of the royal seed
And made a treaty in his need,
And made him swear to him indeed,
And also taken the great land,

The mighty *and the holy band*.

14 So that the kingdom might be weak,
That it might not rise up and peek,
But that by keeping of his pact,
It might remain to stand and act.

15 But he rebelled against the fact
In sending men into Egypt,
To find him horses, and folk clipped.
Shall he prosper? Shall he escape
When he does such things *in a scrape*?
Or does he break his treaty and
Fall in destruction on the land?

16 “And as I live” says the Lord YHWH,
“Surely in that place where the king
Lives whose treaty he broke and the sting
Of whose oath he despised, with him
In Babylon’s centre and grim
He’ll die. 17 “Neither shall Pharaoh and
A mighty army and a grand
Company help him in the war
By building mounds and making score
Of forts to cut off folk and more.

Your word to prophet here is quite
amazing.

It deals in honesty about its phrasing,
Affirms the promise made and all that jazz,
When in fact it’s politics that he has
In recommending Egypt’s on the wane
And Babylon, though upstart’s bound to
gain.

You follow suit with every politician.
They too point out how honest’s their
position,

Not that the way they go is just to win
Forgetting justice in the face of sin.
I’m not sure I should be convinced or sad
That You join with those who know good
and bad

As simple tools to get them where they’re
going.

I leave You to the wild oats You are
sowing.

18 Since he despised the oath and broke
The treaty when he’d in faith spoke,
And has done all these things, he’ll not
Escape but be put on the spot.”

19 Therefore so says the Lord YHWH, “As
I live, indeed my oath he has
Despised and my pact he has broken,
Revenge is on his own head’s token.

20 And I will spread my net on him,
And he’ll fall into my snare *dim*,
And I’ll bring him to Babylon
And deal with him there and *anon*
For his trespass against Me *shone*.
21 And all his fugitives with all
His band there by the sword shall fall,
And who remains shall be spread out
By all the winds that blow about,
And you shall know that I am YHWH
And I have spoken *and I’ll do*.

22 So says the Lord YHWH, “I’ll also
Take the tall cedar’s highest twig
And will set it, I’ll cut off so
From the top of his youngest twig
A tender one, and plant like fig
Upon a high mountain for show.

23 In the mountain of Israel’s height
I’ll plant it to bring into light
Boughs and bear fruit and be delight
For cedar, and under it might
Live all the kinds of birds that fly,
Under its branches they shall lie.

24 All the trees of the field shall know
That I YHWH’ve brought the tall tree low,
Exalted the short tree, and dried
Up the green tree, and made the dried
Tree flourish, I YHWH speak, decide.’

The fact is everyone simply does not
Know You are God alone because the plot
Against Egypt and allies fell through when
Babylon rose to rule the world of men.
I know that You are God and You alone
As I come here before Your awesome
throne

Stretched up invisibly against the sky
Beyond the quartzite boulders of my sty,
Set on the reedy shore beside the lake
That still remains a mirror for Your sake.
Beloved, let me know You are one and that
You remain one no matter who else sat
Beside You on Your throne to show the
earth

The majesty and glory of your worth.

Ezekiel 18

1 The word of YHWH again came to
Me saying 2 “What does this mean you
Repeat in proverb of the land
Of Israel, to understand,
‘The father ate sour grapes and now

The children's teeth on edge somehow?
3 "As I live" says the Lord YHWH, "you
Will nevermore use this word true
In Israel. 4 "See all souls are mine, as the
soul

Of the father so also soul
Of the son's mine, the soul that sins
Is the one that shall die in grins.

All souls are Yours, Beloved, and so I stake
My soul upon Your will and for no rake
Of father or for son come to my wake.
All souls are Yours and mine too in Your
hand

To cast in hell or on the promised land,
Where I shall gnash my teeth or ever stand
To play my harp to Your glory with band
Of the damned or the saved as You
propose.

Beloved, propose what You will for a rose
Or for a thorn, Your verdict must be borne
In happiness or woe, in praise or scorn,
Until eternity is filled with praise
Of You beyond the momentary craze
Of human life of whirling in the maze.

5 "But a just man and one who's right
And lawful, 6 "And upon the sight
Of mountains has not eaten nor
Has lifted up his eyes in store
To idols of Israel's house, nor
Defiled his neighbour's wife, and not
Come near a monstrous woman's lot,
7 "Has not oppressed any, instead
Has restored to the debtor led
His pledge, and spoiled none in the way
Of violence, and given bread
To the hungry, covered from day
The naked with clothing to stay,
8 "Who's not lent on interest, nor taken
Any increase, but has forsaken
Iniquity, and executed
True judgement between two refuted,
9 "Has walked in My statutes and kept
My judgements to deal truly ept,
He's just and he shall surely live"
Says the Lord YHWH *verdict to give*.
10 "If he sires a son thieving, one
To shed blood and to anyone
Does the like of these things, 11 "and not
Doing any of those things taught,
But ate upon the mountains and

Defiled his neighbour's wife in band,
12 "And has oppressed the poor and those
In need and in violence rose,
Has not restored the pledge and yet
Lifted his eyes to idols met,
Committing his abomination,
13 "Has lent to interest for a ration
And taken increase, shall he live?
He shall not live: what he may give
In abominations will sieve
His life out and his blood shall be
Upon himself *and wickedly*.

The eating on the mountain is a thing
That seems so innocent, especially
When the motive's to engage happily
In needed cult of some fertility,
Which digging in the neighbour's wife
implies.

The prophet stays in a word suggesting
Such worship results in a social wing
Oppressing the poor beneath the blue skies.
Beloved, let me keep sex and worship well
Distinct from each other and never tell
The meeting to oppress or play pell-mell.
Abominations seem a cosy way
To make the meeting relevant in sway
And make a buck besides from the poor
pay.

14 "But see, he may sire a son too
Who sees the sins his dad may do,
Considering not to construe
The like, 15 "not eating on the hill,
Nor lifting up his eyes to fill
With idols of Israel's house nor
Defiling his neighbour's wife's store,
16 "Nor oppressing any, and not
Withholding the pledge when it's sought,
Nor spoiling one by violence,
But giving his bread in the tents
Of the hungry, and covering
The naked with a garment's right,
17 "Who's lifted his hand from the poor,
Not receiving the interest sure,
Nor the increase, but stablishing
My judgements and so then walking
In My statutes, he shall not die
For the sin of his father's sty,
But he shall surely live thereby.
18 "As for his father, since he was
Oppressing in cruelty's *claws*,

And spoiled his brother by the strength
Of violence, and did *at length*
What is not good among his folk,
See, he'll die in his sins *a stroke*.

To die in sins is the fate of all men
Except Your grace come in and once again
Create life in the soul that merely breathes,
While heart seeks wickedness and the
tongue seethes.

To die in sins is where all humankind
Is heading unless You, Beloved, take mind
To grant a mercy that works overtime
To resurrect the dead in sin and rhyme.
Beloved, I breathe today by that kiss You
Place on my lips in a live-giving hue,
And with that breath I beg a boon in pew.
Create that life eternal that Your sent
One promised to those who come to
prevent

The dawn with prayers and supplications
lent.

19 "But you say 'Why? Does not the son
Bear the sin that the father's done?
When the son's done what's lawful, right,
And kept all my statutes *in right*,
And done them he'll surely live *tight*."

20 "The soul that sins, that soul shall die.
The son shall not carry the pie
Of wickedness done by his dad,
Nor shall the father bear the bad
Done by the son, the righteousness
Of the righteous is his address,
And wickedness of wicked lies
Upon himself *under the skies*.

21 "But if the wicked turns away
From all his sins he did one day,
And keep all My statutes and do
What is lawful and right and true,
He'll surely live, and he'll not die.

Repentance You have given to the one
Ordained to life eternal and its fun.
I praise You for Your grace unmerited
That falls upon the lucky villain's head.
Forsaking sin by the grace that You give
Provides the cadre of new life to live.
Let me forsake the evil of my way,
Hypocrisy as well as downright stay
Of wickedness, until that life from You
Is all in all in me and in my view.

Beloved, I turn from fathers' trust and right,
I turn from the inheritance of fright,
And stand alone on the grace of Your
might,
Before Your throne, Beloved, and in Your
sight.

22 "All his transgressions he has done,
They shall not be mentioned when done
To him, and in his righteousness
That he's done he shall live and bless.

23 "Have I any pleasure at all
That the wicked should die and fall?"
Says the Lord YHWH, "and not that he
Should turn back from his ways to be
Alive? 24 "But when the righteous turns
away

From his righteousness in the way
Of wickedness and does all by
Abominations of the sly,
Shall he live? All his righteousness
That he's done shall be counted less,
In his trespass that he's trespassed,
And in his sin come in to last,
In them he shall die *an outcast*.

The paradigm of the Arminian
Appears to be that each and every man
Is judged in righteousness before the span
Of the last act that he fries in the pan.
The life of justice that Your give him now
Is nothing, only the deathbed in vow.
The human act will save, or anyhow
Condemn the bugger who slips up from
scow.

Beloved, I do not depend on my ways,
My doings and my own perfection's praise,
But only trust in Your ordained for me,
And turn to live as You mark out to be.
Let me turn from each man's theology,
From the abominations of the free.

25 "Still you say 'The Lord's way is not
Equal.' Hear now, O Israel's house,
Is not my way equal to spouse?

Are not your ways unequal grouse?

26 "When a righteous man turns away
From his righteousness in the sway
Of wickedness, and dies therein,
For what bad he's done he shall die.

27 "Again when the wicked turns fin
Away from wickedness to lie,

And does what's lawful and what's right,
He'll save his living soul from fright.

28 "Since he thinks about it and turns
Away from his transgressions' earns
That he's committed, he shall live
And not die *as a fugitive*.

29 "The house of Israel will say still,
'The way of the Lord's not equal.
O house of Israel, are not My
Ways equal, and yours crooked, sly?

30 "That's why I'll judge you, Israel's
house,

Each one according to his grouse,"
Say the Lord YHWH. "Repent and turn
From all that your transgressions earn,
So wickedness not be your ruin.

31 "Throw out all your wicked acts by
Which you have transgressed *on the fly*,
And make yourselves a new heart and
A new spirit, for why remand
To death, O house of Israel's band?

32 "For I've no pleasure in the death
Of those who die," says *in one breath*
The Lord YHWH, "so repent and
You may keep living *in the land*.

Your prophet says to make myself a heart,
A new heart that will do the heavenly part.
The surgeons of today can just do that,
And put a new heart in the chest and vat.
But none can make a new heart to do right
After the wrong before Your divine sight
But You alone, Beloved, and so the word
Of prophet needs to be a little stirred
With understanding of the wherewithal
Of grace and grace alone upon the ball.
Only He who made the old heart can make
A heart that's sinless at the human stake.
And so I beg that heart of You alone
That can for every sin of life atone.

Ezekiel 19

1 "Moreover raise a lamentation
For the princes of Israel's nation.

2 "And say 'What is your mother but
A lioness who lay down shut
Among the lions to nurse her young
Among young lions *to lick with tongue*.

3 'And she brought up one of her whelps,
It grew as a young lion with helps,
It learned to catch the prey and then
It came to slay, devouring men.

4 'The nations also hear of it,
It was taken into their pit,
And they brought it with chains into
The land of Egypt *all in crew*.

Which of the four wives of Jacob is here
Described as lioness and without fear?
Rachel was not afraid to come out to
The well with sheep to meet her prince
when new.

Leah was willing or not to retreat
Behind the wedding veil to hide her feet.
Bilhah was sure of love in loving one
Who grew up at her side the chosen son,
The loved and loving Joseph without care
Until she died to see his fate and share.
Zilpah perhaps comes with the lion's spoil
To shed the silver tassel and the coil.
Beloved, which of the four gates veils the
face
Of lioness come out with form and grace?

5 "Now when she saw that she had waited,
And her hope lost, mercy conflated,
She took another of her young,
And made of him a lion young.

6 "And he went up and down among
The lions, he became a young
Lion and learned to catch the prey,
And came devouring men to slay.

7 "He knew their palaces desert,
He laid waster their cities inert,
And made all the land desolate,
And everything upon its plate,
By the noise of his roaring's rate.

8 "Then the nations set against him
On every side from province dim,
And spread their net right over him,
He was taken in their pit grim.

9 "They put him in prison in chains,
Brought him to Babylon's king's thanes,
They brought him into dungeon hold,
That his voice should no more be bold
Upon the hills of Israel *cold*.

10 "Your mother's like a vine in blood,
Planted by the waters in flood,
She was fruitful and full of limbs
Because of many waters' *rims*.

11 "She had strong rods for those that rule
Bearing sceptres *instead of tool*,
And her height was increased among
The thick branches and she was *sung*

Appearing in her height with all
 Her many branches *great and small*.
 12 But she was plucked up in the wrath
 To be cast down upon the path,
 And the east wind dried up her fruit,
 Her strong rods were broken in suit
 And withered, the fire burned their root.
 13 Now she's planted in wilderness,
 In a dry and thirsty address.
 14 And fire's gone out of her limbs' rod,
 Devoured her fruit, she's got no rod
 Of strength as a sceptre to rule.
 It is a lamentation's tool
 And shall be for lamenting's *stool*.

Jehoiakin was made and born to be
 A lion of Judah eternally,
 And yet the fate of wickedness prevailed
 And brought him to Babylon stripped,
 unmailed.
 A prophecy aborted then was he
 Of Jesus the Messiah faithfully
 And Ali ibn abi Taleb who made
 His death by the sword that was raised and
 laid
 Upon the man in prayer in the mosque's
 shade.
 Beloved, I see the prophecies of old
 And touch their love entranced in sparkling
 gold
 And take to heart the very things they've
 told.
 The warnings of the rising and the fall
 Of men and princes take my heart in thrall.

Ezekiel 20

1 It happened in the seventh year,
 Fifth month the tenth day to appear,
 Some elders of Israel came to
 Enquire sitting by me of YHWH.
 2 Then came the word of YHWH to me
 Saying 3 "Son of man, speak freely
 To Israel's elders and tell them,
 'So says Lord YHWH and to contemn,
 "As I live" says the Lord YHWH, "I
 Will not answer when you ask why.
 4 "Will you judge them, O son of man,
 Will you judge? Let them know the span
 Of evil their fathers outran.
 5 "Say to them, 'So says the Lord YHWH,
 "On the day when I chose the crew
 Of Israel, lifted My hand

To the seed of Jacob's house *spanned*,
 And made Myself known in the land
 Of Egypt to them lifting up
 My hand to them, saying *like tup*,
 'I am YHWH your Alohim *grand*.'
 6 "In the day I lifted My hand
 To them to bring them from the land
 Of Egypt to a land that I
 Had chosen for them *on the sly*,
 Flowing with milk and honey there,
 The glory of all lands *to share*,
 7 "Then I said to them, 'Throw away
 Each of you the wicked thing's sway
 From his eyes, and defile no more
 Yourselves with idols *of the store*
 Of Egypt, I am YHWH your God.

Some might think it improvement to this
 day
 The ancient gods of Egypt that held sway
 No longer have the power to walk the way.
 It does not matter much that things have
 changed
 And the old gods at last become estranged.
 Their counterparts are live and well to see
 In every church and synagogue and tree.
 Beloved, I cast out every idol here
 And came out of Egypt's country and fear
 To find You in the desert way at last
 Without a golden calf, without one brassed,
 In hope of mornings without smoke of
 prayer
 To any but You only on the stair,
 To any but You among all the fair.

8 "But they rebelled against My *rod*,
 And would not obey Me, but they
 Did not each of them cast away
 Abominations of their eyes,
 Neither did they forsake the guise
 Of Egypt's idols, then I said
 'I'll pour out My wrath on them *spread*,
 Accomplish my anger on them
 In the land of Egypt's *broad hem*.'
 9 "But I did for My own name's sake
 That it should not by heathen take
 Pollution among whom they sat,
 In whose sight I revealed My *fat*
 To them to bring them from the land
 Of Egypt *and to make them stand*.
 10 "That's why I made them all go out
 Of Egypt's land and brought them out

Into the wilderness. 11 And I
 Gave them My statutes and so I
 Showed them My judgement, which if one
 Does them, he'll live *under the sun*.
 12 "Moreover also I gave them
 My Sabbaths to be sign and gem
 Between them and Me, so they'd know
 That I YHWH sanctify their *show*.

Some say that Moses gave the Sabbath law.
 Such do not recognize the divine paw.
 There is no Sabbathless without the rail
 Of false gods and idolatry in pale.
 There is no way to be free of the crust
 Of idol worship on the earthly dust
 Except the Sabbath sanctify the bust.
 The ones who claim to worship only You
 And yet forget the Sabbath are not true,
 But secretly, unconsciously give due
 To idols of the human heart and pew.
 Beloved, though I'm a donkey in the gate
 Of Israelite, I take kindly the fate
 Of rest and respite at the Sabbath's rate.

13 "But Israel's house rebelled from me
 In the desert, not faithfully
 Acting by My statutes and they
 Despised My judgements, which if one
 Does them he'll live right under sun,
 And My Sabbaths they defiled greatly,
 And I said 'I'll pour out my *lately*
 Wrath on them in wilderness
 To consume them *and their address*.'
 14 "What I did for My own name's sake,
 Not to pollute it in the wake
 Of heathen in whose sight I brought
 Them out *and with mighty hand fought*.
 15 "So I raise up my hand in oath
 Also to them in desert growth,
 That I would not bring to the land
 That I had given them in band,
 Flowing with milk and honey there,
 Glory of all the lands to share,
 16 "Because they despised My judgements,
 And did not walk by the good sense
 Of My statutes, but defiled My
 Sabbaths, for their heart went to *buy*
 Their idols *in their idols' tents*.
 17 "Yet My eye spared them from
 destruction,
 Nor did I make an end's deduction
 Of them in the wilderness fluction.

18 "But I said to their children in
 The wilderness *and for their sin*,
 'Don't walk the way your fathers do,
 Don't keep their ordinance in view,
 And don't defile yourselves with gods
 In idols they worshipped in clods.
 19 'I'm YHWH your Alohim, so walk
 In My statutes, and keep the talk
 Of My judgements and do their *stalk*.
 20 'And sanctify My Sabbaths well,
 They shall be a sign *of the spell*
 Between Me and you, so you may
 Know that I'm YHWH your Alohim.'
 21 "And yet the folk rebelled from Me,
 They did not behave faithfully
 By My statutes, nor did they keep
 My judgements to do them *though deep*,
 Which if one does them, he shall live
 In them, and they defile *like sieve*
 My Sabbaths, then I said 'I'll pour
 Out My wrath on them *at the door*,
 And finish My anger on them
 In wilderness, *on desert hem*.

I'm waiting to see wrath at once poured out
 On Sabbath-breakers with a broken spout.
 Instead I see that many who forget
 The sacred hours are well and better met.
 The lovely and the fair keep Sunday or
 No day at all before celestial door,
 While most of those who claim to love
 Your law
 And meet the Sabbath Queen come at the
 draw
 Are stinkers to say least about their claw.
 I am myself a stinker and a mate
 To view the church and state with ample
 hate.
 You have a lot to do, Beloved, to make
 The Sabbath-keepers sweet and come and
 take
 The others out and burn them at the stake.

22 "And yet then I withdrew My hand
 And doing for My name's sake's *stand*,
 That it might not be defiled in
 The sight of the heathen *for sin*,
 In whose sight I brought them from bin.
 23 "I raised My hand to them also
 In the desert, I'd not be slow
 To scatter them among the row
 Of heathen and disperse them through

The countries *of the world in crew*,
 24 "Because they had not done the right
 By My judgements, but in My sight
 Despised My statutes, and defiled
 My Sabbaths, and their eyes were wild
 After their father's idols guiled.
 25 "That's why I also gave them such
 Statutes as were not good to touch,
 And judgements by which they could not
 Continue living in their plot.
 26 "And I declared them unclean in
 Their own gifts, in that they by sin
 Caused to pass through fire the first born,
 That I might make them all forlorn,
 So that they might know in the end
 That I am YHWH *their Lord and Friend.*""
 27 "So Son of man, speak to the house
 Of Israel, both man and spouse,
 And tell them 'So says the Lord YHWH,
 "Your fathers have blasphemed Me too
 In this, that they've committed sin
 Against Me. 28 "When I brought them in
 The land of which I lifted hand
 To give it to them and their band,
 Then they looked at every high hill
 And all the thick trees where to fill
 Their offerings and the sacrifice,
 And there they set the insult twice
 In their offering, and their incense,
 And poured out their drink offerings'
 pence.

You multiplied the statutes of the Jews
 Because of the way they did once abuse
 Your Sabbath day. That's why the Qur'an
 states

Their law became more stringent on their
 pates.

It was not fair, Beloved, to treat them so
 And let the rest of earthly rabble go
 On in the law of jungle for a show,
 Depriving man and beast of Sabbath rest
 And even wench and bairn of all the best
 That You gave on the Sabbath to invest.
 Beloved, I seek eternal Law's great grace,
 The simple statute before divine face,
 The Decalogue for every time and place.

29 "Then I told them, 'What's the high
 place
 To which you go?' The name and trace
 Of it's called Bamah to this day.'"

30 "That's why say to Israel's house, 'So
 Says the Lord YHWH, "So do you show
 Defilement as your fathers did?
 And commit whoredom by their bid?
 31 "For when you offer your gifts, when
 You make your sons pass through again
 The fire, you defile with all your
 Idols, even to this day's door,
 And shall I answer your request,
 O house of Israel? My behest,"
 Says the Lord YHWH, "I will not be
 Enquired of by you *wickedly*.
 32 "What comes to your mind shall not be
 When you say 'We'll be wickedly
 As the heathen, as family
 Of the countries to serve *gods of*
 Wood and stone, *such as people love.*'
 33 "As I live" says the Lord YHWH, "truly
 With a strong hand and an unduly
 Stretched out arm and with fury poured
 Will I rule over you *as Lord*.
 34 "And I'll bring you out from the folk,
 And gather you out at a stroke
 From the countries where you are scattered,
 With a strong hand and *when you're*
battered
 With a stretched out arm, and with wrath
 Poured out *upon the sinful path*.

So Sabbath-breaking's not idolatry
 Alone, but also pure adultery.
 The one who ignores Sabbath finds his bun
 Upon the high place in whoredom to run,
 Inexorably caught in fleshly faith,
 The fables and the myths of earthly wraith.
 Beloved, I meet the judgement day each
 week

As Sabbath draws near to my pallid cheek,
 And see the failures of my life and hand
 Forgiven and erased from promised land.
 I meet the Sabbath newly baptized in
 The miqwe of clean waters for my sin,
 And rise from that grave new and clean to
 be
 Filled with the blessings of the Sabbath
 free.

35 "I'll bring you to the wilderness
 Of the folk and there I'll confess
 Pleading with you then face to face.
 36 "Just as I pleaded with your dads
 In land of Egypt's desert *pads*,

So I'll plead with you" says YHWH God.

37 "I'll cause you to pass under rod,
And I'll bring you in to the bond
Of covenant. 38 "I'll purge out *donned*
Rebels among you, and those that
Transgress against Me, *on the mat*
I'll bring them out from where they're at,
And they shall not enter the land
Of Israel, and you *in band*
Will know that I am YHWH *and stand*.
40 "As for you, house of Israel,"
So says the Lord YHWH, "Go and serve
Every one his idols and swerve
After this, if you'll not obey
Me, but defile the holy way
Of My name no more with your gifts
And with your idols in their shrifts.
40 "For in My holy mountain, in
The mountain of Israel's high win,"
Says the Lord YHWH, "there shall they all
In house of Israel at My call
In all the land, serve Me, there will
I accept them and there I will
Require your offerings and first fruits
Of your oblations with the suits
Of all your holy things *in boots*.
41 "I'll accept you with sweet incense,
When I bring you out from *the tents*
Of the people and gather you
Out of the countries wherein you
Have been scattered, and I shall be
Sanctified among you, holy
Before the heathen *as they see*.
42 "Then you will know that I am YHWH,
When I shall bring you into view
Of Israel's land, into the land
For which I've lifted up My hand
To give it to your fathers' band.

Only the meeting of the Sabbath day
Reiterates that You alone may stay
Before the eye and heart of those who pray.
Seek out, Beloved, rebellion in my heart
And cast it from me as I do my part,
And cast it from the world in which I live,
So that I may enjoy Sabbath You give.
Beloved, I come to greet the Sabbath
Queen

And find the mirage of her form is seen
Upon the shimmer of the day once blessed
To disappear before the vision quest
Revealing You are God alone to me

And to all worlds and for eternity,
To all the universe I cannot see.

43 "And there you'll remember your ways,
And all your doings without praise
In which you've been defiled, and you
Will loath yourselves in your own sight
For all your wicked acts unright.
44 "And you shall know that I am YHWH,
When I have dealt My name with you,
And not according to your ways
Of wickedness, nor by your days
Of corruption, O Israel's house,"
Says the Lord YHWH *to Israel's spouse*.
45 Moreover YHWH's word came to me,
Saying 46 "Son of man, now let be
Your face toward the south and drop
Toward the south and do not stop
Prophesying against the wood
Of the south field *for ill and good*.
47 "And say to southern forest, 'Hear
The word of YHWH, 'So does appear
The Lord YHWH, "See, I'll kindle fire
In you, surely it will devour
Every greet tree in you and each
Dry tree, the burning flame shall reach
And not be quenched, and every face
From the south to the north shall trace
To be burned *in that awful place*.
48 "All flesh shall see that I am YHWH,
And set it not to fail from view.'"
49 Then I said "Ah Lord YHWH, they say
Of me, 'Does he not speak astray
Of parables in the wrong way?'"

I do remember, Lord, the Sabbath day
And come to whirl upon it in my way.
I then remember every task I've done
As well as what I failed to seek or shun.
I take on memory Your holy name
And whirl about the syllables of flame
And catch the message and the greater
claim
That You are YHWH and You only are
God.

Beloved, I bend beneath the Sabbath rod
And find it bloom and blossom on the sod
And last bear fruit of almonds and the date,
The sweetness of creation never late.
And so I turn my weekly path from wrong
And end as I begin in divine song.

Ezekiel 21

1 The word of YHWH came to me saying,
2 “Son of man, set your face to swaying
Toward Jerusalem and drop
Toward the holy places’ crop,
And prophesy against the land
Of Israel and Israel’s band.

3 “And say to Israel’s land, ‘Says YHWH,
“See I’m against you and I drew
Out My sword from its scabbard true
To cut off you from righteous and
The wicked *here in your own land*.

4 “Since I will cut off from you both
The righteous and the wicked growth,
Therefore My sword shall go out from
Its sheath against all flesh to come
From the south to the north *in sum*.

5 “So all flesh may know I am YHWH
And have drawn out My sword in view
From its scabbard and it shall not
Return again into its slot.

Beloved, I think at least I know that You
Are God alone, without the awful view
Of Your sword in the pestilence and wake
Of plague and war and famine that You
make.

Does anyone believe, truly believe
That You are God alone when they receive
The stroke of wickedness or evil sum
Of a catastrophe upon them come?
I doubt, Beloved, that pain inspires true
faith

Any more than the human works of wraith
Or any sense or feeling of the hand
Of human being standing on the land.
No, faith in You is product of the grace
That comes from Your hand and before
Your face.

6 “So sigh now, son of man, and break
Your heart with bitterness and make
Your sighing before their eyes’ stake.

7 “It shall be when they say to you,
‘Why are you sighing so?’ Then you
Will answer, ‘For the news in view,
Because it comes, and every heart
Will melt, and every hand will start
To be feeble and every spirit
Shall faith, and all knees that come near it
Shall be weak water, see, it comes,
And shall be brought to pass as hums,’

Says the Lord YHWH for His own part.”””

All flesh know You are YHWH, all flesh
that breathes.

The fire of human cells boils up and
seethes,

And from the gasping lung comes out the
breath

That keeps the living spirit until death.
There is no breath but sings Your holy
name

And bears a greater witness to the same
Than word of human tongue or vision’s
start

That comes illuminating human heart.
Beloved, all flesh knows that You are the
One,

The only God of universe to stun
The stars with presence of Your battles
done.

Beloved, all flesh knows that You greet the
day

With justice of the night in Your array
Of things made in creation’s light and stay.

8 Again the word of YHWH came to
Me saying, 9 “Son of man, say to

Them prophesying, ‘So says YHWH,
“Say, a sword, a sword, it is sharp,
And also polished like a harp.

10 “It’s sharpened for a mighty slaying,
And polished to a gloss arraying,
Should we then celebrate despising

The sceptre of my son devising
And every tree in *its arising*?

11 It’s handed over to be polished
To be handled on the demolished,
This sword is sharpened and is polished,
For the hand of slayer *abolished*.

12 “So cry and howl then, son of man,
For it’s on My people a span,
Upon all Israel’s princes too,
Terrors by the sword come in view
Of My people, so smite the thigh.

13 “See it’s a test, if it despise
Even the sceptre, shall it rise?”

So’s saying the Lord YHWH *on high*.

14 “You then, O son of man, speak up
In prophecy and strike *like a tup*
Your hands together and let sword
Be doubled, and third time awared,
The sword of the slain, it is the sword

Of the great slain that enters in
Their inner chambers and to win.
15 I have set the point of the sword
Against all of their gates adored,
So the heart faints, and ruin vast,
See brightly wrapped for slaughter's cast.

Your sceptre and Your sword, Beloved,
arise

Before the flammatory coloured skies
Of morning where the wee angels appear
To chatter in the waking of my ear.
Your sword and sceptre counter and they
flash

Across the meadowed corridors I dash
Toward the morning prayer, prostration's
gash.

Beloved, the mirror of my lake in splash
Destroys the image of creation's hour
And turns in one fin's token from the
flower

To splinters of first colours in a shower.
I wait for sword or sceptre in my room,
Acquainted and reconciled to my doom,
Submitted to my joys as well as gloom.

16 Go one way or the other, go
On the right hand or left to show,
Wherever your face meets the glow.

17 "I'll also strike my hands together,
And let My wrath wait on the weather,
I am YHWH and I've set the tether."

18 The word of YHWH came to me then
Once more saying 19 "Now son of men,
Set yourself two ways, that the sword
Of Babylon's king in reward
May come, both shall come from one land,
And choose a place, choose it to stand
On intersection city's strand.

20 Appoint a way so the sword may
Come to Rabbath, Ammonites' sway,
And to Judah defended by
Jerusalem *city on high*.

21 For Babylon's king shall stand at
The intersection of the mat,
At the beginning of two roads,
To use divination in goads,
He made his arrows bright and he
Consulted with images' fee,
Looked in the liver what to see.

I choose, Beloved, at Your holy command

A place upon the earth where I must stand.
The great and fair choose thoroughfare and
road.

I choose the path of hummingbird and toad.
I hear, Beloved, Your voice say stop and
tell

The passer-by the coming of the bell.
As I obey, I find the path grow faint
And turn to tundra's red and purple paint.
Beloved, though I obey Your fashioned
word

And speak aloud with hope and harvest
stirred,

The corner where I stand is open to
The nightly sky and ptarmigan in view.
The ways the cross beneath my foot and
hand

Still clamour to fulfil divine command.

22 At his right hand divining there
Jerusalem, appointing fair
Chiefs to open the mouth of killing,
To raise a voice with shouting filling
To appoint rams against the gates,
To cast a mound, build up the grates.
23 And it shall seem to them as false

A divination in their vaults,
To them with sworn oaths to their faults.
But He will mind iniquity
Of them to find captivity.

Indeed, I've noticed that the words I say
In diversion and hopeless sort of play
Are well received by all upon the way.
The myth and fable wakens praise and talk,
And empty words still glisten without
chalk.

But if I say the truth and lay it bare
Before the eye of multitude to share,
I see the crowds disperse to find their path
Back to the chambers warm with divine
wrath.

Beloved, the voices that You choose to
raise

The vale of death before the crowd in craze
Diminish not the rate of those who rush
Into the hells and fires of sinful gush.
I stand and wait without the cunning maze.

24 That's why the Lord YHWH's saying
so,

"Because you've made your sin to grow

In memory, so that your sins
 Are revealed and so all you sins
 Appear, because you've come to be
 In remembrance, captivity
 Shall take you *up and suddenly*.
 25 'And you, profane and wicked chief
 Of Israel, whose day like thief
 Has come, whose sins fail for relief.
 26 'So says the Lord YHWH, "Now
 remove

The diadem, take off crown, prove
 This not the same, exalt the low,
 And abase the high in the show.
 27 "I'll overturn and overturn,
 It shall be no more though it burn,
 Until he come whose right it is,
 And I'll give it to him *as his*."
 28 "You, son of man, now prophesy
 And say 'So says the Lord YHWH high
 About the Ammonites and of
 Their reproach, even raise a glove
 To say the sword, the sword is drawn,
 For slaughter is arranged at dawn
 To devour with the glittering gone.
 29 While they see vain things in your view,
 While they divine a lie for You,
 To bring you on the necks of slain,
 Of wicked, whose day's come in vain,
 When their in iniquity ends lain.
 30 Shall I put it back in its sheath?
 I shall judge you upon the heath
 Where you were created, and in
 The land where you were born *for sin*.
 31 And I'll pour out My wrath on you,
 I'll blow against you burning rue,
 And give you over to the hand
 Of brutish men, destruction's band.
 32 You'll be the fuel to kindle fire,
 Your blood flow in the land's desire,
 You shall not come to memory,
 For I YHWH say it *faithfully*.

The place of fire that feeds on stone and
 flesh
 In vision burns up bright and in words
 fresh.
 Put back Your sword if You must till the
 day
 When You find no longer set in bay
 The judgement that I see in image way
 Upon the Sabbath signs on Friday night.
 I sink into the raptures of the sight.

Beloved, give wrath or grace or both when
 due.

I wait upon unpainted, hardened pew
 For moving of the spirit where I spin
 And whirl to keep time from the place I'm
 in.

The slighter melody that goes unheard
 Beneath the din of melody and word
 At last calls me up from the grassy bin.

Ezekiel 22

1 Moreover came the word of YHWH
 To me saying 2 "Now son of man,
 Will you judge, will you be the man
 To judge the bloody city's crew?
 Indeed you will show to her all
 Abominations *in her hall*.
 3 "Then say 'So's saying the Lord YHWH,
 "The city sheds blood in the view
 Of all, so that her time may come,
 And makes idols against her sum
 Defiling herself in their stew.
 4 "You've become guilty in your blood
 That you have shed as if in flood
 Defiling yourself with your idols
 Which you have made, and without bridles
 Have caused You days' end to come near,
 And have come to your ends in year,
 Therefore I've made you a reproach
 To the heathen, mockings encroach
 From all the countries *far and near*.
 5 "Those near and far from you shall mock
 You for infamous and vexed stock.
 6 "See, the princes of Israel,
 Every one was in you to dwell
 In power to shed blood *as for hell*.
 Father and mother they've set light
 7 "In you they've dealt oppression's night
 To the stranger, in you they've vexed
 Fatherless and widow perplexed.

The failure to acknowledge but one God
 Is the seed of the violence in prod
 That reigns on earth. The revelation of
 The private god worshipped sweetly in love
 Opens the door to disdain other folk
 Because they don't worship the same high
 bloke
 Called god by one and not known by the
 other.
 But You are the true God without another,
 So there's no private revelation's joke.

You are known directly by every soul
That is aware of being I. The toll
Of supporting gods two or three is great:
It adds up at last to violent hate.
Humans lie in one reality's estate.

8 "You have despised my holy things,
Profaned my Sabbaths in their rings.

9 "In you are men that carry tales
To shed blood, and in you by veils
They eat upon the mountains *that*
Which is offered where idols sat,
And in your midst lewd acts out flat.

10 "In you they've exposed nakedness
Of their own fathers *to caress,*
In you they've lain with those set out
To wait for menstruation's bout.

11 One does abomination with
His neighbour's wife, *as if in myth*
Another lewdly defiled his
Own daughter-in-law, and one is
In you who's lain with his own sister,
His father's daughter *not to twist her.*

12 In you they've taken gifts to shed
Blood, you have taken interest bred
And increase, and you've greedily
Gained from neighbours extortion's fee,
And you've surely forgotten me,"
Says the Lord YHWH *and faithfully.*

13 "See, that's why I have struck my hand
At your dishonest gain in hand
That you have made and at your blood
That is there with you *like a flood.*

14 "Can your heart endure, can your hands
Be strong in the days My commands
Fall on you? I am YHWH who speaks
And I will do *more than such freaks.*

When one God is not known but three,
results

Are first that a violent act exults.
The second fearful degradation is
The neighbour takes the neighbour's wife
as his.

The third great failure to come after law
Of one God is remanded by the claw
Of no god or goes multiple in grace
Is that the Sabbath is lost from all trace.
Beloved, preserve me from these three
great ills

Of heresy that are one mind that fills
The world with faithlessness up to the gills.

Let me stop on the Sabbath day to know
No violence to neighbour or his show,
And that You are God alone on the go.

15 "And I shall scatter you among
The pagan nations and unsung,
And I'll disperse you in the lands
And will consume your filthy hands.
16 "And you'll take your inheritance
In yourself in the heathen tents,
And you'll know I am YHWH *for*
sense. ""

Beloved, You disperse every song and
dance
That comes to fight against Your wondered
chance

To give the human heart a melody
Of law and humble breath of harmony.
The great establishments may seem to rise
In power on the horizon of the skies,
But are decked out unseemly in the guise
Of power struggles among weak and wise.
Beloved, You disperse every church and
mosque

Among the fields of clover and the bosk,
Till none can lift a hand against Your
throne,
And You reign supreme as One God alone.
I find the road to You directly by
Your word, I need no church to multiply.

17 The word of YHWH came to me saying
18 "Now son of man, Israel's house
maying

Has become dross to me, they are
Are brass and tin and iron star
And lead in a furnace, they are
The slag from off the silver *bar.*
19 "That's why so says the Lord God
YHWH,

'Because you have all turned into
Dross, see, therefore I'll gather you
Into Jerusalem in crew

20 "As they gather silver and brass
And iron and lead and tin as crass
In the midst of the furnace there
To blow the fire on it and wear
It down with melting, so shall I
Gather in My anger and fly
In My fury, and I shall leave
You there and melt you, no reprieve.

21 "Indeed I'll gather you and blow
Upon you in the fiery glow
Of My wrath, and you'll melt and go.
22 "As silver's melted in the blast
Of furnace, so you will not last
Its melting, and you'll come to know
That I YHWH have poured out aglow
The fury that you undergo."

Melt in Your fury, my Beloved, and wrath
Every departure from the straightened path
That I might be tempted to join to me.
Beloved, keep me hot in fidelity,
And not a minister of Trinity.
Melt every wish and desire in my heart,
Melt out the evil and the better part
Until none stays but willingness to do
Your will alone and only right and true.
Beloved, the heated furnace rises higher
And sends the sacrifice of smoke and fire
Beyond Sinai to Zion in the spire
Of temple and of mosque with golden
dome:
Beloved lead me burningly to my home.

23 The word of YHWH came to me saying
24 "Now son of man, tell her waylaying,
'You're a land that's not cleansed nor
rained
Upon in the day of wrath stained.'
25 "Her prophets' treachery is there
Like a roaring lion to share
The prey, they have devoured souls, they
Have taken pressures and *the pay*
Of precious things, and they have made
Her many widows *where she stayed*.
26 "Her priests have violated My
Law and profaned My holy awe,
They've not distinguished between holy
And the unholy, nor have lowly
Made difference between unclean
And the unclean, and have not seen
To My Sabbaths, and I thus wise
Am profaned among them *in guise*.
27 "Her chiefs of princes like wolves
ranging
After the prey, shed blood exchanging
To destroy souls for ill-got gain.
28 "Her prophets daubed them with
untempered
Mortar, with vanity distempered,
Divining lies to them and saying

'So says the Lord YHWH,' and so playing
Deceit when YHWH's not been betraying.
29 "The people of the land have used
Oppression, robbery abused,
And vexed the poor and needy, and
Oppressed the foreigner in band.
30 "So I looked for a man among them
Who would make a wall there that strung
them,
And stand in the gap before Me
For the land that I should not be
For its destruction, but found none.
31 That's why I've poured out under sun
My indignation on them, I
Have consumed them with fire of ire,
Their own ways I've returned to view
On their heads," says the Lord God
YHWH.

Ah, My beloved, the wall the great Gadeer
That You would raise among the folk to
fear
Is not for the time of Ezekiel's band,
But for another time, another land.
The hedge the binds the world in loving
faith
Is all but unknown, to the crowds a wraith,
And for this reason destruction has come
Upon the earth soaked in its blood and rum,
The evils gushing through the breach to fall
Upon the head of perpetrator tall.
Beloved, I bow before you at the gap
And follow the details of revealed map
To find the hidden head and chief to bind
The hands of wickedness, the feet of blind.

Ezekiel 23

1 The word of YHWH came to me saying
2 "Son of man, there were two gals
playing,
The daughters of one mom gainsaying,
3 "And they committed whoredom in
Egypt, they committed them in
Their youth, and there were their breasts
pressed
And there they bruised young nipples' nest.
4 "The elder's name was Aholah,
And Aholibah sister's paw,
And they were mine and they had sons
And daughters. The names of those ones
Were Samaria Aholah,
Jerusalem Aholibah.

5 "Aholah played the harlot when
 She was mine and doted on men,
 On the Assyrians, neighbours then,
 6 "Clothed with blue, captains, rulers, all
 Of them desirable in stall,
 Young men and horsemen riding tall
 Upon their horses, *clothed and all*.
 7 "She fornicated with them, all
 The chosen Assyrian men, all
 On whom she doted, and with all
 Their idols she defiled her shawl.

The army always is made up of men
 Who look handsome in uniform again
 Even to the young girls of conquered lands
 Who clap to see them riding in their bands.
 An apt and timely metaphor, I trow,
 Is this for foreign gods that gloat and bow
 In silver and in gold braid to the eye
 That ought to look to You alone or die.
 Beloved, I never was a silly girl,
 I never looked at soldiers with a curl,
 But I have learned that men may also take
 A false god and be seduced by mistake.
 Keep me, Beloved, from every loathsome
 god
 That splits the ripened bean and breaks the
 pod.

8 "She did not forsake whoredom brought
 From Egypt, that in youth was taught
 To her when they lay with her and
 They squeezed her virgin breasts in hand
 And poured their hot lust on her *land*.

9 "So I've delivered her into
 The hand of her lovers in crew,
 Into the hand of Assyrian
 On whom she doted *to a man*.
 10 "They uncovered her nakedness,
 They took her sons and the address
 Of her daughter, killed with the sword,
 She was famous in women's horde,
 They judged her with such a reward.

11 "When her sister Aholibah
 Saw, she was more corrupt in paw
 And in her lawless doting than
 She, and in her whoredoms to scan
 Than was her sister in her span.
 12 "She doted on the neighbour men
 Assyrian captains, rulers then
 Clothed gorgeously, and the horsemen
 Riding on horses all of them

Desirable young men *like gem*."

13 "Then I saw that she was defiled,
 They took both the same way *and wild*.
 14 "And she increased her wickedness,
 For when she saw men's painted dress
 Upon the wall, Chaldean plot
 Portrayed from vermilion paint-pot,
 15 With leather belts about their waist,
 Dyed and combed hair on their heads aced,
 All of them high-class and in fashion,
 After latest Babylon smashing,
 In Chaldea their native land,
 16 "Soon as she set eye on that band,
 She swooned in lust and then she sent
 Messengers to them and they went
 Into the Chaldean's bright tent.

To worship idols in both trinity,
 Brought from Babylon or Egyptian fee,
 Is to make traffic with the porno mob
 That uses leather and whips and the bob
 Of dildoes, it's no new thing under sun,
 But was the seduction that made them run
 To heathen temples in the ancient past.
 The pornographic pictures that were cast
 Upon the walls are what brought people in
 To stay to pray and revel in their sin.
 The same is true to day, the sacred din
 Of sex worship is heard in every church
 Where swaying hip and leather to besmirch
 Is de rigueur for those who rock and lurch.

17 "The Babylonians came to
 Her in bed of lovers in crew,
 And they defiled her with their lust
 And she was polluted like dust
 With them till she had left their trust.

18 "So she revealed her whoredom and
 Uncovered her nakedness spanned,
 Then My spirit left her alone
 As I'd done with her sister grown.

19 "And still she multiplied her deeds
 Of lewdness, and remembered seeds
 Of the days of her youth and when
 She'd lain with the Egyptian men.

20 "She doted on their paramours,
 Whose flesh is like asses' and pours
 Out like the horses out of doors.

21 "So she remembered her lewd youth,
 The squeezing of nipples in truth
 By the Egyptians, teats uncouth.

The faith and liturgy that titillates
 With nipples and bare legs is one that rates
 The popularity of all the crew
 Since ancient times until the very new.
 There is no difference that I can see
 Between the heathen potions of the free
 In Judah and Samaria and those
 That stage in New York and fail not to pose
 In Dallas where the Bible Belt once rose.
 There's more singing and shouting of the
 sex
 Than there is now of reading out the checks
 Your Word would make on sinful acts to
 stop
 The faithlessness of Christian rock and pop.
 Beloved, it seems there's hardly one that
 knows.

22 "Therefore, O Aholibah," so
 Says the Lord YHWH, "I'm on the go
 To raise your lovers against you,
 Because My spirit's against you,
 And I'll bring them against you too
 On every side *you turn to view*.
 23 "The Babylonians and all
 The Chaldeans, Pekod and call
 Of Shoa and Koa and all
 The Assyrians with them, all
 Of them desirable young men,
 Captains and rulers, great lords then
 And famous, all on horses then.

The third time is a charm, and so I note
 At last the name Muhammad that he wrote
 Into this chapter to describe the youth
 Of the Assyrian and say forsooth
 The Babylonian as well to ride.
 I take this little trinity aside
 With a remonstrance that it bodes not well
 For Palestinian nor Israel.
 Beloved, young men of great desire may be
 Walking about the earth, and so freely
 Catch up the tale of hope and helplessness.
 But I wait for the prophet's true address.
 Desire and red wine will distract the man
 Before he sees unfolding of the fan.

24 And they'll come against you with such
 As chariots, wagons, wheels and much
 People set against you in armour
 And shield and helmet round as harmer,
 And I'll set judgement before them

And they'll judge you by stratagem.
 25 "I'll set My jealousy to you,
 And they deal furiously with you,
 They'll take away your nose and ears,
 What's left of you will fail for fears
 Of the sword, and will take your sons
 And your daughters away by tons,
 And what is left of you shall be
 Devoured by the fire *ragingly*.
 26 "They'll also strip away your clothes,
 And take your fair jewels from your nose.
 27 "So I will make your lewdness cease
 From you and your whoredom's increase
 From the land of Egypt, so that
 You'll raise your eyes from where you sat
 To them and not remember more
 Any of the Egyptian shore."
 28 For so says the Lord YHWH, "See here,
 I'll deliver you in the fear
 Of those you hate, into the power
 Of those you've set against *an hour*.
 29 "And they'll deal with you hatefully,
 To take away all of the fee
 Of your labours, and they'll leave you
 Naked and bare, and then in view
 Will be nudity of your lust,
 And your lewdness down in the dust.

All men and women too are born of dust,
 And come out naked on the worldly trust
 To turn upon the gallows for an hour
 And breathe Your hope beneath the hand of
 power.
 Beloved, I sing the dirge and I repent,
 I follow the skirts of the famed and spent
 And see Your judgement fall alike on all,
 The humble and the whore both at the ball.
 The forehead is striped with the painted
 mess,
 The bangles broken tear the evening dress,
 And all the way to darkness and the night
 I hear the sighs and sobbings out of sight.
 All men and women too lie down to sleep
 With nothing but their troubled dreams to
 keep.

30 "I'll do these things to you, because
 You went whoring after the paws
 Of the heathen and since you are
 Polluted with their idols' *star*.
 31 "You've walked in the way of your sis,
 That's why I give her cup to kiss."

32 So says the Lord YHWH, “You will
drink
You sister’s cup deep from the brink,
You’ll be laughed to scorn and mocked too,
So much is in that cup for you.

33 “You’ll be filled with drunkenness too
And sorrow, and astonishment
A cup of desolation meant
With the cup of your sister sent
Out from the Samarian tent.

34 “You’ll even drink it and suck out
And break its shards and without doubt
Tear your own breasts, for I have spoken,”
Says the Lord YHWH *in giving token*.

35 And that’s why the Lord YHWH is
saying

“Because you forgot Me dismaying,
And cast Me behind you, therefore
You suffer consequences’ store
Of your lewdness and whoredom’s score.”
36 Moreover YHWH said to me, “Son
Of man, will you judge when you’ve done
Aholah and Aholibah?

Indeed, declare to them faux-pas,
37 “That they’ve committed adultery,
And blood is on their hands to see,
And with their idols they commit
Adultery, and caused their fit
Sons they gave birth to for My glory
To pass through fire in idols’ story
To be consumed in rituals gory.

38 “Moreover this they’ve done to me,
They’ve defiled My sanctuary
In the same day, and they’ve profaned
My *holy* Sabbaths *unrestrained*.

39 When they finished the sacrifice
Of their children to idols’ slice,
They came the same day in My house
Of holiness to profane *nous*,
And see what they have done to share
In My house *with their idols’ ware*.

Beloved, how can You criticize the host
For sacrificing children on the coast
If You Yourself require a sacrifice
Of Your own son to make atonement’s vice
Great on the earth, great enough to suffice?
The Sabbath is defiled, the temple too
By all the sacrifices brought in crew:
The prayers made by the sight of crucifix
Pretending an atonement by the tricks
Of priest and liturgy and cloud of church.

All such things leave the simple soul in
search,

At last in sinful cage and in the lurch.
If Your son’s slain, I come to weep awhile,
But trust in Your grace for salvation’s
smile.

40 “And in addition you have sent
For men to come from afar bent,
Unto whom a messenger went,
And see, they came. For whom did you
Wash yourself, paint your eyes in view,
And deck yourself with ornament

41 “To sit upon a stately bed,
And before it a table spread,
With My incense and My oil fed?

43 “Music of careless multitude
With her, and with the common brood
Were brought Sabaeans from the camp
Of desert with bracelets revamp
Their hand and fine crowns on their head.

44 “Still they went in to her as such
As go down to prostitute’s touch,
So they went in to Aholah,
Also in to Aholibah,
The lewd women *with painted claw*.

45 “Righteous men shall judge them by
what
They did in adultery shut,
And what they did in shedding blood,
Because they’re whores, hands full of
blood.”

46 For so says the Lord YHWH, “I’ll bring
Up a band on them, *one to sting*,
And I’ll remove them for spoiling.

47 “And the band will stone them with
stones,

And dispatch them with swords in groans,
They’ll slay their sons and daughters too,
And burn their houses with fire, too.

48 “So I’ll put lewdness from the land,
So all women may learn first-hand
Not to do by your lewdness’ *stand*.

49 “And they’ll take vengeance for your sin
On you, and you’ll bear in your skin
The consequences of your idols,
And you will know, infanticidal,
That I the Lord YHWH *will begin*. ”

You make, Beloved, some things to hang
together

That seem not to share so much in the
weather.

Infanticide, the killing of the child
In flaming arms of idols screeching wild,
Adultery, the rite of love set out
To make the spring alive and not to doubt,
These seem to grow together in the late
Church of the trinity and the love great
That we experience in present state
Of social tolerance for fratricide.
I only wonder that the heathen pride
In trinity now's taken other side
Condemning the abortion that once knew
The holiness of every heathen crew.

Ezekiel 24

1 Once more in the ninth year, month ten,
On the tenth of the month, again
Came the word of YHWH to me saying
2 "Son of man, write down the date now,
This very same day for somehow
The king of Babylon set out
Against Jerusalem with clout
On this same day *and with a shout*.
3 "And tell a parable to hear
In the rebellious house and hear,
And say to them, 'So says Lord YHWH,
'Set on a pot, set it in view,
And also pour water into.
4 "Gather the pieces of it up,
Every good piece, the thigh *in cup*,
The shoulder too, and fill it up
With the choicest of bones *of tup*.
5 "Take the best of the flock and burn
Also the bones in it to learn
To make it boil well and let them
Seethe the bones there by stratagem."

The sweet dervish of Damascus came by
With Psalms in incantation to the sky,
The Hebrew syllables, whether or not
He knew their meaning, said over a pot
Of water could in spell make it go to
Another pot across the room in view.
Performance of the trick made many stew,
And none could explain the sign to the few
Who wonder still how the thing could be
done.

The boiling, magic pot is something won
From very times of early prophets spun.
Beloved, I look into the pot to see
The present, future, and eternity,

And know Your knowledge at last sets me
free.

6 'That's why the Lord YHWH says to
them,

"Woe to the bloody city and
To the pot whose scum is in hand,
And whose scum's not gone out of it.
Bring it out piece by piece as fit,
And let no lot here fall on it.

7 "For her blood's in the middle of
Her, she set it on rock above,
She did not pour it on the ground
To cover it with dust around,
8 "So it might raise wrath to come up
To take vengeance, I've set her cup
Of blood upon top of a rock,
Not to be covered *but to shock*."

9 "That's why the Lord YHWH is so saying
"Woe to the bloody city staying!
I'll build up its great pyre *for slaying*.

10 "Heap on the wood, kindle the fire,
Consume the flesh, and spice with ire,
And let the bones be burned, *admire!*

11 "Then set it empty on the coals,
So its brass may get hot on soles,
And may burn that the filthiness
Of it may be melted to press
The scum out to be consumed cess.

12 "She's tired herself with lies, her great
Scum went out of her from the grate,
Her scum shall be till fire abate.

13 "And in your filthiness is lust,
Because I've purged you in the dust
And you did not become clean, you
Will not be cleansed of filth in crew
Any more, till I've made my wrath
Rest upon you *and on your path*.

14 "I YHWH have spoken, it shall be,
And I will do it, you will see,
I will not change my mind, nor will
I spare you, nor repent the bill,
According to your ways and still
According to your doings' fill
They will judge you," says Lord YHWH
still."

In California, in days long ago
I had the habit when I could to stow
My pack and take a hike and cross the hills
To find the great Sequoia trees on rills.
One pot I took to boil my meat and drink

And afterward to wash it on the brink
Of irises in azure and where sink
The liverworts in time to link and think.
Beloved, the dust of quartz and even gold
May serve to cleanse a pot for one not old
Who tramps the forest searching for Your
song.

The years are many and the years are long
Since I washed out the pot with grit and
sand

There where the holy redwoods came to
stand.

15 Also the word of YHWH came to
Me saying, 16 “Son of man, *be true*,
See here, I take away from you
Your eyes’ desire and with a stroke,
But you will not mourn nor invoke
Crying nor tears run down *to choke*.

17 “Stop crying, stop morning for those
Who are dead, tie your turbaned clothes
Up on you, and put on your shoes
On your feet and cover the views
Of you lips and do not come choose
To eat the food of men *in cloak*.”

18 So I spoke to the folk at dawn,
And at evening my wife was gone,
And I did the next day as shown.

19 And the folk said to me, “Will you
Not tell us what means what you do?”

I hardly ever wear a turban now,
Despite my following Ed Elwall’s brow.
It’s not I fear the looks the neighbours give
To one who looks like Muslim on the sieve,
Nor do I fear expense of cloth in rate,
Or any other sort of evil fate.

I bear upon my soul the shift and coil
Of Your own image, my Beloved, and toil
Beneath the sun as conscious of my royal
And sovereign being, that no bit of cloth
Can add in honour or in meal for moth.
The clothing makes the man, but not the
soul,

And the divine alone has been my goal
And comfort while I’m sitting on the dole.

20 Then I answered them, “Word of
YHWH

Came to me saying what is true.

21 ‘Speak to the house of Israel,
“So says the Lord YHWH, ‘See, I spell

Profaneness on My sanctuary,
The excellence of your strength, merry,
The desire of your eyes, and that
Which your soul pities where you sat,
And your sons and daughters you’ve still
Got *now* will fall by the sword’s bill.

22 ‘And you will do as I have done,
You’ll not be comforted by bun,
And you’ll not eat the bread of men.

23 ‘You’ll not put on turbans again,
Nor your shoes on your feet, and you
Will not mourn nor weep, but in crew
You’ll pine away for all your sins,
And mourn for each other *in bins*.

24 ‘So Ezekiel for you’s a sign,
According to all his design
You will do also, when this comes,
You’ll know that I’m Lord YHWH for
sums.”

25 ‘And yet, you son of man, not in
The day I take their strength of sin,
The joy of their glory, desire
Of their eyes, and what *in their ire*
They set their minds on, their sons and
Their daughters *staying in the land*,

26 “The one who escapes on that day
Will come to you to tell the way
In your ears what happened at bay?

27 “In that day you’ll open your mouth
To the one who escapes the drouth,
And you will speak and not be dumb,
And you will be their sign of thumb,
And they will know that I am YHWH,
The one who has spoken by you.”

Perhaps the remnant that claims now to be
Jewish is just the ones You had in fee
To speak out knowing that You are the One
Who penetrated history not for fun,
But that all might know that You are Lord
YHWH

Above the track and trade and cry and hue.
I’ve heard the synagogue rise up to sing
That You alone are Israel’s God and king.
The prophecy says mouths shall open then,
And mouths are open in hearing of men
From synagogue to the gas chamber’s
share,

Hear Israel, our God is YHWH and there
Is no other god upon the universe,
Creator, Dispenser of blessing’s curse.

Ezekiel 25

1 Again the word of YHWH came to Me saying 2 “Son of man, please do Set you face to the Ammonites, And prophesy against their rites.

3 “And say now to the Ammonites, ‘Hear the word of the Lord YHWH’s lights,

So says the Lord YHWH, “Because you Said ‘I told you so!’ when the brew Against My holy house in view

Was profaned, and when Israel’s land Was made a desolation’s sand, And when the house of Judah went Into their captivity’s tent,

4 “Indeed that’s why I’ll set you up A prey to oriental cup And they shall build their palaces In you and make their dwelling whiz In you, and they will eat your fruit And they will drink your milk to boot.

5 “And I will make Rabbah a stall For camels and Ammonites’ hall A pasture for the flocks of sheep, And you will know I’m YHWH *to reap.*”

6 “For so says the Lord YHWH, “Since you Have clapped your hands and stamped your shoe

And rejoiced in your heart with all Your spite against Israel’s land’s fall,

7 “See, that’s why I will stretch out My Hand against you, and set your sty To be a spoil of pagan lands, I and I cut you off from bands Of people and I’ll make you leave The countries where you now receive Enjoyment, I’ll destroy you and You’ll know that I am YHWH *and stand.*”

The sin of Ammon’s always been I see The very same yesterday and today.

The song of Ammon’s not of victory But of rejoicing that Israel might stay In any sort of damp difficulty.

The sin of Ammon is rejoicing when The neighbour catches cold or flight of wen.

The sin of Ammon comes to every heart That sees the neighbour’s troubles without part

To give a helping hand or even cart. Let no envy of joy enter my breast,

Nor rejoicing when others suffer jest, And I shall join Ammon to learn at last To tremble at the blessings at my mast.

8 ‘So says the Lord YHWH, “Now because Moab and Seir say in their paws, ‘Look! Judah’s like the nations’ claws,’

9 “That’s why, see, I’ll open the side Of Moab from the cities’ pride, From his cities on borderlands, The glory of the country stands, Bethjeshimoth, Baalmeon, And Kirjiathaim all outdrawn.

10 “To the men of the east I will Give it as a possession still Together with the Ammonites, Till they’re not mentioned in the sights Among the nations for their rights.

11 “And I’ll send down My judgements on Moab, and they will know at dawn That I am YHWH *and have withdrawn.*

12 ‘So says the Lord YHWH, “Because of What Edom did with hand in glove Against the house of Judah’s love By taking vengeance, and offended Greatly and revenged on them tended,”

13 ‘That’s why the Lord YHWH says “I stretch

Our My hand on Edom to fetch And cut off man and beast from it, And I will make it desolate From Teman, and those of Dedan Shall fall by the sword *of a man.*

14 “And I shall lay My vengeance on Edom by the hand of folk drawn Of Israel, and they shall do In Edom as My wrath accrue, According to My fury’s view, And they shall know My vengeance too,” Is what He’s saying, the Lord YHWH.

15 ‘So says the Lord YHWH, “Now since that

The Philistines dealt vengeance at A spiteful heart and to destroy Because the old hatred would cloy,”

16 ‘That’s why the Lord YHWH says, “See now,

I shall stretch out My hand in vow Upon the Philistines, and I Shall cut off the Cherethim by Destroying what’s left of the host Sitting there by their own sea coast.

17 "I shall lay down great vengeance on
Them with furious rebukes drawn,
And they shall know that I am YHWH,
When I lay vengeance on their crew."'''

What do I learn from what You did one
time

To Edom and Moab and on the dime
To Philistine settled along the sea?
It's not to laugh at those who hurt their
knee.

It is no good news that my enemy
Is dead and buried, unless come to me
That I have been spared from ignominy
Of death and tomb to live eternally.
But such news does not come, all men must
die

Unless like Enoch they have learned to fly.
Beloved, I cover mouth and bear a sigh
For all the doom and such catastrophe
That plagues the people who live far from
me.

Who knows when my turn comes in prose
or rhyme?

Ezekiel 26

1 It happened the eleventh year
The first day of the month, appear
The words of YHWH, saying in ear,
"Now son of man, since Tyre's *folk* said
Against Jerusalem, 'Well sped!
She's broken down, and the folk's gate,
It's now my turn not to be late,
I'll prosper, let her vegetate,'
3 "That's why the Lord YHWH says again,
'See here, I am against your men,
O Tyre, and I'll make many folk
To come against you at a stroke,
And the sea rise in tidal wave
To cover you and make your grave.

A tidal wave is awful when it comes,
Although it can be avoided by sums
Who rush into the hills when they see how
The sea retreats as though awaiting plough.
The simian nature of a man is seen
In that he rushed to the vast latrine
When the tide's out further than he has
seen,
Not thinking that what goes out must come
in.
Man's curiosity is man's worst sin,

Although when not applied to danger
It helps to find out more about the stranger
And even increase life in happy ranger.
Beloved, I watch Tyre rise in history
And then fall back into the silent sea.

4 'And they'll destroy the walls of Tyre,
And break down her towers in a pyre,
I'll also scrape her dust from her
And make her like smooth rock to shirr.

5 'And it shall be a place to spread
The fishing nets from the sea bred,
For I have spoken,' says Lord YHWH,
'And she'll be prey to nations' due.'

6 'Her daughters who are in the field
Will be killed by the sword in yield,
And they shall know I'm YHWH

unsealed.'

7 "For so says the Lord YHWH, 'See now,
I shall bring on Tyre's town My vow,
Nebuchadnezzar who is king
Of Babylon, a king to sting,
From the north with horses and with
Chariots and with horsemen like myth,
And companies and crowds of folk.

Nebuchadnezzar is the flail in hand
Of retribution in every far land.
And yet as kings go and to reprimand,
He is no worse than others take a stand.
The ancient town of Tyre set out in stroke
Of purple and in cedar and of oak
Was place of pride sometimes indeed, and
yet,

It was the seat of good Hiram to bet.
I have a longing for the kingdoms that
Once on the serviceable seaside sat:
Good Hiram fond of David and his son
Ought to have had a better sort of run.
But both fall before Babylon. I guess
The kingdoms of the earth have no address.

8 'He'll kill with the sword at a stroke
Your daughters in the field and he
Will make a fort against you, he
Will cast up a mound against you,
And lift up his armours in view.
9 'He'll set his war engines upon
Your walls and with his axes drawn
He'll break down your towers at *the dawn*.
10 'Because of the abundance of
His horses their dust strung above

You will cover you, and your walls
Will shake at the noise of the calls
Of the horsemen and of the wheels,
And of the chariots in their peels,
When he will enter in your gates,
Through the gap in the city grates.

11 'With hooves of horses he will tread
Down all your streets, and in his dread
He'll kill your people by the sword,
And your strong garrisons unscored
Will fall down to the ground instead.

12 'And they'll make a prey of your
wealth,
And of your merchandise in stealth,
And they'll break down your walls, destroy
Your pleasant houses, and employ
To lay your stones and timber and
Your dust in water *and not land*.

Whether the rush of sea or kingdom come
From Babylon, the dangers overrun
First daughters in the field, as though they
were

The guiltiest of guilty in their fur
It's true the woman's hand is often first
To glorify a golden image curst,
And often the queen behind the king's
throne

Is who encourages worship of stone.
And yet not every maid's one to beset
For sins of fathers she might just forget.
Beloved, history is quite unfair to men,
But worse to women when they turn again.
I wonder that You do not speak aloud
Once more beneath a darkened flame and
cloud.

13 'I'll make the sound of your songs
cease,

The sound of your harps to release.
14 'And I will make you like a rock
Smooth and flat, for a place in stock
To spread nets on, and you shall be
Never again built by the sea,
For I YHWH have spoken the word,'
Says the Lord YHWH *and undeterred*.

I doubt not that the ladies in the field
Were guilty of lewd song that idols yield.
I hear such ditties all about the round
Of every place I travel to resound.
Make cease, Beloved, the ghastly disarray

Of heathen music heard around today,
And let the birdsong of the heart and rill
Be filled upon both plain and every hill
As well as in the park and city gate.
Let all their songs cease that come to relate
Fertility cult and the need to share
Drugs with the weaker ones and with the
fair.

Beloved, make cease the songs whose grate
is cast

Before idolatry as here to last.

15 "So says the Lord YHWH to Tyre now,
'Will not the coasts shake anyhow
At the sound of your fall, when they
Who are wounded cry out and bray,
When slaughter falls on you one day?

16 'Then all the princes of the sea
Will come down from their thrones to see,
And lay aside their robes and put
Of their embroidered cloaks from foot,
And clothe themselves with trembling, they
Will sit upon the ground that day
And treble at each moment's sway,
And be astonished at the way
That you have fallen *from their pay*.

17 'And they'll take up a lamentation,
And tell you "How's destroyed your nation
That was filled with seafaring men,
The famous city, once strong then
Beside the sea, she and the folk
Who lived in her, and make the stroke
Of their terror haunt it and soak.

18 "Now the coasts tremble in the day
Of your fall, indeed the coasts in the sway
Of the sea will in trouble stay
At your departure from the way."

19 "For so says the Lord YHWH, 'When I
Shall make you desolation's sty,
Like the cities that are now void,
When I shall bring the sea employed
And great waters cover your eye,

20 'When I shall bring you down with
those

Who descend in the pit with throes,
With the people of ancient time,
And put you in the low earth's slime,
In ancient places desolate,
With those going down in the pit,
So that you are empty of folk
And set glory where lands awoke,
21 'Then I'll make you a terror and

You'll not be found throughout the land
Though they search for you in a band,'
Says the Lord YHWH, He comes to stand."

The fact is Tyre today is just a place
Where fishing nets are spread about to trace
The smooth rocks where in ancient times
there sat

The greatest port along the eastern flat
Of the great sea. Beloved, I know the word
Of the prophet of old surely occurred
As You predicted. Yet I find the peace
That now settles upon the near release
Of that sea-coast a bounty and a blessing.
There is no noise of market nor the
stressing

Of ships to set the sails to ports unknown.
It has become the footstool of Your throne.
Beloved, create in my the prophecy
Of peace and desolation by the sea.

Ezekiel 27

1 The word of YHWH again came to
Me saying 2 "Now you, son of man,
Raise lamentation on the span
Of Tyre, 3 "Say to Tyre, '*Indeed* You,
You sit at entrance of the sea,
A merchant for the folk that be
On many coasts,' so says Lord YHWH,
'O Tyre, you have proclaimed "I am
Beauty's perfection," 5 "Every jamb
Of all your boards they've made to be
Of cedars and the cypress tree
From Lebanon, and wood to make
You masts of fir both *tall and great*.
6 "Your oars they've made of Bashan's
oaks,
Your deck they've made of larch with
strokes

Of ivory from the Chittim's *yokes*.
7 "Fine linen with embroidered work
From Egypt you've spread out to lurk
As sail, and blue and purple from
The islands of emporium
Of Elishah to cover you.

8 "Zidon's and Arvad's populace
Served as your seamen, and with grace
Your skilled men, O Tyre, living there
Became your pilots everywhere.

Though founded by Phoenicians going
south

Tyre is a city with a louder mouth
In praise of its accomplishments and
wealth.

But if these ancient words spoken in stealth
Were true when spoken, centuries to come
Saw them fulfilled beyond in gloried sum.
Port of Jerusalem before Crusades
Had time to destroy markets palisades,
The city was greater for Muslim care
Than it had been under Phoenician wear.
Beloved, it is no wonder that the pride
Of Tyre struck You and some beside,
Led You to criticize the weight of word
Above the weight of wealth in beast and
bird.

8 "Gebal's ancients and wise men too
Came to caulk with pitch in your due,
All the ships of the sea and all
Their seamen were in you to brawl
Enjoying your merchandise call.

10 "Of Persia and of Lud and Phut
Were in your army and the root
Of your men of war, hanging shield
And helmet in you, beauty's yield.
11 "The men of Arvad with your army
Upon your wall about and swarmy,
And Gammadim were in your towers,
They hung their shields on walls *like*
flowers,

Perfecting You in beauty's *hours*.

12 "Tarshish too was your merchant in
Abundance of wealth in the bin
With silver, iron, and lead and tin
To trade upon your market squares.

13 "Javan, Tubal and Meshech' shares
Were your salesmen of men and brass
In your market places *for crass*.

14 "They of the house of Togarmah
Traded in your fairs *without flaw*
In horses, horsemen and in mules.

Tyre was a middleman between the come
And go of Greece and Persia on the hum
To bring the sweet things from the east to
west

And dress its matrons in the very best.
Tyre was a merchant set beside the sea,
An island safe from every company
That haled toward it. This prophet in hate
May hope that Babylon can crush the state,
But Nebuchadrezzar in siege took long,

And left the city to its right and wrong.
Beloved, I look from Cyprus toward the
gate
Of Tyre, but cannot see so far a rate,
Nor can I find upon the shore a mate
Of purpled shell that once made wealthy
state.

15 “The men of Dedan sold your tools,
And many coasts were merchandise
In your hands, they brought to your eyes
Gifts of horns of ivory and black
Ebony wood to *fill your sack*.

16 “And Syria was your merchant for
Abundance of wares in your store,
They traded in your fairs with *gems*
Of emeralds, purple in hems
And work embroidered, and in fine
Linen, coral, and agate line.

17 “Judah and land of Israel,
They were your merchants, *truth to tell*,
Trading in your market for wheat
Of Minnith and Pannag and *sweet*
Honey and oil and balm *for treat*.

18 “Damascus was your merchant in
Abundance of your wares in bin,
Abundance of wealth, in the wine
Of Helbon and white wool *and fine*.

19 “Dan also and Javan with care
To occupy your every fair:
Bright iron and cassia and as well
Calamus there in market *spell*.

20 “Dedan way your middleman in
Choice cattle for chariots’ din.

21 “Arabia and princes all
Of Kedar, they filled up your stall
With lambs and rams and goats, in these
They were your merchants *come to please*.

Kedar is one to bring in lambs to sell,
And rams and goats and all the cattle’s
spell

Because they did not deal so much in gold,
In iron or jewels or the things that hold
The sights of civilized and lordly cold.
Kedar is sweet and homely, though he’s
bold,

A son of Ishmael, and just like his dad
With bright eyes flashing black and never
sad.

Beloved, among the many come to buy
And sell in Tyre under a prospered sky

My choice is Kedar for his wayward ways,
His faithfulness to You and to Your praise,
The centuries of desert patience brewed
Beneath the skies of inner hope unrue.

22 “The merchants of Sheba and Raamah,
They were your merchant come to claim
her,

Occupied in your fairs and with
Chief of all spices, also with
All precious stones as well as gold.

23 “Haran and Canneh and Eden,
The merchants of Sheba like men,
Assur and Chilmad, merchants then.

24 “There were your merchants in all sorts,
In blue clothing broidered for courts,
In chests of rich apparel bound
With cords and made of cedar round
Among your merchandise *is found*.

25 “The ships of Tarshish say of you
In your market, and to renew
You were made famous in the seas.

26 “Your rowmen brought you into ease
In high waters, the east wind broke
You in the ocean *on a stroke*.

27 “Your wealth, your fairs, your
merchandise,

Your seamen, pilots and to splice
Your caulkers and the keepers of
Your merchandise as well as of
All your soldiers that are in you,
And in all your band *that’s in view*,
Will fall into the raging sea
On the day of your ruin’s *glee*.

28 “When you cry out in fear then shake
Your pilots for your voice’s sake.

Tyre was besieged by Babylon but not
Sacked with the evil of this prophet’s plot.
She paid her tribute to the Persian fane
But did not suffer except in her gain.
The prophecy of hopeless rending must
Refer to Alexander from the dust
Who made a causeway to turn isle into
Peninsula and road for army crew.
He swept the city clean into the sea,
It’s true, but that was long after the spree
Of Your vain prophet who spoke too soon
here

Of what should not appear for many a year.
Perhaps as home of Jezebel the queen
He thought he had a right to be obscene.

29 "The oarsmen, seaman, pilots all
 On the sea will come down at call
 From their ships and stand on the land,
 30 "And raise their voice against you loud,
 And cry in bitterness, and crowd
 Dust on their heads, and wallow fanned
 In ashes *poured out on the band*.
 31 "They'll make themselves completely
 bald

In sorrow for you, and enthralled
 In gunny-sacks they'll come and weep
 For you with bitterness and keep
 A bitter heart wailing *like sheep*.
 32 "And in their wailing they will take
 Up a lament and for your sake
 Cry over you to say "What town
 Is like Tyre's town, now fallen down
 Into the sea?" 32 "When your wares went
 Out on the seas, you filled the vent
 Of many people, you enriched
 The kings of the earth with the pitched
 Multitude of your wealth and wares.
 34 "When you are broken by the sea
 In water depths your wares will be,
 Fallen all of your company.
 35 "Inhabitants of every coast
 Will be astonished at your host,
 And their kings will be most afraid,
 Their face with worry then betrayed.
 36 "The merchants of the folk will hiss
 At you, you'll be terror to miss."

The merchants never hissed so far as I
 Know, unless Nebuchadrezzar's fast try
 Blocked trade for five months or unless the
 field
 That Alexander made reduced their yield.
 Two hissing moments in two thousand
 years
 Is not too bad for this dark world of tears.
 Jerusalem has seen more times to cry
 Than Tyre, I think, and fewer hopes for
 sky.
 Beloved, the sum of Tyre's fate is not sad,
 Except for those two events on the pad.
 The prophecy of wealth was easy made,
 The prophecy of stealth any well-paid
 Might guess, but in the book of history's
 fame
 Tyre still can lift a head and make a claim.

Ezekiel 28

1 The word of YHWH came once again
 To me saying 2 "Son of man then
 Say to the prince of Tyre's town, 'So
 Says the Lord YHWH, "because your low
 Heart's lifted up and you have said
 'I am a god, I sit for dread
 In the high seat upon the seas,'
 Still you're a man, not God to please,
 Even if you set up your heart
 As God's heart *and to play your part*.

But truth is, my Beloved, there is no I
 In human breast but that You plant with
 sigh.

The only I is You, set in the sky,
 Set on the earth in sovereign care's reply.
 If any prince or ploughboy say allowed,
 "I'm God", the fact is truth is in the crowd
 Of words he speaks so lightly and so proud.
 And that's the bit. The pride of fair distils
 The truth and bucks the harvest of the bills
 With try in ointment. No I but You stand
 In heaven, on sea, or on the weary land,
 And yet the heart that's lifted above band
 Of humankind to say divine command
 Is darkened quickly by the truthly hand.

3 "See, you're wiser than Daniel, there
 Is no secret you cannot share,
 4 "With your wisdom and understanding
 You've become wealthy on your landing
 God and silver in your treasures.
 5 "By your great wisdom and your
 measures
 Of selling you've increased you riches,
 And your heart's lifted up for riches."
 6 "That's why the Lord YHWH says
 "Because
 You've set your heart as above laws
 Of Alohim, 7 "See, I'll bring claws
 Of strangers on you, nations grim,
 And they'll draw their swords on the rim
 Of your wisdom's beauty, and they
 Will tarnish your brightness *that day*.
 8 "They'll bring you down into the pit,
 And you'll die the death of who sit
 Destroyed in the sea. 9 "Yet you'll say
 To the one who will come to slay,
 'I am God.' But you will be
 A man and no God in the free
 Hand of the one who kills you, *see*.

10 "You'll die the uncircumcised death
By hands of strangers, *by My breath*
I've spoken it," says the Lord YHWH."'''

The wisdom of the prophet Daniel takes
The reader and the listener of his cakes
In straight and firm steps through the
corridors
Of history down to the end of its shores.
But Daniel was not wise enough to find
A source of wealth to ease his captive
mind.

So prince of Tyre's still wiser than the man
You saw the future clearly in his scan.
Beloved, the prince that held the wealth of
ships
Caught up in fleets beyond the ocean's
dips,
Was right that his heart like all hearts of
men
Contained the divine word spelled out
again,
But lifting heart above Your spoken law
Brought the divine into destruction's claw.

11 Moreover then the word of YHWH
Came to me saying "Son of man,
Take up a lamentation ban
Upon the king of Tyre's town, and
Say to him, 'So says the Lord YHWH,
'"You seal up the sum full of *planned*
Wisdom and perfect beauty *scanned*.
13 "You've been in Eden, garden of
Alohim, every precious stone
Was you covering, carnelian's love,
Topaz and diamond not alone,
The beryl, onyx, jasper stone,
The sapphire, turquoise, emerald and
Gold, workmanship of skilful hand
In tabrets and pipes there prepared
In the day your existence bared.

14 "Anointed covering cherub there,
And I have set you up *with care*,
You were on Alohim's hill of
Holiness, you have walked *in glove*
Among the stones of fire *found there*.

The Jewish commentator said to me
With erudition Messiah's degree
Is defined by the oil of anointing
In its particular fine recipe.
Anyone who may claim the divine thing

As a Messiah, must have oil upon
Him since that is the definition drawn.
The word simply cannot mean God's
appointed,

But must be dampened with the oil
anointed.

This text appears to me in evidence
The messianic appointment makes sense
Without the literal in oil poured out,
Unless the cherub, with a winning shout
And flick of tail is also oiled to pout.

15 "And you were perfect in your ways
From the day you rose up in rays,
Until iniquity was found
In you. 16 "And so as do abound
Your merchandise, so they have filled
Among you with violence killed,
And you have sinned, that's why I'll throw
You as profane out of the show
Of Alohim's holy hill's glow,
And I'll destroy you, cherub drawn
From the stones of fire *on the dawn*.
17 "Your heart was lifted up because
Of your beauty, you have with claws
Torn our your wisdom by the glow,
I'll throw you to the ground and show
You in front of kings, they will know.
18 "You have defiled your sacred room
By abundance of sin to doom,
By the iniquity of your
Dishonest business, now therefore
I'll bring a fire out from you to
Devour you and I shall bring you
To ashes on the earth in sight
Of all of those who see your plight.
19 "All those who know you of the folk
Will be astonished at your stroke,
You'll be a terror never more
To rise and stand beside the door.'''

The sweet Christian finds in these awful
words

A figure of the devil with his birds
Of hellish prey perched out to wait for
turds.

There is no wonder that so is the case,
Since the prince of Tyre in his humbler
race

Hardly fits in the spell and comely trace.
Perhaps because the family brought forth
one

Queen Jezebel to reign beneath the sun
Commends the family all to hear the shame
Of having risen up against Your claim.
Beloved, the words fit every devil here:
We all believe that we are gods to fear,
We all compete with other idols too
In the annihilation of their crew.

20 Again the word of YHWH came to
Me saying 21 “Son of man, set your
Face against Zidon and outpour
Prophecy against Zidon’s score.
22 “And say ‘So says the Lord YHWH,
“See,

I’m against you, O Zidon *wee*,
And I’ll be glorified where you
Are, and they’ll know I am YHWH
When I’ll have pronounced sentence there,
And I’ll be holy of her *share*.

23 “I’ll send on her a pestilence
And blood in her streets *from her tents*,
So judgement will fall on the hurt
In her by the sword to assert
On every side, and they will know
That I am YHWH *and I’m not slow*.

24 “And there’ll be no more pricking brier
To Israel’s house, nor grief’s desire
Of thorn all round them who despise,
And they’ll know I’m Lord YHWH *and
wise*.”

25 “So says the Lord YHWH, “When I’ve
gathered
The house of Israel from the weathered
Folk among whom they have been
scattered,

And I’m holy among them shattered
Before the heathen, then they’ll live,
My servant Jacob’s land I give.

26 “And they will live in safety there,
And build houses, vineyards to bear,
And live safely when I have set
Judgements upon all those I’ve met
Who despise them all around about,
And they will know I’m YHWH to
shout.””

The word against the town of Zidon shows
The same in store for her as for the rows
Of her daughter, the queen of ships that
goes

Down to the sea to sit on island fair
And bask in Tyre and smell of the sea air.

Before the setting sun, both look to see
The shadows on the waves, the mystery
Of this one filling of the basin there
That holds the history of human share.
Like two eyes turned to find the secret wish
Of human destiny in a prune dish,
The mother and the daughter towns repair
Their nets for centuries beneath the gold
And crimson of the failing sun and cold.

Ezekiel 29

1 In tenth year, in month number ten,
In the month’s twelfth day, then again
The word of YHWH came to me saying
2 “Son of man, now set your face swaying
Against Pharaoh, king of Egypt,
And prophesy against his crypt,
Against all the land of Egypt.

3 “Speak and say ‘So says the Lord
YHWH,

“Behold I now come against you,
Pharaoh king of Egyptian crew,
The great dragon that quietly
Lies in the middle of streams’ glee,
Who says ‘My river is my own,
I’ve made it for myself alone.’

4 “But I shall put hooks in your jaws,
And make you rivers’ fish like paws
Stick to your scales, and I shall bring
You up out of your rivers’ spring,
And all the fish of your streams there
Will stick to your scales for your share.

5 “I’ll leave you in abandonment
In the desert, you and the spent
Fish of your rivers; you shall fall
Upon the open fields for stall;
You shall not them be gathered up
Together: I have given to sup
To the beasts of the field and to
The birds of the sky to eat you.

6 “And all the dwellers of Egypt
Will know that I am YHWH unchipped,
Because they’ve been a staff of reed
To Israel’s house come in their need.

7 “When they took hold of you by hand,
You broke and tore their shoulder band,
And when they depended on you,
You broke and set their loins in view.”

I’ve seen the Nile lap clear beside the way
The Coptic museum in Cairo’s sway
Sinks to the waterside before the sun

Describes the Ramadhan now has begun.
 But I saw no dead fish, not even one.
 The black stream flows into the greater part
 Of the Euphrates, at last before cart
 Drew on the dam to close the garden wall.
 And there I saw a gasping fish in thrall
 Upon the silted sands. I put it back
 Into the stream, but saw it just go slack,
 Turn on its dorsal fin and show the white
 Of dying stomach and the coming night,
 The ravage of disease or age or fright.

8 “And therefore says the Lord called
 YHWH,

“See, I shall bring a sword on you,
 And cut of man and beast from view.

9 “And Egypt’s land will be a waste
 And desolate and so effaced,
 And they will know that I am YHWH,
 Because he said ‘The river’s mine,
 And I have made it for my kine.’

10 “So that is why I’m against you,
 And against your rivers in view,
 And I shall make of Egypt’s land
 A waste complete, desolate stand,
 From the tower of Syene up to
 The border of Ethiopian crew.

11 “No foot of man will pass through it,
 Nor foot of beast shall pass though fit,
 Nor shall it be established till
 Forty years there come to fulfil.

12 “And I shall make of Egypt’s land
 A desolation in the band
 Of countries that are desolate,
 And her towns among town and state
 That are laid waste will be the rate
 Of forty years; and I shall spread
 Egyptians among nations led,
 And shall disperse them through the
 world.”

13 “Moreover so says the Lord YHWH,
 “At end of forty years in view
 I shall gather Egyptians’ crew
 From the folk they’ve scattered unfurled.

14 “And I shall end captivity
 Of Egypt and make them come free
 Back to the land of Pathros, to
 The land of their dwelling in crew;
 And they will be there to remain
 A weak kingdom for their domain.

15 “It shall be weakest as a land;
 Neither shall it exalted stand

Above the nations; for I’ll make
 Them diminished, and they will take
 No more rulership in the stake
 Of nations *under their command*.
 16 “And it shall no longer remain
 The confidence of Israel’s fane,
 Bringing to mind iniquity,
 When they shall look to them in fee;
 But they’ll know that I’m the Lord
 YHWH.””

In Ephrata the count of forty years
 Took on the mystic signal of the fears
 Of humankind to find the wedded mate,
 The bride of Wisdom at the marriage plate.
 But never in the count did any know
 Of forty years on Egypt and not slow.
 The Scriptures make of forty years a test,
 A generation’s generation’s best,
 And give the sum a meaning and a zest
 Not meant for merely counting
 unconfessed.

Beloved, the forty years in punishment
 That You gave the Egyptians to consent
 Has long gone by, and yet my heart is sly
 To know the reasons of the earth and sky.

17 In twenty-seventh year it came
 In the first month, the first day’s claim,
 The word of YHWH came to me saying

18 “Son of man, *hear where you are
 staying,*

Nebuchadrezzar who is king
 Of Babylon and everything
 Made his army to do a thing
 Great against Tyre; every head lay
 Bald, and every shoulder in sway
 Was broken, yet he had not pay,
 Nor his army, for Tyre for all
 The thing he did against its wall.

19 “That’s why,” so says the Lord called
 YHWH,

“See, I shall give Egypt’s land to
 Nebuchadrezzar who is king
 Of Babylon and everything,
 And he will take her multitude,
 And take her spoil and take her brood;
 And it shall be for salary
 So he can pay his own army.

20 “I’ve given Egypt’s land to him
 For the work that he did in grim
 Against it, because they worked rue

In My service,” says the Lord YHWH.
21 “In that day I shall cause the strength
Of Israel’s house to bud at length,
And I will give you opening
Of the mouth in midst of their wing;
And they will know that I am YHWH.”

For centuries the house of Israel sat
Beneath the table on the Pharaoh’s mat
And ate the crumbs of Egypt dropped in
store
Since Joseph build the houses and before.
You ask them to leave custom and the
chance
Of knowing where their bread is for a
dance,
And claim that in that turning they shall
know
That You are YHWH alone in history’s
show.
Beloved, the judgement on each nation
spoke
To make them know as such a pagan folk
That You are YHWH, but in another stroke
The judgement on Egypt comes to reveal
Not to Pharaoh the word of woe and weal
But to Israel alone that You are real.

Ezekiel 30

1 The word of YHWH again to me
Came saying 2 “Son of man, agree
To prophesy and say ‘So Lord
YHWH says “Howl, woe the day its
sword!”

3 “Because the day is near, the day
Of YHWH is near, a cloudy day,
To be the time of heathen sway.

4 “The sword shall fall on Egypt’s land,
Great pain upon Cush and its band,
When those killed in Egypt shall fall,
And they take off abundant wall,
Foundations shall break in the stall.

5 “Cush, Libya, Lydia, all the folk
And Chub, and the land’s men in yoke,
Shall fall with them by the sword’s stroke.”

6 So says YHWH, “They also that hold
Up Egypt shall fall, and the bold
Pride of her power come tumbling down,
From the tower of Syene they found
They fall there by the sword to ground,”
Says the Lord YHWH *with fearsome
frown.*

7 “And they will become desolate
Among all countries, every state,
Her towns shall be among those that
Are wasted in a desert flat.

8 “And they will know that I am YHWH,
When I’ve set Egypt on fire too,
And all her aids fail from in view.

9 “On that day messengers will go
Out from Me in ships and not slow
To make Ethiopians fear,
And great pain fall upon their ear,
Like when days of Egypt appear.”

Beloved, Egyptians of today know well
That You are YHWH, they can stand up
and tell

The truth of Your name and Your oneness
now

Despite the many gods that crowned the
brow

In times of Jeremiah and the one
Who saw the vivid visions on the run.
The Copt and Muslim both report belief
In You, Beloved, after Egyptian grief.
Your methods seem long and irrational,
And I could think of better arsenal,
And yet today there’s hardly any man
In Egypt who does not know of Your plan.
They all sweetly admit Your blessed name
And bow in acknowledgement of Your
fame.

10 So says the Lord YHWH, “I will make
The multitude in Egypt’s wake
Disappear by the hand and sake
Of Nebuchadrezzar the king
Of Babylon and everything.

11 “He and his armies, the great fear
Of nations, shall come and appear
To destroy the land: and they’ll draw
Their swords against Egyptian claw,
And fill the land with the slain here.

12 “And I will make the rivers dry,
And sell the land into the sty
Of the wicked: and I will make
The land lie waste and all in wake
By the hand of strangers: I YHWH
Have spoken *of what I shall do.*”

13 So says the Lord YHWH: “I’ll also
Destroy the idols *in the show,*
And I will make their idols cease
Out of Noph; and no more release

A prince in Egypt's land: and I
Will put fear in Egypt's land's sky.
14 "I will make Pathros desolate,
And set fire to Zoan, in rate
Execute judgement in No's state.

Great Babylon is gone with all its fame,
With all its kings and gardens and the claim
Of world renown. But Egypt still stands
fast

Before the breath of history and its blast.
The pyramids stand still in monolith,
The River Nile, though harnessed from its
myth,

Laps at the banks of Cairo. Everywhere
Egypt remains unmoved beneath the air.
Beloved, Egyptians sweetly say Your name
Before and after prayers, always the same,
And though most do not keep Your law
entire,

They have survived Babylon's striking ire.
Your hammer lies crushed on the burning
sand,

While Egypt stricken blooms beneath Your
hand.

15 "I'll pour My fury upon Sin,
The strength of the Egyptian bin;
And I'll cut off the multitude
Of No *and all its living brood.*

16 "I'll set fire in Egypt, and Sin
Shall have great pain and No shall win
No place but be rent in two, and
Noph shall be daily in woe's stand.

17 "Aven's and Pibeseth's youth fall
By the sword: and these cities all
Shall go captive and into thrall.

18 "At Tahephnehes too the day
Shall be darkened, when I shall stay
To break there the yokes of Egypt:
And the pomp of her strength unzipped
Shall cease in her: as for her then
A cloud shall cover hill and glen,
Her daughters captive go again.

19 "So I will execute judgements
In Egypt: and they'll know with sense
That I am YHWH *named among men.*"

The centuries, millennia that hold
Egyptian history swallow up cold
The fires and degradations that are told
In pages of Ezekiel for the bold.

Like battleships sunk in the lonely reach
Of ocean nevermore to hit the beach,
The armies came and conquered and at last
They disappeared before the weight of past
And present bearing on the watered soil.
Egyptians hardly glanced up from their toil.
Beloved, like on my heart as does the sun
Upon the glistening pyramids where the
run

Of time stops and awaits the garnered foil:
My eyes engraved, unseeing when it done.

20 It happened and it came to be
In the eleventh year to see,
In the first month, the seventh day
Of the month, YHWH's word came to say,

21 "Son of man, I've broken the arm
Of Pharaoh king of Egypt's harm;
And see, it shall not be set to
Be healed, but in a splint in view

To make it strong again to hold
The sword *as does a strong man bold.*

22 "Therefore so says the Lord YHWH:
See,

I'm against Pharaoh who's the wee
King of Egypt, and I will break
His arms, the strong, and when I take
I'll cause the sword to fall in wake.

23 "And I will scatter the Egyptians
Among the nations with conniptions,
And will disperse them through the earth.

24 "And I will strengthen the king's power
Of Babylon, and put the shower
Of My sword in his hand; but I
Will break Pharaoh's arms *from the sky*,
And he shall groan before him too
With groanings of a dying crew.

25 "I'll strengthen power of Babylon's
Crown, and Pharaoh's strength as of pawns
Shall fall; and they'll know I am YHWH,
When I put My sword out to hew
In hand of Babylon's king too,
And he'll stretch it out on the view
Of Egypt's land and Egypt's crew.

26 "And I'll scatter Egyptians in
The nations and disperse their bin
Among the countries; and they'll know
That I am YHWH *and on the go.*"

I do not see this prophecy fulfilled
Among Egyptian people starved and billed
In every country of the earth as skilled.

That is because at school the masters chose
To ridicule diffusion in its rows,
And say that Egypt's spreading round the
earth

Was just a myth of idle talk and mirth.
I find Egyptians plenty in the crowd
Of London and other countries allowed,
But not to the extent that others ride,
And not for all the centuries of pride.
Beloved, in Your prophet has got it wrong
In the hyperbole of dance and song,
The words are still singable to the strong.

Ezekiel 31

1 It happened in eleventh year,
In the third month, first day of fear,
The word of YHWH came to me saying
2 "Son of man, speak to Pharaoh swaying
Ruler of Egypt and his brood:
'Who are you like in magnitude?
3 "See, the Assyrian was a cedar
In Lebanon, in branches leader,
And cast a shadow like a shroud,
And was taller than all the crowd,
And his top reached with thick boughs
loud.

4 "The waters made him great, the deep
Set him up on high, and to creep
With rivers running round about
His plants, and so then to send out
Her rivulets to all the trees
Of the field *blowing in the breeze*.
5 "That's why his height was high above
All the trees of the field for love,
And his boughs increased and his branch
Became long where waters unstance,
When he sprouted up *from his knees*.

6 "All the birds of the sky made nests
In his boughs, and under his crests
Did all the beasts of the field bring
Forth their young and under the spring
Of his shadow lived everything.

7 "So he was fair in greatness and
In the length of his branches' band;
For his roots by the waters stand.

8 "The cedars in the garden great
Could not hide from him in their state,
The fir trees were not like his boughs,
The chestnut trees' branches arouse
Not like him nor does any tree
In the great garden for beauty
Vie with him in his majesty.

9 "I've made him beautify to see
By the number of branches free:
So all the trees of pleasure ground
In the great garden all around
Were jealous of him *as they found*."

The prophets have a stock of metaphor
Comparing kings to beasts upon the floor
And trees upon the mountains and the hills.
The prophets say a thing and it fulfils.
The tree is planted by the hidden streams
Beneath the desert sands, beneath the
dreams

Of human envy and of human power.
The kingdom's nourished by a secret hour.
Beloved, I mind the days of long ago
When I a mere lad came to see the row
Of fig trees and of olives in the sand
Of Wadi Natroun rising up to stand.
I watered them with fossil waters that
In later years their roots would reach in vat.

10 That's why so says the Lord YHWH,
"Since

You lifted up yourself to wince,
And he has shot up his top to
The thickness of branches in view,
And his heart's lifted above crew;
11 "I have therefore delivered him
Into the hand of mighty grim
One of the heathen; he'll surely
Deal with him: I've driven to flee
For all his wickedness in spree.

12 "And strangers like horrors of folk
Have cut him off and left by stroke;
Upon the mountains and in all
The valleys his branches must fall,
And his boughs are broken by all
The rivers of the land in thrall;
And all the people of the earth
Have fled from his shadow of dearth,
Abandoning him *and his worth*.

13 "Upon his carcass all the birds
Of heaven shall come to light with turds,
And all the animals abroad
Shall creep on his branches in sod.

It sounds as if the punishment that's let
On Egypt is conversion to the set
Of Parsees who maintain the silent towers
Seducing birds to come down on the
flowers

Of human flesh and enjoy what devours.
 I do abhor the choice of most today,
 Cremation after leaving earthly fray.
 The grave seems cold, at least here where I
 stray
 Among the reindeer herders on their way.
 Perhaps providing banquets for the birds
 Is the best fate to look for beyond words.
 To be stuck in some craw is nothing new.
 I find that is my normal spot of stew.
 At death I'll just return upon my screw.

14 "So in the end none of the trees
 All planted by waters in breeze
 Shall lift themselves in height nor shoot
 Up their top among boughs to boot,
 Neither their trunks stand in their height,
 All that drink water flowing light;
 For they are all given up to death,
 Piled in the lowlands without breath,
 Among the children of men and
 With those to enter the pit's band."
 15 So says the Lord YHWH, "In the day
 When he went to the grave in prey
 I caused a mourning: I put spray
 Upon the deep for him and I
 Restrained its floods, and waters stayed:
 And I caused Lebanon to cry
 For him, and all the trees' parade
 In the field fainted for his aid.
 16 "I made the nations tremble when
 They heard his fall, and I cast then
 Him into hell with those who go
 Into the pit: and all the show
 Of Eden's trees, the choice and best
 Of Lebanon, all drink with zest,
 Shall have their comfort when they come
 Into the lowlands and to hum.
 17 "They also went down into hell
 With him, slain by the sword and fell;
 They were his power and came to dwell
 Under his shadow for a spell
 Among the heathen before knell.
 18 "Who are you like in glory and
 In greatness with the trees to stand
 In Eden? Still you will be brought
 Down with the trees of Eden sought
 Into the lowlands of the earth:
 You will lie in the midst and berth
 Of the uncircumcised and those
 Struck down by the sword in their rows.
 This is Pharaoh and all his train,"

Says the Lord YHWH, *the One to reign.*

The trees of Egypt, Lebanon, and late
 Those of Edenic beauty for their fate,
 All pause before the awful brink of hell
 With one last longing glimpse of water
 well.

The shadows of the wait lurk in the past.
 The tinkle of the bucket that was cast
 Upon the sole reflection of the sky
 Beneath the wings leviathan in try
 Still sound upon the ear to hesitate
 Before the plunge into the yearly rate.
 Beloved, I've spoken once before or twice
 To tell You cutting trees is just not nice,
 And all the more when You make trees to
 be
 The symbol of human eternity.

Ezekiel 32

1 It happened in the twelfth year, in
 The twelfth month, in the month's first bin,
 The word of YHWH came to me, saying
 2 "Son of man, take up lament's praying
 For Pharaoh king of Egypt, and
 Say to him 'You are like a young
 Lion of the nations unstrung,
 And you are like a whale upon
 The seas: and you came out at dawn
 With your rivers, and with your feet
 Stirred up their waters' muddy fleet.'
 3 "So says the Lord YHWH, 'I'll therefore
 Spread out My net over Your floor
 With many people in a crowd,
 You'll be brought in My net allowed.
 4 "Then I'll leave you upon the land,
 I cast you out on open strand,
 And cause all the birds of the sky
 To stay on you, And I will try
 To fill the beasts of the whole world
 On your flesh *slaughtered and uncured*.
 5 "And I will lay your flesh upon
 The mountains, and fill valleys drawn.
 6 "I'll water also with your blood
 The land in which you swim the flood,
 Up to the mountains; and the streams
 Shall be full of you in their teams.
 7 "And when I shall put you out, I
 Will cover the entire sky,
 And make the stars dark; and I will
 Cover the sun with a cloud-fill,
 The moon will not shed her light's till.

8 "All the bright lights of heaven will I
 Make dark over you, and set dark
 On your land," says the Lord YHWH stark.
 "And I'll vex hearts of many folk,
 When I shall bring destruction's stroke
 Among the nations you've not known.
 10 "Indeed, I'll make many folk shown
 Amazed at you, and their kings too
 Shall be in horror's grip for you,
 When I shall brandish My sword's rue
 Before them, and they'll tremble too
 At every moment, every man
 For his own life in that day's span."

I did not speak at all when my grandson
 Retorted that I'd never seen the sun
 Upon a whale beached, dead, and off the
 run.

My memory turned back to see the day
 Beside the breakers north of Monterey
 Where the Pacific wanders through the bay.
 A whale turned up upon the greying sand,
 Before the greyer waters on the strand,
 Covered in cords of kelp. A sombre sky
 Was all the dirge the whale had to go by.
 And so it loomed upon the shore three days
 To rot until a higher sea for praise
 Washed it back to its own eternal grave.
 But for that short time I crouched in its
 nave.

11 For so says Lord YHWH "The sword of
 The king of Babylon above
 Shall come on you and make a shove.

12 "By the swords of the mighty I
 Shall cause your multitude to fly,
 All horrors of the nations and
 They'll spoil the pomp of Egypt's stand,
 And all its crowds shall be destroyed.

13 "I'll also strike all beasts employed
 Beside the great waters, so foot
 Of a man never more will put
 Them to grief, or the hoof of beast
 Trouble them there nor in the least.

14 "Then will I make their waters deep,
 And cause their rivers running *steep*
 Like oil," says the Lord YHWH *in leap*.

15 "When I make desolate the land
 Of Egypt, and the country stand
 Destitute of its plenty, when
 I shall strike all them in their den,
 Then they'll know I am YHWH again.

16 This *is* the lamentation they
 Shall keen upon her; and the prey
 Of nations shall lament her day;
 For Egypt and for all her folk,"
 Says the Lord YHWH *and at a stroke*.

You seem to have a wish as full and strong
 As any in the universe for song
 That puny men in some old place and time
 Should know that You are YHWH and on
 the climb.

Catastrophes of nature and of war
 Seem to be just graffiti on the shore
 Of Your eternity, an idle stroke
 In case a man should read, or even folk.
 The desolation of a company,
 A tribe, a nation, or a family,
 Is just a scratch upon the cosmic wall
 To say that You are Sovereign over all.
 The insight that my childish inclination
 Gives of Your heart and mind's my
 comfort's ration.

17 It happened too in the twelfth year,
 In fifteenth *day* of the month near,
 That the word of YHWH came to me,
 Saying 18 "Son of man, wait for those
 Who live in Egypt, and in throes
 Cast them down, *even* her, and rows
 Of famous nations' daughters' shows
 Into the lowest parts of earth,
 Who go into the pit for berth.

19 "Whom do you surpass in your beauty?
 Lie with uncircumcised in booty.

20 "They'll fall among those killed by
 sword,

She's handed over to its ward,
 Draw her and all her crowds adored.

21 "The strong among the mighty speak
 To him out of the hell they peek
 To help him, they have all gone down
 And lie uncircumcised *in town*,
 Killed by the sword *or by a frown*.

22 "Asshur *is* there and all her band:
 His graves around him for the stand
 Of all killed by the sword's command.

23 "Their graves carved in sides of the pit,
 Her company comes round to sit
 About her grave; all of them slain,
 Felled by the sword that brought the pain
 Upon the land of living hit.

You think it is enough You say to wail
In lamentation for the deathly tale.
You think that forty days of grief is spent,
And then the human soul must rise, relent
And go on with the market and the strife.
You think that sorrow is a part of life.

Beloved, You're wrong. The quiet grief
that goes

Beneath the everyday in after shows
Is buried but not dead. It's only death
That is your mercy after human breath.
No grief dies this side of the barren tomb,
But shares with life its decades in the
womb,

And then sinks still-born to the shades of
gloom,

Eternal as the soul of myth and room.

24 "There's Elam and her multitude
Around her grave, all of their brood
Slain, fallen by the sword, who're gone
Down uncircumcised to the drawn
Parts of the earth, which brought their fear
In the land of the living peer;

But they have borne their shame with those
That go down to the pit in rows.

25 "They have set her a bed among
The slain with all her crowd unsung;
Her grave are round about him there,
All of them uncircumcised slayer
And slain by the sword; through their fear
Was caused in land of living shear,
Still they have borne their shame with those
That go down to the pit in rose,
He's set among the slain and near.

26 "There's Meshech, Tubal, all her crowd,
Her graves are round about him soughed,
All of the uncircumcised, slain
By the sword, though their fear had lain
In land of every living wain.

27 "They'll not lie with the mighty who
Fell of the uncircumcised crew,
Who have gone down to hell with their
Weapons of war; they've laid the share
Of their swords under their heads, but
Their sins shall be on their bones shut,
Though they were in fright of the strong
In the land of the living long.

28 "See, you'll be broken there among
The uncircumcised, and lie *young*
With the slain of the sword *unstrung*.
There's Edom, her kings, every prince,

Who by their power are laid to wince,
Killed by the sword: so they shall lie
With the uncircumcised and by
Them who go down into
The pit to stay there all in crew.
30 *There are the princes of the north,*
All of them, and all who go forth
From Zidon, and who have gone down
With the slain, with their terror's frown
Ashamed of their power; and they lie
Uncircumcised with those who die
By the sword, and bear there their shame
With those gone down to the pit's *flame*.

31 Pharaoh shall see them, and shall be
Comforted for all his degree,
Even Pharaoh and all his army
Slain by the sword, says the Lord YHWH.
"For I've laid My fear on the land
Of living; and he's set to stand
Among the uncircumcised band
Of those slain with the sword in hand,
Even Pharaoh and all his crowd,"
Says the Lord YHWH *and says aloud*.

The foreskin of man's sorrow is not brief.
Each soul is one original in grief,
Eternal in despair, while joy's relief
Is just a moment on the good and fair.
Uncircumcised, unburied, I may lie
Beneath the blades of an embittered sky,
But where I find no solace to make right,
Nor strength to rise above the sore and
fight,

I still find that existence in the night,
The small and piecing breath that is my
might,
Suffices. Though no purpose and no right
Atone, condone, attain, yet in Your sight
I bear such burdens that You, though You
be
Creator, have not loaned eternity.

Ezekiel 33

1 Again the word of YHWH came to
Me, saying 2 "Son of man, speak to
The children of your people's crew,
And say to them, 'When I shall bring
The sword upon a land for sting,
If the folk of the land will take
A man of their parts for the sake
Of watchman, 3 "if when he sees sword
Approach on the land and gored,

And blows a warning trumpet horde,
 4 "Then everyone who hears the sound
 Of the trumpet and takes no bound,
 If the sword comes and bears him off,
 His death is his own fault to scoff.
 5 "He heard the trumpet sound and took
 No warning; his blood's on his crook.
 But the one who takes warning then
 Shall save his life *in den and glen*.
 6 "But if the watchman sees the sword
 Approach and no warning word
 Gives, and the people are not stirred,
 If the sword comes and takes a man
 From among them, and he in scan
 Of his sin is taken away,
 I'll make the watchman come to pay.'
 7 "So you, O son of man, I've set
 As a watchman to Israel's pet
 House, so you'll hear the word and get
 At My mouth and warn them that day.
 8 "When I say to the wicked man,
 'O wicked one, you'll die by plan;'
 If you do not tell him and warn
 The wicked from his way in bourn,
 That wicked one shall die in sin,
 But I'll hold you in account's bin.
 9 "But if you warn the wicked one
 Of his way to repent when done,
 And he does not repent, then he
 Shall die in his iniquity,
 But you've saved yourself from the fee.'

I am no watchman on Your wall below.
 My lip is chapped, my steps have become
 slow,
 And sleep grasps at my soul and at my row.
 I am no watchman at the trumpet sound
 To raise a cry or standard on the ground.
 And yet the circle that my cumbered feet
 Make on the slaughter ground of my retreat
 speak,
 The warnings and the promises I seek.
 While some rush to repentance or to sale,
 I turn before the breath of summer hale
 To find the acilea's shield and mail,
 The buttercup in spreading vine a snare,
 The goatweed still a sword that I can bear.

10 "Therefore, O you son of man, speak
 To Israel's house, so you shall speak,
 And say 'If our transgressions peak

And our sins are on us and we
 Succumb to them, how shall we be?'
 11 "Say to them, "'As I live," says YHWH
 The Lord, "I have no joy in brew
 Of wicked people dying too;
 But rather that the wicked turn
 From his way and live so to earn;
 Repent, repent your evil ways;
 For why will you die *in your stays*,
 O house of Israel *for praise*?"'
 12 "So then, you son of man, say to
 The children of your folk in crew,
 "The righteousness of righteous one
 Shall not save him in the day done
 Of his transgression; and as for
 The wickedness of wicked store,
 It shall not make him fall the day
 He repents of his wicked way;
 Neither shall the righteous be saved
 By his good on the day he graded
 To commit sin *upon the paved*.
 13 "When I say to the righteous folk
 That he will surely live a stroke,
 If he trusts his own righteousness,
 And commits sin, his righteousness
 Shall not be called to mind's address,
 Because of the sin that he did,
 So he'll die for it *without bid*.
 14 "Again, when I say to the bad,
 You'll surely die for what you had,
 If he repents from his sin sad,
 And does the lawful and the right;
 15 "Restoring the pledge and in sight
 Returning what he robbed for plight,
 And act by the statutes of life,
 Committing no violent strife,
 He'll surely live, not die *outright*.
 16 "None of his sins that he has done
 Shall be mentioned in course of run;
 He's done the lawful and the right,
 He'll surely live on *in My sight*.
 17 "Yet the sons of your folk reply,
 The Lord's way is not just foreby.
 But it's their way that's unjust try.
 18 "When the righteous turns from his
 good,
 And does the sin for what he should,
 Then he'll die too *because he would*.
 19 "But if the wicked does repent
 From his wickedness in his tent,
 And does the lawful and the right,
 He shall live because of his flight.

20 "But you say "The Lord's way's not just."

O house of Israel in the dust,
I'll judge you every one that day
By what he does and how's his way."

Beloved, do not judge me, I say, do not!
I have done nothing here in all the plot
To merit Your forgiveness or the spot
Of condemnation. In the day I live
All men, or almost all, are just a sieve.
It's rare to find a saint and rarer still
To find a worthy sinner on the hill.
The most of men are merely mediocre
As artists in the swill or in the poker.
Let me be saint or sinner to subscribe
To great deeds, then You may come in to
bribe

Or judge me with injustice or a will.
Until then, see, I merely grow beneath
The shade of pine, prickly of a fir wreath.

21 It happened in the twelfth year of
Our captivity, the fifth of
The tenth month, that one had escaped
Out of Jerusalem and scraped
Along to me and said "The town
Is struck and it has fallen down."

22 YHWH's power came on me at the
dusk,

Before the escapee in husk
Came to me but my mouth was closed
Until he arrived when morn posed,
And then my mouth was opened and
And was no longer dumb to stand.

23 And YHWH's word came to me and
said

24 "Son of man, those who dwell instead
On those waste places of the land
Of Israel speak by command,
'Abraham was just one and he
Inherited the land for free,
But we are many so the land
Is given to all the heirs in band.'

25 "That's why say to them," so says
YHWH

The Lord, "You eat the bloody brew,
And raise eyes to your idols' crew,
And shed blood, and will you have still
The land *from plain to stream and hill?*

26 "You stand upon your sword and do
Abomination in your pew,

Defiling each his neighbour's wife:
And shall you have the land *for life?*

27 "Tell them this:" So says the Lord
YHWH,

"As I live, surely all the crew
That lives in the waste places too
Shall fall by the sword, and the one
In the open field on the run
I'll give to the beast to devour,
And those in the forts and caves' power
Shall die of the plague in an hour.

28 "And I'll make the land desolate,
Astonishment in every rate,
The glory of her strength shall cease;
And Israel's mountain like a fleece
Be desolate so none pass through.

29 "Then they shall know that I am
YHWH,

When I have laid the desert land
For their abominations' hand.

What You call defiling the neighbour's
wife

Some that I know claim is just part of life,
Expression of the love that You have given
To ease the human lot that we must live in.
What You call gross idolatry some I
Know call the quintessence of life's poetry,
Expression of the best in art and beauty,
And nothing evil, dirty or gone sooty.
Beloved, can You not understand the free
And hopeful expression by earth and sky?
With love and beauty here beneath my
paint,

I know a human law beyond Your quaint.
Go in a gallery, appreciate
The trace of human hand, learn not to hate.

30 "And you, son of man, the sons of
Your people still talk and they shove
Against you by the walls and doors
Of their own houses and their floors,
And speak to each other, each one
To his brother, saying *for fun*
Please come and hear what crazy thing
Has come down from YHWH on the wing.

31 "They come to you as people come,
And sit before you like the sum
Of My folk and they hear your words,
But they will not do them for turds;
For with their mouth they show much love,
Their heart is in covetous glove.

32 And see you are to them as one
Who sings a love-song on the run
With a nice voice and can play well
On any instrument a spell,
For they hear your words, but they do
Not do them *in secret or view*.

33 And when this happens, and it will,
Then they shall know come to fulfil
A prophet is among them still.

And that's exactly what I said before.
Appreciation of man's art in store
Ought to have some merit in judgement
score.

I hear the Hebrew words Ezekiel rose
To rant in comely verses and in pose.
Of course it is an exquisite primrose,
Delight to ear and heart, comfort to toes.
Some cannot now repent, it's sad and true,
But they at least can love the sound of new
And favoured art expressing human grief
And happiness, it's art that brings relief.
Just stop, Beloved, and listen to the tune
Ezekiel sings, even if ancient rune,
And love the melody, if not the boon.

Ezekiel 34

1 YHWH's word came to me and He said
2 "Son of man, prophesy as led
Against Israel's shepherds and say
To them in prophecy today,
'So says the Lord YHWH in His sway
To the shepherds, "Woe be to those
Shepherds of Israel in their rows
Who feed themselves! Should they not feed
The flocks, those shepherds in their greed?
3 "You eat the fat and dress in wool,
You kill those whom you should make full,
Not feeding the flock in their need.
4 "You did not strengthen the diseased,
Nor healed the sick, nor have you pleased
To set the broken bone, nor brought
Back those gone astray from the lot,
Nor have you sought the lost, instead
With force and cruelty you've led.
5 "And they were scattered without one
To be a shepherd on the run.
They became the meal to each beast
Scatter in the fields and increased.
6 "My sheep have wandered through he
hills,
On every high hill that fulfils;

Indeed My flock was scattered wide
Upon the face of the earth's pride,
With none to search and find beside."'''
7 That's why, you shepherds, hear the word
Of YHWH, 8 "As I live," says the Lord
YHWH, "surely because My flock came
To be a prey, and my flock's fame
The meat of every beast in claim
Upon the fields, because there came
No shepherd, neither did My own
Shepherds seek after my flock flown,
But fed themselves instead when grown."
9 Therefore, O shepherds, hear the word
Of YHWH *and let your hearts be stirred*.

So far I've been as anti-clerical
As I can and not be hysterical.
Your words, Beloved, go further than my
own.

In fact, I've wearied standing by Your
throne
To cast a spell against the Trinity,
Idols in stone, idols in poetry,
Idols in churches and theology,
Priests and priest-craft, of all I am weary.
Remove idolatry from just my heart,
The pope from belly, and the priest apart,
And I'll be grateful and let others be.
The shepherds of Israel were scavengers
Twenty-five hundred years ago. My stirs
Of life are too short to complain a wee.

10 So says the Lord YHWH, "Now behold
I am against the shepherds' hold,
And I'll require My flock from them,
And make them stop being the hem
By which to feed the flock, and so
The shepherds shall no longer show
To feed themselves, for I will save
My flock from their mouth like a grave,
So they may not be meat to eat
By any of them *like a treat*."

I guess You must have saved me from the
claw
Of shepherds that raise up a voice and paw.
There is no shepherd Protestant or Catholic
Who would let me stay in the church for
drastic
In measures. No, I am the kind thrown out
Before I even open mouth to shout.
They see the danger in my eyes, I guess.

There is no churchly place for my address.
 Beloved, I share the fate of Your own son,
 Who had no place to lay his head when
 done,
 Or Your Mahdi, who roams around the
 world
 Incog without address or flag unfurled.
 The synagogue, the church, the mosque
 close doors,
 But I plunge in the ocean of Your shores.

11 For so says the Lord YHWH, "Behold,
 I even I will come as bold
 To search for My sheep and seek out.
 12 "As a shepherd seeks without doubt
 His flock when his sheep scatter out,
 So I will seek my sheep and save
 Them from all places where may rave
 The clouds and darkness *of the grave*.
 13 "And I'll bring them out from the folk,
 And gather them from countries' yoke,
 And I'll bring them to their own land,
 And feed them on the mountains' strand
 Of Israel by its flowing streams,
 And in all the campsites and dreams
 Of the land wherever it seems.
 14 "I'll feed them in a meadow fine,
 Upon the high mountains to shine
 In Israel; there they shall lie
 In a good fold, in a fat sty,
 They'll feed upon the mountains of
 Israel, *all the sheep that I love*.
 15 "I'll feed My flock, and I will make
 Them lie down, says Lord YHWH in stake.
 16 "I'll seek the lost and bring again
 Those driven out away from den,
 And I'll bind up the broken and
 Strengthen the sick in all the band,
 But I'll destroy the fat and strong,
 I'll feed them with judgement *on wrong*.

Be careful what You promise, One divine!
 The shepherds of all the world's faiths
 combine
 To let me starve to death and hope I do.
 I only have a shelter left in You.
 But I give warning now that I've a paunch
 That cannot be filled up, not by a launch.
 That's why I could no longer preach for
 those
 Baptists who paid the preacher on his toes
 In Sunday dinners. All the week in fasting

Made me too thin to preach to
 flabbergasting.
 Feed me the hidden manna that You train
 On those caught in the desert sort of plain,
 And I'll complain the fare's too sweet to
 eat,
 And too one-sided to turn out a treat.

17 "And you, My flock," so says Lord
 YHWH,
 "See, I will judge between the crew
 Of cattle and others in view,
 Between the rams and he goats' rue.
 18 "Is it a trifle that you eat
 Up the good pasture, with your feet
 Trample what's left of meadow sweet,
 That you drink up the waters deep,
 And foul the rest in your feet's sweep?
 19 "My flock, they eat what's trodden
 down,
 They drink muddy waters and brown
 Fouled with your feet, *and so they weep*.
 20 "That's why the Lord YHWH says to
 them,
 'See I, even I'll judge the stem
 Between the fat cattle and lean.
 21 "Because you've pushed with side and
 bean,
 Gored with your horns the sick and keen,
 Till you've scattered them to careen.'

The word is for the judgement of the few
 Who read it, not the livelier in crew
 Who go to work without a pause to see
 What Scripture has to say today in fee.
 So let me hear the judgement on my own
 Head for the things that I have done alone.
 I may have trodden down a place to drink
 And left it muddy for the ones to sink
 Who come after me to the shady brink.
 But I have surely not used horn to slow
 Another from the watering hole to go
 On my way with the elbow sort of show.
 You can't pin that on me, Beloved, I know.
 If You judge me, You'll take another think.

22 "Therefore I'll save My flock and they
 Never more shall become a prey;
 And I'll judge between crow and jay.
 23 "I'll set one shepherd over them,
 And he shall feed them in his hem,
 My servant David, he shall feed

Them and be their shepherd agreed.
24 "And I YHWH'll be their Alohim,
And My servant David the cream
Of princes among them; I YHWH
Have spoken it *and so I'll do*.
25 "I'll make them a pact of Islam,
And cause the evil beasts to calm
Out of the land, and they shall stay
In safety in the desert way
And sleep in the woods *after day*.

Alright, alright, the text said peace and not
Islam, but they are both spelled with the
slot
Of the same letters in the order too.
Islam and peace should be the same to You,
And perhaps are the same. And yet I see
Full many of the ones who claim to be
On the right path turn from the way to go
Against the full commandments and not
slow.
You say that You're one God, and that they
get,
But when You say keep Sabbath and not
set
A snare to kill another on the way,
They sometimes forget to take night from
day.
And even Jews Your chosen know to slay.
Beloved, let me have peace and Islam's
way.

26 "I'll make them and the places round
About My hill a blessing found,
And I will cause the shower to pour
Down in its season on the shore,
And there'll be showers of blessing more.
27 "The tree of the field yields her fruit,
And the earth increase from the root,
And they shall be safe in their land,
And know that I'm YHWH, when I stand
To break the bands of their yoke, and
Save them out of the power and hand
Of those who served themselves to boot.
28 "And they shall no more be a prey
To the heathen, nor shall the sway
Of the beast of the land betray,
But they shall dwell in safety there,
And no one make them troubles bear.
29 "And I will lift to them a plant
Of fame and they shall have no want
In the land, nor bear any shame

On the part of the heathen game.
30 "So they shall know that I am YHWH
Their Alohim with them in view,
And they, the house of Israel,
Are My folk," says the Lord YHWH well.
31 "And you My flock, My pasture's flock,
Are men, I'm your Alohim rock,"
Says the Lord YHWH *of Israel*.

I'm glad that doing a good turn also
Reveals that You are YHWH and on the
go.

I'd got the idea in my pate to show
That only evil events could teach men
That You are Sovereign of the field and
glen.

The trees grow and produce the soughten
fruit,

The buds turn into blossoms and the root
Enquires among the hidden streams to find
That You are there to nourish humankind.
Beloved, the good and evil in the draw,
All things that happen in both hand and
claw

Proclaim beyond the pain and long past joy
That You are YHWH alone and no decoy.
My leaf claps with the knowledge You
employ.

Ezekiel 35

1 And the word of YHWH came to me
And said 2 "Son of man set your wee
Face against Mount Seir and say
A prophecy against its way.

3 "And say to it, 'So says Lord YHWH:
'Behold, Mount Seir, I'm in a stew
Against you, and I'll stretch My hand
Out against you, and make your land
A desolation and a stand.

4 "I'll lay your cities waste and you
Shall be a desolation's view,
And you will know that I am YHWH.

5 "Because you had continued hate,
And killed Israel's people of late
By the hand of the sword in time
Of their calamity for crime,
When their sin came to consummate.

6 "That's why, as I live," says Lord
YHWH,

"I will prepare you for bloods spew,
And blood shall follow against you,
Since you have not abhorred blood's view,

Against then blood shall pursue.
 7 "So I shall make Mount Seir a waste,
 And cut of from it the misplaced
 And the one to return in view.
 8 "I'll fill his mountains with his slain:
 In your hills and in valleys lain,
 And in all your rivers, shall they
 Fall that are killed by the sword's sway.
 9 "I'll make you continued wasteland,
 And your cities shall not in band
 Return, and you will know that I
 Am YHWH, *on that you can rely.*

I've seen the land of Edom lie beneath
 The torch of sun and wrapped within the
 wreath
 Of red and purple tints upon the hills.
 I've seen the land of Edom pay her bills.
 The turn and twist of shadow marks the
 ways
 Of wandering among the rocks and craze
 Where there may be a bush or leaf to greet
 The new day, but hardly in that a treat.
 Beloved, the beauty of the land laid bare
 Is still upon the mountains everywhere
 That Edom pastured flocks and Esau knew
 The love and hope and disappointment too.
 The night may catch me in the favoured
 view
 Of Edom's passion and its mystic air.

10 "Because you said 'These two lands and
 These two countries are in my hand,
 And we'll possess it' but the stand
 Of YHWH was there *still to command.*
 11 "That's why, as I live," says Lord
 YHWH,
 "I'll even do according to
 Your wrath, and by your envy too
 Which you have held out in your wrath
 Against them, and I'll bring My path
 Among them, when I have judged you.
 12 "And you will know that I am YHWH,
 And I've heard all your blasphemies
 Which you have spoken in the breeze
 Against Israel's highlands to say
 'They are laid desolate today,
 They're given to us upon a tray.'
 13 "You've opened your mouth then to
 boast
 Against Me, and make words in host
 Against Me, I have heard the most.

14 "So says the Lord YHWH, "When the
 whole
 Earth rejoices, I'll take the toll.
 15 "As you rejoiced at Israel's lot,
 Because it was desolate spot,
 So I shall do to you also:
 You will be desolate *in show*,
 O Mount Seir, and all Idumea,
 Even all of it *to convey her:*
 And they'll know I am YHWH *below.*""

If Idumea joyed to see the sword
 Fall on the folk of Israel, of the Lord,
 It does not mean that one more fatal stroke
 Will put things right again under the oak.
 Beloved, sometimes I think You share the
 meal
 Of the idolater who comes to feel
 That sacrifice of blood upon the sand
 Makes right all wrongs and purifies the
 land.
 Let not Your hand strike Edom for the
 smile
 Of vain rejoicing at the fall and guile
 Of Israel. There's been enough of blood
 Shed since You spoke to prophets on the
 mud.
 Let Edom and Judaea live in peace,
 Whether Islamic or Jewish release.

Ezekiel 36

1 Also, you son of man, now speak
 A prophecy to Israel's peak,
 And say "You hills of Israel,
 Hear the word of YHWH *and hear well.*
 2 "So says the Lord YHWH, 'Since the foe
 Has spoken against you to show,
 See, ancient high places are still
 In our possession on the hill.'
 3 "So prophesy and say 'The Lord
 YHWH says this *to the unrestored*,
 "Since they have made you desolate,
 And swallowed you in every strait,
 So you would be a thing possessed
 To the rest of the heathen blessed,
 To be taken on talkers hips,
 An infamy of the folk's rips,
 4 "Therefore, you hills of Israel,
 Hear the word of the Lord YHWH well,'
 So says the Lord YHWH to the hills
 And to the uplands and the rills,
 And to the valleys and the wastes,

And to the towns' forsaken tastes,
 Which are a prey and thing derided
 To the rest of heathen resided
 That are round about *undecided*,
 5 "So says the Lord YHWH, 'Surely in
 The fire of My jealousy's din
 I've spoken against all the rest
 Of the heathen and have oppressed
 All Idumea, who have set
 My country as the thing to get
 With joy in all their heart, with such
 Despiteful minds to cast as much
 Out for a spoil *that they have met*.
 6 "So speak a prophesy about
 The ground of Israel in rout,
 And say to the mountains and to
 The hills and rills and valleys due,'
 So says the Lord YHWH, 'See, I've spoken
 In My own jealousy for token
 Of fury, because you have borne
 The shame of the heathen *for scorn*.
 7 "That's why' says the Lord YHWH, 'I've
 lifted
 My hand, surely heathen ungifted
 That are around you, they shall bear
 Their own shame *around everywhere*.

Catastrophe that falls from Your raised
 hand,
 Beloved, is not the wrath of the unfanned,
 Is not the fortune of invading band,
 Is not the rage of greed upon the land.
 The dire in consequence of rising up
 Is just results of drinking from the cup
 Of love entwined with rose and mint to sup.
 It's jealousy of love that turns the tup.
 Beloved, rise in Your jealousy and see
 That I return from every idol's spree
 To join my heart and breath to You in fire
 Of love and its extinguishing desire.
 Raise up Your hand against both shame and
 claim,
 But I shall not stop reciting Your name.

8 "But you, O hills of Israel,
 You'll sprout forth your branches a spell,
 And bear your fruit to My folk well
 Of Israel; for they're in hope.
 9 "For see, I'm for you and to cope,
 And I'll turn to you and you will
 Be sown after coming to till.
 10 "And I will multiply on you

Men of all Israel's house in crew;
 And the towns shall be filled with folk,
 The wasted built up at a stroke.
 11 "And I shall multiply on you
 Both man and beast, and in their due
 They shall increase and bring forth fruit,
 And I will settle you in root
 Of your old lands, and will do then
 Better than at the start again,
 And you'll know I am YHWH *to boot*.
 12 "Indeed, I'll make men walk on you,
 My people Israel and true,
 And they shall keep you and possess,
 And you will be their own address,
 And you will no more grieve and guess.'
 13 "So says the Lord YHWH, 'Because
 they
 Say to you, "You consume in sway,
 And have bereaved nations that way,
 14 "Therefore you shall consume no more,
 Nor grieve your nations on the shore,'
 Says the Lord YHWH *to even score*.
 15 "So I will not make people hear
 In you the shame of heathen fear
 Any longer, neither shall you
 Bear the reproach of people's crew,
 Neither shall you make nations fall
 Any more,' says Lord YHWH *of all*."

I've seen the towns in Israel today
 Filled with folk coming there or not to
 pray.
 I've seen the busy wagons on the street,
 The transport of both vegetables and meat,
 The marketing of every kind of treat.
 Your promise is fulfilled at least the while,
 Whether or not fulfilment without guile
 Took place before the crucifixion of
 Your towns throughout the Roman iron
 glove,
 Or when the caliphs reigned in every place
 The sacred ground passed out the holy race.
 The promise is fulfilled, and yet I see
 The populations growing faithfully
 In every place, both sacred and set free.

16 And the word of YHWH came to me
 And said 17 "Son of man, when the house
 Of Israel lived then freely
 In their own land with their own spouse,
 They defiled it by their own way
 And by the doings in their sway,

Their way came up before My eyes
 Like menstruation to despise.
 18 "That's why I poured My wrath on them
 For the blood they had shed on hem
 Upon the land, and for the reach
 Of their idols, polluted each.
 19 "And I spread them among the folk
 Of heathendom, and for a stroke
 They were scattered though all the lands,
 According to their way's demands,
 And by their doings' judgement stands.
 20 "And when they came to heathen lands,
 Where they went, they profaned My name
 Of holiness, when they told them,
 'These are YHWH's folk gone from His
 hem.'
 21 "But I had pity for My name
 Of holiness, when in their claim
 The house of Israel had profaned
 Among the heathen where they gained.

Your calling menstruation the defiled
 Sounds in the ears of some a thing as wild
 As any on the march. And I suppose
 That is the effect of the rows and rows
 Of Palestine's patrimony that froze
 The land of patriarchs instead of mild
 And graceful matriarchs at least self-styled.
 The patriarchal bias of Your word
 Expressed by prophet to both men and bird
 Is something that strikes matriarchal ear
 With sorrow and a wiping of the tear.
 It contrasts with the ten commandments'
 blow
 That does not include the wife in the row
 Of man's subordinates. That's a good
 show.

22 "So say to Israel's house, 'It's so
 Says the Lord YHWH, 'not for your glow
 Do I do this, O Israel's house,
 But for My holy name and blouse,
 Which you've profaned among the folk
 Of heathendom, where you had stroke.
 23 "I'll sanctify My name greatly,
 Which was profaned among the spree
 Of heathen, which you have profaned
 Among them all and where they reigned,
 And heathen will know I am YHWH,'
 Says the Lord YHWH, 'when I'm in view
 Sanctified in you before them.
 24 "For I will take you from among

The heathen and gather you strung
 Out from all lands, and I will bring
 You to your own land *and your spring*.

If You have sanctified a folk among
 The heathen and called Israel on the rung,
 Then why do all men share the promises
 Fulfilled at least in populations' fizz?
 The only thing I see the people bear
 In blessing is the keeping of their share
 Of revelation safe and in good care.
 The Tanakh is spread out beneath the glare
 Of infidelity and doubting where
 The ten commandments shine upon their
 heart.
 The people set apart have done their part.
 But I have yet to see how benefit
 Comes to them for having served to save it.
 It's more a liability to sit.

25 "I'll sprinkle clean water on you,
 And you'll be clean from residue
 Of all your filthiness, and from
 All your idols, I'll cleanse in sum.
 26 "A new heart too I'll give to you,
 And a new spirit put in you,
 And I'll take out the stony heart
 Out of you flesh, and with a start
 Give you a heart of flesh as due.
 27 "I'll put My spirit among you
 And make you act according to
 My statutes, and you'll keep my laws
 And do them *ever without pause*.
 28 "And you'll live in the land I gave
 To your ancestors; you'll be brave
 To be My people, and I'll be
 Your Alohim *eternally*.
 29 "I'll save you from your uncleanness,
 And I'll call for the grain and bless,
 Lay no famine on your address.
 30 "I'll multiply your trees in fruit,
 And increase of the fields to boot,
 And you'll have no more in reproach
 Of famine among heathen coach.
 31 "Then you'll mind your own evil ways,
 And your doings and without praise,
 And shall loath yourselves in your sight
 For your iniquities and spite.
 32 "Now for your sake too I act now,"
 Says Lord YHWH, "be known anyhow
 To you, be ashamed and confounded
 For your own ways, O house *unhounded*

Of Israel *before impounded.*”

Most beautiful of promises, I trow,
Is this, and I don’t mean the watered prow,
But that law set on tables of the heart,
In fleshing places and by divine art.
I do not covet lands and fruits to spare,
I do not covet all the worldly share
You promise in a grace piled on the air.
I covet that law set in mind and hand,
And do not have desire for promised land.
Beloved, if You can extend power and
 grace
For heathens also multiplied in space,
Then You can fairly give me too my place
Among the ones whose heart is struck by
 pen
And wrinkled with Your scribbles there
 again.

33 So says the Lord YHWH, “In the day
That I have cleansed you from the sway
Of your iniquities to pay,
I’ll also make you stay to live
In the cities, and the wastes give
To be built up *in the right way*.”

34 “The desert shall be tilled that lay
Desolate in the sight of day
Before all who passed by that way.

35 “And they shall say ‘This desolate
Land has become like Eden’s rate,
And the waste and desert and spoiled
Cities are fortified, gargoyled,
Filled with inhabitants in state.’”

36 “The heathen that are left around
About you shall know I am found
YHWH to build the spoiled and in ground
Plant what was desolate, and I
YHWH spoke and I will do and cry.”

37 So says the Lord YHWH, “I will yet
Be enquired for this thing to set
By Israel’s house, to do for them,
I’ll multiply them in My hem
With men like a flock *of sheep met*.”

38 “As the holy flock, as the flock
Jerusalem in celebration
Of solemn feasts takes in her dock,
So shall the desert towns be filled
With flocks of men, and they unstilled
Shall know I’m YHWH *to give their
 ration.*”

I know that You are YHWH, Beloved,
 indeed,

Though I am one of awful pagan seed,
Descended from the cannibals of yore,
Barbarians that knocked on Roman door,
The pageant of the red man now of fame
Upon the continent of turtle’s claim.

And yet I know that You are YHWH and
 true,

That You build up the spoiled and give the
 crew

A planted place appropriate to eat
The grape or the black current for a treat.
Jerusalem is filled with those who cast
Their days and years in sacred feasts to last.
The flocks disperse in autumn and in spring
And come before the great throne of the
 king.

Ezekiel 37

1 The hand of YHWH was upon me,
And carried me amazingly
By YHWH’s wind and set me down free
In the middle of the valley
Which was full of bones *silently*.

2 He caused me to pass over them
And all around abundant gem
On the surface of valley’s hem,
And it was very dry *pro tem*.

3 And he said to me “Son of man,
Can these bones live here that you scan?”
And I replied then, “O Lord YHWH,
You know what You can plan and do.”

If I had been taken by gust of wind
Into a field of bones after I’d sinned,
And asked if they could live again, I think
I would have scoffed and said no chance to
 wink.

The prophet is a careful man, I see.
After that ride he thought the thing might
 be,
And if You could carry him in the clouds
You might as easily raise up the crowds
To praise and blasphemy once more on
 earth,

After the lack of rains, after the dearth.
Beloved, I know the sampling’s limited
That teaches that a hard blow on the head
Results in death eternal, so instead
I join the prophet to doubt I am led.

4 Again He came to say to me,
“Prophecy on these bones freely,
And say to them, ‘O you dry bones,
Hear the word of YHWH *for your*
groans.”

5 So says the Lord YHWH to these bones,
“See, I will make breath enter you,
And you shall live *and stand in view.*

6 “I’ll lay you sinews in your due,
And I’ll bring up flesh upon you,
And cover you with skin and put
Breath in you to live *hand and foot,*
And you shall know that I am YHWH.”

I am commanded to preach to the birds
That perch upon my windowsill with turds,
And to the shy and flousy beasts that stalk
About the forest paths I come to walk.
Ezekiel’s commanded to tell the dead.
We both have easy rows to hoe unfed.
Most preachers have to face the human
crew

Alive and breathing in the common pew.
That is a challenge I would hate to try
Beneath the threatening of human sky.
Beloved, I thank You that I come to share
The easy task Ezekiel had to bear,
And preach to those who do not answer
back,
Or if they do, it’s just a beak they pack.

7 So I prophesied by command,
And as I prophesied at land,
There was a sound and shaking there,
The bones came together to share,
Each bone came right back to its pair.
8 And as I looked, sinews and flesh
Came up on them and the skin fresh
Covered them from above, but there
Was no breath in them to forbear.

In all the stories I have heard from youth
And childhood in the Iroquoian truth,
The resurrection always seems to come
After the hero shakes a tree in sum.
The clacking branches of the tree perhaps
Awaken all his relatives in caps.
I’ve seen the rate of Palestine and know
Some places trees are rarely in a row.
No doubt You are too merciful and slow
To wrath to deprive them of life to grow
Just for the reason that no trees are there.

So there is resurrection everywhere.
Beloved, I lay hold on the hope that sat
Too hard for Sadducees to come to bat.

9 Then He said to me, “Prophecy
Unto the wind and prophecy,
O son of man, and tell the wind,
‘So says the Lord YHWH to the binned,
‘Come from the four winds, O breath, and
Breathe on these slain to live and stand.’”
10 So I prophesied by command,
And breath came into them and they
Lived and stood on their feet to sway,
A very great army’s array.

Without the wind it is a futile thing
To raise up bones to stand before the king.
The magic of the sun and stars is still,
There is no rustling of a mouse on hill,
As long as wind does not enter the nose,
It is no use the scattered bones arose.
Beloved, I too have seen the battered way
So many bags of bones go in their way
To shop after the job is done a day,
And go home to the TV set in sway.
Beloved, breathe in my nostrils a fine wind
And take me from the place where I have
sinned
To find a glory and a rushing full
Of fire and breath upon the rope I pull.

11 Then He said to me “Son of man,
These bones are the whole house in span
Of Israel, see how they say
‘Our bones are dried and hope’s astray,
We’re cut off each one from the way.’
12 “So prophecy and say to them,
‘So says the Lord YHWH’s stratagem,
“See, O My people, I shall show
Your grave opened and make you go
Up from your graves and bring you to
The land of Israel in view.

This promise that after the resurrection
The bodies are brought back without
selection
To Palestine and to Jerusalem
Has led to hopes astounding to an em.
Some have believed the bodies roll beneath
The soil and water to pop up in wreath
On the last day when You come down to
judge

The living and the dead and pass out fudge.
 Beloved, I really care not for the sake
 Of future resurrection from the lake,
 If You just breathe in me the while to do
 According to the ten commandments true.
 Then I shall raise a voice in single song,
 Or if You will, eternally and long.

13 And you will know that I am YHWH,
 When I've opened your graves for you,
 O my people and brought you out
 Of your graves *with a word and shout*,
 14 And I'll put My spirit in you,
 And you will live and I shall place
 You in your own country and trace,
 Then you shall know that I YHWH spoke
 And did it," says YHWH, "on the stroke."

Who knows what spirit now employs my
 speech
 And limbs and heart and hand to gather
 peach
 And apple and the black current to reach
 The level I've attained to here to preach?
 Be that as may, Beloved, but now I pray
 That if and when Your promise not astray
 Results in resurrection from the grave
 Of my soul's body to rise up Your slave,
 Let me live by Your spirit and not mine,
 Nor by the teaching of another wine
 Poured out unmixed betwixt the earthly
 vine,
 And I'll net no more country to repair
 My living with the modesty I share
 Among the starlings with whom I now
 dine.

15 The word of YHWH came once again
 To me and spoke *there in my den*.
 16 "Now son of man, take you one stick
 And write upon it for a trick:
 'For Judah, and for Israel's folk
 As his companions,' then in stroke
 Take one more still and write on it,
 'For Joseph, stick of Ephraim fit,
 And all the house of Israel
 And his companions *in a spell*.'
 17 "And join them each to each in one,
 They'll be united in hand done.
 18 "And when the children of your folk
 Shall speak to you and say in yoke,
 'Will you not show us what you mean?'

19 "Say to them, 'So says the Lord
 YHWH,
 "See, I shall take the stick *of crew*
 Of Joseph, which is in the hand
 Of Ephraim, and the tribes *stand*
 Of his fellows of Israel,
 And shall put them with him *in spell*,
 Even with Judah's stick *in sway*,
 And make of them one stick, and they
 Shall be one in My hand *to stay*.'"
 20 "And the stick that you write upon
 Shall be in your hand in sight drawn.
 21 "And say to them, 'So says Lord
 YHWH,
 "See, I shall take out Israel's crew
 From among the heathen where they
 Have gone, and shall gather to stay
 On every side, and bring them to
 Their own land *and heritage due*."

The Russian folktale tells the story better
 Than old Ezekiel in Hebraic letter.
 Grandfather tells two brothers who are
 fighting
 To break a stick, which each one then
 alighting
 Can do with ease. And then he takes the
 two
 Sticks in a bundle and lets them anew
 Try in vain to break them: they cannot do.
 So when together men work in a crowd
 They have more strength than just one is
 allowed.
 Beloved, like You, I am one and not three,
 And that is why perhaps men in the spree
 Think I'm an easy target, one to shoot
 Down and crush quickly under weight of
 boot.
 Beloved, join me and we shall raise a hoot.

22 "And I shall make them one folk in
 The land, on Israel's mountains' bin,
 And one king shall be king to all,
 And they'll be no longer in thrall
 As two nations, neither shall they
 Be separated in that way
 Anymore in two kingdoms' sway.
 23 "Neither shall they defile again
 Themselves with idols in their ken,
 Nor with abominations' rise,
 Nor with their transgressions in guise;
 And I shall save them out of where

They have been living in despair,
Where they have sinned, and shall cleanse
them
So they will be My folk in hem
And I will be their Alohim.

Two sticks together will prevent the wail
Of gross idolatry is promise hale.
Three sticks upon a comb one said to me
Was proof enough of lovely Trinity,
For with one stick alone one combs no hair,
But three tines left will make a comb as
rare

The functions to keep toupee well aware.
That was an argument that burst my gale.
Beloved, I thank You that the crowd that
came

At last from the loins of Israelite game
Eschewed idolatry and still their fame
Is now and ever always to proclaim
That You are One and no one shares Your
name.
So much for two sticks and a Russian tale.

24 "David My servant shall be king
Over them, and they'll have one wing
Of shepherd over all of them,
And they'll walk in My judgements way,
Observe My statutes every day.

25 "And they will live in the land that
I've given to Jacob when he sat
As My servant, where your ancestors
Have lived, and they will stay as questers,
They and their children and the spawn
Of their children eternal dawn,
And My servant David shall be
Their ruler for eternity.

26 "I'll make a covenant of peace
Or Islam with them for release,
It shall be an eternal pact
With them, and I will set their act,
And multiply them and will set
My sanctuary where they're met
For ever and ever exact.

27 "My tabernacle is with them,
Indeed I'll be their Alohim,
And they shall be My folk *in cream*.

28 "The heathen will know I am YHWH
To sanctify Israel in crew
When My temple in holiness
Is ever among their address."'''

Beloved, I take in faith eternal king
David to reign in my heart's sacred ring.
I live in the land with my children and
My children's children in a faithful band.
I take hold of Islam, such peace with You
Obeying Your commandments, all ten true.
I enter in Your temple here on earth
Reflection of the heavenly halls of worth,
Build of the sounds of Psalm arising in
The Hebrew verses that we sing in din.
Beloved, I mark Ezekiel's word and know
That David still reigns though I see no
show

Of pageantry, of palace, or of church
But only red of pine and white of birch.

Ezekiel 38

1 The word of YHWH came down to me
And said 2 "Son of man, turn to see
Gog and the land of Magog's spree,
The chief prince of Meshech and more,
Tubal, prophesy at his door.

3 "And say 'So says the Lord YHWH,
"See,

I come against you, O Gog, see,
You chief prince of Meshech and *more*
Of Tubal and *all of their store*.

4 "And I will turn you back and put
Hooks in your jaws, and bring on foot
Out with all your army in band,
Horses and cavalry men's stand,
All of them clothed with every sort
Of armour, a great crowd in sport
With bucklers and with shields and all
Armed with their swords to kill *in stall*.

5 "Persia, Ethiopia, and Libya
With them, all of them *still in awe*
With shield and helmet *for the draw*.

6 "Gomer and all his bands, the house
Of Togarmah with northern spouse,
And all his bands, and crowds in thrall.

7 "So be prepared and ready, you
And all your companies in crew
And be a guard and keep in view.

The simple name of one of Japheth's sons
After the centuries of wicked runs
Becomes the title of a folk in store,
A king of evil weight and northern bore.
And yet the wanderer upon the earth,
No matter how far he goes from his berth
Toward the north and east to find the fame,

Finds nothing left of Gog and Magog's
claim.
Assyrian raiders with their northern crew
I guess were meant in Ezekiel's view.
Beloved, I find the two-horned past and
hope
Within my own heart and two ways to
cope,
One moving mountains and one blocking
all
The hordes of the invasion on my stall.

8 "After a long time you'll be head,
In later years you will be led
Into that land brought back from sword,
Gathered from many peoples' ward,
Against the mountains of the folk
Of Israel laid waste in stroke,
But brought forth out of all the lands
To stay in safety, all their bands.
9 "You'll go up coming like a storm,
Like a cloud covering the land warm,
You and all your companies round
And many people on your ground."

The return from great Babylon is meant
Perhaps, or then the later coming sent
From every part of earth and city lent
To built again Jerusalem and stay
In Canaan's land and so there to bear sway.
A long time indeed has passed and I say
I find the Jewish state is here today.
But unless Antiochus is named Gog,
I do not yet find the accomplished cog.
The future waits with rushing and with fire
For the accomplishment of all things dire.
But let the heathen church take warning
now
That You, Beloved, are not here to allow
The trampling on Your law written on
brow.

10 "So says the Lord YHWH, "On that day
It will also happen to stay,
At the same time things come to mind,
And evil thought will come to bind.
11 "You'll say 'I shall go to the land
Of open villages to stand,
I'll go to them at rest in peace,
All living without walls to cease,
With neither bars nor gates in bands.'
12 "To take the plunder and the spoil,

To turn your hand upon the soil
Of desolation where now live
The people gathered from the sieve
Of nations, who have cattle and
Goods, that are living upon the land.
13 "Sheba, Dedan, merchants that scan
Tarshish, with all young lions' span,
Will ask you, 'Have you come to take
The spoil, did you come for the sake
Of taking prey, to bear away
Silver and gold, to take as may
Much cattle and goods as by plan?'"

Though these words are ambiguous to write
And hard to understand without the light
Of history and a fulfilling might,
It seems to me that future things to come
Are meant by prophet in his rantings' sum.
Being that's so, then those who think the
church
Has replaced Your folk once left in the
lurch
Are simply wrong. And I bring argument
That church is not replacement of the sent
In the fact that the church has never been
Strong to preserve Your commandments
from sin.
Instead she tramples on the divine law,
Keeps neither God nor Sabbath in her awe,
But only status quo and strength of claw.

14 "So son of man, go prophesy
To God, 'So says the Lord YHWH nigh,
'In that day when My folk and blessed
Of Israel stay safe at rest,
Will you not know *as though confessed*?
15 "And you will come from your place out
Of the far north, you without doubt
And many people with you, all
Riding on horses, a full stall,
And an army of might and stout.
16 "And you will come against My folk
Of Israel like a cloud in stroke
To cover up the land like oak.
So in the latter days I'll bring
You against My own land and spring,
So that the nations may know Me,
When I am sacred in your plea,
O Gog, before their eyes to see."
17 "So says the Lord YHWH, "Are you he
Of whom I've spoken long ago
By My servants in prophecy

In Israel, who spoke in show
 In those days many years ago
 That I would bring you to attack?
 18 "And it shall happen and not slack
 At the same time when Gog comes back
 Against the land of Israel,"
 Says the Lord YHWH, "My fury's spell
 Will show My face *and not My back*.
 19 "For in My jealousy and fire
 Of My wrath I have spoken dire,
 'Indeed in that day there will be
 A great commotion on the lee
 Of Israel. 20 "So that the fishes of the sea
 And the birds of the sky, the beast
 Of the field and creeping things least
 That creep upon the earth, and all
 The men upon the earthly ball,
 Will tremble at My presence, and
 The mountains be thrown down in band
 And the steep places come to fall
 Upon the ground with every wall.'
 21 "I'll call for a sword against Gog,"
 Says the Lord YHWH, "and all agog
 Each man's sword shall be drawn for gall.
 22 "And I will judge him with the plague
 And with blood, and will rain in ague,
 And great hailstones, fire and brimstone.
 23 "So I shall magnify My throne
 And sanctify Myself, and I
 Will be known in each nation's eye,
 And they will know that I am YHWH.""

The man of sin who magnifies his throne
 Against Your Sabbath and against the stone
 Of ten commandments You will meet alone
 With great destruction, fire and sulphurous
 heat,
 With hail and blood upon both head and
 feet.
 Beloved, raise a sword against Magog now,
 Wherever he may be, and raise a row
 Against God for opposing of Your law,
 For scratching Israel with a bloody claw.
 Beloved, come magnify Your throne above
 All nations in the marketplace and shove
 Of military intervention's glove,
 And I shall see You once more sanctified
 Above the relicts of both sin and pride.

Ezekiel 39

1 So, son of man, speak against Gog
 In prophecy and lay the smog:

"So says the Lord YHWH, 'See now, I
 Come against you, O Gog, with cry
 Against the prince of Rosh, Meshech
 And Tubal *for a pound and peck*.
 2 "And I shall turn you back and leave
 Only a sixth of you to cleave,
 And shall cause you to come up from
 The northern places, bring in sum
 To Israel's mountains *to bereave*.
 3 "I'll knock the bow from your left hand,
 Make fall your arrows where you stand
 From your right hand, *faint to receive*.

The truth is no one knows today at all
 Who Rosh is sitting on the northern wall,
 Or even who Gog and Magog in sprawl
 Include among the nations still in thrall.
 The thought that Rosh is Russia is too
 quaint

For me today or any kind of saint,
 And that the ten lost tribes of Israel glow
 Beneath its wings is too ludicrous show.
 But if the words of prophet and of fane
 From ancient times bear nothing now but
 vain

In speculations, still the melody
 Of Hebrew words continues to feed me.
 The bow has no doubt long been knocked
 off free,
 The arrows long since ended sudden pain.

4 "You'll fall on Israel's mountains, you
 And all your bands and people too,
 I'll give you to the hungry fowl
 Of every kind, and to the growl
 Of wild beasts to be put in jowl.
 5 "You'll fall upon the open view,
 For I've spoken," says the Lord YHWH.
 6 "I shall send a fire on Magog,
 Among them without care and shod
 Among the islands, and they'll know
 That I am YHWH, and it is so.
 7 "I'll make My holy name be known
 Among My people Israel lone,
 And I'll not let them profane My
 Holy name more *under the sky*:
 The heathen shall know I am YHWH,
 The Holy One of Israel's crew.

Some think You make Your holy name
 known best

By sacred name movements come in the
quest
Of Russelites and others You know best.
Such quaint conceits arise because a land
Is destitute of native tongue at hand
And has a lingua franca come to stand
In market and in business bill and band.
Because Americans have lost the touch
Of native language, they come to make
much
Of sounds exotic taken from the stall
Of Hebrew and of Greek over in call.
If they just cantillated of Your word
In Hebrew, then their own hearts would be
stirred
Without the need of barked at and the
purred.

8 "See how it comes and will be done,"
Says the Lord YHWH; "this day begun
Of which I've spoken *in the sun*.
9 "Inhabitants of Israel's towns
Will go out and set fire like crowns
And burn the weapons, shield and armour,
With bows and arrows, and from farmer
The hand staves and the pikes as well,
Burn seven years with fires *of hell*.
10 "They'll not bring wood out of the field
Nor cut down wood of forest yield,
But burn their weapons with the fire,
And spoil those that spoiled their desire,
And rob those that robbed them," replies
The Lord YHWH *of the earth and skies*.
11 "And it will happen in that day,
I'll give to Gog a place to stay
There in the graves of Israel,
One valley of travellers in well
On the east of the sea; and it
Will stop the passengers with fit,
And they will bury Gog and all
His multitudes of folk in thrall,
And they'll call the name of the place
The valley of Gog's crowd in trace.
12 "And seven months shall Israel's house
Be burying them like a mouse,
So they might clear the land *and dows*.
13 "Yes, all the people of the land
Will bury them, and come to stand
In fame that day I'm glorified,"
Says the Lord YHWH *and to abide*.
14 "They'll choose out men to go about
The land full-time in travelling scout

To burying those that still remain
Upon the surface of demesne
To clear it; at seven months' end
They'll search them out in dividend.
15 "The searchers will pass through the
land,
And when they see a bone at hand
Of any human, then will he
Set a mark by it so to see,
Till those who bury come and take
It to the valley for the sake
Of Gog's great crowd and company.

If I were buried in the shadow of
Jerusalem the city that I love,
Even though I'm a Gentile just like Gog
And Magog, I should joy in peaceful cog.
I'd wait the coming of the reign of power,
The Messianic day and judgement hour,
Where law and justice meet with mercy's
kiss.
I'd lie me in a grave in perfect bliss.
But I am like to lie instead along
With my own northern ancestors in song,
Beside the lakeshore, by the birch and
strong
Pines wakened from the winters cold and
long.
But whether in the sunny city's arms
Or on the tundra, I'll sleep without harms.

16 "The city's name shall be Hamonah.
So they will clear the land of boner.
17 "And you, son of man," so has said
The Lord YHWH, 'speak to every spread
Fowl and to ever beast of field,
"Gather together for the yield,
Come from all directions so you
May eat the flesh, and drink blood too.
18 "You'll eat flesh of the mighty men,
And drink blood of princes again
Of the earth, of rams and of lambs,
And of goats and bullocks, all shams
Of the fatted of Bashan's slams.
19 "You'll eat the fat till you are full,
And drink the blood till drunk like bull
Of sacrifice that I have slain
On your behalf *and for your pain*.
20 "You'll be satisfied at My feast
With horse and chariot increased
With might men and with all men
Of war," says the Lord YHWH again.

21 "And I'll set My glory among
The heathen and all them unsung
Will see My judgement that I've brought,
And My hand that I've laid on lot.
22 "So the house of Israel shall know
That I am YHWH their God to go
From that day forward in the show.

Who knows what that great glory is You
set

As sign to Israel as well as net
To all the heathen in judgement to get?
Each one may tender what he will before
That glory shines affirming in its store.
I think myself, Beloved, it is the Psalms
Left empty and bereft among the palms,
That shall be one day restored without
qualms,

A temple and a tabernacle built
Of human voices and the quiet lilt
Of angels singing David's lays again
In hearing of both heathen and of men.
Beloved, until that restoration day
I sing the Psalms of David without pay.

23 "And so the heathen then shall know
That Israel's house was never slow
To go into captivity
For all of their iniquity;
Because they trespassed against Me,
So I hid My face not to see,
And gave them over in the hand
Of their foes to fall at sword's band.
24 "According to their uncleanness
And by the transgressions' address
I've dealt with them to hide My face.""

25 "That's why so says the Lord YHWH,
'Now

I shall bring back captives somehow
Of Jacob, and have mercy on
All the house of Israel in spawn;
And I shall be jealous about
My holy name *before the rout*.

26 "After that they have borne their shame,
And all their transgressions of fame
By which they have trespassed on Me,
When they lived in land of safety,
And no one made them fear to be.

27 "When I've brought them back from the
folk

And gathered them from their foes' yoke,
And I've been sanctified in them

Before many nations in gem,
28 "Then they will know that I am YHWH
Their Alohim, who made them do
In captive state among the crew
Of heathen, but I've gathered them
Into their own land and its hem
And left none outside of My view.
29 "Neither shall I hide My face then
Any longer from them again,
For I've poured out My spirit on
Israel's house," says the Lord YHWH
drawn."

It makes no sense to blame the Jewish mate
For punishment he thinks is his own fate,
And at the same time fail to keep the law
By which that punishment acquired its
claw.

The one who would despise Rabbi
For failing to keep Your law on the sly,
And then fail himself of the Sabbath Day,
And worship pagan trinities at bay,
Is a colossal hypocrite, I say.
Beloved, keep me from that beam in the
eye,

And from the eager grasping of the sty.
Then I shall cantillate Your law until
The gleaming of Your glory on the hill,
The reconciling of the words made still.

Ezekiel 40

1 In the twenty-fifth year that we
Abode in our captivity,
At the start of the year, upon
The tenth day of the month to dawn,
In the fourteenth year after that
The city was attacked out flat,
That very day the hand of YHWH
Was on me and brought me in view.
2 In great visions He brought me in
The land of Israel to win,
Setting me high upon a hill,
By which was framed the city still
Toward the southward *argentine*.

3 He brought me there and see, a man,
Appearing like a brazen pan,
Having a line of flax in hand,
A reed to measure, and to stand
In the gate *which he kept and manned*.
4 The man said to me, "Son of man,
See with your eyes, hear with your ears,
And set your heart upon the gears

That I shall show you, for my plan
To bring you here was to that end,
And publish all you see, commend
To Israel's house of all you scan."

After the vision of deliverance
From Gog and Magog I now come to dance
About the views of city and the street
That leads into the temple, leads my feet
Along the streams of silver sands to greet
The glories of Your spires in drink and
meat.

Beloved, I look out from the stricken hills
Toward Jerusalem where the sun fills
The morning at my back, and stage ascent
From Kidron to the place without relent.
I tremble and anticipate the score
Of sounds to rush upon me from the door
Still fastened by the miracle of hope:
I merely pause to raise my telescope.

5 See there was a wall outside there
Around the house, and in the care
Of the man was a measuring reed
Of six arm lengths and a span's need;
So he measured the width one reed,
And the height of the house, one reed.

6 He came to the gate toward the east
And went up the stairs there *unpieced*,
Measured the threshold of the gate,
One reed broad, and the other mate
One reed across *and to relate*.

7 Each gate chamber was one reed long,
And one reed wide, between along
The little rooms were five arm lengths,
And the threshold of the gate strengths
By the porch of the gate within
Was one reed in measure *to win*.

8 He also measured out the porch
Of inner gate, one reed *to scorch*.

9 Then he measured the gate porch too,
Eight arm lengths, and its posts in view,
Two arm lengths, and the gate porch stood
Inward. 10 And the little rooms that
Were in the gate eastward there sat
Three on this side and three on that,
All three were the same size for good,
The posts were equal as they should.

11 He measured the width of the gate
At going in, ten arm length's rate,
And the length of the gate thirteen
Arm lengths. 12 The space also between

In front of the small chambers clean
One arm length, so to on the other
Side, and the small chambers like brother
Were six arm lengths on every side.

13 He measured the gate to abide
From the roof of one little room
To the roof of another loom,
The width was twenty-five arm lengths,
Door facing door *sure of their strengths*.
14 He also made posts of threescore
Or sixty arm length set in store,
To the post of the court around
About the gate *so safe and sound*.

I measure with my eye the eastern gate.
I see the grey domes of Al-Aqsa wait
The coming of the folk to noon-tide prayer,
And know the reed is busy for its share.
I measure out the reed length where I lay
My own prostration on the marbled way,
And sit a while to hear the teaching met
Among the pillars where the children get
Instruction from the turbaned and the wise.
I move among worshipers in disguise:
A man with thinning hair and a grey beard,
I do not strike beholders as one weird.
When I have done my prayers I leave the
house
To find the western gate and regain spouse.

15 From before the entrance gate to
The front of the porch inner view
Of gate were fifty arm lengths too.
16 And there were barred windows in sight
Of the little chambers as right,
And to their posts within the gate
Around about, likewise in state
To the arches, and windows round
And inward, and on each post bound
Were palm trees graced in fronds around.
17 He brought me to the outward court,
And see the chambers there in sort,
And paving made for the court round,
Thirty rooms were upon the ground.
18 The pavement by the side of gates
Over against the length of gates
Was lower in paving's estates.
19 Then he measured the width before
The lower gate unto the fore
Of the inner court and without,
A hundred arm lengths eastward out
And northward *coming to the store*.

The inner court from where I stood one day
 Held Aqsa and the golden dome at bay,
 And offered in a sunken sort of way
 A place for the ablutions of the crew.
 The startled guard called down to tell me
 how
 To wash my forearms dripping from my
 brow
 Instead of downward as I thought my treat.
 I shouted up to him in his defeat
 Not to worry since I followed the style
 Of Shi'ites in the washing of my guile.
 The fifty men about froze in their cracks,
 The guard in shock turned to look from
 their backs,
 And then gave me the smile and go-ahead
 To pray in the delight of marble spread.

20 And the gate of the outward court
 Facing the north, measured for sport
 In length and width, and so he did.
 21 The little chambers were not hid,
 Three on this side and three on that,
 Their posts and arches after sat
 In the measure of the first gate,
 Its length was fifty arm length's rate,
 Its width twenty-five more to state.
 22 Their windows, arches, palm trees too,
 Were after the measure in view
 Of the gate that faces the east:
 They went up to it by *at least*
 Seven steps; the arches in front.

The earthly temple is a thing of stone,
 But that palace of Ezekiel alone
 Was never build except in vision rare
 And it the cantillations of the air.
 The tabernacle fallen from the share
 Of David, who was not aloud to lift
 The cedar walls and gold, but had to shift
 With walls invisible of heavenly hue,
 The spires of song and notion up to You,
 Turns out to be eternal, though the sound
 Within a moment disappears from bound.
 Beloved, I leave the great halls and retire
 Within the little chambers of desire
 And there I find eternity on fire.

23 The inner court gate stood across
 From the gate to the northward toss,
 And toward the east; and he paced off

From gate to gate a hundred prof.
 24 After that he brought me back to
 The south, and see a south gate's view,
 And measured its posts as well
 As the arches of it a spell.
 25 And there were windows in it and
 In its arches around to stand
 Like those windows before it and
 The length was fifty arm lengths and
 The width twenty-five arm lengths *grand*.
 26 There were seven steps to go up
 To it, and the arches like cup
 Were there in front of them, and it
 Had palm trees one on this side fit,
 Another on the other side
 Upon its posts there to abide.

Upon the south today Al-Aqsa sits,
 While enter its seven steps with wits
 About me for the reign of terror flits
 In lightness of the rifles at the gate,
 The hanging bodies where the memories
 wait.

Upon the south tomorrow who can know
 What greater visions enter on the show
 Despite the guards, policemen on the go,
 The hopeless, helpless watching of the
 found
 Who beg a penny on the sacred ground.
 I touch a mother dressed in black with eye
 Of Sabbath passing here beneath the sky
 That still waits for David to raise a cry.
 The swallows twitter as voices resound.

27 A gate was in the inner court
 Toward the south, and he for sport
 Measured from gate to gate toward
 The south a hundred arm lengths *floored*.
 28 He brought me to the inner court
 By the south gate, and stood to take
 The measure of the south gate's wake
 According to these lengths' report.
 29 Its little chambers and its posts,
 And its arches by these lengths' host,
 And there were windows in it too,
 And in the arches round in view,
 Fifty arm lengths in length and yet
 Twenty-five arm length in width set.
 30 And the arches made round about
 Were twenty-five arm lengths and stout,
 And five arm lengths in width *and spout*.
 31 Its archways faced the outer court,

With palm trees on its posts *for sport*,
 Ascending by eight steps' *support*.
 32 He brought me to the inner court
 Towards the east, measured the gate
 According to these measures' rate.
 33 Its little rooms, its posts and yet
 Its arches by their measures set,
 And there were windows there and in
 The arches all around within,
 Fifty arm lengths in length and still
 Twenty-five arm lengths broad to fill.
 34 Its arches faced the outward court,
 And palm trees on its posts resort,
 On this side and on that side too,
 Ascending by eight steps *in view*.

Beneath the fifty arm lengths of the ground
 Of Ali's garden with the palms around
 I wander square to square and touch the
 green
 With sweetness of the things that I have
 seen.
 The springs burst forth to fill the pool and
 show
 The way to light and faith that I must go.
 The while I hear the supplications rise
 From throats of Shi'ite faithful in disguise.
 Beloved the arches of the date plans near
 My heart go out beyond the fifty here
 Into the inner sanctuary's fold,
 Out of the heat into the hidden gold.
 The winders of my temple far from sight
 Open toward eternity in light.

35 And he brought me to the north gate,
 And measured by these measures' rate:
 36 Its little rooms, its posts and more,
 Its arches and windows in store,
 In length fifty arm lengths to rise,
 And twenty-five arm lengths in guise
 Of width. 37 And its posts faced the court
 Toward the outside in transport
 Of palm trees on its posts on both
 This side and that as though in growth,
 Ascending by eight steps' comport.
 38 Its rooms and entryways were by
 The posts of the gates to comply
 With washing of burnt offerings' sort.

The north is safe at last after the siege,
 After the slaughter of Magog and liege,
 After the passing of the age to bear

The chills of my idolatry and glare
 Into forgetfulness of divine claim,
 Beyond the brightness of the living flame.
 The north is safe at last, though silence
 there
 Remains upon the forest and the lake.
 There is no prayer set even for the sake
 Of You, Beloved, the quietness in wake
 Broods but eternity without a cloud,
 No storm at all forever is allowed.
 I skip from stone to stone shot from Your
 heart,
 And disappear here where the ripples start.

39 In the porch of the gate were two
 Tables on this side and yet two
 Tables on that side where to slay
 The burnt offerings at time to pray,
 And sin offering, trespasses too.
 40 On the outside as one goes up
 To the north gate in entry's cup,
 There were two tables, and upon
 The other hand, the gate porch drawn
 There were two tables *as to sup*.
 41 Four tables on this side and four
 Tables on that side to make more,
 By the side of the gate makes eight
 Tables in all for slaughter's rate.
 42 Four tables of faced stone stood there
 For the burnt offering, each a stair
 Of one and one-half arm lengths' share,
 And in width the same as length's care,
 And one arm length high, whereupon
 They laid the tools of death when drawn
 To slay burnt offering, sacrifice.
 43 Inside were hooks to take a slice,
 A handbreadth wide and fastened round,
 And on the tables there was found
 The flesh of the offering *unbound*.

Provision for the flesh is always made
 By humankind set out in the parade
 Of faith and marketry among the staid
 As well as among savage nations laid.
 Provision for the flesh is set to ride
 Upon the stony tables at the side,
 And there the blood drips down at last to
 guide

The runaway in earthen ditches' hide.
 Beloved, I too provide for flesh to wait
 Upon the marble altars at Your gate,

And touch the bloody mess and see it
 quiver
 Under the dead weight of my iron sliver.
 The caldron's ready for the chunks of meat
 To cook a temonosful of priests' treat.

44 Outside the inner gate were rooms
 Of singers in the inner *blooms*
Of the court, which was at the side
 Of the north gate, and so their ride
 Was toward the south, one at the side
 Of the east gate and facing toward
 The north *and not the sunny sward*.

45 And he said to me, "This room here,
 Which faces toward the southern tier,
 Is for the priest and those who keep
 Charge of the house *and not to sleep*.

46 "The room that faces southward is
 For the priests and keepers whose biz
 Is charge of the altar; these are
 The sons of Zadok *for a star*,
 From Levi's sons, those who come near
 To YHWH to serve Him *without fear*."

47 He measured of the court and it
 Was one hundred arm lengths long fit,
 A hundred arm lengths wide, foursquare;
 Altar in front of the house there.

48 He brought me to the temple porch,
 And measured each post of the porch,
 Five arm lengths on this side and five
 Arm lengths on the other contrive,
 And the width of the gate was three
 Arm lengths on this side and yet three
 Arm lengths on the other degree.

49 The length of the porch was twenty
 Arm lengths and the width came to be
 Eleven arm lengths: he brought me
 By the steps going up to see:
 And there were pillars by the posts,
 One on this side and in their boasts
 One on the other referee.

A square, an altar, post and pillar find
 Me turning to You, my Beloved, as blind
 As incense, smoke of holocaust unwined
 To lift me in the supplications' rind.
 A hundred arm lengths make a lofty quire
 Where angels twitter on the eastern pyre,
 And all the white-clad pilgrims ambulate
 About the altar in a fitting state.
 Beloved, watch out for pick-pockets come
 late

Into the temenos to take their rate!
 Your wealth of universe will fail before
 The robbers and the poor even the score.
 Keep eye before and left shoulder on guard,
 But do not leave Your purse unlocked,
 unbarred!

Ezekiel 41

1 He brought me to the temple then,
 And measured the posts and again
 They were six arm lengths wide on each
 Side, the width of the temple's reach.

2 The width of the door came to ten
 Arm lengths, and the door sides again
 Five arm lengths on each side; and he
 Measured the length of its degree
 To forty arm lengths, half as wide
 At twenty arm lengths on a side.

3 Then he went inside and set rule
 To measure the doorpost *with tool*:
 Two arm lengths, and the door at six
 Arm lengths, and the width *not to mix*
 Of the door seven arm lengths fix.

4 He measured the length in arm lengths
 To twenty, and the width for strengths
 To twenty arm lengths there before
 The temple. And he said what's more
 To me, "This is most holy *store*."

You bring me to the temple, yes, indeed,
 Beloved, while I relinquish every creed.
 I lay the heathen store of faith aside
 And rush into the bracing renewed tide.
 The living temple that springs up upon
 The cantillation of the Psalms at dawn
 Is ever new: no crumbling stones repair
 The citadel that floats upon the air.
 You bring me to the temple and I find
 The drought of nectar sweeter than the
 wined

Bath of the Roman still. Your bring me
 where

The Hebrew syllables refresh from care
 And beyond arm lengths measured against
 rain

The tent of David rises up again.

5 He measured the wall of the house,
 Six arm lengths, and the width to dowse
 The side room, four arm lengths around
 The house on every side *that's found*.

6 The side rooms were three over each,

And thirty in order to reach,
 And they entered into the wall
 Which was of the house for the stall
 Of side room round about it all,
 So they would stand, but they did not
 Touch the wall of the temple slot.
 7 And going up by winding stairs
 To the side rooms and all their lairs,
 For it when winding all about
 And upward round and round and out,
 Increasing as it went from low
 To highest room around and slow.
 8 I also saw how high the house
 Rose round about, foundations' dowse
 From the side rooms were a full reed
 Of six great arm lengths, high indeed.
 9 The thickness of the wall that stood
 For the side chamber as it should
 Without was five arm lengths and what
 Was left was the place of room shut
 At the side, inner rooms for good.
 10 Between the chambers was a space
 Of twenty arm lengths round the trace
 Of temple on each side and face.
 11 The doors of the side rooms then faced
 The place of prayer, one door was braced
 Toward the north, another toward
 The south, and what was left and floored
 Was five arm lengths around *and scored*.

Is there no side room in Your house of love
 Where I may stand to take the measure of
 The shoes the worshippers hand in for
 glove?

I brave the wail of morning for the chance
 To guard the shoes of those who join the
 dance

Of prayer in Your prostration in advance.
 Give me a little room, Beloved, where I
 May keep the slippers worshippers are shy
 To leave in care of one without a place.
 Beloved, give me a room before Your face.
 While great ones and the careful of the race
 Hasten to prayer when the cry sounds the
 grace,

I linger at my task, and then I pray
 When all the other men have gone away.

12 The house in front of separate way
 At the end toward the western ray
 Was seventy arm lengths wide *to stay*,
 And the wall of the building reached

Five arm lengths thick around *unbreached*,
 And ninety arm lengths long *in dray*.
 13 He measured the temple to be
 A hundred arm lengths long to see,
 The separating court and stoop
 With its walls a hundred in coop.
 14 The width of the front of the house,
 And separate courtyard to espouse
 Toward the east, a hundred due
 Arm lengths *and before all the view*.
 15 He measured the length of the house
 Opposite the court to divide
 Behind it, and galleries' blouse
 On both sides a hundred arm lengths;
 And inner temple for its strengths,
 And porches of the court beside.
 16 The thresholds and barred windows too,
 And galleries around in view
 Of their three stories by the door,
 Ceiled with wood round about in store,
 And from the ground to window-shape,
 The windows were covered to drape,
 17 And even to the inner place
 And all around outside the space
 Within and out by measured trace.

Take note, Beloved, the threshold's
 counted by
 The man angelic who with reed for why
 Remains to measure everything on earth
 To see if anything's of heaven's birth.
 Three stories in the temple and the ark
 Of Noah raise them both above the park,
 And yet within the range of storm and dark.
 Beloved, I too take note of threshold bare,
 And lay my head upon it as to wear
 The foot of wondered Ali where I bow
 In my prostration here upon my brow.
 The leisure at the threshold's where I take
 My sacrifice of head and heart to make
 My pilgrimage before my sacred vow.

18 And it was made with cherubim
 And palm trees, so that a palm's rim
 Was between cherub and another,
 And each cherub face had its brother,
 19 So the face of a man was turned
 Toward the palm tree it discerned,
 And the face of a lion stayed
 Toward the palm tree on parade
 Against the other side waylaid:
 And so it was through all the way

And round the house in every stay.
20 From the ground to above the door
Were cherubim and palms in store,
And on the temple wall some more.

The cherubim are countless and displayed
From Eden to the temple unafraid
Of good Ezekiel, as were on parade
In desert tent and Solomon's fair glade.
The cherubim are winged, I guess, and
come

With a gazelle-like shadow and a hum.
The breath of Babylon and Persia wafts
The air where cherub idol comes to shafts
Of the iconoclastic fathers' wrath.
I turn for refuge in untrodden path.
Beloved, this is a vision of the right,
And needs no sop of frightened to the
might

Of pagan deities. Why then do You
Call cherubim and such-like into view?

21 The posts of the temple were squared,
The front of the temple as paired,
In like fashion *and so declared*.

22 The wooden altar rose to three
Arm lengths in height, and so to be
The length of it two arm lengths and
Its corners, length and walls to stand
Were made of wood. He said to me,
"This is the table of decree
Set before YHWH *and there to be.*"

23 The temple and the sanctuary
Had two doors *entering and chary*.

24 The doors had two leaves each as two
Turning leaves, two for one door too,
And two leaves for the other's view.

25 Cherubim and palms were carved there
On the doors of the temple fair,
Like those made on the walls to share,
And there were thick planks on the face
Of the porch outside *on the trace*.

26 And there were barred windows and
palms

On the one side *and without qualms*
On the other side and beyond
On the sides of the porch *in frond*,
And on the side rooms of the house,
And planks there too thick *for a mouse*.

The posts of the temple were squared
perhaps

To form a contrast with Egyptian lapse
Of monolatrous faith, the Grecian burn
That crowns acropolis still out to earn.
The square posts flaunt the pillars and the
lust

Of every heathen form of faith and trust,
And call the folk to prayer to bow in dust
Before Your throne, Beloved, and all men
must.

Beloved, the planks are thick, too hard to
cut

With iron tool though sharpened in the rut,
And so they square forever and anon
As evening turns to darkness and to dawn,
Until the walls that glisten there in gold
Have turned to powder, lost, bartered and
sold.

Ezekiel 42

1 He brought me to the outer court,
The way toward the north's resort,
He brought me to the chamber that
Was opposite divided vat,
Opposite the northern house flat.

2 Facing the length of hundred store
Of arm lengths was the northern door,
And the width fifty arm lengths more.

3 Opposite the inner court of
Twenty, and opposite above
The pavement of the outer court,
There was a gallery in sort
Joined to galleries there in three.

4 In front of the chambers inside
Was a walk of ten arm lengths wide,
A path of one arm length and their
Doors faced toward the northern share.

5 The upper rooms were shorter, for
The galleries had higher store
Than these, than the lower and more
Than the temple's middlemost floor.

6 For they were in three levels and
Did not have pillars there to stand
As the pillars in the courts' hand.
That's why they stuck out from band
Of lowest and middlemost floor.

7 The outside wall against the rooms
Toward the outer court in glooms
Of the front part of chambered rooms
Was fifty arm lengths long *in store*.

When Moses built the tabernacle tent
In the desert where all of Israel went,

He did all by the pattern that was sent
Down on him from the sky upon the mount.
The heavenly pattern was a gloried fount,
Despite the fact the colours that he used
Were those still to be found by those who
cruised

The temple furnishings of Egypt's rused.
The earth is just reflection of divine,
And even idol-worship and with wine
Has some remaining echo of the true,
The heavenly, the beautiful in view,
The good against the evil in its rate,
The free against apostasy and State.

8 The chambers toward the outer court
Were fifty arm lengths in report,
While the temple held hundred's score.
9 From under these rooms was the way
To go in from the eastern ray,
As one enters outer court's sway.
10 The rooms were in the wall thickness
Of the court toward eastern address,
Opposite the divided place,
Opposite the building in trace.
11 The path in front of them was like
That of the chambers toward the strike
Of the north, just as long as those,
And just as wide, and all that goes
From both were of a kind, and they
Were according to their doors' sway.
12 It was the same for chamber doors
Toward the south, for all their chores
There was a door to start the path,
The way in front of aftermath
Toward the east in entrance stores.
13 Then he said to me "The north rooms
And the south rooms around which blooms
The place divided, they are rooms
Of holiness, where the priests that
Approach YHWH shall eat of the fat
Of holy things, there they shall lay
The most holy of things in sway,
The meal offering, and sin offering,
The trespass offering, all to bring
To the place every holy thing.
14 "When the priests go in there, then they
Shall not go out of holy way
Into the outer court, but there
They shall lay their clothing just where
They serve, for they are holy too,
And shall put on others in due,
And shall approach the people's crew."

Though I am not a priest except in hope
Of what John said against bishop and pope,
That every one believing has a rope
Of priesthood and a kingly sort of cope,
I enter in the heavenly chamber where
You lay for me a table and not bare.
I taste the succulence of manna there
And sip the nectars of the blossoms where
Celestial breezes tint the spreading scope.
Beloved, as I eat of the priestly share
Of meat and treat I take off what I wear
Of profane garments not to interlope,
And clad me in the linen white and fair
And join in the moving kaleidoscope.

15 And when he'd finished measuring
The inner house, he brought my wing
Out toward the gate that faced the east
And measured it around increased.
16 He measured the east side with that
Reed of measure, five hundred flat
Reeds, with the measure reed in slat.
17 He measured the north side again,
Five hundred reeds, with reed of men
For measuring around *the bat*.
18 He measured the south side again,
Five hundred reed for living men,
With the reed of measure *from den*.
19 He turned about to the west side,
Measured five hundred reeds to bide
With the reed of measure *untied*.
20 He measured it by the four sides,
It had a wall around that hides,
Five hundred long, five hundred wide,
To separate between and hide
The sanctuary from profane,
And keep the holy from the vain.

I am accustomed, my Beloved, to go
A-whirling round the temple lots as slow
As evening touches morning with the glow.
But here Ezekiel bends first to the east,
No problem with the starting in the least,
Nor with his stepping lightly on the ground
Toward the northern summits to be found.
But when he takes the south before the
west,
I wonder at his dance-step at its best,
And stumble where I had already made
The western haunt my next in escapade.

The zigzag course the prophet comes to
make
Is something new, I think, and yet I take
The wine and raisin with the rising cake.

Ezekiel 43

1 And then he brought me to the gate,
The gate facing the eastern wait.
2 See how Israel's Alohim's glory
Came from the way commendatory
Of the east, and His voice was like
The sound of many waters' strike,
And all the earth shone with His glory.

The dance Ezekiel made across the floor
Of temple court to reach the western shore
Was zigzag, true enough, but now I find
That he is brought back without thought or
mind

Into the eastern gate. And yet the path
Of the return is not described in math.
Did he return upon the zigzag trail,
Or did he take a course and not to fail
Around the southern rim, or yet indeed
Around the northern rim to meet his need.
Two more alternative enter to say
He might have gone straight through the
temple way,
Or flown above it straight upon a ray
To find the better part of fading day.

3 It was just like the vision I
Saw when He came up to destroy
The city, like the vision I
Had seen by the river Chebar;
And I fell on my face a-mar.
4 The glory of YHWH came into
The temple by the way and view
Of the gate facing toward the east.
5 The spirit caught me up released
And brought me to the inner court;
And see YHWH's glory in resort
To fill the temple *and increased*.
6 I hear Him speaking then to me
Out of the great sanctuary;
And the man stayed standing by me.

What did I say? The wind came up and
took
The prophet from his solitary nook
And carried him aloft and set him down
Upon the inner court above the town.

Beloved, let me too fly upon the wind
Above the solitary bagged and binned,
And let me find the inner temple filled
After my day and night work at last thrilled
By all the glory of the heavenly place,
The shining of Shekinah on the face
Of gold and marbled walls within the trace
Of inner chamber marked by divine grace.
Beloved, let fly and lie beneath the cloud
Of pigeons rising from the burst allowed.

7 And He said to me, "Son of man,
The place of My throne and the span
Of the soles of my feet, where I
Will stay among the children nigh
Of Israel for ever, and
My holy name shall Israel's band
No more defile, neither shall they,
Nor their kings, by their whoredom's sway,
Nor by the kings' corpses that lie
Upon their sanctuaries high.
8 "By setting their threshold by Mine,
And their post by My posts divine,
And the wall between Me and them,
They have defiled My holy name
By their abominations' claim
That they've committed; therefore I
Consume them in My wrath hereby.
9 "Now let them put their whoredom off,
The carcasses of kings to scoff,
Far from Me, and I'll come to dwell
With them for ever *and a spell*.
10 "You son of man, let Israel see
The temple, for iniquity
Let them be shamed and let them take
The measure of the pattern's wake.
11 "And if they are ashamed of all
That they have done in house and stall,
Show them the form of temple wall,
Its fashion and entrance and all,
And all the forms of it and all
The ordinances, every form,
All the laws, and write in sights worn,
That they may keep the whole of it,
All the ordinances and kit.
12 "This is the temple law to hear:
Upon the mountain top in gear
And all the region round about
Shall be most holy without doubt.
See this is the temple law near.

The inner temple's made of words alone

And of neither the flesh and blood and
bone
Of human being, no, nor yet of stone
And gold and cedar set before a throne.
The inner temple's made of those words
met

On Sinai's throbbing pulse, and those
words set

Within the golden ark and on the heart
In burning letters never to depart.
The high places and royal seed there spilled
Have no part in the righteousness fulfilled
In ordinance Ezekiel came to sound
After the Chebar river made its round.
Beloved, I lift my sight above the wall
That separates the divine from the small.

13 "And these are altar measures here
In arm lengths; The cubit is just
A cubit and a hand span's trust,
Even the bottom shall be made
An arm length, and the width's parade
An arm length, and the border laid
By the edge of it round a span,
This is the higher altar's plan.

14 "And from the bottom on the ground
Up to the lower settle's sound
Be two arm lengths, for width be set
One arm length, from the lesser met
Settle to the greater one yet
Shall be four arm lengths and be wide
One arm length only to abide.

15 "The altar shall be four arm lengths,
And from the altar up full-strength
Shall be four horns *and not to hide*.

16 "The altar may be twelve in length,
Twelve wide, square in four squares *of
strength*.

17 "The settle shall be fourteen long
And fourteen broad in four squares' song,
The border round it shall be half
An arm length, and the bottom gaff
An arm length all about; its stairs
Shall face the east *in shining chairs*.

If I should face the altar and its stairs,
I'd have my back to the east and the glares
Of those who face the east to pray aloud.
I'd be turned opposite the Christian crowd,
Conflicting with Rabbinicals in shroud.
I turn toward the altar's sacrifice,
And let go of my own soul in a trice,

And see it flicker like a spark to go
Up before You, Beloved, and lose its glow
In darkness everlasting in a row.
Although my tiny spark of life and wit
Extinguish at the throne where You still sit,
My self has thus become its Self at last
While circumambulating crowds go past.

18 And He said to me, "Son of man,
'So says the Lord YHWH, "These in plan
Are altar ordinances' scan

For the day they shall make the drawn,
To offer their burnt offerings on,
To sprinkle blood there *as they can*.

19 "And you shall give the priests Levites,
Descendants of Zadok and wights
Who come before Me to serve Me,'
Says the Lord YHWH, 'a young bull's fee
For offering for iniquity.'

20 "And you shall take the blood and put
It on the four horns and the foot
In the four corners of the set,
Upon the border round and yet
You shall so cleanse and purge it met.

21 "You'll also take the bullock for
The sin offering and burn in store
At the appointed temple place
Outside the sanctuary's face.

22 "And on the second day you'll make
An offering of a kid in stake
Of the goats without blemish for
A sin offering, and they'll restore
The altar cleansed as they before
Did clean it with the bullock's gore.

23 "When you have finished cleansing it
You'll offer a young bullock fit,
And a ram from the flock as fit.

24 "You'll offer them there before YHWH,
And the priest will throw on salt too,
And offer them up for a burnt
Offering to YHWH *as you have learnt*.

25 "Seven days you'll prepare every day
A goat for the sin offering's way,
They'll prepare a young bullock too,
And a ram out of the flock due
Without blemish *in any way*.

26 "Seven days they'll cleanse the altar and
Purify it, and keep command
To consecrate themselves *in hand*.

27 "At the end of these days let be
On the eighth day and so in fee
The priests shall make your offerings burnt

Upon the altar, your peace earnt;
And I'll accept you," says Lord YHWH.'"

My round of seven days is hardly spent
In offering up goats, if that's what You
meant.

The blood of goats may cleanse, I'll not say
no,

But I decry the heathen sort of show
That claims the blood of man may purify
The altar and the temple in the sky.

In Mecca once upon the stairs I saw
That human blood had dropped from foot
or claw,

And the man there beside me pointed and
Said to beware contaminating sand.
I stepped over the blood and kept foot clean
To tread the smooth warm stone about the
scene

Of Kaaba where the throngs pressed
circling round

And others bowed prostrating to the
ground.

Ezekiel 44

1 He brought me back by the same gate
Of outward sanctuary's state
That faces toward the east and it
Was shut *behind me and remit.*

2 Then YHWH said to me, "Let this gate
Be shut and not opened in state,
And no man shall go in by it,
Because YHWH, Israel's Alohim
Has entered by it on the scene,
So let it be shut definite.

3 "As for the prince, since he is chief,
He may sit in it for relief
To eat bread before YHWH, but he
Shall go in by the gate porch, see,
And go out by the same way brief."

I've seen the eastern gate upon the wall
In Quds to represent Ezekiel's fall,
And found it shut tight not with lock and
key

But with cement laid thick on filigree.
That must prevent the prince today from
going

Into the gateway for his bread and flowing
Wine just to turn back after satisfied
He has not trodden on the path and wide

Where Your glory once waited for the
bride.

There's such a story my grandmother told
About a bride of one with brothers bold
Who should not go out eastern gates when
sold.

4 He brought me to the north gate's way
In from of the temple's place in sway,
And I looked and, see, YHWH's glory
Filled YHWH's temple, and fell to see
Upon my face, *bowed down to stay.*

5 And YHWH said to me, "Son of man,
Mark well and see what your eyes scan,
And hear with your ears what you can
Of all I say to you about

The ordinances of YHWH's sprout
Of temple, and all its laws too,
And mark well the entrance into
The house, with every going out
Of the sanctuary about.

6 "And you'll say to rebellious ones,
To house of Israel in tons,
'So says the Lord YHWH: "O you house
Of Israel, be enough in grouse
For you of all the things you've done
In your abominations' run,

7 "In bringing strangers, those who are
Uncircumcised in heart to spar,
Uncircumcised in flesh, to be
Polluting My sanctuary,

My house, when you offer My bread,
The fat and blood that you have shed,
And they have broken covenant
With My because of all your rant.

8 "And you've not kept My holy things
In charge, but you've set keepers' wings
Of My charge in My temple for
Your own selves *in both house and store.*"

9 "So says the Lord YHWH: "No stranger,
Uncircumcised in heart nor fer
Uncircumcised in flesh shall come
Into My sanctuary's hum,
Nor any foreigner among
The children of Israel *unstrung.*

I've seen Your glory on the Kaaba round,
I've seen the swallows high above the
ground

To circle with the angels and their sound.
I've fallen on my face towards the place
Which is Your house today for every face

With full right to come there because the
trace

Of circumcision marked my flesh with
grace.

Beloved, condemn uncircumcised today,
And pluck them out from among those who
pray,

Uncircumcised in heart, uncircumcised
In flesh, all wicked men who have despised
Your law, Your grace, the haven You have
made

On earth and Paradise for undismayed.

10 "The Levites gone astray from Me,
When Israel went astray to be,
Who went astray from Me to take
Themselves their idols, they in stake
Shall bear their own iniquity.

11 "Yet they'll serve in My temple there,
Have charge of the gates for their share,
And serve in the house, and beware
To slay the burnt offering as well
As sacrifice for the folk's spell,
And they'll stand before them to serve
Them always *and no more to swerve*.

12 "Because they ministered to them
Before their idols in their hem
And made the house of Israel
Fall in iniquity a spell,
That's why I've lifted up My hand
Against them," says Lord YHWH's
command,

"And they shall bear their sin in band.

13 "And they shall not come near to Me
To do the office and degree
Of a priest to Me, nor to come
Near to any holy things' sum,
In the most holy, but they'll bear
Their shame and wickedness in share
That they have once committed there.

14 "But I will make them keepers of
The charge of the house as above,
For all the serve and for all
That shall be done in house and hall.

15 "But the priests the Levites and sons
Of Zadok, that kept the charge runs
Of My temple when Israel's folk
Went astray from Me at a stroke,
They shall come near to Me to serve
Me, and they shall stand and not swerve
Before Me to offer to Me
The fat and the blood," says Lord YHWH.

16 "They'll come into My sanctuary,
And shall come near My table merry,
To minister to Me and keep
My charge *and beware not to sleep*.

Zadok appears to be among the few
Who did not apostatize with the crew
Of Israel one time who turned from You.
Beloved, there are so many days I know
In history where the great crowd would
show

Their unbelief and disobedience.
And You let them return into their tents.
Majority is always wrong, I see,
And in the end that means one, and not
three

Must come alone before You to present
The empty offering of self that You meant.
Beloved, let the priests come again
Or let them linger lying among men,
The last word is a silent, glowing glen.

17 "And it shall happen when they come
In at the gates of inner sum,
They shall be clothed with linen clothes,
And no wool on them when they rose
To serve in the gates of the court,
The inner court, inside resort.

18 "They'll have their linen turbans too
Upon their heads, and linen cue
For breeches, and they shall not wear
Anything that cases sweat there.

19 "When they go in the outer court,
The outer court of the folk's sort,
They'll put off their clothes in which they
Were ministering and then lay
Them in the holy chambers' way,
And put on other clothes to stay
And sanctify the folk that way.

Within the inner temple where I wait
Upon Your word and hear the din abate,
I wear the linen and the turban too.
But when I come out in the people's view,
I clad me once again in woollen hue,
The dervish dress, a humble dog at gate.
Beloved, the glories of my present state
Are hidden in the towels of common dress,
The remnants from the flea-market in mess.
The glory that I find at plate and eye,
The undiminished flash and alibi,

Are camouflaged from common sight and weal.
I'm silent here beneath the hoof and heel.
And so I sanctify the people's reel.

20 "Neither shall they shave off their head,
Nor let their hair grow long instead,
But they shall only cut their hair.

Beloved, I see the priests of long ago
Could not be Qalandars set in a row,
Since they had their hair cut and never long
Nor never shaven off by barber's song.
The priesthood of believers is a joke
Among the bald and those who take the stroke

Of Nazarite vow. I am not unkind
To keep Qalandarship inside and blind,
So none know where my true repose is set
While I kneel on prie-dieu in a pew yet.
Beloved, I neither rise in welcome sound
Of ecstasy, nor sink into the ground
Of law and false humility in bound.
Instead here face to face You and I met.

21 "Neither shall any priest take share
Of wine when they come in the court
The inner court, inside resort.

The lagered Bektashi who makes the tent
Of dervishhood a tavern with a rent
May take the wine of vine as well as sent
Wine of the ecstasy of angels lent.
I refused to enter that holy room
Of backgammon and dice without perfume,
But stayed beside the now forbidden tomb
Of Hajji Bektash without raki's doom.
I sorrowed to turn down the invitation
So sweetly tendered by a beloved nation,
And as I turned away I met the face
Outside the door of dergah, yet in grace.
While others raised the glass and poured
the sweet,

I entered straightway in the narrow street.

22 "Neither shall they take for their wives
A widow, nor divorced that thrives,
But they shall take maidens to wife
From house of Israel for life,
Or a widow of priest before.

The taking of a wife by any priest

Is not condemned by Scripture in the least,
As long as she was born in the right camp
And was not divorced by a priestly scamp.
Today the priest is celibate, I fear,
At least in the majority career,
And also in the Bektashi regime
The celibacy of some is a dream.
I do not raise an issue here for strife.
Let each man do his own thing with his wife.

I only point out that the word is true,
And oft ignored by those who pretend You
Give them monopoly to grace and fire,
While others wallow in lust and desire.

23 "And they shall teach My folk the score
Between holy and profane lore,
And make them know the difference
Between unclean and clean *in tents*.

The role of priests in ancient days gone by,
The days of prophets and Israel in sty,
Was to determine verdicts for the just
And for the unclean on the things they must.

The Rabbis came to sit in Moses' seat,
And even Jesus Christ sat at their feet,
And ratified their verdicts for a song.
So following a Rabbi can't be wrong.
The marja and the mullah write in dust
The verdicts from the holy Qur'an long,
And so the choice of following for trust
Is as diverse as any fife and gong.
Beloved, I lay a hand on word and deed,
And find what is pure and what not in seed.

24 "And when there shall be a conflict
They'll stand in My judgements as picked,
And shall judge; they shall keep My laws,
And My ordinances in clause
In all My solemn things and they
Shall sanctify My Sabbaths' day.

There are men everywhere who claim to speak
In Your behalf, Beloved, and others seek
To know which marja is the best of all
In order to come under word and thrall.
The one whose verdict takes Your word in claim,
Who keeps the ten commandments in Your name,

And does not leave the Sabbath to his
 blame,
 But recognizes that it too was made
 For all upon the earth, beast on parade
 And humankind. A marja must be just:
 The ten commandments tell us what we
 must
 Consider just among the right and staid.
 The secret is that such men can be found
 Even upon the Persian sort of ground.

25 "And they shall not touch any dead
 To defile themselves toe to head,
 But for a father, mother bred,
 Or son or daughter, brother's stead,
 Or for a sister not yet taken
 As wife, for these they're not mistaken.
 26 "And after he is purified
 They'll count to him seven days to bide.
 27 "And on the day that he returns
 Into the sanctuary's urns,
 Into the inner court again
 To serve in the temple for men,
 He'll offer his sin offering true,"
 And so says the Lord who is YHWH.

The purifying after touching dead
 Is a complete immersion and instead
 Of merely washing hands and feet and
 brow.
 I trace the law that You, Beloved, allow.
 Beloved, with each breath that I breathe I
 die
 And am again brought to life under sky.
 So who's defiled and who's here to belie?
 Must I be purified and shrouded where
 I die my small deaths as I exhale air?
 Beloved, that's why I do not enter tent
 After the clothed and purified who went
 To bow in their prostration toward the goal.
 My lack of right ablutions takes a toll.
 Instead I mind Your name in secret spent.

28 "And it shall come to them in lot,
 I am their inheritance plot;
 And you shall give to them no more
 Possession in Israel in store,
 I am their possession *before*.
 29 "They'll eat the meat offering and sin
 Offering, and trespass offering's bin,
 And every dedicated thing
 In Israel shall be theirs *to bring*.

30 "And the first of first fruits of all,
 And every oblation from call,
 And every oblation in stall
 Shall be the priest's; and you shall give
 To the priest the first of your dough,
 And he will make the blessing *live*
 And rest in your house *and not slow*.
 31 "The priest shall not eat anything
 That's dead of itself, torn in sting,
 Whether it be fowl on the wing,
 Or beast, *nor any of such thing*."

Though I am not a priest, my only lot
 Of wealth upon the earth-forsaken plot
 Is You, Beloved, and if in grace I share
 A house or land from father, I beware
 That there are takers for all things below.
 There's little chance that I shall stand the
 show
 And get a penny for the row I hoe.
 But if there is a thing beside the wealth
 That You provide me secretly in stealth,
 Then let me there find further glories that
 Return me only to the place You're at.
 Beloved, I eat the lean and forfeit fat
 Like any priest of ancient time and glow:
 Remember me, Beloved, for what I know.

Ezekiel 45

1 "And when you divide up the land
 For an inheritance to stand,
 You'll offer an oblation to
 YHWH, a holy portion and true
 Of the land, the length of it be
 Twenty-five thousand reeds to see,
 And the width ten thousand in view.
 This shall be holy everywhere
 In all the borders that you share.
 2 "Out of this let be for the rate
 Of the sanctuary in state
 Five hundred long, five hundred wide,
 Square all around, and so beside
 Fifty arm lengths round it to be
 For the suburbs in their degree.
 3 "And of this measure you shall take
 The length of twenty-five in stake
 Thousand, and the width of it ten
 Thousand, and in it shall again
 Be the temple, most holy den.
 4 "The holy stake of land shall be
 For priests serving sanctuary,
 Who come near to serve before YHWH,

And it shall be for houses due,
 A holy place for temple crew.
 5 "The twenty-five thousand in length,
 And the ten thousand wide for strength
 Shall also be for Levites who
 Serve in the house, for a lot due
 Of twenty rooms *in all* for pew.
 6 "And you'll appoint the city lot
 Five thousand wide, and twenty-five
 Thousand long opposite the spot
 Of the oblation's holy hive;
 It shall be for all Israel live.
 7 "A portion shall be for the prince
 On both sides of oblation's rinse
 Of holiness, and of the lot
 Of the city, before they've got
 The holy oblation in plot,
 And before the possession wrought
 For the city, from the west side
 To westward, and from the east side
 To eastward, and the length shall be
 Opposite the one lot to be,
 From the west end to eastern lea.

The vision of the temple comes from You,
 Beloved, who sit above the earth in view
 Of heaven and its wonders and its place.
 The vision is celestial in its grace.
 And yet it's set to east and west and made
 Of earthly sorts of substances and grade.
 The north and south impinge upon it too,
 As though, Beloved, You could be boxed
 and true.

It's only figment of image in rue,
 The Grecian sort of thought that makes me
 think

That matter is an evil sort of brink,
 And You are spirit only on the wink.
 But if You're spirit and not matter too,
 Then You can even better fit the pew!

9 "So says the Lord YHWH: "Let it be
 Enough for you, Israel's chiefs free,
 Keep far from violence and spoil,
 And execute judgement and toil
 In justice, take away your tax
 From My folk," the Lord YHWH exacts.

10 "You'll have just balances and just
 Measure of ephah and a just
 Bath in measure *of wine or dust*.

11 "The ephah and the bath shall be
 Of one measure, so the bath's fee

May have the tenth part of degree
 Of an homer, and ephah free
 Have the tenth part of homer too;
 The measure of it shall be due
 To an homer *taken in view*.
 12 "The shekel shall be twenty gerahs,
 Twenty shekels *like twenty sparrows*
 And twenty-five shekels and *winnows*
 Of fifteen shekels be you minas.

The measure and the weight and coin are
 set
 By the divine decree written and met.
 And yet I find though measure and weight
 are

Even more precise now than on that far
 Day and place where Ezekiel came to spar,
 The coin is minted out of gospel rate.
 It is not worth the time it takes to state.
 The money's turned to paper and a flick
 Of pen to sign away both thin and thick.
 The candle's burned down to last of the
 wick,

And only imagined wealth comes to stick.
 Beloved, the bankers and the legislators
 Have robbed the people of their own last
 flaters.

We quietly remain as overraters.

13 "This is the oblation that you
 Shall offer, the sixth part in view
 Of an ephah of wheaten homer,
 And you shall give the sixth part roamer
 Of an ephah of barley homer.

14 "Concerning the statute of oil,
 The bath of oil, the tenth in toil
 Of a bath out of the cor's spoil,
 An homer of ten baths in coil,
 For ten baths are an homer's roil.

15 "And one lamb form the flock in count
 Of two hundred, out of the mount
 Of the fat pastures Israel's got;
 For a meat offering and a spot
 Of a burnt offering and for peace
 Offerings to make for them release,"
 Says the Lord YHWH *on the increase*.

A bit of wheat, a bit of barley too,
 A dab of oil, a lamb for fat in view,
 And there is meat in Your house and Your
 pew.

Substantial is the worship You require,

So how can any doubt You in the fire?
 The spirited and thoughtful come to say
 That You cannot be boxed in any way,
 And quote with wisdom of Solomon's
 prayer
 To show that You cannot dwell anywhere.
 Beloved, now You lack Your reality,
 Unboxed by temple earthly or heavenly,
 I'm free to eat the spoil of priest and flock,
 And worship any idol made of rock.
 Your hand in judgement is an empty crock.

16 "All the folk of the land shall give
 This oblation of Israel's prince.
 17 "And it shall be the prince's sieve
 To give burnt offerings and not wince
 At meat offerings and drink oblations,
 In the feasts, at first of month's stations,
 And on the Sabbaths, and in all
 The solemn assemblies in stall
 Of Israel: he shall prepare
 The sin offering, meat offering there,
 The burnt offering, peace offerings' share
 To make atonement for the fair
 House of Israel *with none to spare*.

18 "So says the Lord YHWH: "In the first
 Month, the month's first day, you are
 versed

To take a young bullock without
 Blemish and cleanse the temple out.
 19 "And the priest shall take of the blood
 Of the sin offering in a flood
 And put it on the temple posts,
 And on the four corners in hosts
 Of the ledge of the altar, and
 On the posts of the gate to stand
 In the court from within *the band*.

20 "And so you'll do the seventh day
 Of the month for each one astray,
 And for the simple, so you'll make
 Atonement for the temple's sake.

21 "In the first month, the fourteenth day
 Of the month you shall keep the sway
 Of the Passover, it's a feast
 Of seven days, and one released
 Of leavening to eat increased.

22 "And on that day shall the prince make
 Himself ready for all the sake
 Of the folk of the land to take
 A bullock for sin offering's wake.

23 "And seven days of the feast he
 Shall prepare a burnt offering wee

To YHWH, of seven bullocks free
 And seven rams without degree
 Of blemish every day for seven,
 And a kid of the goats like heaven
 For a sin offering *by decree*.

24 "He'll also make offering of food
 Of an ephah for bullock rude,
 An ephah for a ram and still
 A hin of oil for ephah's fill.

25 "In seventh month, the fifteenth day
 Of the month, he shall do the way
 Of the feast of seven days again,
 According to sin offering then,
 To burnt offering, to food offering,
 And to the oil *come in a spring*."

The yearly feasts are set prophetically,
 And yet it is not sure what counting fee
 The prophets of old times used when they
 set

The dates for the feasts come together met.
 Assumption that the moon in spinning
 round

Reveals the day upon the earthly ground
 Is simply that. The calendar could be
 The one of Qumran and the Jubilee.
 Beloved, reveal the date and I shall keep
 The yearly feasts forever in my sleep,
 But until then the Sabbath is enough,
 Or Ramadhan and Zil-hajj in the rough,
 And finally Ashura where I find
 The sorrow of Hussein has made me blind.

Ezekiel 46

1 "So says the Lord YHWH "The gateway
 Of the inner court that bears sway
 Toward the east shall be shut for
 Six working days, but at the door
 Of the Sabbath it shall be flung
 Open, and on the first day *sung*
 Of every month it shall be so.

2 "The prince shall enter *as they go*
 By way of the gateway entrance
 From the outside, *in vigilance*
 Stand by the gatepost, while the priests
 Shall make his burnt offering *of beasts*
 And his peace offerings. He shall bow
 Prostrating at the gate's threshold,
 Then he shall go out *from the hold*,
 But the gate shall not be shut till
 The evening. 3 "Likewise the folk *still*
 Of *all* the land shall worship at

The entrance to this gateway *flat*
 Before YHWH on the Sabbath days
 And the months' first day *for always*.
 4 "And the burnt offering that the prince
 Shall offer to YHWH to evince
 The Sabbath day will be six lambs
 Without blemish, one of the rams
 Without blemish *at which to wince*.
 5 "And the food offering, it shall be
 An ephah for a ram to see,
 And the food offering for the lambs
 As he can do and without scams,
 A hin of oil to ephah's fee.

Beloved, though every day of faith is lost
 In time and calculated by the bossed
 For what it may and may not be and tossed,
 I thank You that the Sabbath is still near,
 Still ready and a refuge for the dear
 From tribulation and oppression's tear.
 Beloved, though every day of doubt is
 bright
 With tinsel and with starting a new fight,
 I thank You that the offering pure and true
 Of Sabbath without blemish come from
 You
 Remains for me to eat the double fare,
 The blessed from Fridays store, both clean
 and bare.
 Beloved, though every human day is gone,
 At least the donkey's not imposed upon.

6 "On the month's first day it shall be
 A young bullock without degree
 Of blemish, and six lambs in fee,
 And a ram, without snickersnee.
 7 "He'll make food offering, it shall be
 An ephah for bullock in fee,
 An ephah for a ram to see,
 And the food offering for the lambs
 As he can do and without scams,
 A hin of oil to ephah's fee.
 8 "And when the prince comes in, he'll go
 In by the way of the porch show
 Of that gate, and he'll go out by
 The same way he came *by and by*.

The prince is none I know, unless it's true
 That Master of the age, old and not new,
 Is prince today upon the month's first cue.
 The prince is none to show, and more than
 that,

The first day of the month is in the vat
 Uncountable by moon or sun unless
 The equinox in spring gives hint to guess
 When Jubilees are worn like brooch on
 dress.

The prince upon the first day hidden well
 Comes in with offerings succulent and
 swell,
 Rhyme burns the rope, the rope slides in
 the rut,
 And all the sweetmeats rest light on the gut,
 And with his coming, though no man may
 see,
 Time turns to hope, hope to eternity.

9 "But when the people of the land
 Shall come before their YHWH to stand
 In solemn feasts, the one that goes
 In by the northern gate in rows
 To worship shall go out again
 By the way of the south gate's den,
 And the one that goes by the way
 Of the south gate come in to pray
 Shall go out by the northern gate,
 He shall not return in estate
 By the way of the gate that he
 Came in by, but the other lea.
 10 "And the prince in the midst of them,
 When they go in, he shall take hem
 To go in, and when they go out,
 He'll go out also *without doubt*.

11 "And in the feasts and celebrations
 The food offering shall be in rations
 Of ephah to a bullock and
 An ephah to a ram to stand,
 And to the lambs as he can give,
 A hin of oil to ephah's sieve.

12 "When the prince make a sacrifice
 That's burnt and voluntary price
 Or peace offerings to YHWH, then one
 Shall open for him the gate done
 Toward the east, and he shall bring
 His burnt offering and peace offering,
 As he did on the Sabbath day,
 Then he shall go out, then shall stay
 One to shut up the gate that way.

13 "And every day they shall prepare
 A burnt offering to YHWH of fair
 Lamb of the first year without taint,
 Each morning they'll prepare *the saint*.
 14 "And you shall make fool offering too
 For it each morning as the due

Sixth part of an ephah, a third
Part of a hin of oil unstirred,
To temper with the fine four blurred,
A food offering always constant
A statute of YHWH's *covenant*.

15 "So they shall make ready the lamb,
And the food offering without scam,
And oil each morning to remain
A constant burnt offering *in grain*."

To use the north and southern doors now
seems

To my sensitivities made of dreams
Of Iroquoian stories from my youth,
A case of witch-craft borrowing from truth.
The doors to use for life and live are those
That welcome the morn and then at day's
close

Send sunset in the wake for coming night.
The cross-purposes leave no door aright.
Beloved, You cut the witch-craft and the
brew

At root and send the people in their crew
Across the lines of earth to wait for You.
I take the bow, I take the bowl and pit
And shake the narrow passage of a slit
For geese to fly south from their northern
fit.

16 "So says the Lord YHWH: "If the
prince

Gives a gift to any of his
Sons, the inheritance of it
Shall be his sons', it shall be fit
As their lot by inheritance.

17 "But if he gives a gift of his
Lot to one of his servants whiz,
It shall be his until the year
Of the release, and then appear
Returning to the prince, but his
Inheritance shall go in lot
To his own sons *found on the spot*.

18 "Moreover the prince shall not take
Of the folk's inheritance stake
By his oppression, to put them
Out of their land, but he'll take gem
Of his own wealth to give his sons
Inheritance, though it be tons,
So My folk will not be spread out
Everyone from his lot in rout."""

Beloved, when I was in Mashad the first

Time and the last, if I should tell the worst,
They told me I could make a wish come
true,

If I asked from the Imam what to do.
But I remembered that the gift should be
Mine only till the coming Jubilee,
And so I asked no field nor other wealth,
Nor even what I needed, which was health,
But bared my heart in secret of desire
To beg a boon of spirit and of fire
For me and mine in Your eternity,
For me and mine in Paradise to see
The gift of the Imam. Not in this place
Where temporary hopes run in the race.

19 After he brought me through the door
Which was at the side of gate's *score*,
Into the holy rooms of priests,
Which faced toward the north *for feasts*,
And see, there was a place on two
Sides westward *if you turn to view*.

20 Then he said to me, "Right here's where
The priests shall boil the offering's fare
Of trespass and of sin to share,
Where they shall bake the food offering,
So they don't take them out or bring
Into the outer court to sing
A blessing on the people's wing."

21 He brought me to the outer court,
And made me pass four corners' sort
And see, in every corner there
There was a court *set fair and square*.

22 In the four corners of the court
There were courts joined in such a sort
As forty arm lengths long and wide
To thirty, and these corners bide
As four in one measure beside.

23 A row around them, all the four,
Was made in place to boil the gore
In rows around about *the floor*.

24 Then he said to me, "This is where
They'll boil and were the servants share
Of the house shall boil sacrifice
Of the people *and make it nice*."

I've seen the kitchen of Hajji Bektash,
I've seen the caldron and the ladle's stash
Incised with Solomon's seal for the rate
Of incantations from medieval state.
I've seen the place where meat was boiled
and brought

Out steaming for the ones who came and
 sought
 A blessing from the spirit of Imam,
 The guidance of the Master of the calm,
 The courage of the Abdals where they wait
 To whirl across the wooden floor not late
 Beneath the stairs to Paradise and all,
 The door where Ali hides from beck and
 call.
 Beloved, I've seen the kitchen standing
 there
 In readiness, and no one come to share.

Ezekiel 47

1 Then he brought me back to the door
 Of the temple, and there before
 Was water, flowing from beneath
 The threshold of the temple east,
 For the front of the temple faced
 East, the water *from where it's placed*
 Was flowing from under the right
 Side of the temple, from the site
 South of the altar. 2 He brought me
 Out by way of the north gate, *see*,
 And led me round on the outside
 To the outer gateway that cried
 Toward the east, and there the stream
 Of water ran out the right seam.
 3 And when the man went out towards east
 With the line in his hand *increased*,
 He measured one thousand arm lengths
 And brought me through the waters'
 strengths,
 The water *to my ankles rose*.
 4 Again he measured *where it flows*
 One thousand and brought me *again*
 Through the waters to my knees then.
 Once more he measured one thousand
 Where waters rose to my waistband.
 5 Again he measured one thousand,
 A river that I could not cross,
 For the water was *at a loss*
 Too deep, water where one must swim,
 A river not be crossed at whim.

The temple of Ezekiel seems to be
 That very one that John saw in his spree
 Of Patmos, the one from which living
 streams
 Flowed out and measured far beyond the
 beams
 Of palaces to touch eternity.

I grope to ford the heavy, crystal flood
 Of Paradise to lip it in the bud
 And find the water is too deep for me.
 Beloved, I measure with both foot and
 knee,
 I trample where You lead by light of mud
 To crest the falling waters where I find
 The river swells beyond body and mind.
 The eastward facing temple looks down on
 My floundering and smiles to see my dawn.

6 He said to me, "Son of man, do
 You see *this*?" Then he brought me to
 The bank of the river returned.
 7 When I returned, there, *so I learned*
 Along the river bank many
 Trees on both sides abundantly
Grew there. 8 And then he said to me,
 "This water flows into the sea
 Through the east region, down the vale
 And at sea fresh waters prevail.
 9 "And every living thing that goes
 Will live wherein that river shows.
 There will be very many fish
 As these waters go *where they wish*,
 For they shall be fresh everywhere
 They go with living creatures there.
 10 "It shall be *that* fishermen stand
 By it from En Gedi to land
 Of En Eglaim, places to spread
 Their nets with fish like those that bred
 In the Great Sea, exceeding many.
 11 "Its swamps and marshes have not any
 But they will be salty *and fenny*.
 12 "Along both banks of the stream grow
All kinds of trees that people know
 For food, their leaves will not wither,
 Their fruit will not fail *to occur*.
 And every month they'll bear their fruit
 Because their waters flow *in suit*
 From the holy place, and their fruit
 Will be for food, and their leaves for
Healing medicine what is more."

The temple made of Paradise that came
 In view of Ezekiel and John by name
 Was far away in vision seen alone
 Before the starry heights of divine throne.
 But on a day beyond the tread of stair,
 Beyond the flight of sacrifice and prayer,
 That temple shall descend upon the air

That graces Quds, and then shall be made bare.

The tree of life that gives each month its fruit

Will gush with leaves made green by cinder soot

Of evil once destroyed and under foot.

I take the healing plantain with the root
And plaster heart and spirit everywhere,
And hide my eyes from nothing of the glare.

13 So says the Lord YHWH: "This shall be
The border, by which you in fee
Shall hold the land according to
The twelve tribes of Israel in crew;
Joseph shall have two portions too.

14 "And you'll inherit it, the one
As well as every other done,
As I've lifted My hand to give
It to your ancestors to live,
And this land shall fall to you for
Inheritance *forevermore*.

15 "This is the border of the land
Toward the north side of the band
From the great sea, the way to stand
Toward Hethlon, the road to Zedad;
16 "Hamath, Berothah, Sibraim,
Which is between the border rim
Of Damascus, frontier not sad
Of Hamath; Hazarhaticon,
Which is by the coast of Hauran.

17 "The border from the sea shall be
Hazarenan, the border free
Of Damascus, and the north yet,
And border of Hamath as set.
And this is the north side *to get*.

18 "And the east side you'll measure out
From Hauran, from Damascus' scout,
From Gilead and from the land
Of Israel by Jordan to stand,
From the border to the east sea.
And this is the east side to be.

19 "And the south side to southward run
From Tamar to the waters done
In strife in Kadesh, to the stream
Of the great sea. And let this deem
To be the south side *by the sun*.

20 "And the west side also shall be
The great sea from the border free,
Until you come opposite where
Hamath is standing. That's the share

Of the west side *come to compare*.

21 "So you'll divide the land to you
According to Israel's tribes' crew.

22 "It shall happen when you divide
It by lot for place to reside,
And to the strangers among you,
Which shall have children among you,
And they shall be to you as born
In the land of Israel and sworn,
They'll have inheritance with you
Among the tribes of Israel's crew.

23 "And it shall happen, in what tribe
The stranger dwells, there without bribe
You'll give him his inheritance,"
Says the Lord YHWH *of circumstance*.

Ah my Beloved, in Paradise at last
I find that even stranger's not outcast
From the inheritance of land and room.
Beloved, I rush in quest of my own doom.
The twelve tribes have their place eternally,
But those who wander earth among the free
Have not a place to lay the head and no
Hall to call home beneath the hale and
slow.

Beloved, let me come to my Paradise
With empty hand and without sacrifice
To find the stranger at last also lies
In health and wealth before the home-
born's eyes.

I'll keep You to Your word, Beloved, and
raise

A clamour on the judgement for my stays.

Ezekiel 48

1 "Now these *are* the names of the tribes:
From the northern border ascribes
Along the road to Hethlon at
The entrance of Hamath down pat,
To Hazar Enan, to frontier
Of Damascus northward, to veer
In the direction of Hamath,
One for Dan from its eastern path
To its west side, 2 "by the frontier
Of Dan, from the east side to steer
To the west, one for Asher too,
3 "By the border of Asher due,
From the east side to the west, one
For Naphtali, 4 "By border won
Of Naphtali, from the east side
To the west, one for Manasseh,
5 "By the frontier of Manasseh,

From the east side to the west ride,
 One Ephraim, 6 “by the wide
 Frontier of Ephraim, from east
 To west, one for Reuben to rest,
 7 “By the frontier of Reuben, from
 The east side to the west to come,
 One for Judah, 8 “by the frontier
 Of Judah, from the east to veer
 Toward the west, shall be the place
 You shall set apart, twenty-five lace
 A thousand arm lengths wide, in length
 The same as every one in strength,
 From the east side up to the west,
 With sanctuary to invest
 In the middle of all the best.

Beloved, beside the city of my heart,
 The town enlaced with palaces apart,
 The place of minarets and domes that glow
 Beneath the shining ways where angels go,
 I set apart a ground of stone and flint,
 And firm foundation where the quartzites
 glint

And pegmatite lies scintillating where
 The mica flecks beneath the starts to where
 Upon its breast a temple. Here I dare.
 I set apart the chambered palaces
 Of inner temple where Your spirit is
 As sanctuary for Your priest and his.
 Beloved, the spot is sacred to Your fame,
 For there I cantillate alone Your name.

9 “The district that you’ll set apart
 For YHWH *shall be* twenty-five start
 Of thousands in arm lengths of length
 And ten thousand in width and strength.
 10 “To these, to thus priests, shall belong
 The holy area in throng,
 On the north twenty-five thousand strong,
 On the west ten thousand spread wide,
 On the east ten thousand abide,
 And on the south twenty-five more
 Thousand in length *before the door*.
 The sanctuary of YHWH’ll be
 In the middle *of that country*.

11 “For the priest sanctified of those
 Descended from Zadok who chose
 To keep My charge and did not go
 Astray when Israel’s folk below
 Apostatized as the Levites.

12 “The oblation of the land’s rights
 Is offered them in sacred lights

By the border of the Levites.

13 “Against the border of the priests
 The Levites shall have *for their feasts*
 Twenty-five thousand there in length,
 And ten thousand in width and strength,
 All the length twenty-five thousand,
 And the width counted ten thousand.

14 “They shall not sell it nor exchange,
 Nor send out the first fruits to range,
 For it is holy unto YHWH.

Let me exchange no birthright won from
 You,
 Beloved, no not for rents and bonds in due,
 Nor for the jewelled plates I’ve seen in
 view

Where even those who worship You resign
 To eat upon the tempered and the fine.

Let me exchange no lands where forests
 sing

Your holy name upon the harboured spring,
 Nor any streams that rush from melting
 snow

To find the rest You promise here below.
 When nothing is exchanged, and nothing
 lost

Among the favour that You have embossed
 Upon my heart, then I shall know the way
 From heritage to temple where Your sway
 Is held by Guided one from day to day.

15 “And the five thousand that are left
 In the width of land unbereft
 Over the twenty-five thousand,
 Shall be a profane place to stand
 For the city, for dwelling and
 For suburbs: and the city shall
 Be in the middle principal.

16 “And these shall be its measures then,
 The north side four thousand again
 And five hundred, and the south side
 Four thousand and five hundred ride,
 And on the east side four thousand
 And five hundred, and the west hand
 Four thousand and five hundred land.

17 “The suburbs of the city there
 Toward the north shall be in share
 Two hundred fifty, and to go
 Toward the south two hundred show
 And fifty, and toward the east
 Two hundred fifty, and increased
 Toward the west two hundred more

And fifty to finish the score.

18 "The rest in length opposite place
Of holy oblation in trace

Shall be ten thousand eastward, and
Ten thousand westward, on the hand
Of holy oblation to stand

And the increase of it shall be
For food to those in the city
Who serve *faithfully in the land*.

19 "Those who serve the city shall serve
Out of all Israel's tribes with verve.

20 "All the oblation shall be set
At twenty-five thousand and met
My twenty-five thousand; and you
Shall offer holy offering too
Foursquare with the city lot's view.

21 "The rest shall be there for the prince,
On the one side and other since

It is the holy region set
With possession of city met,
Opposite twenty-five thousand
Of the concession toward the hand
Of the east border, and west band
Opposite twenty-five thousand
Toward the west side up unto
The portions for the prince in view:

And it shall be an offering true,
And the sanctuary house too
In the middle of it to stand.

The portion of the prince is now in cloud
Of vision two millennia allowed
To foil and hide. That prince has no address
On earth, no place to call his own, no less
Than vagrant is my prince, the one I bless.
His house is by the temple and the fire
That lies above the stars of my desire.

The wise pretend it is but allegory,
The truth of time perhaps, but just a story
In terms of fast reality. It stands

A truth of spirit, not a plant on lands.
Beloved, those who would not box You in
truth

Find that You disappear before their youth
Is out of its own hope and swaddling bands.

22 "For the possession of Levites,
From the lots of the city's rights,
In the midst of the prince's share,
Between the border of the ware
Of Judah and of Benjamin,
Shall be for the prince *without sin*.

23 "As for the rest of the tribes, from
The east side to the west to hum,
Benjamin has a piece to come.

24 "By the frontier of Benjamin,
From the east side to the west bin,
Simeon shall have lot within.

25 "By the border of Simeon,
From the east side to the west won,
Issachar has a portion done.

26 "By the border of Issachar,
From the east side to western bar,
One portion for Zebulun's star.

27 "By the border of Zebulun,
From the east side to western run,
Gad has a lot under the son.

28 "By the frontier of Gad to go
Toward the southern side in show,
The border shall be from Tamar
To waters of strife in the far
Kadesh, and to the river toward
The great sea out of desert scored.

29 "This is the land that you'll divide
By lot to every Israel's tribe
For their inheritance, and these
Are their portions," says the Lord YHWH.

30 "And these are goings from the leas
Of the city on the north view,
Four thousand and five hundred true.

The place is guarded by twelve tribes
around
With names tried in the furnace sevenfold
As steps to heaven: Reuben first, behold
A son, then Simeon, for You heard the
sound,
For Judah, praise, then Issachar's reward,
And Zebulun for dwelling, Ephraim
From ashes to the crown, forget not him,
Manasseh, right hand son, loved of the
Lord
And Gad, good fortune, coriander seed,
And Naphtali, my struggle in my need.
Fight to the last, is there no final rest?
There is no rest but in the seventh son,
The middle of the law, forgotten one.

31 "And the gates of the town shall be
After the names of tribes in fee
Of Israel; three gates on lea
Of the north, one gate there to be
Of Reuben, one gate of Judah,
One gate of Levi. 32 "At the draw

Of the east side four thousand and
 Five hundred, and three gates that spanned
 The gate of Joseph, Benjamin,
 And one gate for Dan from within.
 33 At the south side four thousand and
 Five hundred measures, three gates stand;
 One gate of Simeon, and one
 Gate of Issachar, and when done
 Again one gate of Zebulun.
 34 "At the west side four thousand and
 Five hundred with their three gates
 planned;
 One gate of Gad, and Asher's gate,
 One gate of Naphtali in state.
 35 "Circumference of eighteen thousand,
 The name of the city to stand
 From that day shall be YHWH's at hand."

Jehovah-Shamma is a name to spell.
 Jerusalem has gone down in the well.
 Is this the city where David at last
 Shall reign forever with flag on the mast?
 Jehovah-Shamma is a name indeed
 To place upon the hopes of every seed.
 YHWH's here at hand, and nearer says the
 word
 Of the Qur'an, than the heart vein when
 stirred.
 Beloved, whatever name the place may be,
 I find that You're at hand, though none can
 see,
 And where You are is ever home to me.
 Beloved, whatever spell You use to trace
 The lines of gratitude in every place,
 All thanks is Yours alone for every grace.

The Book of Daniel

The scholars are sure that the book
 Of Daniel was writ in the nook
 Of one-sixty-seven before Christ
 To one-sixty-four in a trice
 In answer to the challenges
 Of Antioch Epiphanes,
 Who ravaged city and God's house,
 Fearsome to humankind and mouse.
 The theory that Antiochus
 Is the little horn with a fuss
 In chapter seven is as old
 As Josephus's writing bold,
 Who was close enough to the game

To still bear the brunt and the shame
 Of the shock. But this theory now
 Relies on the assumption's prow
 That Daniel is a fiction and
 Could not have written in the stand
 Of the sixth century things that came
 To pass later than his life's claim.
 Denial of prophetic gift
 And Antiochus are in drift
 Together and they do not rift.

Traditional view is the book
 Was written when it claims in brook.
 The problem with this view is just
 That it requires prophetic thrust,
 Ability, God-given or not,
 To see beforetime earthly plot.
 Most prophecy is so unclear
 That it can be dismissed by ear,
 But Daniel takes it to a notch
 Above the general in crotch,
 Detailed and sweeping, it remains
 The target of doubt in the drains.

My own view is that prophecy,
 Prediction of the future sea,
 Is possible without recourse
 To supernatural perforce.
 Astute and careful sight of facts
 May well inform of how one acts
 And what governments and kings might
 Do next week given what's in sight.
 Just as historian of art
 Can tell two artists' work apart,
 While those who do not know the style
 May miss the guess by half a mile,
 So too an informed man may trust
 His guess of what may hit the dust.
 The future is related to
 The past by cause and effect due,
 Or by the structure of events.
 It does not take God's hand in tents,
 Though He may well show His presence.

The critics' attacks on the book
 Have fallen one by one to look,
 Until the main one that is left
 Is who was Darius bereft,
 The Mede. That's hardly enough now
 To damn the book with crease of brow.
 It seems now Aramaic that
 Garnishes the book is as fat
 As what we might expect to find
 In the sixth century when not blind.
 The kingship of Belshazzar has

Been adequately brought to jazz.
 There are no serious blocks today
 To origins of early sway,
 With the exception that prediction
 Is too detailed for the affliction
 Of doubters who wrongly think they
 Must admit the divine in sway
 If they admit an early date.
 Let everyone choose his own mate.

Natural prediction's limited
 To events and trends in the bid
 That can be linked to things observed.
 The arbitrary must be swerved,
 Such as names of a future king.
 Daniel is able thus to sing
 At a certain point what will come
 To Babylon and what will hum
 In Medo-Persia. He is able
 To predict the next power on table,
 The Grecian one. But he is not
 Able to give a name to plot
 Of powers to follow it. This is
 An argument in favour's fizz
 For my theory of astute guessing
 At the future as a confessing
 Of the prophetic utterance.
 Of course those who favour the dance
 Under Antiochus will note
 The danger of stating in quote
 The names of living rulers as
 Evidence against my clear jazz.
 Having thrown a sop to the quaint
 Views of academic and saint,
 My own view is a mystic ride,
 Without regard to where the tide
 And when. I merely would abide.
 As long as the book has in time
 Been held canonical in clime,
 And may be read in function of
 The Decalogue, my own first love,
 It is acceptable to me,
 And I will read it faithfully.

Apocalyptic thought that runs
 Among law-keepers on their buns,
 The folk who celebrate the day
 Of Sabbath in obedience' sway,
 Goes back to Mill Yard in London,
 In the sixteen hundreds for fun,
 Where John James preached Fifth
 Monarchy
 Influenced by Sabbetai Zvi.
 The German Baptist Sabbath-keepers

Were parallel but later reapers.
 Yet Isaac Newton was a man
 Who greatly influenced the scan.
 William Miller American
 Followed his footprints for a span.

The Millerite faiths that succeed
 In numbers to which we give heed,
 The Seventh-day Adventists and
 Jehovah's Witnesses in band,
 Show that historicistic thought
 Is seminal for modern drought.
 Prediction does not disturb me
 In my views that are scholarly,
 Since I do not expect the way
 Of science to explain the ray
 Of all of earth's reality.
 Therefore perceived naïveté
 In such faiths strikes me as fancy
 Of bias only on a spree.

Adam Clarke was the source who stood
 Informing Uriah Smith's wood,
 The one I think who keeps the stall
 Of the historicist in call
 Better than any other met.
 Like Newton he sees beyond threat
 Of all the evil in the world
 The fault of Roman come uncurled
 To find the Ottoman displayed
 In Daniel eleven's parade.
 I would go further than those two
 And see that false Islamic crew
 Even more widely come to view.
 One thus escapes Reformers' bias
 Raising an ugly head to try us.
 I come to this conclusion by
 Applying Smith's principled try
 With more consistency than he,
 And so more hope of truth to see.
 His principles are that the text
 Is to be understood perplexed
 In sequence chronological,
 And all the figures in their stall
 Are well identified in thrall
 By territory in land's call.
 He applies this consistently
 To define the Kings faithfully
 Of burgeoned North and cunning South.
 But he fails to keep his own mouth
 On both accounts when he comes to
 Daniel eleven twenty-two.

With arbitrary count he breaks
 The time sequence there when he takes

Verse 23 and jumps back two
 Hundred years and to misconstrue.
 Retaining Smith's two rules of thumb,
 Time sequence and the land for drum,
 The meaning of the figures late
 Shifts away from the Papal State
 To local rulers of the land
 Of Palestine, that is, the band
 Of Islamic establishment,
 In palace or Bedouin tent.
 While implications in terms of
 Smith's overall view come to shove
 Are immense, it is all based on
 This one small inference here drawn.

My application of some features
 To Musulman state in its bleachers,
 In contradistinction before
 The house of Muhammad in score,
 Upon whom be peace, is my own,
 But hardly unique to the bone,
 As other readers have researched
 That line more thoroughly and perched.
 Isaac Newton, of all time greatest
 Of historicist thought not latest,
 Is credited to have first seen
 Prophetic cycles in the lean
 Chapters of Daniel and John.
 In fact, I think it can be drawn
 That Hypolitus also thought
 In terms of cycles in the plot.
 But Newton also treats at least
 The end of Daniel eleven's feast
 As Ottoman Turkey for beast.
 And Smith agrees. To extend this
 Islamic emphasis in bliss
 Back over all four visions there
 As well as chapter twelve in share
 Is logical consistency.
 It's by comparison made free
 With eight: twenty and twenty-one
 The empires of Medo-Persian
 And Grecia can be surimposed
 On Daniel's image head and toesed.
 By the same token on the basis
 Of Daniel eleven in oasis,
 The feet of iron and clay, the horn
 Of chapter seven and forlorn
 The other horn of chapter eight
 We can with sure logic equate
 With the Kings of the North and South
 Respectively as Sunnite mouth
 After verse 30 by its date.

So head of gold of Daniel two
 Is the winged lion set and true
 Of Daniel seven, and we know
 That to be Babylon in show.
 The chest of silver in the rate
 Of Daniel two finds its own mate
 In the bear of Daniel seven and
 In ram of Daniel eight to stand.
 These are the kings of Persia set
 In Daniel eleven: two met.
 The thighs of brass in Daniel two
 Are the same kingdom to be true
 As the winged leopard that flies out
 Of Daniel seven, and no doubt
 The he-goat of chapter eight too,
 Grecia called mighty king in view
 In Daniel eleven: three,
 Predicting Alexander's spree.
 The legs of iron in Daniel two
 Are the same kingdom spied and true
 As the great beast of Daniel seven,
 And to follow structures for heaven,
 It must be the four horns that rate
 Attention in Daniel eight.
 Such are then the four winds that blow
 Out of Daniel eleven four:
 The Ptolemies and Seleucids
 And Roman intervention's bids.
 The feet of iron and clay appear
 In Daniel two and do not fear
 To be a little horn at last
 In Daniel seven's horrid blast,
 Another little horn to rise
 In Daniel 8, three in one guise
 To stand in Daniel eleven five
 And after as the Kings alive
 Of the North and the South to strive,
 After Ptolemies and their gnomes
 And Seleucids, armies of Rome's,
 And then the Sunnite regencies
 Down to Ottoman tyrannies.
 The stone that was cut without hands
 In Daniel two a kingdom stands
 Of the Messiah true and strong.
 In Daniel seven come along
 It's kingdom of the Son of Man,
 In Daniel eight the cleansing of
 The Sanctuary set above,
 And finally in Daniel twelve
 Michael standing up with axe helve:
 All these are one and the same here,
 The guiding hope from dark and fear.

The first three kingdoms are defined
 By name in Daniel two resigned
 In verse thirty-eight and to spare
 In chapter eight and everywhere
 In verses twenty-one and two
 As Babylon, and then the crew
 Of Medo-Persia, Grecia too,
 And so these are beyond dispute,
 Unless one reverts to the toot
 That Media and Persia must be
 Divided into separate quais,
 Assuming second-century writer
 Did not know history like a blighter,
 And so made the pseudepigraph
 Not knowing they were joint for staff.

The disagreement only comes
 After this section in the hums
 Of the historicists. The late
 Ones of eighteenth century for fate
 Tended to find the Vatican
 Throughout these ages in their span,
 But Isaac Newton saw at end
 Of Daniel eleven the bend
 Of the Ottomans as the King
 Of the North, and so Smith on wing.

I think that Rome or any power
 Outside the Middle East an hour
 Is questionable as a choice
 Because of territory's voice,
 Despite intrusion of Crusades
 Into Jerusalem for spades,
 Anomaly hardly surprising
 If Daniel was a man surmising.
 That's all for centuries twelve and after.
 Rome is significant for laughter
 Only in meddling in affairs
 Of Seleucids and the bug-bears
 Of Ptolemies and finally
 Ruling for after century,
 But not for Pontiff at the stake
 Of Vatican or in his wake.
 At least by century for the east
 Of the empire was led to feast
 By the north-south dichotomy
 In itself, as theology
 Went and as in connection with
 Jerusalem and not a myth.
 In sum that continued until
 Sunnite invasion of the hill,
 Which has remained in place until
 The final period that comes at
 Beginning of Daniel 12 flat.

While one may still be impressed by
 Detailed intuition or sigh
 Of divine knowledge of the man,
 It is not necessary plan
 To exclude one interpretation
 For another as only station,
 As long as it accounts for what
 The prophet writes and writes in glut.
 The types of stress and tension found
 Between the secular or round
 Pagan powers and commandment-keepers
 Are just about the same for bleepers
 In every time and place on earth.
 The prophecy contains in berth
 Configuration of oppression,
 Political and psycho session,
 Descent and the survival that
 Ultimately ought to bespat
 Governments and rulers abounding
 Who impinge on the conscience sounding
 Of those who uphold law of God.
 Not only are the papacy
 And Sunnite empires full and free
 Contenders for Little Horn Prize,
 So is each other power in guise
 In any part of the world wise
 In any age, that fosters laws
 Of set religion giving claws.

The meaningful is not that such
 Detail in prophecy may touch
 Vicissitudes of power that set
 In Palestine for centuries met.
 What's meaningful is that the case
 Of sensitive approach in base
 To the reality in time
 In the sixth century and clime
 Produced in prophecy also
 A systematic faith to go.
 As one's inclined here to accept
 Aesthetic judgement of adept
 Art critic in regard to paint,
 One might be inclined as a saint
 To take the faith values that rise
 From Daniel's visions to the skies.
 A man who could predict the course
 Of events over the divorce
 Of two millennia and more
 Is worth the trouble on the score
 In matters spiritual in store.

The major verdicts of the man
 Are as follows and show the ban
 That's typical of those who live

Under regimes that fail to give
 Glory to God of Torah's sieve.
 First is avoidance of flesh food
 That is unclean by death or brood.
 So Daniel one shows that the way
 To eat is vegetarian hay
 When kosher food is not around.
 The second is participation
 In secular or pagan nation
 Does not include participation
 In idol worship for a ration,
 And Daniel two and three make clear.
 When holy temple was not near,
 Prayer in prostration towards the place
 Three times a day is divine grace
 As Daniel six, verse ten can trace.
 So the faith under false regime
 Contains three points as it would seem:
 Avoidance of the impure and
 Idolatry and daily stand
 Of prayer no matter what's at hand.

Other values too come to view:
 Practice of dream-finding that's true,
 The awareness that God is due
 To control earthly events too
 Despite illusion of the power
 Come down in empires built in tower.
 Belief that God will punish sin
 Underlies everything in bin,
 Though perhaps not now, but in time
 Of final judgement for each crime.

Beside the visions and the values,
 The book contains some other dahlias:
 The question of chronology.
 I've already shown that the tree
 Is broken by Smith in the verse
 Twenty-three of eleven's curse.
 The implication is that all
 The visionary cycles' call
 Is ordered in sequence to fall
 From the time of the vision's stake
 To consummation in its wake.
 But there are sequences that need
 Fitting together in their speed
 In chapters eight and nine and twelve.

In sequence of chapter eight and
 Nine, I accept Uriah's stand
 Without comment or some correction.
 After Antiochus' rejection
 As irrelevant to the book,
 There is no reason now to look
 For fault with the historicist

Position of Smith in the fist
 Of timing of these chapters' brook.

The time sequence of Daniel eight
 Begins in verse fourteen to state:
 And he told me, "Unto the length
 Of two thousand three hundred's strength
 Of evenings and mornings, then shall
 Be put right the holy corral."
 Two questions stay without reply
 In Daniel eight without a sigh.
 When does this era come to start,
 And how is it reckoned in part,
 As literal days or indeed
 As years prophetic writ in seed?
 The only stated time to start
 Is in the next chapter to show
 When start the seventy weeks to go.
 That is the going forth at last
 Of the decreed to rebuild fast
 Jerusalem and God's house row.
 Accepting the day for a year
 And Adventist time-line in gear
 For Daniel eight and nine falls well
 As follows in the running spell.

Year four five seven sees the start
 Of the decree to build the cart
 Of the city, plus seven weeks
 To four oh eight when finished cheeks
 Of the walls rose, plus sixty-two
 Weeks to year twenty-seven's view
 Of common era when the great
 Messiah got anointed state,
 Plus one-half week to thirty-one
 When he was cut off by the gun
 Of Rome, and one-half week to add
 Up to thirty-four, when the glad
 Covenant consummation had,
 And then the line is drawn up to
 The end of two thousand in view
 And three hundred years to begin
 Cleansing sanctuary from sin.

Time prophecies in Daniel twelve
 Are stated to begin to shelve
 When the abomination of
 Desolation is set to shove
 Jerusalem. Here Smith relates
 That the establishment in rates
 Of Papacy between the years
 Five oh eight and thirty-eight years
 The time begins as in arrears.
 Add to that twelve hundred and sixty
 Years (time and times and at last mixty

The half of time) and you come to
 Seventeen ninety-eight in view
 With falling of the papal crew
 And start of the end time in view.
 To take Smith's principle to heart,
 That territory plays a part,
 I would see the fulfilment stay
 In Palestine and not the way
 Of France or Rome, either in sway.
 Furthermore Smith's view leaves the day
 Of twelve ninety as well as ray
 Of thirteen thirty-five to stray
 In limbo. First of all, the year
 Five oh eight itself to appear
 Is calculated counting back
 From seventeen ninety-eight slack,
 A questionable way to say
 The least. This arbitrary point
 Of departure makes out of joint
 Smith's view of the twelve ninety and
 Thirteen thirty-five days to stand.

But if we take the desolation
 In Daniel eleven in station
 To refer to incursions brought
 On the city when Sunnites sought
 To conquer it, then we are taught
 Several dates after Romans fought
 In the first century in plot.
 The invasion by Omar came
 In six three four, the battle flame
 Of Yarmuk in six three six and
 The capture of the town to stand
 Two years later in thirty-eight.
 But then Omar did not create
 Cessation of the daily nor
 Set up abomination's store.
 Abdul Malik completed it
 By making Jerusalem sit
 As seat of the caliphate and
 By building the dome of the rock
 On the temple mount there to stand
 In six nine one right on the clock.
 All time sequences in the last
 Chapter of Daniel come to blast
 Off as a day for a year in
 Predictions that start with the din
 In six three four and end at last
 In eighteen ninety-four and cast
 To nineteen twenty-four and yet
 Up to nineteen sixty-nine's set.
 Or then they start in ninety-one
 And end in nineteen fifty-one,

And eighty-one and at the last
 In twenty-twenty-six aghast.

Other important dates that came,
 Such as Crusader kingdom's fame
 In ten nine nine are quite ignored
 Simply because such kings adored
 Did not change the state of the town,
 Under which the reign settled down
 With the abomination there,
 After the capture of the fair.
 The dates of fifty-one and more,
 Eighty-one may start a new score.

The last of these dates has not come,
 But annexation of the sum
 Of east Jerusalem set off
 Influx of Sunnite men to scoff
 Into the city in that year
 From Jordan and Arab lands' fear.
 Furthermore in eighty the rule
 Of Israel gave out a spool
 Declaring the town united
 And capital of the land bid,
 And implemented the next year.
 Forty-five years later we trust
 To see the end of vision's burst,
 An opportunity to set
 The divine kingdom not yet met
 Up in the town that Daniel knew
 Was the seat of the divine due.
 The choice remains in human view.

I would not see so far in time
 That Daniel's prophecy's a crime
 Determined on the day and year.
 Rather, I see the chance in fear
 To turn then, now or after and
 Begin to keep the Lord's command.

No doubt that Smith and Newton are
 Far brighter lights than I in star,
 And my interpretation's set
 In poverty of knowledge met.
 But prophecies may sometimes be
 Understood in new ways in fee,
 As God appeals to human hearts
 Today to make their righteous starts.
 And so whether right or wrong I
 Return to appeal to the sky
 That all men should come to obey
 The law of Daniel's kingdom's sway,
 The divine rule restored on high.

Daniel 1

1 In the third year of the king's reign,

Jehoiakim king of Judah,
 Nebuchadnezzar *crossed the plain*,
 The king of Babylon *and law*
 Came to Jerusalem, lay siege.
 2 And the Lord gave the king, *His liege*,
 Judah's Jehoiakim in hand,
 And from the house of Alohim
 Vessels he carried to the land
 Of Shinar to his god's esteem
 And placed in his god's house's treasure.
 3 The king told Ashpenaz his pleasure,
 The master of his eunuchs, bring
 Of Israel's folk, sons of the king
 And of the nobles, 4 young men who
 Had no blemish, good-looking, true
 In all wisdom, possessing fact
 And quick to understand, and act
 With able service in the court
 Of the king, and whom with resort
 They might teach Chaldee tongue and law.
 5 And the king set them plethora
 Of daily fare, delicacies
 Royal and wine from his own ease,
 And three years training after which
 They might serve the king without hitch.
 6 Now from among those Judah's sons
 Were Daniel, first among the ones
 Who arrived there with Hananiah,
 And Mishael, and Azariah.
 7 To them the chief eunuch gave names:
 He named Daniel Belteshazzar,
 And to the others equal claims,
 To Hananiah, Shadrach, and
 To Mishael, Meshach as planned,
 To Azariah, Abed-Nego,
Which didn't do much for his ego.

Though I am not a son of nobleman,
 At least not in recent clan history,
 Nor given stipend by the king who can
 Open the doors of Babylon for me,
 I still find that my years pass in the dire
 Regions ruled by spilt blood and kindled
 fire,
 And like the four youths sent to far-off
 land,
 I find the pork and wine on table stand.
 A game or two attaches to my name
 And titles, may You not see them for
 blame,
 Beloved, who in the midst of fame and
 feast

Rejoice to find myself with You the least.
 Keep me, Beloved, within the worldly
 court
 Beneath the silks and jewels a humble sort.

8 But Daniel purposed in his heart
 He'd not defile himself with part
 Of the king's delicacies, nor
 With the wine which he drank, therefore
 He asked the chief eunuch that he
 Might not defile himself *on plea*.
 9 Now Alohim had brought Daniel
 Into the chief's grace and goodwill
 10 The chief eunuch said to Daniel,
 "I fear my lord the king, whose will
 Appointed your food and drink. Why
 Should he see your faces far cry
 From other young men of your age?
 Then you would bring my pilgrimage
 Before the king to early end."
 11 So Daniel told the steward whom
 The chief of eunuchs put in room
 Over Daniel, Hananiah,
 And Mishael, and Azariah,
 12 "Please test your servants for ten days,
 And let them give us lentil stew
 To eat and water to drink too.
 13 "Let our appearance then appraise
 Compared with their appearance who
 Eat from the king's delicacies,
 And as you see fit, with us do."

Let me, Beloved, make purpose in my heart
 As Daniel did to leave the worldly part
 And take Your sustenance and wealth alone
 Despite my veils of blood and flesh and
 bone.

No help is in the wine of heady power,
 But water is refreshment of my hour.
 No help is in the costly condiment
 Of wealth and education that is sent
 By worldly church and worldly
 government.

Let me, Beloved, make purpose firm and
 true
 In what I say, and what I think and do
 To take no sign nor other discernment
 Except the better sign that comes from
 You.

Let me give up the borrowed and the lent.

14 So he answered their entreaties

To test them ten days in the matter.
 15 After ten days they'd faces fatter
 And better than all the young men
 Who ate the king's fare, *pork and hen*.
 16 So the steward took away their
 Portion of delicacies' fare
 And the wine that they were to drink,
 And gave them lentil soup, *just think*.

That anyone should find himself the fatter
 Will not gain favour, Beloved, to Your
 matter
 In these days and this clime where fashion
 says
 That unisex alone finds any praise,
 And men must be beardless and women
 hipless,
 Or be cast on the beach for once and
 shipless.
 The story lacks reality, I think,
 Since now we know who eat fat-back and
 drink
 Corn liquor get their weight from that clear
 brew,
 While eating lentil soup's the thing to do
 For losing weight. This is my last
 conclusion:
 This story's miracle or else confusion.
 I take, Beloved, Your miracles as mine
 And wallow in their glory as divine.

17 As for these four young men, God gave
 Them knowledge and skill, *although slave*,
 In all writing and wisdom, and
 Daniel understood *out of hand*
 All visions and dreams. 18 Now at end
 Of the days, *at the dividend*,
 When the king had said they should be
 Brought in, the chief of eunuchs brought
 Them in before the king to see
 Nebuchadnezzar had them taught.
 19 Then the king interviewed them, and
 Among them all *in his command*
 None was found like Daniel, *his friend*
 Hananiah, Mishael, and *end*
 With Azariah, therefore they
 Served before the king *from that day*.
 20 In all matters of wisdom and
 Understanding which by command
 The king examined them, he found
 Them ten times better *all around*
 Than all the magicians *and those*

Astrologers who *came to pose*
 In all his realm. 21 So Daniel stayed
 Until King Cyrus' first year *grieved*.

Four men of knowledge represent the gates
 Into the city where true knowledge waits.
 "God is my judge" opens both law and
 seeing
 The mystic future to which all are fleeing.
 "YHWH has been gracious" opens the first
 text
 Of bright Qur'an in gate of love's pretext.
 "Who is like God?" expresses best of all
 The gate of Your awareness, where by call
 The human heart perceives all things as
 You
 See from Your high and universal view.
 The fourth gate in row is that "YHWH has
 helped"
 As far as where the howling dervish
 yelped.
 Beloved, I join hands with the holy four
 Whose messages still dance before Your
 door.

Daniel 2

1 It happened in the second year
 Now of Nebuchadnezzar's reign,
 Nebuchadnezzar had dreams' fear,
 And his spirit troubled amain
 So that his sleep left him awake.
 2 Then the king gave for command's sake
 To call the magicians *his way*,
 Astrologers *by night and day*,
 The sorcerers to have their say,
 And Chaldeans saying what seems
 To tell the wakeful king his dreams.
 They came and stood before the king.
 3 And the king said to them this thing,
 "I've had a dream, and spirit fails
 To know the dream *and what it hails*."
 4 Then the Chaldeans spoke aloud
 To the king in a fragrant cloud
 Of Aramaic, "O king, live
 Forever! Tell now positive
 To your servants the dream, and we
 Will give the meaning for a fee."

Such soothsayers and psychoanalysts
 As then and now pretend to clarify
 The depths of human mind and dream and
 mists

Always demand the victim justify
The specialists' *raison d'être* by stating
The problem first in terms the clever can
Twist into meaning in their re-relating.
The king is right to lay them under ban.
Beloved, I see no portents in my dream
Nor prophecy beyond the things that seem,
And yet the message of Your truth is set
Before me in each thing around me met:
Creator mirrored in the universe,
One and alone divine in prose and purse.

5 The king answered and said to them,
The Chaldeans, "Don't haw and hem,
My decision is firm: if you
Do not make known the dream for true
To me, and its meaning, you shall
Be cut in pieces *cubical*,
And your houses shall be made heap
Of ash. 6 "However, if you keep
To tell the dream and its meaning,
You shall receive from me *a string*
Of gifts, rewards, and great honour.
Therefore tell me the dream and her
Interpretation." 7 They answer
Again and say, "Let the king tell
His servants of the dream, and well
Shall we give its interpretation."
8 The king answered with this citation,
"I know for certain that you would
Gain time, because you see my *good*
Decision. 9 "If you do not make
Known the dream to me, *for your sake*
Just one decree for you! For you
Have agreed to speak what's untrue,
Lying and corrupt words to me
Till the time has changed, so be free
To tell me the dream, and I shall
Know that you can give me its *sal*
And meaning." 10 The Chaldeans said
In answer to the king *as led*,
"There's not a man on earth who can
Tell the king's matter, so *no man*
No king, no lord, or ruler asked
Such things of any *one unmasked*
Magician or astrologer,
Or Chaldean *or to confer*.

Exploiters bow at last and then confess
That all they do is hear and smile and
guess,
But truth is not the terrain of a man,

And only You know anything or can.
Exploiters bow at last to save their lives,
And if it were not so that they had hives
They would not bend and plead for
information.
They would be satisfied with their paid
station.
Beloved, send more kings on the earth to
make
The claims the elegance shown to the stake.
Give sense to those who fear and fawn
before
Physicians and psychiatrists in score
And analysts of money and of state.
Send such kings soon, and may they not be
late.

11 "*It is a difficult thing that*
The king requests, and there's none at
The trick to tell it to the king
Except the gods, and whose dwelling
Is not with flesh." 12 For this reason
The king was angry *under sun*
And filled with fury, gave command
To destroy all those in the land
Of Babylon, and all its wise.
13 So the decree went out *by spies*,
And they began killing the wise,
And they sought Daniel and his friends,
To kill *them all and bring their ends*.

The king Nebuchadnezzar found them out,
Both psychoanalyst and Jungian
He stands against the wall, victims of
doubt.
It is pretence for any ranging man
To claim to sound the depths of soul and
mind.
And so the king enlightened goes to find
Interpreters of dreams to kill them all.
Kings make a better world at beck and call.
Astrologer and psychic here today,
Who follow the same charts and foolish
way,
Are not worse than the sacred scientist
Who gives psychology a novel twist.
Beloved, except for killing and the pall,
I praise Nebuchadnezzar most of all.

14 Then with counsel and wisdom he,
Daniel said to Arioch, see,
The captain of the king's guard, who

Had gone out to kill all and few
 Of the wise *men* of Babylon,
 15 He answered and said to *the son*,
 To Arioch the king's captain, "Why
 Is the decree from king so spry?"
 Then Arioch made decision known
 To Daniel. 16 So Daniel when shown
 Went in and asked the king to give
 Him time, that he might go and live
 And tell the king interpretation.
 17 Then Daniel went *with supplication*
 To his house, and made the decree
 Known to Hananiah to be,
 And Mishael, and Azariah,
 All his companions, *not pariah*,
 18 That they might seek mercies from God,
 Allah of heaven for this *sod*
And secret, so that Daniel and
 His friends might not perish in band
 With the wise of Babylon's land.
 19 Then the secret was revealed to
 Daniel in a night vision's *clue*.
 So Daniel blessed Allah of heaven.
 20 Daniel answered and said *at seven*,
 "Blessed be the name of Allah now
 And ever, for this dream in brow,
 For its wisdom and might are His.
 21 And He changes the time that is,
 And the seasons, He removes kings
 And raises up kings, He gives things
 Of wisdom to the wise and knowing
 To those with understanding going.
 22 He reveals deep and secret things,
 He knows what *is* in the darkness,
 And light dwells with His *name to bless*.
 23 "I thank You and praise You, Allah
 Of my ancestors *held in awe*,
 You have lent me wisdom and might,
 And have made known to me the right
 Thing that we asked of You, for You
 Have made known to us *with this clue*
 The king's demand *and what to do*."

The secrets of the human soul and yet
 The politics that move the world to bet
 Are all found in Your mercy and Your
 word

That moves the praying soul, leaves not
 unstirred.

By blessing the name of the Alohim
 I penetrate the veils of things that seem
 And find the secret of the kingly dream.

I lay hold on that wisdom and that might
 That makes the dervish retire from the sight
 Of those who wield the sceptre, and alone
 I thank You, my Beloved, not made of
 stone,
 That You set up the kingdoms on the
 throne
 And bring them down together to the night.
 I quietly look on the woeful sight.

24 So Daniel went to Arioch,
 Whom the king had appointed *stock*
 To kill the wise of Babylon.
 He went and said to him *at dawn*,
 "Don't kill the wise of Babylon,
 Take me before the king, and I
 Will tell the king *and not belie*."
 25 Then Arioch quickly brought in
 Daniel before the king within,
 And said to him, "I've found a man
 Of Judah's captives, one who can
 Make known the meaning to the king."
 26 The king answered and said this thing
 To Daniel, named Belteshazzar,
 "Are you able *to be a star*
 To make known to me the dream which
 I have seen, and its meaning's pitch?"
 27 Daniel answered before the king,
 And said, "The secret which the king
 Has demanded, the wise *men*, and
 Astrologers, magicians *planned*,
 And the soothsayers cannot tell
 Before the king. 28 "But there's One well,
 Allah who is in heaven to dwell,
 Who can reveal each secret spell,
 He has made known to you the King
 Nebuchadnezzar what shall bring
 The latter days. Your dream, and your
 Visions of your head on the score
 Of your bed, were these: 29 "As for you,
 O king, thoughts came to you *while you*
 Were on your bed, *about* what would
 Come to pass after these things should,
 And He who reveals secrets made
 Known to you what will be *displayed*.
 30 "But as for me, this secret's not
 Been given to me because I've got
 More wisdom than anyone living,
 But for *our* sakes who have been giving
 Interpretation to the king,
 And that you may know everything
 Of the thoughts in your heart *that spring*."

Rare thing it is that seeing, knowing men
 Should be brought to the palace once again.
 Rare thing it is a king seeks Your divine
 Word and the secret of the slightly wine.
 The king is far beyond nobility
 Of any ruler since Rome sought to be.
 The best a ruler in these days can do
 Is seek astrologer, magician's view.
 Beloved, the statesmanship the world once
 knew
 Has gone the way of all flesh like the dew.
 The visions on their beds are vain things
 too,
 Not the great themes Nebuchadnezzar
 drew.
 Daniel himself is humble in his mind
 That he bears no secrets to humankind.

31 "You, O king, were watching, indeed,
 A great image! Great to exceed
 This great image, whose splendour *was*
 Excellent, stood before your *cause*,
 And its form *was* awesome indeed.
 32 "This image's head *was* fine gold,
 Its chest and arms of silver *cold*,
 Its belly and thighs bronze *made bold*,
 33 "Its legs of iron, its feet in part
 Of iron and part of clay *in art*.
 34 "You watched while a stone was cut out
 Without hands, and which struck about
 The image on its feet of *hard*
 Iron and clay, shattered *to shard*.
 35 "The iron, the clay, the bronze, and yet
 The silver, and the gold were met
 And crushed together, and became
 Like chaff from summer threshing frame,
 The wind bore them away so that
 No trace was found where they had sat.
 The stone that struck the image came
 To be a great mountain, *its name*
 Filled the whole earth *with its great fame*.
 36 "This *is* the dream, now we shall tell
 Its meaning to the king *and well*.
 37 "You, O king, *are* a king of kings.
 For Allah of heaven *and all things*
 Has given you a kingdom, power,
 Strength, and glory, 38 "and *for an hour*
 Wherever the children of men
 Live, or the beasts of field *again*
 And the birds of the heaven, He
 Has given *them* into your hand,

And made you ruler *in the land*
 Over them all: this head of gold
 Is you. 39 "But after you *are told*
 Shall rise another kingdom less
 In power to yours, and then *a guess*,
 A third kingdom of bronze appears,
 Which shall rule on all earth *with tears*.
 40 "And the fourth kingdom shall be strong
 As iron, as iron breaks all before
 In pieces, shatters every store,
 And like iron that crushes, *that king*
 Will break in pieces everything
 And crush all others *in the wing*.

Four kingdoms of the ancient world appear
 Before Nebuchadnezzar's eyes in fear:
 The golden kingdom Babylon meets fate
 Degeneration in the Persian state,
 When Mede and Persian take the silver
 throne.
 A king of bronze, Alexander alone
 Followed the Persian idol, till he met
 Disintegration at his generals' threat.
 Babylon, Medo-Persia, Greece and kings
 Of north and south are waiting in the
 wings.
 Your kingdom, my Beloved, is mountain
 set
 From stone that crushes all into the fret.
 The world of history has found reflection
 In the prophetic sentence's election.

41 "Whereas you saw the feet and toes,
 Partly of potter's clay *that rose*
 And partly of iron, that king shall
 Divided be, yet *decimal*
 The strength of iron shall be in it,
 Just as you saw the iron fit
 And mix with clay. 42 "And *as* the toes
 Of the feet *were* partly *as grows*
 Of iron and partly of the clay,
 So the kingdom in part shall sway
 In strength and partly fragile be.
 43 "As you saw iron mixedly
 With clay, they will mingle with seed
 Of men, but they will not succeed
 Adhering to each other's way,
 Just as iron does not mix with clay.

Divided was the land left by the great
 Alexander indeed to meet its fate
 In four reduced to two, though iron legs,

Depending once on Rome and its tent-pegs,
Divided north and south, the city store
Of Alexandria and iron legs before
And Damascus the ancient where awaits
The northern king of far and scattered
states.

Beloved, the pleasant land, the favoured
land
Comes always down beneath an iron hand,
And yet the seat of Your throne that's not
seen

By human eye arises bright and keen
Within the heart that turns in faith to You,
In faith indeed, because You have no view.

44 "And in the days of these kings will
Allah of heaven set up *His hill*,
Kingdom never to be destroyed,
The kingdom shall not be deployed
Unto another people *void*,
It shall break in pieces, consume
All these kingdoms, and *bring their doom*
To stand forever in their room.

45 "Inasmuch as you saw that stone
Was cut out of mountain alone
Without hands, and that it broke up
In pieces iron, the bronze, the cup
Of clay, the silver, and the gold
The great Allah now here has told
The king what will come to pass soon.
The dream is certain, and its boon
Interpretation sure *as noon*."

In the days of the kings of iron and clay
Shall You, Beloved, set up eternal sway.
Indeed I've seen the echoes of that realm
Where reigns a thousand years one at the
helm

Invisible behind each church and state.
I hear the ripples of both love and hate,
And know that one invisible retains
The levers and the steering and the reins.
Beloved, the Master of the Age may be
Hidden from sight, and yet he faithfully
Appeared in the days of those fabled kings.
The hope of truth and justice still appears
Behind the tabled watches of the years
With peace the perfume of its beating
wings.

46 Then King Nebuchadnezzar fell
Upon his face, prostrate *a spell*

Before Daniel, commanded that
They should present *where Daniel sat*
An offering and incense to him.
47 The king answered Daniel, said grim,
"Your Allah is Allah of gods,
The Lord of kings, *breaker of pods*
And a revealer of secrets,
Since you could tell where secret sets."
48 Then the king promoted Daniel
And gave many great gifts and swell,
And he made him ruler of all
The province of Babylon's *hall*,
And chief administrator over
All the wise of Babylon's *trover*.
49 Also Daniel petitioned king,
He set Shadrach over a thing,
Meshach, and Abed-Nego on
Affairs of province Babylon,
But Daniel *sat* within the gate
Of the king, *and sat there in state*.

Revealing of the secret things to come
By Daniel made his future, a thing rum,
At court, and so he found a place to stand
For his friends too, nepotism is grand.
The king would offer incense to the man
As though he were a god. Such things in
scan

Predict a razor walk among the men
Who shuffle in the court for power again.
A better reward might have been a place
Of safety, a small cottage with a trace
Of spring water, and amply every week
The bread and lentils that our bodies seek.
Beloved, I pity Daniel for the wise
Things You revealed to him down from the
skies.

Daniel 3

1 Nebuchadnezzar the king made
An image of gold, *when displayed*
Its height was sixty cubits *and*
Its width six cubits *on the land*.
He set it up in Dura plain,
In Babylon's province amain.

Before I judge the king for pride to make
An image all of gold for the mistake
Of the dream's image with its metals base
That cut off Babylon without a trace,
Let me remember that the dream's account

Gave the king room to change the saddle's
mount.

The magic act of turning all to gold
Is just what such a king would do once told
He should fall to another and less fair
As silver is to gold upon the air.
A wise thing the king did in affirmation
Of his eternity on earthly station.
Beloved, we men are wise in what we do,
Although our motives spoil us in the pew.

Sweet Christian reads the word along with
Jew

And thinks the king of Babylon would do
Rebellion and rejection of the dream
That he had in warning from Alohim.
But surely what he did in building craft
Of golden image was not something daft,
But was consistent with what he had
learned.

He went about to fix with what he earned
The coming in catastrophe and weight.
He believed You, Beloved, and in Your
great

Vision, and so he acted for the State.
He made an image magic to replace
Foul change with some stability in place,
And so gave glory to Your honoured face.

2 And King Nebuchadnezzar sent
To gather the satraps absent,
Administrators, and the rest
Of governors, and of the best
Of councillors, the treasurers,
The judges, magistrates *in furs*,
And all the provinces' officials,
To assist at the grand solsticials
Of dedication for the idol
Which King Neb *not tyrannicidal*
Had set up. 3 So the satraps, and
Administrators *of the land*,
The governors, the councillors,
The treasurers, judges *of course*,
The magistrates, and all officials
Of all the provinces' *judicials*
Gathered together dedicating
The image King Neb was instating,
And they stood there before the clone
Image, Nebuchadnezzar's own.
4 Then a herald cried out aloud
"To you it is commanded, crowd,
And peoples, nations, and *all* speeches,

5 "*That* at the time you hear the breaches
Of horn, and flute, and harp, and lyre,
And psaltery, all sound in choir
With every kind of music heard,
You shall fall down and *by my word*
Worship the gold image that King
Nebuchadnezzar's set *to swing*,
6 "And whoever does not fall down
And worship shall be cast *by crown*
Forthwith into a fiery furnace
Able in midst to kill and burn us."

Any who should refuse to fall in faith
Before the image would be but a wraith,
The enemy of the eternal state.
Affirming the reign was the duty taught
To all the courtiers in every plot.
The purpose was not worship of a god
Of gold set as an idol on the sod,
The purpose was a magic act to make
Of none effect the ominous intake
Of the portentous dream of the poor king.
The symphony, the sounding of the ring
Was there to force the issue with a thing
Of music that should make all men fall
down.
Such music's not heard now in any town.

7 So at that time, when all the people
Heard the sound *peeling from the steeple*
Of horn, flute, harp, *and of the lyre*,
All kinds of music in a choir,
Then all the people, nations, and
Languages fell down *in a band*
And prostrated before the gold
Image set up by the king bold
Nebuchadnezzar his name told.

Most ancient use of the word symphony
That I know was written for all to see
How music can be used to unify
The dregs and rulers of society
And force behaviours without thought or
eye,
But overwhelming commands from the sky
In echoes drawn from the symphonic
heights,
Binaural tones sweeping the masses by.
Music cares naught for any human rights,
Cares naught for analytic thought, nor
sights
In intuition, but straightly imposes

Emotions and motives within what chose
us
To do the will of king. Beloved, let Your
Music alone batter down my heart's door.

8 Therefore at that time certain ones
Of the Chaldeans came *with guns*
Forward and accused the Jews' sons.
9 They spoke and they said unto King
Nebuchadnezzar *of the thing*,
"O king, forever live! 10 "And you,
O king, have made a law to do
That everyone who hears the sound
Of the horn, flute, harp, lyre, *and round*
The psaltery, all sing in choir
With all kinds of music *in fire*,
Shall fall down and worship the gold
Image, 11 "and whoever's so bold
As not to fall down and worship
Shall be cast into the *midship*
Of burning fiery furnace *strip*.
12 "There are certain Jews whom you've
set

Over affairs of province met
In Babylon: Shadrach, Meshach,
And Abed-Nego, these men lack,
O king, their due regard for you.
They do not serve your gods on cue
Or worship the gold image you
Have set up." 13 Then in rage and fury
Nebuchadnezzar gave *in hurry*
The command to bring Shadrach and
Meshach, and Abed-Nego's *band*.
So they brought these men to the king.
14 Nebuchadnezzar spoke a thing
Saying to them, "*Is truly so*,
Shadrach, Meshach, Abed-Nego,
That you do not serve my gods or
Worship the gold image before
Which I have set up? 15 "Now if you
Are ready when you hear the cue
Of horn, flute, harp, lyre, *and psaltery*,
All sound in choir in symphony
With all kinds of music, and you
Fall down and worship idol I
Have made, *then that will satisfy*.
But if you do not worship, you
Shall be cast forthwith and adieu
Into the midst of fiery furnace
Which is able in flame to burn us.
And who *is* Allah who'll save you

From my hands?" 16 Shadrach, Meshach
too,
Abed-Nego answered and said
To the king *to whom they were led*,
"O Nebuchadnezzar, we've no
Need to answer you in this show.
17 "If *that's the case*, our Allah whom
We serve is able to raise doom
Delivering us from burning fire
Of furnace, and He will desire
To save *us* from your hand, O king.
18 "But if not, may you know a thing,
O king, that we don't serve your gods,
Nor will we worship golden *clods*
Of image which you have set up,
So we're ready to drink the cup."

The orchestra and rock band that employed
To make the people bow and overjoyed
Meant nothing to the three who chose to
stand
While all the others in that wicked land
Bowed down to save the state. Note doing
so
Immediately implies idolic show,
And who supports the everlasting state
Straight off worships the idols of the great.
Beloved, I see the lack of power in will
Around me where the rock-beats come to
chill
The strategy of every human heart.
I see, and I chose now to do my part
In grasping human choice above the mill:
Beloved, I choose not to worship them still.

19 Then Nebuchadnezzar was full
Of fury, and his face gave pull
In changed expression towards *the men*
Shadrach, Meshach, and *then again*
Abed-Nego. He spoke and said
That they should heat the furnace fed
Seven times more than it was wont.
20 And he commanded *with a taunt*
Certain mighty men of valour
Who *were* in his army to floor
Shadrach, Meshach, Abed-Nego,
And cast them in the fire to go
Into the burning fiery kiln.
21 Then these men were bound in their *frill*
Coats, their trousers, their turbans, and
Their *other* clothes, and cast *in hand*
Into the middle of the fire

Burning in the furnace with ire.
22 Therefore, because the king's command
Was urgent, and the furnace band
Exceeding hot, the flame of fire
Killed those men who took up in quire
Shadrach, Meshach, Abed-Nego.

See the four gates of music when it comes
To support power and greed, the hope in
sums
To live eternally and spread one's power
Beyond the living of the single hour.
The first is falling prostrate at the sound,
The second is cunning complaint that round
About there stand a few who choose to be
Instead of submitting to the flow's spree.
The third is rage of ruler dancing well
To the beats of the drummers come from
hell.

The fourth is destruction in the great blaze
That rock music heats in its fatal craze.
Beloved, I choose to hear Your voice alone
In slender melodies where Psalms atone.

23 And these three men, *who were called*
so,
Shadrach, Meshach, Abed-Nego,
Fell down still bound into the fire
Burning in the furnace *with ire*.

Azariah

1 And they walked about in the flames,
Singing hymns of praise to the names
Of Alohim and blessing YHWH.
2 Then Azariah stood to do
Offering this prayer, in the fire
He opened his mouth *in desire*
And said: 3 "Blessèd are You, O YHWH
Alohim of our fathers, You
Are worthy of praise, and Your name
Is gloried for ever the same.

As I enter fire-gate in search of You,
Beloved, who are closer than heart vein,
shrew
Me that I search when You are nearer than
The places of my searching journeyman.
The cool flames burn about me in desire
To find what is not lost in hidden fire
Or in the dark caves of my heart and sense.
I bow myself to the obedience
Of knowing the Unknowable and True,

Reciting the praise of Your names wherein
You live and have Your being for Your kin.
You live upon a moving tongue and moist
Amidst the raging fires snapping and
voiced,
Accept, Beloved, the praises that I hoist.

4 For You are just in all that You
Have done to us, and all your works
Are true and your ways right, and lurks
In all your judgments only truth.
5 You have executed, forsooth
True judgments in all You have brought
Upon us and Jerusalem,
The holy city *and the gem*
Of our fathers *and what they sought*,
For in truth and justice You've brought
All this upon us for our sins.
6 For we in sin and lawlessness
Departed from You, and address
In all this disobedient
Against the commandments You've sent.
7 We've not observed them or done them,
As You've commanded us in hem
That it might go well with us here.
8 So all that You have brought on us,
And all that You have done to us,
You have done in true judgement's muss.
9 You have given us in the hands
Of lawless enemies in bands,
Most hateful rebels, and unto
An unjust king, the worst in view
In all the world. 10 And now we stay
With mouths shut and in shame's disgrace
Fallen on Your worshippers' race.
11 For your name's sake do not give us
Up altogether, disastrous,
And do not break your covenant,
12 And do not take your mercy's cant
From us, for sake of Abraham
Your beloved and for sake of lamb
Isaac Your servant and Israel
Your holy one, 13 to whom You spell
The promise to make their spawn great
As many as stars in the sky,
And as the sand on the shore by
The sea. 14 O Lord, we've become few,
Less than any nation in crew,
And are brought low this day in all
The world because of sins in thrall.
15 And at this time there is no prince,
Or prophet, or leader *to wince*,

No burnt offering, or sacrifice,
 Or oblation, or incense, and
 No place to make an offering stand
 Before You or to find mercy.
 16 Yet with a contrite heart to see,
 A humble spirit may we be
 Accepted, as though it were by
 Burnt offerings of rams and bulls nigh,
 And with tens of thousands of fat lambs,
 17 Such may our sacrifice *of hams*
 Be in Your eyes today, and may
 We wholly follow you *today*,
 For there will be no shame for those
 Who trust in You. 18 And now we chose
 With all our heart to follow You,
 We fear you and seek You too.
 19 Do not put us to shame, but deal
 With us so in Your mercy's weal,
 And in abundant grace to feel.
 20 Save us by Your miracles' power,
 And give Your name glory in hour,
 O YHWH! Let all who do harm to
 Your servants be put to shame's view,
 21 Let them be disgraced and deprived
 Of all power and its strength derived,
 And let their rule be broken down.
 22 And let them know that You are
 YHWH,
 The only Alohim *and true*,
 Glorious over all the earth."
 23 Now the king's servants who had
 thrown
 Them in did not cease on their own
 To feed the furnace fires with such
 Naphtha, and pitch, and tow, and brush.
 24 And the flame streamed out above it
 To forty-nine cubits arm-lengths to sit,
 25 And it broke through and burned those
 fit
 Of the Chaldeans whom it caught
 About the furnace *in the lot*.
 26 But YHWH's angel came down into
 The furnace to be with the crew
 Of Azariah and his friends,
 And drove the fiery flame in bends
 Out of the furnace, 27 and made it
 Like damp wind to whistle a bit,
 So that the fire did not touch them
 At all or hurt or trouble them.
 28 Then the three of them, with one voice,
 Praised, glorified and blessed by choice
 Alohim in the furnace, saying:

29 "Blessed are You, YHWH, to whom
 we're praying,
 And our ancestors' Alohim,
 And to be praised with high esteem
 For ever, 30 And blessed is Your name
 Of glory and of holy fame,
 To be highly praised and on high
 Exalted for ever and aye,
 31 Blessed are You in the temple of
 Your holy glory and above
 To be extolled and glorified
 For ever. 32 Blessed are You beside,
 Who upon the cherubim ride
 And look upon the deeps, to be
 Exalted everlastingly.
 33 Blessed are You upon the throne
 Of Your kingdom to be alone
 Extolled and honoured without ceasing.
 34 Blessed are You in the firmament
 Of heaven and to be sung increasing
 And glorified to full extent.
 35 "Bless YHWH, all works of YHWH,
 sing praise
 To Him exalted days and days.
 36 Bless YHWH, you heavens, sing praise
 to Him.
 37 Bless YHWH, you angels of YHWH,
 sing
 Praise to Him and exalt His ring
 For ever. 38 Bless YHWH, waters all
 Above the sky, sing praise and call
 To Him and exalt him for all.
 39 Bless YHWH, all powers, sing praise to
 Him
 And glorify Him to the rim
 Of space and time. 40 Bless YHWH, sun,
 moon,
 Praise Him and raise Him high and soon
 Throughout eternity in boon.
 41 Bless YHWH, stars of sky, and sing
 Praise to Him and lift up His wing
 For ever. 42 Bless YHWH, rain and dew,
 Sing praise to Him and raise His view
 For ever and for ever too.
 43 Bless YHWH, all winds, sing praise to
 Him
 And lift His glory to the dim
 Reaches of eternity's rim.
 44 Bless YHWH, both fire and heat, sing
 praise
 To Him and for ever to raise.
 45 Bless YHWH, winter cold and heat

Of summer, sing praise to His seat
 Exalting Him to all time meet.
 46 Bless YHWH, dews and snows, sing His
 praise
 For ever exalting His ways.
 47 Bless YHWH too, both the nights and
 days,
 Sing praise to him and highly raise
 His glory to the end of days.
 48 Bless YHWH, the light and darkness
 too,
 Sing praise to him with all the crew
 Of height and depth beyond time's view.
 49 Bless YHWH, ice and cold, sing His
 praise,
 Exalt Him to the end of days.
 50 Bless YHWH, frosts and snows, sing
 His praise,
 Lift for ever His gloried stays.
 51 Bless YHWH, lightnings and clouds,
 and sing
 Praise to Him with exalted wing
 For ever. 52 Let the earth bless YHWH,
 Let it sing praise to Him as due
 And highly exalt Him in view.
 53 Bless YHWH, mountains and hills, sing
 praise
 To him and highly glory raise
 To Him for ever. 54 Bless YHWH, all
 Things that grow on the earth, and call
 Praise to Him and above the wall
 Extend His plain above time's stall.
 55 Bless YHWH, you springs, sing praise
 to Him
 Exalt Him for ever with vim.
 56 Bless YHWH, seas and rivers, sing
 praise
 To him for ever glories raise.
 57 Bless YHWH, you whales and every
 beast
 That moves in the waters increased,
 Sing praise to Him, exalt His name
 Above all time and every claim.
 58 Bless YHWH, all the fowl of the air,
 Sing praise, exalt Him everywhere.
 59 Bless YHWH, all beasts and all the
 cattle,
 Sing praise to him, *above the battle*
 Sound His glory for ever too.
 60 Bless YHWH, you sons of men, sing
 praise
 To Him and high *above the rays*

Of the sun for ever fame raise.
 61 Bless YHWH, O Israel, sing praise
 To Him, exalt Him days and days.
 62 Bless YHWH, you priests of YHWH,
 and sing
 Praise to Him for ever on wing.
 63 Bless YHWH, you servants of YHWH,
 sing
 Praise to Him and lift up His spring
 For ever *above everything*.
 64 Bless YHWH, spirits and souls of Those
 Who are righteous *in rows on rows*,
 Sing praise to him, highly exalt
 For ever His name without fault.
 65 Bless YHWH, you who are holy and
 Humble in heart, sing praise in band
 To Him and lift Him high to stand
 For ever and on every hand.
 66 Bless YHWH, both Hananiah, and
 Azariah at Mishaël's hand,
 Sing praise to Him in righteous band
 For ever, for He's rescued us
 From Hades and saved from the fuss
 Of death's power and delivered us
 From the midst of the burning muss
 Of fiery furnace, from the fire
 He has delivered us *in choir*.
 67 Give thanks to YHWH, for He is good,
 His mercy lasts as long as could.
 68 Bless Him, all who worship YHWH,
 too,
 The Alohim of gods in crew,
 Sing praise to him and give thanks to
 Him, for His mercy ever true.”

24 Then King Nebuchadnezzar was
 Astonished, and he rose as does
 In haste *and* spoke, saying to his
 Counsellors, “Did we not, *that is*,
 Cast three men bound into the fire?”
 They said answering his desire
 And said to the king, “True, O king.”
 25 “Look!” he answered, “I see a thing,
 Four men loose, walking in the fire,
 And they are not hurt, and the face
 Of the fourth's like Allah's son's trace.”

Who make the central issue of their faith
 To be the Son of God instead of wraith
 Ought to consider that the first time this
 Term was used in the Scripture was amiss,
 Invented by the king of Babylon

Is it the faith of Babylon from dawn
 Of that heathenish system till the time
 When sons of God from every land and
 clime
 Shall once appear to bow before Your
 throne
 Acknowledging that You are God alone?
 Your Decalogue, the single sermon You
 Spoke in the hearing of all in the pew,
 And wrote with Your own finger, that is
 true,
 And is my faith, not gods that sons atone.

26 Then Nebuchadnezzar took pace
 Near the mouth of the burning sod
 Of fiery furnace, spoke a go,
 “Shadrach, Meshach, Abed-Nego,
 Servants of Most High Allah, show,
 Come out, and come *here* .” Then
 Shadrach,
 Meshach, Abed-Nego *no slack*
 Came from the midst of the hot fire.
 27 And the satraps *come to inquire*,
 Administrators, governors,
 And *all of* the king’s councillors
 Gathered together, and they saw
 These men on whose bodies *the claw*
 Of fire had no power, and the hair
 Of their head was not singed *though bare*,
 Nor were their garments affected,
 No smell of fire upon them hid.

The smell of smoke and hell-fire blows
 across
 The sacrificial floor of slave and boss
 Who sway before binaural beat and crash
 Come out to slay truth with its gutful slash.
 The masses are unhooked from reason’s
 help
 To join the hellish phantoms and their
 whelp.
 But I alone if need be stand above
 The flames of devil’s incense and his love
 To cantillate Your names alone that fly
 In secret and in sweetness from the sky.
 Beloved, the sounds that thunder and reply
 To other hearts leave mine cold on the sly.
 Instead I warm my soul on Scriptures sent
 To be sung with tongue, mind and heart
 and meant.

28 Nebuchadnezzar saying then

Spoke, “Blessed be Allah of *these men*
 Shadrach, Meshach, Abed-Nego,
 Who sent His Angel *here to show*
 Deliverance to His servants
 Who trusted in Him, and had sense
 To frustrate the king’s word, and yield
 Their bodies, that they have not kneeled
 To serve nor worship any god
 Except their own Allah *by rod!*
 29 “Therefore I make decree that no
 People, nation, or language stow
 Shall speak a thing amiss to show
 Against the God of Shadrach and
 Meshach, and last Abed-Nego
 But shall be cut in pieces, and
 Their houses made an ash heap, since
 There is no other god to wince
 Who can deliver like this *Prince*.”
 30 Then the king promoted upon
 Shadrach, Meshach, Abed-Nego
 In the province of Babylon
Because of their fantastic show.

If the great golden image was attempt
 At magic to avert catastrophe
 Upon the kingdom by some folk unkempt,
 Then what was done there by the faithful
 three
 Was no more or less than subversion spent
 Upon the State of Babylon, and meant
 That magic failed because three stood
 instead
 Of bowing down hand, body, foot and
 head.
 Beloved, if those three had bowed down to
 fate,
 Obeying the great king come soon and late,
 Would not fair Babylon have stood as state
 Till end of time, and till the consummate?
 Rightly the rulers flay the heretic,
 Rightly they come, accuse and make it
 stick.

See, my Beloved, the first thing that the
 king
 Decrees as soon as he is shot in wing
 Acknowledging that You are One alone:
 He forces men and minds that should atone
 For his own errors in sceptre and throne.
 The use of force, the will to kill, is found
 Wherever Your commandments’ faithful
 sound

Is buried in the trash of stealth and state,
 Is set aside for entertainment late
 Upon the stage of drum and groan for fate.
 Beloved, we need no kings to force Your
 will,
 We need no force at all to foot the bill,
 But only the adherence of all men
 To the commands in promise from Your
 den.

Daniel 4

1 Wrote Nebuchadnezzar the king,
 To peoples, nations, tongues this thing,
 To all that live in all the earth:
 Peace multiplied to you in worth.
 2 I thought good to declare the signs
 And wonders that Most High Allah
 Has worked for me. 3 How great His signs,
 And how mighty His wonders' awe!
 His kingdom *is* everlasting,
 A kingdom domain extending
 From generation *at the first*
 To the last generation's *burst*.

The hidden hand of power, the devilish
 state
 Knows how to sing Your praises soon and
 late,
 Beloved, see how the wakened king writes
 now
 That he's confronted with the divine brow.
 The one point of praise that he sees to note
 Is that Your kingdom's everlasting boat,
 The very thing he coveted himself,
 The sly creature, the evil, cunning elf!
 It's jealousy of You that fuels his part
 In praising and in singing from the heart.
 That is the seed that grows establishment
 Of faith, both church and synagogue and
 bent
 Mosque in this world, where truly Your
 name's praised,
 But at the core all systems are power-
 crazed.

4 I, Nebuchadnezzar, was at
 Rest in my house *and where I sat*,
 And flourishing in my palace.
 5 I saw a dream which made my face
 Afraid, and the thoughts on my bed
 And the visions within my head
 Troubled me. 6 Therefore I issued

Decree to bring in all *reviewed*
 The wise *men* of Babylon to
 Me, that they might make known the clue
 To me of the dream. 7 Then they came,
 Magicians, astrologers, same
 Chaldeans, and soothsayers came
 And I told them the dream, but they
 Did not know its meaning to say.

Even after the threat to kill them all,
 And after Daniel being on the ball,
 Still the king first consults the royal hall
 Of abusers of dreams' reality
 To show them despite all he faithfully
 Upholds the claims of heathen gods to be
 Foundation of his kingdom. One might ask
 How such a thing can be after the task
 Of showing which was wrong and which
 was right.
 The fact is no king cares for right but
 might,
 And Daniel's God simply would take from
 him
 The kingdom's everlasting gear and trim.
 Beloved, give me the penetrating eye
 To see the truth of claims to power and
 why.

8 But at last Daniel came before
 Me (his name *is* Belteshazzar,
 According to my god's *true* name,
 In him *is dwelling for his fame*
 The spirit of the holy gods),
 And I told the dream for his prods,
 Saying 9 "Belteshazzar, the chief
 Of the magicians, with relief
 I know the holy gods' spirit
 Is in you, and no secret fit
 To trouble you, explain to me
 The visions of the dream I see,
 And its interpretation read.
 10 "These *were* the visions of my head
 While on my bed, I looked
 Indeed, a tree in earth *was hooked*,
 And its height was great. 11 "The tree grew
 And became strong, its height reached to
 The sky, and it could be seen to
 The ends of all the earth. 12 "Its leaves
 Were lovely, its fruit *at the eaves*
 Abundant, and in it *was* food
 For all. The beasts of the field *rude*
 Found shade under it, and the bird

Of the sky in its branches stirred
 Lived, and all flesh was fed from it.
 13 "I saw visions of my head *sit*
While on my bed, and there was one,
 A watcher, and a holy one,
 Coming down from heaven. 14 "He cried
 Aloud and said thus, 'Cast aside,
 Chop down the tree and cut off its
 Branches, strip its leaves, scatter its
 Fruit. Let the beasts forsake its shade
 And the birds from its branches *splayed*.

I interject to note the king is sure
 After his meditation that the pure
 Power of his own god Bel enshrined upon
 Daniel in the name given for court and
 fawn

Is what revealed the secret of his dream.
 Besides that, Daniel's answer, it would
 seem
 Required an outlay from the state in gold
 To counteract the dream that had foretold
 The downfall of the kingdom. Now the
 pride

At having thwarted all that You would bide
 Is ready at the heart and tongue of king
 Who has a gilded answer for the thing.
 Surprise is coming to cut down the great.
 Beloved, never leave that plot from the
 gate.

15 'But leave the stump and roots in earth,
Bound with a band of iron its girth
 And bronze, and in the tender grass
 Of the field. Let it be, alas,
 Wet with the dew of heaven, and *let*
 Him graze with the beasts *that are set*
 On the grass of the earth, 16 'and let
 His heart be changed from *of* a man,
 Let him be given a heart of beast,
 And let seven years pass his *bran*.

The iron and bronze creep on the head of
 gold
 And cut it down as those of slave who's
 sold
 Upon the market square. The grave delight
 Of flycatcher on wing, the dewy sight
 Of the brave tree caught on the dawning air
 Are all confounded with the thunder blast
 That strikes once to relieve the first outcast.
 Beloved, I see the stump and roots in earth,

The warning and a dire one of the berth
 Of kings to rise again, though humbled by
 Democracy and yet, finger in pie,
 Know that with companies to gloat and vie
 The world's better apportioned to exploit
 After Babylon and after Detroit.

17 'This fate *is* by watchers' decree,
 And sentence by the holy see,
 In order that the living may
 Know that the Most High holds the sway
 In the kingdom of men, gives it
 To whomever He will see fit,
 Sets over it lowest of men.'
 18 "This dream it was I saw again,
 King Nebuchadnezzar, I've been.
 Now you, Belteshazzar, declare
 Its meaning, since all the wise *men*
 Of my kingdom have not the share
 To make known to me the meaning,
 But you *are* able *dreams to sing*,
 For in you is the spirit of
 The holy ones, the gods *above*."

The king hears the voice proclaim his own
 end
 Accounted by the watchers as a friend.
 The watchers are known better in the books
 Of Enoch and of Jubilees in nooks
 Not often read, and yet they find their way
 Into the visions of kings in their sway.
 The watchers, faithful watchers hold the
 day
 In hand to bring the right creation's light
 Into the human patterns caught in night.
 Beloved, though You hold sway by word of
 king
 Reporting the revealed voice here to sing,
 I seek the downfall of all those in power
 Who wrest Your words along the broken
 tower
 Of human strength. Let watchers be an
 hour.

19 Daniel, Belteshazzar by name,
 Astonished was for a time's *claim*,
 And his thoughts troubled him. The king
 Spoke, and said, "Belteshazzar, *sing*,
 Do not let the dream or its meaning
 Trouble you with sorrow *or keening*."
 Belteshazzar answered and said,
 "My lord, *may* the dream come instead

On those who hate you, and its meaning
 Concern your enemies! 20 "The tree
 That you saw, which grew and was free
 To be strong, whose height touched the
 sky,
 And which all the earth *passing by*
Looked on, 21 "whose leaves *were* lovely
 and
 Its fruit abundant, in which *hand*
Was food for all, under which beast
 Of the field lived, and in whose *least*
 Branches the birds of heaven had home,
 22 "It's you, O king, who under *dome*
Of heaven have grown and become strong,
 For your greatness has grown and reaches
 To the heavens, and your reign *teaches*
 To the end of the earth. 23 "And so
 As the king saw a watcher go,
 A holy one, come from the sky
 And saying, 'Chop down the tree by
 And destroy it, but leave its stump
 And root in the earth *for a hump*,
Bound with a band of iron and bronze,
Before the time of silicons,
 In the tender grass of the field,
 Let it be wet with the dew's yield
 From heaven, and let him graze with beast
 Of the field, till seven years *at least*
 Pass over him', 24 "this is the meaning,
 O king, and this is the decree
 Of the Most High, come intervening
 Upon my lord the king. 25 "They shall
 Drive you from men, your dwelling shall
 Be with the beasts of the field, and
 They'll make you eat grass *out of hand*
 Like oxen. They shall wet you down
 With dew of heaven *around the town*,
 And seven years shall pass over you,
 Till you know that the Most High true
 Rules in the kingdom of men, too,
 And gives it to the one He chooses.
 26 "And inasmuch *as the king loses*,
 They gave the command to leave stump
And roots of the tree at the bump,
 Your kingdom shall be assured you,
 After you come to know the due
 Rule of heaven. 27 "Therefore, O king,
 Let my advice be as sterling
 To you, break off your sins *to be*
 Righteous, and your iniquity
 By showing mercy *to the poor*.
 Perhaps there may be a detour

To lengthen your prosperity."

The vision was a warning and the king
 Had time unmentioned for its length and
 ring

To make repentance and show by a change
 Of heart and action to what ardent range
 He had minded the danger of his pride.
 But kings and presidents and such deride
 Humility before the Lord their God.
 Who lead the corporations out to prod
 The parliament to favour business fraud
 Are ready to fall in the sudden trap
 That is about to cause the king's mishap.
 Beloved, Your mercy to the king is great,
 With dreams to warn him of the coming
 fate.

Most men hear nothing until it's too late.

28 And all *this* came upon the king
 Nebuchadnezzar. 29 At the string
 Of twelve months he was walking round
 The royal palace, *one that crowned*
 Babylon. 30 The king spoke, and said
 "Is not this great Babylon *bred*,
 That I have built for royal dwelling
 By my mighty power full-swelling
 And honour of my majesty?"

31 While the word's in the king's mouth,
see,

A voice fell from heaven "O King
 Nebuchadnezzar, see this thing
 To you spoken. Now the kingdom
 Has departed from you *to hum!*
 32 "And they shall drive you out from men,
 And your dwelling *shall be in den*
 With the beasts of the field. They'll make
 You eat grass like oxen, and take
 Seven years passing over you,
 Until you know the Most High true
 Rules in the kingdom of men, and
 Gives it to whom He will command."

Just as the Sabbath command shows to all
 That the subordinate is not to fall
 In abject obedience to the call
 Of father, mother, employer in stall,
 So watchers on the great celestial wall
 Insist the king should know his power is
 lent,
 And can be withdrawn in a breath once
 spent.

You, my Beloved, the Most High, give the crown
 To whom You will, to test those in renown
 And with the rare exception cause the chap
 To fail before the test of pride's mishap.
 I hope that does not mean all those who lead
 The boardrooms and the companies succeed
 In going down to hell for word and deed.

33 That very hour the word was done
 Upon Nebuchadnezzar's *bun*,
 He was driven from men and ate
 Grass like oxen, his body's state
 Was wet with the dew of heaven till
 His hair had grown like eagles' *quill*
 And his nails like birds' *claws and bill*.

And yet the social scientist with wit
 Will note that those who serve Auschwitz
 best fit,
 Who kill the most in war with enemy,
 Who survive with a boast their enmity,
 Are those who also rise to wealth and fame
 In attending to the corporate game.
 So violence is at the heart of each
 Successful pitch at attaining the peach,
 And who does best to imitate Your song
 As sovereign and creator of the wrong
 Does best to forge his own law's blast of
 gong.
 Beloved, the world's a-trample with the lust
 Of turning precious life into gold dust.
 The true gold's not to grasp, spring's
 failing rust.

34 And at the end of the time I,
 Nebuchadnezzar, lifted eye
 To heaven, and my understanding
 Returned to me, and I blessed *King*
 Most High and praised and honoured Him
 Who lives forever, *grows not dim*:
 For His dominion's everlasting,
 And His kingdom *is for the casting*
Of generations now and coming.
 35 All the dwellers of the earth *bumming*
Are reputed as nothing, He
 Does according to His will free
 In the army of heaven, *among*
 The dwellers of the earth unsung.

No one can restrain His hand or
 Say to Him, "What, why, and wherefore?"
 36 At the same time my reason came
 Back to me, for my kingdom's fame,
 My honour and splendour returned.
 My councillors and nobles learned
 To come to me, I was restored
 To my kingdom majestic lord.
 37 Now I, Nebuchadnezzar, praise
 Extol and honour *all my days*
 The King of heaven, all of whose
 Works *are* truth, and His ways *still* choose
 Justice. And those who walk in pride
 He is able to put aside.

Beloved, there is one and one only who
 Rose to rule the world and then turned from
 view
 And understood after the fiery trial
 That those who walk in pride walk on a
 mile
 To their perdition. Seven years sent out
 To learn from ox and lion not to shout
 Is little cost to avoid infamy
 And pains of hell for an eternity.
 Beloved, though all the rest who wield a
 rod
 Of power upon the earthly, common sod
 Should go into oblivion and night,
 At least I see one burning brand and bright
 Plucked from the raging fires of lust to rule,
 And willing to be brought into Your
 school.

Daniel 5

1 Belshazzar the king made a great
 Feast for a thousand lords *in state*,
 And drank wine in the presence of
 The thousand. 2 While he tasted love
 Of wine, Belshazzar gave command
 To bring the gold and silver band
 Of vessels which his father had,
 Nebuchadnezzar acting bad
 Had taken from the temple which
Was in Jerusalem, *now ditch*,
 That the king and his lords, his wives,
 And his concubines *for their lives*
 Might drink from them. 3 Then they
 brought gold
 Vessels that were taken *of old*
 From the temple of Allah's own
 House which *had been His ancient throne*

In Jerusalem, and the king
 And his lords, his wives, and the ring
 Of his concubines drank from them.
 4 They drank the wine *sparkling like gem*,
 And praised gods of silver and gold,
 Bronze, iron, wood and stone, *bought and
 sold*.

These people were not monotheists here,
 But needed drink to dare to break their fear
 Of desecrating vessels though of gold
 Taken out of Your temple in the old
 Days of the king Nebuchadnezzar's raid.
 They had to drink so's not to be afraid.
 Such people follow on as soon as one
 King learns to do Your will until it's done.
 There's no respite on earth for saints below
 As long as You test tyrants with a show.
 Beloved, You look upon the feast today
 That goes on as it did after the sway
 Of Nebuchadnezzar, and see the drum
 Of wickedness that settles under thumb.

5 In the same hour the fingers of
 A man's hand appeared and above
 Wrote opposite the lamp-stand on
 The plaster of the wall upon
 The king's palace, and the king saw
 The part of the hand that wrote *law*.
 6 Then the king's countenance was
 changed,
 And his thoughts troubled him *and ranged*,
 So that his hips came out unjointed,
 And knees knocked wherever they pointed.
 7 The king cried aloud to bring in
 Astrologers, *those men of sin*,
 The Chaldeans, soothsayers too.
 The king spoke to the *great and few*
 Wise *men* of Babylon to say,
 "Whoever reads this writing *way*,
 And tells me what it means to say,
 Shall be clothed with purple and chain
 Of gold around his neck to reign
 As third ruler in the kingdom."

I told You drunkards shook in superstition,
 But Your delirium tremens' remission
 Is like to scare the pants off Belshazzar.
 It's been a long day since You were the star
 To write something with Your own finger's
 par.
 Let's see, it was the Decalogue You wrote

On stone for every king and fool to quote
 Until the fall of time upon the note
 Of judgement. My Beloved, I see the sign
 Of what You write about the blur of wine.
 The message that endures written on heart
 And wall and stone for treaty from the start
 Convinces me the tale of old is true.
 I find Your message always in my view.

8 Now all of the king's wise *men* come,
 But they could not read the writing,
 Or show its meaning to the king.
 9 Then King Belshazzar greatly troubled,
 His countenance was changed *and doubled*,
 His lords astonished at the thing.
 10 The queen hearing of the king's words
 And of his lords, came to *those birds*
 In the banquet hall. The queen spoke,
 Saying, "O king, forever stoke!
 Do not let your thoughts trouble you,
 Nor let your countenance change *too*.
 11 "There is a man in your kingdom
 To whose spirit the gods have come
 In holiness. And in the days
 Of your father's *eternal praise*,
 Light, understanding and wisdom,
 Like gods' wisdom were found in him,
 And King Nebuchadnezzar *grim*,
 Your father, your father the king,
 Made him chief of magicians' ring,
 Astrologers, Chaldeans, *and*
 All of the soothsayers *at hand*.
 12 "Inasmuch as excellent spirit,
 Knowledge, understanding, *or near it*,
 Interpreting dreams, and to solve
 Riddles, and explaining resolve
 Enigmas were found in this one
 Daniel, whom the king named *when done*
 Belteshazzar, now let be called
 Daniel, and he'll give sense *enthralled*."

I see that Daniel had not been invited
 To the feast when it was so singly blighted
 With drunken excess and with orgy's
 shame.

But he was called when they minded Your
 name.
 The righteous man is needed, if he's known
 By someone in the crowd close to the
 throne,
 When exploitation and excess explode
 Into the crisis evil actions goad.

Beloved, the path is paved with
 carriageways
 Broad enough for the missile-lorries craze,
 But when the spectre silent and complete
 Writes on the wall, the armies know defeat.
 Belshazzar quails, the guests drop cups of
 wine,
 But Daniel simply knows the voice divine.

13 Then Daniel was brought in before
 The king. The king spoke *what is more*,
 And said to Daniel, “Are you that
 Daniel who’s one of those *who sat*
 Among the captives from Judah,
 The king my father brought *by claw*
 From Judah? 14 “I have heard of you,
 The spirit of the gods in you,
 And light and understanding and
 Excellent wisdom at your hand.

15 “Now the wise and astrologers,
 Have been brought in as case avers
 That they should read this writing and
 Make known to me its meaning, but
 They could not give its meaning shut.

16 “And I have heard of you, that you
 Can give interpretations and
 Explain enigmas *out of hand*.

Now if you can read the writing
 And make it known to me *the king*,
 You shall be clothed with purple and
 Have chain of gold around your neck,
 And shall be third to call and beck
 A ruler in the kingdom stand.”

The flattery of state is always there,
 Even in darkest trials the princes bear.
 The coin in plea is always empty power,
 Third in a kingdom with hardly an hour
 Before the armies of the Persian crew
 Break through the flood-gates on the party-
 rue.

A golden chain, a medal on the chest,
 A silken garment or a pin-striped vest,
 And nothing more to meet the fetid heat,
 The shrunken haunch, manicured hands
 and feet.

Beloved, I see the palace with the eyes
 Of Daniel who marks with a nod the wise
 Who wait upon the wall the rivers rise
 And fall before the victor’s cunning guise.

17 Then Daniel answered to the king

Saying, “Let your gifts be a thing
 For yourself, and give your rewards
 To another, *ladies and lords*,
 Yet I shall read the writing to
 The king, and make known at his cue
 The meaning. 18 “O king, the Most High
 Allah once gave your father nigh,
 Nebuchadnezzar, a kingdom
 And majesty, glory *to come*
 And honour. 19 “And because of that
 Majesty given him *where he sat*,
 All peoples, nations, languages
 Trembled and feared for him and his.
 Whomever he wished, he would slay,
 Whomever he wished, saw the day,
 Whomever he wished, he set up,
 And whom he wished, had poison cup.
 20 “But when his heart was lifted up,
 And his spirit was hard in pride,
 He was deposed from his throne’s side,
 And they took his glory from him.
 21 “Then he was driven from the rim
 Of human beings, for his heart
 Was made like the beasts *for his part*,
 And his dwelling *was* with wild ass.
 They fed him like the ox with grass,
 His body was wet with the dew
 Of heaven, till *at last* he knew
 That the Most High Allah now rules
 In the kingdom of men *and fools*,
 Appoints over it whom He choose.
 22 “But you his son, Belshazzar, *lose*,
 For you have not humbled your heart,
 Although you knew all this *or part*.

The tragedy that falls on every man
 Who raises up his heart to rule a span
 Is that he steps in to illusion’s black
 Because he did not realize the lack
 That was the silver self he thought was god.
 He stumbles at the stretching of Your rod.
 The humble heart is not monopoly
 Of any human being’s sophistry,
 But stings for every soul in glory’s grasp,
 Both office boy and manager like asp.
 Belshazzar, though he knew the cup’s deep
 drought,
 Could not bear to relinquish golden spot.

23 “And you have lifted yourself up
 yourself
 Against the Lord of heaven, *not elf*.

They've brought the vessels of His house
 Before you, and you with each spouse
 And your lords and your concubines,
 Have drunk wine, your favourite wines.
 And you have praised the gods of gold
 And silver, bronze and iron *untold*,
 And wood and stone, which do not see
 Or hear or know *a thing to be*,
 Allah who *has* your breath in hand
 And owns all your ways *through the land*,
 You have not glorified *at all*.

The heart believes too easily that when
 The pew is warmed and praises sung in den
 The soul is free to worship its estate
 In gathering up wealth and health and mate.
 The sacrifice that You demand is great,
 And not merely a sop to recompense
 The storm-god or the goddess of hair tents.
 You demand that illusion of men's fate
 Be set aside with gold and silver plate.
 Beloved, the lifting up of soul to be
 A god beside You in a trinity
 Is the one sin that sets all others round
 To dance of death upon the struggle
 ground.
 So Belshazzar meets his eternity.

24 "Then the hand's fingers sent by call
 From Him, and this writing was written.
 25 "And this is the inscription written:
 MENE, MENE, TEKEL, UPHARSIN.
 26 "This *is* the meaning of *each* arson.
 MENE: Allah has numbered your
 Kingdom, and put end to its score,
 27 "TEKEL: You have *also* been weighed
 In balances, found wanting *stayed*,
 28 "PERES: Your kingdom's been divided,
 And to Medes and Persians confided."

The writing on the wall is just the same
 As that You wrote to Moses from the
 flame,
 It simply iterates the Decalogue
 Before the minds caught in a drunken fog
 And clears the soul laid bare before the rod
 To know that each man stands before his
 God.
 The mystic words deal always with the
 score
 To show the day arrives to greet the door

Of judgement, and that judgement once it's
 set
 Puts in the balance hearts and deeds' regret
 Until the fatal stroke lays at the root
 The final and incriminating suit.
 You alone, my Beloved, have power to
 reign.
 All other hearts lift up themselves in vain.

29 Then Belshazzar gave the command,
 And they clothed Daniel *foot and hand*
 With purple and *put* chain of gold
 Around his neck, and made a bold
 Proclamation concerning him
 That he should be the third *in trim*
 A ruler in the kingdom *sold*.
 30 That very night Belshazzar, king
 Of the Chaldeans, saw death ring.
 31 And Darius the Mede took hold
 Kingdom at sixty-two years old.

That very night, what awful words to hear!
 And yet I know within my heart of fear
 That those work speak to every soul that
 lives
 Upon the earth that Your grace' bounty
 gives.

There is a night that comes on suddenly
 To everyone, no matter what the plea,
 When least expected, it falls on the brow
 On the deathbed too soon to be the now.
 The last breath is always at least one drawn
 Before the one that I had counted on.
 That very night, Beloved, the omen dark
 Rests like a shadow on the sunlit park.
 And yet it might have been a surety
 If only Belshazzar had soul set free.

Daniel 6

1 It pleased Darius to set over
 The kingdom, *town, country and clover*
 One hundred and twenty satraps,
 To be over the whole *perhaps*
Of the kingdom, 2 and over these,
 Three governors, of whom *to please*
 Daniel *was* one, that the satraps
 Might give account *without mishaps*
 To them, so that the king would suffer
 No loss. 3 Then this Daniel, *no duffer*,
 Distinguished himself above *all*
 The governors' and satraps' *ball*,
 Because a fine spirit in him,

The king intended to set him
 Over the whole realm. 4 And for this
 The governors and satraps miss
 No opportunity to find
 A charge against Daniel *to bind*
 Concerning the kingdom, but they
 Could find no charge or fault in grey,
 Because he *was* faithful, without
 Any error or fault *to flout*.
 5 Then these men said, "We shall not find
 Any charge against Daniel's kind
 Unless we find *it* against him
 About his Allah's law and dim."
 6 So these governors and satraps
 Thronged before the king *without caps*,
 And said so to him "King Darius,
 Live forever *and without bias!*
 7 "All the governors of the realm,
 Administrators *at the helm*
 And satraps, counsellors, advisors,
 Have consulted *as good surprisers*
 To set a royal statute up
 And make a firm decree *for cup*,
 That whoever petitions god
 Or man for thirty days *by rod*,
 Except you, O king, shall be cast
 Into the den of lions *fast*.
 8 "Now, king, establish the decree
 And sign the writing *and make free*,
 So it cannot be changed *at all*,
 According to the laws that fall
 From the Medes and Persians, which law
 Does not alter *by force or awe*."
 9 Therefore the King Darius signed
 The written decree *not declined*.

The truth is few risk life to pray today,
 And yet without the risk of the king's sway
 It seems there's not excitement in the deed.
 Instead it's few who feel any such need
 At all to pray, whether to Median king
 Or to the manager of anything,
 Much less to One invisible like You.
 Perhaps if there was law that none in pew
 Had right under the legal statute here
 To pray to You, the multitude would fear
 Enough to come back in repentance sheer.
 I doubt. I doubt that prayer can be made
 clear
 Except by the vision of night and mind,
 When You awaken both the lame and
 blind.

10 When Daniel knew the writing signed,
 He went home. In his upper room,
 With his windows open to loom
 Toward Jerusalem, he knelt
 Down on his knees three times *for welt*
 That day, and prayed and gave thanks there
 Before his Allah *and with care*,
As was his custom all his life
To pray both in peacetime and strife.

I note, Beloved, that Daniel thought it right
 And necessary to pray well in sight
 Toward the holy city and qibla
 With You instead of king spread in his awe.
 I note he did so three times in the day,
 Both morning, noon, and night to find his
 way
 Before the divine throne, no law of king
 Of accomple could change his daily
 thing.
 To save my life, I think I'd find enough
 To pray within my heart as do the tough
 Christians today, who always answer so
 When I tell them to bow prostrate to show
 Obedience to Your word. Not many now
 Risk life to pray to You when such ones
 bow.

11 Then these men came together and
 Found Daniel praying *by command*
 And making supplication to
 His Allah. 12 And then they went to
 The king, and spoke about the thing
 That had signature of the king:
 "Have you not signed a law to say
 That every man who comes to pray
 To any god or to appeal
 To any man for thirty days,
 Except to you, O king, for weal
 Shall be cast in the lions' den?"
 The king answered and made apprise,
 "The thing *is* true, according to
 The law the Medes and Persians do,
 Which cannot change." 13 So they replied
 And said before the king betide,
 "That Daniel, who's one of the *slave*
 Captives from Judah, does behave
 Without show of regard for you,
 O king, for the decree that you
 Have signed, but makes his own petition
 Three times a day, *at his admission*."

At least the man could have shut window
fast
Against the spies that came with reproach
cast,
Not for religion and not for faith spawned,
But for the jealousy of courtier fawned.
Perhaps the prophet knew that walls shut
out
The qibla from the soul, perhaps the doubt
That rose from ruins of the temple shore
Made him think that the open window more
Required his eyes and bowed head to the
floor.

Beloved, whatever frail belief or sign
Of superstition in the heady wine
Of hope, whatever stubbornness of mine
Makes me turn to You and against the vine
Of government and business, it is fine.

14 And the king, when he heard *these*
words,
Was greatly displeased with himself,
And set *his* heart *against the birds*
To save Daniel *from man and elf*,
And laboured till the sun went down
To save *the geezer from the town*.
15 Then these men came in to the king,
And said to the king, "Know, O king,
That *it's* the law of Medes and Persians
That no decree or statute's versions
The king establishes may change."
16 So the king started to arrange
Commands, and they brought Daniel and
Threw in the den of lions' *band*.
But the king spoke to Daniel, saying
"Your Allah you serve always staying,
He will deliver you *from slaying*."

I've always found the by-laws of the
church
Or club or government leave in the lurch,
Till none is left but You, Beloved, for those
Who recognize Your laws above all foes.
The law of Medes and Persians, law of
France,
Or law of Britain or the strutting prance
Of States United, foreign workers union
Established by some refugees impunition,
All these are greater far than what You said
On Sinai. So folk follow them instead.
Sunday and trinity and right to kill

Are democratic ways that still fulfil
Illusions of such liberty in gross
That feed the populace with the verbose.

17 Then a stone was brought there and laid
On the mouth of the den *and stayed*,
And the king sealed it with his own
Signet ring and with signets' stone
Of his lords, that the purpose for
Daniel might never be changed more.
18 Now the king went to his palace
And spent the night fasting, with face
Of no musicians in the place,
Yet could not get to fall asleep.

No music could assuage the conscience
thirst

That tempted the king with sins of the
worst?

Today I think matters have greatly
changed:

The president rocks with the roll that
ranged

About the media and concert-hall,
And feels no remorse for the wicked pall
That exploits populace, that shuts in bars
Those who reject the message of rock stars.
Poor king! If only he had had a band
From my century, he could have made a
stand,

And in its numbing opiate stay firm
That who has power to make the other
squirm

Is right and democratic with good taste.
Poor sleeplessness of the king, what a
waste!

19 Then the king very early rose
And quickly went to interpose
At the den of lions. 20 And when
He came to the den, he cried out
With a lamenting voice to shout
To Daniel. The king spoke and said
To Daniel, "Daniel, servant led
Of the living Allah, has your
Allah you served always before,
Been able to deliver you
From the lions?" 21 Then Daniel said
To the king, "O king, always live!
22 "Allah sent His angel to give
A shutting to the lions' maws,
So they've not hurt me *with their claws*,

Because I was found innocent
Before Him, and also intent,
O king, I've done no wrong to you."

Brave Daniel dares to say he's done no
wrong,
Despite his breaking of the statutes strong
Of the land where he lived and served in
state.

Such a view is both sad and perviate.
The essence of democracy is that
We accept injustices on the mat
As soon as they are ratified as law.
It's called the state of justice in the jaw.
Instead he thinks that doing wrong's
defined

By Your law only, Beloved. So confined
A view is unacceptable, I think
The king should throw the prophet in the
clink.

Beloved, to live in ancient days when men,
Even kings, could be swayed by truth
again.

23 And then the king was glad, it's true,
And commanded that they should take
Daniel up from the den *awake*.

So Daniel was taken up out
Of the den, with no harm about
Him, because he believed in his
Allah, *who was true God and is*.

24 And then the king gave the command,
And they brought those men in a band
Who had accused Daniel, and they
Threw *them* into the lions' way,
Them, and their children, and their wives,
And the lions attacked their lives,
And broke their bones in pieces all
Before they even hit the wall
At bottom of the lion's den,
And that was the end of those men.

The retribution of the modern state
Is just the same as that for which we wait
In Persian times and in the Median grate.
Whatever happens, there are those who fall.
At every change, somebody hits the wall.
Not possible, it seems, to feed the all
And send them out to tread the shopping
mall.

Not possible, it seems, to send them out
To dig and delve in field and roundabout.

Somebody has to die, it is the law
Of retribution in the court of claw.
No solution, it seems, has yet been found
Where crucifying's not the choice of
ground.
Simply live and let live is choice too small.

25 Then King Darius wrote, "To all
Peoples, nations, and languages
That live in all the earth to call,
Peace be multiplied unto you.

26 "I make a decree and that is
In every dominion accrue
Of my kingdom, tremble and fear
Before the God of Daniel here.
For He's the living Allah and
Steadfast forever, *and to stand*.
His kingdom *is the one* which shall
Not be destroyed, and His power *shall*
Endure to the end. 27 "He delivers
And rescues, and He works and shivers
Signs and wonders in heaven and earth,
Who has saved Daniel from the berth
Of the lions." 28 So this Daniel
Prospered in Darius' reign well
And in the reign of Cyrus *too*
The king of all the Persian crew.

Religion by decree of kings is set
To treat the world with passions not yet
met

In any other form, though formula
May well propose to keep You in the awe
Of populace by icon, gold and straw.
Ivan the Third had one chance to replace
The heathen dance with Your beloved face,
And settled for a woman's lack of grace
Who grew up by the Vatican's bold mace.
So Ivan called the Terrible arose
From simple choices made against Your
nose.

All Russias could have been from
Novgorod
To Vladivostok palaces of God
Instead of exploitation of the sod.

Daniel 7

1 In the first year of Belshazzar
King of Babylon *and its Czar*,
Daniel had dreams and visions in
His head on his bed *to begin*
To write the dream and give account

Of the matters *as they amount.*

2 Daniel spoke saying "I saw in
My vision at night, and see spin
The four winds of the sky to strive
Upon the great sea *as alive.*

3 "And four great beasts rose from the sea
Different from each as each could be.

4 "The first was like a lion and
Had eagle's wings, I saw it stand
Until its wings were wrenched off and
It lifted from the earth to stand
On its feet like a man to get
The heart of a man in it set.

5 "And see a second beast arose
Like a bear and raised up *to pose*
On one side, and it had in mouth
Three ribs between its teeth *of drouth,*
And they told it 'Get up, consume
Much flesh *unto the day of doom.*'

The bear speaks well of Persian and the
Mede,

The Indo-European in his greed:
It's not just Finno-Ugric that in seed
Of circumpolar cult lifted the bear.
The Alpine finds speak of things to beware:
The hunting magic, bear cult or at least
Totemic kinship patterns with the beast.
If Semite is a lion on the prowl,
The Persian also has the power to growl.
Beloved, I've seen the bear set in the wild,
A fearsome thing to any frightened child.
I've also seen the caged tyrant well set
To entertain the public pirouette.
The bear's an empire that I'll not forget.

6 "After this I looked, and see, yet
Another like a leopard get
Upon its back four wings like those
Of a bird-being in its clothes,
The beast also had four heads and
Dominion was put in its hand.

Three empires stood upon the golden sand
Of the great visionary ocean's strand
In form of beast of prey. Take note, my
soul,

That governments are diverse in their toll,
But all alike are beast of prey. Let none
Obscure that thought with democratic pun.
The truth is human governments are here
To oversee the interests most sincere

Of those who exploit populace with fear
Or advertisement, both such win the race.
Beloved, touch human hearts with divine
grace

To suspect motivations set for power
And violence to pretend to the tower
Of justice. That is only in Your face.

7 "After this I saw in the night
Visions, and see, a fourth of fright,
A beast of dread and terror and
Very strong and it could withstand
By great iron teeth and to consume
And brake in pieces and resume
To trample what's left with its feet,
And it was different in receipt
Of all the beasts that came before,
And had for its horns half a score.

8 "I contemplated then the horns,
And see, there rose among their bourns
Another small horn before which
Three of the first horns thrown in pitch
Were pulled up by their roots, and see,
In this horn there were eyes to see
Like the eyes of a man's degree,
And a mouth speaking horrid things.

Since upper Palaeolithic Aurignacian
Iconographic clips set gods in station
As bison, mammoths, and other great
beasts

Depicted on the walls of caves for feasts.
It may be that those early artists thought
They were depicting You, the god they
sought.

But then there is the possibility
That they envisioned empires in degree,
Sometime ages and ages thence to be
In the realms of a love's eternity.
The difference between You and the tyrant
In human thought may be less than
aspirant,
And love meets hate and faces off the shore
Of the encroaching apathy the more.

Methinks the vision Daniel saw before
Is something now in distant past, the roar
Of horrid beast in guise of human kings
Is something often heard above the springs
Of life upon this weathered, withered
world.

Though thrones and sceptres be ever so
pearled

And rubied, still the heart and claw of beast
Remains the master of the carnal feast.

The glasses clink, the speeches condescend,
But behind all there is not sighted end
Of beast of prey devouring beast of prey,
Of horns gashed out, pulled by the root of
day.

Beloved, what Daniel only saw to come
I stand today to see the awful sum.

9 "I watched till thrones as fit for kings
Were set up and One before time
Sat down, whose clothing white like rime
Mirrored His head's hair, and His throne
Was fiery flame, His wheels alone
As burning fire *consuming stone*.

10 "A fiery stream came out of Him,
Thousand thousands served before Him,
And ten thousand times ten thousand
Stood before Him, and *on command*
The judgement was set and the books
Were opened *plainly to His looks*.

11 "I noticed the voice of the great
Words that the horn spoke from its state,
I watched until the beast was killed,
His body destroyed and then spilled
Into the burning flame *it filled*.

12 "Concerning the rest of the beasts,
They had their powers struck and
decreased,
Yet their lives were prolonged a time,
A season *and an age of crime*.

All these beasts still attend to hopeful
powers

Along the Tigris and Euphrates' towers,
Along the darkened road to Samarqand,
Beside the Aegean, along the strand
Of Alexandria where Roman camp
Set up to wait for Cleopatra's lamp.

But above all their hopes there stands a
throne

Where You, Beloved, wield earth's
sceptres alone,

And all the watchers hasten to obey
The commands from Your lips both night
and day.

Though none can see Your being, yet the
sound

And flight of flames express divine
unbound.

Beloved, let judgement that came to be set
Continue till the great day's crowd is met.

13 "I saw in the night visions still,
See, one like son of man to fill
The clouds of heaven, and so he came
To the One before time in name,
And they brought him near to His *fame*.
14 "And there was given him power and
glory,

A kingdom, all the folk in story,
Nations and languages to serve
Him, and His dominion shall swerve
Never and shall not pass away,
And his kingdom in all its sway
Shall not be destroyed, *always stay*.

The son of man, not son of God as would
Have done by Nebuchadnezzar's dark
wood,

The son of man, Ezekiel, Jesus or
Another hidden one and yet in store,
The son of man to fill the clouds and sky
With justice to rain down and multiply
The earth. Beloved, the picture still invades
My soul's recesses and in light parades
The coming kingdom's revenue and aids.
Each king that fails or passes Your tests
brings

Another king with more of kingly stings,
Whether in government or corporation.
I wait the endless kingdom and the nation
Where You reign sovereign on their
thunderings.

15 "I Daniel sorrowed in my mind
In body *where I was reclined*,
The visions of my head *refined*
Brought troubled thoughts *and unresigned*.

16 "Approaching one of those nearby
I asked him the truth and whereby
Of all of this, and he told me,
Making sense of the things I see.

17 "These enormous beasts which are four
Are kings as many as in score,
Who shall arise out of the earth.

18 "But the saints and those of great worth
Of Al-Yonin shall take the realm
And possess the kingdom in helm
For ever always overwhelm.

I have not seen this day, Beloved, when all
The quartered kingdoms of the earth might
fall,

And the saints take the earth to bless and
keep.

I have not seen the day come in my sleep.
The towers of wealth and power, though
emptiness

Still take the food from widow and address
Of orphan at last to deride, impress

The populace with death. Democracy
Saves alive only those the company
Requires to buy its goods. Who cannot do
So are ground in the mill of scornful rue.
Beloved, though kings are fallen, power is
not.

The humble still are cast upon their lot
Of evil for the wickedness of plot.

19 "I wanted then to know the truth
Of the fourth beast and without ruth
And differing from all other beasts,
Extremely horrid in its feasts,
Whose teeth of iron and claws of brass
Devoured and shattered all that pass
And trampled what's left *in the grass*,
20 "And of the ten horns on his head,
And the other one that was spread
Before which three fell, even that
Horn that had eyes and a mouth fat
To speak terrible things, whose look
Before which all the others shook.

The ten horns following the path of Rome
To rule the holy land not far from home
Are the ten kingdoms from Herodian power
Up to the division of Syrian hour
Of Palestine in first, second and third,
The Byzantine lords that trembled and
heard

The little horn rise up to cast out those
Three Palestinian kingdoms, then arose
To speak great things, has a name that he
chose

For horror, Omar, praised by one and all
Who bow down to the beast in serfdom's
thrall.

His army took the city in the year
Six hundred thirty-eight, and without fear
Went on to persecute the saintly peer.

The thought that the small horn's the
Papacy

Is something that the Protestants in fee
Thought a good excuse for rebellion's way.
So when Josephus said that Antiochus
Epiphanes it was who came to mock us,
The papal commentary latched on that
To prove the pope innocent where he sat.
Though I think both interpretations stand
On motives impure and on the weak sand,
The papal power is evil in the land,
Fostering inquisition and the fire
Of execution on heretic's pyre.
It too seeks to change times and laws and
fails

To keep Your Sabbath in the tunes it wails.

21 "I saw that same horn go to war
Against the saints and win the score,
22 Until the One before time came
And judgement was brought *in acclaim*
To the saints of Al-Yonin, and
The time came that the saints *in hand*
Should have the kingdom *and the land*.

Islamic empires as so called have reigned
Upon the earth from that time till the
stained

Soil filled with blood made Tigris howe'er
swift

Red with the life of men by heavenly gift.
The party of Ali is trodden still
Into the dust on every beaten hill,
And all the pagan trains of Europe come
To trample down the Shi'ite with the hum
Of tank and screech of missile on the air.
And so it shall be till the king and heir
Shall break out in the lightning for his
share

And judgement weigh Yazid's children and
fair.

Beloved, I wait the hateful judgement day
When all of this shall melt and pass away.

Umayyads and Abbasids are not lone
In laying claim to Your rule and Your
throne.

Though Rome is far away and cannot be
A claimant of the shore of Galilee,
It is the same kind of power on the hill,
And seven of them meet the Roman bill.
My mind would turn consistently to those

Who fought against Jerusalem in throes
And filled its streets with blood and then
arose
To build and rebuild temples where to
pose.

Beloved, I look around a world of fate
And see that Palestine has not come late,
But the same blemish comes with every
state,
And all seek to change times and laws for
bait.

23 "So he said 'The fourth beast shall be
The fourth kingdom on earth's degree,
Different from all kingdoms before,
And shall consume the whole world's gore,
And trample on it shattered more.

24 "And the ten horns out of this realm
Are ten kings rising to the helm,
And one shall come up after them,
And he'll have different stratagem,
And he'll break three kings *at his hem*.

Palestine Prime, Secunda, and the late
Third all fall down before the rage and hate
Of Omar's armies, and those three horns'
fate

Ended with the accounting accurate
That opened up the gates of Quds to see
The banners of Muhammad floated free
Upon the stifling air. Muhammad lies
At ill ease with the conquerors' last prize.
Who spoke Your words was followed by
the beast

That broke the fasting with a jocund feast,
And rose unlike any before to climb
Into millennia of ruling rhyme.
Beloved, I do not love the three kings lost,
But still I see them die to raging cost.

25 And he shall speak thing against Al
Yonin, and oppress, yes, he shall
The saints of Al-Yonin, intend
To change times and laws *from his end*,
And they'll be given in his hand
A year, two years and a half *planned*.

26 "But the judgement shall sit and they
Shall take his dominion away,
To consume and destroy its sway.

Omar changed Your great calendar that sat
In two distinct relations on the mat:

One purely lunar and the other one
Solar about the week, Jubilee fun.
So he destroyed the half of time in change,
Keeping only half of the timely range.

He changed laws also, marriage laws for
some,

And dietary laws, he was a bum.
That's why the dream of Daniel tells his
fate

As being one to change both time come late
And Your commandments. The great piece
of time

That includes Omar's empires in the clime
Of history runs from six thirty-four
Twelve hundred sixty years to end the
score.

If Omar is a beast and wench, fine,
He also changed the water into wine,
The calendar of sun and weekly wait
To worship on the Sabbath at Your gate.
And yet he remained on the Sabbath day
To wear the washen robe and bowed to
pray

The Duha prayer in Kubla's mosque, while
pope
Disdained Your day and relinquished Your
hope.

Beloved, let me not follow either man,
The pope or caliph, both of whom in plan
Would take Your place on throne and guide
the state
To rebel against Your law in their hate.

27 "And the kingdom and power and height
Of the kingdom under the right
Of heaven shall be given to the folk
Of the saints of Al-Yonin's stroke,
Whose kingdom's an eternal realm,
And all powers shall serve His whelm
And obey Him *under His yoke*'.

28 "Up to here's the end of the thing.
As for myself, Daniel, the sting
In my thoughts kept me troubled yet,
And my face coloured on the set,
But I kept it under heart string."

Uthman followed the steps of Omar hard
And so I sing the end of such a bard
Who gave his name to the last empire of
The little horn, the Ottomanic glove.
In 1894 the Sultan's rule

Came to its death knell by the great and
cruel

Strike against the Armenian folk and so
Within a generation fell to grow
No more, but opened way for the Mahdi
The Guided One to enter in the spree
And take back the kingdom in
righteousness

After the failure of the kings to bless
The people with Islam, instead oppress.
We search out windows on eternity.

The death knell sounded in year twenty-
three

To prepare for the rise of popes in see
Upon the hill of Vatican to be
With Mussolini a share of the glee.
The sultan fell indeed, but Your great town
Was left intact until with faces brown
In 1950 Arabs filled the street,
Jerusalem bowed down to that defeat.
Beloved, I bow within the mosque to pray
That sits upon the mount of Sion's sway,
And hear the comfort of the sound that
rises

To call the faithful to prayer and surprises.
And yet I know within my heart the fist
That rules Jerusalem I have not kissed.

Daniel 8

1 In the third year in the king's reign,
Belshazzar's, a vision of gain
Appeared to me, even Daniel,
After the one that I'd seen well.

2 And I saw in a vision spell
What happened when I saw it go,
While I was in the palace glow
Of Shushan which is in the state
Of Elam, and I saw the great
Vision come on me then while I
Was beside the river Ulai.

3 I raised my eyes and saw, and see,
There stood before river and me
A ram that had two horns, and those
Two horns were high, but one arose
Higher than the other, and that
Higher one came up last and sat.

4 I saw the ram push towards the west,
The north and south, so none had rest
Among the beasts before his band,
Nor could any save from his hand,
But he did whatever he chose

And became great *in rhyme and prose.*

5 As I was contemplating, see,
A male goat came from western lea
Upon the surface of the earth
And did not touch the ground *to flee*,
And the goat had a massive horn
Between his eyes, *a great king born.*
6 And he came to the ram that had
Two horns, that I'd seen standing *glad*
Before the river, and he ran
Into him in his power's wrath's *span.*
7 I saw him come close to the ram
And moved with anger for *the lamb*,
And struck the ram and broke his two
Horns, and there was no strength in view
For the ram to stand before him,
But he threw him on the ground *grim*,
And trampled on him, there was none
To save the ram from his power's *run.*
8 And so the male goat became great,
And when he was strong in estate
The great horn was shattered, instead
Of it came up for great horns bred
Toward the four winds of the sky.

When Alexander fell beneath the scythe
Of drink and debauchery in a tithe
Of the time he might have lived
righteously,

The noble horn was shattered frightfully.
When Alexander fell the kingdom fled
Into four parts by generals then led
To fill the world with Hellenistic pale
In pagan practices both strong and hale.
Beloved, I see the civilized retreat
To hold the world in sway of bitter-sweet,
And show the path to thoughtful keen
address

Of pagan altar and in love to guess.
I turn to You, Beloved, from my thought's
fame

To cling alone to Your most lovely name.

9 And out of one of them came sly
A little horn that became great
Towards the south and east in rate
And towards the pleasantries foreby.
10 And it became great to the sky,
And threw down stars upon the ground
And trampled on them *all around.*
11 Indeed he advertised himself
Even to the chief on the shelf,

And by him daily *sacrifice*
 Was taken away at a slice,
 The place of his temple confound.
 12 A band was given to him there
 Along with sacrificial share
 Because of the transgression bare,
 And he cast down the truth upon
 The ground and acted from the dawn
 Until prosperity was drawn.
 13 I then heard one holy one speak,
 Another answer him with cheek,
 "How long shall be the vision week
 About the daily *sacrifice*,
 And the transgression of *the vice*
Of desolation to give both
 The holy place and *behemoth*
Of band to be trampled and broken
 Under their feet *and for a token*?
 14 And he told me, "Unto the length
 Of two thousand three hundred's strength
 Of evenings and mornings, then shall
 Be put right the holy corral."

From the time of the final decree to
 Rebuild Jerusalem till comes in view
 The end of two thousand three hundred
 years
 The nations rise and fall against their fears.
 The prophecy is long and it extends
 To 1844 to make amends.
 Then Messiah shall stand in holy place
 And enter most holy before Your face
 To make a living atonement for sin
 To all who in repentance turn from din
 Of human sacrifice, idolatry
 To hope in Your eternal grace and free.
 Beloved, I follow with my prayers the man
 That lives before Your face as none else
 can.

15 It happened when I, even I,
 Daniel had seen vision go by
 And tried to find its meaning, then,
 See there stood before me again
 What seemed like one of *earthly* men.
 16 I heard a man's voice from the middle
 Of the Ulai speaking like fiddle,
 "Gabriel, make this one to know
 What the vision means, *don't be slow*."
 17 So he came near to where I stood,
 And when he came, I feared for good,
 And fell down on my face, but he

Said to me, "Understand and see,
 O son of man, for it shall be
 A vision for the end of time."

Let no man cry that Antiochus came
 To fulfil this vision in all its claim,
 And dying without weapon in his heart
 Showed that he was the one of evil part.
 No, this sight is come down to end of time,
 And what arose soon after Rome to climb
 The hills of Quds must extend through the
 world
 Until the final empires are unfurled.
 Alexander was followed by the four
 Kingdoms that united in two before
 The Romans came, and they were past the
 gate
 With ten kingdoms in Palestine to grate
 Until the three were snatched up by the hair
 When Omar granted Othman as his heir.

18 Now as he was speaking *in rhyme*
 With me, I was in a deep sleep
 Upon my face toward the deep,
 But he touched me and set me right.
 19 And he said "See, I'll make your sight
 Clear of what shall be in the last
 End of the indignation past,
 For at appointed hour the end
Shall come upon both foe and friend.
 20 "The ram you saw with two horns set
 Are Median and Persian kings *met*.
 21 "And the rough goat is Grecian king,
 And the great horn between eyes' *sting*
 Is the first *and most noble* king.
 22 "But when he was broken down then
 Four more stood in its place again,
 And these four kingdoms shall arise
 Up from the nation, but devise
 None of such power as his to *skies*.
 23 "And in the late time of their state
 When wickedness shall fill their plate,
 A king with wrathful face shall stand
 Knowing dark oracles' *demand*.
 24 "His strength shall be great, but not by
 His own hand, he shall not be shy
 To destroy greatly and shall grow
 And do great acts and not be slow
 To destroy great heroes and go
 Against the holy people's row.
 25 "And by his policy shall he
 Cause craft to prosper wonderfully,

And he shall lift himself in heart
And by peace destroy for his part
Many, and he shall also stand
Against the chief prince in the land,
Be he'll be broken without hand."

There was no hand to break the empire
bold
Of Ottomans, they themselves came and
sold
Their souls in persecution of the just
And throwing down the righteous in the
dust.
And yet let me not blame them for the
crust.
Evil they are, and yet good enough to
Be found in the good book for what is true.
England and France and Italy are not
Mentioned because they're filled with
pagan rot,
And their minion the USA has got
Drunk with the heathen rituals in plot.
Islamic empires depart from Your word
Only so far as needed to be stirred
As empires set against Your sovereign
view.

26 The vision of the evening and
The morning that was told is true,
So shut the vision up, please do,
Since it shall many days accrue.

27 I Daniel fainted at the view
And remained ill for many days,
And then I got up in the maze
Of the king's business, but I stayed
Astonished at what the view made,
And no one understood *the raid*.

The vision is shut up because the foil
Is of a nation yet to rise from toil,
And not to be known till the run of men
Has made the foul decision in the glen
To great apostasy as soon as one
Sent from Your hand is dead under the sun.
While Ali washed his body others sat
To form the little horn and so begat
The horrors sealed here. But the evil lies
In that they are so close to true and wise,
And use the right for the expediency
Of killing through decade and century.

Daniel 9

1 In the first year of Darius
The son of Ahasuerus,
Among the offspring of the Medes,
Who was made king over proceeds
Of the Chaldeans, 2 in the first
Year of his reign I Daniel durst
Understand by the writings how
Many years should go under plough
By the word of YHWH that had come
To Jeremiah, prophet's hum,
That He'd fulfil seventy years
Ruined in Jerusalem's fears.
9 I set my face to the Lord Al,
Seeking by prayer both prodigal
And with fasting, sackcloth and ash,
4 And prayed to YHWH my Alohim,
Making confession of my scheme,
And said "O Lord Al great and stern,
Faithful in covenant to earn
Mercy to those that love Him and
To those who're keeping His command,
5 "We have sinned doing wickedness,
Acted unjustly and rebelled,
Departing from Your law's *address*
And from Your judgements *unexcelled*,
6 "Neither have we obeyed the voice
Of Your servants, prophets by choice,
Who spoke in Your name to our kings,
Our princes and fathers of things
And to all the folk of the land.

Good Daniel speaks a prayer like that one
spoken
By Tobit in false Nineveh for token,
And like that prayer of abnegation for
The broken temple not yet on the floor,
So Daniel's prayer after the fact is clear
With same regard to sin upon the gear.
I too no doubt have acted and rebelled
In the same way those ancients downed and
felled.

And so I join in Daniel's prayer that I
May enter in the angel's dream and sky.
I fix my eyes upon the heavenly ground
Not of Jerusalem but the place sound
Of the great temple eternal and true
And find there what I seek in none but
You.

7 "To You, Lord, righteousness, but to
Us confusion of faces due
As at this day, to Judah's men,

Jerusalem's dwellers *again*,
To all of Israel near and afar,
Through all lands where refugees are
Because of the sins they have done
Against You *only under sun*.

8 "YHWH to us confusion of face,
To our kings, our princes and race
Of our fathers because we've sinned
Against Yourself *undisciplined*.

9 "To the Lord our Alohim be
Mercies and forgiveness, though we
Have rebelled against His decree,

10 "Neither have we obeyed the voice
Of YHWH our Alohim by choice
To act according to His laws
Which He has set before our paws
By His servants the prophets' *clause*.

11 "Indeed all of Israel have sinned
Against Your law as in the wind
They have departed that they might
Not obey Your voice, so the night
Of curse is poured out upon us,
And the oath written as a curse
In law of Moses, servant of
Alohim, because hand in glove
We've sinned against *the God of love*.

The law of Moses, yes, that blessed word
That encircles with light the statutes stirred
And sung from Sinai by Your voice and
heard

By millions on the plain where it occurred,
That law is the right and true for all time
And in every land and in every clime
Till judgement be set and the heat and rime
Of frost bring all before the unique stone
Where is writ by Your finger what alone
Can bring to humankind success and peace
And righteousness, from wickedness
release.

Beloved, I pray with Daniel for the sore
Forgotten tables of You law in store,
And know the wonders of Your golden
floor.

12 "And He's confirmed the words that He
Spoke against us, against decree
Of our judges who judged freely
By bringing on us this degree
Of evil, for under the sky
Has not been done has that brought nigh
Upon Jerusalem to see.

13 "As it's written in Moses' law
All this evil came in a draw
Upon us, yet we did not raise
Our prayer before YHWH our God's maze,
To turn from our iniquities
And understand Your truth's decrees.

14 "That's why YHWH considered the
wrath

And brought it across our own path,
For YHWH our Alohim is just
In all His works and does as must,
For we did not obey His voice.

15 "And now, O Lord our Alohim,
Who has brought Your folk from the beam
Of Egypt's land with mighty hand,
And gained the fame as at this day,
We've sinned, gone wickedly astray.

16 "O Lord, by all Your righteousness,
I pray You, let Your wrath's address
And anger be turned from Your town
Jerusalem, Your holy crown,
Because for our sins and because
Of our ancestors' wicked claws
Jerusalem and Your folk are
A reproach to all near and far.

17 "Now therefore hear, our Alohim,
The prayer of Your servant redeem
His supplications, cause Your face
To shine upon Your holy place
That's desolate, for the Lord's race.

18 "Incline, my Alohim, Your ear
And hear, open Your eyes, appear
To see our desolations and
The city called by Your command,
For we do not present our plea
Before You as those righteously,
But only for Your great mercy.

I too lift up my prayer to that great place
In holiness that lightened Moses' face
With the pattern and model in Your grace
To make a tent upon the desert trace.
I too lift up my prayer as Daniel did
So many centuries ago that hid
The sweet scents of the heavenly temple
where

Messiah now stands with his flaming hair
And whitened dress and burnished feet to
show

The way to righteousness for those who'd
go

Into the glory morn and eve to know

The joy of holiness that You bestow.
Beloved, the city and temple I see
Is one beyond the stars not just the sea.

19 “Lord, hear, O Lord, forgive, O Lord
Listen and do, do not slack sword
For Your own sake, my Alohim,
For Your town and folk by Your scheme
Are called by Your name *and accord.*”

20 While I spoke and prayed to confess
My sin and Israel’s folk’s not less,
Giving supplication to YHWH

My Alohim on behalf due
Of the holy mountain *and true*
Of my Alohim’s *residue*,

21 Indeed while I spoke in my prayer
Even the man Gabriel was there,
The one I’d seen in vision from
The start, sent flying swiftly, come
To touch me round about the time
Of evening sacrifice *and chime.*

22 And he informed and talked with me,
Saying “O Daniel, I freely
Come here to give you skill to know.

23 “As soon as you began to pray
The command came to show your way,
For you are greatly loved, and so
Perceive the thing, and grasp the know.

24 “Seventy weeks are decreed on
Your people and your holy town
To finish transgression and make

An end of sin and for the sake
Of forgiving iniquity,
And introduce such righteousness
As shall rise everlastingly,
And seal up the vision’s address

And also seal the prophecy,
And to anoint the most Holy.

25 “Know then and understand that from
The promulgation of the sum
Of the command to restore and
To build Jerusalem to stand
Until Messiah who is Prince
Shall be seven weeks and convince
Threescore and two weeks, then the street
Shall be built again and replete
With the wall in times of retreat.

Decree was finalized in the great year
Of Artaxerxes, without thought of fear,
In four hundred and fifty-seven, he
Completed the restoration’s decree.

Seventy weeks, four hundred ninety years
Count from that time, and in all of the fears
And persecutions that were wrought before,
The times relent to bring earth to the door
Of the Messiah’s coming to the walls
That were rebuilt beneath the bloody calls.
Beloved, the count is accurate and good
To take us to the very time it should
When the Messiah came and preached and
stood

In old Jerusalem long as he could.

26 “And after threescore and two weeks
Shall Messiah be cut *in cheeks*,
But not for himself, and the folk
Of the prince that shall come in stroke
Shall destroy the town and the place
Of holiness, its end to trace
In flood and to the battle’s end
Desolations come to contend.

27 “And he’ll confirm the covenant
With many for one week to grant,
And in the middle of the week
He’ll cause the sacrifice and bleak
Oblation to cease, and to spread
Abominations he’ll be led
To make it desolate until
The consummation to fulfil
Appointed to be poured out on
The desolate *as planned and drawn.*

Messiah’s time was cut off short because
The unbelief of rulers clipped the claws
Of faithful populace, observant Jew,
And showed the wrath of Rome and not
virtue.

But after him the waiting was not long
Until another prince rose up as strong,
Destroyed Jerusalem and fought for wrong
Against Masada’s fortress till he caused
Oblations to cease, at once they were
paused.

The temple mount’s divided to this day,
Trampled by many nations in their sway,
Bleak, desolate and waiting for the end
When judgement shall arise for foe and
friend.

Beloved, I too in desolation pray.

Daniel 10

1 In the third year of Cyrus king
Of Persia was revealed a thing

To Daniel, whose name had been called
Belteshazzar, a thing installed,
But the time appointed was long,
And he perceived the thing *in song*,
And understood the vision *strong*.

What was too long for Daniel in his ear?
The seven weeks it took to make appear
The decree to rebuild Quds with its gear?
The seven weeks of years as forty-nine?
Or was it the long centuries in sign
Until Messiah should enter the line
Of holy and most holy place divine?
Or was it the twelve hundred sixty years
That Omar's empires should cause many
tears?

The time is long, Beloved, to human heart,
But You do not know that lacking a part
Who dwell among eternal cycles and
Look out upon the universe and strand
That sails serene beneath Your great
command.

2 In those days I Daniel was mourning
Three full weeks *as long as unscorning*.
3 I ate no fine food neither meat
Nor wine came to my mouth as treat,
Neither did I anoint myself
At all, till three whole weeks on shelf
Were ended *in complete retreat*.
4 And in the twenty-fourth day of
The first month, as I was *on shove*
By the side of the great stream's *flow*,
Which is the Hiddekel *in row*,
5 I lifted up my eyes to see,
There then a certain man to be
Clothed in linen and with a belt
Of fine gold of Uphaz *to melt*.

No doubt, Beloved, fair Daniel to rebel
Used calendar of Jubilees as well,
And so the twenty-fourth of the first falls
Upon the day of preparation's walls,
The Friday of the pagans, and was sent
The double blessing nourishingly meant
Not only of the bread and grape juice spent
But of the revelation that You gave.
A man in linen with a belt to save
Stands in angelic glory, fine and brave.
Beloved, the angels I see on my block
Are of the feathered and the wrenly stock,
But they are just as welcome here to me

And Daniel's were in graceful symmetry.

6 His body like the beryl, his face
Appeared like the lightning to trace,
His eyes like lamps of fire, his arms
And feet like colour in alarms
Of polished brass, and his words sound
Like a multitude *on the ground*.

7 And just I Daniel saw the thing,
For the men with me on the wing
Did not see the vision at all,
But a great trembling came to fall
On them and they all ran to hide
8 So I alone was to abide.

I saw this great sight and there stayed
No strength in me, I was afraid.

9 But I heard the sound of his words,
And when I heard his sound of words,
Then I was in a deep sleep round
My face had fallen to the ground.

10 And see a hand touched me and set
Me on my knees and still to get
On the palms of my hands *I met*.

The angel Gabriel, no doubt, is fine
For Daniel beside the Median pine,
But the description of the coming bears
A likeness to the book that Enoch wears
And rests upon the great similitude
Of Your Messiah in the pulchritude
That Saint John seems to quote from Daniel
brewed.

I'd think the vision would be one to make
Originality for figures' sake.

And yet the prophets all rely upon
Celestial gates of Enoch in the dawn.
Beloved, words fail the prophets, it is true,
Despite the lovely things they bring to
view,

But without words the glories rise to You.

11 And he said to me, "Daniel, man
Greatly beloved, now know the plan
Of the words that I speak to you,
And stand up straight, for unto you
Have I been sent." And when he spoke
This thing to me, then I awoke
To stand trembling *before his stroke*.

12 Then he said to me, "Do not fear,
Daniel, for when it did appear
The first day you set your heart on
Understanding, and fast from dawn

Before your Alohim, your plea
 Was heard and I came by decree.
 13 "But the prince of the Persian state
 Withstood me twenty-one days late,
 But see, Michael of the chief princes
 Came to help me as he convinces,
 And I stayed there with Persian kings.
 14 "But now I've come flying on wings
 To make you understand the fate
 Of your people in the times late,
 For still the vision's for days' wait."

The prince of Persia! Such men can relate
 And bring the power of angels out to wait.
 The prince of Persia still knows how to
 climb
 The ladders of diplomacy and rhyme.
 The prince of Persia had the cards in hand
 To force the listening ear of contraband.
 I pray the prince of Persia may once more
 Get with an angel or two or a score
 And in a fortnight close the evil door
 That dries the Euphrates up to implore.
 Beloved, send angels to all men of state
 Who thirst for power, and show them to be
 great
 By humbling hardened heart to take away
 Rebellion against Your sovereign, bright
 sway.

15 And when he'd spoken such to me,
 I set my face toward the ground
 And could not utter a word *free*,
Nor even make a single sound.
 16 And see one in the likeness of
 Human offspring touched me above
 My lips, then I opened my mouth
 And spoke to one standing to south
 Of me, "O sir, by this grave sight
 My sorrows turn upon my plight,
 And I have kept none of my might.
 17 For how can one servant of this
 My lord talk with this my lord's bliss?"
 For as for me, right off I had
 No strength in me for good or bad,
 And no breath left in me *to miss*.
 18 Then there came again and touched me
 One who appeared in man's degree,
 And he strengthened me. 19 And he said
 "O man greatly loved, do not fear,
 Peace be to you, be strong with cheer,"
 And when he'd spoken to me led,

I was strengthened and so I said
 "Let my lord speak, for you have made
 Me strong *enough to make the grade.*"
 20 Then he said "Do you know why I
 Come to you? And now I shall fly
 Back to struggle against the guy,
 The prince of Persia, and when I
 Have gone out, see the Grecian prince
 Shall come *again and make men wince.*
 21 "But I'll show you what is writ down
 In the Scripture of truth's renown,
 And none know these things with me but
 Michael your prince, *whose mouth is shut.*"

Michael the prince I love since Enoch
 sought
 To teach the watcher what to do or ought.
 The glories of eternal passing sky
 Beneath a universe that's measured by
 The flight of Michael on the rosy bright
 That tinges heaven with magic day and
 night
 Fall through the consciousness of dark and
 hem
 To rend the veils of gold and silver gem.
 Beloved, I hear the mind of Michael sing
 With knowledge of the wondered, secret
 thing
 Until the stars glow in the bright of day.
 Beloved, I see the darts of Michael fly
 Above the fields of barley and of rye
 To point the slender troop in the right way.

Daniel 11 **Medo-Persia**

1 "And I in first year *of the reign*
 Of Darius the Mede, *for gain*
 I stood his strength, support *again*.
 2 "And now truth *indeed* I'll declare.
 See further three kings standing there
 In Persia, and the fourth shall be
 Richer than all the other *three*.
 And when his wealth has come to power
 He'll stir all *others in an hour*
 Against the kingdoms of the Greek.

Alexander

3 "Then shall stand a king great *to seek*
 To rule from ruling greatly and
 As he desires, so does *his hand*.
 4 "And as he stands his kingdoms shall
 Be shattered and scatter like sal

Upon the four winds of the sky,
But not to his posterity,
Nor by the strength that he ruled by,
For his kingdoms plucked up shall be
Even for others *by decree*.

The angel tells the prophet Daniel how
The Persians despite strengthening allow
The reign to fall before the onslaught of
Alexander in Blitzkrieg and the glove
Of power and lust to rule the world in state.
Who wept for fear his father sealed his fate
To have no worlds to conquer, come too
late,
Fell on the silver kingdom, made it bow.
Beloved, I hear the chosen words and know
That kings rise in the heat and awful glow
Of war against every other in foe,
But You stand still invisible at hand
To override evil by Your command
And scatter windblown fear across the land.

Seleucids and Ptolemies

5 “And the king of the south shall be
Strong. *But* then *one* prince of his, *see*,
Shall prevail over his degree,
With his reign great for majesty.

When Alexander the Great’s power was
broken
Into four kingdoms for another token,
Then Ptolemy Soter arose to be
The king of the south in Egypt’s country,
While another prince of the Grecian host
Strengthened himself against everyone’s
boast,
Seleucus Nicator, and for all time
The north and south oppose themselves in
rhyme
And rhetoric, if not in force of arms,
Working their depredations and alarms.
Beloved, cast down both kings that rise in
me,
That of the north and south and set me free
From every wish to find my own estate,
But rest in You alone, the only Great.

6 “As time goes on they shall make pact
Together, the king’s girl in fact
Of the south shall come to the king
Of the north to make agreeing
In marriage, but shall not succeed

In her position, nor shall the weed
Stand in his strength, but she shall be
Destroyed with all her company,
As well as to whom she gave birth,
And he who defended her worth.

As long as kings have reigned they’ve tried
to make
Peace by the marriage contract for the sake
Of family and country and their power.
So from Egypt Bernice went up an hour
To Syria, but the former queen allowed
She still had words to say as yet uncowed.
She killed her former husband who was
king,
She killed fair Bernice and the infant thing,
And placed her own sons on the throne, and
so
The treaty with Egypt was a no show.
Beloved, I see the machinations take
Form north and south and in the women’s
wake
I see the peace fall and the bloodbath shake
The poor as well as moneyed in the flower.
Who trust in bomb and fortresses and
tower,
In treaty and agreement, fall in the shower.

7 “Then shall stand up out of her roots’
Branch one in his estate *in suits*
To come with an army into
The fortress of the north king’s crew,
And fighting against them prevail.
8 “And he shall also win *the tale*
Of their gods captive to Egypt,
Along with their princes, and *shipped*
Their costly silver vessels and
Golden ones, and he shall command
More years than the king of the north.
9 “But he shall come in the kingdom
Of the king of the south, *the bum*,
And return to his own land’s *crumb*.

Bernice’s brother rose as king to take
Vengeance on Syria for his sister’s sake,
And took the stolen gods back to their
place
In Egypt where polytheistic race
Gave him the title of Euergetes,
The Benefactor of the gods that please.
If unrest in the south had not appeared,
He might have taken all the land he feared.

Beloved, the tidings of both north and
south
Ring in my ears and call up to my mouth
Expressions of praise and faith to Your
name.
The vengeance of men who perceive the
wrong
Has fallen on mother, sister in throng
Succeeds a moment, then turns to the
drouth.

10 "But his sons shall be stirred up and
Assemble an army's command,
Till one come up and overflow
And pass through, return and go
Stirred to his fortress *and trousseau*.

Laodike's sons by the northern king
Seleucus Callinicus stir up to sting.
When the first failed, the second took to
wing
To recover his father's blossoming.
He triumphed over the Egyptian foe
And sat on throne and kept the northern
show
When all seemed lost beneath the crushing
blow
Of Egypt sitting round the campfire's glow.
Beloved, I see the round of kings now set
To reign a term in failure and to get
A grip on market and the price of woe.
Beloved, I see the power's ebb and flow
Of rulers in contest where they have met.

11 "The king of the south in his wrath
Shall come to fight him on the path
Of the king of the north, and he
Shall set out with a great army,
And the crowd shall be given to
His hand, *both master and the crew*.
12 When he's captured the multitude,
His heart shall rise with pride imbued,
And he'll cast down ten thousands, yet
Shall not be strengthened *by the net*.

The Ptolemy who loved his father went
Against the enemy on the north bent
With thousands at his side and there he met
The foe in battle and the victory.
Yet he was weak to press advantage spree,
And let the gain return and for his loss.
He rather sought instead of gold the dross,

Instead of rule the reign of lust until
His kingdom was reduced to but a hill.
Beloved, I strike a blow for right and press
To my advantage every armoured guess
To let the good strengthen in what I do,
And let my wickedness then acquiesce.
Beloved, I look for strength to none but
You.

13 "The king of the north shall return,
And set a crowd upon the burn
Greater than the one in its turn
Before it, and shall certainly
After a time come great army
And with riches abundantly.
14 And in those times shall many stand
Against the king of the south manned,
Also the robbers of your folk
Exalt themselves to give a stroke
To the vision, but they'll go broke.

Fourteen years, one for each of innocence,
To represent the powers that with presence
Come against little children in their lair
To destroy everyone without a prayer.
For the first time in history, grand Rome
Intervenes in pretence of hearth and home
To serve the tiny Ptolemy and grant
A respite for the young and tender plant.
Beloved, each ogre that finds its path in
This work of darkness and of human sin,
Is given its chance to assure and win
The love of humankind beyond the din
Of greed and cruelty. The robbers taught
To serve the weak and innocent for plot.

15 "So the king of the north shall come
And raise a mound and take the sum
Of fortified cities, and the arms
Of the south shall not in alarms
Withstand, nor yet his chosen folk,
Neither shall have the strength in yoke.

Scopas took refuge in Sidon's stronghold
Waited for the attack as he was bold,
But could not stand the hunger and the cold
And so surrendered all but life itself.
The great are fallen down from their high
shelf.
Stripped of their jewels and finery and set
out

To find their own way home, they without
doubt
Had time upon the desert road to think
About the woes of humans on the brink
Of misery for their disastrous work.
Behind failure to obey always lurk
The recompenses of the lust to rule.
They fall upon both wise man and the fool.
Beloved, keep me within obedience' link.

Roman Intervention

16 "But he who comes against him shall
Do by his own will so none shall
Stand before him, and he shall stand
Upon the great and glorious land
Which shall be consumed by his hand.

The Romans who came to rescue the one
Who was the infant Ptolemy and son
Stayed to conquer the Syrian on the run
Since greater to withstand them there were
none.

Hyrchanus and Aristobulus rose
To attract attention of Roman foes
And draw the fire upon the glorious land
And lead the robber in to bloody sand
Of fair Jerusalem in Pompey's stand.
Beloved, I see the walls come tumbling
down
And hear the fatal cries upon the town.
I see the priests go round in sacrifice
Until the Roman soldiers come to slice
The hope from off the hills about and
brown.

17 "He'll also set his face to go
In with the strength of his whole show,
And upright ones with him, and so
Shall he do, and he shall give him
The daughter of women to trim
Her with corruption, but shall not
Stand on his side nor in his plot.

The poor children, brother and sis, that
stood
To gain the southern kingdom if they could
Were divided between the greed that shared
Their protectors, both Romans and the
barred
Egyptian princes. Caesar and Pompey
Both came to Egypt hope to bear sway.
Their machinations led to Cleopatra

And brother Ptolemy the twelfth's last
shattery.

Beloved, look on the evil ways of men
And see how infants are drawn in again
By older and experienced to fall
Despite their innocence, despite the call
Of wisdom caught upon a woman's brain.
Not fate buy wickedness becomes her stain.

18 "After this shall he turn his face
Toward the islands and erase
Many, but a prince for his own
Behalf shall cause the reproach thrown
By him to cease, without his own
Reproach he shall cause it full blown
To turn upon his head alone,
19 "As he turns is face back toward
The fort of his own land *and sward*,
There he shall stumble *suddenly*
And not be found *among the free*.

The wars in Syria and Bosphorus
Drew Julius Caesar out with pomp and fuss
To victory. And yet angelic view
Of celebration of the Roman crew
Is short-lived. How ambition and the spite
Of jealousy turn heroes overnight
To enemies of state! The rhetoric
Can turn on anyone in just a trick
And move the crowd to accept murder
black

As justice despite the knife in the back.
Beloved, I see the fickle turn of fate,
Unstable hearts, loyalty's humble state,
And find my refuge in my prayer to You
And in the slight voice of the Psalms I do.

20 "Then there shall stand up in his place
A raiser of taxes to *brace*
The glory of the kingdom's *pace*.
But in a little time shall he
Be destroyed, not in angry *spree*
Nor in the battle *wantonly*.

Augustus rose after the plagued man's fall
To peacefully refill the coffers' pall,
And so he lived to make the urgent call
That men should return to their cities all
To be counted and registered and taxed.
No wars ruffled his armour when relaxed.
The blood and greed and lust before his
time

Resulted in a moment he could climb
The throne in peace and rule with only
mime.

Beloved, the benign rule the taxes still
With the disarming excuse that the till
Serves socialized medicine's awkward bill
Is but the biding of the ogre's wrath.
Beloved, all rulers know a single path.

21 And in his place shall rise up one
Vile, to whom they'll not give *when done*
The honour of the kingdoms, but
He shall come peacefully and shut
The kingdom for is own as he
Obtains it *all* by flattery.

I've stood upon the very spot to see
The palace Tiberius in Capri
Made to his flattered honour when on spree
Of lust, grossly wicked debauchery.
I've seen the dusty courts of Calvary,
And heard excuses made by one and free
That one man sacrificed for the country
Is an expedience that just must be.
Beloved, in lower courts and houses where
Men rise and fall and ladies come to wear
Wealth on their painted bodies, I find there
The flattery that still serves many tongues.
The ladder to honour has no new rungs,
But reeks still with its poisons and its
dungs.

22 And with the arms of a flood they
Shall be overflowed from his way,
And broken, even the one meant
To be Prince of the covenant.

Despite the fact that every Christian church
Reminds with Eucharist one in the lurch
That Christ was Prince a day on donkey's
back

Only to hear the praises turn to slack
And be borne to the cross, if it is true,
Lacking primary history in view,
I understand that cruelty of death
In claw of Julius or Augustus' breath
Takes none down so effectively as sword
Of flatterers come claiming to the bored
That they represent right and might and
crown

Eternal and divine around the town.
Beloved, I take Your warning and ignore

The word of priest and bishop at the door.

Christological Battles

23 And from the union of his gods
One shall work deceit *on the sods*,
For he'll come up and shall be strong
With just a few people along.

The north king waits in Syria and sets
The church at Antioch to making bets,
While south stays in Egypt all the while
And know Alexandria without guile.
Between the two Jerusalem takes sides
As Constantine draws up the Christian tides
From Nicaea and with the union made
Of three pagan gods one god for those who
strayed.

The holy city sits upon the hill
Aghast at what has come to fit the bill.
Deceit for bishops come to declare who
Is heretic and who worthy of pew
Clouds nothing of the truth between the
stakes
Still standing where the churchly ruler
rakes.

24 In ease and in delicacies
Of the province then he shall please
To do what his fathers have not,
Nor his fathers' fathers in plot,
The booty, plunder and the wealth
He'll scatter to them in his stealth,
Against the fortresses he'll think
His strategies to a time's brink.
25 He'll stir up power and boldness too
Against the king of the south's view
With a great army, and the king
Of the south shall be stirred to wing
In battle with a multitude
In battle, but he'll not be viewed
To stand, for they shall catapult
Their strategies to his insult.

The ebb and flow of power between king
Of north and south has taken for its string
Theology instead of politics
Of warfare and its military tricks.
The king of the north has become the one
To sit in Syria's patriarchal dun,
While Alexandria's still the seat of blessed
Patriarch, king of the south and the best.
The Arian controversy started all,

The Nestorian flag continued thrall,
Until the Monophysitic relief
Brought all of Christendom down in its
grief.

Beloved, the armies of the faith still shout
Theology through economic drought.

26 Indeed who feed on his meat's row
Shall destroy him and army's flow
Shall overrun and many fall
Down slain *in heresy's mad brawl*.

27 And both these kings' hearts are
inclined

To mischief and speak lies in mind
And one table, but it shall not
Prosper, because the end is fraught
For a time appointed *and sought*.

The fight was on for what nature of Christ
Is bourn within the body sacrificed,
And whether natures are of one or two
Within the single person now in view.
Both sides were already in heresy,
Claiming the human clothes divinity,
And both deceits took on the bloody plough
Of war and killing for the golden bough.
Beloved, I stray outside the royal gloom
Of theological sword and the doom
Of faith and doubt, and rest my soul upon
Your heart alone beneath the rosy dawn.
You time appointed flashes on the view
Of sleeping worlds before the sparkling
dew.

28 The he shall go back to his land
With great wealth, and his heart shall stand
Against the holy covenant,
And he shall act and then relent
And go back to his land and tent.

Though Egypt sided with Nicetas and
With Heraclius too as rebels stand
Against the emperor Phocas, the weight
Of Persians came against the holy gate.
Belief and wealth and war must intertwine,
And every god and goddess drink the wine
Of sacrifice their due, while men resign
Themselves to violence among the dew.
Beloved, my bleeding heart turns back to
You.

The turbulence of times comes to a head
Before the last surprise of the unled

To find the blooming desert that was lost
Before the broken dam and water tossed
Into the evil drought as land Godsped.

29 At the time appointed by divine will
The mercenary foes met on the hill,
But not as before or as following.

30 For ships from western sea came up on
wing

Against him for his grief and then go back
With rage against the holy covenant.
So shall he do as though in fervour slack
Return to *the land from which he was sent*
To confer with breakers of covenant.

The bishops and their kings continue to
Debate the trinity and Christ in view
With treachery and artifice and fail
To realize the coming of the gale.
The church has long rejected covenant,
That holy covenant one time you sent
To thunder on Mount Sinai and to write
Itself in promises on fleshly site
Of human hearts. And so they read the sky
Without warning Muhammad's coming by.
Beloved, let my attention in this place
Distracted by security and race
Of wealth not forget to seek for Your face
In prayer and fast and virtue by Your grace.

Umayyad Capture of Jerusalem

31 The strength shall stand for him and
they

Shall pollute holy temple's sway,
And take away the daily and
They shall place *there upon the land*
Abomination that *in hand*
Makes desolate *the holy strand*.

When the Umayyads took Jerusalem
They did not try in any way to stem
The time of Jewish or Christian delight
In pilgrimage into the holy site.
They merely added one more awful rite
To finish abomination begun
By Rabbis and by bishops on the run.
The trinity of faiths in covenant
Against Your Word, Beloved, at last gave
vent

To setting up agreement that has lent
Beastly validity for centuries
To the depletion of the holy trees.

Beloved, I bow within the holy mosque
In prostration to You by-passing kiosk.

In the year six nine one Abdul Malik
Raised Quds to be a city said unique
By building in the seat of caliphate
The dome of the rock as a counterfeit
And as abomination desolate
In answer to the prophecy and fate.
Unwittingly perhaps he started then
The time and times and half a time in den
That would lay waste to faith and hold a
 claw
Of Sunnite Islam at the faithful draw.
So near to the true faith, so near indeed,
And yet inheritor of awful seed
That sought to change Your times and law
 and creed,
Beloved, before the world's most constant
 need.

32 And those who do wickedly by
The covenant by flattery
Shall he corrupt, but the folk who
Know their God shall be strong and do.

Umayyad Islam by its flattery
Converted Christian churches by the sea
And brought them all into the Sunnite fold
To shelter in corruption by the bold.
Because they had corrupted covenant
And turned away from Your own holy tent
Of divine unity and Sabbath-keeping
They could not bear the brunt and turned
 out weeping.
Beloved, I see that if the Christians' goal
Had been to keep Your ten
 commandments' toll,
The weariness of their theology
Would not have broken them off from the
 tree.
Umayyads breaking faith with their own
 prophet
Counselled the Christians to be butt to scoff
 at.

Rise of the Abbassids

33 And they that understand among
The folk shall instruct for stroke
Many, and yet they shall fall by
The sword and flame, captivity
And spoiled *many days' misery*.

Beloved, You raised up divine guidance to
Teach all the faithful what to know and do,
And each divine guide to his son
 transmitted
The holy ordinance of all things fitted.
And yet the Umayyad sword left
To the Abbassids for the true bereft
Was ever sharp and claimed a bloody due
If only by the poison of its dew.
Beloved, I flee to You and weep again
For those lost and killed of Your faithful
 men,
And weep to hear their twelve names sung
 in rhyme,
And weep to hear about the evil time
Their children were slaughtered by king
 and priest
As unfaithfulness on the earth increased.

34 And when they fall they shall get help
A little, although every whelp
Shall stay with them by flattery.
35 Even the wise by them shall fall
Refining those left in their stall
And purifying by the loss
To make white even to the toss
Of the end time, for it is yet
For time appointed *he'll be met*.

The flattery of people and their kings
Runs to the underground of righteous
 things
Until Your divine proof cannot be found
Among the labelled merchants on the
 ground,
But must be taken up in secret kept
While the white robed behind remained and
 wept.
But at the time appointed he shall rise
And proclaim Your name up into the skies,
And with a word deal blows to all around
Who in the triumvirate shall be bound
For punishment that they did not believe
The secret word sent to save and reprove.
The flattery caused occultation's coming
While institutions have remained here
 humming.

Tamerlane

36 The king shall do by his own will
And raise himself higher than hill

Of every god, and speak great things
 Against the God of gods and kings,
 And prosper till the wrath is done
 For what's determined *under sun*.
 37 Neither shall he regard the god
 Of his fathers upon the sod,
 Nor the desire of women nor
 Any god for he'll show in store
 Himself above them all and great.
 38 But he'll honour in his estate
 The god of violence, a god
 His ancestors refused the nod
 He'll gratify with gold and siller,
 With precious stones, pleasant to fill her.
 39 So he'll deal with the fortresses
 Of strength with help of god that is
 Foreign, whom he shall know and give
 Increase of glory, he shall live
 To make them rule over a crowd
 Dividing land for wealth allowed.

Then Tamerlane came from the rushing
 wind
 To rule the world about him where he
 sinned
 By taking the Umayyad's god of force
 And following the Abbassid divorce
 In praise to Allah, righteous name again
 Turned to shame by the actions of bad men.
 The convert of Islam's apostasy
 Did nothing good to support symmetry
 Of divine proof and guidance, but retained
 The name of Islam already blood-stained.
 Beloved, the despots of a former year
 Arise before my eyes and fill with fear
 The heart foreboding the increase of tear,
 And so I seek refuge in You while here.

Saladdin and the Rise and Fall of the Ottomans

40 And at the time of the end shall
 The king of the south with cabal
 Pressure him and the northern king
 Come against him on the wind's wing
 With chariots and with horsemen *bold*
 And many ships *in count untold*
 And enter into the lands *there*
 And overflow and pass *the share*.
 41 He'll enter in the glorious land
 And see overthrown quite a band,
 But these shall escape from his hand,
 Edom, Moab and Ammon's grand.

42 He'll stretch his hand on the countries,
 And Egypt's land shall not escape.
 43 But he'll have power on treasures
 Of gold and silver and *the shape*
Of all precious things of Egypt,
 And Libians and Cushites all shipped
 At his steps *shall not be outstripped*.
 44 But rumours from the east and from
 The north shall trouble him to come
 With raging to destroy and make
 Completely away with their stake.
 45 And he shall set his palace tents
 Between the seas in the presence
 Of the glorious and sacred mount,
 Yet come to end of his account
 And none shall help him *from offence*.

The end of empires in the Middle East
 Is with the Ottomans, last but not least.
 Long centuries maintain the end of time
 After the Sultan came through Palestine
 And took Egypt, the king of southern
 clime,

And rebuilt the walls of the city fine,
 Jerusalem. The end of time and states
 Of empires on the woeful land of hates.
 Beloved, the ebb and flow of kings and
 queens
 Rises in brilliance to pass from the scenes
 Of earth to find Your guided one at last
 Stands up to rule when earthly kings have
 passed.

The Russians and the Persians to their
 shame
 Troubled the sick man of the east to blame,
 And from the east and north came to trip up
 Until he rose in fury like a tup.
 Though in the end the sultans rule no more,
 And fields are dry now that once ran with
 gore,
 The day may come when Turkey shall rise
 and
 Set palaces beyond the mountain's strand
 And set the holy place beyond command.
 Beloved, I look for such a thing to be
 That will reveal the time of Michael's fee,
 And that the earth shall enter trouble's way
 That proceeds with darkness the brighter
 day,
 When the anointed brings eternity.

Daniel 12

1 "And at that time shall Michael stand,
The great prince who stands for the band
Of your people, and there shall be
A time of trouble such to see
As never was since nation came
Even to that same time of fame,
And at that time your folk shall be
Delivered, everyone to be
Found written in the book *to see*.
2 "And many of those in the dust
Of the earth that sleep will be first
To wake up, some to life eternal,
And some to shame, contempt infernal.
3 "And those who are wise then shall shine
As brightness of the firmament,
And those who turn many to clime
Of righteousness like the stars sent
For ever and for ever meant.
4 "But you, O Daniel, close the word
And seal the book to the time stirred
Of the end, till men run about
And knowledge multiply *to shout*."
5 Then I Daniel looked and behold
There stood two others, the one rolled
On this side of the river bank,
The other on the side that sank
Of the river. 6 And one spoke to
The man clothed in the linen hue
Who was upon the river dew,
"How long to the end of this crew?"

The prophecies of time have ended now.
I look about the shifting and the slough
And see a world grown old in wickedness.
I do not have to squint my eyes or guess.
I see the time of trouble flinging past
And spreading like a cancer at the mast.
I see the flight of refugee and post
Of army and civilians from the coast
Across the continent to set a flag
To fallen Babylon, the withered hag.
Beloved, I see and hear and know Your
train
Comes with the shining stars to fill the
plain
With justice as the Guided one appears
Allaying pain of righteous ones and tears.

7 I heard the linen-clothed man *say*,
Who was on river water's sway,
When he held up his right hand and

His left hand to the sky *on strand*
And swore by Him that ever lives
That it shall be a year *in sieves*
And two years and a half, and when
He shall have finished upon men
The scattering of the holy crowd,
All these things shall be finished *loud*.
8 And I heard, but I did not know
What it meant, then I said once low,
"O sir, what's the end of this show?"
9 And he said "Go your way, Daniel,
For the words are closed up a spell
And sealed till the end time as well.
10 Many shall be made clean and white,
And tried, but the wicked in sight
Shall do evil, and none of them
For evil shall know *ought of gem*,
But the wise ones left in the land,
Only they'll come to understand.
11 And from the time the daily's taken
And abomination that's shaken
The desolate out in its power,
Shall be a thousand *in that hour*
Two hundred and ninety days *all*.
12 Blessed is the one that waits *the call*
And comes to the thousand and three
Hundred thirty-five days *in fee*.
13 But you your way till the end be,
For you shall rest and stand your lot
At the end of the days *in plot*.

Counting from Umar 634 C.E.

In 1894 the end appears
To twelve hundred and sixty plotted years.
The reputation of the Ottoman
Died with the rumours of Armenian ban.
Add thirty years and 1924
Sees the sultanate shunted from the door.
Add forty-five years and Jerusalem
Is opened to the hordes that will condemn
The world to the last false faith of them all
That tries to rise against Your earthen ball.
All faiths of all usurpers meet at last
While I stand aside from the motley cast
And pray my lot may be with Daniel now
That judgement looms upon the pallid
brow.

Counting from Abdul Malik 691 C.E.

Jerusalem became the caliph's seat
Under Abdul Malik, who for a treat
Built the dome of the rock in ninety-one

Of seventh century: the time is done
 Of time and times and half a time when
 won
 In nineteen fifty-one when Arab hordes
 Entered Jerusalem from Jordan's cords.
 Jerusalem Law made the city wear
 The title of the capital and fair
 After nineteen eighty the prophet followed,
 Saw how the city wavered and it wallowed
 Until the last date comes when it shall be
 In year two thousand twenty-six freely
 Capital city for eternity.

Counting from the rise of Islam 612 C.E.

Fact is, I'm not the first to train my eye
 On this grand scheme of prophecy on sly.
 Adam Clarke, that great scholar name and
 guy,
 Read this to end in nineteen forty-seven.
 What happened then on earth if not in
 heaven?
 United Nations approved the partition
 Of Palestine to give the Jews' sedition
 The possibility of legal fate.
 That opened the way for the Jewish state,
 The capital to be born in the great
 City Jerusalem and raise the hope
 Of many that the rulership of pope
 And Caesar would turn to Your kingdom's
 rate.
 Clarke got it right and tied it up with rope.

Beloved, I simply don't believe You gave
 A date when earth would become bold and
 brave.
 Though human freedom is illusion's store,
 You Yourself don't determine history's
 score.
 The pleading of the prophet is not doom,
 But liberation giving humans room.
 We can rise to the prophecy and take
 Your Decalogue as rule of thumb and make
 Your world a world of justice and a realm
 Where peace-prosperity is at the helm.
 We can do it in twenty-twenty-six,
 But it would be no sleight of hand or tricks
 To do the thing today and do it now.
 At least I take Your law's word as I bow.

Thousands have played with numbers on
 the count
 Of Daniel's and the Revelation's mount

And erred to find the date of this or that.
 I'm one of those if I sit where I've sat.
 I do not fool myself to think the world
 Will last to twenty-twenty-six unfurled.
 I wait You and Your judgement day each
 week
 As Sabbath starts where the first stars come
 peek.
 And even that's presumption that I seek
 To live a moment here beyond this breath
 That may be the last one before my death.
 Beloved, I joy in judgement day today,
 And find the future has no time nor ray,
 And all the numbers file and fade away
 Before the boast of Your grand roundelay.

Daniel 13 Susanna

1 There was a man of Babylon
 Whose name was Joakim, 2 and one
 Wife he took named Susanna, she
 Was daughter of Hilkiah, she
 Was a most beautiful lady,
 And one who feared YHWH *gratefully*.
 3 Her parents were righteous, and had
 Taught their daughter *the good and bad*
 According to the law of Moses.
 4 Joakim was quite rich *in roses*,
As well as in silver and gold,
 And had a spacious paradise
 Adjoining his house, *to be bold*
 The Jews would come to him because
 He was most honoured in their laws.
 5 That year two elders *not too nice*
 From the people were set as judges.
 YHWH had said concerning *such smudges*,
 "From Babylon iniquity
 Came forth, from elders who were free
 Judges, who ought to rule the folk."
Thus Alohim anciently spoke.
 6 These *two bad* men were frequently
 At Joakim's house, and all who
 Had suits at law came to them there.
 7 When the people left at noon *to*
Eat lunch, Susanna would go to
 Her husband's garden *for fresh air*.
 8 The two elders would see her there
 Each day, going in, walking there,
 And they began to desire her.
 9 And they perverted their minds and
 Turned away their eyes *upon her*
 From looking up to heaven and
 Remembering righteous command.

Ah, my Beloved, make me not great to be
 A judge in Israel, for that company
 Is famous with all priests and kings to bear
 Abuse of their divine authority.
 Let me instead be one in poverty
 To peer above the garden walls to see
 No lustful sights among the roses there
 But only Your delights and Your mercy.
 Lead me, Beloved, along the lonely ways
 That grace the outer edges of Your praise,
 Where few come for the rugged, stony road
 To find Your easy yoke and lighter load.
 Give me no wealth or power, but keep me
 free
 Of those temptations to impurity.

10 Both were overcome with passion
 For her, but did not tell the one
 The other what their passion won,
 11 For they were ashamed to reveal
 The lustful desires that both feel
 To lie with her. 12 And they watched well,
 Day after day, caught in her spell.
 13 They told each other, "Let us go
 Home, for it's mealtime." 14 And *for show*
 When they went out, they went each way,
 But turning back, they met *astray*
 Again, and when each pressed the other
 For the reason, each to his brother
 Confessed his lust. Then they together
 Arranged for a time when and whether
 They could find her alone. 15 Once, while
 They were watching *both in their guile*
 For an opportune day, she went
 In as before with two maids sent,
 And wished to bathe in paradise,
 For it was hotter *then than ice*.
 16 And no one was there but the two
 Elders, who'd hid what they would do
 And watched her from their hiding place.
 17 She told her maids, "Bring *for my face*
 Oil and ointments, and shut the doors
 Of paradise, no visitors
 Shall see me bathe." 18 They did as she
 Said, shut the garden doors *tightly*,
 And went out by the side doors to
 Bring her what they had been told to,
 They did not see the elders, who
 Were hidden. 19 When the maids had gone,
 The elders rushed and fell upon
 Her, and said, 20 "Look, the garden doors

Are shut against all visitors,
 No one sees us, and our lust burns
 Toward you, so give your due consent
 And lie with us, 21 the one who spurns
 Our hot advance will live to hear
 Our testimony in the ear
 Of Israel against you that
 A young man was here where you sat
 And that's why you dismissed your maids."
 22 Susanna sighed deeply, and said,
 "I'm hemmed in by your naughty raids.
 For if I do this thing, it's death
 For me, and if I do not, breath
 Cannot help me escape your hands.
 23 "I choose not to fall in sin's bands,
 But rather to fall in your hands,
 Rather than to sin in the sight
 Of YHWH *and do what is not right.*"

The two elders threatened to testify,
 And since that day, since sin does always
 lie
 Within the heart of leader of the flock,
 It is no longer righteous to take stock
 Of accusation of adultery
 On basis of witnesses two or three.
 Adultery requires four witnesses
 Of the act itself before justice is
 Meted to sinner. That's the effect on
 The law providing for priest's sin and
 brawn.
 Who take a pregnancy as sign enough
 Of faithlessness would be distinctly rough
 On holy Mary with her saintly child.
 Beloved, Islamic law is running wild.

24 Then Susanna cried out aloud,
 And the two elders shouted too
 Against her. 25 And one of them ran
 And opened the doors to the crowd.
 26 And then the household servants who
 Heard the shouting, came quick as can
 In at the side door to see what
 Had happened in the garden shut.
 27 And when the elders told their tale,
 The servants were ashamed *and pale*,
 For nothing like was ever said
 About Susanna *and her bed*.
 28 The next day, when the people came
 To the house of Joakim by name,
 The elders came, full of the plot
 To kill Susanna on the spot.

29 They said before the people, "Send
For Susanna, Hilkiah's bend,
Who is the wife of Joakim."
30 So they sent for her, and she came,
With her parents, her children, and
All her kindred. 31 Lady of grand
Refinement was Susanna and
Beautiful in appearance then.
32 As she was veiled, the wicked men
Ordered her to be unveiled, that
They might feast eye where beauty sat.

The evil men who claimed to be the law
Held neither justice nor virtue in awe,
But only cared about their own lust and
Their game of power and ruthless
command.

The innocent is always brought to trial,
The judge is always filled with sin and
guile.

O my Beloved, look on this world a while.
I seek refuge in You, who love the meek
And keep the seventh day holy each week.
Strike down the hand that seeks to take the
veil
From off the head where righteous women
vail.

There are enough to spare this day and
time,
But few there are to press their case in
rhyme,
And few to seek redress and justice' grail.

33 But family and friends and all
Who saw her wept. 34 Then *at the call*
The two elders stood up before
The people, and laid hands *what's more*
Upon her head. 35 And she, weeping,
Looked up toward heaven to *pray a thing*.
Because her heart trusted in YHWH.
36 The elders said, "As just we two
Were walking in the garden, this
Woman came in with two maids, shut
The garden doors maids to dismiss.
37 Then a young man hidden *for bliss*
Came to her and lay with her, what.
38 We in a corner of the spot
Saw this evil and ran like sot,
39 We saw them in embrace, but we
Could not hold the man, who got free,
For he was too strong for us, he
Opened the doors and dashed away.

40 So we seized this woman to say
Who the young man was, but she would
Not tell us *anything she could*.
These things we testify *for good*."
41 The assembly believed them then,
Because they were elders *and men*
And judges of the people, they
Condemned *the lamb* to death *that day*.

The common people will believe the
crown,
And follow wealth, not virtue, in the town.
The status for the crowd gives way to truth,
And Edward's word stands up against poor
Ruth.

The well-respected man speaks in his turn,
His rhetoric and grammar make us spurn
The virtuous whose speech is what it is.
Rich up, poor down, not hers, but always
his.

Politically correct is always right,
Glass is a diamond, and day is night.
In ancient time at least family and
Friends wept for injustice and out of hand.
Now, my Beloved, the good must stand
alone,
Forsaken by his own flesh, blood and bone.

42 Then Susanna cried out aloud
And prayed before assembled crowd,
"O eternal Alohim, who
Discern the secret and the true,
Who are aware of all things e'er
They come to be, 43 You know right fair
These men bear false witness of me.
And now I am to die! Yet I
Have not done what they wickedly
Invent against *my heart and me!*"
44 The Lord *Almighty* heard her cry.
45 And as she was led to be slain,
Alohim roused and raised amain
The holy spirit of young lad
Named Daniel, 46 who with voice he had
Cried out aloud, "I'm innocent
Of the blood of this woman *rent*."
47 All the folk turned to him, and said,
"What is this thing that you have said?"
48 Taking his stand among them, he
Said "Are you such fools, Israel's folk?
Have you condemned a daughter spoke
Of well in Israel without test
To learn the facts *and what is best?*"

Beloved, You hear each day such prayers
that be
The anguished heart of those who are not
free,
But pour their sorrows on the gallows floor,
And beat their breasts up to Your heaven's
own door.
Each day go down to silence those who call
In vain for justice as they touch the pail.
Do You respond in grace only and when
There is a Daniel to stand up to men?
Have You no tongue nor arms to cure their
fate
Who follow justice down until too late?
Beloved, rise now, though only for a crow
Who's pelted at the table, eating slow.
Domestic justices are just as true.
I hold myself in judgement up to You.

49 "Return to the place of judgement.
For these men have been falsely sent
Against her." 50 Then all the folk went
In haste. And the elders said *boldly*,
"Come, sit among us and speak *coldly*,
For Alohim gives you that right."
51 And Daniel told them *in their sight*,
"Separate them far from each other,
And I'll examine *son and brother*."
52 When they were separated from
Each other, he summoned one "Come"
He said to him, "You wicked sot,
Your sins return upon your plot,
Which you've committed in the past,
53 "Pronouncing unjust judgments fast,
Condemning the innocent and
Letting guilty go in the land,
Though YHWH said, 'Do not put to death
An innocent and righteous *breath*.'

Return, return to the place of judgement!
That's hard to do these days, as cases sent
Must have the money in the hand to pay.
Justice is for the rich alone today.
Divide and conquer Daniel will learn
Is the best rule in Babylon to earn.
The patronizing elders speak the word,
While Daniel, just a youth, calls them a
turd.

Such language is too often found in youth,
But on occasion is used as the truth.
Who slay the innocent deserve to be

Called by the very name that I here see.
Beloved, call me by name and let that name
Not be such as by my acts cause me shame.

54 Now then, if you really saw her,
Tell me this, where did it occur,
Under what kind of tree did you
See them engaged in dalley-hoo?"
He said, "Under a mastic tree."
55 And Daniel said, "Well and so be!
You have lied against your own head,
For the angel of Alohim
Has got sentence from Alohim
And will right quickly see you dead."
56 Then he put him aside, and said
To bring the other. And he said
To him, "You offspring of Canaan
And not of Judah, beauty can
Deceive you and lust turn your heart.
57 "This is how you both played your part
Against the daughters of Israel,
Who lay with you when fears prevail,
But one daughter of Judah would
Not endure your evil, nor could.
58 "Now then, tell me, under what tree
Did you catch them intimately?"
He said, "Under evergreen oak."
59 And Daniel said to him, "Well spoke!
You've lied also against your head,
For the angel of Alohim
Is waiting with his sword *and gleam*
To cut you in two, that he may
Destroy you both *now and today*."
60 Then all the folk shouted loudly
And blessed Alohim, who saves those
Who hope in Him. 61 And they arose
Against the two elders greatly,
For out of their own mouths convicted,
Daniel found their witness conflicted.
62 And they did to them as they had
Wickedly planned to do as bad
To their neighbour, according to
The law of Moses *and of YHWH*,
They put them both to death that day,
So innocence was saved that way.
63 And Hilkiah and his wife praised
Alohim for their daughter *dazed*
Susanna, and so Joakim
Her husband and all those who seem
To be her kindred, since nothing
Shameful was found in her *to sting*.
64 And from that day onward Daniel

Had great repute in Israel.

O my Beloved, I look about the park
Of prayer and incense, in the light and
dark,
To find You whom my soul loves and
desires,
To quench in You the burning gates of
fires.
I see the empty pool, the light of star
And moon glance on its quiet ripples far.
I see the marbled corridors gleam bright
Against the fragrant and almost white
night.

The empty garden scented and perfumed
Awaits, it seems, Your coming to be
roomed.

Alone I wait in silence, till I see
What and YHWH was there in my
company

Unseen, unfelt, unheard, but suddenly
Appearing present under every tree.

Daniel 14 Bel and the Dragon

1 'Twas when King Astyages was laid
With his fathers, Cyrus the Persian
Received his kingdom *for diversion*.
2 And Daniel was companion made
To the king, and most honoured of
His friends *for wisdom and for love*.
3 Now Babylonians had an
Idol called Bel, and *as they can*
Every day they spent on it twelve
Bushels of fine flour and *to delve*
Forty sheep, fifty jars of wine.
4 The king revered it as divine
And went each day to worship it.
But Daniel worshipped *as was fit*
His own Alohim. 5 And the king
Said to him, "Why do you this thing
Not worshipping Bel?" He answered,
"Because I do not, *in a word*,
Revere idols made by the hand
Of man, but the living command
Of Alohim, who made the earth
And heaven, *and ocean, sea and firth*
And has dominion on all flesh."
6 The king said to him, "*Don't be fresh*,
Don't you see Bel's a living god?
Do you not see how much he eats
And drinks each day *of wine and treats?*"

The wise and powerful set for their proof
With quaintly academic words to spoof.
Does every thing that eats and drinks
become

Divinity? I think that's wisdom's sum.
But proof for Daniel is the best of all:
He's God who made the whole terrestrial
ball.

That proof well meets the challenge of the
score

Or more who wait with claims beside the
door.

One need not seek out truth, try to find
God,

As though a hidden corner sheltered rod.
One only needs to look from here to there
And know the one Creator's everywhere
Reality looks out on graven stone
And ridicules creation left alone.

7 Then Daniel laughed, and said, "Do not
Be deceived, O king, by this plot
For this is but clay inside and
Brass outside *made by human hand*,
It never ate or drank a thing."

8 Then anger boiled within the king
And he called his priests, said to them,
"If you don't tell, I shall condemn,
Who is eating this stuff, say now
Or you shall all die anyhow."

9 "But if you prove that Bel eats them,
Daniel shall die for his blaspheme
Against Bel." Daniel told the king,
"Let be done as you've said the thing."

10 Now there were seventy priests of Bel,
Besides wives and children *to tell*.

And the king went with Daniel
Into the *great* temple of Bel.

11 And the priests of Bel said, "Indeed,
We'll stay outside, you, king, shall feed
With food and mix and place the wine,
And shut the door and seal it fine
With your signet. 12 "When you return
The morrow, if you do not find
That Bel has eaten it and wined,
We will die, or else Daniel will,
Who's telling lies about us still."

13 They were unconcerned, for beneath
The table they'd made hidden *wreath*
An entrance, through which they would go
In night by night to eat the dough.

14 When they had gone out, the king set

Forth the dainties for Bel's banquet.
 Then Daniel ordered his servants
 To bring ashes and take the chance
 To sift them through the temple thrown
 In presence of the king alone.
 Then they went out, and shut the door
 And sealed it *behind and before*
 With the king's signet, and departed.
 15 In the night the priests came *light-
hearted*
 With wives and children, as was custom
 And ate and drank the things to burst them.
 16 Early in the morning the king
 Rose and came, and Daniel walking.
 17 And the king said, "Are seals unbroken,
 Daniel?" He answered, "They're unbroken,
 O king." 18 But when the doors were flung
 The king looked at the table hung,
 And shouted in a loud voice, "You
 Are great, O Bel, truly with you
 There's no deceit, no, none at all."
 19 Then Daniel laughed, and stopped the
 fall
 Of the king's foot upon the hall,
 And said, "Look at the floor, and see
 Whose footsteps are abundantly."
 20 The king said, "I see the footprints
 Of men's, women's and children's *stints*."
 21 Then the king was enraged, and he
 Seized priests, their wives and children
 free,
 And they showed him the secret door
 Under the table, through the floor,
 Through which they would enter and eat
 And drink the wine and every treat.
 22 Therefore the king put them to death,
 And gave Bel *up like Ashtoreth*
 To Daniel, who destroyed the thing
 And its temple *before the king*.

 Ah, wisdom of antiquity well met!
 Such things today are very hard to get.
 Reason's dethroned by every strange
 addiction,
 And when one shows the footprints of the
 fiction
 And the trap door beneath the table's
 groan,
 Today's kings point to seal of door and
 throne
 And to the empty plates and goblets here.
 A weak argument taught with oil and gold

Is satisfaction that the truth appear.
 The real truth is bound up and tied and sold
 To be burned at the dump with wrappings
 sere.

Beloved, I look beyond the washing words
 That soar in empty spaces like the birds
 And stand before reality, one bold.

23 There was also a great dragon,
 Which Babylonians prayed on.
 24 And the king said to Daniel,
 "You can't deny the dragon's spell,
 That he's a living god and so
 Worship him." 25 Daniel said, "No,
 I'll worship YHWH my Alohim,
 For He's the living Alohim.
 26 "But if you, king, will give me way,
 I'll slay the dragon, *no delay*,
 Without sword or without a club."
 The king said, "I will never snub,
 You have permission." 27 Daniel took
 Pitch, fat, and hair, to boil and cook
 Them all together and made cakes,
 Which he fed the dragon for aches.
 The dragon ate them, burst open.
 And Daniel said, "See what you've been
 Worshipping!" 28 The Babylonians
 Heard it, and were out of their skins
 For anger and conspiring then
 Against the king, some of the men
 Said "The king has become a Jew,
 Destroyed Bel, and the dragon, too,
 And slaughtered the priests." 29 So they
 said
 To the king, "Give Daniel's head
 To us, or else we'll kill you and
 Your household." 30 The king saw the
 stand
 They made against him pressing hard,
 Was forced to put Daniel in guard.

Who think they reign in power because
 they wield
 The bank key and the oil well in the field
 Know well the populace has power enough
 To stoke the fires to burn them in their
 scruff.
 And so they put the just in irons and den
 To satisfy the real power among their men.
 The argument that claimants to divine
 Are true because they live as well as dine
 Disarms with its ingenuous design.

To live does not equal the divine show.
Two arguments arise but they must go:
It is no proof that one is God because
He lives or has honey upon his paws.
Beloved, Your fame has never been so low.

31 They threw Daniel in lions' den,
He was there for six days *in pen*.
32 There were seven lions in the den,
And every day they had been given
Two human bodies and two sheep,
But these were not now given nor driven
To them, so that in hunger deep
They might devour Daniel in keep.
33 Now the prophet Habakkuk was
In Judea, *as prophet does*.
He had boiled pottage, broken bread
In a bowl with which reapers fed.
34 But the angel of YHWH said to
Habakkuk, "Take the dinner to
Babylon to Daniel, who's there
In lions' den." 35 Habakkuk said,
"Sir, I've never seen Babylon,
Nor have I been there anywhere
And I know nothing nor have read
About the den *that you mention*."
36 Then the angel of YHWH took him
By the crown of his head, and grim
Lifted him by his hair and set
Him down in Babylon, *well met*
Right over the den, with the sound
Of rushing wind itself around.
37 Then Habakkuk shouted, "Daniel,
I say, Daniel! Take the lunch well
Which Alohim has sent to you."
38 And Daniel said, "Alohim, You
Remembered me, and not forsaken
Those who love you *and not mistaken*."
39 So Daniel arose and ate.
And the angel of Alohim
Returned Habakkuk to his gate
Quickly in his own place *and scheme*.

Beloved, if you had lifted me by hair
When I was younger, I trust that the fare
For flight to Babylon was worth the price.
But now the trip that way would be no dice.
You see, when I was young my hair was
thick,
But now lifting by hair's a gentle trick.
There are spots not bald on this pate of
mine,

But just the one You need has not a tine.
Habakkuk may have been the first to fly
Two thousand years and more before the
cry
Of the Wright brothers, yet he claimed no
gift,
But even gave You credit for the lift
Of soup and bread he brought in hand to
give.
Beloved, it is not I but You who live.

40 On the seventh day the king came
To mourn for Daniel. When he came
To the den he looked in, and there
Sat Daniel, *not turning a hair*.
41 And the king shouted with loud voice,
"You are great *and the only choice*,
O Lord Alohim of Daniel,
And there's no other besides You."
42 And he pulled Daniel out, as well,
And threw in the den the men who
Had attempted his own destruction,
Who were devoured *without obstruction*
Quickly before his eyes *withdrew*.

The Sabbath is the day of setting right
What in the week was craving divine sight.
The eve after the day of congregation
Sees judgment coming as its revelation.
I hear Your footsteps as the sun goes down
And Sabbath descends on unwitting town,
And know that with Your coming I shall go
Out from the lion's pit to find Your show.
The mourning of both prisoner and king
Is changed to joy and gladness at the ring
Of Sabbath's entrance at the golden gate.
On Sabbath all men escape their foul fate
To dance in ecstasy upon the floor
Of glass and crystal from an ancient lore.

Manasseh

1 O Lord Almighty, Alohim
Of our fathers, of Abraham
And Isaac and Jacob's esteem
And of their righteous child and dam,
2 You who have made the heaven and earth
With all their order *and their worth*,
3 Who have shackled the sea by Your
Word of command, who have set door
Upon the deep and sealed it by
Your terrible and glorious name,
4 At whom all things shudder and fly,

And tremble before your *great* power,
 5 For glorious splendour not an hour
 To be borne, and the wrath of your
 Threat to sinners no sinner bore,
 6 Yet great, unsearchable is your
 Promise of mercy, 7 for You are
 YHWH Most High, and of greater far
 Compassion, long-suffering, and then
 Most merciful, to feeble men.
 You, O Lord, by Your great goodness
 Promised repentance, forgiveness
 To those who have sinned against You,
 And in Your mercies' multitude
 You have set repentance unrud
 For sinners, that they may be saved.
 8 Therefore You, O Alohim YHWH
 God of the righteous, have not craved
 Repentance from the righteous, from
 Abraham, Isaac, Jacob, some
 Who did not sin against you, but
 You have appointed repentance
 For me, who am in sinner's stance.
 9 For the sins I've committed are
 More numerous than sand or star,
 And my transgressions multiplied,
 O YHWH, are multiplied beside!
 I am unworthy to look up
 And see the height of heaven's cup
 Because of my iniquities.
 10 I am weighted down with *all of these*,
 Many an iron fetter, so I'm
 Rejected for my sins and crime,
 And I have no relief, for I've
 Provoked your wrath and *while alive*
 Done what is evil in your sight,
 Setting up idols, great offence.
 11 And now I bend both knee and heart,
 Beseeching you for kindness' right.
 12 I've sinned, O YHWH, sinned without
 sense,
 And I know my transgressions' part.
 13 I earnestly beseech You now,
 Forgive me, YHWH, forgive somehow!
 Do not destroy me with my crimes!
 Do not be angry now betimes
 Nor lay for ever evil for
 Me, do not condemn, *I implore*,
 Me to the depths of earth. For You
 Are Alohim *and Lord* and YHWH
 Of those who repent, who repent.
 14 In me You will show goodness sent,
 For, unworthy as I am, You

Will save me in your great mercy,
 15 And I shall praise, praise You freely
 All the days of my life. For all
 The host of heaven sings Your praise,
And angels to each other call
 Your glory from eternal days. Amen.

From splendour to repentance goes the
 prayer,
 And I follow its glories everywhere.
 The fallow slope grown up in saplings bare
 Beneath a spring grey scintillates in air,
 The pastureland forgotten by the claim
 Of sports still sanctifies Your holy name
 As lingering snows turn to the gushing
 frame
 Of brooks in temporary melodrama.
 Along with wakened housefly and a hare
 Still white with winter darkness and its
 care,
 I praise and praise again Your love and art
 Who created me to live in Your heart.
 Your mercies' multitude indeed fulfils
 The thousand benedictions of the hills.

Hosea

The first of twelve prophets, the writings
 show
 The last of Hebrew texts that come to glow
 With the number outright of twelve to
 know
 That You, Beloved, appoint men to reveal
 In very action before woe and weal
 The good and right, and what men ought to
 do.
 The final Hebrew twelve now come to
 view.
 The first slot must remind of the last one
 Who began cycle of the twelve and won,
 Ali, to whom the prophet gave his hand
 And word that he should rule both folk and
 land.
 Beloved, I sing from the start to the end
 Of the twelve, Ishmaels sons came out to
 bend
 In all reality Your grace to lend.

Hosea 1

1 The word of YHWH *the word* that came
 To Hosea the son of Beerī,

In the days of Uzziah's *fame*,
 Jotham, Ahaz, *not to be weary*
 And Hezekiah, kings of Judah,
 In Jeroboam's days the son
 Of Joash, king of Israel *done*
Two centuries before the Buddha.

Can any man grasp words so old and made
 Centuries before abstract terms were laid
 To trouble human vision with the stayed
 Instead of glassy waters and the grade
 Of oil and grape juice that abides the corn?
 Can any man read these words without
 scorn?

I pray I can, Beloved, since they are found
 Within the book of revelation's sound,
 And spoken before kings and in the days
 When Your commandments were not in a
 haze,

But well remembered in the tribe and
 nation

That stayed near Sinai or in an elation
 Went migrant to the isle of Zanzibar,
 Or in the other way ten times as far.

2 YHWH began to speak by Hosea,
 And so YHWH said then to Hosea,
 "Go, take unto yourself a wife
 Of harlotry, children *for strife*
 Of harlotry, because the land
 Commits uncleanness every hand
 Away from YHWH." 3 And so he went
 And took Gomer the daughter sent
 Of Diblaim, and she conceived
 And bore him a son *undeceived*.
 4 Then YHWH said to him, "Call his name
 Jezreel, for soon I shall claim
 Vengeance upon the house of Jehu
 For bloodshed of Jezreel, he who
 Shall bring an end on Israel's house
 Whose kingdom *I shall surely drowse*.
 5 "It shall come to pass in that day
 That I will break Israel's bow's sway
 In the Valley of Jezreel."

6 And she conceived again as well
 Gave birth to a daughter. Then said
Alohim to him, "Call her head
 Lo-Ruhamah, for I'll have no
 More mercy upon Israel's show,
 But utterly take them away.

7 Yet on Judah I still shall show
 Mercy, and will save them by YHWH

Their God, and not save them by bow,
 Nor by sword or battle renew,
 By horses or horsemen *to go*."

The prophet fathers on a wife, a whore,
 A son and daughter, I've heard that before.
 There's hardly man alive whose mind is not
 A marriage of the good and the ill-taught,
 And that mind brings forth on the modern
 scene

Among the men called righteous an
 obscene

Pair of twins male and female on the street.
 The boy is named for bloodshed on the feet
 Of those who live by the oppression sweet
 That banks provide upon the grimy treat
 Of poverty turned source of power's heat.
 The girl's a crone dolled up to look her best
 While eating up the east and pluming west.
 Beloved, give me no marriage of the mind,
 But let no self be known but You. I'm
 blind.

8 When she had weaned Lo-Ruhamah,
 She conceived and, *anathema*,
 Gave birth to a son. 9 Then he said,
 "Call his name Lo-Ammi *instead*,
 For you are not My people, and
 I will not be *at your command*.
 10 "Yet the number of Israel
 Shall be as sand by sea *and shell*,
 Not to be measured, numbered, and
 It shall come to pass in the land
 Where it was said to them, 'You're not
 My people,' *There* it shall be taught
 Them, 'Sons of living Alohim.'

11 "Then Judah's children and *the cream*
 Of Israel shall come together,
 And choose one head *led without tether*,
 Come up out of the land, for great
Shall be the day of Jezreel's fate!"

Let me have no part of a folk who chooses
 A head from among evil crowd that loses
 The approbation of Your judgement word.
 Let me have no part in what has occurred.
 The head of state I seek and find and know
 Is the one You appointed long ago,
 The one hidden behind the battle scenes
 To rule the secret of what this world means.
 And yet Jezreel swelters in the blood
 That covers the earth like a cursèd flood.

Beloved, why do the proper poor still wait
In their oppression for another fate?
Let Your chosen one make some justice
here
For those who sit in silence and their fear.

Hosea 2

1 Say to your brothers, "My people,"
And to your sisters "*Mercy's full.*"
2 Bring charges against your mother,
Bring charges, she's not My wife, her
Husband I'll not *be!* Let her put
Her uncleanness away from foot,
Adulteries between her breasts,
3 Lest I strip her *despite protests*
Naked and expose her, as in
The day that she was born therein,
And make her like a wilderness,
And set her like a dry land's *fess*,
And slay her with thirst. 4 *But* I'll not
Have mercy on her children's *lot*,
For they *are* children of uncleanness.
5 For their mother has, *in her meanness*,
Played the harlot, she who conceived
Them has shamefully *unreprieved*
Behaved, for she said, "I will go
After my lovers, who *with show*
Give *me* my bread, my water, my
Wool, linen, oil, my drink *and dry.*"

You are, Beloved, the goal of all desire.
It's harlotry to turn from You to fire
Of any other passion: read my fate
In my desire to have no other mate.
In eye of every passer-by I see
The glimmer of Your divine symmetry.
Let me see no other but You in face
Of every being in this haunted place.
Let me not look for bread or water sure
In any but Your springs of water pure
And in Your baking ovens filled with
bread.
Let no charge be brought against my fair
head.
Beloved, I look to neither right nor left,
Nor seek to escape from Your rocky cleft.

6 "Therefore, indeed, I will hedge up
Your way with thorns, and wall her up,
So that she cannot find her paths.
7 "She will chase her lovers and baths,
Not overtake them, though she seek

Them, but not find. Then she will squeak,
'I will go and return to my
First husband, it was a far cry
And better then for me than now.'
8 "For she did not know anyhow
That I gave her grain, new grape juice,
And oil, and multiplied for use
Her silver and her gold, *which* they
Prepared for *worship in Baal's way*.
9 "Therefore I will return and take
Away My grain in its time's wake
And My new grape juice in its season,
And will take back My wool *with reason*
My linen for her nudity.
10 "Now I will uncover her lewdness
In the sight of her lovers' *shrewdness*,
And no one shall deliver her
From My hand *and what will occur*.
11 "I will also cause all her mirth
To cease, her feasts *from off the earth*,
Her first days of the months, and all
Her Sabbaths, appointed feasts' *call*.
12 "And I will destroy her vines and
Her fig trees *from upon her land*,
Of which she has said, 'These *are* my
Wages that my lovers give and buy.'
So I will make them a forest,
And the beasts of the field shall *rest*
And eat them. 13 I will punish her
For days of Baals to which *aver*
She burned incense. She decked her out
With her earrings and jewellery *stout*,
And went after her lovers, but
Me" answers YHWH, "she has forgot."

Though rain seem to come from the sun on
cloud
And taken from the ocean's cloak and
shroud,
Distilled upon the fields and hills by means
That appear natural and follow scenes
Of regularity on lake and sea,
I know my draught of drink eternally
Comes from Your hand, Beloved, I see the
fee.
Through bread comes from the earth on
stalk of grain
Well chosen for its size and value's gain,
And ground by human hand and set to bake
Within the ovens for the seller's sake,
I know my crumb comes ever from Your
hand,

Beloved, and nothing grows upon the land
But from your heartbeat and Your eye full
scanned.

14 “Therefore, indeed, I will allure her,
Will bring into the wilderness,
And speak comfort and to assure her.
15 “I’ll give her her vineyards from there,
And the Valley of Achor where
She has a door of hope, she’ll sing
There as in days when she took wing,
As in the day when she came out
From the land of Egypt *with shout*.
16 “And it shall be, in that day,” says
YHWH, “*That you’ll call Me (wearing fez)*
‘My Husband,’ And no longer just
‘My Master,’ *with head in the dust*.
17 “For I’ll take from her mouth the names
Of the Baals, and names of such shames
On them shall be no more remembered.
18 In that day I will make a membered
Pact for them with the beasts of field,
With birds of air, and *with concealed*
The creeping things upon the ground.
Both bow and battle sword I’m bound
I’ll shatter from the earth to make
Them lie down safely. 19 “I will take
You betrothed to Me always, yes,
I’ll betroth you to My caress
In righteousness and justice, in
Loving-kindness and genuine
Mercy, 20 I’ll betroth you to Me
In faithfulness, and faithfully
You shall know YHWH. 21 “And it shall
be
That day I will answer,” says YHWH,
“I will answer the heavens, and they
Shall answer the earth *in their way*.
22 “The earth shall answer then with grain,
With new grape juice, with oil *again*,
They shall answer Jezreel *in gain*.
23 “Then I will sow her for My own
In the earth, and I will have mercy
On *her who had not obtained mercy*,
Then I will say to *those who were*
Not My people *nor to prefer*,
‘You are My people!’ And they’ll say
‘You are my God both night and day!’”

More than my Master my Beloved You are
Though every day my feet may wander far

From knowing that Your presence lies with
me.

You are by me whether or not I see.
Let no names of false gods come on my
tongue,
Not self nor silver, nor the tempting rung
Ambition lays before the youngest son.
I walk and sleep, I may awake and run,
But You are always there as sure as I
Know my own self beneath the by and by.
You are, Beloved, my God both night and
day
As I go stumbling on the nether way
Beneath the vineyard shades by door of
hope,
I run and wheel, or then I stop and grope.

Hosea 3

1 Then YHWH said to me, “Go again,
To love a woman *who is vain*,
Loved by one in adultery,
Just like the love of YHWH for those
Children of Israel, who chose
To look to other gods and love
The raisin cakes of pagan shove.”
2 So I bought her for myself for
Fifteen of silver, what is more,
One and one-half measures of grain
Of barley, 3 and told her again,
“You shall stay with me many days,
You’ll not go in adulterous ways,
Nor shall you have a man. So too
Will I surely be toward you.”
4 For the children of Israel shall
Abide for days like prodigal
Without king or prince, sacrifice
Or sacred pillar to entice,
Without ephod or teraphim.
5 Afterward Israel’s folk grown dim
Shall turn and seek YHWH their God and
David their king, and understand
To fear YHWH and His goodness till
The latter days come to fulfil.

I had a classmate once who chose
To frequent prostitutes and those
Became his friends and at last he
Married one of those girls of glee,
And as it turned out passing years
Saw more in joy than bitter tears.
One never knows who will become
The best of people, so in sum,

It's no use judging one and all
 By prejudices from the fall.
 I only state here with loud voice
 The witness preachers give of choice
 Salvation from devious dames,
 Drink and drugs moves me to shames'
 blames.

In times to come, I hope and I believe
 That this old world shall come to have
 reprieve,
 And Israel will seek after You alone
 And after David the king on the throne
 In resurrection for ever and aye
 Beneath eternal and untroubled sky.
 I worship You alone, Beloved, and take
 For King alone David and for Your sake.
 I wonder that the many prophecies
 That speak of David's return on the breeze
 Are ignored by both Jew and Muslim and
 By Christian in a sordid sort of band.
 If I alone remember Your anointed,
 I shall still come before divine appointed.

Hosea 4

1 Hear the word of YHWH, You children
 Of Israel, YHWH *brings* commission
 Against the dwellers in the land:
 "There is no truth or mercy grand,
 Alohims knowledge in the land.
 2 "By swearing, lying, killing and
 Stealing, committing adultery,
 They break all restraint *and go free*
 With bloodshed upon bloodshed *call*.
 3 "Therefore the land will mourn, and all
 Who dwell therein will waste away
 With the beasts of the field *and prey*
 And the birds of the air, the fish
 Of the sea disappear with swish.
 4 "Now let no man contend, rebuke
 Another, for your people *spook*
 Like those who contend with the priest.
 5 "Therefore you shall stumble at least
 In the day, the prophet shall stumble
 Also with you at night *and grumble*,
 And I will make your mother humble.

Destruction of the earth is evident
 Result of unrestraint upon those meant
 To guard and keep the ground well from
 the start.
 Destruction of the earth begins with heart

That thinks to lie and kill is a small thing
 And stealing and adultery will bring
 But wealth and pleasure to the bold man's
 ring.

But such do not stop there, they have in
 mind

The right to rape the earth as well in kind
 Until the beast of field without a home
 Mourns with the land and bird and fish to
 comb

The earth and sea for tranquil place and fair
 Where no poisons pollute water and air.
 Beloved, I turn and find that You're still
 there.

The word of prophecy that prophets come
 To stumble on the land and law in sum
 Does not I trow refer to those men but
 To those who claim to follow them in glut.
 Both fair Muhammad and Jesus the humble
 Remained in faith, nor did either one
 stumble,

But kept Your Decalogue through stick and
 sin.

Their followers put on a different grin,
 And claim they gave permission to go out
 And work and play on Sabbath with a
 shout.

In followers alone the prophets fail,
 Not in their own hands set to spade and
 pail.

But though both Jesus and Muhammad fall,
 I shall remain true to You and Your call.

6 "My people are destroyed for lack
 Of knowledge, because you are slack
 To accept knowledge, I'll also
 Be slack to accept you to go
 As priest for Me, and because you
 Forget your God's law, so I do
 Forget your children. 7 "And the more
 They increased, also sinned the more
 Against Me, I'll change their
 Glory to shame. 8 "They eat *in air*
 The sin of My people, they set
 Their heart on their iniquity.

9 "Like people, like priest it shall be.
 So I will punish them, you bet,
 For their ways, and reward them for
 Their deeds. 10 "For they shall eat the
 more,

But not be filled, they shall commit

Their harlotry, but not be fit
To beget or conceive because
They've stopped obeying their YHWH's
laws.

11 "Harlotry, wine, and new grape juice
Enslave the heart *for their abuse*.

The Rabbis contend all the world should
well

Obeys the Noahide laws Israel
Has determined are great for one and all.
That's because lack of knowledge hit the
wall

And they forgot the ten commandments are
Your law for all and not just for the star.
And so You reject them as priestly race
To all the world until they come to face
Their role is to preserve the law, not to
invent rabbinical statutes in crew.
They would steal from the world the
Sabbath rest

That belongs to the beast and all confessed
Created with rights not to take away:
They would deprive of justice in one day.

12 "My people ask counsel from their
Wood, and their staff informs the air,
A shameful idol, for the spirit
Of harlotry's caused to stray near it,
And they've played the harlot against
Their God. 13 "They offer on the *fenced*
Mountaintops sacrifices, burn
Incense upon the hills, beneath
Oaks, poplars, terebinths *in sheath*,
Because their shade *is* good. Therefore
Your daughters commit harlotry,
Your brides adultery and more.
14 "I'll not punish your daughters when
They commit harlotry *with men*,
Nor your brides for adultery,
For *the men* themselves go out free
With harlots, offer sacrifice
With a ritual harlot's *vice*.
Therefore *who* do not understand
Will be trampled *upon the land*.

Is this Your way of dealing with men now,
Beloved? I think it shows a lack somehow.
You hold folk guilty only when they do
A sin that's rare among the motley crew.
But when the thing is rampant, then you
say

There is no wrong since all men act that
way.

That's the excuse I hear from childish lips
That say because the neighbour boy too
sips

The liquor it cannot be wrong for me.
Your prophet's words foster eternally
The excuse of the damned that the whole
sea

Of hell is sure of virtue's trinity
In seeking love in their adultery.
Beloved, let me turn from such heathen
rips.

15 Though you, Israel, play the harlot,
Let not Judah offend *and plot*.

Do not come up to Gilgal, nor
Go up to Beth Aven, what's more,
Nor swear an oath, "And as YHWH lives"

16 For Israel is as stubborn gives,
Like headstrong calf, now YHWH will let
Them forage like a lamb and set
In open country. 17 Ephraim's joined
To idols, let him be purloined.

18 Their drink is *their* rebellion, they
Commit harlotry every day.

Her rulers dearly love dishonour.

19 The wind has brashly blown upon her,
And they shall *greatly* be ashamed
For sacrifices that they named.

Let every Christian and establishment
Of Christian faith listen and now relent.
Shame, shame for taking sacrifice of man
Upon a wooden stake for righteous ban!
The prophecy is that they shall have shame
For sacrifices that should have no name
Among mankind, and yet the rebel call
Is still sounded in every churchly hall
That human sacrifice relieves of guilt,
No matter what a man has done or spilt.
Shame, shame upon such ghastly word and
aim!

Repentance only can find release from
Guilt, and Your grace alone the lofty claim,
Though every thief must give back stolen
sum.

Hosea 5

1 "Hear this, O priests! Take heed, O house
Of Israel! Give ear *like grouse*,
O house of the king! For judgement

Is yours *and is upon you sent*
 Since you to Mizpeh were a snare
 And on Tabor a net spread there.
 2 "Revoltors are deeply involved
 In slaughter, though I've not absolved.
 3 "I know Ephraim, and Israel's not
 Hidden from Me, for now the plot,
 O Ephraim, is you commit *wild*
 Harlotry, and Israel's defiled.
 4 They don't direct their deeds toward
 Turning to their God, *but to sword*,
 For the spirit of harlotry
 Is in their midst *abundantly*.
 And they do not know YHWH *at all*.
 5 The pride of Israel *in his fall*
 Testifies to his face, therefore
 Israel and Ephraim stumble more
 In their iniquity, Judah
 Also stumbles with them *at law*.
 6 With their flocks and herds they shall go
 To seek YHWH, but they'll be slow
 And not find *Him*, He has withdrawn
 Himself from them *and from their spawn*.
 7 They have dealt treacherously with
 YHWH,
 For they've begotten heathen crew.
 Now a new one shall eat them up,
 Their heritage, *both plate and cup*.

The lovely and the true of long ago
 Were priests that did their work to beat the
 show.
 The very priests of Israel and the chosen
 Were instrumental in the cold and frozen.
 They led the people to idolatry
 And taught them to pray to the Trinity
 Of El and Ashtoreth and Baal and claimed
 It was the civilized way and unblamed.
 If it was so that those You chose Yourself
 Behaved like craven robbers and like elf,
 Then what of the priests in the church
 today
 Who lead the people everywhere astray?
 Not one in one thousand is fit to feed
 Upon Your word, Beloved, with heathen
 creed.

8 "Blow the ram's horn in Gibeah,
 The trumpet also in Ramah!
 Cry loud *at* Beth Aven, 'Behind
 You, Benjamin!' 9 "Ephraim shall be
 Desolate in day of rebuke,

Among Israel's tribes *as a fluke*
 I make known what is sure *as duke*.
 10 "The princes of Judah are like
 Those who remove a landmark *spike*,
 I will pour out my wrath on them
 Like water, *let them haw and hem*.
 11 "Ephraim is oppressed *and* broken
 In judgment, since he had a yen
 To walk by *human* precept *then*.
 12 "Therefore I *will* to Ephraim
 Be like a moth, and to the *prim*
 House of Judah like rottenness.
 13 "When Ephraim saw his sickness,
 And Judah *saw* his wound's *undress*,
 Ephraim turned to Assyria
 And sent to King Jareb *in awe*,
 Yet he cannot cure you, nor heal
 You of your wound *and how you feel*.
 14 "For I *will be* like lion to
 Ephraim, and like young lions to
 The house of Judah. I, *just* I,
 Will tear *them* and go passing by,
 I will take *them* away, and no
 One shall rescue *them from my go*.
 15 "I will return again to My
 Place till they confess their offence.
 Then they will seek My face *foreby*,
 In their affliction they'll have sense
 Earnestly to seek *recompense*. "

If You tore Israel from her promised shelf
 In ancient times and came down there
 Yourself
 To see the evil they had done, I guess
 No others can stand just at Your address.
 These were the cream of humankind who
 lay
 Their foreheads down in idol harlot's way.
 The best of all were never good enough:
 They added to Your law civilized scuff,
 Pretending that the scientific creed
 Was just an explanation in the need
 Of those who were above the desert law
 Good only for the primitive in claw.
 They thought the slaves from Egypt needed
 such,
 While the sophisticated had their touch.

Hosea 6

1 Come, and let us return to YHWH,
 For He has torn, but He will do
 Us healing, He has stricken, but

He will bind us up, *our wounds shut*.
 2 After two days He will revive
 Us, on third day He'll make alive,
 That we may thus live in His sight.
 3 Let's know, let's pursue knowledge of
 YHWH, His going forth is *in love*
 Established as the morning *main*,
 He will come to us like the rain,
 Like late *and* early rain to earth
To heal the dry and parching dearth.

Indeed You are ready to health the torn
 As soon as they repent from the hell-born.
 You even cast a gracious eye upon
 The white-clad Celt and Indian at the dawn.
 Beloved, each day it seems that I return
 Rekindling fires of love that cease to burn
 At the cold dawn before the pearly sky
 Is lit with fires of day awakened by.
 The third day is the resurrection nigh
 After the mid-week turning to the wry
 Where all the stars rejoice to see You fly.
 Beloved, the morning comes with gentle
 rain
 To heal the burdened heart and spirit's
 pain.
 The whirling stops at last, but You remain.

4 "Ephraim, what shall I do to you?
 Judah, what shall I do to you?
 Your faithfulness like morning cloud,
 And like the early dew in shroud
 It goes away. 5 "Therefore I've hewn
Them by the prophets, I have *soon*
 Slain them by the words of My mouth,
 And your judgments, light *from the south*.
 6 "For I desire mercy and not
 Sacrifice, and the knowledge taught
 Of Alohim more than burnt offerings.
 7 "But like men they transgressed in
 profferings
 Against the covenant, there they
 Dealt treacherously *in the way*
 With Me. 8 "Gilead *is* a town
 Of evildoers, *and made brown*
 Defiled with blood. 9 "As bands of thieves
 Lie in wait for a man *that grieves*,
 So the band of priests murder on
 The way to Shechem, *and at dawn*
 Surely they commit lewdness *drawn*.
 10 "I have seen a horrible thing
 In the house of Israel's *king*:

There was Ephraim's harlotry,
 Israel defiled *by every tree*.
 11 "Also, O Judah, harvest's set
 Against you, when I turn to get
 The captives of My people yet."

My faithfulness goes not like morning mist
 After a day and night within the list
 Of just and righteous men. No, I have
 kissed
 My breath with fire and felt the cold renew
 As soon as I breathed out. There is no dew.
 The faithfulness of Ephraim's for a day,
 But I, Beloved, am only breath away
 From turning to the death instead of life.
 My faithlessness arises without strife.
 Though Ephraim's steadfast through the
 day and night,
 I falter with each exhalation's blight.
 And yet, Beloved, You breathe again in me
 The breath of faith each time I draw it free.
 From breath to breath I enter faithlessness
 And at the same time turn to Your address
 And find You never weary at the guess.

Hosea 7

1 "When I would have healed Israel,
 Then Ephraim's wickedness *as well*
 Was uncovered, the wickedness
 Samaria essayed to transgress
 In fraud, a thief has entered in,
 A band of thieves take spoil in sin.
 2 "They do not take the thing to heart
That I remember all their *part*
 In wickedness, now their own deeds
 Have surrounded them *in their weeds*,
 They are before My face *for creeds*.
 3 "They make a king glad with their sin
 And princes with their lies *and din*.
 4 "They're all adulterers, like an
 Oven heated by baker man
 He ceases stirring *fire* when done
 Kneading the dough *under the sun*,
 Until it is leavened to last."
 5 In the day of our king *not past*
 Princes have made *him* sick, inflamed
 With wine, he stretched out hand *unshamed*
 With scoffers. 6 They prepare their heart
 Like an oven, they lie in wait,
 Their baker sleeps all night to start,
 At dawn it burns like flames in grate.
 7 "They are all hot, like oven hot,

And have devoured their judges' *pot*,
All their kings fell, none of them calls
Upon Me *and My saving walls*."

Though I am really not much for the
pleasure
Adulterers find with the loins' heart
treasure,
Nor do I find the taste of wine a treat
To give me courage on the weekend beat,
Two out of three's enough, I'd think for
me,

So why should I not join in thievery?
A band of thieves might just be what I
need,
Since that is the way squirrels today are
treed.

A band of thieves runs every company
And every government by usury
And fast corruption seduces the best.
I too had top grades along with the rest,
I'm eminently corruptible guy,
But others get the cream. I sit and sigh.

8 "Ephraim has mixed himself among
The peoples, Ephraim's cake of dung.
9 "The aliens have devoured his strength,
But he does not know *it at length*,
Yes, grey hairs are here and there on
Him, yet he does not know *what's gone*.

10 "The pride of Israel testifies
Unto his face, but *in their lies*
They don't return to YHWH their God,
Nor seek Him for all this *as prod*.

11 "Ephraim also is like a dove,
Silly and without sense or love,
They call to Egypt, and they go
To Assyria *to make a show*.

12 "Wherever they go, I will spread
My net on them, *and as I've said*
I'll bring them down like birds in air,
I'll chastise them and by what their
Congregation has heard *to be*.

13 "Woe to them, for they've fled from
Me!

Destruction to them, since they have
Transgressed against Me! Though I have
Redeemed them, yet they've spoken lies
Against Me. 14 "They did not raise cries
Out to Me with their heart when they
Wailed there upon their beds *to pray*.
They come together for the grain

And the new grape juice, *then insane*
They rebel against Me, 15 "Though I
Disciplined *and* strengthened their arms,
Yet they devise evil foreby
Against Me, 16 "They return *from harms*,
But not to the Most High, they are
Like a treacherous bow *afar*.
Their princes shall fall by the sword
For cursings of their tongue's afford.
This *shall be* their derision in
The land of Egypt *for their sin*."

Whether the death of Christ's redemption
or

Mere tragedy upon the Roman shore,
I leave to You to guess, but all the more,
Those who believe such ought to take in
store

The message of this verse that here reveals
How after such redemption at the heels
The people still speak lies about Your
wheels.

Because of that redemption they believe
That You are three in one on Christmas
Eve.

That witness to Your number imprecise
And inconsistent with everything nice
Remains a lie and stain upon the church
As well as every Christian sort of perch.
No wonder such folk leave me in the lurch.

Beloved, like Ephraim I flee from You
In fear, in greed of my illusions view,
In hope of honour and the gain in pew.
Beloved, like Ephraim I flee Your nest
To follow paths in actions I think best,
The structure of the human mind in quest
My guide instead of Your word to be true.
Beloved, I flee from Your face till I find
In my flight refuge from the flaming rind.
I flee along the corridors of time
And hide myself in meters and in rhyme,
Look back over my shoulder in my flight
And run blind in Your bosom of delight
Before I know to swerve away in night.

Hosea 8

1 "Lift up the trumpet now to sound!
He shall come like an eagle found
Against the house of YHWH, because
They've transgressed covenant and laws.
2 "Israel will cry to Me, 'My God,

We know You!’ 3 “Israel *from the sod*
 Has rejected the good, and so
 He is pursued by *every* foe.
 4 “They set up kings, but not by Me,
 They made princes, but futilely.
 From their silver and gold they made
 Them idols, ones that have not stayed.
 5 “Samaria! See how your calf
 Is rejected! On their behalf
 My anger is aroused. How long
 Until they find innocent song?
 6 “For from Israel *is* even this:
 A workman made it *in artifice*,
 And it *is* not a god at all,
 But the calf of Samaria’s *fall*
 Is broken in a heap of pieces.
 7 “They sow the wind, and it increases
 To whirlwind when they come to reaping.
 The stalk does not a bud reveal,
 It never shall produce a meal.
 If it should bring forth *in a cup*,
 Strangers would come to swallow up.

The golden calf has always been in sight
 Since the Egyptians taught it the sunlight
 Is glory of divinity to wear
 About the head of ox in sterling glare.
 The idol of the rich and wise I find
 Is still the focus of seeing and blind,
 The way that seems the only way to go
 As I whirl in my thoughts of gilded glow.
 Beloved, the broken stalk shakes in the
 wind
 With none to notice it because we’ve
 sinned
 In thinking that the human mind alone
 Suffices to set up the divine throne,
 Is great enough to define god and tree,
 Wise enough to limit reality.

8 “Israel is swallowed up, now they
 Are going in the Gentiles’ way
 Like vessel in which *is* no pleasure.
 9 “For they have gone up *from their*
treasure
 To the Assyrian, *Like* wild ass
 Alone and stubborn, Ephraim has
 Hired lovers. 10 “Yes, though they have
 hired
 Among the nations, now I’ve desired
 To gather them, and they shall sorrow
 A little, because of the *borrow*,

The burden of the king of princes.
 11 “Because Ephraim has *without winces*
 Made many altars for sin offering,
 They’ve become altars for sin proffering.
 12 I’ve written for him the great things
 Of My law, they thought them strange
 things.
 13 “*For* sacrifices of My offerings
 They slay flesh and eat, *but for scofferings*
 YHWH does not accept them. Now He
 Will remember iniquity
 And punish their sins. They’ll return
 To Egypt. 14 “For Israel will spurn
 Forgetting his Maker, and build
 Temples, Judah also has filled
 The land with cities fortified,
 But I’ll send fire upon his pride
 Of cities, and it shall devour
 His palaces *within the hour*.”

Send fire upon my pride, Beloved, and I
 Shall burn with sacrifices in the sty.
 The Canaanitic myth of Trinity
 Reflects the gross Egyptical Unity,
 And I forget my Maker in turmoil
 Of getting wealth and health from faded
 soil.
 Send fire upon my pride, Beloved, and yet
 Send fire unquenchable that in love’s bet
 Burns on from breath to breath eternally,
 Beyond the crumbling of desire and sea.
 The roiling waves still hiss upon the flame
 Of lava rolling on the tumbled main,
 Until the hardened mass comes to my
 claim,
 And my feet trample pumice in the rain.

Hosea 9

1 Do not rejoice, O Israel,
 With joy like *other* peoples tell,
 For you have played the harlot and
 Against your God lifted you hand.
 You have made love *for* hire upon
 Each threshing floor *before the dawn*.
 2 The threshing floor and the winepress
 Shall not feed them *in their distress*,
 And the new grape juice shall fail her.
 3 They shall not live in YHWH’s confer,
 But Ephraim to Egypt returns,
 To eat unclean *another spurns*
 In Assyria. 4 They shall not offer

Grape juice *offerings* to YHWH, nor
 proffer
 Their sacrifices pleasing Him.
 Like bread of mourners *at the rim*,
 All who eat it shall be defiled.
 For their bread *shall irreconciled*
Be for their *own* life, it shall not
 Come into YHWH's house *and be got*.
 5 What will you do in day appointed,
 And in the feast day YHWH's *anointed*?
 6 For indeed they are gone because
 Of destruction. Egyptian *claws*
 Shall gather them up, Memphis shall
 Bury them, nettles' *arsenal*
 Shall take their silver treasures, thorns
Shall be in their tents *without bourns*.

The foxes tell me that the mountain ash
 With berries high upon the branch to stash
 Is not as good as grapes to tongue and
 teeth,
 But I am living on a barren heath.
 The foxes say the berries there are sour,
 But since my cherries nourish not an hour,
 I join the jays to taste the flaming crash
 Of mountain ash fruit through the bitter
 bower.
 Beloved, though I know foxes have a way
 Denying the reality in sway,
 I cannot gather grapes from fir and birch,
 And without mountain ash, I'm left in
 lurch.
 And so I wait the coming of the tune
 Of mountain ash under the autumn noon.

7 The days of punishment have come,
 The days of recompense have come.
 Israel knows! The prophet's a fool,
 The spiritual's an insane *tool*,
 Because of your iniquity
 And greatness of your enmity.
 8 The watchman of Ephraim's with God,
 But the prophet's a fowler's *prod*,
 A snare in every way and dream,
 Hate in house of his Alohim.
 9 They are deeply corrupted, as
 In the days of Gibeah's *razz*.
 He'll remember iniquity,
 He'll punish their sins, *wait and see*.
 10 "I found Israel like desert grapes,
 I saw your fathers as *escapes*
 The first fruits on the fig tree in

Its first season. They went to sin
 In Baal Peor, and separated
 Themselves *to* shame, *idol created*,
 They became an abomination
 Like the thing they loved *with elation*.

With din of rock called music and the store
 Of idols given Your name when the noise
 tore
 Obedience from the heart and hand, the
 folk
 Sank into civilized expedience' stroke.
 The whoredom of false worship is
 acclaimed
 In every place that people are enflamed
 With appetite for titillating pence,
 Enthusiasm for new age of sense.
 Beloved, I turn to fond simplicity
 Of ten-step dance beneath eternity,
 And as I whirl the heathen gods appear
 No longer on horizons to my fear.
 Let me be like the thing I love in You,
 The Decalogue with all but sombre crew.

11 "*As for* Ephraim, their glory flies
 Away like a bird, no replies
 To birth, pregnancy, nor conceiving.
 12 "Though they bring up children
deceiving,

Yet I'll bereave them to the last.
 Yes, woe to them when I go past
 Away from them! 13 "Just as I saw
 Ephraim like Tyre, planted *like straw*
 In pleasant places, so Ephraim
 Will bring his children back to him
 Who murders." 14 Give them, O YHWH,
 what

Will You give them? A womb that's shut
 Give them and dry breasts! 15 "All their sin
Is in Gilgal, to their chagrin
 I hated them there, because their
 Deeds are evil I'll drive them where
 My house is not, love them no more.
 All their rebellious princes *score*.
 16 "Ephraim is stricken, root dried up,
 They shall bear no fruit *to the cup*.
 Yes, were they to bear children, I
 Would kill the darlings where they lie."
 17 My God will cast them *all* away,
 Because they did not Him obey,
 And they'll go to wander among
 The nations *and remain unsung*.

A place where Your house is not is a place
Most difficult to find. Before Your face
All things exist that exist on the vine
Of universe reflected in design.
There is no place without Your house, and
yet

The temple of the sky above pines set
Is empty to my sight, and in my view
There is a nothing pacing and not You.
Wherever I may be upon the dress
Of the terrestrial hopeful and its guess,
Your house is with me as soon as I lay
The cantillation of Your word in sway,
And You are sitting in my heart enthroned
Beneath the lovely words once more
intoned.

Hosea 10

1 Israel empties *his* vine, he brings
Forth fruit for himself *as he sings*.
According to the multitude
Of his fruit he's increased the rude
Altars, according to the bounty
Of his land *and in every county*
They've decorated sacred pillars
Of Ashtoreth as heathen fillers.
2 Their heart's divided, now they are
Held guilty, He'll break down altar,
And He will ruin their sacred pillars.
3 For now they say, "We have no *killers*
For kings, because we did not fear
YHWH. And if a king should appear,
What would he do for us?" 4 They've
spoken

Words, swearing making a false token
Of covenant. So judgement springs
Up like hemlock in furrow rings
Of the field. 5 The inhabitants
Of Samaria fear askance
Because of the calf of Beth Aven.
For its people mourn at its haven,
And its priests shriek for it *and wail*
For its departed glory's tale.
6 *The idol* also shall be carried
To Assyria, a present *ferried*
For King Jareb. Ephraim shall get
Shame, and Israel with shame beset
In his own counsel. 7 *As for that*
Samaria, her king has sat
Cut off like twig on serpentine.
8 Also the high places of Aven,

The sin of Israel, shall be broken.
The thorn and thistle *as a token*
Shall grow on their altars, they'll say
To the mountains, "Hide us away!"
And to the hills, "Fall on our *way!*"

The land fails where the wicked king will
rule,
But when democracy comes out of school
The vague hope that a righteous king may
rise

Goes up in smoke before empty disguise.
The folk who claims not to have any king,
But reigns over itself in oppressing
Minorities impoverished for good,
Is floating in the ditch into the wood.
Beloved, the sins of Israel that stoke
The thorn and thistle and then goes for
broke

Result in crying to the mountains' gale
And hills to hide them from the hopeless
wail.

The story is repeated where the sound
Of democratic fallacy is found.

9 "O Israel, you have sinned from days
Of Gibeah, stood in the ways.
The battle in Gibeah opposing
The children of evil enclosing
Did not overtake them *bull-doing*.
10 When *it's* My desire, I will chasten,
Folks shall be gathered and to hasten
Against them when I bind them for
Their two transgressions *if not more*.
11 Ephraim *is* a trained heifer that
Loves to thresh *corn*, but *where she sat*
I harnessed her fair neck, I'll make
Ephraim pull a *plough for My sake*.
Judah shall plough, Jacob shall break
His clods." 12 Sow for yourselves right
doing,

Reap mercy, break your fallow stewing,
For *it is* time to seek YHWH, till
He comes and rains right doing's fill
Upon you. 13 You have ploughed in sin,
You've reaped iniquity *in bin*.
You've eaten the fruit of your lies,
Because you trusted in your wise,
In multitude of mighty men.
14 Therefore tumult shall rise again
Among your people, all your forts
Are plundered as Shalman's cohorts

Plundered Beth Arbel in the day
Of battle, a mother astray
Who dashed in pieces *her* offspring.
15 So it shall be done you a thing,
O Bethel, because of your sin
So great. At dawn now Israel's king
Shall utterly be well done in.

The Middle Eastern way of war for spite
Is to crush infants' heads in lark of night.
Each culture has its own in recompense,
And every people shows their lack of
sense.

The reaping of iniquity is not
A punishment though prophet in his plot
Thinks so, or else You Yourself. I unseat
The fair illusion: punishment's a treat
For those who caused catastrophe in wares
And in the human lives caught in despair.
Beloved, You might as well be bound to
plough

Yourself as trust in Ephraim for now,
And in the mark that Judah scratches well
In name of all the house of Israel.

Hosea 11

1 "When Israel *was* a child, I loved
Him, and out of Egypt unloved
I called him as My son. 2 *As* they
Called them, so they went from their way,
They sacrificed to Baals, and burned
Incense to carved images *spurned*.
3 "I taught Ephraim to walk, taking
Them by the hand, but *ignoring*
They did not know that I healed them.
4 I drew them with gentle cords' hem,
With bands of love, I was to them
As those who take the yoke from their
Neck. I stooped *and* fed them *with care*.
5 "He shall not return to the land
Of Egypt, but the Assyrian's hand
Shall be his ruler, because they
Refused to repent *from their way*.
6 And the sword shall slash in his cities,
Devour his districts *without pities*,
And consume *them*, because of their
Own counsels. 7 My people are fair
Bent on backsliding from Me. Though
They call to the Most High *for show*,
None at all exalt *Him also*.

Beloved, you make the wrong appeal to
men.

The bands of love may be thrown out again
And once again, but never catch or lure
The hearts of the busy and the impure.
You feed with care indeed, but human teeth
Were made to snap at the hand with the
wreath,

And what the forest answers when You call
Is never the true echo of Your bawl,
But howling of the law of jungle's thrall.
That You placed conscience on unholy
plane

Of vermin is the true sin in the main,
As well as creation's most valued gain.
Repent or not, Beloved, You fit the bill,
You pay the cost of everything You till.

8 "How can I give you up, Ephraim?

How can I hand you off the rim,
O Israel? How can I make you
Like Admah? *How* can I set you
Like Zeboiim? My heart churns in
Me, My sympathy's stirred within.

9 I will not execute the fire
Of My wrath, I do not desire
Again to destroy Ephraim.
For *I'm indeed* God, Alohim,
And not a man, the Holy One
Among you, and I will not run
To you with terror. 10 "They shall walk
After YHWH, and He'll roar *and stalk*
Just like a lion. When He roars,
Then *His* sons shall come *on all fours*
And trembling from the west, 11 They'll
come

Trembling like Egyptian bird's hum,
Like a dove from Assyrian land.
And I will let them live in band
In their houses," Says YHWH *and cries*.
12 "Ephraim's encircled Me with lies,
The house of Israel with deceit,
But Judah still walks *on his feet*
With Alohim, even with One
Holy and faithful *when all's done*.

Like every teen-age girl that drops her skirt
To the boys in her class and to her hurt,
You now complain that love will not let go,
Despite the awful things Your lovers show.
Of course the girl may not have in her
power

To blast her own seducers from the tower
 As You have over humankind in store,
 And yet I do not see You doing more
 To punish guilty people for their score.
 It's more often the innocent will die
 Under the retribution of the sky,
 What with quaint faith the atheists embark
 To call an act of God done in the dark.
 The rest keep putting fingers in the pie.

Hosea 12

1 "Ephraim feeds on the wind, pursues
 The east wind, he daily imbues
His life with lies and desolation.
 Also they make a pact with nation
 Of the Assyrians, and with oil
 Carried to Egypt *for their spoil*.
 2 "YHWH also *brings* a charge of treason
 Against Judah, and for his reason
 Will punish Jacob by his deeds,
 He'll recompense him *as He needs*.
 3 He took his brother by the heel
 In the womb, and his strength to feel
 He struggled with a great one too,
 4 Yes, struggled with the Angel and
 Prevailed, he wept, and sought *at hand*
 His favour. In Bethel he found
 Him, and there He spoke to us *sound*,
 5 That is, YHWH God of hosts to be
 YHWH *as His name eternally*
Shall be service of memory.
 6 So you, by your God, now return,
 Observe mercy and *do not spurn*
 Justice, and wait always on God
Who blesses your way on the sod.

You are like all the world the way You
 blame
 The weak for what they do as though in
 shame.
 If Jacob before birth took hold of heel
 Of brother for his woe and for his weal,
 Is it just to pronounce on him the weight
 Of evil sentence for eternal fate?
 He's always blamed he took the heel in
 hand.
 For Christ's sake he was just a babe
 uncanned!
 Irrational of accusation rises
 To levels that never cease in surprises.
 I too stand oft accused, not for the true
 Guilt I may have for evil things I do,

Nor even for the good that I implore,
 But for some faith ridiculous in store.

7 "A cunning Canaanite! False scales
Are in his hand, and his hand fails
 Not to oppress. 8 "And Ephraim said,
 'Surely I've become rich, *well fed*,
 I have found wealth for myself, *in*
 All my labours and without sin.'
 9 "But I *am* YHWH your God, since when
 You left the land of Egypt then,
 I'll make you live again in tents,
 As in appointed feast day's *sense*.
 10 "I also spoke by every prophet,

And gave *you* visions *not to scoff at*,
 I've given symbols through the word
 Of witness that the prophets *stirred*."
 11 Though Gilead *has* idols, surely
His idols are all vanity,
 Although they sacrifice bulls in
 Gilgal, indeed their altars' *sin*
Shall be heaps in the field's furrows.
 12 Jacob fled to *where the wind blows*
In Syrian land, served for a wife,
 And for a spouse kept *the sheep's life*.
 13 By *hand of* prophet YHWH brought out
 Israel from Egypt *and from doubt*,
 And by prophet he was preserved.
 14 Ephraim provoked *Him undeserved*
 To bitter anger, therefore his
 Lord will leave the guilt *where it is*,
 His bloodshed upon him, return
 His reproach upon him *to spurn*.

The argument that idols cannot feed
 Those who worship their stumps and come
 in greed
 Is just not true. I see around the mess
 Of degradation in the world's address
 That many who deny Your name and
 power,
 Or use them and abuse them in their hour,
 Applying Your name to the idol rust
 That rises from the criminal caught dust
 Live here to prosper above all the gain
 Of those who keep Your law without a
 stain.

So I am glad Hosea came to bring
 Another argument against the ring
 Of foul idolatry, and that is just
 Fidelity to the first wife's a must.

Hosea 13

1 When Ephraim spoke, trembling, he was
Exalted in Israel for cause,
But when he offended through Baal,
He died. 2 Now their sins more prevail,
And they have made them images
Moulded, idols where silver is,
According to their *ill-met* skill,
All of it's work of craftsmen *still*.
They say of them, "Let the men who
Sacrifice kiss the calves, *go to!*"
3 Therefore they'll be like morning cloud
And like early dew *in a crowd*
That pass away, like chaff blown off
From threshing floor and like smoke *cough*
From a chimney. 4 "Yet I *am* YHWH
Your God since the Egyptians spew
You out of the land, and so you
Shall know no gods but Me *are true*,
For *there's* no Saviour besides Me,
And none to come eternally.

It may be indeed that idolatry
Works for all humankind set on the spree
But not for those caught up in Your love's
web,
Retrieved from worldly waters' flow and
ebb.
The argument's that Ephraim in stow
Was prosperous when living in the glow
Of Decalogue, but when Baal took the
show
The people failed and fell beneath the
stroke.
Perhaps prosperity depends on folk.
Beloved, I am not born of Ephraim's oak,
Nor am I son of Judah in the pale.
But I take hold of Your law in the gale
And trust You only where I come to sail.
It may mean that I simply come to croak.

5 I knew you in the wilderness,
And in the land of great dryness.
6 When they had pasture, they were filled,
They were filled and their heart *unstilled*
Exalted, so they forgot Me.
7 "And therefore to them I shall be
Like a lion, a leopard by
The road I'll lurk, 8 and until I
Will meet them like a bear deprived,
I'll tear open their breast *who strived*,

And there I will devour them like
A lion, wild beast to tear and strike.

The fatal jealousy of husband comes
Upon the wayward wife like lion's hums
And claws of bear that open up the breast
To see if anything will bear the test.
Today the way of pay is rather short:
Fall in love, muck about and then abort.
It may not be a good plan here for life,
But it at least relieves the soul of strife.
Just turn the back as soon as sound of fife
Calls to another love, or love turns rife.
Beloved, I cannot free myself from You
Despite the stories of the prophets true.
Wherever I may turn, the empty sky
And empty earth is filled with where You
fly.

9 "O Israel, you are destroyed,
But your help *is* from Me deployed.
10 "I'll be your King, where *is the one*
To save you in your cities done?
And your judges to whom you said,
'Give me a king and prince well-bred'?
11 "I gave you a king in My ire,
Took *him* away in My wrath's *fire*.
12 "Iniquity of Ephraim's bound,
His sin's stored up. 13 "The sorrows found
Of woman in childbirth shall come
Upon him, unwise son *and glum*,
For he should not remain long where
Children are born *to great and fair*.
14 "I'll ransom them from the grave's
power,
I will redeem them from death's *hour*.
O Death, I will be for your plagues!
O Grave, I will be your destruction!
Pity is hidden *in the dregs*
And from My eyes is its obstruction."
15 Though he is fruitful among brothers,
An east wind shall come, wind that
smothers,
The spirit of YHWH shall come from
The wilderness, then his spring *swum*
Shall become dry, and his fountain
Shall be dried up, and He again
Shall plunder the treasure of each
Instrument of Muhammad's *reach*.
16 Samaria's held guilty, for
She has rebelled against her *store*
In Alohim. So they shall fall

By the sword, and their infants all
Shall be dashed in pieces, and their
Women with child ripped open *bare*.

After the thirsty dryness of the air
That swept the folk of Israel from their
share
And saw them flee to Yemen and the care
Of Ethiopia beside the sea,
The full treasure appeared for all to see,
The Desired one, Muhammad by Your
hand,
Beloved, who promised treasures in the
sand.
Beyond the guilt, the flight, the warring
song
His bright words beam across the desert
strong
And bring hope to the once rebellious
throng,
Who find the precious message of peace
where
The sword is dropped, the rose has sprung
up there.
Your spirit, My Beloved, come from the
east
To open the dry fountains for the least.

Hosea 14

1 Israel, return to YHWH your God,
For you have stumbled as you plod
Because of your iniquity,
2 Take words with you, return to be
With YHWH. Say to Him, "Take away
All sin, receive *us* graciously,
For we will offer sacrifice
With our lips, *and not once or twice*.
3 "Assyria shall not save us, we
Will not ride on horses, nor be
Saying again to our hands' work,
'*You are our gods.*' *You do not shrink*,
For in You the orphan will find
Mercy *and love to heal and bind.* "

There was no need to offer sacrifice
Of animal or child in arm like vice
Of Baal filled with the fires to burn the
head
Of children agonized for molten led.
There was no need to offer up a god
Or man upon a cross above the sod.
There only is the need to turn around

And pray You take away our sins' abound,
And give You sacrifices of the lip,
The praises king David on our ship.
And yet it was in ire You gave a king,
Both Saul and even David on the wing.
It was in ire. But turn that ire to spring
And hear the Psalms that I have come to
sing.

4 "I will heal their backsliding, I
Will love them freely too, for My
Anger has turned away from him.
5 I'll be like the dew *of the rim*
To Israel, He shall grow up like
The lily, and stretch his roots ' *spike*
Like Lebanon. 6 His branches spread,
His beauty shall be *on his head*
Like olive tree, and his fragrance
Like Lebanon. 7 Those who *to dance*
Live under his shadow return,
They'll be revived grain *not to burn*
Nor like the chaff, but grow like vine,
Their scent like Lebanese *new wine*.

Backslidings I have had abundantly,
And even though I am not of the tree
Of Ephraim, still I have felt the lash
Of medicine to heal me from cold cash.
Backslidings of both feet and hand and
heart
Have been my plough in every sort of art,
And still I've found You coming with a
start
To heal my ways and doings from the
brash.
You are indeed like dew, Beloved, who
come
Without a word in silence for the drum
Of morning and as soon as sun is out
You disappear before the daytime shout.
I wait Your coming day to day as waits
The lily and the Lebanon at gates.

8 "Ephraim *shall say*, 'What have I now
To do with idols anyhow?'
I've heard and observed him, I'm like
A green cypress tree *by the pike*,
Your fruit *at last* is found in Me."
9 Who is wise? Let him these things see.
Who is prudent? Let him know them.
For the ways of YHWH's *stratagem*
Are right, the righteous walk in them,

But transgressors stumble in them.

Like Ephraim I lay my hand and heart
Aside from idols from both end and start.
And like the son of Joseph have my part
In saying I am like a cypress tree
That bears its pungent fruit, the gift of me.
Such trees do not produce apples or pears,
The lemon and the grapefruit and such
wares

Are not to be found on the cypress bough.
Instead inedible its berries bow.

The useless berries of my sonnets here
Are pungent when one bites them with a
tear,

But taste of sweet fruit is a thing not found
In all the cantillations in my sound.

Joel

The second prophet of twelve on the shelf
Is like Hasan who came to beat the elf
With fine diplomacy instead of war
And never one to settle angry score.
The book of Joel speaks of that great cloud
That fell upon the city and the crowd,
The horrible abomination's spell,
And how the northern king came in to quell
And then without a hand to help him fell.
The warning trumpet sounds the judgement
call

To bring the remnant into heavenly hall,
The secret place before Your ark and
throne

Where Your commandments glow on heart
and stone,

Where Your law stands in fragrance and
alone.

Joel 1

1 The word of YHWH that came to Joel
And he was the son of Pethuel.

2 Hear this, you elders, and give ear,
All you inhabitants appear
Upon the land! Has *anything*
Like this happened in *all* your spring,
Or even in your fathers' days?

3 Tell your children about *the ways*,
Let your children *tell* their offspring,
And theirs a generation more.

4 What caterpillars left goes in

The stomach of locusts *for sin*,
And what the locusts leave is eaten
By crawling locusts *still unbeaten*,
And what the crawling locusts leave
The cankerworms *at last* receive.
5 Wake up, old drunks and shed a tear,
And howl aloud, who wine revere,
Because the sweet wine is cut off
From your mouths *that have learned to*
scoff.

6 A nation's arrived in my land,
Strong and without number in band,
Whose teeth are like the lion's teeth,
With molars like young lions' *sheath*.

7 He's laid my vine waste, barked my fig,
He's made it wholly bare *of twig*,
And thrown it out, made branches white,
And destroyed everything in sight.

Beloved, I'd think that when the locusts
came

The folk would know how to avoid the
shame

By filling barn with locust carcass till
There was enough grasshopper meat to fill
The stomach of each one till they were ill.
I'd eat the locusts that ate up the grain
That had grown for me under sun and rain.
I'd fry them in the stubble left to eat
By the consumer of barley and wheat.
When You, Beloved, lay on the world a
shroud

Of punishment, there's silver on each
cloud,

And where Your hand destroys, You think
aloud

Of mercy on the sinful, wicked crowd.
You are too good to us, more than is meet.

Fair John too saw the locusts rise in swarm
From the abyss, and along the smoke warm
To fill the earth with hissing and the storm.
When Abdul Malik finally came in power
To cut down the town with his judgement
hour,

To build the caliphate upon the rock
Of holiness, it was a locust stock.

The Muslim hordes could have been
messengers

Of sweetness and of righteousness that
stirs,

They could have been, but were not, but
brought tears
To those who kept Your law within the
fears
Of prophets and divine guides. I still come
Into the temple with hands washed and
hum
My prayers beneath Al-Aqsa's marbled
piers.

8 Lament like a virgin in sack
Cloth mourning for young husband's back.
9 The meal offering, wine offering too,
Are cut off from the house of YHWH,
Mourn priests and ministers of YHWH.
10 The field is wasted, the land mourns,
The corn destroyed, the grape juice bourns
Are dried up, and the last oil scorns.
11 Be you ashamed, you farmer men,
And wail, you vineyard keepers then,
For wheat and barley, harvest lost
And out of every field *now tossed*.
12 The vine's dried up, the fig tree too,
The pomegranate tree knows no dew,
The palm also and apple tree,
All the trees in both field and lea
Are withered, because joy is gone
From the children of men *at dawn*.
13 Tighten your belts and cry, you priests,
Howl, altar servants, *like the beasts*,
Come lie the night in sackcloth dressed,
My God's servants *and self-confessed*,
Because the meal offering and drink
Offering is held off from *the brink*
Of the house of your Alohim,
And all of you are lost in scheme.

Today I'd say the farmer should not be
Ashamed of what he tried to do and see.
It's politicians and the marketplace
That have set noble farmer in disgrace.
Its economic laws of global range
That limit good prospects and foster
strange
Fire on the altar of the betting house.
It's humankind that's worse than nibbling
mouse.
In those days ancient when Joel preached,
the act
Of God or earth's disaster was the fact
That fated humankind to bite the dust.
But now it's spoilers of the sacred trust

Of the world bank who mouse and locust-
like
Eat all, but they're not edible like shrike.

14 Make a fast holy, call to pray,
Gather the elders and *the sway*
Of all the dwellers in the land
To the house of YHWH your God's *stand*,
And pray to YHWH *to lend a hand*.
15 Woe on the day! For YHWH's day's
near,
Devastation shall *soon* appear
From the Almighty *and for fear*.
16 Is not food wasted in our sight,
Joy and gladness from our God's right?
17 The seeds shrivel under their ploughs,
The garner destroyed and the *cows'*
Barns broken, for corn's under blight.
18 The very animals groan loud,
The herds of cattle *in a crowd*
Stand there perplexed, because they've got
No pasture, flocks of sheep *in lot*
Are desolate *before the plot*.
19 To You, O YHWH, I cry aloud,
The fire's consumed the pastures' shroud
Upon the wilderness, the flame
Burned all the trees in the fields' *claim*.
20 The beasts of the field cry to You
Also for the rivers of dew
Are dried up and the fire devoured
The desert pasture *and unshowered*.

The earth itself keeps Ramadhan to fast
From food and drink before the east wind's
blast.
The pastures rise before the blazing sun
To find the dry wind when the day is done.
The prophet may use the disastrous way
That nature sometimes takes from human
sway
To call the folk to Your repentance when
The immoral of town and country men
Forget that justice is a divine law.
They'd rather live by sabre, tooth and claw.
Beloved, though all about me is Your glow,
And everything I see is divine show,
It is my choice, not Yours, that I return
In faith to You when leaves of pasture
burn.

Joel 2

1 Blow the trumpet in the fortress,

And sound an alarm of *redress*
In My holy mountain! Let all
The dwellers in the land tremble,
For the day of YHWH is coming,
For it is at hand, *at the spring*.
2 A day of darkness, gloominess,
A day of clouds and thick darkness,
Like morning *clouds* spread on the hills.
A people, great and strong, *distils*
The like of whom has never been,
Nor will there ever be such *seen*
After their coming, even for
Many generations and more.

3 A fire devours before them, and
Behind them a flame burns, the land
Is like the Garden of the Lord,
As Eden before them, a *sword*
And wilderness behind them shows,
Surely nothing escapes *that goes*.
4 The likeness of them's like the way
That horses look and horsemen's sway,
And so like that they'll run away.
5 And like the sound of chariots
On mountaintops they'll jump *like shots*,
And like the noise of fiery flame
Devouring stubble, as the claim
Of a strong folk in battle aim.

When Omar's armies swept across the land
The prophecy fulfilled in all that planned
The flaming hordes, and yet You stood to
weep
That so soon Your own prophet's people
keep
The heathen power alive. No quicker sum
Of earth's apostasy had ever come.
While Ali washed the body of the fair,
While it was still warm, they all gathered
where

Apostasy was framed with pagan care.
That meeting in the back shed was the start
Of martyrdom and plague of war to part
The world in evil trinities of fate.
Hypocrisy's to foster soon and late
Divine One to divided folk and state.

6 Before their face the folk shall be
Pained greatly, all faces shall see
Blackness. 7 They'll come to run like great
Warriors, they'll climb the wall *and gate*
Like men of war; and they shall march
Every one on his ways, through arch

They'll not break their ranks *or be late*.
8 Neither shall one push on another,
In his own path shall walk each brother,
And *when* they fall upon the sword,
They shall not be wounded *or gored*.
9 They shall run back and forth into
The city; they shall run *in crew*
Upon the wall, and they shall climb
Up on the houses, *in their time*
They'll enter windows like a thief.
10 The earth shall quake before them and
The sky shall tremble at the stand
Of sun and moon darkened, and stars
Shall stop their shining at the bars.
11 And YHWH shall send His voice before
His army, for His camp *on shore*
Is very large, for His word goes
Out in strength: as when YHWH's day
shows
Great and terrible. Who can close?

The trumpets blown on Zion in a call
Of warning echo from the city wall,
They rise in woes that John saw from the
isle
Where he dispelled the veils and saw a
while.

The prophecy of that dark century
That saw abomination set freely
Upon the temple mount that was laid bare
Appears here in such words that still seem
fair
In all their cant and poetry on air.
Abomination on that hill is not
The golden dome or Aqsa to be sought,
But that gross dividing of lot from lot,
The trinity of faiths that should in plot
Be one who have one God, Beloved and
rare.

12 "That's now also why," so says YHWH,
Turn back to Me with all your heart,
And with fasting and weeping too,
And with the mourning *of your part*.
13 "And tear your heart, and not your
clothes,
And turn to YHWH your Alohim,
For He is gracious and does seem
Merciful, slow to wrath and of
Great kindness and turns in His love
From evil worked out on the scene.

Ah my Beloved, here in the words You sent
Down on the prophet to tell what You
meant

Begin with the great pair that is now known
From the Qur'an and each day must be
shown

In prayer prostrating before Your great
throne.

Rahim Huu! As I hear the rising sound
My soul whirls like a spark up from the
ground

As momentary sacrifice to You
The length that human breath can ever do.
Though I may fast and weep and tear my
heart

As well as patched and woollen cloak
unsmart,

My soul cannot remain downtrodden long,
It joins too quickly in the praise and song
That prophets and divine guides have made
strong.

The true faith in this day calls for the sound
Of weeping and the beating breast around.

While pagan deities on earth abound,
And the din of their worship on the ground
Fill all the air of church and palace hall
Of grand cathedral and the quire stall,
My own heart bows beneath breast-beating
hand,

And I weep for the sacrifice on land
Of good and true, Your own sent in the
band.

Beloved, I can identify the faith
Of truth in contrast to the cult of wraith
By sound of weeping on Karbela's sand.
I turn from sorrow and from joy at last
And find Your heart open to the outcast.

14 Who knows if he'll return, repent
And leave a blessing with the sent,
A food offering and drink one too
Before YHWH your Alohim's view?

15 Blow the trumpet in Zion and
Set apart a fast, call the band
In solemn assembly to stand.

16 Gather the folk and sanctify
The congregation, and bring by
The elders, gather all the sons
And those that suck the breast *in tons*,
Let the bridegroom go from his room
And the bride from her closet's doom.

17 Let the priests, ministers of YHWH,
Weep between the porch and the view
Of the altar, and let them say,
"Spare Your folk, O YHWH, in Your way,
And do not give Your heritage
To be reproached by pagan rule,
So they should say among the school
Of people, where's their God in age?"

18 Then YHWH will be jealous before
His land and pity His folk more.

19 Indeed, YHWH will answer and say
To His folk, "See now on that day
I'll send you corn and wine and oil,
And you'll be satisfied for toil,
And I'll make you no more reproach
Among the heathen in their broach.

20 "But I'll remove far off from you
The northern *army*, and will strew
Him in a land barren in view,
And desolate, with his face on
The east sea, and his back *at dawn*
Toward the western sea, the smell
Of his spoil and rot shall rise well,
Because he's done awful things *drawn*.

The great fall of the northern king without
Help of any is prophesied, no doubt,
In Daniel and we saw the Ottoman
Fall without help and without any plan
By Arab and the hand of Englishman.
That prophecy was great and clearly seen
By old Uriah Smith with vision keen,
And caught up in a book and spread
abroad,

And then denied by his assembly's laud.
Beloved, if I had held that clear-eyed way,
It would have kept me from the form and
sway

Of evil masquerading for the good,
It would have kept me in the way I should.
I take just Your big ten to guide through
wood.

21 Fear not, O land; be glad, rejoice:
For YHWH will do great things and choice.
22 Don't be afraid, beasts of the field,
For desert pastures spring, trees yield
Their fruit, the fig tree and the vine
Give of their strength *to wine and dine*.

23 Be glad, sons of the fortress, and
Rejoice in YHWH your Alohim;
He's given the early rain as planned,

And He'll *surely* bring down *on beam*
 The early rain, and then at last
 The latter rain before is passed
 The first month *in the spring amassed*.
 24 And the floors shall be full of wheat,
 The vats shall overflow *on feet*
 With grape juice and with oil *to beat*.
 25 I'll make a restitution for
 The years the locust ate the store,
 The cankerworm's destruction and
 The caterpillar and the band
 Of palmerworm, My great army
 I sent among you *on a spree*.
 26 You'll eat in plenty satisfied,
 And praise the name of YHWH beside,
 You Alohim that has done great
 Wonders for you, and My folk *late*
 Shall never be shamed *in the gate*.
 27 And you will know that I'm among
 Israel, YHWH you Alohim sung,
 And no other, and My folk's fame
 Shall never enter into shame.

The ones who tire of waiting for the gift
 The promise of Your word contrives to lift
 Forget the first month and the promised
 rain,

The harvest and the hope of honest gain.
 Instead they set the year back in the grade
 Of winter and of autumn in parade,
 And set up thrones to fill the earth with
 crass

And reign as men ignoring You en masse.
 Beloved, I wait the equinox and then
 Count to the fourth day of the week again
 And start my year of Sabbaths and the time
 To meet with you in rain or sunny clime.
 The sweetness of Your harvest rises while
 I count Your Sabbaths off mile after mile.

28 It will happen after that I
 Will pour out upon every guy
 My spirit, and your sons and lasses
 Shall prophesy, your old men's passes
 Shall be in dreams and your young men
 Shall come to see visions again.

29 Also on man-servants and on
 Maid-servants in those days I've drawn
 My spirit *from the dawn to dawn*.

30 And I'll show wonders in the sky,
 And in the earth, blood, fire and high
 Pillars of smoke. 31 The sun shall be

Turned into darkness, and the moon
 To blood, before great horror's noon
 Of YHWH to come *for woe and boon*.
 32 And it shall happen every one
 Who cantillates YHWH's name when done
 Shall be saved, for in fortress mount
 And in Jerusalem to count
 Shall be deliverance, as YHWH
 Has promised, and the remnant crew
 That YHWH shall call out into view.

The centuries have seen the rise of those
 Who prophesied in poverty of clothes,
 The wonders of the sky once all arose
 In dark days and in bloody moons that
 froze

The heart of people who had read or not
 Your words of comfort and of fearful plot.
 And so today I live upon the shore
 Of judgement waiting for the sword in store
 To set of justice on the fated earth,
 And as I wait I cantillate Your worth
 And so join in the remnant that is sealed
 To Your obedience for their faith's yield.
 The few are scattered all about the earth,
 Yet drink Your hidden waters in the dearth.

Joel 3

1 See, in those days and in that time
 When I shall bring back from the crime
 Of their captivity Judah
 And Jerusalem, 2 I will draw
 Also all nations and will bring
 Them down into the valley's spring
 Of Jehoshaphat, and will plead
 With them there for My folk in need
 And for My heritage Israel,
 Whom they have scattered hill from dell
 Among the nations and in plot
 Divided up My land they got.

3 And they have cast lots for My folk,
 And have traded a boy in stroke
 For prostitute's and sold a girl
 For wine to drink *in bout and swirl*.

4 So what do you have in My way,
 O Tyre and Sidon and the sway
 Of all the coasts of Palestine?
 Will you give back recompense fine?
 And if you recompense me then
 I'll quickly turn your pay again
 Upon your own head *and your men*.

5 Since You've received silver and gold

From me, and carried as in fold
Into your temples my good things,
6 And Judah's children and the wings
Of fair Jerusalem you've sold
Out to the Grecians, so you might
Remove them from their borders' right.
7 See, I shall raise them from the place
Where you have sold them, and the pace
Return on your own head *and face*.

I guess this is the prophetic record
By which the Maccabees once could afford
To claim the Spartans as their kith and kin,
Unless it was by contrast to the din
Of Hellenistic fascination with
The gymnast and checkered Athenic myth.
Beloved, Your own are bought and sold
today
In hardly a less mercantile way,
And served up on the altar of high style,
And portioned out to make a buck a mile.
The weathered artefacts offered in aid
Of ancient civilizations well paid
Offer a veil and opening in glade:
The more things change the more they are
waylaid.

8 I'll sell your sons and daughters too
Into the hand of Judah's crew,
And they'll sell them to Sabeans,
To a far folk, and by YHWH's plans.
9 Proclaim this among the Gentiles,
Prepare for war, wake up the files
Of mighty men, let soldiers come
Near and let them rise up *and hum*.
10 Beat your ploughshares in swords and
your

Pruning hooks into spears by score,
Let the weak say "I'm strong in corps."
11 Gather together and come all
You pagan people *to the ball*,
And bring your mighty ones *in stall*
To come down by YHWH *at His call*.
12 Let the heathen awake and come
Up to Jehoshaphat's vale's sum,
For there I'll sit to judge them all,
The heathen round about *the kraal*.
13 Turn in the sickle, harvest's ripe;
Come down, the press is full to swipe,
The vats are running over, mate,
See how their wickedness is great.
14 The crowds, the crowds stand in the vale

Of the decision: for the wail
Of YHWH's day is near in the vale
Of their decision *to regale*.

How can You judge the nations at the stall
Unless You gave them laws on which to
call?

Justice demands the judge be backed by
what

The royal legislation has to shut.
The divine right to judge is proof enough
That there's a divine law, benign or gruff,
By which to live and by which to judge call
Beneath the ivory throne and marble wall.
Beloved, I know commandments once
proclaimed

On Sinai have passed round a world
enflamed

To be the moral ground in every place.
Beloved, I know Your law is found in trace
In every faith that springs along the fence
Of fortunes and of platitudes in tents.

15 The sun and moon shall become dark,
The stars withdraw shining on park.

16 And YHWH shall shout from fortress
hill,

And send voice from Jerusalem;
And heavens and earth shall shake, but still
YHWH shall be His folk's hope *and gem*,
The strength of Israel's people's *hem*.

17 So you shall know that I am YHWH
Your Alohim who lives in view
Of the fortress, My holy mount.
Holy Jerusalem shall count,
And there'll be no strangers to pass
Through her again to say alas.

18 And it shall come to pass that day
The mountains shall drop in the way
New grape juice and the hills shall flow
With milk, and all the rivers show
Judah waters in plenty, and
A spring shall come out of the grand
House of YHWH and water the vale
Of Shittim and to great avail.

19 Egypt shall be a desolation,
And Edom a desert for nation,
Because of violence they brought
Against the sons of Judah sought,
Because they shed innocent blood
In their land *to flow like a flood*.

20 But Judah shall stay evermore,
 Jerusalem in every score
 Of generations more and more.
 21 I'll make enquiry for their blood
 That I have left as in a flood
 And unavenged, for YHWH shall dwell
 In the fortress *of Israel*.

I've seen the hills of Edom in distress
 Of poverty and in the humble dress
 Of dearth, while on the high Judean shore
 The blossoms of the almonds fade no more.
 The fifth kingdom after the ragged tear
 Made in the tent of David not to spare
 Arises in the heart and hope to bear
 The fruit of righteousness upon the air.
 Beloved, take vengeance on the lands and
 sea
 That have in devastation tragically
 Left hate and sorrow in the gate of Gath
 And wiped across the hills a sullen path.
 When time has failed to bring Your
 kingdom on,
 Let purpose in uprightness speed the dawn.

Amos

The third of twelve prophets appears to be
 The harbingers of Hussein in the spree
 At Karbela. Amos looks round to find
 The tabernacle of David confined
 To its oblivion, destruction's bind.
 He prophesies the rise of that fair tent
 And in that prophesy the fourth that went
 Up living from the blood of Karbela
 Sang Psalms of Islam with all David's awe.
 Beloved, Amos is resurrection's gauge,
 The hope in hopeless ages for an age
 Of messianic fervour and the skill
 Of harpist and of slinger on the hill.
 Beloved, I turn to sing in Amos' mill.

Amos 1

1 The words of Amos, who was with
 The herdsmen of Tekoa's *kith*,
 That he saw about Israel
 In the days of Uzziah's spell
 As king of Judah, in the time
 Of Jeroboam son of Joash,
 King of Israel *and for no crime*,
 Two years before the earthquake *bash*.

2 And he said "YHWH from fortress roars,
 From Jerusalem His voice pours,
 'The pastures of the shepherds mourn,
 And Carmel's crest withers at bourn.'"

You chose, Beloved, a worthy time to send
 A prophet calling to repentance' bend,
 Two years before the earthquake that they
 might
 Turn from their evil ways soon, and their
 spite.

Today as I was writing out the words
 I speak to You, as heard from singing birds
 Or winged angels above the white trees
 Cut out in black jet lines and frosty frieze,
 Shri Lanka's coast was cut down by the
 blast

Of tidal wave and earthquake from the mast
 Of Indonesia and Thailand as far
 As India's fishing villages and star.
 Beloved, as I sit safely I repent,
 In sorrow's ashes I find the day spent.

3 YHWH says "For three transgressions of
 Damascus, and four *as above*,
 I'll not turn away its *judgement*,
 Because they've threshed Gilead *rent*
 With implements of iron *spent*.

4 But I will send a fire into
 The house of Hazael *to do*,
 Which shall devour the palaces
 Of Ben-Hadad *and all of his*.

5 I'll also break the bar that stands
 Before Damascus, and cut bands
 Off the inhabitant on plain
 Of Aven, and from whom remain
 To hold sceptre in house of Eden
Of iron or gold or even reeden.
 The folk of Syria shall go
 Captive to Kir," Says YHWH *not slow*.

Beloved, do You really greet heathen cant
 With such unsophisticated a slant
 As violence physical and puissant?
 I'll not call bluff, though preachers tell me
 true

That You are love alone and nothing grew
 Of violence from Your arm bared to brew.
 So Ben Hadad's palaces faded fair
 Because they did not recognize You there.
 The sceptre falls from every human hand
 By the process we call nature's command,

And even righteous folk take to death bed
After a life well met and fortune spread.
Beloved, Damascus falls, and the same fate
Awaits the Roman church, Genevan state.

6 YHWH says “For three transgressions of
Gaza, and four, I will *in love*
Not turn away its *judgement*, for
They took captive whole lot and store
To deliver *them* up to Edom.
7 But I will send fire *on their freedom*
Upon the wall of Gaza, which
Shall burn its palaces like pitch.
8 I will cut off inhabitant
From Ashdod, and the one to rant
Holding the sceptre from *the town*
Of Ashkelon, I will *with frown*
Turn My hand against Ekron, and
The rest of the Philistines’ band
Shall perish there,” Says the Lord YHWH.

You call Your judgements down on
Philistine
As well as British empire in to dine.
Their sin was worshipping fish god instead
Of You, and the rebirthing of the red
Sun that fell in the sea like Riding Hood
Who dawdled in the forest when the wood
Seemed sweet enough to linger in light’s
good.

Who worship the absolute of space-time,
Calling it science instead of the rhyme
Of human hearts in darkness find the climb
To Ashdod and to Ekron meet the slime
Of Sodom and Gomorrah. My Beloved,
When I set out to worship shod and gloved,
Let me not worship Dagon’s stumps and
shoved.

9 YHWH says “For three transgressions
too
Of Tyre, and for four, I will not
Turn away its *punishment hot*,
Because they brought captivity
On the whole of Edom to be,
And did not remember the pact
Of brotherhood *and how to act*.

Tyre, Tyre, sings by the sea and loves to
gloat
That she’s like New York City, town of
note,

And realizes not her judgement’s due,
Even if by the hand of Muslim crew
Ignoring Your commands of what to do,
And wallowing in sinful bed and brew
To gather courage to go out and screw.
Damned is Tyre, lovely Tyre, and damned
the goat
That steps with dainty sounds upon the rote
Of freedom, damned the hand of violence
That follows sin into its hidden tents.
Did she bring on Edom’s captivity?
Once more five times five hundred years in
glee
She steals Edom’s bread in her oily fee.

10 But I will send a fire upon
The wall of Tyre, which shall be drawn
To destroy *all* its palaces.”
11 YHWH says “For three transgressions’
fizz
Of Edom, and for four, my biz
Is not to turn away its fall,
Because he chased brother *from hall*
With the sword, and cast off all pity,
His anger tearing the committee,
Keeping his wrath like the banditti.
12 But I will send a fire upon
Teman, which shall devour the drawn
Palaces of Bozrah *till dawn*.”

If You wreak vengeance on despoiler of
Edom, You do not let her off the shove,
But bring Edom to justice for the sword
She wields. Beloved, I have no brother
bored,
Not of the flesh nor even the church board.
So far as faith goes I’ve not even scored.
I find escape from wrath since none are
born
To call me brother, though they had been
sworn.
I have no palace in Bozrah nor keep
In Teman with a silky place to sleep.
But send Your fire, Beloved, upon my heart
As I look to You with my simple part,
Ready to feel the sting of Your love’s dart.
Send fire into the fields, love’s fire to reap.

13 YHWH says “For three transgressions
of
The people of Ammon *to shove*,
And for four, I’ll not turn away

Its *punishment and judgement* sway,
 Because they ripped open females
 With child in Gilead *with wails*,
 Just to get more land in their pails.
 14 But I will kindle fire on wall
 Of Rabbah, and it shall appal
 Its palaces with battle shout,
 And a tempest in day of rout
 And whirlwind. 15 Their king shall go out
 Into captivity, he and
 His princes together in band,”
 Says YHWH *out from the heavenly land*.

If son of Esau escapes not Your sword,
 Then son of Lot lets down a single cord
 Into the pit to catch a poisoned fish
 To place upon his finest dinner dish
 And sleep eternal sleep as his last wish.
 I pass the palaces of the great sons
 Sitting on oil wealth warming their buns,
 And know their turn is coming for the runs
 They’ve made against the earth and the
 earth’s tons
 Of hungry children. My Beloved, I bear
 A silent witness of the troubles there.
 I’ve chatted with the guards upon the steps
 Of steel and concrete, seen their busy reps
 Enter their limousines with silken heps.

Amos 2

1 YHWH says “For three transgressions
 more
 Of Moab, and *even* for four,
 I will not turn away its *fate*,
 Because he burned the bones of *late*
 The king of Edom in lime *pit*.
 2 But I will send a fire on it
 In Moab, and it shall devour
 Kerioth’s palaces *an hour*.
 Moab shall die in that tumult,
 With shouting *and* trumpet insult.
 3 I’ll cut off the judge from its place,
 And kill all its princes by race,”
 Says YHWH *in His love and His grace*.

Moab too falls the fate of all who rise
 To sin against the thunder of the skies,
 Against Creator of the world and all
 That sparkle in the ocean’s sandy hall.
 Grant me a vision of the way to go
 That leads to life and breath while on the
 stow,

The scene where You, Beloved, make show
 Of tumult on the mountain where now
 dwell
 The lonely inmates of monastery’s shell.
 Moab too falls, and with her sounding fall
 The houses of culture and charity
 Remain bleak and sore as they come to see
 That civilized efforts to contain force
 In time must bend to the rival divorce.

4 YHWH says “For three transgressions yet
 Of Judah, and for four, *you bet*,
 I will not turn away its fate,
 Because they have despised the *great*
 Law of YHWH, and have not kept His
 Commandments *as it was their biz*.
 Their lies lead them astray, *lies* which
 Their fathers followed *in the ditch*.
 5 But I’ll send a fire on Judah,
 And it shall devour to the *raw*
 Palaces of Jerusalem.”

6 YHWH says “For three transgressions’
 hem
 Of Israel, and for four, I
 Will not turn away its *die*,
 Because they sell the righteous for
 Silver, and the poor what is more
 For a pair of sandals *in store*.
 7 They pant after the dust of earth
 On the head of the poor *in birth*,
 And pervert the way of the humble.
 A man and his father a-bumble
 Go to the *same* girl, to defile
 My holy name *in churchly guile*.
 8 They lie down by every altar
 On clothes taken in pledge *too far*,
 And drink the wine of the condemned
In the house of their god *well-hemmed*.

Your people in times past, Beloved, knew
 well
 The path leading to temple harlot’s door
 Where for a silver coin a man could spell
 A scientific plot to crease the score
 And secure the fertility of lot
 As well as wife and cattle, servants’ spawn.
 A man could spend his silver there till
 dawn.
 The bloody altar now reeks of the spill
 Of candle wax, but Baal still gets his fill.
 Frenetic grinding of the hips is still
 The main attraction charismatics bill.

Beloved, the temple harlots' ancient skill
Remains the Christian path from church to
church
Where scantily clothed fillies twitch and
lurch.

9 "Yet *it was* I *who once* destroyed
The Amorite before employed,
Whose height *was* like the cedars' height,
And he *was as* strong as the bright
Oaks, yet I destroyed of his fruit
Above and beneath to his root.

The armies of the Lord also went out
From time to time and set the foe at rout,
Yet You, Beloved, take credit for the
doubt.

I wot not when the three hundred bore
lamps
And broke their pitchers on the evening
damps

You were the One to cancel out their
stamps.

But sometimes Israel fought with sword in
hand.

It was not always You who gave command.
You take the credit for the slaughtering
Whether by hand of man or at the spring
Of natural catastrophe or at
The instigation of wonders that sat
As marvels in the sacred text. I know
In every human face I see Your glow.

10 Also *it was* I *who* brought you
Up from the land of Egypt *true*,
And led you forty years and through
The wilderness, to take the land
Of the Amorite *in your hand*.

While Aaron and Miriam make squabbling
do

To say not only Moses brought them
through,

But they were chosen prophets, they both
too,

Beloved, You sound the word as strong and
true

That You brought up the folk from Egypt's
land.

The visible I trow in Moses' hand
Was rod and serpent and his full command,

And yet You were the Saviour from the
place
Of bondage who walked with them without
trace

Upon the desert sands. I seek Your face
Beyond the thing visible to my race
And find You still to do and be and come.
You are the fullness of goodness and sum,
Whether with rod and veil, or sword and
mace.

11 I raised up some of your sons as
Prophets, and of your young men as
Nazirites. *Is it* not so, O
You children of Israel *and slow?*"
Says YHWH. 12 "But you gave Nazirites
Wine to drink, and commanded *knights*,
The prophets saying, 'Do not speak
In prophecy!' 13 "Indeed, I'm sleek
Weighed down by you, as a full cart
Of sheaves is weighed down *on depart*.

Ah, Amos knew the feeling when the lord
Officer of the king took up the sword
In hilt and came and handed him the word
Not to speak when You slashed his heart
and stirred.

Though I am not a prophet, I have felt
The burning word in heart and tongue and
welt

On soul: my word fell unheard on the air.
I too have known the futile, lonely prayer.
Beloved, I turn my face away from wine
Of the Eucharist when it's brought out fine
For all to bow and worship at the vine.
Beloved, I turn my heart and hand from
that

Cup filled with glut the dervish through the
slat

Would give instead of visions where
You're at.

14 So flight shall perish from the swift,
The strong shall not strengthen his shrift,
Nor shall the mighty save his soul,
15 He shall not stand *upon the goal*
Who handles the bow, swift of foot
Shall not escape, nor shall he put
His trust in a horse to save him.

16 The most courageous men and grim
Shall flee naked upon that day,"
Says YHWH *now as He has His say*.

That day the strong shall flee away in fear
Before the wrath that You make to appear.
Perhaps You mean the days when You
came down

To teach the Edomite what was Your
frown,

And Ammonite to strip of golden crown,
And Philistine to hurry out of town.

Perhaps You mean the days that are to
come

On Israel in the next chapter in sum.

Perhaps, and best, Beloved, You mean for
me

The hope of seeing beyond grasping fee
That You will turn the plague of arms I see
Into a work that brings Your will to be
Done on this earth, though kings may make
a row,

And presidents at church pretend to bow.

Amos 3

1 Now hear this word that YHWH has
spoken

Against you, folk of Israel, token
Against the whole family which I
Brought up from Egypt's land *awry*,
Saying 2 "You only have I known
Of all families of the earth *shown*,
Therefore I will punish you for
All your iniquities *and more*."

Beloved, You know the way of righteous
men

But the way of the wicked once again,
Because You know it not, is gone astray,
Destroyed in the néant of judgement day.
Beloved, Beloved, know my iniquity
And destroy all the wickedness You see
In my action and word or even thought.
Leave nothing but the purity You wrought
In my self as reflection of the true.
Beloved, see and know everything I do,
And in Your seeing, Your creative sight
Turn all the lead and dross to golden bright,
Work out in secret shop the alchemy
That turns time's naught into eternity.

3 Can two walk together, unless
They are agreed? 4 Will lion address
To roar in the woods without prey?
Will a young lion cry astray

Out of his den, if he has caught
Nothing? 5 Will a bird fall into
A snare on the earth *with ado*,
Without a deadfall to catch it,
Even if it be plump and fit?
Will a snare spring up from the earth,
If it has caught nothing of worth?
6 If a trumpet is blown in city,
Will not the folk in fear run gritty?
If there's calamity in town,
Will not YHWH have on it looked down?
7 Surely the Lord YHWH does not do
Anything unless He shows to
His servants the prophets the *hidden*
Secrets *to which they have been bidden*.

Beloved! What secret things You have
revealed

To prophet messengers, all things
concealed!

Have You one secret left to give to me?
Then give me now that sacred mystery!
I turn to find Your name spelt out in sound,
One twit of finch, and flitting on the ground
The bright-eyed glint of robin says the
word

Is found. Your secret is kept safe by bird.
I find Your name spelt out in leaf and twig
And scrawled across the sky in cloud as
big.

Indeed I seek in vain to find a place
Where Your name's not, that does not hide
Your face.

Then why should I be startled when I find
There is no I but You, no I in kind?

8 A lion has roared! Who has not feared?
The Lord YHWH has spoken, *appeared!*
Who can but prophesy *the weird?*

9 "Proclaim in Ashdod's palaces,
And in the halls where Egypt is,
And say 'Assemble on the hills
Samaritan, and see what fills
Her with great tumults, the oppressed
Within her. 10 For they have not guessed
And do not know to do the right,'
Says YHWH, 'Who store up *in their spite*
Violence in their palaces
And robbery *where their heart is*.'"

Amos saw that Your people were just like
The Amorites in works, and in the spike

Like Philistines whose gods of sea and
 wave
 Were taking all the people to the grave.
 Amos saw that their worship of You was
 Set out in the same colours and the claws
 Of sense and sensuality because
 The heart of all men in illusion's paws
 Invents demonic faith in what it gnaws.
 Beloved, You look upon the church today
 And see the synagogue in Satan's sway
 And hear the rock music echo its way
 Through sacred halls of mosques where
 some men pray:
 Righteous and wicked cut from the same
 rave.

11 That's why the Lord YHWH says to
 them,
 "An enemy around your stem,
 He'll sap your strength from you, and your
 Palaces shall be plunder's *score*."

Indeed, Beloved, I see the plundered stroke
 Upon the temple stones of which You
 spoke,
 Even today they fall beneath the hand
 Of civilized with military band.
 The enemy stands in Jerusalem
 And sparks the battle from the holy hem,
 One shouting God is One to answer clear
 The challenge that there is no god to fear
 But God alone, and in that argument
 Find strength to kill the child in helmet
 bent,
 The man with stone in fist, the woman sent
 To spy the way with glowering portent.
 I see the palaces plundered again,
 Which is why we make them of glass and
 yen.

12 YHWH says "As a shepherd takes from
 The mouth of a lion two legs *come*
 Or a piece of an ear, so shall
 The folk of Israel *prodigal*
 Be taken out of Samaria
 Who *still* live there in a *pariah*,
 The corner of a bed and on
 The edges of a couch *withdrawn*!

May I be that remnant You snatch away
 From the harm of the church and state to
 bay

At frozen star and moon, alone to stay
 Upon the edge of couch, in corner lot
 Surrounded by the roads that men forgot
 To make right through my late depleted
 plot.
 I cling to You alone, Beloved, when church
 And priest despise Your law, leave in the
 lurch
 The hungry and confess the company
 Oppressing the poor has more right to be.
 Your own are but the froth cast on the
 shore
 From a great ship proud tossed, but now no
 more,
 The ragged, shivering survivor alone
 On desert isle without a god of stone.

13 "Hear and witness against the house
 Of Jacob," Says the Lord YHWH, God
 Of hosts, 14 "That in the day I growse
 Israel for their transgressions' *prod*,
 I'll also bring it on the altars
 Of Bethel, and horns of the altars
 Shall be cut off, fall to the ground.
 15 "I will destroy *what I have found*
Of winter house along with *what*
Is left of the summer house *shut*,
 The houses of ivory shall end,
 The great houses shall have an end,"
 Says YHWH *the faithful God and Friend*.

Did You know that ivory now is banned
 By law international from the stand
 Of peddler? Now the only ones who get
 That stuff are the wealthy who can pay yet
 The price of poach and secret contraband.
 Destroy, Beloved, the summer house,
 destroy,
 And leave no great house left to the employ
 Of Your name in the worship and the joy
 Of idol in image of stone or in
 The sound of sensual worship for its din,
 Or in the mental images that peek
 From creeds set out in Latin or in Greek.
 Beloved, leave me a palace in my heart
 Of stone enlightened by Your better part.

Amos 4

1 Hear this word, you cows of Bashan,
 Upon Samaria's mountain ran,
 Who oppress the poor, crush the needy,
 Who say to your husbands *though seedy*,

“Bring wine, let us drink *to a man!*”

Bring wine, they say, bring wine and let us
make

A feast to the Lord for his body’s sake,
A dance in honour of the ecstasy
That comes from whirling on the dergah’s
scree.

Bring wine, they say, bring wine and let us
go

Into the house of idols for the show
Of light and sound, the great gyration’s
take,

The delight of every wench and her rake.
Beloved, give me the wine from Your own
lips

That I may imbibe all Your words in sips
Until the sea once covered with fair ships
Is dry for the ink that Your day required
To write Your melodies bright and
inspired,

That none can hear from the choked and
the wired.

2 The Lord YHWH has by holiness
Sworn, “Indeed, the days shall address
You when He’ll take you all away
With fishhooks *in your skin to flay*,
And so too your posterity.

3 You’ll go out the broken *city*,
Each one straight ahead of her, and
You’ll be cast into Harmon’s land,”
Says YHWH. 4 “Now come to Bethel and
Transgress, at Gilgal multiply
Transgression, bring and *testify*
Your sacrifices every morn,
Your tithes every three days *as sworn*.

A cynical word, my Beloved, You speak
To ancient Israel because their cheek
In ritual to cover up their sleek
Oppression of the poor and their unjust
Dealings arouses in Your heart the dust
Of choking, incensed, marbled murder-lust.
Let them indeed transgress at Bethel and
Westminster Abbey, while the other hand
Rakes off the interest to pay their tithes.
So You prefer the singing of the scythes
Across a meadow rich with grass and thorn,
Instead of Psalms recited to Your scorn.
Beloved, Gilgal is buried in the sand,
But sacrifices still raise their demand.

5 Offer a sacrifice of thanks
With heaven, proclaim *from your banks*
And announce the freewill offerings,
For this you love in *all its stings*,
Folk of Israel!” Says the Lord YHWH
That speaks His scathing words to you.
6 “Also I gave cleanness of teeth
To you, in your cities’ *bequeath*.
And lack of bread in all your places,
Yet you’ve not returned Me *your faces*,”
Says YHWH. 7 “I also withheld rain
From you, with still three months to gain
The harvest. I made it rain on
One city, I withheld *at dawn*
Rain from another city *drawn*.
One part was rained upon, and where
It did not rain it withered there.

I too live in a world where faith is bought
And sold in every holy sort of plot,
And where its lovely sounds and colours
rise

To send prayers Christian up into the skies,
Where Buddhist prayer wheels come in
every size

And shape to show how wonderfully wise
Is faith, and where Jew and Muslim despise
Each other’s claim to sharing in disguise
The same God. I too live where rain may
fall

And where the dearth raise up the sane in
pall

Across the heavens riddled by the prayers
Of humankind. I too see merchant’s wares
Displayed as soon as the catastrophe
Loosens the hungry out on the debris.

8 So two *or* three cities wandered
To another city *preferred*
To drink water, but they were not
Satisfied, yet you were *not taught*
To come to Me,” Says YHWH *distraught*.

All men seek after breath the watered brook
That beckons thirsty throats from the dry
brook

To taste the real and swallow what is fresh
To the taste of blood, bone, and skin and
flesh.

All men seek after water, food to fill
The belly with the hand, avoiding swill

If there is sweetness and new ripened fruit,
 Or green shoots tender to the living root.
 From city to grand city I have gone
 To seek the waters of the rosy dawn,
 To find the broken cisterns overdrawn.
 From city and grand city I return
 To You, Beloved, to find the thirsty burn
 Quenched in Your name and what Your
 name may earn.

9 "I blasted you with blight and mildew.
 When your gardens increased, and filled
 you

Your vineyards, your fig trees, and your
 Olive trees, *all safe put in store*,
 The locust consumed, yet you've not
 Returned to Me," says YHWH *unsought*.

Ah, my Beloved, I do return this day
 From nibbling at the fronds that still may
 stay

Upon the twigs the locusts in their way
 Devoured for their rejoicing prayers and
 sweet.

Ah, my Beloved, I do not spurn the pay
 In ecstasy that from the altar may
 Arise into the dark night and the sway
 Of whirling before Your throne, at Your
 feet.

And yet I file past vineyards and fig trees
 That find their olives too touched by the
 blight

While mildew creeps in an unholy frieze
 Across the prayer book covers in my sight.
 Ah, my Beloved, earth is not here to please
 But lie in solid truth before Your light.

10 "I sent among you a plague then
 After the way of Egypt's men,
 Your young men I killed with a sword,
 Along with all your captive *horde*
 Of horses, I made your camps' stench
 Come up your nostrils, *man and wench*,
 Yet you have not returned to Me,"
 Says YHWH *saying sorrowfully*.

Have You not noticed, my Beloved, that
 fear

And damnation and damage of the gear
 Does not produce faith in the fond career
 Of human hearts? Ah, You have noticed
 well

Catastrophe but reinforces spell
 Of heathen heartfelt prayer before the bell.
 Captivity and plague are not conducive
 To other than false worship and abusive.
 If You would have us listen on the stones
 Where we bow down to praise our father's
 bones,
 Then You must set aside prophet and profit
 And speak once more from Sinai not to
 scoff at.

Perhaps the stinking of the human camp
 Will then blow off to sea. Lord, light a
 lamp.

11 "I overthrew *some* of you too,
 As Alohim *once* overthrew
 Sodom and Gomorrah, and you
 Were like a firebrand plucked *as few*
 From the burning, yet you have not
 Returned to Me," says YHWH *besot*.

Atomic bombs may well put some to sleep
 And raise up other to a vigil keep,
 But firebrands from the burning, far
 between,

Are like the fireflies on the summer scene
 Or shooting stars, a moment seen and
 passed.

The firebrand is no message here to last.
 The Huguenot that fled with burning heart
 Filled with faith and with Psalm to do his
 part

Gave birth to men illiterate and poor
 To stand on Point Mountain at cabin door
 Unconscious of the faith that led them
 there,

Unconscious of the fiery faith of Pierre,
 While the spawn of the one who stayed
 behind
 Sell diamonds from boutiques well stocked
 in kind.

12 "Therefore so will I do to you,
 O Israel, because I'll do
 This to you, now prepare to meet
 Your God, O Israel, *on your feet!*"

13 For indeed, He who forms the hills,
 And makes the wind, who gives the bills
 To man declaring him his thoughts
 And makes the morning darkness *plots*,
 Who treads upon the earth's high places,
 YHWH God of hosts, *so* His name *traces*.

Do You, Beloved, tread on high places of
 The green earth to look down on me in
 love?
 You form the hills and make the wind
 above,
 And then declare to me my heart's first
 thoughts.
 The red trunk of the pines, the greyer fir
 Speak to those thoughts and make them rise
 and stir.
 The aspen and the birch turn and in blur
 Cover the hillside and its treasure lots.
 With silent step You tread indeed on high
 And whisper to my lowly mind as I
 Look out upon Your tracks upon the sod.
 I bend toward You passing on the clod.
 Beloved, the morning darkness on the snow
 Leaves me knowing the pathways where
 You go.

Amos 5

1 Hear this word against you I take,
 A lament, house of Israel's *sake*:
 2 The virgin of Israel has fallen,
 She'll rise no more *with none to call on*.
 She lies forsaken on her land,
There's no one to raise up her *hand*.
 3 For so says the Lord YHWH *to stand*,
 "The city with a thousand strong
 That goes out in a mighty throng
 Shall have *at last* a hundred left,
 And one that goes out *as by theft*
 A hundred strong shall have ten left
 To the house of Israel *bereft*."

I see the cities go out thousands strong
 To worship at the seat of idol's wrong
 And in gyrations meet the fatal crew
 That webs a track across the morning dew.
 All sleep. The silent morning creeps along
 The wall where all in drunken rage fall
 down.

So love abundant troubles none in town.
 The virgins fall to rise vaginas dripping
 With what seed the drums gave them in
 their tripping.
 The driving rhythms of the gods still speak
 Within the sleeping brains after the leak.
 I wait to see the last hundred to seek,
 But silence covers every morning cloud,
 And only Your word speaks to me aloud.

4 For so says YHWH to Israel's house,
 "Seek Me and live, 5 but do not grouse
 With Bethel, nor enter Gilgal,
 Nor pass on to Beersheba's *pal*,
 For Gilgal surely goes into
 Captivity, and Bethel too
 Shall come to nothing. 6 So seek YHWH
 And live, lest He break out on you
 Like fire *in* the house of Joseph,
 Devouring *it*, with no one *chef*
 To quench *it* in Bethel, 7 you who
 Turn justice to wormwood *in crew*,
 And lay earth's righteousness to rest!"
 8 He made the Pleiades and best
 Orion, He turns death's shadow
 Into morning and makes day show
 Dark as night, He calls for the flow
 Of the sea and pours them out on
 The surface of the earth at dawn,
 YHWH *is* His name. 9 He rains upon
 The strong a ruin, so that fury
 Comes on the fortress *in a hurry*.

That You rain on the strong a ruined fury
 Is comfort to my soul, weak in its curry.
 Let me not turn justice, how few the cases
 Where I have such power with swords or
 with maces,

Into wormwood. I've seen it done alas
 By every police force that hits the grass,
 And every court that is set up to pass
 On what men do. Beloved, the beth deen
 crass

Of the Rabbis was never one so apt
 To corrupt justice as the ones now capped.
 Make day show dark as night, indeed, and
 yet

The night glistens upon the snow to fret
 Out all along the hoarfrost. I have met
 Your angels all invisible, though set.

10 They hate the one who in the gate
 Rebukes, and they abhor the *fate*
 Of one who speaks uprightly *late*.

Oh do they now hate one who at the door
 Reminds them of what You said once
 before?

Indeed, repeat the Decalogue and see
 How many would be ready at a pea
 To crucify You, it's a darling thing

That You appear not in the flesh and wing.
I and mine live beside the gate to hear
How none arise to speak because of fear,
And how assurance companies can leer
At those they fail to reimburse the tear.
Beloved, I look back on the generations
From which I spring and see their dreary
rations.

11 Therefore, because you tread the poor
And take wheat bushels from his door,
Though you have built houses of stone,
Yet you shall not live in them *lone*,
You've planted pleasant vineyards *too*,
But you'll not drink grape juice they grew.
12 For I know your many transgressions,
Your mighty sins *without confessions*:
Afflicting the just, taking bribes,
Diverting the poor *from the scribe*
Of justice at the gate. 13 Therefore
The wise keep still in that time's store,
For it's an evil time *to war*.

14 Seek good and not evil, that you
May live, So YHWH God of hosts true,
As you've spoken, will be with you.
15 Hate evil, love good, and set firm
Justice in the gate, *do not squirm*.
It may be that YHWH God of hosts
Will be gracious to raise the boasts
Of the remnant of Joseph's *coasts*.

One of the fundamentals of true faith
Hides in Amos' passage and like a wraith
Rustles the air and with no hue nor cry
Walks on through darkened morning,
trembles by

The lilacs ready to cast off their blooms.
The word of Amos echoes through my
rooms.

Seek good and love it, evil things eschew
And hate the evil whatever you do.
Beloved, I stop a-sudden in mid-air
And hear the harping of Amos and where
Your truth appears like diamond in the
dust.

I seek the good, Beloved, and take the
crust,
I drop the evil thing red hot and burning
And turn to You alone with all my
yearning.

16 Therefore YHWH God of hosts, the
Lord,

Says this, "In all the streets *restored*
Wailing, in the highways proclaim,
'Alas! Alas!' They'll call the man
Of the field to mourning, and skilled
Lamenters to wailing *distilled*.

17 And in all vineyards *there shall be*
Wailing, for I'll pass your *country*,"
Says YHWH. 18 Woe to you who desire
The day of YHWH, *the day of fire!*
For what good *is* the day of YHWH
To you? *It will be darkness true*,
And not light. 19 *It will be as though*
A man fled from a lion's *show*,
And a bear met him! Or *as though*
He went into the house, and leaned
His hand on the wall, and he *gleaned*
A serpent there to bite his *hand!*
20 *Is* not the day of YHWH dark stand,
And not light? *Is it not* most dark,
With no brightness in it *to park?*

Your day, Beloved, dawns bright at end of
week,
The Sabbath with its golden veils and chic.
It is no day of darkness, though I peek
At prophet's words of warning, still I seek
Through shimmering veils of light the
secret dark

That is not found at all outside the park,
And is not missing from the solitude
Of temple and of bar-room in the feud.
The darkness must remain in light and
cloud,
The whisper of truth shall never be loud,
Not even on the great day when the shroud
Shall tear on which reality's relief
Is etched for faith and works and men's
belief.

I handle in the balance what's accrued.

21 "I hate, I despise your feast days,
I shall not smell your sacred ways
Of assemblies. 22 Though you give Me
Burnt offerings and your grain in fee,
I will not accept *them*, nor will
I regard your fattened peace hill.
23 Away from Me your noisy songs,
I'll not hear the sound of your *gongs*
Of stringed instruments *with their prongs*.
24 But let justice run down like flows

Of water, and righteousness grows
Like a mighty stream *as it goes*.

The holiday beats like washing machine
Heard through three walls before the thing
is seen,
With thunder drumming, screeching and
the sound
Of entranced virgins plummeting the
ground.
You hate, Beloved, the holiday and groove
That wails upon the worshippers who move
In grand array of love about the grove?
You hate the blood and sacrifice where
strove
The priests and kings to find a treasure
trove?
If You had been as we, descended from
The tapping simian toe from which we
come
You'd understand why rock and roll since
Baal
And Ashtoreth has always been on sale.
Stop, my Beloved, to enjoy sacred wail.

25 "Did you offer Me sacrifice
And offerings *and everything nice*
In the desert for forty years,
O house of Israel, *without tears*?
26 You bore in celebration tent
Of Moloch wherever you went,
And Chiun, your idols, the star
Of your gods, wherever you are
You made for yourselves. 27 Therefore I
Will send you in captivity
Beyond Damascus," Says YHWH too,
Whose name *is* the God of hosts, *YHWH*.

The worship of Moloch is necessary
For the growth of cattle, corn and
strawberry.
The wealth of the nation and its well-being
Depends on sacrificing to unseeing
Eye of Moloch and laying in his arms
Heated red hot our children for his charms.
The brash, oil-heated hands of Moloch still
Claim victims for democracy's fair hill,
Captivity beyond Damascus and
The slaughter of the poor in every land.
Carnivorous gods are the best in state,
And worshipping them is for cup and plate
The essence of our science and our doom.

Beloved, come in and welcome to Your
room.

Amos 6

1 And woe to you *who are* at ease
In the fortress, and put your ease
In Samaria's hills, in chief
Of the nations, to whose *relief*
The house of Israel has come!
2 Go to Calneh *and see the sum*,
From there go to Hamath the great,
Then go down to Gath wherein wait
The Philistines. Better than these
Kingdoms or their own panoplies,
Greater are your territories?
3 You who postpone the day of doom,
Who cause the violent in room
To come near, 4 who in ivory beds
Lie stretched out on your couches *heads*,
Eat lambs out of the flock and calves
From the midst of the stall *in halves*,
5 Who sing to the sound of the lute,
Inventing for yourselves the flute
Like David, 6 who drink wine from bowls,
Anointed with perfumes for souls,
But not grieved for affliction of
Joseph *and for his children's love*.

There is a rite that postpones judgement
day,
And brings a lamb in sacrifice to sway,
And touches the lute with new songs to
sound
The wine from every bowl that's passed
around.
I take the day of judgement here and now,
And bring myself in offering and not cow,
While whispering the Four Books for my
song,
I sip a wine of ecstasy and long.
Beloved, I sit among the idol throng
And seem to bow with those who know no
wrong,
But heart and heel see only You behind
The forms and sacrifices of the blind.
Beloved, I sit, I rise, I whirl away
To find a glowing spark and then to stay.

7 Therefore now they shall go captive
As the first of the captives *live*,
And those who recline at banquets
Shall be removed *from their fine sets*.

I join the love feast, take the bread once set
Upon the rough hewn table and forget
The clamour and the din of those set free
By sacred dance and sacred revelry.

I join the love feast, foot soaked and made
bare

Before the servant of the house and stair,
And single out the tapers burning bright
Before the love feast ends in the midnight.

Beloved, I sit at banquet too, and see
The visions of the golden-clad city,

I share the sop and grasp the tendered
beard,

I kiss the cheek and brush the marbled
feared,

And take my place covered in cowl and
rope.

Beloved, I lift my eyes into the hope.

8 The Lord YHWH has sworn by His soul,
YHWH God of hosts says *at the toll*

"I abhor Jacob's excellence,
And hate his palaces *and fence*,

Therefore I will deliver up
The city and all in its cup."

Beloved, I have no palaces to hate,

I am a beggar sitting at the gate,

Unseen, unknown, and yet I am not late

To cross Your divine law with the estate

Of love, awareness till I kiss the truth,

All tattered, ragged, and in word uncouth.

Beloved, I have no excellence that You

Might abhor here above the morning dew

As I sip the light thread of the prayers due.

Beloved, I seek Your palaces and all

The excellences of Your opened hall.

The city and its fill have passed me by.

Perhaps my voice and song are just too shy.

I have no goat, no calf fattening in stall.

9 Then it shall truly come to pass,

That if ten men sit in one class,

They shall die. 10 When uncle of dead

And bone collector with ash spread

Pick up the bones to take them out

Of the house, *and without a shout*,

And say to one beside the house

"Are any more with you?" *By grouse*

He'll answer, saying "No, *not one.*"

And he'll say, "Hold your tongue *when done!*"

We dare not mention name of YHWH,
Even if He should come in view."

Set in the house of the dead, by the hearth

Casting its glowing on pallid and swarth,

Feeling the jarring of lamenters come

To raise the dead to life by chewing gum,

I turn to mention Your name at the crest

Of my remembrance, for Your name's the
best.

Some dare and some do not to say the name
That fills my soul with every burning

flame,

And some who say it set aside the claim

Of Your law and Your love for rock and
fame.

Beloved, the dead souls rustle in their
sleep,

The guardians gyrate in vigil they keep,

And whether or no Your name I repeat,

The windows of the house glaze with the
sleet.

11 For indeed, YHWH gives a command:

He'll break the great house in the land,

And the little house into pieces.

12 Do horses run on rocks *and creases?*

Does *one* plough *there* with oxen's *nieces?*

But you've turned justice into gall,

Righteousness' fruit to wormwood's pall,

13 You who rejoice over néant,

Who say "Have we not taken want

Of horns for ourselves by our strength?"

14 "But, indeed, I will raise at length

A nation against you, O house

Of Israel," Says YHWH *to douse*,

The God of hosts, "And they'll afflict

You from entrance of Hamath picked

To the desert river relict."

The church by definition has to turn

Your justice into dust, or they would burn

With the desire to rule both house and land

Of every peasant and worker on hand.

Have You no patience with the hardy brood

Who make their wealth from oil brought
out of food?

Your own sent one turned water into wine,

So why should they not make oil from the
fine?

The church is here to justify the mine,
And not to worship You, Beloved divine.
It's time to raise the nation and the wall
That puts end to ecclesiastic ball,
And makes justice out of the taste of gall,
And righteousness from wormwood's
caterwaul.

Amos 7

1 So the Lord YHWH showed me, indeed,
He formed locust swarms at the seed
Of the late crop, late crop indeed
After the king's mowings to *plead*.

When You, Beloved, send judgement on a
people,
You also provide escape from the steeple.
The locust swarms may eat the green and
all

The fruit not safe and round in bin and
stall,

But as the green food disappears from
sight,

You raise up something tasty for delight.
You once said fruit for man and for the
beast

The green thing in the lot, baked without
yeast,

But since that day You gave a full release
That summer and winter should never
cease.

When plagues of locusts flutter on the field
I go out by Your law and reap the yield
Of insects and dip them in fire to taste,
With You and me nothing shall go to
waste.

2 And so it was, when they had done
Eating the country's grass for fun,
That I said "O Lord YHWH, forgive,
I pray! Oh, that Jacob may live,
For he *is* small!" 3 So YHWH repented
For this. "It shall not be," consented
YHWH. 4 So the Lord YHWH showed me
true,

The Lord YHWH called conflict by due
Fire, and it consumed the great deep
Devouring the land *flat and steep*.

If I escape the horde of locusts' jaws,
I cannot flee away from Your firm laws.
Locusts give way to fire, and no escape,

And so I burn in flames of no god's shape.
I too am small, and in Your mercy great
I feel the fires to come to You not late,
But burn if I must in Your loving heart
Never again to be from You apart.
Let Your fire consume all of my desire
And let my acts both good and ill expire
Within the purifying furnace of
Your grace and Your eternal burning love.
Repent not, my Beloved, of judgement set
Until face to face You and I have met.

5 Then I said "Lord YHWH, cease, I pray!
Oh, that Jacob may stand *and stay*,
For he *is* small!" 6 And YHWH repented
For this. "This also shall not be,"
Said the Lord YHWH and faithfully.

I pray You, cease, Beloved, I cannot bear
The burden of Your love to me, I swear.
The new day on the forest with its light
Upon the leaf of pine and fir but smite
Me with a burden of new ecstasies
Too heavy for my heart and for my knees.
The frostwork on the high and holy trees
Blinds eye and soul until even thoughts
freeze.

The new spun brightness of the sun on lake
Is too much for my morning prayer to take.
I pray You, cease, Beloved, unless You
wish

To unmake me before the banquet dish
Of Your new day upon a reeling world,
I pray You, cease before a life uncurled.

7 Then He showed me, indeed, the Lord
Stood on a wall plumb with a cord
In His hand. 8 And YHWH said to me,
"Amos, *now* what it is that you see?"
And I said, "A plumb line." Then He,
The Lord said "Indeed, I am setting
A plumb line for Israel's abetting,
I'll not pass by them anymore.
9 The high places of Isaac's *shore*
Shall be deserted, and the tents
Of Israel shall be indigence.
I'll rise with the sword on the house
Of Jeroboam *and his spouse*."

Beloved, lift up Your splitting sword on
me,

And raise a plumb line that my eyes may see

What wall is broken, bent and purposely
Left out of joint. Beloved, cast up the stone
On which Your law is written, Yours alone.
And I shall look out from my fortress cleft
Upon the sterile land caught and bereft,
And in that vision find a straighter steel
To mark my words and deeds and fix my heel.

Pass me not by, Beloved, stretch out the line

Of Your commandments, spill out the design

That would forebear to build Your temple right.

And I shall find a tent straight and alight
With guidance from Your hand to meet the fight.

10 Then Amaziah priest of Bethel
Sent to Jeroboam king *lethal*
Of Israel, saying "Amos here
Conspires against you without peer
In Israel's house. The land is not
Able to bear his words *in plot*."

Ha! I have heard as much to raise my head
Upon the shame of righteous blood when shed,

To hear the accusation of well-bred
Poured on me too. Yet I have little done
In favour of Your law, Beloved, when sun
Sets in the glowing west. My foil is spun
Of a word spoken and a silence wrought
Before the engines of a battle fought.
The land cannot stand before feeble plot
Of quietly doing what You have sought
To reveal in ten words. I know the glow,
I know the retribution's steel and show.
Beloved, in silent prayer I meet with You
And cast behind my back the State and pew.

11 "For so Amos has said 'Let die
Jeroboam by sword, *or try*,
And Israel surely shall be led
Away captive from their own bed.'"

So I too say, the president and those
Who follow their rock music and their shows

Of worship in the square and in the throes
Of dying churches, all shall perish truly.
Your judgement comes on all the world and duly.

The sword shall slay the one who raises it,
Even if You, Beloved, have seen it fit
To raise the State in order and to keep
The robber from disturbing peaceful sleep,
The murderer from coming round to peep.
The Bible Belt shall give up from their beds

The preachers who have soiled them with their shreds

Of righteousness to be dealt with by fire.
Indeed, captivity shall gain its hire.

12 Then Amaziah said to Amos:
"Go out, you seer! *and do not blame us*,
But flee to the land of Judah.
There eat bread, and cast spells for awe.
13 But never again prophesy
At Bethel, for it's the king's sty,
And it's the royal residence,
Where there should not be your presence."

I too have been cast out of pulpit and
Pew, I too have gone out upon the land
To cantillate Your Word on every hand,
In church and synagogue and mosque-ly stand,

And even in the temple where the crew
Of idols waits for worshippers to view.
I too have eaten bread in Judah's hills,
Appalled by the dry rocks with which it fills

The sky as far as lowly Jericho.
I too have been called aside from the show
And asked not to prophesy in the glow
Of ancient Hebrew syllables, but sing
Contemporary Christian posturing.

14 Then Amos answered, and he said
To Amaziah, "*I was led*
As no prophet, nor *was* I son
Of a prophet *when I'd begun*,
But *I was* a herdsman and tender
Of sycamore figs *for the vendor*."

Your prophet Amos, tender of such figs
Led a life of hardship not fit for pigs.
To make such fruit come on takes careful pricks

For each piece of small fruit worth hardly
sticks.

There is no toil today of such profile,
So lowly and so arduous in style,
Requiring patience and skill without due
Recompense for the task. Amos in view
Is pastor who ekes out a living far
Below the poverty line, not a star.
Beloved, I'd send a tithe to Amos now
To feed a paunch, but it's too late, I trow.
No doubt he would not take my charity,
For fear I might impinge on liberty.

15 Then YHWH took me as by the flock
I followed on *from rock to rock*,
And YHWH said to me, 'Prophesy
Go to My folk Israel, *please try*.'

16 Now therefore, hear the word of
YHWH:

You say, 'Do not prophesy true
Against Israel, and do not rant
Against house of Isaac *with cant*.'

17 "Therefore says YHWH, 'Your wife
shall be

A harlot in the great city,
Your sons and daughters shall fall by
The sword, Your land shall be by spy
Divided by the line, and you
Shall die in a defiled land's *crew*,
And Israel surely shall be led
Away captive from his own bed.'"

Beloved, I too for decade past my prime
Prophesied to Your folk in Hebrew rhyme,
And saw them turn away to whoredom's
bright

Stanzas couched in rock music for the
fight.

They die before my noble prophecy
In spirit before dying bodily.
The empty shell of worship on the stair
Still meets the Sabbath crown and holy air.
But famished for Your Word, its melodies
Bright on the tongue and filled with sights
to please,

The worshipper brought justly to his knees
Goes down unjustified because his pleas
Where sent to Baal and Ashtoreth with
gifts.

Alone I sing the Torah. Heart uplifts.

Amos 8

1 So the Lord YHWH showed me, indeed,
A basket of summer fruit *feed*.

2 He said, "Amos, what do you see?"

I said, "Summer fruit *from the tree*."

Then YHWH said to me, "The end's come
Upon My people *burdensome*,
Israel, I'll not pass by them more.

3 Their temple songs shall be howling
In that day," says the Lord YHWH, "for
Many dead bodies *there to sing*
They shall be thrown out in silence."

4 Hear this, you who swallow *presents*
To the needy, and make the poor
Of the land fail, 5 saying "When will
The first day of the month be past,
That we may sell corn *for the still?*

And the Sabbath, that we may trade
Grain? Making the ephah small *grade*,
The shekel large, to falsify

The scales by *our* deceit *and lie*,

6 That we may buy the poor for *naught*
In silver, and the needy for
A pair of sandals, what is more
Sell the bad wheat cut in the blast?"

Pretence of spirituality gains
The governance of institutions' reins
In all times and climes by the same means
that

Do the rituals while remaining fat
On the oppression of the poor and on
The grasping greed at evening, noon, and
dawn.

Who whirl in sacrifice while eating bread
Snatched from the poor, find that the song
that's said

Becomes the melodies of Baal and cry
That blast a burnished and an empty sky.
For that the rite continues and the breast
Is filled with love and prayers to beat the
best.

Beloved, deliver me from what I think
Is lovely music, lovely bread and drink.

7 YHWH has sworn by the pride *He taught*
To Jacob, "Surely I shall not

Forget any of their works brought.

8 Shall not the land tremble at last,
For this, and all mourn who live there?
All of it shall swell like the flood,
Heave and subside like Egypt's mud.
9 "And it shall come to pass that day,"

Says the Lord YHWH, "That I'll betray
 The sun and make it sink at fair
 Noon, darken the earth in daylight,
 10 I'll turn your feasts *before your sight*
 Into wailing, and all your songs
 Into lamentation *for wrongs*,
 I'll bring sackcloth on every waist,
 And baldness on each head *in haste*,
 Like mourning for an only child,
 The end like a day bitter, *wild*.

The popular faith comes in thousands of
 Bright candy wrappers, each distinct in
 love,
 But having at the heart one condiment,
 The daylight darkened for a false faith sent.
 Despite the different colours of the
 wrapping,
 It's all one faith betrayed by the same
 tapping
 And slapping of the drums that beat the
 rate.
 Who mentions it is howling finds the hate
 That was parading as love at his gate.
 Beloved, I take instead that Jacob's pride
 That sings upon Your words and multiplied
 In every syllable of the Four Books,
 Which are enough for sacred sound and
 looks,
 To keep me whirling, whirling at Your
 side.

11 "Indeed, the days are coming *soon*,"
 Says the Lord YHWH, "That I'll lampoon
 The land with famine, not of bread,
 Nor a thirst for water, but read
 And heard words of YHWH. 12 They shall
 go
 From sea to sea, and *not be slow*
 From north to east, run to and fro,
 Seeking the word of YHWH, but not
 Find it. 13 "In that day the *besot*
And fair virgins and strong young men
Shall faint from thirsty regimen.
 14 Those who swear by Samaria's sin,
 Who say 'As your god lives *within*,
 O Dan!' And 'As Beersheba's way
 Lives!' They'll fall not to rise *and play*."

As You dwell in the praise of Israel
 And not in temple made by hands and well,
 So every false god also dwells within

The songs sung by Samaria for sin.
 The rhythm and the beat and melody
 Call home the wandering god to hearth to
 be
 The ruler of that place where his song's
 sung,
 No need to set his name upon the tongue.
 I've see the teenage girls as well as young
 Men faint in ecstasy before the blast
 Of that wailed rhythm. Beloved, let me last
 In firm and grateful recitation cast
 In the same melodies Your ancient Word
 Still takes to live and feed, though all eat
 turd.

Amos 9

1 I saw the Lord stand by the place
 Of slaughter, He spoke *to my face*
 "Strike the doorposts, that the thresholds
 May shake, and break them on the *folds*
Of all their heads, for I shall slay
 The last of them with sword *and fray*.
 Who flees them shall not get away,
 He who escapes them shall not be
 Delivered. 2 "Though they dig *on spree*
As far as hell, from there my hand
 Shall take them, *even* though they stand
 To climb up to heaven, from there
 I shall bring them down, *as I swear*,
 3 And though they hide themselves on top
 Of Carmel, from there I'll *not stop*
 But search and take them, though they hide
 From My sight at the bottom *side*
 Of the sea, from there I'll command
 The serpent, it shall bite *their hand*,
 4 Though they go in captivity
 Before their *unsought* enemy,
 From there I will command the sword,
 And it shall slay them *for reward*.
 I'll set My eyes on them for harm
 And not for good, but *for alarm*."

I cannot hide from You, Beloved, who see
 The depths of my heart from eternity.
 If I flee from Your face I cannot bear,
 I turn away from You and find You there.
 In whirling in my haste to get away,
 I run from You to You and find the way
 Of Your wrath and Your love of the same
 pay.
 But slay me with no sword from the
 outside,

Nor with a serpent dragon from inside,
But extirpate my nimble soul in flight
That there remain only the Soul in sight.
See eye on me for harm indeed and right,
And I shall be at rest in You by day,
And every night give only You the sway.

5 The Lord YHWH of hosts, He who
touches

The earth and it melts *in His clutches*,
And all of *them* who live there mourn,
All of it shall swell like the storm,
And subside like Egyptian Nile.

6 Who builds His layers for a while
In the sky, has founded His strata
In the earth, who calls for the water
Of the sea, pours it out upon
The face of the earth, YHWH *is drawn*
To be His name. 7 “Are you not like
The people of Cush in my strike,
O children of Israel?” says YHWH.

“Did I not bring up Israel *too*
From the land of Egypt, *also*
The Philistines from Caphtor, show
The Syrians *the way* from Kir?
8 “Indeed, the eyes of the Lord YHWH
Are on the sinful kingdom’s rear,
And I’ll destroy it from the face
Of the earth, yet I’ll leave a trace
Of the house of Jacob,” Says YHWH.

Ah my Beloved, since I am Philistine
And Ethiopian, I do not pine.
As You have loved Israel in their time,
So You have loved my dark-skinned pagan
rhyme.

As You have led the bondman to be free
Of Egypt’s yoke, so too have You led me.
Look on the sinful kingdom that I hold
Despite my willingness to travel bold,
Destroy it from my heart and hand and eye,
And leave only the trace to multiply
That is Your grace to Jacob who set out
To live and love despite his spoiling doubt.
Beloved, look on this whirling soul for
good

And lead me whirling, whirling as I should.

9 “For surely I’ll command, and sift
The house of Israel *in short shrift*
Among all nations, as *corn*’s sifted
In a sieve, not the smallest *lifted*

Grain shall fall to the ground. 10 But all
My people’s sinners hear the call
Of death by the sword, those who say,
‘Calamity’ll not come our way.’

11 “On that day I shall raise the tent
Of David, which has fallen rent,
And fix its damage, I will raise
Up its ruins, as in the days
Of old I shall rebuild it 12 that
They may possess the remnant *fat*
Of Edom, all the Gentiles who
Are called unto My name,” says YHWH
Who does this thing. 13 “Indeed, the days
Are coming,” says YHWH, “When the
plough

Shall overtake the reaper’s *brow*,
The treader of grapes him who sows
Seed, mountains shall drip *as it goes*
With sweet grape juice, and all the hills
Shall flow *with it*. 14 *Against all ills*
I shall bring back the captives of
My people Israel, *whom I love*,
They shall build the waste cities and
Inhabit *them, by their own hand*
They shall plant vineyards and shall drink
Grape juice from them, shall also sink
Their gardens in the soil and eat
Fruit from them. 15 I will plant their *feet*
In their land, and no longer shall
They be pulled up *as prodigal*
From the land I give them,” says YHWH
Your God *in everything you do*.

Calamity give to whirl corn and vine!
But when calamity is done, design
To raise the tent of David in my place
So I may cantillate before Your face
The Psalms of David, tried and taught and
true
Which are the dwelling place of God and
YHWH.

For my sake that tent lies in tattered rags
While I prance round in fad designer tags.
Give me the woollen cloak worn sere and
bare
And take from me a living heart and where
You may again live on the chanting tongue
That sounds the ancient songs that David’s
sung.

And from that tent of David I shall rise
To whirl from seed to harvest in the skies.

Obadiah

Brother to Jeremiah in the message told,
So prophet Obadiah, not left out in the
cold,
Wreaks vengeance on the Edomites, and
lays
The question of both Spain and France's
days.
The words of Joel also echo clear
The message Obadiah still holds dear,
And both, like others, clamour in the hope
The Day of YHWH will rise and be a rope
Of righteousness upon an earth once caught
In doom of wickedness as though in plot.
Beloved, I touch the morning and the light
That Obadiah brings after the night,
And choose within the son of righteousness
And not the brother that brings his duress.

1 The vision of Obadiah.
So says the Lord YHWH *of the straw*
Of Edom, "We have heard *in awe*
A message from YHWH, and one's sent
As representative and meant
Among the nations: 'Get you up,
And let's attack her like a tup.'
2 "See, I make you small among folk,
And greatly despised at a stroke.
3 "Your heart's pride has deceived you
while
You live in the rock's clefts in style,
Your palaces on the high hills,
Saying in your heart for your thrills,
'Who'll bring me down to the ground's
chills?'
4 "Though you make your nest high to rate
Like that of eagles for your mate,
And though you set it with the stars,
I'll bring you down from there *in bars*,"
Says YHWH *when He comes to relate*.
5 If thieves came, robbers in the night,
How are you divided *in spite*,
Would they not steal all in their might?
If harvesters of grapes came in,
Would they not leave some in the bin?
6 How is Esau examined now!
In sight his hidden place's row!
7 All the men of your federation
Have brought you to border of nation;
Those who were at peace with you stand

In your deception on the sand
To conquer you, and those who eat
Your very bread set for your feet
A snare, and you don't see retreat.

A mountain man is always proud and free,
And looks down from the heights on the
valley,
And thanks his lucky stars he came to be
A mountain man, one free and always
proud.
I too remember how Point Mountain's
frown
Was green before my eyes, before the town
Of Webster Springs, of its local renown,
A kingdom set against the shoving crowd.
Beloved, if Edom is a mountain crew,
I understand their patronizing view.
The West Virginian is a proud man too,
To stand both head and shoulders above
those
Who tread the mills and malls of lowland
toes,
Who bask on easy beaches in their rows.

8 "Shall I not in that day," says YHWH,
"Destroy Edom's wise men in crew,
And sight from Esau's mountain too?"
9 Your mighty men, O Teman, fear,
So in the end it will appear
All are cut off from the Mount *Seir*
Of Esau by slaughter *and tear*.
10 For violence you perpetrated
On your brother Jacob instated
Shame shall cover you, and you'll be
Cut off always, eternally.
11 The day you stood apart, the day
That strangers carried him away,
And foreigners came into play
In his gates and cast lots in sway
Upon Jerusalem, then you
Participated in that crew.
12 You should not have gazed on the day
Of your brother in time of sway
Of his disaster, nor rejoiced
Over Judah's folk come to hoist
Destruction, nor spoken proudly
In the distress *and in the spree*.
13 You should not have entered the gate
Of My folk on their day of fate,
You should not have stared at their rate
Of suffering made desolate,

Nor come to loot their gear and store
In the time that disaster tore.
14 Neither should you have stood beside
The road to catch those in the tide
Who tried to escape, nor should you
Have delivered up those in crew
That did remain that day of rue.

Not only Esau in the times gone past,
But recently, in European fast,
The looters came to take the wealth and
cast
It in their own bank vaults while owners
went
By cattle car to Auschwitz for a bent.
Not only Esau sat beside the road
To capture fleeing children with a goad,
But not so long ago Hungarian
And Frenchman joined the crew with evil
plan,
And caught a Jew or two to set in span
Of labour forced in captive court and can.
Beloved, if curses fall on Esau's head,
I know a few remaining in his stead
Who wait Your punishment, though
Christian spread.

15 For near rises the day of YHWH
Upon all nations, as you do
So then it shall be done to you.
Your dealing shall return upon
Your own head *and head of your spawn*.
16 For as you've drunk upon My mount
Of holiness, so shall the fount
Of all nations drink without end,
Indeed they shall drink all they send,
And it shall be as though they'd not
Ever existed on the plot.
17 But in the fortress mountain there
Shall be those that escape the care,
And it shall be holy, while room
Of Jacob shall possess their bloom.
18 And Jacob's house shall be a fire,
And Joseph's room flame *of desire*,
And Esau's house of straw for fuel,
And they shall kindle *in their pool*
And consume them, and there shall not
Be any left of Esau's plot,
For YHWH has spoken *and has taught*.
19 Those from the south shall come possess
The mountain of Esau's *address*,
And lowlanders, the Philistines,

Shall take the field of Ephraim's *vines*,
And the field of Samaria,
And Benjamin shall hold in claw
All Gilead. 20 Captivity
Of this band of Israel's sons *free*,
That are among the Canaanites,
Even to Zarephath in sights,
And prison of Jerusalem,
That is in Sepharad *and stem*,
Shall take the southern towns in hem.
21 Deliverers shall rise up in
The fortress hill to judge the sin
Of Esau's mountain, and the reign
Shall be to YHWH *on hill and plain*.

The golden rule is do as you'd have done,
And it's an ethic shining like the sun.
For judgement, though, it's opposite is true:
You'll feel in your own skin the sword you
drew.

Beloved, I take advice well spent and lent,
I take it all to heart, each word You sent.
I see results of Christian sort of rate,
That crucifying Middle Eastern mate
Brings nothing but more harm upon the
pate.

I turn from Roman power, Genevan fate,
And Lutheran let live the wicked skate
While calling innocent suffering deserved
For standing in the way when sinners
swerved.

Let me be done by as I've done and meant.

Jonah

The prophecy of Jonah is a tale
Couched as bare history that might avail,
Except resemblance to the pagan rite
Of three days for the resurrection's sight
And the sun pattern of the gourd as well
Suggest the mythological in spell.
Sweet Jesus seems to make a parallel,
Which may well be exact: he too was one
Whose story was over-covered and spun
According to the dying, resurrecting
God-men of Middle Eastern folks'
selecting.
But my Beloved, I love the final twist
Against the racist calling I have missed,
And even animals at last are kissed.

Jonah 1

1 There was a word of YHWH that came
To Jonah Amittai's son's claim,
To say: Get up and go your way
To Nineveh, great city's sway,
And shout against it, for their sin
Has come before Me *in a din*.

3 But Jonah got up then to flee
Into Tarshish, lest YHWH should see,
And went down to Joppa, and he
Found a ship to Tarshish *and free*,
And so he paid the fare and went
Down into it, to go as *meant*
To Tarshish so YHWH would not see.

4 But YHWH sent great wind on the sea,
And there was a fierce storm to be
Upon the waves, so that the ship
Was near to break up *on the slip*.

5 And so the sailors were afraid,
And prayer each man to his god made,
And threw out the cargo that weighed
The ship into the sea and stayed
To lighten it. But Jonah's *wreck*
Went to lie down under the deck
And he was fast asleep *and laid*.

6 The captain came to him and said,
"What's wrong with you here still in bed?
Get up and pray to your own God,
It may be God will take a prod
And think of us to save from dread."

7 They said to each other "Come now,
Let us cast lots to show the prow
For whose sake this calamity
Has come upon us *in the sea*."
So they cast lots and the lot fell
On Jonah *who had caused the spell*.

It seems that there are fish, and big enough,
To swallow up a man and one so tough,
So that is not a thing too wild to rough.
What makes me doubtful of this word and
stuff

Is that it rings as true the divination
Of every heathen folk and pagan nation.
In the name of the gods that You declared
Should not even be mentioned or repaired
They cast their lots, and You, Beloved, did
not

Come intervening in the wicked plot.
They meant to make a human sacrifice,
And that is something You do not think
nice.

Perhaps the Gospel word is right to say
Like Jonah from the cross three night and
day.

8 Then they asked him, "Tell us now,
please,
What made this evil hit our knees?
What is your work? Where are you from?
Your nationality in sum?

And of what people do you come?"
9 He answered them, "I'm a Hebrew,
And I'm a fearer of *Lord YHWH*,
The Alohim of heavenly *crew*,
Who made the sea and dry *land too*."

10 And so the men became afraid,
And said to him, "Why have you stayed
To do this?" For the men knew well
That he had fled from YHWH a spell,
Because he had blabbed that as well.

11 Then said they to him, "What shall we
Do to you then, so that the sea
May be calm for us?" For the sea
Was furious and was stormy.

12 And he said to them, "Take me up,
And throw me in the sea *like pup*,
And then the sea will calm for you,
For I know that for my sake *true*
This great storm has come down on you."

13 But still the men rowed hard to bring
It to the land, but failed the thing,
For the sea raged with tempesting.

14 So they prayed to YHWH and they said
"We beg you, O YHWH, as we're bred,
Don't let us die for this man's life,
And do not count us in the strife
Guilty of innocent blood rife,
For You, O YHWH, do as You've said."

I've often blamed the Christian for the bill
Of pagan commentary on the hill
Of Calvary in human sacrifice.

But here the heathen do not think it nice,
And try their best to avoid cross in sight,
While Jonah, Hebrew faithful, brings to
light

Expedience of crucifixion's bite.
The heathen pray to You not to accuse
Them when they resort to sacrifice' ruse.
Beloved, let me not blame the heathen crew
For human sacrifice, but rather You
And Your own people in the sacred pew.
The mess of mass is justified I think

By Jonah on the ship's tossing at brink.

15 They grabbed Jonah and threw him out
Into the sea, the sea *and shout*
Ceased from her raging *all about*.

16 The men feared YHWH exceedingly,
And offered sacrifice in fee
To YHWH and made their vows freely.

17 Now YHWH had prepared a great fish
To swallow Jonah up *in dish*.
And Jonah was in the fish belly
For three days and three nights *like jelly*.

The worship You accept, Beloved, I trash
As worthless as the charcoal and the ash:
The thought that any such catastrophe
Must be the fault of someone on a spree;
The divination in the heathen name
Of gods and goddesses You say are shame;
The execution of the sacrifice
Of humankind to atone for the nice;
The fearing You without the circumcision
And without rational in their decision;
The offerings of such sent up with prayers
Appealing to Your name upon the stairs
Of heathen vows. All this I here condemn.
And yet You take it all in stride and hem.

It's fine enough to rate upon the crew
Of ancient ships for superstitious view
That their calamity is the result
Of human action amid the tumult.
At least they took responsibility,
Even if they scapegoat calamity.
The world is now in greater storm and
crisis

Polluting and disturbing to suffice us,
And with the fair knowledge it is our fault,
We still do nothing to repair the malt.
We'd best follow example of those men
Who shipped a ship to Tarshish back again:
Throw overboard every oil company,
And go back to the sail and horse feet free.

Jonah 2

1 Then Jonah prayed to the Lord YHWH
His Alohim from fish's stew,
2 And said "I call for *what I felt*
Of my affliction and my welt
To YHWH, and He even hears me
Out of Sheol and its belly.
I cantillated *to rejoice*,

And You have come to hear my voice.

3 "For you had thrown me in the deep,
In the midst of the seas *to weep*,
And the floods came to surround me,
All Your billows and Your waves *free*
Passed and passed and passed over me.
4 "Then I said 'I'm cast from Your sight,
Yet I'll look toward Your temple bright.'

Some people say it matters not a whit
In which direction prayer is made to fit.
Others say prayer must be made to the east,
So in the church and synagogue at least.
Good Jonah in the belly of the fish
Was not prone to disobey divine wish
That prayer be made toward the holy
house,
Your temple, prayer made by a man or
mouse.

If even in the fish's belly he
Thought it worth trying to establish where
Your temple lay, in order to agree
To make his prayer correct and done with
care,
Then I today, cast on a further shore,
Turn to Your house, Beloved, and seek its
door.

5 The waters compassed me about,
Even to the point to make doubt
Of my survival. The deep closed
Me all around, the seaweeds posed
Around my head. 6 I went down to
Foundations that the mountains drew,
The bars of the earth kept me in
All the time, yet out of that bin
You brought up my life not to seem
Corruption, YHWH my Alohim.
7 When my soul fainted in me, I
Remembered YHWH, my prayer came
nigh

To You, into Your holy house.
8 Those who follow the lying grouse
Of idols leave their own mercy.
9 But I'll sacrifice to You by
The voice of thanksgiving, and I
Will pay my vow *and faithfully*.
Salvation is of YHWH to be."
10 And YHWH spoke to the fish, and it
Threw up Jonah and so he lit
Upon the dry *land from his fit*.

At last I find the true faith in this story
That started out to strike me as quite gory,
With human sacrifice and slaughtered goats
By mariners to keep afloat their boats.
The service of remembrance is not vain
When it's directed to Your name and reign,
And not to vanities decked out in praise
As gods and goddesses with names in
craze.

Beloved, though I am not set in the tomb
Of fish's belly, but the gallows room,
I too lift sacrifice, not one of doom,
But of thanksgiving's voice, until I find
Myself thrown on the beaches where I
mind
The shore is hallowed by the ice-plant
lined.

Jonah 3

1 YHWH's word came to Jonah again,
Saying 2 "Get up, go to the men
Of Nineveh, that great city,
And preach there what I give in fee."
3 So Jonah got up from his place
And went to Nineveh to race
According to the word of YHWH.
Now Nineveh was very great,
A city at three days' in rate.
4 And Jonah started at the gate
Of the city and went a day
And cantillated on the way,
Saying "In forty days' time then
Nineveh shall fall down again."
5 So the folk of Nineveh heard
And took Alohim at His word,
Proclaimed a fast, put on sackcloth,
From greatest to the least *in froth*.
6 For word came to Nineveh's king,
And he got up from his throne's thing
And put off his robe and put on
Sackcloth and sat in ashes *drawn*.
7 And he caused it to be proclaimed
And published through Nineveh famed
By the royal decree and great,
"Let neither man nor beast of late
Nor herd nor flock taste anything,
Let them not feed nor drink in ring,
8 "But let man and beast stand beneath
Sackcloth *for covering and wreath*,
And cry greatly to Alohim,
And let them all turn from the dream
And way of evil and also

From violence in their hands' show.
9 "For who can tell if Alohim
Will change His mind and turn the seam
Of His fierce wrath, so we shall not
Be destroyed *by our evil plot?*"
10 And Alohim saw what they did,
Turning from evil ways in bid,
And Alohim then changed His mind
Of evil that He had designed
And did not destroy *combed and vined*.

Repentance is enough to turn the rate
Of punishment even from pagan pate.
But beyond fasting and sackcloth come
late,

There must be leaving off the wicked act
And violence, and that is just a fact.
The pagan earth today might well repent
And thus avoid the evils that are sent
Upon the earth from each polluted tent.
But that repentance would entail that all
Of Your ten commandments set on the wall
Be kept down to the last and to the best,
That Sabbath too be given as the rest
That's not negotiable, for man and beast,
Not just for great, especially for least.

Jonah 4

1 Jonah was very displeased and
Angry about the countermand.
2 He prayed to YHWH and said "I pray
You, O YHWH, and what did I say
When I was still in my own land?
That's why I fled to Tarshish: for
I knew that You're a gracious El,
And merciful and slow before
Anger, and of great kindness' store,
And turn away from evil spell.
3 "Therefore now, YHWH, I pray You take
My life from me, and for my sake
It's better to die than to live."
4 Then YHWH said to him, "Now, what
give?
When you're so mad, do you do well?"
5 So Jonah went out of the town,
And sat at east side with a frown,
And made himself a shanty there,
And stayed under its shadow's share,
Till he might see what would become
Of the town *where he was a bum*.
6 And YHWH Alohim made a gourd
Grow up to cover Jonah's sward,

That it might be a shade for him
 To save him from his grief and grim.
 So Jonah was exceeding glad
 Because of the gourd's shade he had.
 7 But Alohim also prepared
 A worm when the morning repaired
 The next day, and it struck the gourd
 Which withered *as though cut by sword*.
 8 It happened when the sun came up,
 That Alohim prepared *like tup*
 A strong east wind, and the sun beat
 Down on Jonah's head and with heat
 So that he fainted, and he wished
 In his heart he might die *as squished*.
 9 And Alohim said to Jonah,
 "Do you do well in anger's claw
 Because of the gourd?" and he said
 "I do well to be mad as dead."
 10 Then said YHWH, "You had pity on
 The gourd, for which you had not spun
 Nor made it grow, that grew up in
 A night and perished in night's bin.
 11 "And should not I spare Nineveh,
 That great city in which the sway
 Of more than sixty thousand men
 Live that cannot discern again
 Between their right hand and their left,
 And also much cattle *bereft*?"

Beloved, You play with human feelings till
 The man is like to go crazy as Bill.
 The patience of Jonah is like to that
 Described for Job upon the righteous mat.
 You fling him in the sea, in fish's belly,
 Where he is three days without any telly
 Or radio, then throw him on the beach
 And tell him once more to go out and
 preach.
 And then You change Your mind and let
 him take
 The scoffing that accrues in mercy's wake.
 Beloved, it was no gourd that Jonah pitied.
 It was himself, outcast and unremitted.
 For that I don't forgive: I take the job
 In favour of animals worth a bob.

When Soma raised a wick, and Dagon sent
 A torso from his mouth as Jonah went,
 And sun rose from the park of night and
 lent
 To Riding Hood and grandma something
 spent

In belly of the wolf, You would invent
 A tale in the same vein of pagan rent.
 The gourd is no exception, but is made
 A parallel of the sun on parade,
 An allegory of the god's renown
 Before Nineveh had become a town.
 Beloved, the heathen story is a gain
 Over the Nehemiad, which in vain
 Is racist, not to speak of cattle where
 The divine judgement once had deigned to
 spare.

Micah

The scholars will admit three chapters are
 The writings of Micayah and a star,
 While chapters four and five would best
 relate
 To post-exilic authors in a state.
 But six and seven seem to them unlike
 Because they are not racist for a strike.
 So this is writing typical to show
 How ancient texts are reworked on the go
 To provide for new needs after the show.
 Beloved, You know who wrote and when
 and why,
 And keep Your secret from the wise on sly.
 I find the universal grace You give
 In the heart of this book makes me to live,
 And makes me reach above me to the sky.

Micah 1

1 The word of YHWH come to Micah
 The Morasthite in days of awe
 Of Jotham, Ahaz, Hezekiah,
 Kings of Judah, which he saw *higher*
 Concerning Samaria and *nigher*
 Jerusalem, *some visions dire*.
 2 Hear, all you people; listen, earth,
 And all who dwell within its girth,
 And let the Lord YHWH witness yet
 Against you, the Lord who is set
 In His holy temple *of fire*.
 3 For see, YHWH comes out of His place,
 And will come down, and tread with grace
 Upon the high places of earth.
 4 The mountains shall melt under Him,
 The valleys shall be slip and slim
 As wax before the fire, in rush
 As of waters poured out to crush
 From a steep place *and at its rim*.

5 For the transgression of Jacob
 Is all this, and for the sins' hub
 Of Israel's house. What is the sin
 Of Jacob in Samaria's din?
 And what the high places of Judah?
 Are they not Jerusalem *ruder*?
 6 Therefore I'll make Samaria
 As a heap of the field in straw,
 As plantings of a vineyard, and
 I'll pour down the stones on the strand
 And make bare its foundations stand.
 7 And all its graven images
 Shall be beaten and crushed *in fizz*,
 And all the rents of it shall be
 Burned with the fire, all idols' spree
 I shall lay waste and desolate,
 For she gathered a harlot's rate,
 And shall return into that state.

Beloved, I so rejoice in Micah's words,
 Because I love to see the idols turds
 Crushed in the wake of judgement You
 have set.

I love the vengeance You pour on the pet.
 A heap of stones lies in Samaria,
 And rent and burnt monument at the draw
 On high places, and I rejoice and sing
 The Psalms of precious David, who was
 king.

Beloved, in ecstasy I seek the straw
 Of fields between Jerusalem and fat
 Samaria. I find there for all that
 The burgeoning of green, though winter
 pales,
 The filling out of nimbus and new sails,
 All poised in pregnant silence before gales.

8 Therefore I'll wail, therefore I'll howl,
 I'll go stripped naked without towel,
 I'll make like dragons' wailing and
 Mourning as owls *upon the land*.

9 For her wound is incurable;
 For it's come into Judah full;
 He's come into My people's gate,
 Even to Jerusalem *late*.

10 Do not tell it in Gath, don't weep
 At all; in Aphrah's house to keep
 Roll yourself in the dustbin's heap.

11 Pass by, Saphir's inhabitant,
 With your shame bared, inhabitant
 Of *weighted* Zaanan did not come
 Out in Bethazel's mourning *dun*,

He'll get from you his standing *won*.
 12 For Maroth's dweller waited well
 For good, but evil *rose in spell*
 Come down from YHWH into the gate
 Of Jerusalem's *fair estate*.

13 O you, dweller of Lachish, bind
 The chariot to the swift hind,
 She's the start of the wickedness
 To Zion's daughter: to transgress
 Israel was found in your address.
 14 Therefore you'll give in aftermath
 Presents and gifts to Moresethgath:
 The houses of Achzib a lie
 To the kings of Israel *for fie*.

15 Yet I will bring an heir to you,
 Dweller of Mareshah in view,
 He shall come into Adullam,
 The glory of Israel *in scam*.
 16 Pull out your hair for the sweet waifs,
 Increase baldness as eagle strafes,
 For they've gone to captivity
 And wandered far from your country.

The prophet strips down naked, what a
 sight!

If he'd been a sweet Christian of the night,
 He would have been more modest, I
 declare.

Now he's exposed to every kind of air.
 Harness the horses, then, the chariot fast
 To take him far away from the repast
 Of Zion's daughter. She pulls out her hair
 To find that idols are no longer there.
 Beloved, hypocrisy is everywhere
 That men repose in false gods with their
 prayer.

Give me a faith that looks beyond the state
 Of skin and hair and eyes, that can relate
 To heart and righteousness beneath the veil,
 Or under sun laid bare. Give me chain mail.

Micah 2

1 Woe to those who invent the wrong,
 Devising in their bed a song,
 And when the light of morning comes
 They put in practice all their sums,
 Because their chance is to be strong.
 2 They covet fields and take by force,
 And houses too, taken of course,
 So they oppress both man and house,
 A man and his heritage dowse.
 3 That's why YHWH says, "See,

Against this clan I plan a spree
 From which you'll never save your necks,
 Nor go down proudly, the time wrecks.
 4 In that day take a parable,
 A cry of woe, and he said full,
 We have been completely destroyed,
 The lot of my folk He's deployed,
 How does He move against my sake,
 To apostate our fields in stake.
 5 So you will have none who will cast
 A line by lot in YHWH's crowd fast.

The time of Micah, though it may have
 been
 In the eighth century of Judah's din,
 Or in the night of Babylon to win
 Two hundred years later because of sin,
 Seems very like today. Today they still
 Steal land and houses from the poor to bill
 The bank a ton in profits and to fill
 The politicians pockets with the swill.
 Beloved, I've lived for decades on the
 earth,
 And seen a corner or two of its berth,
 And think that everywhere I come to rest
 The same thing meets the eye and hurts the
 breast.

I too have felt the sting of hopeless state
 And given up on justice being late.

6 Don't prophesy! say to those who
 Would prophesy, they'll not show cue
 To them, nor take the shame that's due.
 7 Does Jacob's house now cantillate:
 Has YHWH's spirit been circumscribed?
 Are these His doings? Don't relate
 My words to do good to the bribed
 To walk uprightly and not late?
 8 Just yesterday My people rose
 As enemy: you strip the clothes
 From confident passers-by and
 As those turning from battle's stand.
 9 The women of My folk you've thrown
 Out of their pleasant houses grown,
 From their offspring you take away
 My glory for ever in sway.
 10 Get up, leave, this is not your rest,
 Since with uncleanness to invest
 It shall destroy and spoil with zest.
 11 If one is going with the wind
 And falsehood to lie and so sinned,
 To say, "I'll prophesy to you

Of wine and liquor in your brew,"
 That one will be accepted by
 The folk as one to prophesy.
 12 I'll surely gather all of you,
 O Jacob, and summon in pew
 The remnant of Israel; and I
 Will put them to gather to spy
 Like sheep of Bozrah, as the flock
 In the midst of their fold in lock;
 They'll make a great noise when they rock.
 13 They've broken through and passed the
 gate,
 And have gone out not to be late,
 And their king shall pass before them,
 And YHWH passing at head of them.

The prophecy of Micah stands a chance.
 He said that prophets would be led to dance
 By those who wanted profits rather than
 The judgements messages in Micah's span.
 For the old men of feats in David's day
 It was enough to get a harp and play,
 And prophecy fell from the lips with
 power.

But in the times that Micah sees, an hour
 Of drinking wine and liquor, both well
 spent,

Is needed to get going in the vent.
 Beloved, despite the disappointment here
 That prophecy no longer can come near,
 Fact is the prophesying in the wake
 Of alcohol is popular in stake.

Micah 3

1 And I said "Listen, please, now chiefs
 Of Jacob, and princes in feoffs
 Of Israel; should you not know
 How to deal justly in the show?
 2 "You hate the good and love the bad;
 You flay the skin from what they had
 And flesh from off their bones below;
 3 "You also devour My folk's flesh,
 And skin them and break out afresh
 Against their bones and chop them up
 As though prepared for pot and cup.
 4 "And they shall cry to YHWH, but He
 Will not hear them, they will not see
 His face, because they have behaved
 Themselves in their doings depraved.
 5 "So says YHWH of prophets who made
 My people err, that bite waylaid
 With teeth and yet cry 'Peace! Islam!'

He does not put the message balm
In their mouths, and they still prepare
Rebellion against Him in war.

6 "So night to you shall be without
A vision, but dark in your doubt,
You'll not guess what will come before
The sun goes down upon the score
Of prophets and the day be dark.
7 "Ashamed shall be the seers and those
Divining confused in their rows,
The lay hand on their lips for all
Have no answer of God in call."

The many prophets that rise up today
To show the world the righteous light of
way
Are all impostors, that I know full well,
Simply because none come in Israel
After Muhammad on whom be Your peace.
For fourteen centuries prophecies cease.
A night without a vision, dark of doubt
Sweeps all around the world, inside and
out,
And yet the ancient words are fresh this
night
As any day in prophecy and bright.
Beloved, the divination in the dust
Performed by Muslims who for all their
rust
Should know better, is foul as any deed,
But not as foul as the war-market breed.

8 But truly I am full of power
By YHWH's spirit and judgement's hour,
And might to declare Jacob his
Transgression and Israel's sin's whiz.
9 Hear this, please, you chiefs of the house
Of Jacob, princes of the house
Of Israel, who hate justice,
Perverting all right *as in bliss*.
10 They build up the fortress with blood,
Jerusalem with evil stud.
11 Its chiefs judge for reward, its priests
Teach for a salary like beasts,
And prophets predict for the sum
Of money given to the bum;
And still they want to rely on
YHWH and say "Is not YHWH here
drawn?"

No evil comes on us at dawn."
12 So Zion for your sake shall be
Ploughed like a field and the city

Jerusalem become a heap,
And mountain of the house to weep
As the heights of the forest lea.

The fact is if Muhammad had not come
To save me from the Baptist sort of bum,
I might be preaching even now for pay
Instead of being hermit in the way.
A Baptist sort of Muslim's what I am.
I maintain duty to follow the scam
Of Scripture as I read it for myself,
Instead of following a priest or elf.
Beloved, I was set free from chains when
You
Called me to be among the Baptist crew,
So I shall not go back to chains when I
Find Scripture is broader than meets the
sky.

Micah 4

1 But in the last days it shall come
The mountain of YHWH's house shall hum
To mountaintops, and it shall be
Exalted above hills to see,
And folk shall flock to the city.
2 And many nations come and say
"Come let us go up now to pray
In YHWH's mountain and to the house
Of Alohim of Jacob, and
He'll teach us of His ways to stand
And we'll walk in His paths *like grouse*,
For from Zion shall the law go out,
And YHWH's word from Jerusalem.
3 And He shall judge among the hem
Of many folk, rebuke redoubt
Of strong nations far off with clout,
And they shall beat their swords into
Ploughs and their spears beaten *askew*
As pruning hooks; nation shall not
Lift up a sword against the lot
Of nation, neither shall they learn
War any more, and so adjourn.
4 But each of them shall sit beneath
His vine and under his fig wreath,
And none shall make any afraid;
The mouth of YHWH of hosts has said.
5 For all folk will walk every one
In the name of its own god spun,
And we will walk in name of YHWH
Our Alohim forever true.

Every folk has its god and that is right

When every nation follows in the light
 Of Your commandments, not to swear and
 fight,
 Not to commit adultery, not to steal,
 Nor lie, nor covet, but in woe and weal
 To honour parents and keep Sabbath day,
 So man and beast may rest and show the
 way
 That no man's power is limitless in due.
 All faiths are right when they point back to
 You.
 Let all men walk in each world faith until
 All hearts are knit in one and know the
 thrill
 Of vast return of every face before
 The divine throne from which each face in
 store
 Was sent out on the universal shore.

6 "In that day," says YHWH, "I will come
 Assembling the lame there to hum,
 Gather back those I've driven out,
 And her that I afflict devout.
 7 "I'll make the lame a remnant and
 The one cast off strong nation's band,
 And YHWH shall reign over them all
 In Mount Zion from now to call
 Forever in eternal stall."

Though every faith leads to Your throne at
 last,
 Not every faith is equal in the blast,
 Not every faith flies flag above half-mast.
 Because each faith keeps more than half of
 what
 You spoke on Sinai, each is more in glut
 Of good than evil. Yet the score must turn
 At last so every faith that some may spurn
 Redeems the way by their obedience
 Each under a fig tree or in their tents.
 Beloved, You reign from Zion and the
 mount
 Of every place that You have made a fount,
 From Sinai, from Samaria, and the tree
 Under which Ishmael left to die could see
 Zamzam burst forth to make the desert free.

8 And you, O tower of the flock,
 The fortress of Zion's spawn's rock,
 To you it will come, even that
 First power, the kingdom come out flat
 To daughter of Jerusalem.

9 Now, why do you should out aloud?
 A king, is there none in your crowd?
 Has your adviser failed in stem?
 Pains take you like labour in hem.
 10 Hurt and labour to bear the child,
 O daughter of the fortress wild,
 Like a woman in labour: for
 Now you'll go out the city's door,
 And you will stay there in the field,
 Go to Babylon unconcealed.
 11 Many nations come against you,
 Saying "Let her be spoiled in crew,
 And let us see the fortress due."
 12 But they don't know the thoughts of
 YHWH,
 Nor understand His counsel true;
 For He shall gather them apart
 As the sheaves of the floor to start.
 13 Get up and thresh, daughter of Zion;
 For I shall make your horn of iron,
 And I will make your hoofs of brass;
 And you shall crush people that pass,
 I and will consecrate their gain
 To YHWH and their wealth to the reign
 Of the Lord of the whole earth's train.

Given that even king and counsellor
 Could not fathom beforehand on the shore
 That Babylon would conquer Egypt's land
 And cast a plague upon the Pharaoh's hand,
 The scholar cannot fathom Micah could
 Reveal the thing as early as he should.
 And so they say some other hand came by
 After the fact to paint a painted sky.
 Beloved, You know all things, and that is
 true.
 And yet I say a wise man through and
 through
 Can sometimes tell the future as in view.
 The editors need only save in hand
 The ones that happened to be right and
 stand.
 The scholars are impoverished as a band.

Micah 5

1 Now gather yourself up in troops,
 O daughter of troop, where he stoops
 Against us; they shall strike the judge
 Of Israel on the cheek to budge
 With a rod. 2 But you, Bethlehem
 Ephrata, you are small in hem
 Of Judah's thousands, out of you

Shall he come forth to me as due
Ruler in Israel; and who
Has mandate from the ancient time,
From everlasting *and sublime*.

Can You believe, Beloved, that some take
fast

Hold of this text to claim it proves at last
That Jesus is eternal Son of God,
From everlasting Your word and Your rod?
The blindness of the human race I see
Is far beyond what can be righteously
Computed. Let poor Bethlehem restate
Its claim upon its steeper hills of late.
The prophecy was fulfilled long before
It had been written on the lovely shore
Of Judah. It was fulfilled in the reign
Of David righteous king, shepherd, and
fane.

Beloved, I follow on the glowing rod
Of Your authority, hold You as God.

3 That's why he will give them up till
The time of her labour's to fill;
Then the rest of his brother come
Back to Israel's folk at the drum.
4 And he shall stand and feed in strength
Of YHWH, in majesty at length
Of the name of YHWH Alohim;
And they shall stay, for now to seem
Great to the ends of earth in sum.
5 This man shall be our peace when come
Assyrian into our land;
And when he'll tread upon our grand
Palaces, then shall we raise up
Against seven shepherds a tup
And eight chief men all set to stand.
5 And they shall spoil Assyrian land
With the sword, also Nimrod's band
In its gates, so he shall save from
Assyrian, when he may come
Into our land and when he treads
Inside our borderlands with dreads.

The man from Bethlehem, the one that rose
According to Ezekiel in this throes
To reign eternally, David by name,
He is a man I take and for his fame.
Beloved, let David bear his sceptre now
At least upon my heart and on my brow,
While I still sing his Psalms. Then teach me
how

To cantillate above the lower claim.
Beloved, from Bethlehem the chains arise
In names of holy leaders You apprise
Down to the last, but all are caught in one,
The reign of David, since his reign is fun.
Assyrian and Nimrod stand and wait
To bow to David and to kiss their fate.

7 And what is left of Jacob shall
Be in the middle of the dale
As dew from YHWH, as showers on grass
That does not wait for man to pass
Nor sons of men. 8 The remnant of
Jacob shall be among the shove
Of Gentiles in the middle of
Many people as lion among
The beasts of the forest unsung,
As a young lion in the flocks
Of sheep; who if he goes through stalks,
Treads down, tears in pieces so none
Can save any from what he's done.
9 Your hand shall be lifted up on
Your adversaries, all the spawn
Of your foes shall be cut and drawn.
10 "It will happen that day," says YHWH,
"That I will cut your horses through,
And I'll destroy your chariots too.
11 "And I will cut towns from your land,
And cast down every fortress band.
12 "I'll cut witchcrafts out from your hand;
You'll have no soothsayers to stand.
13 "Your graven images also
I will cut off and so will stow
Your standing images from you;
And you shall no more worship crew
Produced in art of your own hand.
14 "I'll pull up your groves out of you,
And I'll destroy your towns in view.
15 "And I will execute vengeance
In anger and wrath on the dance
Of heathen, as never came true.

Beloved, the execution of Your power
Upon the proud of Israel in an hour
Because of their greedy idolatry
Is warning to my family and me.
The groves about me shield no idol set
In market or in engine to be met
With admiration and its worship here.
The groves about me shelter none of fear.
I walk among the trees and hear no sound
But that of bird and beast upon the ground,

And yet I know Your voice is soft and clear,
The proclamation like a cantileer
That You are one, no other comes to sit
On my heart's throne, no other god is fit.

Micah 6

1 Hear now what YHWH says: "Get up,
plead

Your cause before the maintains' *mead*,
Let the hills hear your voice decreed.

2 Hear, O you mountains, YHWH's
complaint,

And you, earth's strong footing's restraint,
For YHWH's got a bone for His folk,
And He'll lay on Israel a stroke.

3 "O My folk, how did I treat you?

And how is it I've wearied you?

Witness against Me what is true.

4 I've brought you up from Egypt's land,
Redeeming you from bandage' hand,
I sent before you Moses and
Aaron and Miriam to stand.

5 O My people, remember now

Balak the king of Moab's vow,

And what Balaam son of Beor

Answered him from the distant shore

Of Acacia Grove to Gilgal,

That you may know YHWH's righteous
sal."

The Prophet Micah gives the sense

In virtues, not in pounds and pence,

Of what the words of law define

As sheaf of corn and oil and wine.

By bread of growing grain is meant

Do justly, not expedient.

The oil is loving mercy, not

Mere feeding poor for what we're taught.

The sweet wine represents the prayer

That sees You walking everywhere.

The social justice of this time's

Expedience for fear of crimes.

The loving mercy in this place

Is charity's disdainful face.

6 With what shall I appear before

YHWH bowing myself to the floor

Before the high Alohims's store?

Shall I come to Him with the gift

Of burnt offerings as though to lift,

With calves of twelve months old to shift?

7 Will YHWH be pleased with myriads of
Rams or with ten thousands to shove

In streams of oil? Shall I give my

First-born for my transgression's cry,

My body's fruit for soul's sins high?

8 He has shown you, O man, what's good,

And what does YHWH require you should,

But to do justly, and to love

Mercy, and to walk hand in glove

With your Alohims *in the wood*?

The god that walks our city streets

Thinks all the world's the merest treats

To fatten human power and paunch

With heart disease and flabby haunch.

In disregard of holy matter

We just consume and just get fatter

Until no sacred thing is left,

Nothing survives unholy theft.

Not only Man is sacred but

Men in the plural, princess, slut,

Immoral men and men of strength,

Wise women, fools and tarts at length,

Both youth and age, both strong and weak,

Both silent and the ones who speak.

9 YHWH's voices cries to the city and

The wise one shall see Your name stand,

Hear then the rod and who appoints

The ones to stand that He anoints.

10 Are there still wicked treasures in

The house of the wicked for sin,

And lawless wealth of horrid skin?

11 Shall I count them pure with the weights

Of wicked balances in fates,

And with lead hollowed out in rates?

12 Rich men are filled with violence,

The dwellers speak lies from their tents,

Their tongue's deceitful in their rents.

13 "Therefore I'll also make *you* sick

By striking you *to make it stick*,

By making *you* waste place of bins

Because of you and all your sins.

All life is sacred, of one breath,

All things that wander on toward death.

And when the tree is turned to stone

It still is sacred soul and bone.

With sacredness the world is filled,

One holy, god-fed, secret guild.

There is no atom, carbon, gold

That is not a divine stronghold.

Beloved, though You are everywhere,
Though You rest in the foul and fair,
Still You are One and one apart
From all creation and from art.
In all, beyond, above, You are
And yet You set foot on this star.

14 You will eat but never be filled;
And you'll throw down what you have
 spilled;
You will take hold, but not deliver,
What you bring I shall be the giver
Of that to the sword *and untitled*.
15 You'll sow, but not reap, no nor dine,
You'll tread the olives and the vine,
But not anoint yourself with oil,
Sweet wine, but not drink of your toil.
16 For statutes of Omri are kept, All
The works of Ahab's house *are swept*,
And you walk in their counsels too,
That I may make desert of you,
And your inhabitants a shame.
So you'll bear My folk's lot of shame."

We know not that in truth we're holy,
All races, creeds, both great and lowly,
And so in ignorance we're spent
And wasted with our own consent
Who should have worshipped You alone
And had a glory of our own.
For lack of bread and oil and wine
I must seduce the asinine.
The bread and oil and wine must feed
My body-soul on her black steed.
They are a tree of life that grows
Such sephiroth that no one knows.
They are expressed in ten bright words
That flash with Sinai's red storm-birds.

Micah 7

1 Woe to me! for I am as when
They gathered summer fruits again,
As the grape gleanings at the time
Of vintage; no cluster for dime
To eat; my soul desired the first
Ripe fruit, *and here I sit one cursed*.
2 The good man's perished from the earth;
There are none upright in their berth,
They all lie in ambush for blood,
Hunting each one with net in stud.
3 For evil, both hands do suffice.
The prince asks, and the judge in trice,

For recompense, and the great too
Demand fulfilment of the due
Of their desires, and keep the cue.
4 The best of them is just a brier;
The most upright than thorn hedge higher;
The day of your watchmen appears,
Your visitation comes in fears,
Now shall they be troubled arrears.
5 Don't trust a friend, nor put in guide
Your confidence, but set aside,
Keep the doors of your mouth from her
Who lies upon your breast to stir.
6 For the son dishonours his dad,
The daughter rises from her pad
Against her mother, and son's wife
Against his mother in the strife,
A man's foes are of his own rife.

The first commandment in apostasy
Is the dishonour any man can flee:
Dishonour to the mother and the dad
Who bore the babe and saved from every
 bad.

The first commandment that men must
 decline

Is that: they're sure in pagan form and
 shrine

That justice demands everyone must earn
The honour that is due to family urn.
If one must earn that honour, then the foil
Has gone back to the jungle law to spoil.
Confucius knew the fact, even the Tao
Follows the flow of that pattern somehow.
Beloved, let me and mine keep every law
That You have spoken and avoid the claw.

7 Therefore I will look up to YHWH;
I'll wait for Alohim in view
Of my salvation, and my God
Will hear *me praying on the sod*.

8 Rejoice not against me, O foe,
When I fall, I'll get up and go;
When I sit in the darkness, YHWH,
Shall be a light upon my view.

9 I'll bear the wrath of YHWH since I
Have sinned against Him *on the fly*,
Until He pleads my case and sits
In judgement for me *when it fits*;
He'll bring me out to light and I
Shall see His righteousness *go by*.

10 And my foe shall see, be ashamed
For saying to me as though blamed,

"Where is YHWH your Alohim now?

My eyes shall behold her, and now
She'll be trodden down in the mud
Of the streets *covered with the flood*.

11 I the day that your walls are built,
That day the decree will be spilt.

12 In that day also he shall come
To you from the Assyrian hum,
And fortified towns from the fort
As far as the river for sport,

From sea to sea, from hill to hill,
13 And the ground that's been desert rill,
Because of its inhabitants,
For the results of all their rants.

You are my light, Beloved, here where I sit
Rejected by the brave, the proud, the fit.
You are my light, Beloved, beneath the
shade

Of rowan where in winter on parade
A banquet's set of berries for the crew
Of angels tufted that await on You.
You are my light, Beloved, in darkness set,
In a land where the pagan wrath is met
And law and faith are bartered and
betrayed.

You are my light, Beloved, though I'm
waylaid

By each adherent of the faiths You made.
But light is all I need when I am paid
In manna daily where You show Your hand
To pilgrims wandering in a desert land.

14 So see your people with your rod,
The flock of you heritage pod,
Who dwell alone and in the wood,
In the midst of Carmel *for good*,
Let them feel in Bashan and in
Gilead as in old days' *din*.

15 According to the days you came
Out of the land of Egypt *lame*,
I'll show him wonders *in the game*.

16 The nations see and are ashamed
Of all their power, they lay *as blamed*
Hand on mouth, turn their ears *enflamed*.

17 They'll lick the dust like serpents, they
Shall move out of their holes away
Like worms of the earth, they shall be
In fear of YHWH our Alohim,
And be afraid of what you seem.

18 Who's an alohim like You are,
Who pardons all iniquity,

And passes by transgressions' bar
For the rest of His heritage?

He is not always angry for
He delights in mercy far more.

19 He'll turn back and He'll pity us,
He puts away our sinful fuss,
Casting their sins into the sea.

20 You'll give truth to Jacob, mercy
To Abraham, as You have sworn
To our dads before we were born.

Who is indeed a god like You, Beloved,
Among the armoured and the armour-
gloved?

Though steel may bear the brunt of some
attack,

Compared to You, each great one with
bared back

Returns upon his heels to spite the dust.
All fall at last but You, Beloved, who must.
Who can indeed pardon the sins gone past
But You? Even the Christian at repast
Knows well it takes a miracle of power,
Though he mistakes the task upon an hour
Of crosses and of resurrection's scour.
Who is a god like You, Beloved, to stand
Upon the raging sea, upon the land?
None can compare, none pardon can
remand.

Nahum

The seventh minor prophet came to write
In seventh century of You and spite.
The slot is filled by Musa l-Kadhim too,
The seventh Imam in the Shi'ite view.
The name means comfort, and if comfort's
due

From absolute in vengeance on the ones
Who were forgiven once, then in their tons
Apostatized, good name for prophet's stew.
Beloved, I hear the cadence of the verse
Call down on Nineveh the judgement's
course,

I hear the call at last of grace bestowed
On remnant faithful in a higher ode.
And so I take the double message load
Knowing that in the end I could do worse.

Nahum 1

Nineveh's burden, and the book

Of Nahum the Elkoshite's look.
 2 El's jealous, YHWH revenges; YHWH
 Revenges with fury undue;
 YHWH will take vengeance on His foes,
 From reserves for enemies' woes.
 3 YHWH's slow to anger, great in power,
 He'll not acquit in just an hour;
 YHWH has ways in whirlwind and storm,
 The clouds are His feet's dust in bourn.
 4 He rebukes the sea, makes it dry,
 He dried up all the rivers nigh;
 Bashan languishes and Carmel,
 The blossom of Lebanon fell.
 5 The mountains tremble at His sight,
 The hills melt and the earth with might
 Is burned from before His face, yea,
 The world all that in it stay.
 6 Who can remain before His wrath?
 Who abide His anger's fierce path?
 His fury's poured out like the fire,
 The rocks thrown down before His ire.
 7 YHWH's good, a strong hold in the day
 Of trouble, and He knows the way
 Of those confiding in His sway.
 8 But with an overrunning flood
 He will make utter end of stud,
 And darkness shall pursue His foes.

The first Psalm's quoted almost in the term
 Of Your knowing the way that those affirm
 Who set their confidence in Your great
 power,
 The goodness that You show from hour to
 hour.

The two ways there too form the watershed
 Between the righteous path and that one
 spread

Out for destruction. In the running flood
 A contrast appears with the Psalm for mud.
 Beloved, the fierce wrath is a thing indeed
 That Nahum is so vivid I must heed.
 The mountains tremble, and the hills are
 made

To skip about as if they were dismayed.
 The thunder is Your voice Sinai displayed,
 And that is what I hear in all my greed.

9 What do we devise against YHWH?

An end He makes, never in view
 Shall rise again affliction's *stew*.

10 For while they enclose as the thorns,

And while they're drunk and drunkards'
 horns,
 They'll be consumed like dry straw goes.
 11 Out of you shall come a device
 Against YHWH in counsel of vice.
 12 So says YHWH: "Though complete in
 all,

Still they've been cut off at the fall,
 And he shall pass away in thrall.
 Though I've afflicted you, Now I
 Shall never more afflict your *eye*.

13 "And now I break his rod from you,
 And your bands I draw off from view.

14 "And YHWH has given a command
 Regarding you, no more in land
 Shall your name be sown, from the house
 Of your gods I will cut and douse
 The graven image, molten too:

I'll make a grave for your vile crew."

15 See on the mountains the feet of
 One bringing good news from above,
 To declare peace, O Judah and
 To keep you solemn feasts at hand,
 Perform your vows, for evil man
 Shall no more pass through you in span,
 He's utterly cut off *from plan*.

I've come to expect You to rage in ire
 Against idolatry and such desire,
 But rarely do You rage against the drunk
 Laid out or stumbling past when in a funk.
 Let every priest that blesses wine take
 heed,

And every soul that drinks his staff with
 greed,

For Nahum's word apply to sacrifice
 To trinities of gods as to the nice
 Sweet wine that represents their blood in
 trice.

The tinkling of the bell comes to blaspheme
 The prophecy of Nahum and his dream.
 Declare Your peace, Beloved, declare
 Islam

Without a qualm, in calm, more soothing
 balm,

And richer at the core than it may seem.

Nahum 2

1 He who scatters comes up before
 Your face, so man the fort! What's more
 Keep watch upon the road! Make strong
 The flanks! And fortify *along*

Your forces mightily. 2 For YHWH
 Will restore Jacob's excellence,
 Like Israel's fineness *He shall do*,
 For those who empty have cast hence
 And ruined the branches of their vine.
 3 The shields of his mighty men *fine*
Are made red, and the valiant men
Are dressed in scarlet, chariots *then*
 With flaming torches in the day
 Of his preparing, and betray
 Spears brandished, 4 And the chariots rage
 In the streets, jostle and engage
 In the broad roads, they seem like flames,
 They run like lightning *in their games*.
 5 He minds his nobles, in their walk
 They stumble, make haste to her stalk
 And walls, so the defence prepares.
 6 The gates of the rivers *and stairs*
 Are opened, the palace dissolved.
 7 It is decreed *and is resolved*:
 Captive she shall be led away,
 She shall be brought up *in that day*,
 And her maidservants shall lead *her*
 As with the voice of doves aver,
 Beating their breasts. 8 Though Nineveh
 Of old *was* like a pool *to stay*
 Of water, now they flee away.
 "Halt! Halt!" *they cry*, but none turns back.
 9 Take spoil of silver bric-a-brac!
 Take spoil of gold! *There is* no end
 Of treasure or wealth to expend,
 Muhammad's instruments in all.
 10 She's empty, desolate, and waste!
 The heart melts, knees shake *at the call*,
 Much pain's on every side, and all
 Their faces are colour *of paste*.

Through generations Israel's folk remained
 Desirous of the coming one, sustained
 That hope through enemy attack, defeat,
 But when wealth and pride overwhelmed
 conceit,
 The prophet lays their fond gropes in the
 dust.
 The treasure has become a spoil that must
 Be given to another. Yet the hope
 Once wrenched away by grasping interlope
 Becomes the prey of all the populace
 Of earth dressed in woollen or silken lace.
 The fortress gates are broken down and
 free,
 The king's riches are scattered on the lee,

And You, Beloved, proclaimed to son and
 all
 One and alone, and by Muhammad's call.

11 Where is the dwelling place of lions,
 The feeding place of the young lions,
 Where the old lion walks and where
 The lion cup comes in to share
 Without fearing from anywhere?
 12 The lion tears in pieces what
 Its whelp must eat until the glut,
 Strangled for his mates, and he fills
 His holes with prey, his den with kills.
 13 "See, I am against you," says YHWH
 Of hosts, "and I will burn her chariots too
 In smoke, and the sword shall devour
 Your young lions, and in an hour
 I'll cut of your prey from the earth,
 And the voice of sent ones from berth
 Shall no more be heard in their dearth."

The lion was the symbol of the power
 Assyrians wielded in the world an hour.
 But Nahum uses it to cast a spell
 Of scorn upon the land and every swell.
 The lion of Judah is also known,
 And Ali is a lion before the throne
 Divine. Who knows how far back symbols
 go,
 And who the first one was who came to
 show
 The lion's deck. Beloved, I've seen the row
 Of symbols, eagles, bears, and even one
 Called donkey for his place under the sun.
 But of all symbols of Your strength and
 might,
 I find not one that remains my delight.
 I shed all signs and strive to find the own.

Nahum 3

1 A plague upon that blood-filled town!
 It's all full of lies *for renown*
 And robbery. *Its* victim sits.
 2 The noise of a whip *from the pits*,
 And noise of rattling wheels *in fits*,
 Of horses galloping along,
 Of chariots clattering *to wrong!*
 3 Horsemen charge with the glint of sword
 And sparkling spear *of one adored*.
 Pile upon pile of dead men killed,
 A mountain made of corpses filled,
 The tanks grind to a halt and stand,

And cannot drive across the land.

4 It's all because the fornication
Of the seducing whores in nation,
The madame and her sorceries,
Who sells nations through harlotries,
And families through sorceries.
5 "Indeed, I *am* against you *here*,"
Says YHWH of armies, "*Without fear*
I'll lift your skirts over your face,
I'll show the nations your disgrace
Of nakedness, people your shame.
6 "I'll throw abomination's filth
Upon you, and make vile your tilth,
Make you a spectacle for blame.
7 "All who see you will run away
From you, and all of them will say,
'Nineveh's laid to waste! And who
Will come to weep her due?'
Where shall I seek mourners for you?"

If I used Nahum's own vocabulary
I'd be met by the next constabulary.
I've always said the Lutheran state kept
A ritual striptease as part unswept
Of the faith and religion. That is seen
By the fact that such houses red and green
Are closed during the Sunday service while
They open for the sight and for the guile
When priests are off their tender. That may
be

To give the priests a chance to join the
spree.

Beloved, I volunteer to mourn the fate
Of Nineveh as well as Nordic state,
And weep that You are off the stage and
out

Of heart and mind though You may give a
shout.

8 Are you better than Ammon's No,
That dwelling among brooks that go?
Waters she's got around here there,
Whose shield's the sea, waters wall's share.

9 Ethiopia and Egypt stand
Her strength, and it indeed was grand;
Put and Lubim helpers at hand.

10 And still she was carried away,
She went into the captive way;
Her young offspring were dashed to death
In all the chief streets' shibboleth;
They cast lots for her honoured men,
Her great ones all in chains again.

11 You'll also be drunk, you shall hide,
You shall look for strength to abide
Because of the foe *at your side*.

All cities fall one day, it is the rule
That history teaches in every school.
Exception is the city now that reigns:
It only is eternal with its fanes.

The human myth in fine illusion brings
The merry shoppers with necklace and
rings,

With bobs piercing the tongue and naval
where

The wobble shows the wearer does not
care.

Beloved, there are no honoured men around
To cast lots for, they're all struck to the
ground

And gassed and burnt and scattered on the
air

To fall on land and sea and every stair.
Great ones in chains are never seen today,
But only drunken, not hiding away.

12 All your forts like fig trees that bear
The first-ripe figs; if shaken there
They fall onto the eater's tongue.

13 See, your folk in your midst are strung
Like women; the gates of your land
Shall be set wide open to stand
Before your enemies; the fire
Shall consume your bars in its ire.

14 Draw water for the siege, make strong
Your forts, go into the clay long
And tread the mortar, make the blocks
In the brick kiln *and fill the stocks*.

15 There to consume you is the fire;
For cutting you the sword of ire,
It shall consume you like the worm,
Make yourself heavy as the firm
Cankerworm, heavy *in the pyre*
Before the locust of *desire*.

16 You've multiplied your merchantmen
Above the stars of the sky's ken;
The cankerworm comes in to spoil,
Then flies away *before the toil*.

17 Your guards are like the locusts come,
Your captains like grasshoppers hum,
That camp in hedges from the cold,
But when the sun comes up as bold
They flee away, and their place told
Is not known at all in the fold.

18 Your shepherds slumber, O king of
Assyria, your nobles shove,
Your folk is gone and scatter on
The mountains where no man is drawn.
19 There is no healing of your bruise,
You wound is sore, all those who use
To hear your noise shall clap their hands
In glee to celebrate your bands,
For who has not suffered beneath
Your biding wickedness in wreath?

The fig tree is always the one to curse.
Even sweet Jesus found it was the worse
And struck it with a spell to wither where
No hidden streams appear to give its share.
My own granddad planted some fig trees
too,
And they bore some fruit before he joined
crew
Of buried resting ones at the curfew.
I know the taste of figs, I taste with care.
Beloved, if Nineveh casts out her own
Like figs into the mouth to fall like stone
Behind the teeth of raging eater, I
Also open my mouth wide for a try.
Maybe a benefit of treats will fly
Into my gullet from the craven throne.

Habakkuk

Nobody knows for sure if Habakkuk
Is the son born to one who came to look
To Elisha for help, the Shunemite.
At any rate he raises up in sight
The question why the good sink down in
fright,
While wicked ones attack them without law
And without recourse to justice or claw.
The only answer that the prophet gives
Is that You are just to each one that lives,
And in Your time or Your eternity
All things shall be made right and all made
free.
Beloved, that question still burns in the
heart
Of atheist and faithful from the start,
An argument against You on their part.

Habakkuk 1

1 The burden that Habakkuk saw
As prophet without a faux-pas.

2 YHWH, how long shall I cry, and you
Will not hear my complaint in view
Of violence, while You don't save?
3 Why do you show me wicked wave
And make me see the grief like grave?
For spoil and violence by me
Raise up strife and contention's fee.
4 That's why law ceases and judgement
Never goes forth in right intent;
Since wicked take the upper hand
Above the righteous in the land
And so wrong judgement is present.

If Ali Riddha, the eighth in the line,
Is like Habakkuk sitting under vine,
He too might make complaint usurper takes
The grape and leaves nothing for eaters'
sakes.

The wicked takes the upper hand in glee
And promises a restitution's fee
For future time, but that is all a foil,
A smokescreen to cover the coming spoil.
Beloved, I too have my experience
That tells me when I hear of love's
expense,

The next thing I know is the knife thrust in
The back, and my sinking before the din.
I run when love's proclaimed to save my
life,
And life of son and daughter, and of wife.

5 Look at the nations and behold
And marvel at the things untold,
For I'll do a work in your days
Which you will not believe for praise.
6 See, I'll raise up the Chaldeans,
That bitter, hasty nation's plans,
And they shall march throughout the land
To take houses not theirs in hand.
7 They're terrible and dreadful too,
Their judgement and their dignity
Shall go before them in the hue.
8 Their horses run faster than do
The leopards, and more fierce to see
Than wolves at evening; cavalry
Shall spread and horsemen come from far
To fly like eagles to the bar.
9 They shall come all for violence;
Their faces swallowing the tents
Of the east wind, to gather like
The sand captivity *to strike*.
10 They'll scoff at kings and princes be

A scorn to them, they shall deride
Every strong fortress that they see,
For they'll heap dust and so abide.
11 Then passed on will the spirit, and
He shall transgress, ascribe the hand
Of his power to his god's stand.

The prophets whose writings were stored
away
And kept safe and aground for rainy day
Were those who in minority laid bare
Prediction that Babylon had a share
In world empires to come. The other ones,
Though fawned upon by king in royal
sway,
Were cast out for their failure on their buns.
But truth of their fulfilment was too late
To save the nation from the evil fate,
Or save the prophets who were right from
all
The persecutions of the royal all.
It was too late for the most part to send
The false predictors to their deserved end.
Moral: stick with the royal hopes in stall.

12 Are you not from beginning, YHWH
My Alohim, Holy One due?
We shall not die. O YHWH, You've set
For them judgement that will be met,
O Rock, for reproof You will get.
13 Too pure are Your eyes to behold
The evil, You cannot enfold
Iniquity, then why do You
Regard their treachery undue,
And hold Your tongue when wicked men
Consume the righteous *in his den*?
14 Do You make men like ocean fish,
Like creeping things, without the wish
Or rulers? 15 They take up all those
With the angle, they catch their toes
In their net and gather them in
Their drag, and rejoice in the din.
16 So they sacrifice to their net,
And burn incense to their drag set;
Because by them their profit's fat
And their meat plenty in the vat.
17 Shall they therefore empty their net,
And stop always killing all met?

The truth is that it seems hazard of fate
Determines who succeeds and who is late.
Sometimes the wicked serve a curving ball

That sets the righteous out of house and
stall.
Sometimes the righteous perish and
sometimes
Live on in wealth and health and comely
rhymes.
The faith that what goes round always
comes back
Is not founded on empirical track.
The prophet sighs and wonders as do I
But neither of us know the truth of sky.
The human prophecy is hope's despair,
And wandering on the desert and the air.
Beloved, though prophets here come cry
and weep,
I merely return to Your house to sweep.

Habakkuk 2

1 I will stand up upon my watch
And set myself up in the crotch
Of a tower and will stand to see
What He will speak then against me,
And what I may reply to him
Reproving me *for what is dim*.
2 And YHWH answered me and said
"Write
The vision and make it plain sight
Upon the tables, so he may
Run that reads it, *not go astray*.
3 "The vision's an appointed time,
But at the end it shall give mime
And not lie; thought it seem to take
A long time, wait there in its wake,
Because it will come surely and
It will not tarry *in the land*."
4 See the presumptuous one, he's not
Upright within, but Huguenot
Shall live by his steadfastness' plot.

Is any man steadfast, Beloved, in face
Of limitation of the human race?
The flesh and blood itself's ephemeral,
Subject to the winds and the bitter gall
Of fleeting life. Beloved, steadfastness here
Is not a human thing to grasp in fear.
The faith that inspires human breast
Is always presumptuous at its best,
If only in the hope that one more breath
Will grace the consciousness before one's
death.
Beloved, I grasp the words and feel the
rope

Burn in my hands before I know its hope.
Your universe is too sharp on the heel
For human heart, Beloved, a world of steel.

5 Also because wine's treacherous,
A man is haughty and makes fuss
To leave his house, make large desire
As is sheol and as death's mire,
And cannot be satisfied then,
But gathers to himself all men
Of all nations and makes a heap
For himself of all people deep.
6 Do not these, all of them, take up
A parable against the tup,
A moral of sharp saying when
They say "Woe to him who draws in
The wealth that is not his to bin,
Till when he also multiplies
To himself heavy pledges' *sighs*."

7 Shall they not rise up suddenly
That shall bite you and awake free
What can only trouble you here,
And you shall be spoiled at their ear?
8 Since you have spoiled all nations dear,

The remnant of the folk appear
To spoil you; because of men's blood,
And for ground's violence in mud,
Of the city and all who dwell
Within its *gates to cast a spell*.

9 Woe to the one who covets what
Is evil to his house in glut,
So he may set his nest up high,
And be delivered from the spy
Of evil power *in what is shut*.

10 You have come here to consult shame
For your house by cutting off name
Of many peoples, and have sinned
Against your own soul *in the wind*.

11 The stone shall cry out of the wall,
The bean out of the timbered stall
Shall answer it *and tell it all*.

12 Woe to the one who builds a town
With blood and sets a city down
By his iniquity *in crown*.

13 See, is it now from YHWH of hosts
That people labour in the boasts
Of very fire, and the folk tire
Themselves for an idol's vain hire?

14 For full is the earth of the true
Knowledge of the honour of YHWH,
As water covers the sea's view.

Woe to the one who builds a town on
blood,
And yet in every place after the flood
All towns are built on blood and on deceit.
Every land claim in New York is a cheat
With California at end of the street.
Beloved, have mercy on the men to take
The livelihood of others and in wake
Leave widows, orphans and their dogs in
stake
Of hunger and of pestilence and death.
Have mercy on all men who still draw
breath.

I cry You mercy, my Beloved, by right
Of one who has not by a hand of sleight
Found prey among my neighbours. Fit the
bill
To bring peace down on earth and let it fill.

15 Woe to the one who gives to drink
To his neighbour, from bottle's stink
To make drunk and have sex, just think!
16 You're filled with shame instead of
glory,

So drink up also, let your gory
Foreskin be exposed, and the cup
Of YHWH's right hand shall turn to sup
For you, and shameful spewing be
On you, your honour and glory.

17 For violence of Lebanon
Shall cover you, and spoil anon
Of beasts become afraid to smell
The blood of men and so to tell
The violence of the land and
Of the city and all who stand.

18 What profits the idol to those
Who made it graven to the toes,
The molten image, taught by lies,
That its maker trusts in its eyes,
Though it can see nothing that goes?
19 Woe to the one who says to wood,
"Wake up!" To the dumb stone it should
Get up and teach. See it is laid
Over with gold and silver paid,
And there's no breath in it at all.
20 And YHWH is in His temple stall,
Be still before Him, earth in thrall.

How many of the famous and the right
Who dine in festival here in my sight
Serve liquor and wine to their own delight
And that of leaders of the left and night!

Your prophet speaks in curses on the high
 And noble of the country where I lie
 And of the one from which I also spring.
 We are a world of drunkards at the spring
 Of the water of life. That's why we sing
 More of the pit than of celestial ring.
 Beloved, forgive me that as time goes by
 I don't replace grandfather's sign, whereby
 Each passer-by read well the imprecations
 On those who drank their alcoholic rations.

Habakkuk 3

1 A prayer of Habakkuk Nabi
 Upon Shigionoth to see.
 2 O YHWH, I've heard Your speech, and
 fear,
 O YHWH, revive Your work and hear,
 In the midst of the years make known;
 In wrath remember mercy *grown*.
 3 Allah from Teman comes, the Holy
 One from Mount Paran, no place lowly.
 His glory fills the face of sky,
 The earth runs with His praise to vie.
 4 The brightness is as light to see;
 He had horns from His hand to be;
 And even then full blast of power
 Was lying hidden at that hour.
 5 Before Him went the pestilence,
 And burning coals from His feet hence.
 6 He stood and measured off the earth;
 He saw the melted nations' worth;
 The ancient mountains crushed in berth.
 The hills of the world bowed down by
 The journeys of eternity.
 7 Under sorrow I've seen the tents
 Of Cushan, tremble do the vents
 Of Midian land amidst her rents.

Not only David's voice rises to show
 The height of Psalmistry upon the glow
 Of day and night, the east and western flow
 Of comfort and delight, of warning's bow.
 No Psalm more beautiful that this is writ
 Within the sacred Scriptures and the fit,
 The melting words of pestilence and pain,
 The flights eternal into sun and rain.
 Beloved, indeed the world runs full of all
 The power and pleasures of the divine call,
 The hidden and the revealed in the stall.
 So then revive, Beloved, Your work in me
 That makes creation seem eternity,
 And colours mere-ness with exquisitry.

8 Was YHWH displeased against the
 streams?

Was Your anger against their beams?
 Was Your wrath set against the sea
 That You rode on Your cavalry
 And chariots of salvation's fee?

9 Your bow was made bare by the oaths
 Of the tribes, by Your word and quoths.
 You split the earth with streams and sea.
 10 The mountains saw You, trembling

stood;

The overflowing waters could
 Pass by; the deep uttered its voice,
 Lifting up its hands to rejoice.

11 The sun and moon stood still where they
 Dwell; at the light your arrows flay,
 At shining of Your spear to play.

12 You marched through the land in Your
 wrath,
 You threshed the heathen in Your path.

13 You went out to save Your own folk,
 Save Your anointed, at a stroke
 You wounded the head of the house
 Of wickedness, uncovered mouse
 Up to the neck and laid in yoke.

14 You pierced with his staves still the
 head

Of his leaders, and they are spread
 In tumult against me, their cry
 Exults to consume poor man's rye.

15 You passed through the waters and sea
 In a heap by Your cavalry.

When Joshua commands, the story goes,
 The sun and moon stand still above the
 throes

Of death-shakes on the wicked with their
 bows

All broken by Your chosen ones in rows.
 Beloved, the rending of the air presumes
 Too much on human sight and ears'
 costumes.

Though time may be a stable or then not,
 The proof is not in what men see in lot.
 The horror of the moment makes the sun
 Stand still for an eternity, then run
 Beyond the stars anguished looking for fun.
 Beloved, save Your anointed one indeed,
 Whoever he may be, the woman's seed
 Or one born in the stable like a weed.

16 When I hear, my belly would quake;
My lips quivered at the voice' sake;
My bones trembled corrupted there,
And quaked in myself for the rest
In the day of trouble to nest,
When he arrives to find the folk
With troops invading at a stroke.

17 Though the fig tree does not bear
flower,

Nor come fruit on vines in that hour,
The labour of the olive fail,
The field yield no food for a meal,
The flock cut off from very fold,
No herd found in the stall unsold;

18 Yet I'll rejoice in YHWH, I'll joy
In God of my salvation's ploy.

19 YHWH Alohims become my strength,
And He will make my feet at length
Like feet of hinds, and He will make
Me walk in my high places' stake.
To the chief singer this is sent
To play on my stringed instrument.

The trembling of the fearful and the dance
Of those who rejoice join in penitance
Of Your creative power to make earth stand
Or else to fall prostrated by command.
Though no corn blows upon the place
where I

Remain to stand, to breathe, or live or die,
Let me rejoice as long as I stand here,
Whether in hope and comfort or in fear.
Your name alone is worthy of my joy.
The fleeting powers about me all employ
Illusions for the faint, the beating cloy
Of melodies ephemeral and quaint.
Beloved, I go beyond tinsel and paint,
Beyond the bread and water that appear.

Zephaniah

The fact he is an African himself
Gives Zephaniah right upon the shelf
To cry down Ethiopian as elf.
The fact he is of some royal descent
Gives him the chance to brave the kingly
tent

With condemnation for the ways they went.
Whether the writing was produced in call
Of the Josian reforms on the wall,
Or whether much was written in the stall

Of later times, it still remains to pall
The way things were done in the holy hall
Of Your city Jerusalem for all.
The threats themselves affirm Jerusalem
To be the grapple of Your eye and hem.

Zephaniah 1

1 The word of YHWH which came unto
Zephaniah of Cushi's crew,
The son of Gedaliah who
Was son of Amariah too,
The son of Hizkiah, in days
Of Josiah the son of praise
Of Ammon, king of Judah's ways.
2 "I'll utterly consume all things
From off the land," says YHWH *for stings*.

3 "I shall consume both man and beast,
I'll consume birds in sky at least,
And fishes of the sea and yet
The stumbling blocks with wicked met,
And I'll cut off man from the land,"
Says YHWH *so all may understand*.

4 "I'll also stretch My hand upon
Judah, and on all dwellers drawn
Out of Jerusalem; and I
Will cut off the remnant in sty
Of Baal from this place, and the name
Of Chemarims with priests of fame;
5 "And those who worship stars in sky
Upon the housetops, and who try
To worship and to swear by YHWH
While swearing name of Malcham too;
And those who are turned back from
YHWH,

And those who have never sought YHWH
Nor enquired of Him *for His due*.

7 "Be silent in the presence of
The Lord YHWH, because the day of
YHWH is at hand, For YHWH's prepared
A sacrifice, invited guests.

Beloved, I answer invitation sent,
I rush into the flowered Meccan tent
To be Your guest and devour Your present.
No matter that I must provide the lamb
Myself alone, though a guest's what I am.
You do not enquire of me in Your quest
How I dealt with the food and drink You
blessed.

Instead You judge me by the pleasant
things:

The proclamation You alone have wings,

The rising early to send prophets out,
And the divine in guidance without shout.
The lamb that I provide You gave to me
Along with all creation in degree,
Along with every pleasant thing I see.

8 “It shall be when the day *arrests*
Of YHWH’s sacrifice *when it’s bared*,
That I’ll punish princes and king’s
Children, all who wear clothes *and rings*
Of foreign origins. 9 That day
I’ll punish all who go their way,
All those omitting the threshold,
Who fill their masters’ house with bold
Violence and deceit. 10 “There’ll be
On that day,” says YHWH, “Mournfully
The sound of crying from Fish Gate,
A wailing from Second Estate,
And a loud crashing from the hills.
11 Wail, dwellers of Maktesh for ills!
For all the merchantmen in frills
Cut down; and all those set to see
In silver and in jewellery
Cut off. 12 And it shall come to pass
At that time I’ll search through the mass
Of Jerusalem with a torch,
And punish men sleeping on porch,
Who say in their heart, “God will not
Do good or evil on the spot.”
13 That’s why their wealth becomes a
 spoil,
Their houses desolation’s coil,
They’ll build houses and not live there;
They plant vineyards, nor drink their share.

I stop to kiss the threshold, my Beloved,
Not caring for the crowd that pushed and
 shoved,
I touched the doors and pickets with my
 lips
Across each phantom mosaic that skips
Across the shrine beneath the sun and
 shade.
And then I enter in the light betrayed.
I stop to kiss the threshold where I stayed
To see the vision of a man bereft
Of power and song before the sword heart
 cleft.

The vision of the glory that I see
Within the veil brings wondering to me,
Where all the polished, bevelled mirrors
 shine,

Filled to the brim with fire, air, water,
 wine,
Where I find earth at last at tip of spine.

14 The great day of YHWH’s near, nearby,
And comes on swiftly, voice of joy
Of YHWH’s day, might men shall cry
There bitterly. 15 That day’s of wrath,
Day of trouble, distressful path,
A day of waste and wilderness,
A day of darkness, gloomy dress,
A day of clouds and thick darkness.
16 A day of trumpet and alarm
Against the cities built for harm,
Against the high towers in address.
17 And I will bring on men distress,
So they shall walk like blind men, for
They’ve sinned against YHWH and to pour
Their blood out as the dust in store,
Their flesh as excrements in score.
18 Neither their silver nor their gold
Shall be able to save their hold
In the day of YHWH’s wrath untold,
But the whole land shall be devoured
By the fire of jealousy scoured,
For He shall make a speedy end
Of all who live where lands extend.

No wonder, my Beloved, You keep them
 brief,
These minor prophets speak without relief.
The warnings are too pointed to digest:
Today they would lead to asylum’s best.
I myself cannot bring myself in zest
To use such awful language in my vest.
I am too delicate to sing the tune
That people’s flesh is excrements. My rune
Is touched with the conciliatory note
Of my own time and place and the free
 vote.
But let the land devour and be devoured
Until the fire has scoured the earth and
 scoured
Away injustice and each fault in me
As well as in frightful fraternity.

Zephaniah 2

1 Gather yourselves together, yea,
Gather together *on a day*,
O nation not desired *for pay*,
2 Before the decree bring it out,
Before the day goes by in shout

Like chaff, before the fury's spout
 Of YHWH that comes on you, before
 The day of YHWH's anger in store.
 3 Seek YHWH, all the meek of the earth,
 Who have done justly, for desert
 Seek righteousness, seek meekness too,
 It may be you'll be hidden crew
 In the day of the wrath of YHWH.
 4 Gaza shall be forsaken then,
 And Ashkelon an empty den;
 They'll drive out Ashdod at the noon,
 And Ekron be uprooted soon.
 5 Woe to the dwellers on sea coast,
 Nation of Cherethites in boast!
 YHWH's word attacks you, Canaan's land,
 And country of Philistine band;
 I will destroy you till none stand.
 6 The sea coast shall be cottages
 To harbour shepherds and flocks' fizz.
 7 The coast shall be for the few left
 Of house of Judah soon bereft;
 They'll feed there, and in Ashkelon
 Like down from evening until dawn;
 For YHWH their Alohim shall come
 To turn back captivity's hum.

There are two kinds of people on the earth,
 And that's a principle that has no dearth.
 All men see them and us and so requite
 The stricken soul between the black and
 white.

But here the two kinds are those on the run
 Who come together, gathered by the sun,
 And those who seek You, my Beloved and
 wait

Alone upon the Dergah floor in state.
 The crowd is always right, is always strong,
 And like the chaff is always in the wrong.
 The single soul that lifts a Psalm in prayer
 Is dissipated on the frozen air.
 Beloved, I choose among the choices thus
 And find I'm not among the numerous.

8 I've heard reproach of Moab, and
 Revilings of Ammon's sons sad,
 By which they have chided the pad
 Of My folk and magnified bad
 Against their borderlands *like cad*.
 9 "So as I live," says YHWH of hosts,
 The Alohim of Israel's boasts,
 "Surely Moab be as Sodom,
 And Ammon's children as the scum

Of Gomorrah, nettles to grow
 And salt pits and nothing to show
 For ever; while the residue
 Of My folk shall spoil them in crew,
 And what's left of My people too."
 10 This shall they have for all their pride,
 Since they reproached and magnified
 Against the folk of YHWH of hosts.
 11 YHWH will be terrible in boasts
 To them; for He will starve the ghosts
 Of all exalted in the earth;
 And men shall worship him, each one
 From his place on the coasts he's won.
 12 Cushites too, you'll be killed by sword.
 13 And He'll stretch out His hand adored
 Against the north and to destroy
 Assyrian, and Nineveh
 He'll make a desolation dry
 Like wilderness in desert sway.
 14 And flocks shall lie down there to rest,
 All beasts of the nations confessed,
 The cormorant and bittern sleep
 Upon its beams, their voice to peep
 Upon the window sills and keep
 Desolation on thresholds there,
 Where he shall make cedar work bare.
 15 So may rejoice the town that gave
 Careless living and so to rave
 In her heart saying "I, and there
 Is none beside me for a share;"
 How is she fallen and desert,
 A place for beasts to lie inert!
 All who pass by hiss for shame
 And shake their heads *as though in blame*.

Just because he is black does not mean he
 Has the right to use the N word so free.
 Let Ethiopians be killed, he cries.
 But I take issue with the curledly wise.
 And so does the dog too. I saw him go
 Against the gull and cormorant and crow
 And chase them all from the lawn in a row.
 That's two in witness against prophet's
 show.

Beloved, let me rejoice here in the town
 That gave to careless living its renown,
 Without participating in the deed
 Or in the pride of life on which they feed.
 Then none will shake a head and none pass
 by
 Except the very ones there on the sly.

Zephaniah 3

1 Woe to her that's filthy, unclean,
To the oppressing city mean!
2 She did not obey the voice; she
Did not receive correction's fee;
She did not trust in YHWH, and she
Did not come near her Alohim.
3 Her princes roaring lions seem,
Her judges wolves at evening scream;
They wait till dawn to gnaw bones free.
4 Her prophets are senseless and men
Of treachery; her priests again
Pollute the temple, they have done
Violence to the law and spun.
5 The just YHWH's in the midst; He'll not
Do iniquity in the plot;
Every morning He comes to bring
His right to light; fails not to sing;
But the unjust knows no shame's *wing*.
6 I've cut off the nations, their towers
Are desolate; I've made streets *scours*,
So none pass by, their towns destroyed,
So that this is no man employed;
There's no inhabitant *in bowers*.
7 I said "Surely you will fear Me,
You'll not receive instruction's fee;
So their dwelling should not be cut
Off, however I punish rut;
But they rose early to corrupt
All their doings and to disrupt.

The son of king if not the son of priest,
This prophet curses loudly at the least.
Beloved, if I curse pope and president,
And businessman successful to relent,
Then cast no blame on me, and cast no
blame,
I merely follow Your own prophet's claim
And raise a message without any blame.
It's not my fault he mentions priest and
prince,
Even if that now makes a person wince
Who's born and fed in fair democracy,
The pinnacle of earth's hypocrisy.
The nations You cut off may not be here,
But there are others risen, so I fear,
So let again Your prophecy appear.

8 "So wait for Me," says YHWH, "until
The day that I rise to fulfil
Against the prey; for I intend
To gather nations to attend,

That I may gather kingdoms and
Pour on them My wrath *in command*,
All My fierce anger: all the earth
Shall be consumed with fire *in dearth*
Before My jealousy *in brand*.
9 "For then will I turn to the folk
A pure tongue, that they may invoke
The name of YHWH, serve Him and stand.
10 "From beyond the rivers of Cush,
My supplicants, and there to rush
The daughter of My scattered ones
Bring sacrifices to My runs.
11 "That day you shall not be ashamed
For all your doing and acclaimed,
By which you have transgressed and sinned
Against me; for then I'll rescind
Out of your midst those who rejoice
In your pride, and you'll find no voice
Of haughtiness more in the hill
Of My holiness to fulfil.
12 "And I'll leave in the midst of you
A poor and needy people true;
And they shall hope in YHWH's name too.
13 "The residue of Israel
Shall not do wickedness nor spell
Lies; neither shall deceitful tongue
Be found in their mouth: they shall feed
And lie down without fear to lead."

The prophecy is well fulfilled in that
The Axumite reform is where it's at.
The early faith that came there to approve,
The Jewish-Christian love of narrow
groove,
Reacted against Monophysite faith
And thus was born the great Islamic wraith.
Cush is the source of revelation now,
The cradle of Qur'an, the holy brow
Of revelation saved and hidden well
To come to light in the last days a spell.
The poor and needy of all time and place
Rise up to witness before Your own face
And show that what is left is here to stay,
A testimony to the divine way.

14 Sing, daughter of the fortress, shout
O Israel; be glad about
And rejoice with all the heart, O
Daughter of Jerusalem's row.
15 YHWH has taken away your right,
He's cast out your foes from your sight;
The king of Israel, even YHWH

Is here and in the midst of you;
 You'll never see more evil crew.
 16 That day said to Jerusalem,
 "Do not fear;" to Zion the gem,
 "Let not your hands be slack to do."
 17 YHWH your Alohim among you
 Is mighty; He will save, and He
 Will rejoice over you with glee;
 He'll rest in His love quietly;
 He'll joy in you with singing's spree.
 18 "I'll summon to the solemn feast
 Of you from reproach burdened, leased.
 19 "See, at that I, I will undo
 All who afflict and trouble you;
 And I will save the lame one too,
 And gather in the driven out;
 And I will grant them praise and shout
 Of fame in every land where they
 Have been put to shame on the way.
 20 "Even at that time I'll bring you,
 Even in the time summon you;
 For I will make of you a name
 And a praise among nations' fame
 In all the earth, when I turn back
 Captivity before your track,"
 Says YHWH *in promise and in flame*.

I'm ready for a king, indeed I am,
 And not a king that's lion or a lamb,
 But rather You, Beloved, You are my king,
 The overthrow of despot and the ring
 Of lobbyists about the senate met
 To bring injustice to the ruling set.
 I'm ready for a king, this world has gone
 Too far into the fading of the dawn,
 Too far into the spoil that may seem bright
 To those who have the wherewithal to
 fight.
 If You are flighty on the grave, stand down
 And bring a new thing out upon the town.
 If You are mighty, One to save, stand up
 And topple now the tumbler and the tup.

Haggai

The first of the three prophets come to
 stand
 After the return to the Promised Land,
 Haggai speaks in five warnings on the sand
 Encouraging the hopeless to the grand
 Vision of temenos and temples planned.

Obscure though Naqi may be in the rate
 Of divine proof both in the Persian State
 And in fair Palestine come up of late,
 The start of David's realm returned is well
 The tenor of my heart and not to quell
 After two thousand and five hundred years.
 Let priest and king faint in their well-
 earned fears.
 Five roots of faith Haggai brings to the
 fore,
 And even now I wish for no roots more.

Haggai 1

1 In second year of Darius
 The king, in the sixth month to trust
 In the first day of the month, came
 YHWH's word by Haggai *in flame*
 The prophet to Zerubbabel
 Who was son of Shealtiel,
 Governor of Judah, and to
 Joshua son of Josedech,
 The high priest, saying with a hue:
 2 "So says YHWH of hosts for a speck:
 'This folk says, "The time has not come,
 The time that YHWH's house should be
 plumb."'"

3 Then YHWH's word came by Haggai
 The prophet, saying, 4 "*Is time nigh*
 For you yourselves to live in fine
 Cedar-panelled houses, while this
 Temple *lies* in ruins amiss?"

Two thousand years have passed since
 when that king
 And priest and governor heard spoke the
 thing
 That time was not yet ripe to build the wall
 And raise the temple roof. Beloved, I call
 You as a witness that the people say
 The same today. They say that human way
 And heart have not progressed to that
 degree
 That all can know there is no I to see
 But You alone. They say the mystic fire
 Is for the few not lost in vain desire.
 I say that he who can say I can tell
 There is no I but You between both hell
 And heaven. The panelled house makes
 blind the man
 Who might see temple arch gargantuan.

5 Now therefore, so says YHWH of hosts:

“Ponder your attitudes for boasts.
6 “You have sown much, and bring in little,
You eat, but do not have a fiddle,
You drink, but mostly just a piddle,
You deck yourselves, but no one’s warm,
Your salaries leak but conform.”

For all my frantic running here and there
To catch a mite of wealth that I might share
With family, dependent, and, if some
Be left, with indigent, the dervish drum
And shaman’s wand warn that no man can
eat

Beyond his portion. Manna is a treat
But none may take beyond the measure of
The day. The worm eats all the human love
That’s set by lock and key. Beloved, make
me

To know the moment from all care set free.
Breath must be breathed and then let go or
die.

I see the gold and silver passing by.
I thank You that the money bag has holes
That I may live in now instead of goals.

7 So says YHWH of hosts: “Think about
Your attitudes in what you spout!

8 “Go up to the mountains and bring
Wood and build the temple for fling,
That I may take pleasure in it
And be glorified,” says YHWH fit.

9 “*You* looked for much, but indeed *it*
Produced little, and when you brought
It into store, I blew the lot.
Why?” says YHWH of hosts. “Because My
House lies in ruins, while your sty
Is your refuge under the sky.”

O my Beloved, let my stone chamber in
This fleshly heart not be a den of sin,
But rather washed and poshed and
brightened with

The candle of Your presence and not myth.
I lay within its standing, private wall
A carpet for my prayers to grace the hall
With colour and with wool. There I
prostrate

Both night and day while I in my estate
Take on the busy round of my affairs.
My soul recites Your name upon the stairs
Of granite and of flint, while feet take on
The shape of shovel in the rosy dawn,

While hand is bent to saw and axe. I seek
My bread with body though my soul is
meek.

10 “Therefore the skies above you keep
Back the dew, and the earth as deep
Withholds its fruit. 11 “For I called drought
On the land and the hills and wrought
On the corn and the new grape juice
And the oil, on what of use
The earth has the power to produce,
On men and cattle and their spruce.”

Let labour of my hands be full or vain,
Let earth miss dew, and let the cloud lack
rain,

And let the earth, the lovely earth, withhold
The fruitful harvest, I am meek and bold
To trust You, my Beloved, for nourishment
In what in dearth or in abundance sent
I have from Your own hand. There’s
nothing else

I would have, not my earnings nor the pelts
Of others’ gifts. What wine and oil I take
In luxury or destitution make
No dent on my resolve to drink Your cup
And drink no other. This day I look up
And find the sky immense above the earth,
And earth here where I stand to be of
worth.

12 Zerubbabel son of Shealtiel,
Joshua son of Jehozadak,
The high priest, with all head and heel
Left of the folk that had come back,
Obeyed the voice of YHWH their God,
And the words of Haggai the prod,
As YHWH their Alohim had sent,
And the folk feared the face of YHWH.

13 And Haggai, Messenger of YHWH
Spoke YHWH’s message to the folk due,
Saying “*I am* with you, says YHWH.”

14 So YHWH stirred up the spirit of
Zerubbabel who was son of
Shealtiel, governor of Judah,
And the spirit of Joshua
Son of Jehozadak, high priest,
And spirit of all the released
Remnant of the folk, and they came
And worked on the house of YHWH’s
fame,

That of their Alohim in claim,

15 On twenty-fourth day of month six,
In King Darius' second tricks.

Beloved, I build by day and night the web
Of Your temple with every flow and ebb
Of hope's recall. The silent fashions group
Around the threads of gold across my
stoop.

Let there not be, Beloved, an idol store
Within the sanctuary of my door.
The heavenly pattern that You once sent
down

To Moses and Ezekiel for a crown
Be the print whereupon I meet Your way.
Lead me, Beloved, into a brighter day,
Or if not brighter, at least scented by
The sweeter guidances of earth from sky,
By more than flame of poppies on the
round,

By meeting Your law firmly on the ground.

Haggai 2

1 In *month* the seventh, twenty-first
Day of the month, then YHWH's word
burst

Upon Haggai the prophet, saying:
2 "Speak to Zerubbabel *waylaying*
The son of Shealtiel, of Judah
The governor, and to Joshua
Son of Jehozadak, high priest,
And to the folk's remnant *increased*,
Saying, 3 'Who's left of *man or beast*
Among you who saw temple in
Its former glory *sapphirine*?

And how then do you see it now?
Compared with that, you must avow
That this is nothing in your sight.

4 'Yet now be strong, Zerubbabel,'
Says YHWH, 'and increase in your might,
Joshua, son of Jehozadak,
The high priest, and be strong *in paddock*,
All you folk in the land who dwell,'
Says YHWH, 'and work, for I'm with you,'
Says YHWH of hosts. 5 'According to
The word that I agreed with you
When you came out of Egypt's *land*,
So My spirit remains with you,
Do not fear then!' 6 "For so says YHWH
Of hosts, 'Once more, a little stand,
I shall shake heaven and earth, the sea
And the dry land, 7 'and I will shake
All nations, and Muhammad be

Of all nations come *for My sake*,
And I will fill this temple, *see*,
With glory,' says YHWH of hosts' *wake*.
8 'The silver's Mine, the gold *is* Mine,'
Says YHWH of hosts. 9 'The glory *fine*
Of this latter temple shall be
Greater than the former,' says *He*,
YHWH of hosts. 'And in this place I
Will give Islam,' says YHWH of sky."

The glory that David and Solomon
Put on the temple mount in benison
Was thrown down by the king of Babylon.
Rebuilt a shadow of the former grace,
The people wept to see its loss of face,
Until the prophet came to say the place
Would be filled with a greater glory when
The hoped for should appear among mere
men.

Jesus walked on the sacred stones set there
And looked forward to see caught up in air
Muhammad and his horse before Your
throne.

I grasp the peace of Islam teeth and bone,
And thank You for the message clear and
fair,
And bow to You, Beloved, to You alone.

10 On twenty-fourth day of month nine,
In Darius' second year fine,
Came the word of YHWH by Haggai
The prophet, saying, *not so sly*,
11 So says YHWH of hosts, "Ask the
priests

About the law *of beasts and feasts*:

12 "If someone carries holy flesh
In the hem of his robe in mesh,
And with the cloth touch bread or cheese,
Or wine or oil or what you please,
Shall it be holy by the touch."

The priests answered, "No, not as much."

13 Then Haggai says "If the unclean
Of body comes against the seen
Of these, is it then thing unclean?"
And the priests say "It is unclean."

14 Then Haggai answered and said
"So is this folk and nation led
Before Me," so says YHWH and dread,
"And so is every thing they do,
And what they bring into their pew,
It is unclean *from crown to shoe*.

15 "And now, please think about today

And onward, before stone did lay
 On stone in YHWH's temple to stay;
 16 "Since those times when once came to
 A pile of twenty, ten were due;
 When one came to the press to draw
 Out fifty measures if a straw,
 There were but twenty held in paw.
 17 "I stuck you with blast and mildew
 And hail on all the things you do,
 But you repented not," says YHWH.
 18 Consider now today and on,
 From twenty-fourth of ninth month draw,
 From the day YHWH's foundations lay,
 Consider that temple today.
 19 Is the seed still in the barn? yea,
 As still the vine and fig tree sway,
 And pomegranate, and olive tree,
 They bear not: from this day you see
 I will bless you in house and bay.

All the concern of priest with the unclean
 And the clean seems to have its source and
 bean

In Persian customs and in Persian prophet.
 Water is more use than to come and quaff
 it.

Ablutions for unclean to make them clean
 Are well recorded in Biblical scene
 Despite the fact the Christians in their store
 Forget to wash themselves before the door.
 Beloved, though I like Peter was both
 hands

And feet and head according to commands
 Of those who sit in Moses' seat, I still
 Pray for a clean heart and a cleaner bill.
 And then I'll rise up to Your sacred house,
 Both I and my offspring along with spouse.

20 And once again came word of YHWH
 To Haggai in the day then due,
 Twenty-fourth of the month to say:
 Zerubbabel without delay,
 Governor of Judah to say:
 "I'll shake the heavens and earth and sway;

22 "And I will overthrow the throne
 Of kingdoms and I'll break the bone
 Of kingdoms of the heathen grown;
 And I'll overthrow chariot,
 And those that ride in them for nought,
 The cavalry shall fail, each one
 Felled by sword of his brother's son.

23 "In that day," says YHWH of hosts, "I

Will take you, Zerubbabel, My
 Servant, the son of Shealtiel,"
 Says YHWH, "and will make you as well
 A signet, for I've chosen you,"
 Says YHWH of hosts, *and so says YHWH.*

If anyone is here to satisfy
 Some prophecy of messianic spy,
 It's not Jesus or Ahmad unwary
 In Pakistan, but good Zerubbabel,
 Who's chosen even in the din and spell
 Of cavalry and falling of the sword,
 And shaking of the powers of heaven
 adored.

If anyone rose up to meet the sway
 Of challenges in messianic way,
 It was the good Zerubbabel one day.
 It's not his fault, Beloved, the years go by,
 And history is filled with evil guy,
 And all seems as no messiah has come.
 We're always faced with truth if just a
 hum.

Zechariah

I have remembrance of Your name that I
 Recite at morn and eve, on Sabbath's wry
 Return in judgement and in joy and peace.
 But You, too, my Beloved, enjoy release
 Of the remembrance of the names You
 choose

To keep in life and love, no breath to lose.
 The prophet with name of remembrance
 here

Came in Darius the king's second year,
 Five-twenty, and remained perhaps another
 To finish the book's last half as to smother
 The clarity, if such exists in this.
 Truth is, there's only one thing not to miss
 In Zechariah: that's to keep Your law,
 Beloved, and let the heathen wranglers
 caw.

Zechariah 1

1 In the eighth month, the second year
 Of Darius, came the word clear
 Of YHWH to *prophet* Zechariah,
 Who was the son of Berechiah,
 The son of Iddo the prophet,
 Saying 2 "YHWH has been sore beset,
 Displeased with your ancestors *met*.

3 "So say to them," says YHWH of hosts,
 "Turn back to Me away from boasts,"
 Says YHWH of hosts, "and I will turn
 To you," says YHWH of hosts *and stern*.
 4 "Do not be like your ancestors,
 To whom the former prophets' spurs
 Cried, saying 'So says YHWH of hosts,
 "Repent your evils ways' ripostes,
 And from your evil doings' roasts,"
 But they did not hear nor obey
 Me," says YHWH *who is still in sway*.
 5 "Your ancestors, where are they now?
 And do prophets live always, how?
 6 "But My words and My statutes, which
 I commanded My servants' stitch,
 The prophets, did they not take hold
 Of your fathers?" They returned bold
 And said "Just as YHWH of hosts thought
 To do to us by our ways wrought,
 According to the things we do,
 Just so has He dealt with our crew."

It's hardly fair, Beloved, to compare flesh
 And blood with written word caught in the
 mesh
 Of Scriptures handed down for generations,
 Writing recopied over for our rations.
 When man's body's worn out, it's planted
 deep
 And there's nothing left for it but to weep.
 When Your law's tattered, then another
 score
 Or sheep were slaughtered for their skins
 and more,
 And voilà! All is new, in fresh ink crested,
 While bones alone remain of the men
 bested.

Beloved, the good and evil, are all laid
 Down in the grave after their life's parade,
 While truth remains to hear and see and do,
 The only self that stays is that of You.

7 On the twenty-fourth day in view
 Of the eleventh month and true,
 Which is the month Sebat, and in
 Second year of Darius' win,
 Came YHWH's word unto Zechariah
 Who was the son of Berechiah,
 The son of Iddo, prophet, saying:

Is this a kind thought, my Beloved, to find
 The calendar's Babylonized, resigned

Behind the Persian royalty combined?
 What month is this, this Sebat in the year
 Of sacred rounds of Sabbaths without fear?
 Put out, Beloved, Babylon's feast of days,
 Rabbinical in counting to amaze,
 And give us back the calendar in phase
 With Enoch and with Noah for Your praise.
 Gregorian divides the western plot
 Upon a year from Julian once sought
 In Russian cloisters by the twice begot.
 Beloved, hand down the righteous days
 again
 From heaven and the celestial, starry glen.

8 I saw by night and see, a man
 Riding on a red horse in span,
 And he stood among myrtles swaying
 Below; and behind him to go
 Red horses, speckled and white show.
 9 And I said "O sir, what are these?
 And the angel that spoke with ease
 Said to me, "I'll show what you please."
 And the man stand in the trees
 Of myrtle replied and he said
 "These are the ones that YHWH has led
 To walk around through the earth spread."
 11 They answered the angel of YHWH
 That stood among the myrtle crew,
 And said "We've walked about the earth,
 And see, all's at rest in its berth."
 12 And the angel of YHWH replied
 And said "O YHWH of hosts, abide,
 How long will You have no mercy
 On Jerusalem and city
 Of Judah, against which you've held
 Wrath seventy year and unquelled?"
 13 YHWH replied to the angel there
 That talked with me good wards and fair.
 14 So the angel speaking with me,
 Said to me, "Call and say in fee,
 So says YHWH of hosts, 'I am bound
 In jealousy upon the ground
 Of Jerusalem and its fort
 With jealousy greater than sport.
 15 "And with great wrath I'm angry too
 Against the nation who in pew
 Sit at their ease, for in My small
 Displeasure they made speck a wall.'
 16 So says YHWH, 'I have now returned
 To Jerusalem I had spurned
 With mercies; My house shall be built
 In it,' says YHWH of hosts, to tilt

A line shall be stretched out upon
Jerusalem *when comes the dawn.*”
17 Call out again, say so says YHWH
Of hosts, “My cities by and through
Prosperity shall yet be spread
Abroad, and YHWH comfort instead
Zion, and choose Jerusalem.”

The coloured horses of Zechariah
Are there to say when the time comes the
straw

Of wrath is over and the temple spires
Must be raised once more for human
desires.

The horses portend the setting aright
Of sanctuary after human plight.
So why should horses in the Revelation
Be so difficult in interpretation?
They too predict the line drawn out again
Toward Jerusalem and its good den.
They ride the earth to show that heaven
seat

Where Your Messiah serves to wash the
feet

Of saint once sinner till all sin is gone
And blotted from eternity’s fair dawn.

18 And I raised up my eyes and saw
And there were four horns *like a claw.*

19 And I said to the angel that
Talked with me, “What are these at bat?”
And he replied to me, “These are
The horns which scattered wide and far
Judah, Israel, Jerusalem.”

20 And YHWH showed me four
carpenters.

21 And I said “What work do these fers?”
And he spoke up and said to me,
“These are the horns that scattered free
Judah, so no man lifted head;
But these have come to fray instead,
To cast out the Gentile horns which
Lifted their power over the pitch
Of Judah to scatter its bed.”

The book of Revelation has the horns
And horses, the destroyers with their scorn
And the predictors of the temple shown
In glory above all things on earth known.
But carpenters are missing from the share,
No doubt because they came to build the
fair

City of old Jerusalem one day.
But in the Revelation all the sway
Is new creation, without need of stroke
Of hammer or of nail by any bloke.
The new earth and the new sky come to
shake

The temple cleansed of every sin in wake.
Beloved, I still like carpenters and feel
They have a place and vision to reveal.

Zechariah 2

1 I lifted up my eyes and saw
Indeed a man held in his paw
A measuring line. 2 And I asked him,
“Where are you going *with that trim?*”
And he told me, “To lay a line
In measurement of *the divine*
Jerusalem, to see how wide
And how long it is on each side.”
3 See, the angel addressing me
Went out, and another freely
Came to meet angel *in degree.*
4 And said to him, “Run tell this youth,
‘Jerusalem for lodge and booth
Shall be filled to capacity
With man and beast abundantly.’”
5 “And I will be to her” says YHWH,
“A wall of fire around *her view,*
And as a glory in her breast.
6 “Avast, flee out from the north land,”
Says YHWH, “For I have spread *like sand*
You from heaven’s four winds,” says
YHWH.
7 “Ho, Zion, escape, you who live with
The daughter of Babylon’s *myth.*”

Rabbis today still follow Babylon,
The Talmud written in the light of dawn.
And so who follow them still have a plate
And part with Babylon, the desolate.
But let me not join in the prophet’s song
To criticize the Rabbanite for wrong.
I too cherish the ardent wish that made
Them write that book and put it on parade,
That is, to know and do Your will in all,
Even in those things missing in Your call.
Let me, Beloved, escape my own desire
To serve and love You with my heart on
fire
To flee to Your heart and there sink as one
With You who spread me out under the
sun.

8 For so says YHWH of hosts who sent
 Me after the glory *unspent*
 To the nations that have spoiled you,
 "For he who lays a hand on you
 Touches the apple of His eye.
 9 "For indeed I will shake My hand
 Over them and they'll be a *band*
 Of prey to those who served their way,"
 And you shall know that YHWH of hosts
 Has sent me *to speak in your coasts*.
 10 "Rejoice and be glad, Zion's child,
 For indeed I come *reconciled*
 To live among you," has said YHWH.
 11 And many Gentiles in that day
 Shall flee to YHWH *for refuge sway*
 And live among you, and you'll know
 The Lord of Hosts has *not been slow*
 To send me to you *on the go*.
 12 And YHWH shall inherit His part
 Of Judah in the holy *mart*
 To choose Jerusalem again.
 13 Be silent, then, all flesh of men
 Before YHWH, for He has come out
 Of His holy dwelling *with shout*."

My ancestry of Hittite rushed upon
 Your call and woke up early with the dawn
 To find You living in the sacred tent
 Of cedar and stone on Zion's ascent.
 Who knows but that the one who graved
 the stone
 With Decalogue and left it with the bone
 Of Hopewell and Adena native's plot.
 My grandmothers would fill a boiling pot.
 Beloved, whether I come to claim as heir
 Jerusalem's heritage, do not spare
 Me of Your word. In silence I repare
 Before Your throne, and turn both east and
 west
 To find Your dwelling in valley and crest
 Of Zion. Beloved, let me too be blessed.

Zechariah 3

1 He showed me Joshua the high
 Priest standing before angel nigh
 Of YHWH, and Satan standing there
 At his right hand to resist share.
 2 And YHWH said to Satan, "May YHWH
 Rebuke you, Satan, even YHWH
 That's chosen Jerusalem now
 Rebuke you; is this not somehow

A brand plucked out of the fire now?"

I translate the word Satan, but I think
 That adversary or accuser's link
 Might be a better choice. And yet I know
 That Persian thoughts of the Satanic show
 Might well have had effects on Zechariah,
 Who caught the spirit of the age in fire.
 The very adversary that came by
 Ahura Mazda to unshaped the sky
 Stands before priest and son of Aaron now
 To brings excitement in the show
 somehow.
 Beloved, whether this satan was a man
 Or being supernatural by plan,
 I do eschew what he's about to do,
 And pity Joshua before the view.

3 And Joshua was decked in clothes
 Of filth and where the angel rose.
 4 The angel quoted and spoke to
 Those standing round and in his crew,
 And said "Now take away the clothes
 Of filth from him." And to him chose
 To say "See I've made pass away
 Iniquity and I will deck
 You with a change up *to your neck*."
 5 And I said "Let them set a fair
 Mitre upon his head to wear."
 So they set a fair mitre there,
 And clothed him with garments to wear.
 And the angel of YHWH stood there.
 6 The messenger of YHWH spoke up
 To Joshua protesting tup,
 Saying: 7 "So says YHWH of hosts, 'If
 You will walk in My counsels stiff,
 And if you'll keep My charge, then you
 Shall also judge My house in view,
 And also shall keep My courts, and
 I'll give you here a place to stand.

Equating clean clothes with moral
 exactness
 Is ancient Persian too matter-of-factness.
 It's still done by that chosen race with
 grace
 To overwork ablutions of the face
 And hand and rub the feet before the score
 Of prayer in such prostration at the door.
 One's tempted to say Persians at the time
 Invented Judaism for a rhyme
 Against Samaritans to make in proof

Divide and rule the better sort of roof.
Beloved, I too perform ablutions here,
And walk around the Kaaba with my gear,
While pick-pockets relieve companions
near
Of money while attention runs aloof.

8 "Hear now, O Joshua, high priest,
You and your fellows here increased
Who sit with you; that they are men
To be wondered at; see, again
I'll bring out My servant, a shoot.
9 "For the stone that I've laid before
Joshua; upon one stone's root
There thrall be seven eyes to boot:
See I'll engrave the graving's score,'
Says YHWH of hosts, 'and I'll remove
Iniquity from that land's groove
In one day, *and so My love prove.*
10 "In that day,' says YHWH of hosts,
'you
Shall each one call his neighbour to
The vine under the fig tree too.'"

The word for eye is not too clear to me,
Although it's quoted with the horns to see
By John the Revelator. It can be
The word means mesh or colour or at last
A spring or fountain on the way to blast.
A stone of seven colours suits the way
I'd like to see the thing in light of day:
The first stone of the temple new to sway.
The stone of seven fountains comes along
After the stones of Moses where the wrong
Replied to right and left the man to die.
The seven springs of stone unstruck to fly
And also stone unspoken to, tells why
The living waters flow beneath the sky.

Zechariah 4

1 The angel that talked with me came
Again and waked me just the same
As a man's wakened from his sleep.
2 He asked me, "Do you see a flame?"
And I said "I have looked in deep,
And there's a candlestick of gold
With a bowl on top of it told,
And its lamps seven from the cold,
And seven tubes to seven lights
That are upon the top for sights.
3 "And there are two olive trees there,
One on the right of the bowl's share,

The other on the left to bear."
4 I spoke with the messenger there
Who talked with me and asked to share:
"What are these, sir?" 5 The messenger
That talked with me replied to stir,
"Don't you know what these are for sure?"
And I replied, saying "No sir."
6 Then he answered and spoke to me,
Saying "This is YHWH's word *to see*
To Zerubbabel, and to say
'Not by might nor by power to sway,
But by My spirit,' so says YHWH
Of hosts." 7 Who are you, great mountain
Before Zerubbabel a plain?
He shall bring out the corner stone
With shoutings of "Grace, grace alone."
8 And there was a word of YHWH then
Addressed to me and once again.
9 "The hands of Zerubbabel laid
Foundation of this house arcade,
His hand shall also finish it;
So you will know that YHWH of hosts
Has sent me to inform your toasts.
10 "Who has despised time of small things?
They shall rejoice and see what brings
The plummet in the hand by seven
Beside Zerubbabel; from heaven
They are the eyes of YHWH, which run
Throughout the whole world paragon."

The horses and all things in sevens are seen
As eyes divine that run through the whole
green
Earth to see how soon temples can be built
With seven or eight on a working tilt.
Not by the might or power of men shall be
All things set right throughout eternity,
But by the spirit of YHWH come to see.
Beloved, Zerubbabel, and what a name!
It sounds like woollen sole of Bel in flame.
Well let the man and not the name rebuild
The sanctuary with Your spirit filled.
And I shall find its pattern in the gloom
Of sky and earth before I meet my doom,
Before I come into the golden room.

11 And I answered and said to him,
"What are these two olive trees trim
On the right side of candlestick
And on its left too just as thick?"
12 And I replied again and said
To him, "What are these two outspread

Olive branches which through the two
Golden pipes empty golden hue
Out of themselves?" 13 And he replied
To me and said "Don't you divide?"
And I said "No sir, please confide."
14 And he said "These are the two sons
Of oil who stand before the bums
Ruling the whole earth, all beside."

Zechariah 5

1 Then I turned to lift up my eyes,
And looked and saw upon the skies
A flying roll. 2 And he asked me,
"What is it now that you can see?"
And I replied, "Flying roll;
The length is twenty arm lengths' toll,
The width is ten arm lengths in fee."
3 Then he said to me, "This curse goes
Over all the face of earth's rows;
For every one that steals shall be
Cut off this side accordingly,
And every one that swears shall be
Cut off that side accordingly.
4 "I'll bring it out," says YHWH of hosts,
"And it shall enter in the coasts
Of the thief and into the house
Of him who swears falsely to grouse;
And it shall stay there in the middle
Of his house and consume and riddle
Its timbers and its stones in fee."

The flying roll, one Pentecostal said
To me, is television on the spread.
I somehow doubted where his meaning led.
And yet I cannot find a word among
The four here that the prophet's strung
That does not apply to the flying tongue
And the electronical sort of lung.
No doubt, Beloved, Your word had better
sense

In centuries past in Bedouin tents,
But that does not mean that the fickle mind
Of man may not find messages behind
To prop up every quaintness of belief
And bring the ragged soul sweeter relief.
So let it be the television's feoff.

5 Then the angel that talked with me
Went out and said once more to me,
"Lift up your eyes, what do you see?"
6 And I said "What is it?" and he
Replied, "This is an ephah free

That goes about." And so said he,
It like this throughout all the earth.
7 See there was lift a talent's worth
Of lead; and this is she that sits
In the middle of ephah's pits."
8 And he said "This is wickedness."
And he threw it in the address
Of the ephah; and he cast in
The weight of lead upon its bin.
9 And I lifted up my eyes and
Looked and see there came out in band
Two women with wind in their wings;
For they had wings like a stork's things;
And they lifted the ephah up
Between the earth and sky *like cup*.
10 Then I said to the angel that
Talked with me, "Where do these off pat
Take the ephah *out of the flat*?"
11 And he said to me, "To build it
A house in land of Shinar's kit;
And it shall be established there
And set on her own base to wear."

How many women build a house to rise
In Shinar between the earth and the skies?
The visions of the roll and ephah are
Really but one warning against the car
Of Israel, that, though peace may abound,
And restoration on the lovely ground,
That disobedience to Your law brings
Always the curse of Shinar in its wings.
Beloved, though I have been forgiven,
restored,

Let me not rest on laurels of the Lord,
But faithfully live in the light of law
Instead of by the human word of claw.
Then I shall fly not by the roll or by
The ephah flying under Shinar's sky.

Zechariah 6

1 And I turned to lift up my eyes
And looked and saw there by surprise
Four chariots from between two hills;
And the hills were of brazen fills.
2 At the first chariot horses red;
And at the second black ones led;
3 And at the third white horses fed,
While at the fourth chariot there stay
Grizzled horses as well as bay.
4 Then I replied and I said to
The messenger that spoke the true
To me, "What are these sir, pray tell?"

5 And the angel answered a spell
 And said to me, "These are the four
 Spirits of the sky which go out
 From standing on the earth before
 The ruler of all *on the shore*."
 6 The black horses there go out to
 The north country, the white in view
 Go after them; the grizzled go
 Towards the south country *and slow*.
 7 And the bay went out, tried to go
 To walk through the earth to and fro;
 And he said "Go away from here
 And walk through the earth far and near."
 So they walked to and fro from berth
 To go walking through all the earth.
 8 Then he shouted and said to me,
 "See those that go to north country
 Have calmed my spirit in northland."

The vision of four-coloured horses here
 Reveals the meaning of those to appear
 To John in Revelation: they are those
 Celestial messengers that once arose
 To take the warning message to its close
 In every land and way upon the earth.
 The word goes out indeed with pain and
 mirth,

With every facet of the law and grace
 Preparing tribes and nations, every race,
 To gather in judgement before Your face.
 Beloved, I see the horses running still:
 It is not something lost upon the hill.
 I hear the messages and with a thrill
 I lay hold on the hope come to fulfil.

9 And the word of YHWH came to me,
 Saying 10 "Take of captivity,
 Of Heldai, of Tabijah, and
 Of Jedaiah, which come to stand
 From Babylon, and come that day
 And go into the house to stay
 With Josiah son of one called
 Zephaniah *by honed and halled*.
 11 "Then take silver and gold, make crown,
 And set them on the head renown
 Of Joshua Josedech's son
 The high priest when all's said and done.
 12 "And speak to him, say 'So says YHWH
 Of hosts, saying "See the man who
 Is called the Sprout; and he shall grow
 Up out of his place, not be slow
 To build the temple of YHWH's *show*."

13 "He'll even build temple of YHWH;
 And he shall bear the glory too,
 And shall sit and rule on his throne;
 And he shall be priest all alone;
 And counsel of peace shall intone
 Between them both *without a bone*.
 14 "The crowns shall be for Helem and
 For Tobijah, as well as stand
 On Jedaiah, and for the son
 Of Zephaniah, Hen undone
 For a memorial there in
 The temple of YHWH *without sin*.
 15 "Those far off shall come here to build
 The temple of YHWH glory-filled,
 And you shall know that YHWH of hosts
 Has sent me to you in your coasts.
 And this shall happen if you will
 Diligently obey the will
 Of YHWH who's your Alohim still."'''

Joshua the high priest is chosen now,
 The namesake of poor Jesus and whose
 brow
 Was cut by thorns. I hear the word go out
 As though the great and messianic clout
 Had come at last and never should there be
 More any curse upon terrestrial lee.
 It's always the same here, Beloved, I see
 The border of the reign of justice rise
 And always recede before cloudy skies.
 Mirage upon the desert, nothing more
 Is prophecy of good things in Your store.
 Unless a man grasp now and taste the good
 He has no hope before him in the wood,
 But only and for ever choice as should.

Zechariah 7

1 Now in the fourth year of the King
 Darius it happened a thing
That the word of YHWH came in ear
 Of Zechariah not to fear,
 On the fourth day of the month nine,
 Called Chislev by the people fine,
 2 When *they* sent Sherezzer, with him
 Regem-Melech and his men grim,
To house of Alohim, to pray
 Before YHWH, 3 *and* to ask the way
 Of the priests who *were* in the house
 Of YHWH of hosts, and not to grouse
 The prophets, saying, "Should I weep
 In the fifth month and a fast keep
 As I have done for so many years?"

4 And word of YHWH of hosts appears
 To me, saying, 5 “Tell all the folk
 Of the land and the priests a stroke:
 ‘When you fasted and mourned a bit
 In the fifth and seventh *months fit*
 During those seventy years, did you
 Really fast for Me, for My views?
 6 “And when you eat and when you drink,
 Do you not eat and drink *for meet*
Of yourselves? 7 “*Should you not have*
done

The words which YHWH proclaimed and
 spun
 Through the earlier prophets when
 Jerusalem and the towns then
 Around it were inhabited
 And prosperous, and the south bid
 And lowlands were inhabited?”

St Paul quoted the proverb in his day,
 Whether to eat and drink or go astray,
 Or do all for the glory of the Lord.
 I eat and drink but fail to raise the sword.
 As I take in the eating in my due,
 And drinking of both water and the dew,
 Let me not follow St Paul in the view
 That all the prophets said in past days now
 Has been rescinded by each holy brow.
 Nor let me blame St. Paul for all the craft
 Of following the heathen sort of graft,
 And using and abusing prophecy
 To excuse disobedience in spree.
 Then I shall find my hope and health fall
 free.

8 The word of YHWH to Zechariah said,
 9 “So says YHWH of hosts: ‘Execute
 True justice, show mercy *to boot*
 And compassion, everyone led
 To his brother. 10 Do not oppress
 The widow or the fatherless,
 The alien or yet the poor.
 Let none of you plan, *evil-doer*,
 Wickedness in his heart *at all*
 Against his brother *to make fall*.’
 11 “But they refused to heed, and shrugged
 Their shoulders, and stopped their ears and
 plugged
 So that they could not hear. 12 “Yes, they
 made
 Their hearts like flint, refused, gainsaid
 The law and the words YHWH of hosts

Had sent by His spirit *and boasts*
 Through the former prophets. So great
 Wrath came from YHWH of hosts *on state*.
 13 “Therefore it happened, just as He
 Proclaimed and they’d not hear *freely*,
 So they called and I would not listen,”
 Says YHWH of hosts. 14 “But I shall
 christen
 Them scattered with a whirlwind in
 All the nations where they’d not been.
 So the land became desolate
 After them, so that no one passed gate
 Or returned, for they made the land
 Of Muhammad desolate *land*. ”

The promise You made to Abram one night
 That his descendant would have the land’s
 right
 Was truly promise of the message bright
 To live the good life in Your loving sight.
 Rebellion against Your word sealed the fate
 Of those who would not follow to Your
 gate,
 But set their hearts like flint and so the land
 Was desolation like flint in their hand.
 Repentance for the violence and woe
 Is all it takes to make the bare field grow.
 The promise of Abram is resurrected
 In the prophet You finally selected.
 Let me return to that one promised land
 Which is obedience beneath Your hand.

Zechariah 8

1 Again the word of YHWH of hosts
 Came saying 2 So says YHWH of hosts,
 “I was jealous of Zion’s coasts
 With a great jealousy, and I
 Was jealous for her fury’s cry.”
 3 So says YHWH: “I’ve returned at last
 To Zion’s fortress and to cast
 My dwelling in Jerusalem;
 Jerusalem by stratagem
 Shall be called a city of truth;
 And the mountain of YHWH of hosts,
 A mountain *both holy and couth*. ”
 4 So says YHWH of hosts: “There shall yet
 Old men and old women come get
 To inhabit Jerusalem,
 Her streets, and every man in hem
 With his cane in his hand to let.
 5 “And the streets of the town shall be
 Full of boys and girls happily

Playing in the streets *where they met.*”

6 So says YHWH of hosts: “If it be
A marvel for the eyes to see
Of the remnant of this folk in
These days, should it also begin
A marvel in My sight?” says YHWH
Of hosts. 7 So says YHWH of hosts too:
“See, I will bring My people’s crew
From the east country, and from west.
8 “And I will bring them of the best
To inhabit Jerusalem:
And they shall be My folk and gem,
And I will be their Alohim
In truth and righteousness *to beam.*”

The streets of old Jerusalem are sweet
And shady in the narrow way they meet.
But they are not much crowded with the
feet
Of children playing there. The fine
prediction
Is not now fulfilled in the last eviction.
To north and west of wailing wall there
were
Some Arab children who used to infer
They had a place to play. But now the town
Is rather filled with tourist sort of gown,
And neither Jew nor Arab come to play
Hopscotch or twinkle-toes in garments gay.
But I trust that the prophecy is sound
And has been sometime fulfilled on the
ground,
Or else in future days will come around.

9 So says YHWH of hosts: “Let your hands
Be strong, you that hear in these stands
These words by prophets’ mouth the day
Foundations of the house of YHWH
Of hosts they came about to lay
So temple might be built as due.
18 “For before these days there was no
Hire for man nor for beast in show;
Neither any Shalom for him
Who went out or came in as dim
Because of the affliction’s rate;
For I set all men of each state
Against his neighbour to berate.
11 “But now I’ll not be to the rest
Of this folk as earlier zest,”
Says YHWH of hosts *of former nest.*
12 “For the seed shall be prosperous;
The vine shall give its fruit in muss,

The ground shall give its own increase,
The skies shall give their dew *on fleece;*
And I will cause the remnant of
This people to take all in glove.
13 “And it shall happen as you lay
A curse among the heathen way,
O house of Judah, Israel’s too,
So I will appear to save you,
And you shall be a blessing new;
Don’t be afraid, but let your hands
Be strong against *the waning bands.*”

14 For so says YHWH of hosts,
“I intended to afflict you,
When your ancestors rose in crew
To provoke Me to wrath,” says YHWH,
“And I did not turn from the true.”
15 “So now again I’ve thought these days
To do well to Jerusalem
And to the house of Judah’s gem;
Do not fear *but repent your ways.*
16 “These are the things that you will do;
Speak every man the truth in view
To his neighbour; and execute
The judgement of truth and recruit
Peace in your gates *and not the boot.*
17 “Let none of you keep in your heart
Evil imaginings apart
Against your neighbour; do not love
False oaths, for all these things above
I hate,” says YHWH, *and from the start.*

Peace in the gate could well abide if those
Who look for future building on the rows
Of temple mount might take a look again
And see a temple there built for all men.
Al-Aqsa and the dome of the rock stay
Open for prayer both in the night and day,
And those who wish to praise Your name
may come
And prostrate themselves while they gaily
hum.
Beloved, I washed my hands and face and
feet
In the fountain of ablutions’ retreat,
And peered into the sacred precincts where
The rock is visible for its own share,
And bowed between the red pillars that
make
Al-Aqsa beautiful and for Your sake.

18 And the word of YHWH of hosts came
To me, saying 19 So says YHWH’s claim

Of hosts: "The fast of the fourth and
The fast of the fifth month at hand,
And the fast of the seventh too,
And the fast of the tenth in view,
Shall be to house of Judah's crew
Both joy and gladness, and such feasts
Of good cheer, therefore love the feasts
Of truth and peace *as it is due.*"

20 So says YHWH of hosts: "there shall
come

A folk and city-dwellers rum:

21 "And the inhabitants of one
Town shall go elsewhere on the run,
Saying 'Let us go fast to pray
Before YHWH and seek YHWH today
Of hosts, I'll also go my way.'"

22 Indeed, many people and strong
Nations shall come to seek along
YHWH of hosts in Jerusalem,
And pray before YHWH *at His hem.*

23 So says YHWH of hosts: "In those days
Ten men shall take hold from the ways
Of all the languages of earth,
Take hold of the robe of one worth
Being a Jew, and say 'We'll go
With you, for we've heard in the show
That Alohims with you below.'"

In Babylon the people stopped to weep
And fast in four months of the year and
creep

Out of the dreary dwellings where they
wept

And blink in the false sunlight having slept.

They wept for fair Jerusalem in plight
Of ruin and its degradation's night.

But when the restoration came along
Those months of fasting turning into a
song.

No doubt fair Jesus, when he spoke aloud,
That his own did not fast among the crowd
As long as he was there, he meant that he
Was temple enough for the heathen spree.
Today I raise a temple of praise where
David's Psalms speak to me upon the air.

Zechariah 9

1 The burden of the word of YHWH
In the land of Hadrach's preview,
And Damascus and suburbs too;
When the eyes of a man as all
The tribes of Israel in the thrall

Of YHWH *shall lift up at the call.*

2 And Hamath too has borders there;
Tyre and Zidon in wisdom's share.

3 And Tyre built for herself a strong
Fort and heaped silver all along
As dust, and fine gold as the mire
Of the streets. 4 Behold then desire,
The Lord will cast her out, and He
Will strike her power upon the sea;
And she shall be devoured with fire.

5 Ashkelon will see it and fear;
Gaze also shall see appear
And be in grief, and Ekron too;
For her awaiting in shame's view;
And the king shall perish from Gaza,
And Ashkelon be empty praiser.

6 A bastard shall live in Ashdod,
And I'll cut off the pride from sod
Of Philistines. 7 And I will take
Away blood from his mouth in cake,
And his abominations from
Between his teeth; but from the scum
The one who's left shall be for God,
And he shall be a ruling prod
In Judah and a Jebusite
In Ekron *not put out of right.*

8 And I will camp around my house
Because of the army to grouse,
Because of those who will pass by,
And because of returner sly;
And no oppressor shall pass through
Them any more, for now in view
I have seen them with my own eye.

That's the point that I keep coming back to.
Beloved, we need a time now, not in view,
When there shall be no more oppression's
fear,

No more to take by force the fun and gear.
As long as Sabbath is just one day more
To bicker about on the dergah floor,
The law of jungle will appear to rule
Democracy and kingdoms where they
grew.

There may be oppression, and so there is,
Where Sabbath is acknowledge in the biz,
But there's freedom from the oppressor's
hand

Only where Sabbath is held in the land.
A concrete minder must come every week
To show the rights indelible we seek.

9 Rejoice greatly, daughter of Zion;
Shout, daughter of Jerusalem:
See, your king comes to you like lion;
He's just, salvation's in his hem;

He's lowly and rides on an ass,
And on the young foal of an ass.
10 I'll cut the chariot from Ephraim
And the horse from Jerusalem,
And the battle bow shall be broken,
And he shall speak Shalom in token
To the heathen, and his dominion
Shall be from sea to sea in pinion,
And from the river to the end
Of the earth, *everywhere a friend*.

11 As for you also, by the blood
Of your covenant set in bud
I've sent out your captives in all
From the dry pit *they've been in thrall*.

When Matthew wrote about Jesus he
thought

This passage proved his messianic plot,
If he could make him ride upon an ass
Or two in fact as a surprise to pass.
Truth is no messianic age of peace
Can be installed by two donkeys' release.
The donkey is protected by the law
Of Sabbath from the human sort of claw,
But even Rabbis never stop to think
That people too have rights upon the brink
Equal to those of donkeys where they stink.
That's why they would forbid the Sabbath
day

To all but Jews and such as in their sway.
They don't want to upset the status prey.

12 Turn you to the strong fort and be
Prisoners of your hope to see;
Even today I do declare
I'll render double to your share.

13 When I have bent Judah for me,
Filled the bow with Ephraim to see,
And raised up your sons, Zion free,
Against your sons, O Greece, to be,
And made you like a soldier's sword.

14 And YHWH shall appear over-scored,
And His arrows shall fly like flash
Of lightning; and Lord YHWH shall crash
With trumpet sound and shall go out
With the whirlwinds upon the south.

15 YHWH of hosts shall defend them, and
They shall devour subduing band

With sling stones; and they'll drink and
make

A noise as through wine and its sake;
And they shall be filled up like bowls,
As corners of the altar's tolls.

16 And YHWH their Alohims shall save
Them in that day as flocks to crave
Of His folk; for they'll be as stones
Of a crown lifted in signs' tones
Upon his land. 17 For how great's His
Goodness and how great beauty's His
The corn shall joy the young men's heart,
And new grape juice the maidens' start.

It's fine You preach of Your defending
hand

And how You save Your people in a band.
Fact is the next year the same raping claw
Comes looming up again and with éclat.
The true salvation's not that You might see
Your way to intervene upon the spree,
But that all men might understand that You
Are one God of all people in one crew.
The confrontation is inherent in
Perceiving we're all in a different bin.
One God, one boat contains who cannot
swim,

And we'll all dependent on bright and dim.
The joy will come when there's no wall
between

The Jew, the Christian and Islamic bean.

Zechariah 10

1 Ask of YHWH rain in the due time
Of the late rain; so YHWH makes climb
The bright clouds, and gives showers of
rain

To each herb of the field's domain.

2 For idols just speak vanity,
Divines see a lie and they flee
To false dreams to comfort in vain;
So they go their way like a flock,
Troubled without shepherd or stock.

3 My wrath rose against shepherds, I
Punished the goats, for YHWH of hosts
Descends upon His flock in coasts
Of Judah, and made them rely
As His fine horse at battle cry.

4 Out of him came the corner, out
Of him the nail, out of the rout
The battle bow, out of him all
Oppressors gathered *at the wall*.

The shepherds and the goats are live and well,
They are the ones who rule the church with spell

Of heathen Trinity and the goats are
The ones who bow before the gracious star
Of Queen of Heaven without a qualm or bar.

Let rise Your wrath, indeed, Beloved, and make

The shepherd and goatfoot in me forsake
The hope of life and enter in the pit
Of doom and destitution where I sit.
Leave in my heart none but the lowly fit
Who will obey Your commandments and so

Attain the love of life and heavenly glow.
Punish the goat in me and mine and bring
The shepherds out upon the fields to sing.

5 And they shall be like mighty men,
That tread down foes in mire again
Upon the streets in battle den;
And they shall fight, because that YHWH
Is with them and the riders too
On horses shall be amazed then.

6 And I will strengthen Judah's house,
And save Joseph's house *like a mouse*,
And I will bring them once again
To place them in My mercy's glen,
And they shall be as though I'd not
Cast them off; for I'm YHWH their God,
And will hear them *cry on the sod*.

7 And Ephraim shall be like one bold,
And their heart rejoice as through sold
Grape juice, indeed their children told
Shall see it and be glad *as gold*;
Their heart shall rejoice in YHWH's *fold*.

8 I'll whistle and summon them in,
For I have redeemed them *from sin*;
And they shall increase more and more.

9 And I will plant them in the score
Of peoples; and they shall mind Me
In every and in far country;
And they shall live with their offspring
And then return *to Me to sing*.

10 I'll bring them again also out
Of Egypt's land, and turn about
From Assyria; and I will bring
Them into Gilead's land and spring
Of Lebanon; till there's no room

Found to contain abundant bloom.

11 And he shall pass upon the sea
With his affliction and shall be
Upon the sea waves, all the deep
Of the streams shall dry up and seep;
The pride of Assyria shall be
Brought down and Egypt's sceptre flee.
12 And I will strengthen them in YHWH,
And they shall walk to and fro too
In His name, and so's spoken YHWH.

Redemption and the strengthening You
give

Come not from heathen sacrifice and sieve,
The fables that to slay an innocent
Beneath the gate will set city and tent
On a hill of success, the fables that
A god-man crucified brings in the fat.
You are redeemer and bringer of grace,
The strengthener of heart and hand and face
By Your name alone in this darkened place.
And so I look to Your name in my hope,
And in my weakness and my narrow scope,
And trust that name alone brings down the true,

The liberty to obey only You,
The melody at last I would dance to.

Zechariah 11

1 Open your doors, O Lebanon,
That fire may consume cedars won.

2 Howl, fir tree; for the cedar's cut;
The mighty are spoiled to the gut;
Howl, O you oaks of Bashan too;
The wood of vintage come to hew.

3 A voice of shepherds howling, for
Their glory's spoiled, a voice to roar
Among young lions; for Jordan's pride
Is spoiled *with nothing left to hide*.

The sound of howling and of horrid pain
Rises from throat of idolaters' wain,
The hollow images with golden crust
Before reality have turned to dust.
This hymn against the progress of the race
Rushing into a peace of fabric's lace
Instead of justice set upon Your law,
Including Sabbath, Your oneness, and straw

Of the non-violent in hand and claw,
Rejoices my heart above every trace
Of hopeful technology in this place.

Beloved, return and build avast and sure
Upon the shore a people right and pure
Who know and love and keep within Your
grace.

4 So says YHWH my Alohim: "Feed
The flock of the slaughter in need.
5 "Whose owners kill them without guilt
Upon their conscience; those who lilt
To sell them say 'Blessed now be YHWH;
For I am rich, and their own crew
Have no pity on them *in pew.*'

6 "For I'll pity no more those who
Inhabit the country," says YHWH;
"But see, I will deliver men
Each into his own neighbour's den,
And into the hand of his king;
And they shall strike the land and spring,
And out of their hand I'll not fling.

7 "And I will feed the flock to slay,
You, O poor of the flock in stray,
And I took to me two staves: one
I called Beauty, the other spun
I called Bands, and I fed the flock.
8 "Three shepherds I cut off in one
Month, and My soul loathed them when
done,

And their soul too hated my stock."

9 Then I said "I will not feed you;
Whoever dies, let him die too;
And the one to be cut off, let
It be cut off, and the rest met
Each one eat the flesh he can get.

10 "And I took my staff, Beauty, and
I cut it in two with my hand,
So I may break my covenant
Made with all the people *to rant.*

11 "And it was broken in that day;
And so the poor of the flock stray
That waited on me knew that it
Was the word of YHWH that had hit."

12 "And I said to them, 'If you think
It good, pay me My price and wink,
If not, forbear.' So they weighed clink
For my price thirty silvered twink."

13 And YHWH told me, "Just throw it out
To the potter: a good price stout
That I was priced by them about."

I took those thirty silver coins
And threw them to the potter's *loins*
In the house of YHWH *that adjoins.*

14 I cut in to my other staff,

Bands, to break the brotherhood in gaff
Between Judah and Israel's *chaff.*

The Gospel writer copied from this word
And made the story follow it though
blurred.

To do so is no proof at all to bring
Before the eyes of those who come to sing.
You break the three shepherds to take that
wit

As something in the ark to make them fit.
You break down Trinity and come at last
Replacing it with the One God and fast.
Beloved, I take hold of the Jesus man
And love him without help or hope to scan,
Not since some word of prophet in good
plan

May be applied to him, but because he
Upholds the ten commandments in the
spree,

And follows Your word always, faithfully.

15 And YHWH said to me, "Take to you
The vessels of the foolish crew
Of shepherds *here before My view.*

16 "See, I'll raise a shepherd here
In the land who shall not appear
To those cut off, neither shall seek
The young, nor heal the broken peak,
Nor feed the one that's standing still;
But he shall eat flesh of the fat,
And tear their claws in pieces flat.

17 "Woe to the shepherd of false gods
That leaves the flock stumbling on clods!
The sword shall be upon his arm,
And on his right eye to do harm;
His arm shall be clean dried up and
His right eye darkened in the land."

I take the chalice covered in fine gold,
The paten where they come in prayer to
hold

The divine biscuit that is human flesh,
And cast them out once more with curses
flesh.

I take the vessels that the folk adore
When held up by the priest upon the floor,
And break them and crush them and bring
them out

To mix with the water of those in rout.
Let Moses rage, let Pharaoh even doubt,

Let Aaron cringe, but keep my bright heart
 stout.
 Beloved, let temple vessels in my view
 Be nothing more than the words safe and
 true
 Of Your divine book, the one David drew,
 The Psalms where I rejoice as well as pout.

Zechariah 12

1 The burden of the word of YHWH
 Against Israel. And so says YHWH,
 Who stretches out the heavens' *view*,
 Lays the foundation of the earth,
 And forms man's spirit *from his birth*:
 2 "Indeed, I'll make Jerusalem
 A cup of drunkenness, condemn
 All the surrounding folk, when they
 Lay siege against Judah *in sway*
 And on Jerusalem *for pay*.
 3 "And it shall happen in that day
 That I will make Jerusalem
 A very heavy stone *in hem*
 For all nations, all who would heave
 Her away will *without reprieve*
 Surely be cut in pieces, though
 All nations of the earth shall show
 Against her. 4 "In that day," says YHWH,
 "I will strike every horse with *due*
 Astonishment, its rider too
 With madness, I'll open My eyes
 On the house of Judah *in guise*,
 And I will smite every horse of
 The nations with blindness *in glove*.
 5 "And the rulers of Judah shall
 Say in their *own heart's arsenal*,
 'The dwellers of Jerusalem
 Are my strength in YHWH of hosts' *gem*,
 Their God.' 6 "In that day I will make
 The rulers of Judah *in stake*
 Like a hearth burning to wood's *grief*,
 Like a torch of fire in a sheaf,
 They shall devour the folk around
 On right and left where they are found,
 But Jerusalem shall again
 Be inhabited by her men,
 In her own place, Jerusalem.
 7 "YHWH will save first Judah's tents
 then,
 So that the glory of the hearth
 Of David and the glory *swarth*
 Of the inhabitants *then found*
 In Jerusalem shall *unbound*

Not be greater than of the sound
 Of Judah. 8 "In that day YHWH will
 Defend the inhabitants *still*
 Of Jerusalem, the one who
 Is feeble then among their crew
 Shall be like David, and the room
 Of David like *place of God's doom*,
 Like YHWH's Angel before their *bloom*.

Who lay oppressed beneath affairs of State,
 Held necessary to empires of late,
 Are promised a return to house and home,
 And to a better thing from which they
 roam.

Who lay oppressed, whether for guilty stain
 Or merely for their innocence and pain,
 Receive the promise, ages once again,
 And still look out upon a world of men,
 In generations beyond golden law
 That shackles slaying arm and treading
 paw.

Beloved, I pray You, though I am the least
 That You will lead me into David's feast
 To share his arm and song before the beast
 Among a congregation and increased.

9 "It shall be in that day I
 Will seek to destroy *on the fly*
 All the nations that come *to fight*
 Against Jerusalem *in site*.

10 "And I will pour on David's house
 And on inhabitant *and spouse*
 Of Jerusalem spirit of
 Grace and supplication *in love*,
 And they will look for My *part* on
 The one whom they have pierced *and*
drawn.

They'll mourn for him as one mourns for
 His only *darling*, and grieve for
 Him as one grieves for a firstborn.

11 "In that day there shall be forlorn
 A mourning in Jerusalem,
 Like mourning at Hadad Rimmon
 In Megiddo's valley *at dawn*.

12 "And the land shall mourn, each family
 Alone: David's house's family
 Apart, and their wives *set* apart,
 The family of Nathan's part

By itself, and apart the spouse,
 13 "And family of Levi's house
 By itself, and their wives apart,
 Shimei's family set apart,

And their wives in their solitude,
14 "All the families that remain,
Every family by its feud,
And their wives lonely without gain.

Let me not see, Beloved, the horrid world
With warring banners flying and unfurled
To count the dead by weight and numbers
strong,

Let me not see the suffering of the throng.
I would not join You, my Beloved, to share
The agony and anguish of Your care
Who see the wanton destruction of life
That seemed essential to the good of strife
When men went out to war. Beloved, I
show

My face to a small part of gore and grow
Faint with my weeping that a child is found
Pierced through and bleeding, fastened to
the ground.

Beloved, I cling to Your word once made
law,
Do not kill anyone with tooth or claw.

Zechariah 13

1 In that day there shall be a spring
Opened to David's house and wing
Of dwellers in Jerusalem
For sin and for uncleanness' hem.

2 "And it shall come to pass that day,"
Says YHWH of hosts, "I'll cut in sway
The names off that their idols bray
Out of the land, and they no more
Shall be remembered in their score;
And I will also cause to go
Out of the land the unclean show
Of spirit and prophets below.

3 "And it shall happen when any
Shall yet prophesy *for a fee*,
Then his dad and mum who bore him
Shall say to him without a whim,
'You shall not live, for you speak lies
In YHWH name;' and upon his cries
His dad and mum who bore him too
When he predicts will thrust him through.

4 "And it shall come to pass that day,
Prophets shall be ashamed to say
Each one his vision when predicted;
Neither shall they wear when convicted
The rough clothes to deceive *the prey*.

5 "And he shall say 'I am no prophet,
I'm just a farmer, none to scoff at;

For I've been taught from my youth up
To keep cattle, *both sheep and tup*.'

6 "And someone will say to him then,
'What are these marks in your hands' ken?'
Then he shall answer and reply,
'I got hurt in my friends' house, why?'"

Since my David, my sweet, my lovely one,
With ruddy cheeks and shining like the sun,
Went to the shade and left the kingdom
won

In hand of his spawn, first to Solomon,
Oppression has ruled all the world for fun.
I'm waiting, my Beloved, and for that day
When David shall stand once more in the
sway,

And David's kingdom, David's seat again
Shall rule among the remnants of Your
men.

The marks upon the hands, indeed, they're
cast

As Jesus' marks upon the torture mast.
But nothing can atone for now or past.

7 "Awake, O sword, against my shepherd,
Against the man my fellow leopard,"
Says YHWH of hosts; "and strike the
shepherd,

And the sheep shall be scattered, and
I'll turn my hand on little band.

8 "And it shall happen in the land,"
Says YHWH, "two parts cut off to stand
Shall die, but the third shall be left.

9 "And I will bring the third bereft
Through fire and will refine them still
As silver is refined to fill,
And will try them as gold is tried;
They shall call on My name relied,
And I will hear them; I will say
'It is My people' and they'll say
'YHWH is my Alohim today.'"

Though Judaism is a faith long past
Its prime with sinful glittering avast,
And Christianity was fallen from
The day that Constantine took it for rum,
If You mean that Islam is third and great,
Let me tell You how fast they fell from
state.

While those who wept washed then the
body of

The dead prophet, the others, hand in glove,
 Voted their own apostasy in shove,
 The fastest of apostasies on earth
 From its beginning to the final berth.
 So try Your people if You must, but bring
 The Ummah from the desert in to sing,
 And give them once more David as a king.

Zechariah 14

1 "See a day comes to YHWH and it
 Divides your spoil to make you fit.
 2 "For I'll gather all nations down
 Against Jerusalem in town
 To battle, and the city fall
 And houses rifled to the wall,
 And women ravished, half the town
 Shall go into the captive frown,
 And those left of the folk shall not
 Be cut off from the city plot."
 3 Then YHWH shall go out and shall fight
 Against those nations, as in sight
 When He fought in the battle light.
 4 And His feet shall stand in that day
 Upon the mount of Olives way,
 Which is before Jerusalem
 On the east and mount Olives' hem
 Shall split down the middle toward
 The east and toward the west in hoard,
 And there shall be a very great
 Valley; and half the mountain's state
 Shall remove to the north and half
 Of it toward the south *in staff*.
 5 And you'll flee to the mountains' vale;
 For mountains' valleys shall prevail
 To reach up to Azal; indeed,
 You'll flee, just as you in your need
 Fled from the earthquake in the days
 Of Uzziah king of the ways
 Of Judah; YHWH my Alohim
 Shall come, all the saints with your beam.
 6 And it shall happen on that day,
 The light shall not be clear nor stray:
 7 But it shall be one day that's known
 To YHWH, not day or night alone;
 But it shall come to pass at eve
 It shall be light *as for reprieve*.

It's not so much Assyrian on the run
 That ravishes the women just for fun.
 The heathen doctrine caught in Christian
 dress

Now ravishes the mind in its duress,
 And bows the body lower to confess
 That Baal and Ashtoreth are here to stay,
 The ones to whom every people must pray.
 I flee indeed to mountain pass and find
 The spires and domes of fainter gods still
 bind
 And ravish all the folk that they make
 blind.
 The dark day is repeated with the sight,
 The secular as well as priestly might
 Across the graves and squares in their
 delight
 Is cast for substance, though a bitter rind.

8 And it shall come to pass that day
 That living streams of waters' sway
 Out from Jerusalem to run;
 Half of them toward the former spun
 Sea, and half of the to the back;
 In summer and in winter's track.
 9 And YHWH shall be king of the earth;
 In that day shall be one of worth
 YHWH and His name be one, *no lack*.
 10 All the land shall be turned a plain
 From Geba to Rimmon *in skein*,
 South of Jerusalem; and it
 Shall be lifted up and be fit
 For habitation in her place,
 From Benjamin's gate to the trace
 Of the first gate, to corner share,
 From tower of Hananeel there
 As far as the king's winepress there.
 11 And men shall dwell in it, and there
 Shall be no more destruction's share;
 Jerusalem shall be safe lair.
 12 And this shall be the plague by which
 YHWH will strike all the folk in pitch
 That have fought Jerusalem's ditch;
 Their flesh shall consume away while
 They stand upon their feet in guile,
 And their eyes shall consume away
 In their holes, and their tongue in prey
 Consume away in their mouth's clay.
 13 And it shall come to pass that day,
 A great noise from YHWH shall bear sway;
 And they shall lay hold every one
 On the hand of his neighbour won,
 And his hand shall rise up to strike
 The hand of his neighbour with spike.
 14 Judah also shall come to fight
 Jerusalem; and wealth in sight

Of all the heathen round about
Shall be gather together stout
Gold and the silver, and fine clothes,
In great abundance *and for woes*.
15 And so shall be the plague of horse,
Of mule and camel and of course
Of donkey and of every beast
That shall be in these tents increased
As this plague *that shall be released*.

Shall You be king of earth, Beloved? If
You
Are as good a king as the one in view,
My David, my sweet David, good and true,
Then come, come sit upon the earthly
throne,
And I shall obey You and You alone.
But if You fail to life to the ideal
Attained by David against woe and weal,
Then out, Beloved, out and let David in
To deal with all injustices and sin.
I do not doubt Your goodness in the least,
That is established by the word increased
Of Your commandments. But You've yet
to show
That You can deal with evil in the row,
That You can better stand in David's glow.

16 And it shall happen, every one
That's left of all the nations spun
That came against Jerusalem
Shall even go up in the hem
From year to year to worship there
The King, YHWH of hosts and keep share
In feast of tabernacles care.
17 And it shall be, whoever will
Not come up of earth's clans to fill
Jerusalem and worship King,
YHWH of hosts, even on their wing
Shall be no rain *or anything*.
18 If clan of Egypt does not go
And does not come to meet the show
Without rain, there shall be a plague,
Whereby YHWH will strike heathen vague
Who do not come to keep the feast
Of tabernacles there at least.
19 This shall be Egypt's punishment,
And that of all nations once sent
That do not go up to the feast
Of tabernacles there increased.
20 In that day there'll be on the bells
Of horses Holy to YHWH spells;

And the pots in YHWH's house shall be
Like bowls before the altar wee.
21 Every pot in Jerusalem
And in Judah of holy gem
To YHWH of hosts; and all who give
Sacrifices shall come and live
To take them and seethe in them, and
In that day there shall come to stand
No more the Canaanite in boasts
In the temple of YHWH of hosts.

The temple is not brick and stone and
wood,
It is instead the crown that David should
Raise in the cantillation of Your praise.
The feast of tabernacles I would raise
Is not the gathering on doubtful days,
But the heart raised after the judgement
spent
In songs of David and Psalmodic tent.
Let Canaanite hymn fail, let rock and roll
That bides the churchly worship on the dole
Lie vacant and abhorred, while David's toll
Is resurrected from degraded pent.
Beloved, the sacrifices of Your songs
Lisped by the boy David against all wrongs
Again inspires and strengthens, so relent.

Malachi

The last book of the Hebrew Bible shows
That after all the plagues laid out in rows,
And after the captivity and yet
After the temple was rebuilt and set,
The truth is nothing changes in the way
The human hearts goes after evil sway.
The second temple brought the greatest
sound
Of glory music that's every been found,
The inspiration of the liturgy
Of power and justice without Trinity,
And still the folk fell into avarice,
And factions to seduce the Grecian bliss.
Today I stand upon the bickered brink
Of the same world writ large, is what I
think.

I mind the law of Moses that was spoken
On Sinai for eternity, not token
Of what a band of slaves and fugitives

Ought to do with their time while Moses
lives.
I mind the message of Elijah taught,
Not to bow down to Baalim when they're
sought
By priest and king and church. I mind the
threat
Of judgement on the earth that's not come
yet.
And in my minding, I read on to find
That he'll turn hearts of fathers to their
kind,
And children to their parents, so to keep
Commandment with its promise not to
sleep
A death too soon on earth. I see the way
That families are waiting for that day.

Malachi 1

1 The burden of the word of YHWH
To Israel by Malachi's *due*.
2 "I have loved you," says YHWH. "Yet
you
Say, 'In what way have You loved us?'
Esau's not Jacob's brother *buss*?"
Says YHWH. "Yet Jacob I've loved *better*,
3 But Esau I've hated, *abettor*,
And laid waste his mountains and his
Heirloom where desert jackal is."
4 Even though Edom has said, "We
Have been impoverished, but we
Will return and build desolate
Places," So says YHWH of hosts *great*,
"They may build, but I will throw down,
They shall be called a wicked frown,
And people against whom YHWH will
Always have indignation's ill.
5 Your eyes shall see, and you shall say,
'YHWH's great beyond Israel's sway.'

Destroy in me the cities and their walls,
The jackals and whatever spirit calls
To idol glories in the place of You.
I may be son of Jacob, Esau, true,
Or son of neither, yet I stop to pray
To You who are God of both earth and day.
I make no claim to Your love in my place,
I make no claim of worth before Your face.
Love whom You will, and bless the worthy
race,
While I bring no demand for curse or grace.
It is enough to feel both cold and heat,

It is enough to taste the sour and sweet.
It is enough I'm made to love Your way,
Though I can only twitch my tail and bray.

6 "A son honours *his* father, and
A servant *his* master's *command*.
If then I am the Father, Where
Is My honour? And if I *swear*
To be a Master, where *is* My
Reverence?" Says YHWH of hosts by
"You priests who despise My name. Yet
You say, 'How have we set
Your name in disgrace *and regret*?' "

Your revelation, my Beloved, is sent
In human words and lovely to prevent
The claim that humankind has not the
breath
To understand Your glories before death.
And yet the words, though human, cannot
fail
To make ambiguous the royal mail.
You are, Beloved, a Father, yet You take
No wife, nor son nor daughter in her wake.
You are, Beloved, a Master without whip,
Without an arm akimbo on your hip.
You are One without honour and unseen,
And without worldly reverence. Intervene
That I may not despise Your noble name,
Who call You Father, Master, just the
same.

7 "You offer filthy food upon
My altar and say 'What's the con,
And how have we polluted You?'
By that you mean table of YHWH
Is contemptible *from your pew*.
8 "If you give the blind for offering,
It that not just a wicked thing?
And if you offer lame and sick,
It that not still an evil trick?
Give it as gift to ruler's hand
And see if he'll be pleased to stand
And welcome you," says YHWH of hosts
Before your empty words and boasts.

I am the slaughtered lamb upon the floor,
The gallows swings, the throat is open
gore.
Do you accept as sacrifice today
The blind and lame and sick? I go astray
To offer you the only heart I know,

Though blind it is the whole of my
trousseau.

If I lay on Your altar a vain gift,
Know that it is my all I want to lift
To You, Beloved, not just the fine and
good,

Not just my gold, but also straw and wood.
Take up my bleeding self and cast it out,
Replace it with Your Self, and turn about.
I bring both good and evil to Your hand
And save not anything to reprimand.*

9 I ask you now, pray Alohim
To be gracious to us, I deem
This has been your fault. Will He make
Acceptance for your persons' sake?
So says YHWH of hosts *at your stake*.

10 "Who among you would shut the door
Without a reason in the store?
Neither do you kindle the light
On My altar with naught in sight.
So I have no pleasure in you,"
Says YHWH of hosts, "Neither will I
Accept an offering you set by.

11 For from the rising of the sun
Until its going down is won
My name for greatness and among
The Gentiles where it shall be sung
In every place and incense brought
In offering to My name unsought
And a pure offering, for My name
Among the heathen shall gain fame,"
Says YHWH of hosts *and without blame*.

I thank You that You deign to take the gift
Of Gentile Christians as they come to lift
Their incense cloud before iconograph,
And thank You if You do not stop to laugh.
I thank you that You bend to smell the
sweet

Perfume the Muslims place on hands and
feet

To prostrate in each mosque beneath a
dome.

I thank You that You hear the prayer at
home

Where I, outcast by Jew and Gentile, wait.

I thank You that You meet me at the gate.

But that the universe may become true
I pray that You accept also the Jew.

In one all humankind, in love or sin,

Breathe but Your name, Beloved, take us
all in.

12 "But you've profaned it when you say
YHWH's table is polluted way,
And its fruit and its meat agley.

13 "You also said 'See how it's boring'
And you've snuffed it out by ignoring,"
Says YHWH of hosts; "and you have
brought

Torn offerings and lame, sick and sot;
That's how you brought your gifts on cue.
Should I accept your hand?" says YHWH.

14 "And cursed is a deceiver, who
Has in his flock a male one too,
And vows and sacrifices it
Corrupted to the Lord as fit;
For I'm a great King here to sit,"
Says YHWH of hosts, "My name of dread
Is known among the heathen *led*."

Who says to say Your name in repetition
Is weariness of soul has the tuition
Of other forms of oral prophecy.
Too bored to say Allah for Trinity,
Or Huu instead of making sacrifice
Of bread and wine in cannibal device,
Too bored seeks music amplified beyond
The bounds of sanity. You don't respond.
I turn from Baal and Ashtoreth in fear,
Not of the throbbing rhythms that I hear,
But of the glories that come in Your name,
And blush that humans stir without a
shame.

I turn from loud illusion and its airs
To climb the shining and the tinkling stairs.

Malachi 2

1 "And now, O priests, here's your
command.

2 If you'll not hear and lay to hand,
To give glory to My name, then,"
Says YHWH of hosts, "I'll send again
A curse on you, and I will curse
Your blessing; indeed, I do worse
Already, since you do not pay
Attention to the things I say.

Beloved, there are times in the week when I
Remember to take Your name and comply,
And cantillate the Hebrew words on high,

Your word and name as the breaths
counterlie.

Beloved, there are times in the day when by
The confrontation of a choice I take
Obedience to You for my own sake,
And do the things You say when I'm
awake.

Beloved, You too have cantillation rare,
The things to take in blessing on the air
And those who take in curses when You
swear.

Take my name too, as I take Yours today,
And in remembrance let us whirl away,
And in remembrance let us go, not stay.

3 "See, I'll corrupt your seed and spread
Shit on your faces, excrements
On your solemn feasts and presents;
And you'll be taken from your tents.
4 "And you will know that I have sent
This commandment to you unbent,
That My pact might be with Levi,"
Says YHWH of hosts *beneath the sky*.

Beloved, I really hate the things You say.
Politically correct is not Your way.
Of course I understand that You are God,
And therefore are not bound upon the sod
By the same rules as I, both in my speech
And in the things I have a right to reach.
But still You ought to clean up Your foul
talk,

It's not a think to balk at or to squawk.
There are some sweet Christians who do
not hear
Beyond the crunch of swearing in the ear,
And might think You are rude and mal
élevé

When they hear You repeat the prophet's
pay.

Leave excremental features from Your
sermon,
And John and Jack and Jill will praise Your
vermin.

5 "My covenant was with him for
Life and for Islam's peace and more;
And I gave them to him for fear
By which he feared me, to appear
In reverence before My name.

6 "The law of truth was in his claim,
No wickedness was found for shame

In his lips; he walked with me in
Shalom and justice without sin
And did not turn many away
From iniquity and to stray.
7 "For the priest's lips keep knowledge,
and

They should seek the law at his hand;
For he's angel of YHWH of hosts.
8 "But you went out of the right coasts,
You've caused many to stumble at
The law; you've corrupted *the bat*
Of Levi's covenant like cat,"
Says YHWH of hosts *after all that*.

9 "That's why I also have made you
Contemptible and base in view
Of all people, according to
The way you have not kept My ways,
Choosing from the law for your praise."

Beloved, I love Your law and I repeat
Its sweet words in Hebrew in every meet
Place that I walk and whirl, both in the
street
And on the shaded paths beneath the trees
That hide my house from drunks and other
sleaze.

Beloved, I love Your law and I confess
Its melodies no matter how I dress,
And take its deep commandments and
relate
Each one to what I do as well as state.
For doing is the proof of pudding's taste,
And I wish to eat all and leave no waste.
And so I recite every word and touch
The act as well as singing with my crutch.
Beloved, I hear, recite and do in haste.

10 Have we not all one father here?
Has not one Alohims to steer
Created us? Why do we deal
In treachery and show the heel,
Profaning the pact that once made
Our ancestors the time they prayed?
11 Judah has dealt in treachery,
Abomination done in fee
In Israel, Jerusalem;
For Judah's profaned holy gem
Of YHWH, whom He loved, and went out
And married the daughter *in rout*
Of a strange god *and took in hem*.

Beloved, indeed I married one of tongue

Strange and unknown to me when I was young.

But she was not the daughter of strange god,

In fact our families were of one pod.

Her mother was apostle to the Lapps,

My great-grandfather, horse and buggy flaps

Full speed, went out each day to sell the same

Books to the people to warn of the flame.

Beloved, hardly could I find closer mate

And further from a strange god to relate,

And still today we hear the word and true

And follow in that worthy faith that You

In grace imparted to ancestors' heart:

The faith to do each day commandments' part.

12 YHWH will cut off the man to do

This, the master and scribe in crew,

Out of the tents of Jacob too,

And the one that offers a gift

To YHWH of hosts *with such a rift.*

13 And this you've done again to shed

Upon the altar of YHWH's dread

Tears, weeping crying out, that He

Does not regard your offering's fee,

Or take it with good will in hand.

14 Yet you say "Why?" Just because

YHWH

Has been a witness between you

And the wife of your youth to whom

You have been traitor, yet in bloom

She's your companion and the wife

Of your covenant *and your life.*

15 Did He not establish the one?

Still He has the rest of the gun

Upon His mind. And why just one?

So that He might seek out a seed

Of godliness instead of greed.

So take heed to your attitude,

And let no one deal with the brood

In treachery against the wife

Of his youth *or then meet the knife.*

16 For YHWH, the God of Israel,

Says he that hates dividing spell,

For one hides violence with cloak,

Says YHWH of hosts, so take heed's stroke

To your own attitude and not

To deal a traitor in the plot.

17 You make YHWH tired to hear your words.

And still you say "What harm in turds?"

When you say "Every one that makes

Evil in wickedness' mistakes

Is good in the sight of YHWH, and

He delights in them," or in band

"Where does God of judgement now stand?"

Beloved, no doubt You are tired of my speech,

The words that tumble constantly to preach

To You of Your own law as though a

peach.

If You are the spouse of the faithful few,

You ought to know the art of listening too.

The spouse repeats the same song every day,

And only love keep boredom from its ray.

Beloved, do not be tired to hear me pray

Each morning and each evening in the sway

Of ecstasies to see Your sun appear,

Astonished by the moon's visage as sheer

And silver with the lovely light of myth

Come true where You're enthroned by kin and kith.

Boredom is the bane of the insincere.

Malachi 3

1 "Indeed, I send My messenger,

And he'll prepare My way to stir.

And the Lord, whom you seek, will come

All of a sudden to the hum

Of His temple, the angel too

Of the covenant, in whom you

Delight, and he's coming," says YHWH

Of hosts. 2 "But who can stand the view

Of the day of His coming true?

And who can stand when He appears?

For He's like a refiner's fears

Of fire, and like washerman's soap.

3 "He'll sit as a refiner's hope

And tester of silver, he'll clean

The sons of Levi, purge their spleen

As gold and silver, that they may

Offer to YHWH an offering's sway

In righteousness *and justice' way.*

I guess there still are sons of Levi there,

The people name Cohen still hold that
 share,
 If all be not a myth and legend bare.
 But what is not is the fair temple wrought,
 Unless we take, as perhaps should, the lot
 Of the dome of the rock, the golden dome
 As temple for all people after Rome.
 Jesus they say stood on the very spot,
 And so did good Muhammad in the plot
 Of ecstasy, caught up to heaven to see
 The lion of the tribe of Judah wee.
 Whoever is the angel that was sent
 In name of covenant comes out to vent
 Perhaps, but the newsmen forget his bent.

4 "Then the offering of Judah and
 Jerusalem will come to stand
 As pleasant to YHWH, as in days
 Of old, in former years *of praise*.
 5 "And I will come near you to judge,
 I'll be a swift witness to budge
 Against the sorcerers, and more
 Against adulterers in store,
 Against perjurers, against those
 Who exploit wage earners, widows
 And orphans, also against those
 Who turn away an alien,
 Because they do not fear My den,"
 Says YHWH of hosts. 6 "For I *am* YHWH,
 I do not change, and that's why you
 Are not consumed, sons of Jacob.
 7 "Yet from days of your fathers' hub
 You've gone away from what I said,
 And have not kept statutes I led.
 Return to Me, and I'll return
 To you," Says YHWH of hosts *and true*.
 "But you said, 'In what way to do
 Shall we return?' 8 "Will a man rob
 Alohim? Yet you have robbed My cob!
 But you say, 'In what way have we
 Robbed You?' In tithes and offerings fee.

I'd like to know, Beloved, to whom we
 owe
 The tithes and offerings of the wheat we
 sow
 And in which year, and who can count and
 know?
 You can't pay tithes unless you farm the
 land,
 And not without a calendar in hand.

But land's not mine, nor is the count of
 years.
 The almanacs are all turned in arrears.
 So how can I rob You, Beloved, when You
 Do not reveal to me the days as true?
 I only know the Sabbath day unrent,
 And so I bring its offering as unspent,
 The double lamb upon the cringing sod,
 The double love of single soul to God,
 The life and hope of all that You have lent.

9 "You are cursed with a curse, for you
 Have robbed Me, this whole folk, of due.
 10 Bring all the tithes now then into
 The storehouse, that there may be bread
 I My house, and try Me as led,"
 Says YHWH of hosts, "If I will not
 Open for you the windows' slot
 Of heaven and pour you out such blessing
 That *there'll not be room* for assessing.
 11 "And I will rebuke the insect pest
 For your sakes, so he'll not invest
 Destroying the fruit of your ground,
 Nor shall the vine fail to bear sound
 Fruit for you in the field," Says YHWH
 Of hosts, 12 "And all nations too
 Will call you blessed, for you will be
 A land delightful," Says YHWH of
 Hosts. 13 "Your words have been without
 love
 To Me," Says YHWH, "And yet you say,
 'What have we spoken out of way?'
 14 You have said, 'It's useless to serve
 Alohim, what profit's to *swerve*
 And keep His ordinance, and toasts
 As mourners before YHWH of hosts?
 15 So now we call the proud ones blessed,
 For those who do wickedness best
 Are praised; those tempting God go free.'" 16 Those who feared YHWH spoke each to
 each,
 And YHWH listened and heard *their reach*,
 So a book of remembrance writ
 Before Him for those who would sit
 In fear of YHWH, recite His name.
 17 "They shall be Mine," says YHWH of
 hosts,
 "On the day that I lay my claim
 To My gems. And I'll spare them then
 As a man spares his son again
 Who serves him." 18 Then you shall again
 Distinguish between righteous men

And wicked, between one who serves
Alohim and the one that swerves.

Discrimination is not right, it seems,
To those politically correct, whose dreams
Require that all things in this world are
right
And equally so, but such souls in night
Who disagree. Beloved, You would discern
Between the ones who serve You, what
they earn,
And those who are politically correct.
And so You make Your way here to select
Among souls by their vision and behaviour.
Stay hidden or You will Yourself need
Saviour
From gendarmerie out to pick up the ones
Who make distinction between loyal sons
And bastard Sufis bent on gaining ground
By progress on and upward from Your
sound.

Malachi 4

1 “For indeed, the day’s coming *fast*,
Burning like an oven *to last*,
And all the proud, yea, all that do
Wickedness will be stubble’s *crew*.
And the day that comes shall consume
Them,” Says YHWH of hosts *to their*
doom,
“That will leave them nor root nor branch.
2 But to you My name fearing blanch
The Sun of righteousness shall rise
With healing in His wings *apprise*,
And you shall go out and grow fat
Like calves fed in the stalls *that sat*.
3 You shall tread down the wicked crew,
For they shall be ashes *in stew*
Under the soles of your feet *too*
On the day that *this thing* I do,”
Says YHWH of hosts *from where He’s at*.
4 “Remember the Law of Moses,
My servant, which I did not miss
Commanding him in Horeb’s *mount*
For all of Israel *to count*
Statutes and judgements. 5 Indeed, I
Will send you Elijah the by
That prophet before coming of
The great and dreadful day *above*
Of YHWH. 6 And he will turn the hearts
Of the fathers to children’s parts,
And the hearts of the children to

Their fathers, lest I come *with rue*
And smite the earth with a curse *due*.”

Remember law of Moses, so I do,
Beloved, in every sema read anew.
Remember law of Moses, and zekor
The statutes glowing in the signs before
The shimmering songs that David one time
sang.
I never hear them without rush and pang.
Remembering law of Moses, truly You
Dwell in the tents of Moses and the clang
Of cantillating on the Sabbath light.
Beloved, I come to You remembering
The law of Moses, and still come to sing
The Psalms of David, the Qur’an in swing,
The Gospel loves and joys in my looking.
In all remembering I find You bright.

So ends the Torah or Tawrat,
As well as Zabur or the plot
Of David’s Psalms and writings that
Support his reign. Two great truths show
From these two sacred books in row:
The Decalogue is the foundation
Of every sort of faith and nation,
And David is the king of time
Past as well as of future climb
If resurrection comes to set
Eternal kingdom, a sure bet.
Two more books support divine law
In Decalogue instead of claw,
And the same books repeat with awe
The prophecy that David’s reign
Is an eternal one as fane.
These are the books to which I turn
Now with ignited faith to burn
In heart with love, and not to spurn
Either the Gospel or Injl
Or the Qur’an upon its heel.
But those two books must both be read
To conform to the doctrine spread
In the Tanakh, or else they’re false,
Leading astray in dance and waltz.
Here ends the great Scripture, but I
Now turn to lesser ones to fly,
Such books as came to bring reform,
To take the hearer back from storm
Into the faith of Abraham,
The faith of Moses and the lamb,
The faith eternal of the King
David who rises still to sing

With those few who remain in ring
To cantillate the Psalms at last
Sabbath by Sabbath though outcast.